

Frankenstein

Mary Shelley · 1818

1831 revised edition (with the 1818 Preface)

TEACHER EDITION · CURRICULUM UNIT

Indiana 2023 edition (standards shown for this framework only)

30 chapter lessons plus 3 seminar day(s), a test day and an essay day: 36 class days of 90 minutes, 5 a week (block schedule), 8 weeks
Syllabus · 90-minute lesson plans · lecture scripts · vocabulary · quizzes with keys · writing prompts at eleven rigor levels · SAT-style items · whole-book test · essays

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Contents and unit overview

1. Unit overview and the 90-minute lesson
2. Syllabus (weekly pacing)
3. Lesson 1: introduction (author, context, reception, overview)
4. Lesson plans and lecture scripts (chapters 1–30), each with vocabulary, discussion questions, annotation focus, quiz and key, writing prompts and SAT-style items
5. Unit test (eleven rigor versions) with answer keys and scoring guides
6. Final paper
7. Essay assignments at eleven rigor levels

Edition: The reading text is Mary Shelley's revised 1831 edition (Standard Ebooks, from Project Gutenberg #42324), which also prints the 1818 Preface and the 1831 Introduction. In 1818 Elizabeth is Victor's cousin; in 1831 she is the orphaned daughter of a Milanese nobleman, adopted by Victor's mother. Chapter breaks also differ (e.g. around Chapter III). Cite this edition.

Content note for teachers: The novel includes suicide, the murder of a child, a wrongful execution and the murder of a bride; see the chapter notes and the safe-messaging script.

Grades: Grades 9–12 (also 7–8; scales to graduate via rigor levels). Excerpt-based support track: these novels are above the grades 6–8 text-complexity band, so Middle School prompts work from teacher-selected passages. **Weeks:** 8. **Class days:** 36 × 90 minutes (30 chapter lessons plus seminar, test and essay days).

Essential questions

- What does Frankenstein suggest about the costs of unchecked ambition?
- What does Frankenstein suggest about creation and responsibility?
- What does Frankenstein suggest about isolation and the need for companionship?
- What does Frankenstein suggest about nature versus nurture?
- What does Frankenstein suggest about the sublime power of nature?

Objectives

- Cite textual evidence to support analysis of what the text says explicitly and implicitly.
- Determine themes and analyze their development over the course of the novel.
- Analyze how characters, setting and point of view interact.
- Determine the meaning of words and phrases as they are used in the text.
- Write arguments to support claims with clear reasons and relevant evidence.

Standards: Indiana 2023

7.RC.2, 7.RC.3, 7.W.1, 9-10.RC.1, 9-10.RC.2, 9-10.RC.3, 9-10.RC.9, 9-10.RC.12, 9-10.W.1, 11-12.RC.1, 11-12.RC.3, 11-12.RC.4, 11-12.RC.11, 11-12.RC.13, 11-12.W.1

Indiana Academic Standards, English/Language Arts (2023), IDOE

Assessments: Daily chapter quizzes (auto-graded); Weekly writing prompt (rubric); Socratic seminars (scheduled days); Whole-book test (scheduled day); Final essay (scheduled day); College Sophomore and above write one essay of the five
Differentiation: Every prompt and quiz has eleven rigor levels (Middle School through Graduate / PhD); the app applies student override, then class standard, then the automatic level. Each prompt is tagged for Common Core, Indiana 2023, Dual Credit (Indiana College Core), AP and Cambridge where they apply.
Materials: Liber et Libri reader; Annotation journal; Chapter lecture slides or script

The 90-minute lesson

#	Segment	Mode	Minutes	Clock
1	Bell-ringer	You do	8	0–8
2	Vocabulary with etymology notes	I do	10	8–18
3	Background and context	I do	10	18–28
4	I do: modeled close reading	I do	12	28–40
5	We do: guided annotation	We do	15	40–55
6	You do: independent annotation	You do	15	55–70
7	Discussion	We do	10	70–80
8	Exit ticket / chapter quiz	You do	7	80–87
9	Closure	I do	3	87–90
	Total		**90**	

Syllabus

Week	Chapters	Lessons	Focus and activities	Assessment
1	*Introduction: author, context and reception* Introduction Preface Letter I Letter II	5 × 90 min (450 min)	*the costs of unchecked ambition* • Daily 90-minute lesson: bell-ringer, vocabulary and word histories, background, I do / We do / You do, discussion, exit ticket, closure • Chapter quizzes in the app • Introduction: author, context and reception • Writing prompt at assigned rigor (one graded per week)	Quiz average plus one graded writing prompt
2	Letter III *Socratic seminar on the costs of unchecked ambition* Letter IV Chapter I Chapter II	5 × 90 min (450 min)	*creation and responsibility* • Daily 90-minute lesson: bell-ringer, vocabulary and word histories, background, I do / We do / You do, discussion, exit ticket, closure • Chapter quizzes in the app • Socratic seminar on the costs of unchecked ambition • Writing prompt at assigned rigor (one graded per week)	Quiz average plus one graded writing prompt
3	Chapter III Chapter IV Chapter V Chapter VI Chapter VII	5 × 90 min (450 min)	*isolation and the need for companionship* • Daily 90-minute lesson: bell-ringer, vocabulary and word histories, background, I do / We do / You do, discussion, exit ticket, closure • Chapter quizzes in the app • Writing prompt at assigned rigor (one graded per week)	Quiz average plus one graded writing prompt
4	Chapter VIII Chapter IX *Socratic seminar on creation and responsibility* Chapter X Chapter XI	5 × 90 min (450 min)	*nature versus nurture* • Daily 90-minute lesson: bell-ringer, vocabulary and word histories, background, I do / We do / You do, discussion, exit ticket, closure • Chapter quizzes in the app • Socratic seminar on creation and responsibility • Writing prompt at assigned rigor (one graded per week)	Quiz average plus one graded writing prompt
5	Chapter XII Chapter XIII Chapter XIV	5 × 90 min	*the sublime power of nature* • Daily 90-minute lesson: bell-ringer, vocabulary and word histories, background, I	Quiz average plus one graded writing prompt

	Chapter XV Chapter XVI	(450 min)	do / We do / You do, discussion, exit ticket, closure • Chapter quizzes in the app • Writing prompt at assigned rigor (one graded per week)	
6	Chapter XVII Chapter XVIII Chapter XIX *Socratic seminar on isolation and the need for companionship* Chapter XX	5 × 90 min (450 min)	*the costs of unchecked ambition* • Daily 90-minute lesson: bell-ringer, vocabulary and word histories, background, I do / We do / You do, discussion, exit ticket, closure • Chapter quizzes in the app • Socratic seminar on isolation and the need for companionship • Writing prompt at assigned rigor (one graded per week)	Quiz average plus one graded writing prompt
7	Chapter XXI Chapter XXII Chapter XXIII Chapter XXIV *Whole-book test (90 minutes)*	5 × 90 min (450 min)	*creation and responsibility* • Daily 90-minute lesson: bell-ringer, vocabulary and word histories, background, I do / We do / You do, discussion, exit ticket, closure • Chapter quizzes in the app • Whole-book test (90 minutes) • Writing prompt at assigned rigor (one graded per week)	Whole-book test and final essay
8	*Final essay workshop and submission*	1 × 90 min (90 min)	*isolation and the need for companionship* • Daily 90-minute lesson: bell-ringer, vocabulary and word histories, background, I do / We do / You do, discussion, exit ticket, closure • Chapter quizzes in the app • Final essay workshop and submission • Writing prompt at assigned rigor (one graded per week)	Whole-book test and final essay

Lesson plans and lecture scripts

Each chapter is one 90-minute class. Scripts are a starting point; adapt them to your students. Teacher summaries contain spoilers.

Lesson 1: Introduction to Frankenstein

Author biography

Mary Wollstonecraft Godwin was born in London on 30 August 1797, the daughter of two of the most famous radical writers of the 1790s: the philosopher William Godwin (author of Political Justice) and the feminist Mary Wollstonecraft (author of A Vindication of the Rights of Woman). Wollstonecraft died of puerperal fever about eleven days after the birth, so Mary grew up with her mother's books rather than her mother. In 1814, at sixteen, she left England with the married poet Percy Bysshe Shelley; they married in December 1816, weeks after his first wife's suicide. She began Frankenstein at eighteen and published it at twenty. Her adult life was marked by loss: three of her four children died young, and Percy drowned in Italy in July 1822. She supported herself and her surviving son by writing, produced novels including The Last Man (1826), edited Percy's poems, and died in London on 1 February 1851.

Historical and cultural context

The novel was born in the summer of 1816, the "year without a summer," when ash from the 1815 eruption of Mount Tambora in Indonesia chilled and darkened Europe. Mary, Percy, her stepsister Claire Clairmont, Lord Byron and Byron's physician John Polidori were kept indoors near Lake Geneva, and Byron proposed that each write a ghost story. The science in the air was electricity and life: Luigi Galvani had made dissected frogs' legs twitch with current, and in 1803 his nephew Giovanni Aldini publicly applied current to the corpse of an executed man in London. The book also belongs to Romanticism, a movement that prized feeling, nature and the solitary genius, and that was fascinated by Prometheus, the Titan who stole fire for humankind and was punished for it; the novel's subtitle is The Modern Prometheus. Behind it, too, is Mary's inheritance from her parents' arguments about education, injustice and how society makes people what they are.

Publication and reception, then and now

Frankenstein; or, The Modern Prometheus appeared anonymously in three volumes on 1 January 1818 (London: Lackington, Hughes, Harding, Mavor and Jones), in an edition of about 500 copies, with a preface by Percy Shelley and a dedication to William Godwin. A second edition (1823), arranged by Godwin, named Mary as author after a stage version, Richard Brinsley Peake's Presumption, became a hit. In 1831 she revised the text heavily for Colburn and Bentley's Standard Novels and added the Introduction that tells the story of its origin; that 1831 text is the one we read.

Then: Early reviews were split. Walter Scott, in Blackwood's Edinburgh Magazine (March 1818), praised its "original genius" and assumed Percy Shelley was the author; John Wilson Croker in the Quarterly Review called it "a tissue of horrible and disgusting absurdity." Many reviewers were uneasy with a story that seemed to question God and moral order, and with an anonymous author linked to Godwin's radicals.

Now: Today Frankenstein is one of the most taught novels in English. Brian Aldiss (Billion Year Spree, 1973) called it the origin of science fiction; feminist critics beginning with Ellen Moers (Literary Women, 1976) read it as a "birth myth" shaped by Mary's experience of pregnancy and infant death; others read it through politics,

race, disability and bioethics. Its title has become shorthand in debates about genetic engineering and artificial intelligence, and 2018 brought bicentenary editions and projects worldwide.

Overview (spoiler-free)

A ship's captain, Robert Walton, sailing toward the North Pole, writes letters to his sister. In the ice he rescues a dying stranger, Victor Frankenstein, who tells him how, as a young student, he discovered the secret of life and built a living being. What happens to Victor, his family and his creation is told in three nested voices: Walton's, Victor's and, at the center, the creature's own. The book asks what we owe the things we make and the people we reject.

Main themes

- creation and responsibility: what a maker owes what it makes; watch how often the creature asks to be cared for and how Victor answers.
- ambition and knowledge: the hunger to discover, shared by Walton and Victor; ask whether the book condemns curiosity or something more specific.
- isolation and companionship: almost every character is cut off from someone; notice who is allowed to belong and why.
- nature and nurture: is anyone born a monster, or are monsters made by how they are treated?
- the sublime: mountains, ice and storms that awe and dwarf human beings.

Why it matters

Frankenstein is the founding story for every argument about technology that outruns responsibility, from gene editing to artificial intelligence, and its creature still speaks for anyone judged by appearance before being heard. It also shows students that a teenager wrote one of the most influential books in the world.

Spoilers · teacher only

Victor abandons the creature the moment it wakes. Rejected by every human it meets, the creature kills Victor's brother William (and frames Justine, who is executed), demands a mate, and, when Victor destroys the half-made female, kills Clerval and then Elizabeth on her wedding night. Victor pursues the creature to the Arctic and dies on Walton's ship; the creature mourns him and vanishes into the dark to die.

Lesson plan (90 minutes)

> **0–8 min · Bell-ringer · You do (8 min)**
>
> *Before we open Frankenstein: Should scientists be allowed to do anything they are able to do? Write for five minutes and give an example.*
> **Prompt:** Before we open Frankenstein: Should scientists be allowed to do anything they are able to do? Write for five minutes and give an example.

8–18 min · Key terms · I do (10 min)

Romanticism (art valuing emotion, nature and the individual); the sublime (awe mixed with terror before vast nature); galvanism (electricity applied to living or dead tissue); Prometheus (the Titan who gave fire to humans); frame narrative (a story inside a story); epistolary (told in letters).

18–28 min · Mini-lecture: author, context, reception · I do (10 min)

About the author. Mary Wollstonecraft Godwin was born in London on 30 August 1797, the daughter of two of the most famous radical writers of the 1790s: the philosopher William Godwin (author of Political Justice) and the feminist Mary Wollstonecraft (author of A Vindication of the Rights of Woman). Wollstonecraft died of puerperal fever about eleven days after the birth, so Mary grew up with her mother's books rather than her mother. In 1814, at sixteen, she left England with the married poet Percy Bysshe Shelley; they married in December 1816, weeks after his first wife's suicide. She began Frankenstein at eighteen and published it at twenty. Her adult life was marked by loss: three of her four children died young, and Percy drowned in Italy in July 1822. She supported herself and her surviving son by writing, produced novels including The Last Man (1826), edited Percy's poems, and died in London on 1 February 1851. The world of the book. The novel was born in the summer of 1816, the "year without a summer," when ash from the 1815 eruption of Mount Tambora in Indonesia chilled and darkened Europe. Mary, Percy, her stepsister Claire Clairmont, Lord Byron and Byron's physician John Polidori were kept indoors near Lake Geneva, and Byron proposed that each write a ghost story. The science in the air was electricity and life: Luigi Galvani had made dissected frogs' legs twitch with current, and in 1803 his nephew Giovanni Aldini publicly applied current to the corpse of an executed man in London. The book also belongs to Romanticism, a movement that prized feeling, nature and the solitary genius, and that was fascinated by Prometheus, the Titan who stole fire for humankind and was punished for it; the novel's subtitle is The Modern Prometheus. Behind it, too, is Mary's inheritance from her parents' arguments about education, injustice and how society makes people what they are. Publication and reception. Frankenstein; or, The Modern Prometheus appeared anonymously in three volumes on 1 January 1818 (London: Lackington, Hughes, Harding, Mavor and Jones), in an edition of about 500 copies, with a preface by Percy Shelley and a dedication to William Godwin. A second edition (1823), arranged by Godwin, named Mary as author after a stage version, Richard Brinsley Peake's Presumption, became a hit. In 1831 she revised the text heavily for Colburn and Bentley's Standard Novels and added the Introduction that tells the story of its origin; that 1831 text is the one we read. Then: Early reviews were split. Walter Scott, in Blackwood's Edinburgh Magazine (March 1818), praised its "original genius" and assumed Percy Shelley was the author; John Wilson Croker in the Quarterly Review called it "a tissue of horrible and disgusting absurdity." Many reviewers were uneasy with a story that seemed to question God and moral order, and with an anonymous author linked to Godwin's radicals. Now: Today Frankenstein is one of the most taught novels in English. Brian Aldiss (Billion Year Spree, 1973) called it the origin of science fiction; feminist critics beginning with Ellen Moers (Literary Women, 1976) read it as a "birth myth" shaped by Mary's experience of pregnancy and infant death; others read it through politics, race, disability and bioethics. Its title has become shorthand in debates about genetic engineering and artificial intelligence, and 2018 brought bicentenary editions and projects worldwide.

28–40 min · I do: the book in one passage · I do (12 min)

"I saw the pale student of unhallowed arts kneeling beside the thing he had put together" (Introduction, paragraph 11). Shelley's 1831 account of the waking vision that became the novel. Note "unhallowed" (unholy) and "thing": before we have read a page, the creator is a student and the creation is not yet a person.

> *I saw the pale student of unhallowed arts kneeling beside the thing he had put together* *(Introduction, paragraph 11)*

Think-aloud: "I saw the pale student of unhallowed arts kneeling beside the thing he had put together" (Introduction, paragraph 11). Shelley's 1831 account of the waking vision that became the novel. Note "unhallowed" (unholy) and "thing": before we have read a page, the creator is a student and the creation is not yet a person.

40–55 min · We do: overview and themes · We do (15 min)

What the book is about (no spoilers): A ship's captain, Robert Walton, sailing toward the North Pole, writes letters to his sister. In the ice he rescues a dying stranger, Victor Frankenstein, who tells him how, as a young student, he discovered the secret of life and built a living being. What happens to Victor, his family and his creation is told in three nested voices: Walton's, Victor's and, at the center, the creature's own. The book asks what we owe the things we make and the people we reject. Themes to track: creation and responsibility: what a maker owes what it makes; watch how often the creature asks to be cared for and how Victor answers. ambition and knowledge: the hunger to discover, shared by Walton and Victor; ask whether the book condemns curiosity or something more specific. isolation and companionship: almost every character is cut off from someone; notice who is allowed to belong and why. nature and nurture: is anyone born a monster, or are monsters made by how they are treated? the sublime: mountains, ice and storms that awe and dwarf human beings.

55–70 min · You do: reading journal · You do (15 min)

Set up a reading journal: one page per theme with a prediction and a question. Theme page "creation and responsibility": Prediction: Victor will regret what he makes. Question: will he ever take care of it?
Task: Set up a reading journal for Frankenstein: one page per theme, each with a prediction and a question.
Exemplar: Theme page "creation and responsibility": Prediction: Victor will regret what he makes. Question: will he ever take care of it?

70–80 min · Discussion · We do (10 min)

Why does Frankenstein still matter? Frankenstein is the founding story for every argument about technology that outruns responsibility, from gene editing to artificial intelligence, and its creature still speaks for anyone judged by appearance before being heard. It also shows students that a teenager wrote one of the most influential books in the world.
Anchor question: Why might Frankenstein still be taught today?
Facilitation: Frankenstein is the founding story for every argument about technology that outruns responsibility, from gene editing to artificial intelligence, and its creature still speaks for anyone judged by appearance before being heard. It also shows students that a teenager wrote one of the most influential books in the world.

80–87 min · Exit ticket · You do (7 min)

Name one fact about Mary Shelley's life or the summer of 1816 that you expect to matter in the novel, and explain why. Answer: Examples: her mother died after giving birth to her (the novel is about a creator who abandons what he brings to life); the ghost-story contest (the book began as a tale of terror); galvanism (Victor's science echoes real experiments).
Exit ticket: Name one fact about Mary Shelley's life or the summer of 1816 that you expect to matter in the novel, and explain why.
Answer: Examples: her mother died after giving birth to her (the novel is about a creator who abandons what he brings to life); the ghost-story contest (the book began as a tale of terror); galvanism (Victor's science echoes real experiments).

87–90 min · Closure · I do (3 min)

Tomorrow we begin reading: Introduction.

Teacher notes · sources: Britannica, "Mary Wollstonecraft Shelley" (https://www.britannica.com/biography/Mary-Wollstonecraft-Shelley); Mary Shelley, Introduction to the 1831 edition (in this reading text); British Library, "Frankenstein: the 1818 first edition" (https://www.bl.uk/collection-items/frankenstein-first-edition); Walter Scott, review in Blackwood's Edinburgh Magazine 2 (March 1818); John Wilson Croker, Quarterly Review 18 (January 1818) (https://romantic-circles.org/reference/chronologies/mschronology/reviews.html); Brian Aldiss, Billion Year Spree (1973); Ellen Moers, Literary Women (1976) (https://www.worldcat.org/); Library of Congress/NEH Frankenstein bicentennial resources (https://www.neh.gov/humanities/2018/winter/feature/the-strange-and-twisted-life-frankenstein)

Flags (verify before teaching):

- The exact night of the ghost-story proposal and of Mary's waking dream is uncertain: her 1831 account compresses events, and Polidori's diary points to mid-June 1816. Present the 1831 story as her own later recollection.
- The extent of Percy Shelley's edits to the 1818 manuscript is debated (Charles E. Robinson's 2008 edition marks his contributions). He wrote the 1818 Preface; the novel is Mary's.
- The first-edition print run is usually given as about 500 copies; treat it as approximate.

Critical voice: “This is a novel, or more properly a romantic fiction, of a nature so peculiar, that we ought to describe the species before attempting any account of the individual production.” (Walter Scott (attrib.), novelist and critic, *"Remarks on Frankenstein, or the Modern Prometheus; A Novel," Blackwood's Edinburgh Magazine 2:12 (March 1818), p. 613 (opening sentence)*; public domain). Bell-ringer: Scott could not name the genre in 1818. What would you call it (Gothic, science fiction, philosophical romance)? Defend one label with a detail from the Introduction. *Objective:* Classify the novel's genre and explain how its structure (frame narrative, "marvellous" premise) shapes meaning. *Standards:* RL.11-12.5, 11-12.RC.3

Critical voice: “Our readers will guess from this summary, what a tissue of horrible and disgusting absurdity this work presents.” (John Wilson Croker, critic, *Review of Frankenstein, The Quarterly Review 18 (January 1818), 379-385, p. 382*; public domain). Pair with Scott's and Percy Shelley's praise: why did reviewers in 1818 split so sharply? Students sort the three reviews on a moral-vs-aesthetic axis. *Objective:* Trace the novel's reception at publication ("then") against its reputation today ("now"). *Standards:* RL.11-12.9, SL.11-12.1, 11-12.RC.4

Lesson 2: Introduction

Focus: the origin of the novel and the idea of creation

Objective: Students will analyze how point of view develops in “Introduction” by writing a claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph that cites at least 2 quotations from the section, and will score at least 80% on the section quiz.

Standards: CCSS RL.9-10.6, W.9-10.1, L.9-10.4 · IN 9-10.RC.1, 9-10.W.1, 9-10.RC.9, 9-10.RC.11

Teacher only · spoilers

Writing in 1831, Shelley explains how the novel began: a rainy summer near Geneva in 1816, a ghost-story contest with Byron and Percy Shelley, conversations about galvanism, and a waking vision of a 'pale student of unhallowed arts' kneeling beside the thing he had put together. She calls the book her 'hideous progeny.'

Background: The 1816 'year without a summer' followed the eruption of Mount Tambora. Galvani's experiments making frog legs twitch with electricity fed public speculation about reanimation.

Significance: The Introduction is one of the most famous origin stories in literature and frames the novel as both a dream and a deliberate artistic creation, mirroring Victor's own act of making.

Lesson plan and lecture script (90 minutes)

> **0–8 min · Bell-ringer · You do (8 min)**
> Students write to the bell-ringer, then pair-share.
> *Shelley calls her book her 'hideous progeny.' How does that phrase connect the author to Victor? Write for five minutes. Starters: I think... because... / This connects to creation and responsibility because....*
> **Prompt:** Shelley calls her book her 'hideous progeny.' How does that phrase connect the author to Victor?
> **Sentence starters:** I think… because… · This connects to creation and responsibility because…
> **Strong response:** A strong response takes a position and anticipates this: Shelley calls the book her "hideous progeny" and sends it out into the world, as Victor does his creature; but unlike Victor she wishes it to "prosper." The author models the care the character fails to give.

8–18 min · Vocabulary with etymology notes · I do (10 min)

Five key words in context, with verified word histories.

Today's words: platitude — dullness; a lack of freshness or originality; invocations — calls or appeals for help or inspiration; retrospection — looking back on the past; galvanism — electricity produced by chemical action, used in early experiments on muscles; beatings — beats; throbs (of the heart). "platitude": Borrowed from French platitude, from plat "flat". "invocations": From Middle English invocacioun, from Old French invocacion, from Latin invocatio, invocationem. Equivalent to invoke + -ation. "galvanism": Named after Luigi Galvani (1737–1798), the Bologna anatomist who made dead frogs' legs twitch with electric current; galvanism meant electricity produced by chemical action. "beatings": By surface analysis, beat + -ing.

Words: platitude: dullness; a lack of freshness or originality · invocations: calls or appeals for help or inspiration · retrospection: looking back on the past · galvanism: electricity produced by chemical action, used in early experiments on muscles · beatings: beats; throbs (of the heart)

18–28 min · Background and context · I do (10 min)

Mini-lecture (read or adapt the script).

The 1816 'year without a summer' followed the eruption of Mount Tambora. Galvani's experiments making frog legs twitch with electricity fed public speculation about reanimation. The Introduction is one of the most famous origin stories in literature and frames the novel as both a dream and a deliberate artistic creation, mirroring Victor's own act of making. Point of view: Shelley speaks in her own voice, thirteen years later, as an author looking back. She shapes a legend about herself: a shy young woman among famous poets who cannot think of a story until a vision comes. Ask students what she gains by presenting the book as a dream rather than a plan. Allusion: The Introduction is thick with real names (Byron, Percy Shelley, Dr. Darwin, galvanism). Each one ties the fiction to real science and real literary rivalry, which is why the story felt possible to its first readers. Imagery: The vision is told in sharp visual details: the kneeling student, the "hideous phantasm," the yellow, watery eyes. Students will meet these images again in Chapter V; flag them now. Watch for the dream: Dreams recur through the novel (Victor's nightmare after the creation). Here the dream is creative; later it becomes a punishment.

28–40 min · I do: modeled close reading · I do (12 min)
Model the close reading of the anchor quotation using the written think-aloud below.
I read the line once for meaning and once for craft. “I saw the pale student of unhallowed arts kneeling beside the thing he had put together” (Introduction, paragraph 11). "Unhallowed" means unholy, and "thing" refuses the creation a name. Students can use this to argue that the novel judges the act of creation as a transgression from its first image. That is point of view at work: Shelley speaks in her own voice, thirteen years later, as an author looking back. She shapes a legend about herself: a shy young woman among famous poets who cannot think of a story until a vision comes. Ask students what she gains by presenting the book as a dream rather than a plan.

> *I saw the pale student of unhallowed arts kneeling beside the thing he had put together* (Introduction, paragraph 11)

Think-aloud: I read the line once for meaning and once for craft. “I saw the pale student of unhallowed arts kneeling beside the thing he had put together” (Introduction, paragraph 11). "Unhallowed" means unholy, and "thing" refuses the creation a name. Students can use this to argue that the novel judges the act of creation as a transgression from its first image. That is point of view at work: Shelley speaks in her own voice, thirteen years later, as an author looking back. She shapes a legend about herself: a shy young woman among famous poets who cannot think of a story until a vision comes. Ask students what she gains by presenting the book as a dream rather than a plan.

40–55 min · We do: guided annotation · We do (15 min)
Guided analysis of a second quotation; expected answers given.
Ask: What words in this line stand out, and what do they suggest? Expected: "Hideous" admits the book is frightening; "progeny" (offspring) makes her its mother; "prosper" is a parent's blessing. Link: Victor makes a creature but never blesses it, so the line sets up the theme of responsibility. Ask: How does this line connect to creation and responsibility? Expected: Shelley calls the book her "hideous progeny" and sends it out into the world, as Victor does his creature; but unlike Victor she wishes it to "prosper." The author models the care the character fails to give. (Shelley presents herself as a parent of the book. Use this to connect author and character: both make something "hideous," but only one blesses it.)

> *And now, once again, I bid my hideous progeny go forth and prosper* (Introduction, paragraph 15)

Ask: What words in this line stand out, and what do they suggest?
Expected answer: "Hideous" admits the book is frightening; "progeny" (offspring) makes her its mother; "prosper" is a parent's blessing. Link: Victor makes a creature but never blesses it, so the line sets up the theme of responsibility.
Ask: How does this line connect to creation and responsibility?
Expected answer: Shelley calls the book her "hideous progeny" and sends it out into the world, as Victor does his creature; but unlike Victor she wishes it to "prosper." The author models the care the character fails to give. (Shelley presents herself as a parent of the book. Use this to connect author and character: both make something "hideous," but only one blesses it.)

55–70 min · You do: independent annotation · You do (15 min)

Independent annotation and a claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph (exemplar given).

Annotate the chapter for point of view, allusion (three marks with a margin note each), then write one claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph: what does this chapter suggest about the origin of the novel and the idea of creation? Then start your writing prompt at your assigned level (HS Sophomore: Analyze how Introduction develops the idea of the origin of the novel and the idea of creation. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of point of view and allusion shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.) Exemplar: Shelley frames her novel as a creation that, unlike Victor's, is accepted and sent out with care. When the text says "And now, once again, I bid my hideous progeny go forth and prosper" (Introduction, paragraph 15), it shows this directly. By calling the book her "hideous progeny" she uses the language of parenthood; wishing it to "prosper" is exactly the blessing the creature never receives, so the frame sets up the novel's test of what makers owe what they make.

Task: Annotate the chapter for point of view, allusion (three marks with a margin note each), then write one claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph: what does this chapter suggest about the origin of the novel and the idea of creation? Then start your writing prompt at your assigned level (HS Sophomore: Analyze how Introduction develops the idea of the origin of the novel and the idea of creation. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of point of view and allusion shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.)

Exemplar: Shelley frames her novel as a creation that, unlike Victor's, is accepted and sent out with care. When the text says "And now, once again, I bid my hideous progeny go forth and prosper" (Introduction, paragraph 15), it shows this directly. By calling the book her "hideous progeny" she uses the language of parenthood; wishing it to "prosper" is exactly the blessing the creature never receives, so the frame sets up the novel's test of what makers owe what they make.

70–80 min · Discussion · We do (10 min)

Structured discussion from the 30 tiered questions, with facilitation notes.

Anchor question: Shelley calls her book her 'hideous progeny.' How does that phrase connect the author to Victor? If students say the Introduction "is just background," ask why Shelley added it in 1831: how does knowing a nineteen-year-old dreamed this change how we read the book? Expect a split on whether the dream story is literally true. Use the teacher-notes flag: it is her later recollection, and that is itself a choice.

Anchor question: Shelley calls her book her 'hideous progeny.' How does that phrase connect the author to Victor?

Facilitation: If students say the Introduction "is just background," ask why Shelley added it in 1831: how does knowing a nineteen-year-old dreamed this change how we read the book? · Expect a split on whether the dream story is literally true. Use the teacher-notes flag: it is her later recollection, and that is itself a choice.

80–87 min · Exit ticket / chapter quiz · You do (7 min)
Chapter quiz in the app and an exit ticket (answer given).
Chapter quiz in the app, then: In one sentence, what does this chapter suggest about the origin of the novel and the idea of creation? Support it with one short quotation. Model answer: Shelley frames her novel as a creation that, unlike Victor's, is accepted and sent out with care. ("And now, once again, I bid my hideous progeny go forth and prosper", Introduction, paragraph 15). Accept any defensible claim backed by a quotation from the chapter; the answer key for the quiz is in the Quiz section.
Exit ticket: In one sentence, what does this chapter suggest about the origin of the novel and the idea of creation? Support it with one short quotation.
Answer: Model answer: Shelley frames her novel as a creation that, unlike Victor's, is accepted and sent out with care. ("And now, once again, I bid my hideous progeny go forth and prosper", Introduction, paragraph 15). Accept any defensible claim backed by a quotation from the chapter; the answer key for the quiz is in the Quiz section.

87–90 min · Closure · I do (3 min)
Summarize the lesson and preview the next reading.
Today we saw how point of view shapes the origin of the novel and the idea of creation. Key takeaway: Shelley calls the book her "hideous progeny" and sends it out into the world, as Victor does his creature; but unlike Victor she wishes it to "prosper." The author models the care the character fails to give.

Total: 90 minutes.

Teacher analysis (spoilers)

Literary elements

- **Point of view:** Shelley speaks in her own voice, thirteen years later, as an author looking back. She shapes a legend about herself: a shy young woman among famous poets who cannot think of a story until a vision comes. Ask students what she gains by presenting the book as a dream rather than a plan.
- **Allusion:** The Introduction is thick with real names (Byron, Percy Shelley, Dr. Darwin, galvanism). Each one ties the fiction to real science and real literary rivalry, which is why the story felt possible to its first readers.
- **Imagery:** The vision is told in sharp visual details: the kneeling student, the "hideous phantasm," the yellow, watery eyes. Students will meet these images again in Chapter V; flag them now.

Themes and how they develop

- **creation and responsibility:** Shelley calls the book her "hideous progeny" and sends it out into the world, as Victor does his creature; but unlike Victor she wishes it to "prosper." The author models the care the character fails to give.

Symbols and motifs

- **the dream:** Dreams recur through the novel (Victor's nightmare after the creation). Here the dream is creative; later it becomes a punishment.

Key quotations (checked against the reading text)

- "I saw the pale student of unhallowed arts kneeling beside the thing he had put together" (Introduction, paragraph 11) "Unhallowed" means unholy, and "thing" refuses the creation a name. Students can use this to argue that the novel judges the act of creation as a transgression from its first image.
- "And now, once again, I bid my hideous progeny go forth and prosper" (Introduction, paragraph 15) Shelley presents herself as a parent of the book. Use this to connect author and character: both make something "hideous," but only one blesses it.
- "Invention, it must be humbly admitted, does not consist in creating out of void, but out of chaos" (Introduction, paragraph 9) Shelley's theory of creativity: you build from existing materials, as Victor builds from old bones. Good evidence for a claim about the novel's self-awareness.

Model claim-evidence-reasoning

Claim: Shelley frames her novel as a creation that, unlike Victor's, is accepted and sent out with care.
Evidence: "And now, once again, I bid my hideous progeny go forth and prosper" (Introduction, paragraph 15)
Reasoning: By calling the book her "hideous progeny" she uses the language of parenthood; wishing it to "prosper" is exactly the blessing the creature never receives, so the frame sets up the novel's test of what makers owe what they make.

Vocabulary with etymology notes

Word	Definition (in this sentence)	In context	Word history
platitude (noun)	dullness; a lack of freshness or originality	*The illustrious poets also, annoyed by the platitude of prose, speedily relinquished their uncongenial task.*	"platitude": Borrowed from French platitude, from plat "flat". (Wiktionary, https://en.wiktionary.org/wiki/platitude#Etymology)
invocations (noun)	calls or appeals for help or inspiration	*I felt that blank incapability of invention which is the greatest misery of authorship, when dull Nothing replies to our anxious invocations.*	"invocations": From Middle English invocacioun, from Old French invocacion, from Latin invocatio, invocationem. Equivalent to invoke + -ation. (Wiktionary, https://en.wiktionary.org/wiki/invocation#Etymology)
retrospection (noun)	looking back on the past	*Blank and dreary on retrospection I call them; they were not so to me then.*	
galvanism (noun)	electricity produced by chemical action, used in early experiments on muscles	*Perhaps a corpse would be reanimated; galvanism had given token of such things: perhaps the component parts of a creature might be manufactured, brought together, and endued with vital warmth.*	"galvanism": Named after Luigi Galvani (1737–1798), the Bologna anatomist who made dead frogs' legs twitch with electric current; galvanism meant electricity produced by chemical action. (Online Etymology Dictionary, https://www.etymonline.com/word/galvanism)

beatings (noun)	beats; throbs (of the heart)	*One which would speak to the mysterious fears of our nature, and awaken thrilling horror—one to make the reader dread to look round, to curdle the blood, and quicken the beatings of the heart.*	"beatings": By surface analysis, beat + -ing. (Wiktionary, https://en.wiktionary.org/wiki/beating#Etymology)
reanimated (verb)	brought back to life or strength; revived	*Perhaps a corpse would be reanimated; galvanism had given token of such things: perhaps the component parts of a creature might be manufactured, brought together, and endued with vital warmth.*	"reanimated": From re- + animate. (Wiktionary, https://en.wiktionary.org/wiki/reanimate#Etymology)
appertain (verb)	to belong to or be connected with	*In all matters of discovery and invention, even of those that appertain to the imagination, we are continually reminded of the story of Columbus and his egg.*	"appertain": From Middle English apperteinen, apertenen, borrowed from Old French apartenir (French appartenir), from Late Latin appertinēre]], from ad "to" + Latin pertinēre]]. More at pertain. (Wiktionary, https://en.wiktionary.org/wiki/appertain#Etymology)
cradled (verb)	held gently, as in a cradle	*The shape was lost beneath the shadow of the castle walls; but soon a gate swung back, a step was heard, the door of the chamber opened, and he advanced to the couch of the blooming youths, cradled in healthy sleep.*	
inciting (verb)	give an incentive for action	*He was forever inciting me to obtain literary reputation, which even on my own part I cared for then, though since I have become infinitely indifferent to it.*	"inciting": From Middle French inciter, from Latin incitō "to set in motion, hasten, urge, incite", from in "in, on" + citō "to set in motion, urge", frequentative of cieō "to rouse, excite, call". (Wiktionary, https://en.wiktionary.org/wiki/incite#Etymology)
parquet (noun)	a wooden floor laid in a pattern	*I see them still; the very room, the dark parquet, the closed shutters, with the moonlight struggling through, and the sense I had that the glassy lake and white high Alps were beyond.*	

Discussion questions

1. Shelley calls her book her 'hideous progeny.' How does that phrase connect the author to Victor?

2. Where does point of view appear in this chapter, and what effect does it have? Point to one passage.
3. How does this chapter connect to the book's larger concern with the costs of unchecked ambition?

Classroom discussion questions (30, tiered)

Wait time after every question (3 s for DOK 1, 5 s for DOK 2, 8 to 10 s for DOK 3 and 4); think-pair-share on DOK 3 and 4; answer each response with a follow-up probe; close with student-generated questions. Focus sets by rigor level: Middle School: 1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 6, 11, 12, 13, 14, 21, 22; HS Freshman: 1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 12, 13, 14, 15, 22, 23, 24; HS Sophomore: 1, 2, 3, 4, 13, 14, 15, 16, 17, 23, 24, 25; HS Junior: 1, 2, 3, 14, 15, 16, 17, 18, 24, 25, 26, 27; HS Senior: 1, 2, 3, 15, 16, 17, 18, 25, 26, 27, 28, 29; AP: 1, 2, 16, 17, 18, 19, 20, 26, 27, 28, 29, 30; College Freshman: 1, 2, 17, 18, 19, 20, 21, 22, 27, 28, 29, 30; College Sophomore: 1, 2, 11, 18, 19, 20, 21, 22, 23, 28, 29, 30; College Junior: 1, 11, 12, 19, 20, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 29, 30; College Senior: 1, 11, 12, 13, 20, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 26, 30; Graduate / PhD: 1, 11, 12, 13, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 26, 27, 28

Literal / recall

1. Where was Shelley staying when the ghost-story contest began? [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · 7.RC.1, 7.CC.1, 9-10.RC.1] Look for: Near Geneva, Switzerland
2. Who proposed that each guest write a ghost story? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · 7.RC.1, 7.CC.1, 9-10.RC.1] Look for: Lord Byron
3. What scientific topic did the group discuss that influenced the idea? [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · 7.RC.1, 7.CC.1, 9-10.RC.1] Look for: Galvanism and the principle of life
4. How did the central image of the novel come to Shelley? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · 7.RC.1, 7.CC.1, 9-10.RC.1] Look for: In a vivid waking vision as she lay in bed
5. What does Shelley call her book? [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · 7.RC.1, 7.CC.1, 9-10.RC.1] Look for: Her hideous progeny
6. Retell the three most important events of “Introduction” in order, in one sentence each. [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · 7.RC.1, 7.CC.1, 9-10.RC.1] Look for: Writing in 1831, Shelley explains how the novel began: a rainy summer near Geneva in 1816, a ghost-story contest with Byron and Percy Shelley, conversations about galvanism, and a waking vision of a 'pale student of unhallowed arts' kneeling beside the thing he had put together. She calls the book her 'hideous progeny.'
7. Which characters appear or are mentioned in “Introduction”? Name two and one thing each says or does. [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · 7.RC.1, 7.CC.1, 9-10.RC.1] Look for: Names and actions taken from the chapter; check against the teacher summary.
8. Where and when does “Introduction” take place? Point to the line that tells you. [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · 7.RC.1, 7.CC.1, 9-10.RC.1] Look for: A place/time detail quoted from the chapter.
9. Reread: “The illustrious poets also, annoyed by the platitude of prose, speedily relinquished their uncongenial task.” What does “platitude” mean here, and what is literally happening in this line? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · 7.RC.1, 7.CC.1, 9-10.RC.1] Look for: platitude: dullness; a lack of freshness or originality.
10. Reread: “I felt that blank incapability of invention which is the greatest misery of authorship, when dull Nothing replies to our anxious invocations.” What does “invocations” mean here, and what is literally happening in this line? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · 7.RC.1, 7.CC.1, 9-10.RC.1] Look for: invocations: calls or appeals for help or inspiration.

Inferential / analytical

1. What does “Introduction” suggest about the origin of the novel and the idea of creation? State the inference and the line that supports it. [DOK 2 · thinkPairShare · wait 5 s · 7.RC.2, 7.CC.2, 9-10.RC.2] Look for: The Introduction is one of the most famous origin stories in literature and frames the novel as both a dream and a deliberate artistic creation, mirroring Victor's own act of making.
2. Find one example of point of view in this chapter. What does it reveal that a plain statement would not? [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · 7.RC.1, 7.CC.2, 9-10.RC.1] Look for: Look for who is telling the story and what that narrator can and cannot know.
3. How does the allusion in this chapter shape what we understand about the origin of the novel and the idea of creation? [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · 7.RC.2, 7.CC.2, 9-10.RC.1] Look for: Look for references to other books, myths, history or religion.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Shelley frames her novel as a creation that, unlike Victor's, is accepted and sent out with care. Useful evidence: “I saw the pale student of unhallowed arts kneeling beside the thing he had put together” (Introduction, paragraph 11): "Unhallowed" means unholy, and "thing" refuses the creation a name. Students can use this to argue that the novel judges the act of creation as a transgression from its first image. On allusion: The Introduction is thick with real names (Byron, Percy Shelley, Dr. Darwin, galvanism). Each one ties the fiction to real science and real literary rivalry, which is why the story felt possible to its first readers. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
4. In the passage that begins “I busied myself to think of a story—a story to rival those which had excited us to this task.”, why might Shelley have chosen these particular words? Pick two and explain their connotations. [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · 7.RC.12, 7.CC.2, 9-10.RC.12] Look for: Diction analysis of two words in the anchor passage.
5. What causes the main turn in “Introduction”, and what effect is it likely to have on what follows? [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · 7.RC.3, 7.CC.2, 9-10.RC.1] Look for: Writing in 1831, Shelley explains how the novel began: a rainy summer near Geneva in 1816, a ghost-story contest with Byron and Percy Shelley, conversations about galvanism, and a waking vision of a 'pale student of unhallowed arts' kneeling beside the thing he had put together. She calls the book…
6. As the opening chapter, what does “Introduction” set up that the rest of Frankenstein will need? [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · 7.RC.3, 7.CC.2, 9-10.RC.3] Look for: A causal or structural link between this and the previous chapter.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Shelley frames her novel as a creation that, unlike Victor's, is accepted and sent out with care. Useful evidence: “And now, once again, I bid my hideous progeny go forth and prosper” (Introduction, paragraph 15): Shelley presents herself as a parent of the book. Use this to connect author and character: both make something "hideous," but only one blesses it. Theme link: Shelley calls the book her "hideous progeny" and sends it out into the world, as Victor does his creature; but unlike Victor she wishes it to "prosper." The author models the care the character fails to give. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
7. What can we infer about a character's motives from what they say and do here, as opposed to what they claim? [DOK 3 · followUp · wait 8 s · 7.RC.3, 7.CC.2, 9-10.RC.1] Look for: An inference about motive supported by a quoted line.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Shelley frames her novel as a creation that, unlike Victor's, is accepted and sent out with care. Useful evidence: “Invention, it must be humbly admitted, does not consist in creating out of void, but out of chaos” (Introduction, paragraph 9): Shelley's theory of

creativity: you build from existing materials, as Victor builds from old bones. Good evidence for a claim about the novel's self-awareness. Theme link: Shelley calls the book her "hideous progeny" and sends it out into the world, as Victor does his creature; but unlike Victor she wishes it to "prosper." The author models the care the character fails to give. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

8. The bell-ringer asked: “Shelley calls her book her 'hideous progeny.' How does that phrase connect the author to Victor?” Now that we have read closely, how would you revise your first answer, and which line changed your mind? [DOK 2 · thinkPairShare · wait 5 s · 7.RC.2, 7.CC.2, 9-10.RC.2] Look for: A revised answer anchored in the text.
9. Where does imagery appear, and how does it connect this chapter to the larger concern with the costs of unchecked ambition? [DOK 3 · followUp · wait 8 s · 7.RC.12, 7.CC.2, 9-10.RC.12] Look for: Look for sensory details (sight, sound, cold, light) and what mood they create.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Shelley frames her novel as a creation that, unlike Victor's, is accepted and sent out with care. Useful evidence: “I saw the pale student of unhallowed arts kneeling beside the thing he had put together” (Introduction, paragraph 11): "Unhallowed" means unholy, and "thing" refuses the creation a name. Students can use this to argue that the novel judges the act of creation as a transgression from its first image. On imagery: The vision is told in sharp visual details: the kneeling student, the "hideous phantasm," the yellow, watery eyes. Students will meet these images again in Chapter V; flag them now. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
10. Background: The 1816 'year without a summer' followed the eruption of Mount Tambora. Galvani's experiments making frog legs twitch with electricity fed public speculation about reanimation. How does knowing this change the way you read one moment in the chapter? [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · 7.RC.3, 7.CC.2, 9-10.RC.1] Look for: A specific moment reread in light of the context.
    Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Shelley frames her novel as a creation that, unlike Victor's, is accepted and sent out with care. Useful evidence: “And now, once again, I bid my hideous progeny go forth and prosper” (Introduction, paragraph 15): Shelley presents herself as a parent of the book. Use this to connect author and character: both make something "hideous," but only one blesses it. Theme link: Shelley calls the book her "hideous progeny" and sends it out into the world, as Victor does his creature; but unlike Victor she wishes it to "prosper." The author models the care the character fails to give. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

Evaluative / synthesis / creative

1. A critic might argue: “The Introduction is one of the most famous origin stories in literature and frames the novel as both a dream and a deliberate artistic creation, mirroring Victor's own act of making.” How far do you agree? Take a stand and defend it with two lines from the chapter. [DOK 3 · fourCorners · wait 8 s · 7.RC.2, 7.CC.3, 9-10.RC.2] Look for: A defended position with evidence and one counterpoint.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Shelley frames her novel as a creation that, unlike Victor's, is accepted and sent out with care. Useful evidence: “Invention, it must be humbly admitted, does not consist in creating out of void, but out of chaos” (Introduction, paragraph 9): Shelley's theory of creativity: you build from existing materials, as Victor builds from old bones. Good evidence for a claim about the novel's self-awareness. Theme link: Shelley calls the book her "hideous progeny" and sends it out

into the world, as Victor does his creature; but unlike Victor she wishes it to "prosper." The author models the care the character fails to give. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

2. Which character in this chapter acts most wisely, and which least? Judge them by a standard you name. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · 7.RC.3, 7.CC.3, 9-10.RC.1] Look for: An evaluation using an explicit criterion and evidence.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Shelley frames her novel as a creation that, unlike Victor's, is accepted and sent out with care. Useful evidence: “I saw the pale student of unhallowed arts kneeling beside the thing he had put together” (Introduction, paragraph 11): "Unhallowed" means unholy, and "thing" refuses the creation a name. Students can use this to argue that the novel judges the act of creation as a transgression from its first image. Theme link: Shelley calls the book her "hideous progeny" and sends it out into the world, as Victor does his creature; but unlike Victor she wishes it to "prosper." The author models the care the character fails to give. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

3. Rewrite one moment of “Introduction” from the point of view of a different character. What does the new angle reveal or hide about the origin of the novel and the idea of creation? [DOK 4 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · 7.RC.1, 7.CC.3, 9-10.RC.1] Look for: A creative product with a rationale tied to the text.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Shelley frames her novel as a creation that, unlike Victor's, is accepted and sent out with care. Useful evidence: “And now, once again, I bid my hideous progeny go forth and prosper” (Introduction, paragraph 15): Shelley presents herself as a parent of the book. Use this to connect author and character: both make something "hideous," but only one blesses it. On point of view: Shelley speaks in her own voice, thirteen years later, as an author looking back. She shapes a legend about herself: a shy young woman among famous poets who cannot think of a story until a vision comes. Ask students what she gains by presenting the book as a dream rather than a plan. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

4. Write three questions of your own about “Introduction”: one recall, one “why/how”, and one “should/what if”. Trade with a partner and answer theirs. [DOK 3 · studentGenerated · wait 8 s · 7.RC.2, 7.CC.3, 9-10.RC.2] Look for: Student-generated questions at three levels.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Shelley frames her novel as a creation that, unlike Victor's, is accepted and sent out with care. Useful evidence: “Invention, it must be humbly admitted, does not consist in creating out of void, but out of chaos” (Introduction, paragraph 9): Shelley's theory of creativity: you build from existing materials, as Victor builds from old bones. Good evidence for a claim about the novel's self-awareness. Theme link: Shelley calls the book her "hideous progeny" and sends it out into the world, as Victor does his creature; but unlike Victor she wishes it to "prosper." The author models the care the character fails to give. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

5. Connect this chapter to creation and responsibility: is the link strong or weak so far? What would Shelley need to show next to strengthen it? [DOK 4 · socraticCircle · wait 8 s · 7.RC.2, 7.CC.3, 9-10.RC.2] Look for: A judgment of thematic development across the work.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Shelley frames her novel as a creation that, unlike Victor's, is accepted and sent out with care. Useful evidence: “I saw the pale student of unhallowed arts kneeling beside the thing he had put together” (Introduction, paragraph 11): "Unhallowed" means unholy,

and "thing" refuses the creation a name. Students can use this to argue that the novel judges the act of creation as a transgression from its first image. Theme link: Shelley calls the book her "hideous progeny" and sends it out into the world, as Victor does his creature; but unlike Victor she wishes it to "prosper." The author models the care the character fails to give. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

6. Is the point of view in this chapter effective, or does it feel heavy-handed? Evaluate it as a reader would in a review. [DOK 3 · fourCorners · wait 8 s · 7.RC.1, 7.CC.3, 9-10.RC.1] Look for: An evaluative judgment with criteria and evidence.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Shelley frames her novel as a creation that, unlike Victor's, is accepted and sent out with care. Useful evidence: “And now, once again, I bid my hideous progeny go forth and prosper” (Introduction, paragraph 15): Shelley presents herself as a parent of the book. Use this to connect author and character: both make something "hideous," but only one blesses it. On point of view: Shelley speaks in her own voice, thirteen years later, as an author looking back. She shapes a legend about herself: a shy young woman among famous poets who cannot think of a story until a vision comes. Ask students what she gains by presenting the book as a dream rather than a plan. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

7. Compare how “Introduction” treats the origin of the novel and the idea of creation with how another text, film or event you know treats a similar idea. What does Frankenstein see that the other misses? [DOK 4 · socraticCircle · wait 8 s · 7.RC.2, 7.CC.3, 9-10.RC.2] Look for: A cross-text synthesis.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Shelley frames her novel as a creation that, unlike Victor's, is accepted and sent out with care. Useful evidence: “Invention, it must be humbly admitted, does not consist in creating out of void, but out of chaos” (Introduction, paragraph 9): Shelley's theory of creativity: you build from existing materials, as Victor builds from old bones. Good evidence for a claim about the novel's self-awareness. Theme link: Shelley calls the book her "hideous progeny" and sends it out into the world, as Victor does his creature; but unlike Victor she wishes it to "prosper." The author models the care the character fails to give. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

8. Predict what “Preface” will bring, using two clues from this chapter. After reading, evaluate your prediction. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · 7.RC.3, 7.CC.3, 9-10.RC.3] Look for: A prediction or judgment justified with textual clues.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Shelley frames her novel as a creation that, unlike Victor's, is accepted and sent out with care. Useful evidence: “I saw the pale student of unhallowed arts kneeling beside the thing he had put together” (Introduction, paragraph 11): "Unhallowed" means unholy, and "thing" refuses the creation a name. Students can use this to argue that the novel judges the act of creation as a transgression from its first image. Theme link: Shelley calls the book her "hideous progeny" and sends it out into the world, as Victor does his creature; but unlike Victor she wishes it to "prosper." The author models the care the character fails to give. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

9. Design a one-paragraph modern adaptation of this chapter (setting, characters, conflict). What must stay the same for it to still be about the origin of the novel and the idea of creation? [DOK 4 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · 7.RC.2, 7.CC.3, 9-10.RC.2] Look for: A creative transfer that keeps the core idea.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Shelley frames her novel as a creation that, unlike

Victor's, is accepted and sent out with care. Useful evidence: “And now, once again, I bid my hideous progeny go forth and prosper” (Introduction, paragraph 15): Shelley presents herself as a parent of the book. Use this to connect author and character: both make something "hideous," but only one blesses it. Theme link: Shelley calls the book her "hideous progeny" and sends it out into the world, as Victor does his creature; but unlike Victor she wishes it to "prosper." The author models the care the character fails to give. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

10. What question would you most like to ask Mary Shelley about this chapter, and what answer do you think the text itself gives? [DOK 4 · studentGenerated · wait 8 s · 7.RC.2, 7.CC.3, 9-10.RC.2] Look for: A student-generated question answered from evidence.

    Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Shelley frames her novel as a creation that, unlike Victor's, is accepted and sent out with care. Useful evidence: “Invention, it must be humbly admitted, does not consist in creating out of void, but out of chaos” (Introduction, paragraph 9): Shelley's theory of creativity: you build from existing materials, as Victor builds from old bones. Good evidence for a claim about the novel's self-awareness. Theme link: Shelley calls the book her "hideous progeny" and sends it out into the world, as Victor does his creature; but unlike Victor she wishes it to "prosper." The author models the care the character fails to give. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

Annotation focus

- **Point of view:** look for who is telling the story and what that narrator can and cannot know (anchor passage in the We do segment)
- Also notice **Allusion**: references to other books, myths, history or religion
- Also notice **Imagery**: sensory details (sight, sound, cold, light) and what mood they create

Chapter quiz: item bank (all eleven rigor versions)

1. [fill · recall · DOK 1] Complete the quotation from Introduction, paragraph 11: “I saw the pale student of _____ arts kneeling beside the thing he had put together”

   Key: unhallowed

2. [fill · recall · DOK 1] Complete the quotation from Introduction, paragraph 15: “And now, once again, I bid my _____ progeny go forth and prosper”

   Key: hideous

3. [mc · recall · DOK 1] Where was Shelley staying when the ghost-story contest began?

   A. In Venice

   B. On a ship to the Arctic

   C. In London

   D. Near Geneva, Switzerland

   Key: D (Near Geneva, Switzerland)

4. [fill · recall · DOK 1] Fill in the blank with the vocabulary word that fits: “One which would speak to the mysterious fears of our nature, and awaken thrilling horror—one to make the reader dread to look round, to curdle the blood, and quicken the _____ of the heart.” Word bank: retrospection, platitude, invocations, beatings

   Key: beatings

5. [mc · recall · DOK 1] How did the central image of the novel come to Shelley?

   A. In a vivid waking vision as she lay in bed

   B. From a newspaper story

   C. In a letter from a friend

   D. While reading a play

   Key: A (In a vivid waking vision as she lay in bed)

6. [fill · recall · DOK 1] Fill in the blank with the vocabulary word that fits: “In all matters of discovery and invention, even of those that _____ to the imagination, we are continually reminded of the story of Columbus and his egg.” Word bank: platitude, retrospection, appertain, invocations

   Key: appertain

7. [mc · recall · DOK 1] Who proposed that each guest write a ghost story?

   A. Victor Frankenstein

   B. Shelley's father

   C. Robert Walton

   D. Lord Byron

   Key: D (Lord Byron)

8. [mc · recall · DOK 1] In the line “Blank and dreary on retrospection I call them; they were not so to me then.”, what does “retrospection” most nearly mean?

   A. abundant wealth

   B. looking back on the past

   C. troubled; inconvenienced

   D. the state of being excommunicated

   Key: B (looking back on the past)

9. [fill · recall · DOK 1] Fill in the blank with the vocabulary word that fits: “Perhaps a corpse would be _____; galvanism had given token of such things: perhaps the component parts of a creature might be manufactured, brought together, and endued with vital warmth.” Word bank: retrospection, platitude, invocations, reanimated

   Key: reanimated

10. [short · inference · DOK 2] What can you infer from this line? “I saw the pale student of unhallowed arts kneeling beside the thing he had put together” (Introduction, paragraph 11) Answer in two or three sentences with one detail.

    Sample answer: "Unhallowed" means unholy, and "thing" refuses the creation a name. Students can use this to argue that the novel judges the act of creation as a transgression from its first image.

11. [short · inference · DOK 2] What can you infer from this line? “And now, once again, I bid my hideous progeny go forth and prosper” (Introduction, paragraph 15) Answer in two or three sentences with one detail.

    Sample answer: Shelley presents herself as a parent of the book. Use this to connect author and character: both make something "hideous," but only one blesses it.

12. [mc · inference · DOK 2] What does this passage most clearly show? “And now, once again, I bid my hideous progeny go forth and prosper” (Introduction, paragraph 15)

    A. Shot after a rescue; bitter irony.

B. Elizabeth sees what Victor hides; his guilt shows on his face.

C. A careful double negative: not "possible," only "not impossible." Evidence that the book presents itself as grounded in real science.

D. Shelley presents herself as a parent of the book. Use this to connect author and character: both make something "hideous," but only one blesses it.

Key: D (Shelley presents herself as a parent of the book. Use this to connect author and character: both make something "hideous," but only one blesses it.)

13. [mc · inference · DOK 2] What does this passage most clearly show? “I saw the pale student of unhallowed arts kneeling beside the thing he had put together” (Introduction, paragraph 11)

A. Dismissal without explanation; Victor later blames this.

B. Self-horror learned from others' standards of beauty.

C. Elizabeth is presented as a gift; useful for discussions of how women are treated in the novel.

D. "Unhallowed" means unholy, and "thing" refuses the creation a name. Students can use this to argue that the novel judges the act of creation as a transgression from its first image.

Key: D ("Unhallowed" means unholy, and "thing" refuses the creation a name. Students can use this to argue that the novel judges the act of creation as a transgression from its first image.)

14. [mc · analysis · DOK 3] Which literary element does this describe in “Introduction”? The Introduction is thick with real names (Byron, Percy Shelley, Dr. Darwin, galvanism). Each one ties the fiction to real science and real literary rivalry, which is why the story felt possible to its first readers.

A. Symbolism

B. Tone / mood

C. Allusion

D. Alliteration

Key: C (Allusion)

15. [mc · analysis · DOK 3] Which literary element does this describe in “Introduction”? Shelley speaks in her own voice, thirteen years later, as an author looking back. She shapes a legend about herself: a shy young woman among famous poets who cannot think of a story until a vision comes. Ask students what she gains by…

A. Theme

B. Foreshadowing

C. Imagery

D. Point of view

Key: D (Point of view)

16. [short · synthesis · DOK 4] Close reading: how do the diction and syntax of “And now, once again, I bid my hideous progeny go forth and prosper” (Introduction, paragraph 15) shape its meaning? Consider a second, competing reading.

Sample answer: Shelley presents herself as a parent of the book. Use this to connect author and character: both make something "hideous," but only one blesses it.

17. [mc · recall · DOK 1] What does Shelley call her book?

A. Her little ghost

B. Her hideous progeny

C. Her Prometheus

D. Her summer diary

Key: B (Her hideous progeny)

18. [fill · recall · DOK 1] Fill in the blank with the vocabulary word that fits: “The shape was lost beneath the shadow of the castle walls; but soon a gate swung back, a step was heard, the door of the chamber opened, and he advanced to the couch of the blooming youths, _____ in healthy sleep.” Word bank: cradled, invocations, retrospection, platitude

    Key: cradled

19. [mc · inference · DOK 2] Which choice best states a central concern of “Introduction”?

    A. Destroying the companion

    B. Horror at the moment of creation

    C. The origin of the novel and the idea of creation

    D. Learning compassion by watching

    Key: C (The origin of the novel and the idea of creation)

20. [mc · analysis · DOK 3] In this chapter, which theme does the following most directly develop? Shelley calls the book her "hideous progeny" and sends it out into the world, as Victor does his creature; but unlike Victor she wishes it to "prosper." The author models the care the character fails to give.

    A. Isolation and the need for companionship

    B. Nature versus nurture

    C. Creation and responsibility

    D. The costs of unchecked ambition

    Key: C (Creation and responsibility)

21. [short · analysis · DOK 3] Analyze the word choice in “Invention, it must be humbly admitted, does not consist in creating out of void, but out of chaos” (Introduction, paragraph 9). Pick two words and explain what they suggest.

    Sample answer: Shelley's theory of creativity: you build from existing materials, as Victor builds from old bones. Good evidence for a claim about the novel's self-awareness.

22. [mc · recall · DOK 1] In the line “Perhaps a corpse would be reanimated; galvanism had given token of such things: perhaps the component parts of a creature might be manufactured, brought together, and endued with vital warmth.”, what does “galvanism” most nearly mean?

    A. in a kind, well-meaning way

    B. cannot be removed or erased

    C. argue in protest or opposition

    D. electricity produced by chemical action, used in early experiments on muscles

    Key: D (electricity produced by chemical action, used in early experiments on muscles)

23. [mc · inference · DOK 2] What does this passage most clearly show? “Invention, it must be humbly admitted, does not consist in creating out of void, but out of chaos” (Introduction, paragraph 9)

    A. Victor makes Justine's death about his suffering: a striking self-centeredness.

    B. Shelley's theory of creativity: you build from existing materials, as Victor builds from old bones. Good evidence for a claim about the novel's self-awareness.

C. Confession to his father, dismissed as madness.

D. Ingratitude repays virtue; the word "treacherous" carries the creature's (and the narrative's) judgment.

Key: B (Shelley's theory of creativity: you build from existing materials, as Victor builds from old bones. Good evidence for a claim about the novel's self-awareness.)

24. [short · synthesis · DOK 4] Evaluate this claim about the chapter: “Shelley frames her novel as a creation that, unlike Victor's, is accepted and sent out with care.” Is it fully persuasive? Argue with evidence, including a passage that complicates it.

Sample answer: By calling the book her "hideous progeny" she uses the language of parenthood; wishing it to "prosper" is exactly the blessing the creature never receives, so the frame sets up the novel's test of what makers owe what they make.

25. [short · synthesis · DOK 4] Close reading: how do the diction and syntax of “I saw the pale student of unhallowed arts kneeling beside the thing he had put together” (Introduction, paragraph 11) shape its meaning? Consider a second, competing reading.

Sample answer: "Unhallowed" means unholy, and "thing" refuses the creation a name. Students can use this to argue that the novel judges the act of creation as a transgression from its first image.

26. [fill · recall · DOK 1] Complete the quotation from Introduction, paragraph 9: “_____, it must be humbly admitted, does not consist in creating out of void, but out of chaos”

Key: Invention

27. [mc · recall · DOK 1] What scientific topic did the group discuss that influenced the idea?

A. Astronomy

B. Botany

C. Steam engines

D. Galvanism and the principle of life

Key: D (Galvanism and the principle of life)

28. [mc · recall · DOK 1] In the line “I felt that blank incapability of invention which is the greatest misery of authorship, when dull Nothing replies to our anxious invocations.”, what does “invocations” most nearly mean?

A. following the course of; marking out

B. hold spellbound

C. calls or appeals for help or inspiration

D. prickling or stinging slightly

Key: C (calls or appeals for help or inspiration)

29. [short · synthesis · DOK 4] Synthesis: trace how creation and responsibility develops from an earlier chapter to “Introduction”. Use one quotation from each.

Sample answer: Shelley calls the book her "hideous progeny" and sends it out into the world, as Victor does his creature; but unlike Victor she wishes it to "prosper." The author models the care the character fails to give.

30. [short · analysis · DOK 3] Claim: Shelley frames her novel as a creation that, unlike Victor's, is accepted and sent out with care. Explain how this evidence supports the claim: “And now, once again, I bid my hideous progeny go forth and prosper” (Introduction, paragraph 15).

Sample answer: By calling the book her "hideous progeny" she uses the language of parenthood; wishing it to "prosper" is exactly the blessing the creature never receives, so the frame sets up the novel's test of what makers owe what they make.

Rigor version	Items (in order)	Mix

Middle School	1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 6, 7, 8, 9, 10, 11, 12, 13, 14, 15, 16	recall 9, inference 4, analysis 2, synthesis 1
HS Freshman	17, 8, 18, 3, 9, 7, 1, 5, 10, 13, 19, 12, 20, 14, 21, 16	recall 8, inference 4, analysis 3, synthesis 1
HS Sophomore	7, 4, 8, 9, 5, 22, 19, 13, 23, 10, 11, 14, 20, 15, 24, 25	recall 6, inference 5, analysis 3, synthesis 2
HS Junior	26, 9, 1, 27, 28, 11, 23, 19, 13, 12, 21, 20, 15, 14, 29, 25	recall 5, inference 5, analysis 4, synthesis 2
HS Senior	4, 9, 27, 8, 11, 19, 10, 12, 23, 30, 20, 21, 15, 24, 16, 25	recall 4, inference 5, analysis 4, synthesis 3
AP	2, 22, 4, 10, 19, 13, 12, 21, 30, 14, 15, 20, 25, 16, 29, 24	recall 3, inference 4, analysis 5, synthesis 4
College Freshman	4, 9, 7, 19, 13, 11, 12, 21, 30, 20, 14, 15, 29, 24, 25, 16	recall 3, inference 4, analysis 5, synthesis 4
College Sophomore	4, 9, 10, 13, 11, 19, 23, 21, 20, 15, 30, 14, 29, 25, 16, 24	recall 2, inference 5, analysis 5, synthesis 4
College Junior	4, 2, 11, 19, 13, 12, 23, 15, 14, 30, 20, 21, 24, 29, 25, 16	recall 2, inference 5, analysis 5, synthesis 4
College Senior	9, 4, 19, 23, 10, 13, 11, 15, 30, 14, 20, 21, 25, 29, 24, 16	recall 2, inference 5, analysis 5, synthesis 4
Graduate / PhD	4, 9, 10, 13, 11, 23, 19, 15, 21, 14, 20, 30, 24, 25, 16, 29	recall 2, inference 5, analysis 5, synthesis 4

Writing prompts (eleven rigor levels)

Middle School (250 words; Indiana 2023: 7.RC.1, 7.W.1): Supported track (work from the passage your teacher selects). In “Introduction,” how does Shelley show the origin of the novel and the idea of creation? Write a paragraph that states your claim, quotes two details from the passage, and explains how each detail supports your idea. Use the point of view you noticed as one piece of evidence.

HS Freshman (350 words; Indiana 2023: 9-10.RC.1, 9-10.W.1): In Introduction, how does Shelley develop the idea of the origin of the novel and the idea of creation? State a clear claim, support it with two or three quotations, and explain how the point of view in the chapter helps build that idea.

HS Sophomore (450 words; Indiana 2023: 9-10.RC.1, 9-10.W.1): Analyze how Introduction develops the idea of the origin of the novel and the idea of creation. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of point of view and allusion shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.

HS Junior (550 words; Indiana 2023: 11-12.RC.3, 11-12.RC.1, 11-12.W.1): Analyze how the structure of Introduction (where it begins, turns and ends) and its point of view shape the reader's understanding of the origin of the novel and the idea of creation. Identify one place where the text leaves matters uncertain and explain how that uncertainty adds to its meaning. Distinguish what is directly stated from what is really meant.

HS Senior (600 words; Indiana 2023: 11-12.RC.1, 11-12.W.1): Two readers disagree about what Introduction suggests about the origin of the novel and the idea of creation. Lay out two plausible interpretations, weigh the evidence for each (including the chapter's point of view and allusion), and argue for the stronger one in a sustained, well-organized essay. Distinguish what is directly stated from what is really meant.

AP (650 words; Indiana 2023: 11-12.RC.1, 11-12.W.1): Write a literary argument in which you analyze how Mary Shelley uses point of view in Introduction to complicate the reader's understanding of the origin of the novel and the idea of creation. Develop a defensible thesis, select evidence purposefully, and explain how specific choices of diction and syntax create meaning.

College Freshman (1000 words; Indiana 2023: see unit standards): Situate Introduction within its historical and literary context and argue how the chapter's treatment of the origin of the novel and the idea of creation responds to that context. Engage with at least one secondary perspective (a critic, historian or the author's own statements), integrate quotations smoothly, and cite in MLA style.

College Sophomore (1250 words; Indiana 2023: see unit standards): Read Introduction alongside the conventions of its genre and period. Argue how the chapter's handling of the origin of the novel and the idea of creation follows or bends those conventions, using the point of view as evidence, and test your reading against one published critic. Document two secondary sources in MLA.

College Junior (1500 words; Indiana 2023: see unit standards): Apply a named critical approach (for example formalist, historicist, feminist, psychoanalytic or ecocritical) to Introduction and its treatment of the origin of the novel and the idea of creation. State your method, show what it reveals in the chapter's point of view and allusion, and identify where the text resists it.

College Senior (2000 words; Indiana 2023: see unit standards): Develop a research argument that reads Introduction as evidence for a larger claim about the origin of the novel and the idea of creation in Frankenstein. Connect close reading of the chapter to the whole novel, engage at least four scholarly sources, and state precisely where your reading departs from theirs (Chicago style).

Graduate / PhD (2500 words; Indiana 2023: see unit standards): Develop an original argument that reads Introduction as a hinge in the novel's larger treatment of the origin of the novel and the idea of creation. Position your reading within a named critical conversation (for example formalist, historicist, psychoanalytic, feminist or postcolonial approaches), account for the textual history where relevant, and articulate the stakes of your intervention for scholarship on Frankenstein.

SAT-style questions

1. *Blank and dreary on retrospection I call them; they were not so to me then.*

   As used in the text, what does the word “retrospection” most nearly mean?

   A. give an incentive for action

   B. a wooden floor laid in a pattern

   C. looking back on the past

   D. held gently, as in a cradle

2. *I busied myself to think of a story—a story to rival those which had excited us to this task. One which would speak to the mysterious fears of our nature, and awaken thrilling horror—one to make the reader dread to look round, to curdle the blood, and quicken the beatings of the heart. If I did not accomplish these things, my ghost story would be unworthy of its name. I thought and pondered—vainly. I felt that blank incapability of invention which is the greatest misery of authorship, when dull Nothing replies to our anxious invocations. Have you thought of a story? I was asked each morning, and each morning I was forced to reply with a mortifying negative.*

   Which choice best states a central concern of “Introduction”?

   A. Language, knowledge and sorrow

   B. The origin of the novel and the idea of creation

C. Loss and leaving home

D. The meeting of two ambitious men

SAT key: 1. C (looking back on the past); 2. B (The origin of the novel and the idea of creation)

Lesson 3: Preface

Focus: the author's stated purpose

Objective: Students will analyze how tone / mood develops in “Preface” by writing a claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph that cites at least 2 quotations from the section, and will score at least 80% on the section quiz.

Standards: CCSS RL.9-10.4, W.9-10.1, L.9-10.4 · IN 9-10.RC.12, 9-10.W.1, 9-10.RC.9, 9-10.RC.11

Critical voice: “In the class of fictitious narrations to which we allude, the author opens a sort of account-current with the reader; drawing upon him, in the first place, for credit to that degree of the marvellous which he proposes to employ; and becoming virtually bound, in consequence of this indulgence, that his personages shall conduct themselves, in the extraordinary circumstances in which they are placed, according to the rules of probability, and the nature of the human heart.” (Walter Scott (attrib.), novelist and critic, *"Remarks on Frankenstein, or the Modern Prometheus; A Novel," Blackwood's Edinburgh Magazine 2:12 (March 1818), p. 614*; public domain). Essay lens: does Shelley keep her side of the "account-current"? Students find one place where characters act by "the rules of probability" and one where they do not. *Objective:* Analyze the author's stated purpose in the Preface and how it asks readers to accept an impossible premise. *Standards:* RL.11-12.6, 11-12.RC.1

Teacher only · spoilers

The 1818 Preface (written by Percy Shelley in Mary's voice) claims the central event is not impossible according to some physiologists, insists the story aims to show 'the amiableness of domestic affection,' and recalls the ghost-story origin.

Background: Prefaces in the period often defended novels against charges of immorality or absurdity. Erasmus Darwin, mentioned here, was a well-known physician and poet who speculated about life.

Significance: The Preface sets up the tension between scientific plausibility and moral fable that runs through the whole work.

Lesson plan and lecture script (90 minutes)

> **0–8 min · Bell-ringer · You do (8 min)**
> Students write to the bell-ringer, then pair-share.
> *Why might an author defend the 'possibility' of a fantastic event before the story begins? Write for five minutes.*
> *Starters: I think... because... / This connects to creation and responsibility because....*
> **Prompt:** Why might an author defend the 'possibility' of a fantastic event before the story begins?
> **Sentence starters:** I think… because… · This connects to creation and responsibility because…
> **Strong response:** A strong response takes a position and anticipates this: The Preface claims the story shows "the amiableness of domestic affection"; keep this phrase on the board. The novel will test it: domestic love is shown, then destroyed.

8–18 min · Vocabulary with etymology notes · I do (10 min)
Five key words in context, with verified word histories.
Today's words: innovate — to make changes; to introduce something new; scrupled — hesitated because of a moral doubt; spectres — ghosts; environs — the area in which something exists or lives; disadvantages — the quality of having an inferior or less favorable position. “scrupled”: From Latin scrupulus "small sharp stone; uneasiness," the image of a pebble in one's shoe; the verb means "to hesitate on grounds of conscience." “disadvantages”: From Middle English disavauntage, from Old French desavantage.
Words: innovate: to make changes; to introduce something new · scrupled: hesitated because of a moral doubt · spectres: ghosts · environs: the area in which something exists or lives · disadvantages: the quality of having an inferior or less favorable position

18–28 min · Background and context · I do (10 min)
Mini-lecture (read or adapt the script).
Prefaces in the period often defended novels against charges of immorality or absurdity. Erasmus Darwin, mentioned here, was a well-known physician and poet who speculated about life. The Preface sets up the tension between scientific plausibility and moral fable that runs through the whole work. Tone / mood: The 1818 Preface is defensive and reasonable. It insists the event is "not of impossible occurrence" and that the book is moral. The tone tells us what readers of 1818 might object to: impiety and absurdity. Allusion: "Dr. Darwin" is Erasmus Darwin, physician and poet (Charles Darwin's grandfather), whose speculations about life were well known. Citing him borrows scientific authority. Point of view: The Preface was written by Percy Shelley in Mary's voice. Students can discuss how a "frame" around a book tells readers how to read it. Watch for light and fire: Light stands for knowledge and fire for its double edge: warmth and burning. Victor seeks the "light" of discovery; the creature discovers fire and is burned by it. In this chapter: “and in the evenings we crowded around a blazing wood fire, and occasionally amused ourselves with some German stories of ghosts, which” (Preface, paragraph 4).

28–40 min · I do: modeled close reading · I do (12 min)
Model the close reading of the anchor quotation using the written think-aloud below.
I read the line once for meaning and once for craft. “the amiableness of domestic affection, and the excellence of universal virtue” (Preface, paragraph 3). The stated moral purpose. Students can test whether the plot actually shows this, or shows what happens when domestic affection is withheld. That is tone / mood at work: The 1818 Preface is defensive and reasonable. It insists the event is "not of impossible occurrence" and that the book is moral. The tone tells us what readers of 1818 might object to: impiety and absurdity.

> *the amiableness of domestic affection, and the excellence of universal virtue* (Preface, paragraph 3)

Think-aloud: I read the line once for meaning and once for craft. “the amiableness of domestic affection, and the excellence of universal virtue” (Preface, paragraph 3). The stated moral purpose. Students can test whether the plot actually shows this, or shows what happens when domestic affection is withheld. That is tone / mood at work: The 1818 Preface is defensive and reasonable. It insists the event is "not of impossible occurrence" and that the book is moral. The tone tells us what readers of 1818 might object to: impiety and absurdity.

40–55 min · We do: guided annotation · We do (15 min)
Guided analysis of a second quotation; expected answers given.
Ask: What words in this line stand out, and what do they suggest? Expected: "Not of impossible occurrence" is a cautious double negative: the writer claims only that science does not rule it out. This shows the book defending itself, which tells us how daring the idea was in 1818. Ask: How does this line connect to creation and responsibility? Expected: The Preface claims the story shows "the amiableness of domestic affection"; keep this phrase on the board. The novel will test it: domestic love is shown, then destroyed. (A careful double negative: not "possible," only "not impossible." Evidence that the book presents itself as grounded in real science.)

> *The event on which this fiction is founded, has been supposed, by Dr. Darwin, and some of the physiological writers of Germany, as not of impossible occurrence (Preface, paragraph 1)*

Ask: What words in this line stand out, and what do they suggest?
Expected answer: "Not of impossible occurrence" is a cautious double negative: the writer claims only that science does not rule it out. This shows the book defending itself, which tells us how daring the idea was in 1818.
Ask: How does this line connect to creation and responsibility?
Expected answer: The Preface claims the story shows "the amiableness of domestic affection"; keep this phrase on the board. The novel will test it: domestic love is shown, then destroyed. (A careful double negative: not "possible," only "not impossible." Evidence that the book presents itself as grounded in real science.)

55–70 min · You do: independent annotation · You do (15 min)
Independent annotation and a claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph (exemplar given).
Annotate the chapter for tone / mood, allusion (three marks with a margin note each), then write one claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph: what does this chapter suggest about the author's stated purpose? Then start your writing prompt at your assigned level (HS Sophomore: Analyze how Preface develops the idea of the author's stated purpose. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of tone / mood and theme shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.) Exemplar: The Preface tries to make a shocking story respectable by grounding it in science and morality. When the text says "The event on which this fiction is founded, has been supposed, by Dr. Darwin, and some of the physiological writers of Germany, as not of impossible occurrence" (Preface, paragraph 1), it shows this directly. By citing Dr. Darwin and German physiologists it claims the event is "not of impossible occurrence," and by naming domestic affection and virtue as its aims it answers the charge that a horror story is immoral.
Task: Annotate the chapter for tone / mood, allusion (three marks with a margin note each), then write one claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph: what does this chapter suggest about the author's stated purpose? Then start your writing prompt at your assigned level (HS Sophomore: Analyze how Preface develops the idea of the author's stated purpose. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of tone / mood and theme shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.)
Exemplar: The Preface tries to make a shocking story respectable by grounding it in science and morality. When the text says "The event on which this fiction is founded, has been supposed, by Dr. Darwin, and some of the physiological writers of Germany, as not of impossible occurrence" (Preface, paragraph 1), it shows this directly. By citing Dr. Darwin and German physiologists it claims the event is "not of impossible occurrence," and by naming domestic affection and virtue as its aims it answers the charge that a horror story is immoral.

70–80 min · Discussion · We do (10 min)
Structured discussion from the 30 tiered questions, with facilitation notes.
Anchor question: Why might an author defend the 'possibility' of a fantastic event before the story begins? Ask whether a book needs to defend itself. What would a reader in 1818 have found offensive in a man creating life?
Anchor question: Why might an author defend the 'possibility' of a fantastic event before the story begins?
Facilitation: Ask whether a book needs to defend itself. What would a reader in 1818 have found offensive in a man creating life?

80–87 min · Exit ticket / chapter quiz · You do (7 min)
Chapter quiz in the app and an exit ticket (answer given).
Chapter quiz in the app, then: In one sentence, what does this chapter suggest about the author's stated purpose? Support it with one short quotation. Model answer: The Preface tries to make a shocking story respectable by grounding it in science and morality. ("The event on which this fiction is founded, has been supposed, by Dr. Darwin, and some of the physiological writers of Germany, as not of impossible occurrence", Preface, paragraph 1). Accept any defensible claim backed by a quotation from the chapter; the answer key for the quiz is in the Quiz section.
Exit ticket: In one sentence, what does this chapter suggest about the author's stated purpose? Support it with one short quotation.
Answer: Model answer: The Preface tries to make a shocking story respectable by grounding it in science and morality. ("The event on which this fiction is founded, has been supposed, by Dr. Darwin, and some of the physiological writers of Germany, as not of impossible occurrence", Preface, paragraph 1). Accept any defensible claim backed by a quotation from the chapter; the answer key for the quiz is in the Quiz section.

87–90 min · Closure · I do (3 min)
Summarize the lesson and preview the next reading.
Today we saw how tone / mood shapes the author's stated purpose. Key takeaway: The Preface claims the story shows "the amiableness of domestic affection"; keep this phrase on the board. The novel will test it: domestic love is shown, then destroyed.

Total: 90 minutes.

Teacher analysis (spoilers)

Literary elements

- **Tone / mood:** The 1818 Preface is defensive and reasonable. It insists the event is "not of impossible occurrence" and that the book is moral. The tone tells us what readers of 1818 might object to: impiety and absurdity.
- **Allusion:** "Dr. Darwin" is Erasmus Darwin, physician and poet (Charles Darwin's grandfather), whose speculations about life were well known. Citing him borrows scientific authority.
- **Point of view:** The Preface was written by Percy Shelley in Mary's voice. Students can discuss how a "frame" around a book tells readers how to read it.

Themes and how they develop

- **creation and responsibility:** The Preface claims the story shows "the amiableness of domestic affection"; keep this phrase on the board. The novel will test it: domestic love is shown, then destroyed.

Symbols and motifs

- **light and fire:** Light stands for knowledge and fire for its double edge: warmth and burning. Victor seeks the "light" of discovery; the creature discovers fire and is burned by it. In this chapter: "and in the evenings we crowded around a blazing wood fire, and occasionally amused ourselves with some German stories of ghosts, which" (Preface, paragraph 4).

- **sublime nature:** Mountains, glaciers, storms and lakes reflect and sometimes soothe the characters' feelings; the sublime is both comfort and terror. In this chapter: “my two friends left me on a journey among the Alps, and lost, in the magnificent scenes which they present, all memory” (Preface, paragraph 5).

Key quotations (checked against the reading text)

- “The event on which this fiction is founded, has been supposed, by Dr. Darwin, and some of the physiological writers of Germany, as not of impossible occurrence” (Preface, paragraph 1) A careful double negative: not "possible," only "not impossible." Evidence that the book presents itself as grounded in real science.
- “the amiableness of domestic affection, and the excellence of universal virtue” (Preface, paragraph 3) The stated moral purpose. Students can test whether the plot actually shows this, or shows what happens when domestic affection is withheld.
- “I passed the summer of 1816 in the environs of Geneva” (Preface, paragraph 4) Places the book in real time and place; compare with the 1831 Introduction's fuller account.

Model claim-evidence-reasoning

Claim: The Preface tries to make a shocking story respectable by grounding it in science and morality.
Evidence: “The event on which this fiction is founded, has been supposed, by Dr. Darwin, and some of the physiological writers of Germany, as not of impossible occurrence” (Preface, paragraph 1)
Reasoning: By citing Dr. Darwin and German physiologists it claims the event is "not of impossible occurrence," and by naming domestic affection and virtue as its aims it answers the charge that a horror story is immoral.

Vocabulary with etymology notes

Word	Definition (in this sentence)	In context	Word history
innovate (verb)	to make changes; to introduce something new	*I have thus endeavoured to preserve the truth of the elementary principles of human nature, while I have not scrupled to innovate upon their combinations.*	
scrupled (verb)	hesitated because of a moral doubt	*I have thus endeavoured to preserve the truth of the elementary principles of human nature, while I have not scrupled to innovate upon their combinations.*	“scrupled”: From Latin scrupulus "small sharp stone; uneasiness," the image of a pebble in one's shoe; the verb means "to hesitate on grounds of conscience." (Online Etymology Dictionary, https://www.etymonline.com/word/scruple)
spectres (noun)	ghosts	*The event on which the interest of the story depends is exempt from the*	

		disadvantages of a mere tale of spectres or enchantment.	
environs (noun)	the area in which something exists or lives	*I passed the summer of 1816 in the environs of Geneva.*	
disadvantages (noun)	the quality of having an inferior or less favorable position	*The event on which the interest of the story depends is exempt from the disadvantages of a mere tale of spectres or enchantment.*	"disadvantages": From Middle English disavauntage, from Old French desavantage. (Wiktionary, https://en.wiktionary.org/wiki/disadvantage#Etymology)
elementary (adjective)	basic; fundamental	*I have thus endeavoured to preserve the truth of the elementary principles of human nature, while I have not scrupled to innovate upon their combinations.*	"elementary": From Middle English elementare, from Latin elementārius "elementary", from elementum "one of the four elements of antiquity; fundamentals" + -ārius. Cognate with French élémentaire. By surface analysis, element + -ary. (Wiktionary, https://en.wiktionary.org/wiki/elementary#Etymology)
ghostly (adjective)	resembling or characteristic of a phantom	*The weather, however, suddenly became serene; and my two friends left me on a journey among the Alps, and lost, in the magnificent scenes which they present, all memory of their ghostly visions.*	
weaving (verb)	interlace by or as if by weaving	*I shall not be supposed as according the remotest degree of serious faith to such an imagination; yet, in assuming it as the basis of a work of fancy, I have not considered myself as merely weaving a series of supernatural terrors.*	
occurrence (noun)	an event that happens	*Darwin, and some of the physiological writers of Germany, as not of impossible occurrence.*	"occurrence": From Latin occurrere "to run to meet," from ob- "toward" + currere "to run." (Online Etymology Dictionary, https://www.etymonline.com/word/occurrence)
expedient (noun)	a means to an end; not necessarily a principled or ethical one	*It was commenced partly as a source of amusement, and partly as an expedient for exercising any untried resources of mind.*	"expedient": From Middle English expedient, from Old French expedient, from Latin expediens (stem expedient-), present participle of expedire "to bring forward, to dispatch, to expedite; impers. to be profitable, serviceable,

			advantageous, expedient", from ex "out" + pēs "foot, hoof". (Wiktionary, https://en.wiktionary.org/wiki/expedient#Etymology)

Discussion questions

1. Why might an author defend the 'possibility' of a fantastic event before the story begins?
2. Where does tone / mood appear in this chapter, and what effect does it have? Point to one passage.
3. How does this chapter connect to the book's larger concern with creation and responsibility?

Classroom discussion questions (30, tiered)

Wait time after every question (3 s for DOK 1, 5 s for DOK 2, 8 to 10 s for DOK 3 and 4); think-pair-share on DOK 3 and 4; answer each response with a follow-up probe; close with student-generated questions. Focus sets by rigor level: Middle School: 1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 6, 11, 12, 13, 14, 21, 22; HS Freshman: 1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 12, 13, 14, 15, 22, 23, 24; HS Sophomore: 1, 2, 3, 4, 13, 14, 15, 16, 17, 23, 24, 25; HS Junior: 1, 2, 3, 14, 15, 16, 17, 18, 24, 25, 26, 27; HS Senior: 1, 2, 3, 15, 16, 17, 18, 25, 26, 27, 28, 29; AP: 1, 2, 16, 17, 18, 19, 20, 26, 27, 28, 29, 30; College Freshman: 1, 2, 17, 18, 19, 20, 21, 22, 27, 28, 29, 30; College Sophomore: 1, 2, 11, 18, 19, 20, 21, 22, 23, 28, 29, 30; College Junior: 1, 11, 12, 19, 20, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 29, 30; College Senior: 1, 11, 12, 13, 20, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 26, 30; Graduate / PhD: 1, 11, 12, 13, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 26, 27, 28

Literal / recall

1. Which scientist does the Preface mention as having supposed the event possible? [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · 7.RC.1, 7.CC.1, 9-10.RC.1] Look for: Dr. Darwin
2. According to the Preface, what value does the story hope to display? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · 7.RC.1, 7.CC.1, 9-10.RC.1] Look for: The amiableness of domestic affection
3. What kind of writing does the Preface compare the work to? [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · 7.RC.1, 7.CC.1, 9-10.RC.1] Look for: Great works such as the Iliad and Shakespeare's plays
4. What is the tone of the Preface? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · 7.RC.1, 7.CC.1, 9-10.RC.1] Look for: Measured and defensive of the book's seriousness
5. What season and weather does the Preface recall? [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · 7.RC.1, 7.CC.1, 9-10.RC.1] Look for: A cold, rainy summer
6. Retell the three most important events of “Preface” in order, in one sentence each. [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · 7.RC.1, 7.CC.1, 9-10.RC.1] Look for: The 1818 Preface (written by Percy Shelley in Mary's voice) claims the central event is not impossible according to some physiologists, insists the story aims to show 'the amiableness of domestic affection,' and recalls the ghost-story origin.
7. Which characters appear or are mentioned in “Preface”? Name two and one thing each says or does. [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · 7.RC.1, 7.CC.1, 9-10.RC.1] Look for: Names and actions taken from the chapter; check against the teacher summary.
8. Where and when does “Preface” take place? Point to the line that tells you. [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · 7.RC.1, 7.CC.1, 9-10.RC.1] Look for: A place/time detail quoted from the chapter.
9. Reread: “I have thus endeavoured to preserve the truth of the elementary principles of human nature, while I have not scrupled to innovate upon their combinations.” What does “innovate” mean here, and what is literally happening in this line? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · 7.RC.1, 7.CC.1, 9-10.RC.1] Look for: innovate: to make changes; to introduce something new.

10. Reread: “I have thus endeavoured to preserve the truth of the elementary principles of human nature, while I have not scrupled to innovate upon their combinations.” What does “scrupled” mean here, and what is literally happening in this line? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · 7.RC.1, 7.CC.1, 9-10.RC.1] Look for: scrupled: hesitated because of a moral doubt.

Inferential / analytical

1. What does “Preface” suggest about the author's stated purpose? State the inference and the line that supports it. [DOK 2 · thinkPairShare · wait 5 s · 7.RC.2, 7.CC.2, 9-10.RC.2] Look for: The Preface sets up the tension between scientific plausibility and moral fable that runs through the whole work.
2. Find one example of tone / mood in this chapter. What does it reveal that a plain statement would not? [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · 7.RC.12, 7.CC.2, 9-10.RC.12] Look for: Look for word choices that reveal the narrator's attitude or the scene's feeling.
3. How does the theme in this chapter shape what we understand about the author's stated purpose? [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · 7.RC.2, 7.CC.2, 9-10.RC.2] Look for: Look for statements or moments that connect to the book's big ideas.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The Preface tries to make a shocking story respectable by grounding it in science and morality. Useful evidence: “The event on which this fiction is founded, has been supposed, by Dr. Darwin, and some of the physiological writers of Germany, as not of impossible occurrence” (Preface, paragraph 1): A careful double negative: not "possible," only "not impossible." Evidence that the book presents itself as grounded in real science. Theme link: The Preface claims the story shows "the amiableness of domestic affection"; keep this phrase on the board. The novel will test it: domestic love is shown, then destroyed. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
4. In the passage that begins “The event on which this fiction is founded, has been supposed, by Dr.”, why might Shelley have chosen these particular words? Pick two and explain their connotations. [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · 7.RC.12, 7.CC.2, 9-10.RC.12] Look for: Diction analysis of two words in the anchor passage.
5. What causes the main turn in “Preface”, and what effect is it likely to have on what follows? [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · 7.RC.3, 7.CC.2, 9-10.RC.1] Look for: The 1818 Preface (written by Percy Shelley in Mary's voice) claims the central event is not impossible according to some physiologists, insists the story aims to show 'the amiableness of domestic affection,' and recalls the ghost-story origin.
6. How does “Preface” build on “Introduction”? Name one link of cause and effect. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · 7.RC.3, 7.CC.2, 9-10.RC.3] Look for: A causal or structural link between this and the previous chapter.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The Preface tries to make a shocking story respectable by grounding it in science and morality. Useful evidence: “the amiableness of domestic affection, and the excellence of universal virtue” (Preface, paragraph 3): The stated moral purpose. Students can test whether the plot actually shows this, or shows what happens when domestic affection is withheld. Theme link: The Preface claims the story shows "the amiableness of domestic affection"; keep this phrase on the board. The novel will test it: domestic love is shown, then destroyed. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
7. What can we infer about a character's motives from what they say and do here, as opposed to what they claim? [DOK 3 · followUp · wait 8 s · 7.RC.3, 7.CC.2, 9-10.RC.1] Look for: An inference about motive supported by a quoted line.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The Preface tries to make a shocking story respectable

by grounding it in science and morality. Useful evidence: “I passed the summer of 1816 in the environs of Geneva” (Preface, paragraph 4): Places the book in real time and place; compare with the 1831 Introduction's fuller account. Theme link: The Preface claims the story shows "the amiableness of domestic affection"; keep this phrase on the board. The novel will test it: domestic love is shown, then destroyed. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

8. The bell-ringer asked: “Why might an author defend the 'possibility' of a fantastic event before the story begins?” Now that we have read closely, how would you revise your first answer, and which line changed your mind? [DOK 2 · thinkPairShare · wait 5 s · 7.RC.2, 7.CC.2, 9-10.RC.2] Look for: A revised answer anchored in the text.
9. Where does allusion appear, and how does it connect this chapter to the larger concern with creation and responsibility? [DOK 3 · followUp · wait 8 s · 7.RC.2, 7.CC.2, 9-10.RC.1] Look for: Look for references to other books, myths, history or religion.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The Preface tries to make a shocking story respectable by grounding it in science and morality. Useful evidence: “The event on which this fiction is founded, has been supposed, by Dr. Darwin, and some of the physiological writers of Germany, as not of impossible occurrence” (Preface, paragraph 1): A careful double negative: not "possible," only "not impossible." Evidence that the book presents itself as grounded in real science. On allusion: "Dr. Darwin" is Erasmus Darwin, physician and poet (Charles Darwin's grandfather), whose speculations about life were well known. Citing him borrows scientific authority. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
10. Background: Prefaces in the period often defended novels against charges of immorality or absurdity. Erasmus Darwin, mentioned here, was a well-known physician and poet who speculated about life. How does knowing this change the way you read one moment in the chapter? [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · 7.RC.3, 7.CC.2, 9-10.RC.1] Look for: A specific moment reread in light of the context.

    Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The Preface tries to make a shocking story respectable by grounding it in science and morality. Useful evidence: “the amiableness of domestic affection, and the excellence of universal virtue” (Preface, paragraph 3): The stated moral purpose. Students can test whether the plot actually shows this, or shows what happens when domestic affection is withheld. Theme link: The Preface claims the story shows "the amiableness of domestic affection"; keep this phrase on the board. The novel will test it: domestic love is shown, then destroyed. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

Evaluative / synthesis / creative

1. A critic might argue: “The Preface sets up the tension between scientific plausibility and moral fable that runs through the whole work.” How far do you agree? Take a stand and defend it with two lines from the chapter. [DOK 3 · fourCorners · wait 8 s · 7.RC.2, 7.CC.3, 9-10.RC.2] Look for: A defended position with evidence and one counterpoint.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The Preface tries to make a shocking story respectable by grounding it in science and morality. Useful evidence: “I passed the summer of 1816 in the environs of Geneva” (Preface, paragraph 4): Places the book in real time and place; compare with the 1831 Introduction's fuller account. Theme link: The Preface claims the story shows "the amiableness of domestic affection"; keep this phrase on the board. The novel will test it: domestic love is shown, then destroyed.

Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

2. Which character in this chapter acts most wisely, and which least? Judge them by a standard you name. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · 7.RC.3, 7.CC.3, 9-10.RC.1] Look for: An evaluation using an explicit criterion and evidence.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The Preface tries to make a shocking story respectable by grounding it in science and morality. Useful evidence: “The event on which this fiction is founded, has been supposed, by Dr. Darwin, and some of the physiological writers of Germany, as not of impossible occurrence” (Preface, paragraph 1): A careful double negative: not "possible," only "not impossible." Evidence that the book presents itself as grounded in real science. Theme link: The Preface claims the story shows "the amiableness of domestic affection"; keep this phrase on the board. The novel will test it: domestic love is shown, then destroyed. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

3. Rewrite one moment of “Preface” from the point of view of a different character. What does the new angle reveal or hide about the author's stated purpose? [DOK 4 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · 7.RC.1, 7.CC.3, 9-10.RC.1] Look for: A creative product with a rationale tied to the text.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The Preface tries to make a shocking story respectable by grounding it in science and morality. Useful evidence: “the amiableness of domestic affection, and the excellence of universal virtue” (Preface, paragraph 3): The stated moral purpose. Students can test whether the plot actually shows this, or shows what happens when domestic affection is withheld. On point of view: The Preface was written by Percy Shelley in Mary's voice. Students can discuss how a "frame" around a book tells readers how to read it. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

4. Write three questions of your own about “Preface”: one recall, one “why/how”, and one “should/what if”. Trade with a partner and answer theirs. [DOK 3 · studentGenerated · wait 8 s · 7.RC.2, 7.CC.3, 9-10.RC.2] Look for: Student-generated questions at three levels.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The Preface tries to make a shocking story respectable by grounding it in science and morality. Useful evidence: “I passed the summer of 1816 in the environs of Geneva” (Preface, paragraph 4): Places the book in real time and place; compare with the 1831 Introduction's fuller account. Theme link: The Preface claims the story shows "the amiableness of domestic affection"; keep this phrase on the board. The novel will test it: domestic love is shown, then destroyed. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

5. Connect this chapter to isolation and the need for companionship: is the link strong or weak so far? What would Shelley need to show next to strengthen it? [DOK 4 · socraticCircle · wait 8 s · 7.RC.2, 7.CC.3, 9-10.RC.2] Look for: A judgment of thematic development across the work.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The Preface tries to make a shocking story respectable by grounding it in science and morality. Useful evidence: “The event on which this fiction is founded, has been supposed, by Dr. Darwin, and some of the physiological writers of Germany, as not of impossible occurrence” (Preface, paragraph 1): A careful double negative: not "possible," only "not impossible." Evidence that the book presents itself as grounded in real science. Theme link: The Preface claims the story shows "the amiableness of domestic affection"; keep this phrase on the board. The novel will test it:

domestic love is shown, then destroyed. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

6. Is the tone / mood in this chapter effective, or does it feel heavy-handed? Evaluate it as a reader would in a review. [DOK 3 · fourCorners · wait 8 s · 7.RC.12, 7.CC.3, 9-10.RC.12] Look for: An evaluative judgment with criteria and evidence.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The Preface tries to make a shocking story respectable by grounding it in science and morality. Useful evidence: “the amiableness of domestic affection, and the excellence of universal virtue” (Preface, paragraph 3): The stated moral purpose. Students can test whether the plot actually shows this, or shows what happens when domestic affection is withheld. On tone / mood: The 1818 Preface is defensive and reasonable. It insists the event is "not of impossible occurrence" and that the book is moral. The tone tells us what readers of 1818 might object to: impiety and absurdity. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

7. Compare how “Preface” treats the author's stated purpose with how another text, film or event you know treats a similar idea. What does Frankenstein see that the other misses? [DOK 4 · socraticCircle · wait 8 s · 7.RC.2, 7.CC.3, 9-10.RC.2] Look for: A cross-text synthesis.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The Preface tries to make a shocking story respectable by grounding it in science and morality. Useful evidence: “I passed the summer of 1816 in the environs of Geneva” (Preface, paragraph 4): Places the book in real time and place; compare with the 1831 Introduction's fuller account. Theme link: The Preface claims the story shows "the amiableness of domestic affection"; keep this phrase on the board. The novel will test it: domestic love is shown, then destroyed. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

8. Predict what “Letter I” will bring, using two clues from this chapter. After reading, evaluate your prediction. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · 7.RC.3, 7.CC.3, 9-10.RC.3] Look for: A prediction or judgment justified with textual clues.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The Preface tries to make a shocking story respectable by grounding it in science and morality. Useful evidence: “The event on which this fiction is founded, has been supposed, by Dr. Darwin, and some of the physiological writers of Germany, as not of impossible occurrence” (Preface, paragraph 1): A careful double negative: not "possible," only "not impossible." Evidence that the book presents itself as grounded in real science. Theme link: The Preface claims the story shows "the amiableness of domestic affection"; keep this phrase on the board. The novel will test it: domestic love is shown, then destroyed. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

9. Design a one-paragraph modern adaptation of this chapter (setting, characters, conflict). What must stay the same for it to still be about the author's stated purpose? [DOK 4 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · 7.RC.2, 7.CC.3, 9-10.RC.2] Look for: A creative transfer that keeps the core idea.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The Preface tries to make a shocking story respectable by grounding it in science and morality. Useful evidence: “the amiableness of domestic affection, and the excellence of universal virtue” (Preface, paragraph 3): The stated moral purpose. Students can test whether the plot actually shows this, or shows what happens when domestic affection is withheld. Theme link: The Preface claims the story shows "the amiableness of domestic affection"; keep this phrase on the board. The

novel will test it: domestic love is shown, then destroyed. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

10. What question would you most like to ask Mary Shelley about this chapter, and what answer do you think the text itself gives? [DOK 4 · studentGenerated · wait 8 s · 7.RC.2, 7.CC.3, 9-10.RC.2] Look for: A student-generated question answered from evidence.
    Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The Preface tries to make a shocking story respectable by grounding it in science and morality. Useful evidence: “I passed the summer of 1816 in the environs of Geneva” (Preface, paragraph 4): Places the book in real time and place; compare with the 1831 Introduction's fuller account. Theme link: The Preface claims the story shows "the amiableness of domestic affection"; keep this phrase on the board. The novel will test it: domestic love is shown, then destroyed. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

Annotation focus

- **Tone / mood:** look for word choices that reveal the narrator's attitude or the scene's feeling (anchor passage in the We do segment)
- Also notice **Theme**: statements or moments that connect to the book's big ideas
- Also notice **Allusion**: references to other books, myths, history or religion

Chapter quiz: item bank (all eleven rigor versions)

1. [mc · recall · DOK 1] What season and weather does the Preface recall?
   A. A cold, rainy summer
   B. A snowy winter in London
   C. A hot spring in Italy
   D. An autumn harvest

   Key: A (A cold, rainy summer)
2. [fill · recall · DOK 1] Fill in the blank with the vocabulary word that fits: “I have thus endeavoured to preserve the truth of the _____ principles of human nature, while I have not scrupled to innovate upon their combinations.” Word bank: elementary, scrupled, spectres, innovate
   Key: elementary
3. [fill · recall · DOK 1] Fill in the blank with the vocabulary word that fits: “The weather, however, suddenly became serene; and my two friends left me on a journey among the Alps, and lost, in the magnificent scenes which they present, all memory of their _____ visions.” Word bank: innovate, scrupled, ghostly, spectres
   Key: ghostly
4. [mc · recall · DOK 1] In the line “I passed the summer of 1816 in the environs of Geneva.”, what does “environs” most nearly mean?
   A. decrease in size, extent, or range
   B. infected and full of pus
   C. an unfortunate mishap; especially one causing damage or injury
   D. the area in which something exists or lives

   Key: D (the area in which something exists or lives)

5. [fill · recall · DOK 1] Fill in the blank with the vocabulary word that fits: “I shall not be supposed as according the remotest degree of serious faith to such an imagination; yet, in assuming it as the basis of a work of fancy, I have not considered myself as merely _____ a series of supernatural terrors.” Word bank: spectres, weaving, innovate, scrupled

   Key: weaving

6. [fill · recall · DOK 1] Fill in the blank with the vocabulary word that fits: “The event on which the interest of the story depends is exempt from the _____ of a mere tale of spectres or enchantment.” Word bank: spectres, innovate, scrupled, disadvantages

   Key: disadvantages

7. [mc · recall · DOK 1] What kind of writing does the Preface compare the work to?

   A. Great works such as the Iliad and Shakespeare's plays

   B. Sermons

   C. Cookbooks

   D. Newspaper reports

   Key: A (Great works such as the Iliad and Shakespeare's plays)

8. [mc · recall · DOK 1] In the line “The event on which the interest of the story depends is exempt from the disadvantages of a mere tale of spectres or enchantment.”, what does “spectres” most nearly mean?

   A. regular court sessions held in English counties (until 1971)

   B. a companion at play

   C. to dull or stain the brightness of

   D. ghosts

   Key: D (ghosts)

9. [mc · recall · DOK 1] In the line “I have thus endeavoured to preserve the truth of the elementary principles of human nature, while I have not scrupled to innovate upon their combinations.”, what does “innovate” most nearly mean?

   A. pure; not mixed with anything else

   B. to make changes; to introduce something new

   C. reject with contempt

   D. made easier

   Key: B (to make changes; to introduce something new)

10. [mc · inference · DOK 2] What does this passage most clearly show? “I passed the summer of 1816 in the environs of Geneva” (Preface, paragraph 4)

    A. Victor's lesson; partly retracted.

    B. Shelley presents herself as a parent of the book. Use this to connect author and character: both make something "hideous," but only one blesses it.

    C. The first sentence already contains a warning (his sister's "evil forebodings"). Strong evidence for foreshadowing.

    D. Places the book in real time and place; compare with the 1831 Introduction's fuller account.

    Key: D (Places the book in real time and place; compare with the 1831 Introduction's fuller account.)

11. [short · inference · DOK 2] What can you infer from this line? “The event on which this fiction is founded, has been supposed, by Dr. Darwin, and some of the physiological writers of Germany, as not of impossible occurrence” (Preface, paragraph 1) Answer in two or three sentences with one detail.
    Sample answer: A careful double negative: not "possible," only "not impossible." Evidence that the book presents itself as grounded in real science.
12. [mc · inference · DOK 2] What does this passage most clearly show? “the amiableness of domestic affection, and the excellence of universal virtue” (Preface, paragraph 3)
    A. The first words he learns: basic needs and the home.
    B. The creature will ask for exactly this. Evidence that the need for companionship is universal in the novel.
    C. The stated moral purpose. Students can test whether the plot actually shows this, or shows what happens when domestic affection is withheld.
    D. The argument from isolation.

    Key: C (The stated moral purpose. Students can test whether the plot actually shows this, or shows what happens when domestic affection is withheld.)
13. [mc · inference · DOK 2] What does this passage most clearly show? “The event on which this fiction is founded, has been supposed, by Dr. Darwin, and some of the physiological writers of Germany, as not of impossible occurrence” (Preface, paragraph 1)
    A. A careful double negative: not "possible," only "not impossible." Evidence that the book presents itself as grounded in real science.
    B. Restoration that the reader suspects cannot last.
    C. Dismissal without explanation; Victor later blames this.
    D. An allusion that promises he will not offend against nature; readers who know Coleridge sense danger.

    Key: A (A careful double negative: not "possible," only "not impossible." Evidence that the book presents itself as grounded in real science.)
14. [mc · analysis · DOK 3] Which literary element does this describe in “Preface”? "Dr. Darwin" is Erasmus Darwin, physician and poet (Charles Darwin's grandfather), whose speculations about life were well known. Citing him borrows scientific authority.
    A. Hyperbole
    B. Allusion
    C. Metaphor
    D. Diction / vocabulary

    Key: B (Allusion)
15. [short · analysis · DOK 3] Claim: The Preface tries to make a shocking story respectable by grounding it in science and morality. Explain how this evidence supports the claim: “The event on which this fiction is founded, has been supposed, by Dr. Darwin, and some of the physiological writers of Germany, as not of impossible occurrence” (Preface, paragraph 1).
    Sample answer: By citing Dr. Darwin and German physiologists it claims the event is "not of impossible occurrence," and by naming domestic affection and virtue as its aims it answers the charge that a horror story is immoral.
16. [short · synthesis · DOK 4] Close reading: how do the diction and syntax of “the amiableness of domestic affection, and the excellence of universal virtue” (Preface, paragraph 3) shape its meaning? Consider a

second, competing reading.

Sample answer: The stated moral purpose. Students can test whether the plot actually shows this, or shows what happens when domestic affection is withheld.

17. [fill · recall · DOK 1] Complete the quotation from Preface, paragraph 4: “I passed the summer of 1816 in the _____ of Geneva”

    Key: environs

18. [fill · recall · DOK 1] Complete the quotation from Preface, paragraph 3: “the _____ of domestic affection, and the excellence of universal virtue”

    Key: amiableness

19. [mc · recall · DOK 1] According to the Preface, what value does the story hope to display?

    A. The wealth of nations
    B. The glory of war
    C. The beauty of cities
    D. The amiableness of domestic affection

    Key: D (The amiableness of domestic affection)

20. [mc · recall · DOK 1] In the line “I have thus endeavoured to preserve the truth of the elementary principles of human nature, while I have not scrupled to innovate upon their combinations.”, what does “scrupled” most nearly mean?

    A. hesitated because of a moral doubt
    B. gives up; abandons
    C. speeches or remarks of high praise
    D. spoils; makes impure

    Key: A (hesitated because of a moral doubt)

21. [mc · inference · DOK 2] Which choice best states a central concern of “Preface”?

    A. Rejection and the turn to revenge
    B. A letter, a secret and the wedding
    C. The demand for a companion
    D. The author's stated purpose

    Key: D (The author's stated purpose)

22. [short · inference · DOK 2] What can you infer from this line? “the amiableness of domestic affection, and the excellence of universal virtue” (Preface, paragraph 3) Answer in two or three sentences with one detail.

    Sample answer: The stated moral purpose. Students can test whether the plot actually shows this, or shows what happens when domestic affection is withheld.

23. [mc · analysis · DOK 3] Which literary element does this describe in “Preface”? The 1818 Preface is defensive and reasonable. It insists the event is "not of impossible occurrence" and that the book is moral. The tone tells us what readers of 1818 might object to: impiety and absurdity.

    A. Diction / vocabulary
    B. Irony
    C. Tone / mood
    D. Foreshadowing

Key: C (Tone / mood)

24. [mc · analysis · DOK 3] In this chapter, which theme does the following most directly develop? The Preface claims the story shows "the amiableness of domestic affection"; keep this phrase on the board. The novel will test it: domestic love is shown, then destroyed.

    A. Creation and responsibility

    B. Isolation and the need for companionship

    C. The costs of unchecked ambition

    D. Nature versus nurture

    Key: A (Creation and responsibility)

25. [short · synthesis · DOK 4] Evaluate this claim about the chapter: “The Preface tries to make a shocking story respectable by grounding it in science and morality.” Is it fully persuasive? Argue with evidence, including a passage that complicates it.

    Sample answer: By citing Dr. Darwin and German physiologists it claims the event is "not of impossible occurrence," and by naming domestic affection and virtue as its aims it answers the charge that a horror story is immoral.

26. [mc · recall · DOK 1] Which scientist does the Preface mention as having supposed the event possible?

    A. Isaac Newton

    B. Dr. Darwin

    C. Humphry Davy

    D. Galileo

    Key: B (Dr. Darwin)

27. [short · synthesis · DOK 4] Close reading: how do the diction and syntax of “The event on which this fiction is founded, has been supposed, by Dr. Darwin, and some of the physiological writers of Germany, as not of impossible occurrence” (Preface, paragraph 1) shape its meaning? Consider a second, competing reading.

    Sample answer: A careful double negative: not "possible," only "not impossible." Evidence that the book presents itself as grounded in real science.

28. [short · analysis · DOK 3] Analyze the word choice in “I passed the summer of 1816 in the environs of Geneva” (Preface, paragraph 4). Pick two words and explain what they suggest.

    Sample answer: Places the book in real time and place; compare with the 1831 Introduction's fuller account.

29. [short · synthesis · DOK 4] Synthesis: trace how creation and responsibility develops from an earlier chapter to “Preface”. Use one quotation from each.

    Sample answer: The Preface claims the story shows "the amiableness of domestic affection"; keep this phrase on the board. The novel will test it: domestic love is shown, then destroyed.

30. [mc · recall · DOK 1] What is the tone of the Preface?

    A. Romantic and lovesick

    B. Comic and mocking

    C. Angry and accusatory

    D. Measured and defensive of the book's seriousness

    Key: D (Measured and defensive of the book's seriousness)

31. [fill · recall · DOK 1] Complete the quotation from Preface, paragraph 1: “The event on which this fiction is founded, has been supposed, by Dr. Darwin, and some of the _____ writers of Germany, as not of

impossible occurrence”

Key: physiological

Rigor version	Items (in order)	Mix
Middle School	1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 6, 7, 8, 9, 10, 11, 12, 13, 14, 15, 16	recall 9, inference 4, analysis 2, synthesis 1
HS Freshman	2, 17, 18, 8, 19, 4, 1, 20, 12, 21, 13, 22, 15, 23, 24, 25	recall 8, inference 4, analysis 3, synthesis 1
HS Sophomore	8, 1, 17, 18, 6, 26, 22, 11, 13, 12, 21, 15, 24, 23, 27, 25	recall 6, inference 5, analysis 3, synthesis 2
HS Junior	8, 19, 5, 3, 4, 11, 21, 22, 13, 12, 28, 24, 15, 14, 16, 29	recall 5, inference 5, analysis 4, synthesis 2
HS Senior	2, 30, 5, 4, 13, 11, 10, 21, 12, 24, 15, 28, 23, 27, 29, 25	recall 4, inference 5, analysis 4, synthesis 3
AP	4, 18, 31, 10, 21, 22, 13, 24, 23, 14, 15, 28, 29, 16, 25, 27	recall 3, inference 4, analysis 5, synthesis 4
College Freshman	6, 5, 30, 10, 22, 11, 13, 24, 23, 15, 28, 14, 27, 25, 29, 16	recall 3, inference 4, analysis 5, synthesis 4
College Sophomore	6, 2, 13, 10, 12, 22, 21, 15, 28, 23, 24, 14, 27, 16, 29, 25	recall 2, inference 5, analysis 5, synthesis 4
College Junior	31, 5, 12, 13, 11, 10, 22, 23, 24, 14, 28, 15, 29, 16, 25, 27	recall 2, inference 5, analysis 5, synthesis 4
College Senior	3, 6, 12, 13, 11, 22, 21, 24, 15, 14, 28, 23, 27, 16, 29, 25	recall 2, inference 5, analysis 5, synthesis 4
Graduate / PhD	6, 2, 12, 21, 11, 13, 22, 28, 24, 23, 14, 15, 25, 29, 27, 16	recall 2, inference 5, analysis 5, synthesis 4

Writing prompts (eleven rigor levels)

Middle School (250 words; Indiana 2023: 7.RC.12, 7.W.1): Supported track (work from the passage your teacher selects). In “Preface,” how does Shelley show the author's stated purpose? Write a paragraph that states your claim, quotes two details from the passage, and explains how each detail supports your idea. Use the tone / mood you noticed as one piece of evidence.

HS Freshman (350 words; Indiana 2023: 9-10.RC.12, 9-10.W.1): In Preface, how does Shelley develop the idea of the author's stated purpose? State a clear claim, support it with two or three quotations, and explain how the tone / mood in the chapter helps build that idea.

HS Sophomore (450 words; Indiana 2023: 9-10.RC.12, 9-10.W.1): Analyze how Preface develops the idea of the author's stated purpose. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of tone / mood and theme shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.

HS Junior (550 words; Indiana 2023: 11-12.RC.3, 11-12.RC.1, 11-12.W.1): Analyze how the structure of Preface (where it begins, turns and ends) and its tone / mood shape the reader's understanding of the author's stated purpose. Identify one place where the text leaves matters uncertain and explain how that uncertainty adds to its meaning.

HS Senior (600 words; Indiana 2023: 11-12.RC.13, 11-12.W.1): Two readers disagree about what Preface suggests about the author's stated purpose. Lay out two plausible interpretations, weigh the evidence for each (including the chapter's tone / mood and theme), and argue for the stronger one in a sustained, well-organized essay.

AP (650 words; Indiana 2023: 11-12.RC.13, 11-12.W.1): Write a literary argument in which you analyze how Mary Shelley uses tone / mood in Preface to complicate the reader's understanding of the author's stated purpose. Develop a defensible thesis, select evidence purposefully, and explain how specific choices of diction and syntax create meaning.

College Freshman (1000 words; Indiana 2023: see unit standards): Situate Preface within its historical and literary context and argue how the chapter's treatment of the author's stated purpose responds to that context. Engage with at least one secondary perspective (a critic, historian or the author's own statements), integrate quotations smoothly, and cite in MLA style.

College Sophomore (1250 words; Indiana 2023: see unit standards): Read Preface alongside the conventions of its genre and period. Argue how the chapter's handling of the author's stated purpose follows or bends those conventions, using the tone / mood as evidence, and test your reading against one published critic. Document two secondary sources in MLA.

College Junior (1500 words; Indiana 2023: see unit standards): Apply a named critical approach (for example formalist, historicist, feminist, psychoanalytic or ecocritical) to Preface and its treatment of the author's stated purpose. State your method, show what it reveals in the chapter's tone / mood and theme, and identify where the text resists it.

College Senior (2000 words; Indiana 2023: see unit standards): Develop a research argument that reads Preface as evidence for a larger claim about the author's stated purpose in Frankenstein. Connect close reading of the chapter to the whole novel, engage at least four scholarly sources, and state precisely where your reading departs from theirs (Chicago style).

Graduate / PhD (2500 words; Indiana 2023: see unit standards): Develop an original argument that reads Preface as a hinge in the novel's larger treatment of the author's stated purpose. Position your reading within a named critical conversation (for example formalist, historicist, psychoanalytic, feminist or postcolonial approaches), account for the textual history where relevant, and articulate the stakes of your intervention for scholarship on Frankenstein.

SAT-style questions

1. *The event on which the interest of the story depends is exempt from the disadvantages of a mere tale of spectres or enchantment.*

   As used in the text, what does the word “spectres” most nearly mean?

   A. interlace by or as if by weaving

   B. ghosts

   C. a means to an end; not necessarily a principled or ethical one

   D. an event that happens

2. *The event on which this fiction is founded, has been supposed, by Dr. Darwin, and some of the physiological writers of Germany, as not of impossible occurrence. I shall not be supposed as according the remotest degree of serious faith to such an imagination; yet, in assuming it as the basis of a work of fancy, I have not considered myself as merely weaving a series of supernatural terrors. The event on which the interest of the story depends is exempt from the disadvantages of a mere tale of spectres or enchantment. It was recommended by the novelty of the situations which it develops; and, however impossible as a physical fact, affords a point of view to the imagination for the delineating of human passions more comprehensive and commanding than any which the ordinary relations of existing events can yield.*

Which choice best states a central concern of "Preface"?

A. A privileged childhood and family love

B. The first spark of obsession

C. Confrontation between creator and creation

D. The author's stated purpose

SAT key: 1. B (ghosts); 2. D (The author's stated purpose)

Lesson 4: Letter I

Focus: ambition and the hunger for discovery

Objective: Students will analyze how point of view develops in “Letter I” by writing a claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph that cites at least 2 quotations from the section, and will score at least 80% on the section quiz.

Standards: CCSS RL.9-10.6, W.9-10.1, L.9-10.4 · IN 9-10.RC.1, 9-10.W.1, 9-10.RC.9, 9-10.RC.11

Teacher only · spoilers

Robert Walton writes to his sister Margaret Saville from St. Petersburg. He is about to sail toward the North Pole, eager to discover a passage and the secret of the magnet, and he describes his self-education and longing for glory.

Background: Arctic exploration and the search for a Northwest Passage were major public dreams in the early 1800s. Letters were a popular novel form (the epistolary novel).

Significance: Walton is Victor's double: an ambitious man willing to risk others for discovery. The frame narrative invites readers to judge whether he will learn from Victor.

Lesson plan and lecture script (90 minutes)

0–8 min · Bell-ringer · You do (8 min)
Students write to the bell-ringer, then pair-share.
What do Walton's dreams of the North Pole reveal about his character? Write for five minutes. Starters: I think... because... / This connects to ambition and knowledge because....
Prompt: What do Walton's dreams of the North Pole reveal about his character?
Sentence starters: I think… because… · This connects to ambition and knowledge because…
Strong response: A strong response takes a position and anticipates this: Walton dreams of "a part of the world never before visited." The novel begins with a second Victor before we meet the first.

8–18 min · Vocabulary with etymology notes · I do (10 min)
Five key words in context, with verified word histories.
Today's words: enticement — something that tempts or attracts; fluctuate — to rise and fall; to change often; effusions — an unrestrained expression of emotion; satiate — fill to satisfaction; foretaste — an early limited awareness of something yet to occur. “enticement”: From Old French enticement. “fluctuate”: From Latin fluctuare "to move in waves," from fluctus "a wave," from fluere "to flow." “effusions”: Middle French effusion, from Latin effūsiō "outpouring". Displaced native Old English āgotennes. “foretaste”: From Middle English fortaste, equivalent to fore + taste.
Words: enticement: something that tempts or attracts · fluctuate: to rise and fall; to change often · effusions: an unrestrained expression of emotion · satiate: fill to satisfaction · foretaste: an early limited awareness of something yet to occur

18–28 min · Background and context · I do (10 min)
Mini-lecture (read or adapt the script).
Arctic exploration and the search for a Northwest Passage were major public dreams in the early 1800s. Letters were a popular novel form (the epistolary novel). Walton is Victor's double: an ambitious man willing to risk others for discovery. The frame narrative invites readers to judge whether he will learn from Victor. Point of view: The novel opens in letters from Robert Walton to his sister Margaret Saville. The epistolary form makes us readers of private letters and puts a listener (Margaret, and us) at the edge of the story. Characterization: Walton is ardent, self-educated and lonely; his ambition is described in the same glowing language Victor will use. Mark his superlatives. Setting: St. Petersburg and the far North: the cold, unknown pole stands for the limits of human knowledge. Watch for light and the pole: Walton imagines the pole as a land of light and warmth; the novel will reverse this into darkness and ice.

28–40 min · I do: modeled close reading · I do (12 min)
Model the close reading of the anchor quotation using the written think-aloud below.
I read the line once for meaning and once for craft. "You will rejoice to hear that no disaster has accompanied the commencement of an enterprise which you have regarded with such evil forebodings" (Letter I, paragraph 1). The first sentence already contains a warning (his sister's "evil forebodings"). Strong evidence for foreshadowing. That is point of view at work: The novel opens in letters from Robert Walton to his sister Margaret Saville. The epistolary form makes us readers of private letters and puts a listener (Margaret, and us) at the edge of the story.

> *You will rejoice to hear that no disaster has accompanied the commencement of an enterprise which you have regarded with such evil forebodings (Letter I, paragraph 1)*

Think-aloud: I read the line once for meaning and once for craft. "You will rejoice to hear that no disaster has accompanied the commencement of an enterprise which you have regarded with such evil forebodings" (Letter I, paragraph 1). The first sentence already contains a warning (his sister's "evil forebodings"). Strong evidence for foreshadowing. That is point of view at work: The novel opens in letters from Robert Walton to his sister Margaret Saville. The epistolary form makes us readers of private letters and puts a listener (Margaret, and us) at the edge of the story.

40–55 min · We do: guided annotation · We do (15 min)
Guided analysis of a second quotation; expected answers given.
Ask: What words in this line stand out, and what do they suggest? Expected: "Satiate" makes curiosity sound like hunger; "ardent" means burning. Together they suggest an appetite that could consume him, linking to the theme of ambition. Ask: How does this line connect to ambition and knowledge? Expected: Walton dreams of "a part of the world never before visited." The novel begins with a second Victor before we meet the first. ("Satiate" (fully satisfy) and "ardent" reveal appetite-like ambition. Use for a claim about the dangers of curiosity.)

> *I shall satiate my ardent curiosity with the sight of a part of the world never before visited (Letter I, paragraph 2)*

Ask: What words in this line stand out, and what do they suggest?
Expected answer: "Satiate" makes curiosity sound like hunger; "ardent" means burning. Together they suggest an appetite that could consume him, linking to the theme of ambition.
Ask: How does this line connect to ambition and knowledge?
Expected answer: Walton dreams of "a part of the world never before visited." The novel begins with a second Victor before we meet the first. ("Satiate" (fully satisfy) and "ardent" reveal appetite-like ambition. Use for a claim about the dangers of curiosity.)

55–70 min · You do: independent annotation · You do (15 min)
Independent annotation and a claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph (exemplar given).
Annotate the chapter for point of view, characterization (three marks with a margin note each), then write one claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph: what does this chapter suggest about ambition and the hunger for discovery? Then start your writing prompt at your assigned level (HS Sophomore: Analyze how Letter I develops the idea of ambition and the hunger for discovery. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of point of view and foreshadowing shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.) Exemplar: Walton is introduced as a mirror for Victor, so the novel's warning about ambition begins before Victor appears. When the text says "I shall satiate my ardent curiosity with the sight of a part of the world never before visited" (Letter I, paragraph 2), it shows this directly. His dream of a land "never before visited" and his heart that glows with enthusiasm use the same fevered vocabulary Victor will use about creating life, which invites readers to compare the two men.
Task: Annotate the chapter for point of view, characterization (three marks with a margin note each), then write one claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph: what does this chapter suggest about ambition and the hunger for discovery? Then start your writing prompt at your assigned level (HS Sophomore: Analyze how Letter I develops the idea of ambition and the hunger for discovery. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of point of view and foreshadowing shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.)
Exemplar: Walton is introduced as a mirror for Victor, so the novel's warning about ambition begins before Victor appears. When the text says "I shall satiate my ardent curiosity with the sight of a part of the world never before visited" (Letter I, paragraph 2), it shows this directly. His dream of a land "never before visited" and his heart that glows with enthusiasm use the same fevered vocabulary Victor will use about creating life, which invites readers to compare the two men.

70–80 min · Discussion · We do (10 min)
Structured discussion from the 30 tiered questions, with facilitation notes.
Anchor question: What do Walton's dreams of the North Pole reveal about his character? Some students will admire Walton. Let them; then ask what his sister's "evil forebodings" are for.
Anchor question: What do Walton's dreams of the North Pole reveal about his character?
Facilitation: Some students will admire Walton. Let them; then ask what his sister's "evil forebodings" are for.

80–87 min · Exit ticket / chapter quiz · You do (7 min)
Chapter quiz in the app and an exit ticket (answer given).
Chapter quiz in the app, then: In one sentence, what does this chapter suggest about ambition and the hunger for discovery? Support it with one short quotation. Model answer: Walton is introduced as a mirror for Victor, so the novel's warning about ambition begins before Victor appears. ("I shall satiate my ardent curiosity with the sight of a part of the world never before visited", Letter I, paragraph 2). Accept any defensible claim backed by a quotation from the chapter; the answer key for the quiz is in the Quiz section.
Exit ticket: In one sentence, what does this chapter suggest about ambition and the hunger for discovery? Support it with one short quotation.
Answer: Model answer: Walton is introduced as a mirror for Victor, so the novel's warning about ambition begins before Victor appears. ("I shall satiate my ardent curiosity with the sight of a part of the world never before visited", Letter I, paragraph 2). Accept any defensible claim backed by a quotation from the chapter; the answer key for the quiz is in the Quiz section.

87–90 min · Closure · I do (3 min)
Summarize the lesson and preview the next reading.
Today we saw how point of view shapes ambition and the hunger for discovery. Key takeaway: Walton dreams of "a part of the world never before visited." The novel begins with a second Victor before we meet the first.

Total: 90 minutes.

Teacher analysis (spoilers)

Literary elements

- **Point of view:** The novel opens in letters from Robert Walton to his sister Margaret Saville. The epistolary form makes us readers of private letters and puts a listener (Margaret, and us) at the edge of the story.
- **Characterization:** Walton is ardent, self-educated and lonely; his ambition is described in the same glowing language Victor will use. Mark his superlatives.
- **Setting:** St. Petersburg and the far North: the cold, unknown pole stands for the limits of human knowledge.

Themes and how they develop

- **ambition and knowledge:** Walton dreams of "a part of the world never before visited." The novel begins with a second Victor before we meet the first.

Symbols and motifs

- **light and the pole:** Walton imagines the pole as a land of light and warmth; the novel will reverse this into darkness and ice.

Key quotations (checked against the reading text)

- "You will rejoice to hear that no disaster has accompanied the commencement of an enterprise which you have regarded with such evil forebodings" (Letter I, paragraph 1) The first sentence already contains a warning (his sister's "evil forebodings"). Strong evidence for foreshadowing.
- "I shall satiate my ardent curiosity with the sight of a part of the world never before visited" (Letter I, paragraph 2) "Satiate" (fully satisfy) and "ardent" reveal appetite-like ambition. Use for a claim about the dangers of curiosity.
- "I feel my heart glow with an enthusiasm which elevates me to heaven" (Letter I, paragraph 3) Religious, heightened language for exploration; compare later with Victor's rapture.

Model claim-evidence-reasoning

Claim: Walton is introduced as a mirror for Victor, so the novel's warning about ambition begins before Victor appears.
Evidence: "I shall satiate my ardent curiosity with the sight of a part of the world never before visited" (Letter I, paragraph 2)
Reasoning: His dream of a land "never before visited" and his heart that glows with enthusiasm use the same fevered vocabulary Victor will use about creating life, which invites readers to compare the two men.

Vocabulary with etymology notes

Word	Definition (in this sentence)	In context	Word history
enticement (noun)	something that tempts or attracts	*My life might have been passed in ease and luxury; but I preferred glory to every enticement that wealth placed in my path.*	"enticement": From Old French enticement. (Wiktionary, https://en.wiktionary.org/wiki/enticement#Etymology)
fluctuate (verb)	to rise and fall; to change often	*My courage and my resolution is firm; but my hopes fluctuate, and my spirits are often depressed.*	"fluctuate": From Latin fluctuare "to move in waves," from fluctus "a wave," from fluere "to flow." (Online Etymology Dictionary, https://www.etymonline.com/word/fluctuate)
effusions (noun)	an unrestrained expression of emotion	*These visions faded when I perused, for the first time, those poets whose effusions entranced my soul, and lifted it to heaven.*	"effusions": Middle French effusion, from Latin effūsiō "outpouring". Displaced native Old English āgotennes. (Wiktionary, https://en.wiktionary.org/wiki/effusion#Etymology)
satiate (verb)	fill to satisfaction	*I shall satiate my ardent curiosity with the sight of a part of the*	

		world never before visited, and may tread a land never before imprinted by the foot of man.	
foretaste (noun)	an early limited awareness of something yet to occur	*This breeze, which has travelled from the regions towards which I am advancing, gives me a foretaste of those icy climes.*	“foretaste”: From Middle English fortaste, equivalent to fore + taste. (Wiktionary, https://en.wiktionary.org/wiki/foretaste#Etymology)
entranced (verb)	attract; cause to be enamored	*These visions faded when I perused, for the first time, those poets whose effusions entranced my soul, and lifted it to heaven.*	“entranced”: From Middle French entrance "entry". Replaced native Middle English ingang "entrance, admission", from Old English ingang "ingress, entry, entrance". (Wiktionary, https://en.wiktionary.org/wiki/entrance#Etymology)
diffusing (verb)	spreading out	*There, Margaret, the sun is forever visible; its broad disk just skirting the horizon, and diffusing a perpetual splendour.*	“diffusing”: From Middle French diffuser, from Latin diffūsus, past participle of diffundere, from dis- + fundere. (Wiktionary, https://en.wiktionary.org/wiki/diffuse#Etymology)
sledges (noun)	a vehicle mounted on runners and pulled by horses or dogs; for transportation over snow	*They fly quickly over the snow in their sledges; the motion is pleasant, and, in my opinion, far more agreeable than that of an English stagecoach.*	
seafaring (adjective)	used on the high seas	*These volumes were my study day and night, and my familiarity with them increased that regret which I had felt, as a child, on learning that my father’s dying injunction had forbidden my uncle to allow me to embark in a seafaring life.*	
forebodings (noun)	a feeling of evil to come	*You will rejoice to hear that no disaster has accompanied the commencement of an enterprise which you have regarded with such evil forebodings.*	

Discussion questions

1. What do Walton's dreams of the North Pole reveal about his character?
2. Where does point of view appear in this chapter, and what effect does it have? Point to one passage.

3. How does this chapter connect to the book's larger concern with isolation and the need for companionship?

Classroom discussion questions (30, tiered)

Wait time after every question (3 s for DOK 1, 5 s for DOK 2, 8 to 10 s for DOK 3 and 4); think-pair-share on DOK 3 and 4; answer each response with a follow-up probe; close with student-generated questions. Focus sets by rigor level: Middle School: 1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 6, 11, 12, 13, 14, 21, 22; HS Freshman: 1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 12, 13, 14, 15, 22, 23, 24; HS Sophomore: 1, 2, 3, 4, 13, 14, 15, 16, 17, 23, 24, 25; HS Junior: 1, 2, 3, 14, 15, 16, 17, 18, 24, 25, 26, 27; HS Senior: 1, 2, 3, 15, 16, 17, 18, 25, 26, 27, 28, 29; AP: 1, 2, 16, 17, 18, 19, 20, 26, 27, 28, 29, 30; College Freshman: 1, 2, 17, 18, 19, 20, 21, 22, 27, 28, 29, 30; College Sophomore: 1, 2, 11, 18, 19, 20, 21, 22, 23, 28, 29, 30; College Junior: 1, 11, 12, 19, 20, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 29, 30; College Senior: 1, 11, 12, 13, 20, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 26, 30; Graduate / PhD: 1, 11, 12, 13, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 26, 27, 28

Literal / recall

1. To whom is Walton writing? [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · 7.RC.1, 7.CC.1, 9-10.RC.1] Look for: His sister, Margaret Saville
2. Where is Walton when he writes the first letter? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · 7.RC.1, 7.CC.1, 9-10.RC.1] Look for: St. Petersburg
3. What does Walton hope to discover? [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · 7.RC.1, 7.CC.1, 9-10.RC.1] Look for: A passage near the pole and the secret of the magnet
4. How did Walton educate himself as a boy? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · 7.RC.1, 7.CC.1, 9-10.RC.1] Look for: Reading his uncle's library of voyages
5. What does Walton's ambition foreshadow? [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · 7.RC.1, 7.CC.1, 9-10.RC.1] Look for: Victor's own dangerous pursuit of knowledge
6. Retell the three most important events of “Letter I” in order, in one sentence each. [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · 7.RC.1, 7.CC.1, 9-10.RC.1] Look for: Robert Walton writes to his sister Margaret Saville from St. Petersburg. He is about to sail toward the North Pole, eager to discover a passage and the secret of the magnet, and he describes his self-education and longing for glory.
7. Which characters appear or are mentioned in “Letter I”? Name two and one thing each says or does. [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · 7.RC.1, 7.CC.1, 9-10.RC.1] Look for: Names and actions taken from the chapter; check against the teacher summary.
8. Where and when does “Letter I” take place? Point to the line that tells you. [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · 7.RC.1, 7.CC.1, 9-10.RC.1] Look for: A place/time detail quoted from the chapter.
9. Reread: “My life might have been passed in ease and luxury; but I preferred glory to every enticement that wealth placed in my path.” What does “enticement” mean here, and what is literally happening in this line? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · 7.RC.1, 7.CC.1, 9-10.RC.1] Look for: enticement: something that tempts or attracts.
10. Reread: “My courage and my resolution is firm; but my hopes fluctuate, and my spirits are often depressed.” What does “fluctuate” mean here, and what is literally happening in this line? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · 7.RC.1, 7.CC.1, 9-10.RC.1] Look for: fluctuate: to rise and fall; to change often.

Inferential / analytical

1. What does “Letter I” suggest about ambition and the hunger for discovery? State the inference and the line that supports it. [DOK 2 · thinkPairShare · wait 5 s · 7.RC.2, 7.CC.2, 9-10.RC.2] Look for: Walton is Victor's double: an

ambitious man willing to risk others for discovery. The frame narrative invites readers to judge whether he will learn from Victor.

2. Find one example of point of view in this chapter. What does it reveal that a plain statement would not? [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · 7.RC.1, 7.CC.2, 9-10.RC.1] Look for: Look for who is telling the story and what that narrator can and cannot know.
3. How does the foreshadowing in this chapter shape what we understand about ambition and the hunger for discovery? [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · 7.RC.3, 7.CC.2, 9-10.RC.3] Look for: Look for hints, warnings or images that point to later events.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Walton is introduced as a mirror for Victor, so the novel's warning about ambition begins before Victor appears. Useful evidence: “You will rejoice to hear that no disaster has accompanied the commencement of an enterprise which you have regarded with such evil forebodings” (Letter I, paragraph 1): The first sentence already contains a warning (his sister's "evil forebodings"). Strong evidence for foreshadowing. Theme link: Walton dreams of "a part of the world never before visited." The novel begins with a second Victor before we meet the first. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
4. In the passage that begins “You will rejoice to hear that no disaster has accompanied the commencement of an enterprise which you have regarded with such evil forebodings.”, why might Shelley have chosen these particular words? Pick two and explain their connotations. [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · 7.RC.12, 7.CC.2, 9-10.RC.12] Look for: Diction analysis of two words in the anchor passage.
5. What causes the main turn in “Letter I”, and what effect is it likely to have on what follows? [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · 7.RC.3, 7.CC.2, 9-10.RC.1] Look for: Robert Walton writes to his sister Margaret Saville from St. Petersburg. He is about to sail toward the North Pole, eager to discover a passage and the secret of the magnet, and he describes his self-education and longing for glory.
6. How does “Letter I” build on “Preface”? Name one link of cause and effect. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · 7.RC.3, 7.CC.2, 9-10.RC.3] Look for: A causal or structural link between this and the previous chapter.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Walton is introduced as a mirror for Victor, so the novel's warning about ambition begins before Victor appears. Useful evidence: “I shall satiate my ardent curiosity with the sight of a part of the world never before visited” (Letter I, paragraph 2): "Satiate" (fully satisfy) and "ardent" reveal appetite-like ambition. Use for a claim about the dangers of curiosity. Theme link: Walton dreams of "a part of the world never before visited." The novel begins with a second Victor before we meet the first. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
7. What can we infer about a character's motives from what they say and do here, as opposed to what they claim? [DOK 3 · followUp · wait 8 s · 7.RC.3, 7.CC.2, 9-10.RC.1] Look for: An inference about motive supported by a quoted line.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Walton is introduced as a mirror for Victor, so the novel's warning about ambition begins before Victor appears. Useful evidence: “I feel my heart glow with an enthusiasm which elevates me to heaven” (Letter I, paragraph 3): Religious, heightened language for exploration; compare later with Victor's rapture. On characterization: Walton is ardent, self-educated and lonely; his ambition is described in the same glowing language Victor will use. Mark his superlatives. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

8. The bell-ringer asked: “What do Walton's dreams of the North Pole reveal about his character?” Now that we have read closely, how would you revise your first answer, and which line changed your mind? [DOK 2 · thinkPairShare · wait 5 s · 7.RC.2, 7.CC.2, 9-10.RC.2] Look for: A revised answer anchored in the text.
9. Where does characterization appear, and how does it connect this chapter to the larger concern with isolation and the need for companionship? [DOK 3 · followUp · wait 8 s · 7.RC.3, 7.CC.2, 9-10.RC.1] Look for: Look for what characters say, do and think, and how others react to them.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Walton is introduced as a mirror for Victor, so the novel's warning about ambition begins before Victor appears. Useful evidence: “You will rejoice to hear that no disaster has accompanied the commencement of an enterprise which you have regarded with such evil forebodings” (Letter I, paragraph 1): The first sentence already contains a warning (his sister's "evil forebodings"). Strong evidence for foreshadowing. On characterization: Walton is ardent, self-educated and lonely; his ambition is described in the same glowing language Victor will use. Mark his superlatives. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
10. Background: Arctic exploration and the search for a Northwest Passage were major public dreams in the early 1800s. Letters were a popular novel form (the epistolary novel). How does knowing this change the way you read one moment in the chapter? [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · 7.RC.3, 7.CC.2, 9-10.RC.1] Look for: A specific moment reread in light of the context.
    Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Walton is introduced as a mirror for Victor, so the novel's warning about ambition begins before Victor appears. Useful evidence: “I shall satiate my ardent curiosity with the sight of a part of the world never before visited” (Letter I, paragraph 2): "Satiate" (fully satisfy) and "ardent" reveal appetite-like ambition. Use for a claim about the dangers of curiosity. On setting: St. Petersburg and the far North: the cold, unknown pole stands for the limits of human knowledge. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

Evaluative / synthesis / creative

1. A critic might argue: “Walton is Victor's double: an ambitious man willing to risk others for discovery. The frame narrative invites readers to judge whether he will learn from Victor.” How far do you agree? Take a stand and defend it with two lines from the chapter. [DOK 3 · fourCorners · wait 8 s · 7.RC.2, 7.CC.3, 9-10.RC.2] Look for: A defended position with evidence and one counterpoint.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Walton is introduced as a mirror for Victor, so the novel's warning about ambition begins before Victor appears. Useful evidence: “I feel my heart glow with an enthusiasm which elevates me to heaven” (Letter I, paragraph 3): Religious, heightened language for exploration; compare later with Victor's rapture. Theme link: Walton dreams of "a part of the world never before visited." The novel begins with a second Victor before we meet the first. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
2. Which character in this chapter acts most wisely, and which least? Judge them by a standard you name. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · 7.RC.3, 7.CC.3, 9-10.RC.1] Look for: An evaluation using an explicit criterion and evidence.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Walton is introduced as a mirror for Victor, so the novel's warning about ambition begins before Victor appears. Useful evidence: “You will rejoice to hear that no disaster has accompanied the commencement of an enterprise which you have regarded with such

evil forebodings" (Letter I, paragraph 1): The first sentence already contains a warning (his sister's "evil forebodings"). Strong evidence for foreshadowing. On characterization: Walton is ardent, self-educated and lonely; his ambition is described in the same glowing language Victor will use. Mark his superlatives. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

3. Rewrite one moment of "Letter I" from the point of view of a different character. What does the new angle reveal or hide about ambition and the hunger for discovery? [DOK 4 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · 7.RC.1, 7.CC.3, 9-10.RC.1] Look for: A creative product with a rationale tied to the text.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Walton is introduced as a mirror for Victor, so the novel's warning about ambition begins before Victor appears. Useful evidence: "I shall satiate my ardent curiosity with the sight of a part of the world never before visited" (Letter I, paragraph 2): "Satiate" (fully satisfy) and "ardent" reveal appetite-like ambition. Use for a claim about the dangers of curiosity. On point of view: The novel opens in letters from Robert Walton to his sister Margaret Saville. The epistolary form makes us readers of private letters and puts a listener (Margaret, and us) at the edge of the story. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

4. Write three questions of your own about "Letter I": one recall, one "why/how", and one "should/what if". Trade with a partner and answer theirs. [DOK 3 · studentGenerated · wait 8 s · 7.RC.2, 7.CC.3, 9-10.RC.2] Look for: Student-generated questions at three levels.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Walton is introduced as a mirror for Victor, so the novel's warning about ambition begins before Victor appears. Useful evidence: "I feel my heart glow with an enthusiasm which elevates me to heaven" (Letter I, paragraph 3): Religious, heightened language for exploration; compare later with Victor's rapture. Theme link: Walton dreams of "a part of the world never before visited." The novel begins with a second Victor before we meet the first. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

5. Connect this chapter to nature versus nurture: is the link strong or weak so far? What would Shelley need to show next to strengthen it? [DOK 4 · socraticCircle · wait 8 s · 7.RC.2, 7.CC.3, 9-10.RC.2] Look for: A judgment of thematic development across the work.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Walton is introduced as a mirror for Victor, so the novel's warning about ambition begins before Victor appears. Useful evidence: "You will rejoice to hear that no disaster has accompanied the commencement of an enterprise which you have regarded with such evil forebodings" (Letter I, paragraph 1): The first sentence already contains a warning (his sister's "evil forebodings"). Strong evidence for foreshadowing. Theme link: Walton dreams of "a part of the world never before visited." The novel begins with a second Victor before we meet the first. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

6. Is the point of view in this chapter effective, or does it feel heavy-handed? Evaluate it as a reader would in a review. [DOK 3 · fourCorners · wait 8 s · 7.RC.1, 7.CC.3, 9-10.RC.1] Look for: An evaluative judgment with criteria and evidence.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Walton is introduced as a mirror for Victor, so the novel's warning about ambition begins before Victor appears. Useful evidence: "I shall satiate my ardent curiosity with the sight of a part of the world never before visited" (Letter I, paragraph 2): "Satiate" (fully satisfy) and "ardent" reveal appetite-like ambition. Use for a claim about the dangers of curiosity. On point

of view: The novel opens in letters from Robert Walton to his sister Margaret Saville. The epistolary form makes us readers of private letters and puts a listener (Margaret, and us) at the edge of the story. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

7. Compare how “Letter I” treats ambition and the hunger for discovery with how another text, film or event you know treats a similar idea. What does Frankenstein see that the other misses? [DOK 4 · socraticCircle · wait 8 s · 7.RC.2, 7.CC.3, 9-10.RC.2] Look for: A cross-text synthesis.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Walton is introduced as a mirror for Victor, so the novel's warning about ambition begins before Victor appears. Useful evidence: “I feel my heart glow with an enthusiasm which elevates me to heaven” (Letter I, paragraph 3): Religious, heightened language for exploration; compare later with Victor's rapture. Theme link: Walton dreams of "a part of the world never before visited." The novel begins with a second Victor before we meet the first. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

8. Predict what “Letter II” will bring, using two clues from this chapter. After reading, evaluate your prediction. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · 7.RC.3, 7.CC.3, 9-10.RC.3] Look for: A prediction or judgment justified with textual clues.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Walton is introduced as a mirror for Victor, so the novel's warning about ambition begins before Victor appears. Useful evidence: “You will rejoice to hear that no disaster has accompanied the commencement of an enterprise which you have regarded with such evil forebodings” (Letter I, paragraph 1): The first sentence already contains a warning (his sister's "evil forebodings"). Strong evidence for foreshadowing. Theme link: Walton dreams of "a part of the world never before visited." The novel begins with a second Victor before we meet the first. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

9. Design a one-paragraph modern adaptation of this chapter (setting, characters, conflict). What must stay the same for it to still be about ambition and the hunger for discovery? [DOK 4 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · 7.RC.2, 7.CC.3, 9-10.RC.2] Look for: A creative transfer that keeps the core idea.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Walton is introduced as a mirror for Victor, so the novel's warning about ambition begins before Victor appears. Useful evidence: “I shall satiate my ardent curiosity with the sight of a part of the world never before visited” (Letter I, paragraph 2): "Satiate" (fully satisfy) and "ardent" reveal appetite-like ambition. Use for a claim about the dangers of curiosity. Theme link: Walton dreams of "a part of the world never before visited." The novel begins with a second Victor before we meet the first. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

10. What question would you most like to ask Mary Shelley about this chapter, and what answer do you think the text itself gives? [DOK 4 · studentGenerated · wait 8 s · 7.RC.2, 7.CC.3, 9-10.RC.2] Look for: A student-generated question answered from evidence.

    Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Walton is introduced as a mirror for Victor, so the novel's warning about ambition begins before Victor appears. Useful evidence: “I feel my heart glow with an enthusiasm which elevates me to heaven” (Letter I, paragraph 3): Religious, heightened language for exploration; compare later with Victor's rapture. Theme link: Walton dreams of "a part of the world never before visited." The novel begins with a second Victor before we meet the first. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

Annotation focus

- **Point of view:** look for who is telling the story and what that narrator can and cannot know (anchor passage in the We do segment)
- Also notice **Foreshadowing**: hints, warnings or images that point to later events
- Also notice **Characterization**: what characters say, do and think, and how others react to them

Chapter quiz: item bank (all eleven rigor versions)

1. [mc · recall · DOK 1] In the line "My life might have been passed in ease and luxury; but I preferred glory to every enticement that wealth placed in my path.", what does "enticement" most nearly mean?

   A. express strong disapproval of; deplore

   B. an encroachment or intrusion

   C. something that tempts or attracts

   D. dip a foot or hand briefly into a liquid

   Key: C (something that tempts or attracts)

2. [fill · recall · DOK 1] Complete the quotation from Letter I, paragraph 3: "I feel my heart glow with an _____ which elevates me to heaven"

   Key: enthusiasm

3. [fill · recall · DOK 1] Fill in the blank with the vocabulary word that fits: "This breeze, which has travelled from the regions towards which I am advancing, gives me a _____ of those icy climes." Word bank: enticement, foretaste, effusions, fluctuate

   Key: foretaste

4. [fill · recall · DOK 1] Fill in the blank with the vocabulary word that fits: "There, Margaret, the sun is forever visible; its broad disk just skirting the horizon, and _____ a perpetual splendour." Word bank: effusions, fluctuate, diffusing, enticement

   Key: diffusing

5. [mc · recall · DOK 1] In the line "My courage and my resolution is firm; but my hopes fluctuate, and my spirits are often depressed.", what does "fluctuate" most nearly mean?

   A. showing someone the truth; freeing from a false belief

   B. to cut apart in order to examine closely

   C. poorly educated; unable to read well

   D. to rise and fall; to change often

   Key: D (to rise and fall; to change often)

6. [fill · recall · DOK 1] Complete the quotation from Letter I, paragraph 1: "You will rejoice to hear that no disaster has accompanied the _____ of an enterprise which you have regarded with such evil forebodings"

   Key: commencement

7. [mc · recall · DOK 1] In the line "I shall satiate my ardent curiosity with the sight of a part of the world never before visited, and may tread a land never before imprinted by the foot of man.", what does "satiate" most nearly mean?

   A. brought back to life or strength; revived

   B. take in, also metaphorically

C. make one's home in a particular place or community

D. fill to satisfaction

Key: D (fill to satisfaction)

8. [mc · recall · DOK 1] In the line “These visions faded when I perused, for the first time, those poets whose effusions entranced my soul, and lifted it to heaven.”, what does “effusions” most nearly mean?

   A. careful and persistent

   B. a heat-resistant container used for melting substances

   C. makes disappear; scatters

   D. an unrestrained expression of emotion

   Key: D (an unrestrained expression of emotion)

9. [fill · recall · DOK 1] Fill in the blank with the vocabulary word that fits: “These visions faded when I perused, for the first time, those poets whose effusions _____ my soul, and lifted it to heaven.” Word bank: entranced, fluctuate, enticement, effusions

   Key: entranced

10. [mc · inference · DOK 2] Which choice best states a central concern of “Letter I”?

    A. Injustice and exile

    B. Loneliness and the desire for a friend

    C. Confidence before danger

    D. Ambition and the hunger for discovery

    Key: D (Ambition and the hunger for discovery)

11. [short · inference · DOK 2] What can you infer from this line? “I shall satiate my ardent curiosity with the sight of a part of the world never before visited” (Letter I, paragraph 2) Answer in two or three sentences with one detail.

    Sample answer: "Satiate" (fully satisfy) and "ardent" reveal appetite-like ambition. Use for a claim about the dangers of curiosity.

12. [mc · inference · DOK 2] What does this passage most clearly show? “You will rejoice to hear that no disaster has accompanied the commencement of an enterprise which you have regarded with such evil forebodings” (Letter I, paragraph 1)

    A. Revulsion at his labor.

    B. The ending: ambiguous death.

    C. Psychological insight into grief and guilt.

    D. The first sentence already contains a warning (his sister's "evil forebodings"). Strong evidence for foreshadowing.

    Key: D (The first sentence already contains a warning (his sister's "evil forebodings"). Strong evidence for foreshadowing.)

13. [short · inference · DOK 2] What can you infer from this line? “You will rejoice to hear that no disaster has accompanied the commencement of an enterprise which you have regarded with such evil forebodings” (Letter I, paragraph 1) Answer in two or three sentences with one detail.

    Sample answer: The first sentence already contains a warning (his sister's "evil forebodings"). Strong evidence for foreshadowing.

14. [short · analysis · DOK 3] Analyze the word choice in “I feel my heart glow with an enthusiasm which elevates me to heaven” (Letter I, paragraph 3). Pick two words and explain what they suggest.
    Sample answer: Religious, heightened language for exploration; compare later with Victor's rapture.
15. [short · analysis · DOK 3] Claim: Walton is introduced as a mirror for Victor, so the novel's warning about ambition begins before Victor appears. Explain how this evidence supports the claim: “I shall satiate my ardent curiosity with the sight of a part of the world never before visited” (Letter I, paragraph 2).
    Sample answer: His dream of a land "never before visited" and his heart that glows with enthusiasm use the same fevered vocabulary Victor will use about creating life, which invites readers to compare the two men.
16. [short · synthesis · DOK 4] Synthesis: trace how ambition and knowledge develops from an earlier chapter to “Letter I”. Use one quotation from each.
    Sample answer: Walton dreams of "a part of the world never before visited." The novel begins with a second Victor before we meet the first.
17. [mc · recall · DOK 1] To whom is Walton writing?
    A. A ship's captain
    B. Victor Frankenstein
    C. His father
    D. His sister, Margaret Saville

    Key: D (His sister, Margaret Saville)
18. [mc · recall · DOK 1] What does Walton's ambition foreshadow?
    A. Victor's own dangerous pursuit of knowledge
    B. His return home rich
    C. A happy marriage
    D. A war with Russia

    Key: A (Victor's own dangerous pursuit of knowledge)
19. [mc · recall · DOK 1] What does Walton hope to discover?
    A. Gold in Siberia
    B. A lost city
    C. A cure for disease
    D. A passage near the pole and the secret of the magnet

    Key: D (A passage near the pole and the secret of the magnet)
20. [mc · inference · DOK 2] What does this passage most clearly show? “I shall satiate my ardent curiosity with the sight of a part of the world never before visited” (Letter I, paragraph 2)
    A. "Satiate" (fully satisfy) and "ardent" reveal appetite-like ambition. Use for a claim about the dangers of curiosity.
    B. Repetition of the threat.
    C. Victor's lesson; partly retracted.
    D. Elizabeth's honest question.

    Key: A ("Satiate" (fully satisfy) and "ardent" reveal appetite-like ambition. Use for a claim about the dangers of curiosity.)

21. [mc · analysis · DOK 3] Which literary element does this describe in “Letter I”? Walton is ardent, self-educated and lonely; his ambition is described in the same glowing language Victor will use. Mark his superlatives.
    A. Conflict
    B. Hyperbole
    C. Characterization
    D. Metaphor

    Key: C (Characterization)

22. [fill · recall · DOK 1] Fill in the blank with the vocabulary word that fits: “They fly quickly over the snow in their _____; the motion is pleasant, and, in my opinion, far more agreeable than that of an English stagecoach.” Word bank: sledges, effusions, fluctuate, enticement

    Key: sledges

23. [mc · recall · DOK 1] How did Walton educate himself as a boy?
    A. Working in a laboratory
    B. Studying law
    C. Attending university in Paris
    D. Reading his uncle's library of voyages

    Key: D (Reading his uncle's library of voyages)

24. [mc · inference · DOK 2] What does this passage most clearly show? “I feel my heart glow with an enthusiasm which elevates me to heaven” (Letter I, paragraph 3)
    A. An allusion that promises he will not offend against nature; readers who know Coleridge sense danger.
    B. The creature curses his own birth, echoing Job.
    C. Self-blame.
    D. Religious, heightened language for exploration; compare later with Victor's rapture.

    Key: D (Religious, heightened language for exploration; compare later with Victor's rapture.)

25. [mc · analysis · DOK 3] Which literary element does this describe in “Letter I”? The novel opens in letters from Robert Walton to his sister Margaret Saville. The epistolary form makes us readers of private letters and puts a listener (Margaret, and us) at the edge of the story.
    A. Imagery
    B. Point of view
    C. Foreshadowing
    D. Theme

    Key: B (Point of view)

26. [short · synthesis · DOK 4] Close reading: how do the diction and syntax of “You will rejoice to hear that no disaster has accompanied the commencement of an enterprise which you have regarded with such evil forebodings” (Letter I, paragraph 1) shape its meaning? Consider a second, competing reading.

    Sample answer: The first sentence already contains a warning (his sister's "evil forebodings"). Strong evidence for foreshadowing.

27. [short · synthesis · DOK 4] Evaluate this claim about the chapter: “Walton is introduced as a mirror for Victor, so the novel's warning about ambition begins before Victor appears.” Is it fully persuasive? Argue with evidence, including a passage that complicates it.

Sample answer: His dream of a land "never before visited" and his heart that glows with enthusiasm use the same fevered vocabulary Victor will use about creating life, which invites readers to compare the two men.

28. [fill · recall · DOK 1] Complete the quotation from Letter I, paragraph 2: "I shall satiate my ardent _____ with the sight of a part of the world never before visited"
    Key: curiosity
29. [short · synthesis · DOK 4] Close reading: how do the diction and syntax of "I shall satiate my ardent curiosity with the sight of a part of the world never before visited" (Letter I, paragraph 2) shape its meaning? Consider a second, competing reading.
    Sample answer: "Satiate" (fully satisfy) and "ardent" reveal appetite-like ambition. Use for a claim about the dangers of curiosity.

Rigor version	Items (in order)	Mix
Middle School	1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 6, 7, 8, 9, 10, 11, 12, 13, 14, 15, 16	recall 9, inference 4, analysis 2, synthesis 1
HS Freshman	17, 7, 18, 2, 19, 8, 3, 6, 10, 12, 13, 20, 14, 21, 15, 16	recall 8, inference 4, analysis 3, synthesis 1
HS Sophomore	4, 9, 5, 22, 18, 23, 10, 11, 13, 24, 20, 25, 15, 14, 26, 16	recall 6, inference 5, analysis 3, synthesis 2
HS Junior	18, 6, 23, 19, 22, 10, 13, 11, 12, 24, 14, 15, 21, 25, 16, 27	recall 5, inference 5, analysis 4, synthesis 2
HS Senior	19, 22, 7, 28, 20, 12, 24, 11, 10, 25, 15, 14, 21, 16, 27, 29	recall 4, inference 5, analysis 4, synthesis 3
AP	4, 3, 17, 11, 24, 10, 12, 20, 21, 15, 25, 14, 16, 29, 27, 26	recall 3, inference 5, analysis 4, synthesis 4
College Freshman	3, 5, 6, 12, 13, 20, 10, 11, 14, 21, 25, 15, 16, 27, 29, 26	recall 3, inference 5, analysis 4, synthesis 4
College Sophomore	9, 2, 24, 20, 10, 12, 11, 13, 25, 14, 21, 15, 26, 27, 29, 16	recall 2, inference 6, analysis 4, synthesis 4
College Junior	22, 3, 20, 13, 24, 11, 12, 10, 14, 25, 15, 21, 16, 29, 26, 27	recall 2, inference 6, analysis 4, synthesis 4
College Senior	9, 3, 24, 10, 12, 13, 20, 11, 25, 15, 21, 14, 29, 16, 26, 27	recall 2, inference 6, analysis 4, synthesis 4
Graduate / PhD	3, 2, 24, 20, 11, 13, 12, 10, 21, 25, 15, 14, 26, 16, 27, 29	recall 2, inference 6, analysis 4, synthesis 4

Writing prompts (eleven rigor levels)

Middle School (250 words; Indiana 2023: 7.RC.1, 7.W.1): Supported track (work from the passage your teacher selects). In "Letter I," how does Shelley show ambition and the hunger for discovery? Write a paragraph that states your claim, quotes two details from the passage, and explains how each detail supports your idea. Use the point of view you noticed as one piece of evidence.

HS Freshman (350 words; Indiana 2023: 9-10.RC.1, 9-10.W.1): In Letter I, how does Shelley develop the idea of ambition and the hunger for discovery? State a clear claim, support it with two or three quotations, and explain how the point of view in the chapter helps build that idea.

HS Sophomore (450 words; Indiana 2023: 9-10.RC.1, 9-10.W.1): Analyze how Letter I develops the idea of ambition and the hunger for discovery. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of point of view and foreshadowing shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.

HS Junior (550 words; Indiana 2023: 11-12.RC.3, 11-12.RC.1, 11-12.W.1): Analyze how the structure of Letter I (where it begins, turns and ends) and its point of view shape the reader's understanding of ambition and the hunger for discovery. Identify one place where the text leaves matters uncertain and explain how that uncertainty adds to its meaning. Distinguish what is directly stated from what is really meant.

HS Senior (600 words; Indiana 2023: 11-12.RC.1, 11-12.W.1): Two readers disagree about what Letter I suggests about ambition and the hunger for discovery. Lay out two plausible interpretations, weigh the evidence for each (including the chapter's point of view and foreshadowing), and argue for the stronger one in a sustained, well-organized essay. Distinguish what is directly stated from what is really meant.

AP (650 words; Indiana 2023: 11-12.RC.1, 11-12.W.1): Write a literary argument in which you analyze how Mary Shelley uses point of view in Letter I to complicate the reader's understanding of ambition and the hunger for discovery. Develop a defensible thesis, select evidence purposefully, and explain how specific choices of diction and syntax create meaning.

College Freshman (1000 words; Indiana 2023: see unit standards): Situate Letter I within its historical and literary context and argue how the chapter's treatment of ambition and the hunger for discovery responds to that context. Engage with at least one secondary perspective (a critic, historian or the author's own statements), integrate quotations smoothly, and cite in MLA style.

College Sophomore (1250 words; Indiana 2023: see unit standards): Read Letter I alongside the conventions of its genre and period. Argue how the chapter's handling of ambition and the hunger for discovery follows or bends those conventions, using the point of view as evidence, and test your reading against one published critic. Document two secondary sources in MLA.

College Junior (1500 words; Indiana 2023: see unit standards): Apply a named critical approach (for example formalist, historicist, feminist, psychoanalytic or ecocritical) to Letter I and its treatment of ambition and the hunger for discovery. State your method, show what it reveals in the chapter's point of view and foreshadowing, and identify where the text resists it.

College Senior (2000 words; Indiana 2023: see unit standards): Develop a research argument that reads Letter I as evidence for a larger claim about ambition and the hunger for discovery in Frankenstein. Connect close reading of the chapter to the whole novel, engage at least four scholarly sources, and state precisely where your reading departs from theirs (Chicago style).

Graduate / PhD (2500 words; Indiana 2023: see unit standards): Develop an original argument that reads Letter I as a hinge in the novel's larger treatment of ambition and the hunger for discovery. Position your reading within a named critical conversation (for example formalist, historicist, psychoanalytic, feminist or postcolonial approaches), account for the textual history where relevant, and articulate the stakes of your intervention for scholarship on Frankenstein.

SAT-style questions

1. *These visions faded when I perused, for the first time, those poets whose effusions entranced my soul, and lifted it to heaven.*

   As used in the text, what does the word "effusions" most nearly mean?

   A. a vehicle mounted on runners and pulled by horses or dogs; for transportation over snow
   B. used on the high seas
   C. a feeling of evil to come
   D. an unrestrained expression of emotion

2. *You will rejoice to hear that no disaster has accompanied the commencement of an enterprise which you have regarded with such evil forebodings. I arrived here yesterday; and my first task is to assure my dear sister of my welfare, and increasing confidence in the success of my undertaking.*

   Which choice best states a central concern of "Letter I"?

   A. The first death and growing guilt
   B. Confidence before danger
   C. Destroying the companion
   D. Ambition and the hunger for discovery

SAT key: 1. D (an unrestrained expression of emotion); 2. D (Ambition and the hunger for discovery)

Lesson 5: Letter II

Focus: loneliness and the desire for a friend

Objective: Students will analyze how characterization develops in “Letter II” by writing a claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph that cites at least 2 quotations from the section, and will score at least 80% on the section quiz.

Standards: CCSS RL.9-10.3, W.9-10.1, L.9-10.4 · IN 9-10.RC.1, 9-10.W.1, 9-10.RC.9, 9-10.RC.11

Teacher only · spoilers

From Archangel, Walton hires a ship and crew but confesses that he has no friend who shares his enthusiasm. He describes his master and lieutenant and promises Margaret, “I shall kill no albatross.”

Background: Coleridge's 'The Rime of the Ancient Mariner' (1798), alluded to here, was hugely popular; Mary Shelley heard Coleridge recite it as a child.

Significance: Walton's loneliness introduces the novel's central need: companionship. The albatross allusion warns of punishment for violating nature.

Lesson plan and lecture script (90 minutes)

0–8 min · Bell-ringer · You do (8 min)
Students write to the bell-ringer, then pair-share.
Why does Walton feel he needs a friend, and what kind of friend does he want? Write for five minutes. Starters: I think... because... / This connects to isolation and companionship because....
Prompt: Why does Walton feel he needs a friend, and what kind of friend does he want?
Sentence starters: I think… because… · This connects to isolation and companionship because…
Strong response: A strong response takes a position and anticipates this: the desire for a sympathetic friend is the thread connecting Walton, Victor and the creature.

8–18 min · Vocabulary with etymology notes · I do (10 min)
Five key words in context, with verified word histories.
*Today's words: albatross — a very large seabird of the southern oceans; embarkation — going on board a ship to start a voyage; amassed — gathered or collected a large amount of; unemployed — not engaged in a gainful occupation; endowments — natural abilities or qualities. “embarkation”: From French embarcation. By surface analysis, embark + -ation. “amassed”: From Middle English *amassen (found only as Middle English massen "to amass"), from Anglo-Norman amasser, from Medieval Latin amassāre, from ad + massa "lump, mass". See mass. “endowments”: From Middle English endowement; equivalent to endow + ment.*
Words: albatross: a very large seabird of the southern oceans · embarkation: going on board a ship to start a voyage · amassed: gathered or collected a large amount of · unemployed: not engaged in a gainful occupation · endowments: natural abilities or qualities

18–28 min · Background and context · I do (10 min)
Mini-lecture (read or adapt the script).
Coleridge's 'The Rime of the Ancient Mariner' (1798), alluded to here, was hugely popular; Mary Shelley heard Coleridge recite it as a child. Walton's loneliness introduces the novel's central need: companionship. The albatross allusion warns of punishment for violating nature. Characterization: Walton confesses loneliness: he has "no friend." His self-education (from his uncle's travel books) makes him intense but unbalanced. Allusion: "the land of mist and snow" and the albatross come from Coleridge's The Rime of the Ancient Mariner, a poem about a man who commits a crime against nature and must tell his story. Walton's joke sets up Victor as a mariner-like teller. Foreshadowing: Walton's wish for a friend whose eyes reply to his will be granted, terribly, in Victor. Watch for isolation: Almost every narrator ends up alone; solitude is both the cost of ambition and the creature's suffering. In this chapter: "me very desirous to engage him. A youth passed in solitude, my best years spent under your gentle and feminine fosterage, has" (Letter II, paragraph 4).

28–40 min · I do: modeled close reading · I do (12 min)
Model the close reading of the anchor quotation using the written think-aloud below.
I read the line once for meaning and once for craft. "I have no friend, Margaret" (Letter II, paragraph 2). Short and plain amid his long sentences: the emotional core of the letter. That is characterization at work: Walton confesses loneliness: he has "no friend." His self-education (from his uncle's travel books) makes him intense but unbalanced.

> *I have no friend, Margaret* (Letter II, paragraph 2)

Think-aloud: I read the line once for meaning and once for craft. "I have no friend, Margaret" (Letter II, paragraph 2). Short and plain amid his long sentences: the emotional core of the letter. That is characterization at work: Walton confesses loneliness: he has "no friend." His self-education (from his uncle's travel books) makes him intense but unbalanced.

40–55 min · We do: guided annotation · We do (15 min)
Guided analysis of a second quotation; expected answers given.
Ask: What words in this line stand out, and what do they suggest? Expected: "Whose eyes would reply to mine" pictures friendship as mutual recognition. It connects to isolation: the creature will be rejected precisely because people cannot bear to look at him. Ask: How does this line connect to isolation and companionship? Expected: The desire for a sympathetic friend is the thread connecting Walton, Victor and the creature. (The creature will ask for exactly this. Evidence that the need for companionship is universal in the novel.)

> *I desire the company of a man who could sympathise with me; whose eyes would reply to mine* (Letter II, paragraph 2)

Ask: What words in this line stand out, and what do they suggest?
Expected answer: "Whose eyes would reply to mine" pictures friendship as mutual recognition. It connects to isolation: the creature will be rejected precisely because people cannot bear to look at him.
Ask: How does this line connect to isolation and companionship?
Expected answer: The desire for a sympathetic friend is the thread connecting Walton, Victor and the creature. (The creature will ask for exactly this. Evidence that the need for companionship is universal in the novel.)

55–70 min · You do: independent annotation · You do (15 min)

Independent annotation and a claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph (exemplar given).

Annotate the chapter for characterization, allusion (three marks with a margin note each), then write one claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph: what does this chapter suggest about loneliness and the desire for a friend? Then start your writing prompt at your assigned level (HS Sophomore: Analyze how Letter II develops the idea of loneliness and the desire for a friend. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of characterization and theme shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.) Exemplar: Walton's loneliness introduces the novel's central human need, which the creature will later voice most powerfully. When the text says “I desire the company of a man who could sympathise with me; whose eyes would reply to mine” (Letter II, paragraph 2), it shows this directly. His wish for someone whose "eyes would reply to mine" names the sympathy every major character lacks, so the novel ties ambition to isolation from its first pages.

Task: Annotate the chapter for characterization, allusion (three marks with a margin note each), then write one claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph: what does this chapter suggest about loneliness and the desire for a friend? Then start your writing prompt at your assigned level (HS Sophomore: Analyze how Letter II develops the idea of loneliness and the desire for a friend. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of characterization and theme shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.)

Exemplar: Walton's loneliness introduces the novel's central human need, which the creature will later voice most powerfully. When the text says “I desire the company of a man who could sympathise with me; whose eyes would reply to mine” (Letter II, paragraph 2), it shows this directly. His wish for someone whose "eyes would reply to mine" names the sympathy every major character lacks, so the novel ties ambition to isolation from its first pages.

70–80 min · Discussion · We do (10 min)

Structured discussion from the 30 tiered questions, with facilitation notes.

Anchor question: Why does Walton feel he needs a friend, and what kind of friend does he want? Ask: is Walton lonely because he is ambitious, or ambitious because he is lonely? Push for a line from the letter.

Anchor question: Why does Walton feel he needs a friend, and what kind of friend does he want?

Facilitation: Ask: is Walton lonely because he is ambitious, or ambitious because he is lonely? Push for a line from the letter.

80–87 min · Exit ticket / chapter quiz · You do (7 min)
Chapter quiz in the app and an exit ticket (answer given).
Chapter quiz in the app, then: In one sentence, what does this chapter suggest about loneliness and the desire for a friend? Support it with one short quotation. Model answer: Walton's loneliness introduces the novel's central human need, which the creature will later voice most powerfully. ("I desire the company of a man who could sympathise with me; whose eyes would reply to mine", Letter II, paragraph 2). Accept any defensible claim backed by a quotation from the chapter; the answer key for the quiz is in the Quiz section.
Exit ticket: In one sentence, what does this chapter suggest about loneliness and the desire for a friend? Support it with one short quotation.
Answer: Model answer: Walton's loneliness introduces the novel's central human need, which the creature will later voice most powerfully. ("I desire the company of a man who could sympathise with me; whose eyes would reply to mine", Letter II, paragraph 2). Accept any defensible claim backed by a quotation from the chapter; the answer key for the quiz is in the Quiz section.

87–90 min · Closure · I do (3 min)
Summarize the lesson and preview the next reading.
Today we saw how characterization shapes loneliness and the desire for a friend. Key takeaway: the desire for a sympathetic friend is the thread connecting Walton, Victor and the creature.

Total: 90 minutes.

Teacher analysis (spoilers)

Literary elements

- **Characterization:** Walton confesses loneliness: he has "no friend." His self-education (from his uncle's travel books) makes him intense but unbalanced.
- **Allusion:** "the land of mist and snow" and the albatross come from Coleridge's The Rime of the Ancient Mariner, a poem about a man who commits a crime against nature and must tell his story. Walton's joke sets up Victor as a mariner-like teller.
- **Foreshadowing:** Walton's wish for a friend whose eyes reply to his will be granted, terribly, in Victor.

Themes and how they develop

- **isolation and companionship:** the desire for a sympathetic friend is the thread connecting Walton, Victor and the creature.

Symbols and motifs

- **isolation:** Almost every narrator ends up alone; solitude is both the cost of ambition and the creature's suffering. In this chapter: "me very desirous to engage him. A youth passed in solitude, my best years spent under your gentle and feminine fosterage, has" (Letter II, paragraph 4).

Key quotations (checked against the reading text)

- "I have no friend, Margaret" (Letter II, paragraph 2) Short and plain amid his long sentences: the emotional core of the letter.
- "I desire the company of a man who could sympathise with me; whose eyes would reply to mine" (Letter II, paragraph 2) The creature will ask for exactly this. Evidence that the need for companionship is universal in the novel.
- "I shall kill no albatross" (Letter II, paragraph 6) An allusion that promises he will not offend against nature; readers who know Coleridge sense danger.

Model claim-evidence-reasoning

Claim: Walton's loneliness introduces the novel's central human need, which the creature will later voice most powerfully.
Evidence: "I desire the company of a man who could sympathise with me; whose eyes would reply to mine" (Letter II, paragraph 2)
Reasoning: His wish for someone whose "eyes would reply to mine" names the sympathy every major character lacks, so the novel ties ambition to isolation from its first pages.

Vocabulary with etymology notes

Word	Definition (in this sentence)	In context	Word history
albatross (noun)	a very large seabird of the southern oceans	*I am going to unexplored regions, to "the land of mist and snow"; but I shall kill no albatross, therefore do not be alarmed for my safety, or if I should come back to you as worn and woeful as the "Ancient Mariner."*	
embarkation (noun)	going on board a ship to start a voyage	*Those are as fixed as fate; and my voyage is only now delayed until the weather shall permit my embarkation.*	"embarkation": From French embarcation. By surface analysis, embark + -ation. (Wiktionary, https://en.wiktionary.org/wiki/embarkation#Etymology)
amassed (verb)	gathered or collected a large amount of	*Some years ago, he loved a young Russian lady, of moderate fortune; and having amassed a considerable sum in prize-money, the father of the girl consented to the match.*	"amassed": From Middle English *amassen (found only as Middle English massen "to amass"), from Anglo-Norman amasser, from Medieval Latin amassāre, from ad + massa "lump, mass". See mass. (Wiktionary, https://en.wiktionary.org/wiki/amass#Etymology)
unemployed (adjective)	not engaged in a gainful occupation	*I first became acquainted with him on board a whale vessel: finding that he was unemployed*	

		in this city, I easily engaged him to assist in my enterprise.	
endowments (noun)	natural abilities or qualities	*He is an Englishman, and in the midst of national and professional prejudices, unsoftened by cultivation, retains some of the noblest endowments of humanity.*	"endowments": From Middle English endowement; equivalent to endow + ment. (Wiktionary, https://en.wiktionary.org/wiki/endowment#Etymology)
illiterate (adjective)	poorly educated; unable to read well	*Now I am twenty-eight, and am in reality more illiterate than many schoolboys of fifteen.*	
encompassed (verb)	surrounded	*How slowly the time passes here, encompassed as I am by frost and snow; yet a second step is taken towards my enterprise.*	"encompassed": From Middle English encompassen. By surface analysis, en + en + compass. (Wiktionary, https://en.wiktionary.org/wiki/encompass#Etymology)
retains (verb)	keeps	*He is an Englishman, and in the midst of national and professional prejudices, unsoftened by cultivation, retains some of the noblest endowments of humanity.*	
mildness (noun)	gentleness	*The master is a person of an excellent disposition, and is remarkable in the ship for his gentleness and the mildness of his discipline.*	"mildness": From Middle English mildenesse, from Old English mildnes, mildness, equivalent to mild + ness. Cognate with Old High German miltnissa "compassion, mercy, sympathy, pity". (Wiktionary, https://en.wiktionary.org/wiki/mildness#Etymology)
voyages (noun)	an act of traveling by water	*But it is a still greater evil to me that I am self-educated: for the first fourteen years of my life I ran wild on a common, and read nothing but our uncle Thomas's books of voyages.*	

Discussion questions

1. Why does Walton feel he needs a friend, and what kind of friend does he want?
2. Where does characterization appear in this chapter, and what effect does it have? Point to one passage.
3. How does this chapter connect to the book's larger concern with nature versus nurture?

Classroom discussion questions (30, tiered)

Wait time after every question (3 s for DOK 1, 5 s for DOK 2, 8 to 10 s for DOK 3 and 4); think-pair-share on DOK 3 and 4; answer each response with a follow-up probe; close with student-generated questions. Focus sets by rigor level: Middle School: 1,

2, 3, 4, 5, 6, 11, 12, 13, 14, 21, 22; HS Freshman: 1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 12, 13, 14, 15, 22, 23, 24; HS Sophomore: 1, 2, 3, 4, 13, 14, 15, 16, 17, 23, 24, 25; HS Junior: 1, 2, 3, 14, 15, 16, 17, 18, 24, 25, 26, 27; HS Senior: 1, 2, 3, 15, 16, 17, 18, 25, 26, 27, 28, 29; AP: 1, 2, 16, 17, 18, 19, 20, 26, 27, 28, 29, 30; College Freshman: 1, 2, 17, 18, 19, 20, 21, 22, 27, 28, 29, 30; College Sophomore: 1, 2, 11, 18, 19, 20, 21, 22, 23, 28, 29, 30; College Junior: 1, 11, 12, 19, 20, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 29, 30; College Senior: 1, 11, 12, 13, 20, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 26, 30; Graduate / PhD: 1, 11, 12, 13, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 26, 27, 28

Literal / recall

1. What does Walton say he lacks most? [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · 7.RC.1, 7.CC.1, 9-10.RC.1] Look for: A friend who shares his feelings
2. Which poem does Walton allude to? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · 7.RC.1, 7.CC.1, 9-10.RC.1] Look for: The Rime of the Ancient Mariner
3. From what port does Walton write this letter? [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · 7.RC.1, 7.CC.1, 9-10.RC.1] Look for: Archangel
4. What theme is introduced by his longing? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · 7.RC.1, 7.CC.1, 9-10.RC.1] Look for: The need for companionship
5. How does Walton describe his crew's master? [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · 7.RC.1, 7.CC.1, 9-10.RC.1] Look for: Kind and gentle, remarkable for mildness
6. Retell the three most important events of "Letter II" in order, in one sentence each. [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · 7.RC.1, 7.CC.1, 9-10.RC.1] Look for: From Archangel, Walton hires a ship and crew but confesses that he has no friend who shares his enthusiasm. He describes his master and lieutenant and promises Margaret, "I shall kill no albatross."
7. Which characters appear or are mentioned in "Letter II"? Name two and one thing each says or does. [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · 7.RC.1, 7.CC.1, 9-10.RC.1] Look for: Names and actions taken from the chapter; check against the teacher summary.
8. Where and when does "Letter II" take place? Point to the line that tells you. [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · 7.RC.1, 7.CC.1, 9-10.RC.1] Look for: A place/time detail quoted from the chapter.
9. Reread: "I am going to unexplored regions, to "the land of mist and snow"; but I shall kill no albatross, therefore do not be alarmed for my safety, or if I should come back to you as worn and woeful as the "Ancient Mariner."" What does "albatross" mean here, and what is literally happening in this line? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · 7.RC.1, 7.CC.1, 9-10.RC.1] Look for: albatross: a very large seabird of the southern oceans.
10. Reread: "Those are as fixed as fate; and my voyage is only now delayed until the weather shall permit my embarkation." What does "embarkation" mean here, and what is literally happening in this line? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · 7.RC.1, 7.CC.1, 9-10.RC.1] Look for: embarkation: going on board a ship to start a voyage.

Inferential / analytical

1. What does "Letter II" suggest about loneliness and the desire for a friend? State the inference and the line that supports it. [DOK 2 · thinkPairShare · wait 5 s · 7.RC.2, 7.CC.2, 9-10.RC.2] Look for: Walton's loneliness introduces the novel's central need: companionship. The albatross allusion warns of punishment for violating nature.
2. Find one example of characterization in this chapter. What does it reveal that a plain statement would not? [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · 7.RC.3, 7.CC.2, 9-10.RC.1] Look for: Look for what characters say, do and think, and how others react to them.
3. How does the theme in this chapter shape what we understand about loneliness and the desire for a friend? [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · 7.RC.2, 7.CC.2, 9-10.RC.2] Look for: Look for statements or moments that connect to the book's big ideas.

Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Walton's loneliness introduces the novel's central human need, which the creature will later voice most powerfully. Useful evidence: “I have no friend, Margaret” (Letter II, paragraph 2): Short and plain amid his long sentences: the emotional core of the letter. Theme link: the desire for a sympathetic friend is the thread connecting Walton, Victor and the creature. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

4. In the passage that begins “How slowly the time passes here, encompassed as I am by frost and snow; yet a second step is taken towards my enterprise.”, why might Shelley have chosen these particular words? Pick two and explain their connotations. [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · 7.RC.12, 7.CC.2, 9-10.RC.12] Look for: Diction analysis of two words in the anchor passage.
5. What causes the main turn in “Letter II”, and what effect is it likely to have on what follows? [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · 7.RC.3, 7.CC.2, 9-10.RC.1] Look for: From Archangel, Walton hires a ship and crew but confesses that he has no friend who shares his enthusiasm. He describes his master and lieutenant and promises Margaret, “I shall kill no albatross.”
6. How does “Letter II” build on “Letter I”? Name one link of cause and effect. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · 7.RC.3, 7.CC.2, 9-10.RC.3] Look for: A causal or structural link between this and the previous chapter.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Walton's loneliness introduces the novel's central human need, which the creature will later voice most powerfully. Useful evidence: “I desire the company of a man who could sympathise with me; whose eyes would reply to mine” (Letter II, paragraph 2): The creature will ask for exactly this. Evidence that the need for companionship is universal in the novel. Theme link: the desire for a sympathetic friend is the thread connecting Walton, Victor and the creature. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
7. What can we infer about a character's motives from what they say and do here, as opposed to what they claim? [DOK 3 · followUp · wait 8 s · 7.RC.3, 7.CC.2, 9-10.RC.1] Look for: An inference about motive supported by a quoted line.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Walton's loneliness introduces the novel's central human need, which the creature will later voice most powerfully. Useful evidence: “I shall kill no albatross” (Letter II, paragraph 6): An allusion that promises he will not offend against nature; readers who know Coleridge sense danger. On characterization: Walton confesses loneliness: he has "no friend." His self-education (from his uncle's travel books) makes him intense but unbalanced. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
8. The bell-ringer asked: “Why does Walton feel he needs a friend, and what kind of friend does he want?” Now that we have read closely, how would you revise your first answer, and which line changed your mind? [DOK 2 · thinkPairShare · wait 5 s · 7.RC.2, 7.CC.2, 9-10.RC.2] Look for: A revised answer anchored in the text.
9. Where does tone / mood appear, and how does it connect this chapter to the larger concern with nature versus nurture? [DOK 3 · followUp · wait 8 s · 7.RC.12, 7.CC.2, 9-10.RC.12] Look for: Look for word choices that reveal the narrator's attitude or the scene's feeling.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Walton's loneliness introduces the novel's central human need, which the creature will later voice most powerfully. Useful evidence: “I have no friend, Margaret” (Letter II, paragraph 2): Short and plain amid his long sentences: the emotional core of the letter. Theme link: the desire for a sympathetic friend is the thread connecting Walton, Victor and the

creature. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

10. Background: Coleridge's 'The Rime of the Ancient Mariner' (1798), alluded to here, was hugely popular; Mary Shelley heard Coleridge recite it as a child. How does knowing this change the way you read one moment in the chapter? [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · 7.RC.3, 7.CC.2, 9-10.RC.1] Look for: A specific moment reread in light of the context.

    Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Walton's loneliness introduces the novel's central human need, which the creature will later voice most powerfully. Useful evidence: “I desire the company of a man who could sympathise with me; whose eyes would reply to mine” (Letter II, paragraph 2): The creature will ask for exactly this. Evidence that the need for companionship is universal in the novel. Theme link: the desire for a sympathetic friend is the thread connecting Walton, Victor and the creature. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

Evaluative / synthesis / creative

1. A critic might argue: “Walton's loneliness introduces the novel's central need: companionship. The albatross allusion warns of punishment for violating nature.” How far do you agree? Take a stand and defend it with two lines from the chapter. [DOK 3 · fourCorners · wait 8 s · 7.RC.2, 7.CC.3, 9-10.RC.2] Look for: A defended position with evidence and one counterpoint.

    Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Walton's loneliness introduces the novel's central human need, which the creature will later voice most powerfully. Useful evidence: “I shall kill no albatross” (Letter II, paragraph 6): An allusion that promises he will not offend against nature; readers who know Coleridge sense danger. Theme link: the desire for a sympathetic friend is the thread connecting Walton, Victor and the creature. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

2. Which character in this chapter acts most wisely, and which least? Judge them by a standard you name. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · 7.RC.3, 7.CC.3, 9-10.RC.1] Look for: An evaluation using an explicit criterion and evidence.

    Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Walton's loneliness introduces the novel's central human need, which the creature will later voice most powerfully. Useful evidence: “I have no friend, Margaret” (Letter II, paragraph 2): Short and plain amid his long sentences: the emotional core of the letter. On characterization: Walton confesses loneliness: he has "no friend." His self-education (from his uncle's travel books) makes him intense but unbalanced. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

3. Rewrite one moment of “Letter II” from the point of view of a different character. What does the new angle reveal or hide about loneliness and the desire for a friend? [DOK 4 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · 7.RC.1, 7.CC.3, 9-10.RC.1] Look for: A creative product with a rationale tied to the text.

    Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Walton's loneliness introduces the novel's central human need, which the creature will later voice most powerfully. Useful evidence: “I desire the company of a man who could sympathise with me; whose eyes would reply to mine” (Letter II, paragraph 2): The creature will ask for exactly this. Evidence that the need for companionship is universal in the novel. Theme link: the desire for a sympathetic friend is the thread connecting Walton, Victor and the creature.

Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

4. Write three questions of your own about “Letter II”: one recall, one “why/how”, and one “should/what if”. Trade with a partner and answer theirs. [DOK 3 · studentGenerated · wait 8 s · 7.RC.2, 7.CC.3, 9-10.RC.2] Look for: Student-generated questions at three levels.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Walton's loneliness introduces the novel's central human need, which the creature will later voice most powerfully. Useful evidence: “I shall kill no albatross” (Letter II, paragraph 6): An allusion that promises he will not offend against nature; readers who know Coleridge sense danger. Theme link: the desire for a sympathetic friend is the thread connecting Walton, Victor and the creature. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

5. Connect this chapter to the sublime power of nature: is the link strong or weak so far? What would Shelley need to show next to strengthen it? [DOK 4 · socraticCircle · wait 8 s · 7.RC.2, 7.CC.3, 9-10.RC.2] Look for: A judgment of thematic development across the work.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Walton's loneliness introduces the novel's central human need, which the creature will later voice most powerfully. Useful evidence: “I have no friend, Margaret” (Letter II, paragraph 2): Short and plain amid his long sentences: the emotional core of the letter. Theme link: the desire for a sympathetic friend is the thread connecting Walton, Victor and the creature. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

6. Is the characterization in this chapter effective, or does it feel heavy-handed? Evaluate it as a reader would in a review. [DOK 3 · fourCorners · wait 8 s · 7.RC.3, 7.CC.3, 9-10.RC.1] Look for: An evaluative judgment with criteria and evidence.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Walton's loneliness introduces the novel's central human need, which the creature will later voice most powerfully. Useful evidence: “I desire the company of a man who could sympathise with me; whose eyes would reply to mine” (Letter II, paragraph 2): The creature will ask for exactly this. Evidence that the need for companionship is universal in the novel. On characterization: Walton confesses loneliness: he has "no friend." His self-education (from his uncle's travel books) makes him intense but unbalanced. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

7. Compare how “Letter II” treats loneliness and the desire for a friend with how another text, film or event you know treats a similar idea. What does Frankenstein see that the other misses? [DOK 4 · socraticCircle · wait 8 s · 7.RC.2, 7.CC.3, 9-10.RC.2] Look for: A cross-text synthesis.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Walton's loneliness introduces the novel's central human need, which the creature will later voice most powerfully. Useful evidence: “I shall kill no albatross” (Letter II, paragraph 6): An allusion that promises he will not offend against nature; readers who know Coleridge sense danger. Theme link: the desire for a sympathetic friend is the thread connecting Walton, Victor and the creature. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

8. Predict what “Letter III” will bring, using two clues from this chapter. After reading, evaluate your prediction. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · 7.RC.3, 7.CC.3, 9-10.RC.3] Look for: A prediction or judgment justified with textual clues.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Walton's loneliness introduces the novel's central

human need, which the creature will later voice most powerfully. Useful evidence: “I have no friend, Margaret” (Letter II, paragraph 2): Short and plain amid his long sentences: the emotional core of the letter. On foreshadowing: Walton's wish for a friend whose eyes reply to his will be granted, terribly, in Victor. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

9. Design a one-paragraph modern adaptation of this chapter (setting, characters, conflict). What must stay the same for it to still be about loneliness and the desire for a friend? [DOK 4 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · 7.RC.2, 7.CC.3, 9-10.RC.2] Look for: A creative transfer that keeps the core idea.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Walton's loneliness introduces the novel's central human need, which the creature will later voice most powerfully. Useful evidence: “I desire the company of a man who could sympathise with me; whose eyes would reply to mine” (Letter II, paragraph 2): The creature will ask for exactly this. Evidence that the need for companionship is universal in the novel. Theme link: the desire for a sympathetic friend is the thread connecting Walton, Victor and the creature. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

10. What question would you most like to ask Mary Shelley about this chapter, and what answer do you think the text itself gives? [DOK 4 · studentGenerated · wait 8 s · 7.RC.2, 7.CC.3, 9-10.RC.2] Look for: A student-generated question answered from evidence.

    Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Walton's loneliness introduces the novel's central human need, which the creature will later voice most powerfully. Useful evidence: “I shall kill no albatross” (Letter II, paragraph 6): An allusion that promises he will not offend against nature; readers who know Coleridge sense danger. Theme link: the desire for a sympathetic friend is the thread connecting Walton, Victor and the creature. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

Annotation focus

- **Characterization:** look for what characters say, do and think, and how others react to them (anchor passage in the We do segment)
- Also notice **Theme**: statements or moments that connect to the book's big ideas
- Also notice **Tone / mood**: word choices that reveal the narrator's attitude or the scene's feeling

Chapter quiz: item bank (all eleven rigor versions)

1. [mc · recall · DOK 1] Which poem does Walton allude to?

   A. The Rime of the Ancient Mariner

   B. Hamlet

   C. Paradise Lost

   D. The Iliad

   Key: A (The Rime of the Ancient Mariner)

2. [mc · recall · DOK 1] From what port does Walton write this letter?

   A. Ingolstadt

   B. Archangel

   C. Lisbon

D. Geneva

Key: B (Archangel)

3. [mc · recall · DOK 1] In the line “I am going to unexplored regions, to “the land of mist and snow”; but I shall kill no albatross, therefore do not be alarmed for my safety, or if I should come back to you as worn and woeful as the “Ancient Mariner.””, what does “albatross” most nearly mean?

   A. hesitated because of a moral doubt

   B. a very large seabird of the southern oceans

   C. immune to attack; impregnable

   D. freed from a burden

   Key: B (a very large seabird of the southern oceans)

4. [mc · recall · DOK 1] What theme is introduced by his longing?

   A. The joy of solitude

   B. The need for companionship

   C. The evils of travel

   D. The love of money

   Key: B (The need for companionship)

5. [fill · recall · DOK 1] Complete the quotation from Letter II, paragraph 2: “I desire the company of a man who could _____ with me; whose eyes would reply to mine”

   Key: sympathise

6. [fill · recall · DOK 1] Fill in the blank with the vocabulary word that fits: “He is an Englishman, and in the midst of national and professional prejudices, unsoftened by cultivation, _____ some of the noblest endowments of humanity.” Word bank: embarkation, retains, albatross, amassed

   Key: retains

7. [fill · recall · DOK 1] Fill in the blank with the vocabulary word that fits: “Now I am twenty-eight, and am in reality more _____ than many schoolboys of fifteen.” Word bank: illiterate, amassed, albatross, embarkation

   Key: illiterate

8. [mc · recall · DOK 1] In the line “I first became acquainted with him on board a whale vessel: finding that he was unemployed in this city, I easily engaged him to assist in my enterprise.”, what does “unemployed” most nearly mean?

   A. tempted; attracted

   B. declaiming wildly

   C. any bird of the family Icteridae whose male is black or predominantly black

   D. not engaged in a gainful occupation

   Key: D (not engaged in a gainful occupation)

9. [mc · recall · DOK 1] In the line “Some years ago, he loved a young Russian lady, of moderate fortune; and having amassed a considerable sum in prize-money, the father of the girl consented to the match.”, what does “amassed” most nearly mean?

   A. make sense of; assign a meaning to

   B. holds (attention)

   C. gathered or collected a large amount of

D. a means to an end; not necessarily a principled or ethical one

Key: C (gathered or collected a large amount of)

10. [mc · inference · DOK 2] What does this passage most clearly show? “I have no friend, Margaret” (Letter II, paragraph 2)
    A. Short and plain amid his long sentences: the emotional core of the letter.
    B. Confession to his father, dismissed as madness.
    C. Self-horror learned from others' standards of beauty.
    D. Blunt, short sentence in the father's letter.

    Key: A (Short and plain amid his long sentences: the emotional core of the letter.)

11. [mc · inference · DOK 2] What does this passage most clearly show? “I desire the company of a man who could sympathise with me; whose eyes would reply to mine” (Letter II, paragraph 2)
    A. "Crown" suggests royal triumph; the promise reads as hubris.
    B. The novel's warning stated outright.
    C. Shot after a rescue; bitter irony.
    D. The creature will ask for exactly this. Evidence that the need for companionship is universal in the novel.

    Key: D (The creature will ask for exactly this. Evidence that the need for companionship is universal in the novel.)

12. [mc · inference · DOK 2] Which choice best states a central concern of “Letter II”?
    A. The wedding night and its catastrophe
    B. First experiences of the senses
    C. Confrontation between creator and creation
    D. Loneliness and the desire for a friend

    Key: D (Loneliness and the desire for a friend)

13. [short · inference · DOK 2] What can you infer from this line? “I desire the company of a man who could sympathise with me; whose eyes would reply to mine” (Letter II, paragraph 2) Answer in two or three sentences with one detail.

    Sample answer: The creature will ask for exactly this. Evidence that the need for companionship is universal in the novel.

14. [mc · analysis · DOK 3] Which literary element does this describe in “Letter II”? Walton confesses loneliness: he has "no friend." His self-education (from his uncle's travel books) makes him intense but unbalanced.
    A. Conflict
    B. Foreshadowing
    C. Symbolism
    D. Characterization

    Key: D (Characterization)

15. [short · analysis · DOK 3] Claim: Walton's loneliness introduces the novel's central human need, which the creature will later voice most powerfully. Explain how this evidence supports the claim: “I desire the company of a man who could sympathise with me; whose eyes would reply to mine” (Letter II, paragraph 2).

    Sample answer: His wish for someone whose "eyes would reply to mine" names the sympathy every major character lacks, so the novel ties ambition to isolation from its first pages.

16. [short · synthesis · DOK 4] Close reading: how do the diction and syntax of “I desire the company of a man who could sympathise with me; whose eyes would reply to mine” (Letter II, paragraph 2) shape its meaning? Consider a second, competing reading.
    Sample answer: The creature will ask for exactly this. Evidence that the need for companionship is universal in the novel.
17. [fill · recall · DOK 1] Fill in the blank with the vocabulary word that fits: “How slowly the time passes here, _____ as I am by frost and snow; yet a second step is taken towards my enterprise.” Word bank: amassed, encompassed, embarkation, albatross
    Key: encompassed
18. [mc · recall · DOK 1] In the line “Those are as fixed as fate; and my voyage is only now delayed until the weather shall permit my embarkation.”, what does “embarkation” most nearly mean?
    A. a defamatory or abusive word or phrase
    B. going on board a ship to start a voyage
    C. putting a quality or feeling into something
    D. cursing; expressions of hatred
    Key: B (going on board a ship to start a voyage)
19. [mc · recall · DOK 1] How does Walton describe his crew's master?
    A. Lazy and drunk
    B. Kind and gentle, remarkable for mildness
    C. Cruel and violent
    D. A former pirate
    Key: B (Kind and gentle, remarkable for mildness)
20. [fill · recall · DOK 1] Fill in the blank with the vocabulary word that fits: “He is an Englishman, and in the midst of national and professional prejudices, unsoftened by cultivation, retains some of the noblest _____ of humanity.” Word bank: endowments, embarkation, amassed, albatross
    Key: endowments
21. [short · inference · DOK 2] What can you infer from this line? “I have no friend, Margaret” (Letter II, paragraph 2) Answer in two or three sentences with one detail.
    Sample answer: Short and plain amid his long sentences: the emotional core of the letter.
22. [short · analysis · DOK 3] Analyze the word choice in “I shall kill no albatross” (Letter II, paragraph 6). Pick two words and explain what they suggest.
    Sample answer: An allusion that promises he will not offend against nature; readers who know Coleridge sense danger.
23. [mc · analysis · DOK 3] Which literary element does this describe in “Letter II”? "the land of mist and snow" and the albatross come from Coleridge's The Rime of the Ancient Mariner, a poem about a man who commits a crime against nature and must tell his story. Walton's joke sets up Victor as a mariner-like teller.
    A. Allusion
    B. Metaphor
    C. Setting
    D. Foreshadowing
    Key: A (Allusion)
24. [short · synthesis · DOK 4] Evaluate this claim about the chapter: “Walton's loneliness introduces the novel's central human need, which the creature will later voice most powerfully.” Is it fully persuasive? Argue with

evidence, including a passage that complicates it.

Sample answer: His wish for someone whose "eyes would reply to mine" names the sympathy every major character lacks, so the novel ties ambition to isolation from its first pages.

25. [mc · inference · DOK 2] What does this passage most clearly show? “I shall kill no albatross” (Letter II, paragraph 6)

    A. The nurture argument in one line.

    B. Total despair; in the next chapter it becomes a vow of revenge.

    C. Echoes the "lifeless matter" of creation.

    D. An allusion that promises he will not offend against nature; readers who know Coleridge sense danger.

    Key: D (An allusion that promises he will not offend against nature; readers who know Coleridge sense danger.)

26. [short · synthesis · DOK 4] Close reading: how do the diction and syntax of “I have no friend, Margaret” (Letter II, paragraph 2) shape its meaning? Consider a second, competing reading.

    Sample answer: Short and plain amid his long sentences: the emotional core of the letter.

27. [mc · recall · DOK 1] What does Walton say he lacks most?

    A. Money for the voyage

    B. A friend who shares his feelings

    C. A ship

    D. Maps of the Arctic

    Key: B (A friend who shares his feelings)

28. [short · synthesis · DOK 4] Synthesis: trace how isolation and companionship develops from an earlier chapter to “Letter II”. Use one quotation from each.

    Sample answer: the desire for a sympathetic friend is the thread connecting Walton, Victor and the creature.

Rigor version	Items (in order)	Mix
Middle School	1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 6, 7, 8, 9, 10, 11, 12, 13, 14, 15, 16	recall 9, inference 4, analysis 2, synthesis 1
HS Freshman	17, 18, 2, 3, 4, 19, 1, 20, 21, 13, 12, 10, 22, 23, 15, 24	recall 8, inference 4, analysis 3, synthesis 1
HS Sophomore	5, 4, 8, 20, 3, 2, 11, 13, 10, 21, 25, 15, 14, 22, 24, 16	recall 6, inference 5, analysis 3, synthesis 2
HS Junior	20, 7, 18, 9, 2, 21, 10, 25, 12, 11, 22, 15, 14, 23, 16, 26	recall 5, inference 5, analysis 4, synthesis 2
HS Senior	20, 8, 6, 27, 11, 25, 13, 21, 10, 14, 15, 23, 22, 26, 16, 28	recall 4, inference 5, analysis 4, synthesis 3
AP	20, 7, 8, 25, 10, 13, 21, 12, 15, 14, 22, 23, 26, 28, 16, 24	recall 3, inference 5, analysis 4, synthesis 4
College Freshman	20, 5, 27, 10, 13, 25, 11, 12, 22, 15, 14, 23, 26, 28, 16, 24	recall 3, inference 5, analysis 4, synthesis 4
College Sophomore	20, 7, 12, 11, 21, 13, 10, 25, 15, 23, 22, 14, 28, 26, 24, 16	recall 2, inference 6, analysis 4, synthesis 4
College Junior	20, 7, 13, 21, 25, 12, 11, 10, 14, 15, 22, 23, 24, 16, 28, 26	

		recall 2, inference 6, analysis 4, synthesis 4
College Senior	20, 7, 13, 21, 25, 12, 10, 11, 22, 15, 23, 14, 16, 26, 24, 28	recall 2, inference 6, analysis 4, synthesis 4
Graduate / PhD	20, 17, 21, 10, 11, 25, 12, 13, 14, 23, 15, 22, 28, 24, 16, 26	recall 2, inference 6, analysis 4, synthesis 4

Writing prompts (eleven rigor levels)

Middle School (250 words; Indiana 2023: 7.RC.3, 7.W.1): Supported track (work from the passage your teacher selects). In “Letter II,” how does Shelley show loneliness and the desire for a friend? Write a paragraph that states your claim, quotes two details from the passage, and explains how each detail supports your idea. Use the characterization you noticed as one piece of evidence.

HS Freshman (350 words; Indiana 2023: 9-10.RC.1, 9-10.W.1): In Letter II, how does Shelley develop the idea of loneliness and the desire for a friend? State a clear claim, support it with two or three quotations, and explain how the characterization in the chapter helps build that idea.

HS Sophomore (450 words; Indiana 2023: 9-10.RC.1, 9-10.W.1): Analyze how Letter II develops the idea of loneliness and the desire for a friend. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of characterization and theme shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.

HS Junior (550 words; Indiana 2023: 11-12.RC.3, 11-12.RC.1, 11-12.W.1): Analyze how the structure of Letter II (where it begins, turns and ends) and its characterization shape the reader's understanding of loneliness and the desire for a friend. Identify one place where the text leaves matters uncertain and explain how that uncertainty adds to its meaning.

HS Senior (600 words; Indiana 2023: 11-12.RC.1, 11-12.W.1): Two readers disagree about what Letter II suggests about loneliness and the desire for a friend. Lay out two plausible interpretations, weigh the evidence for each (including the chapter's characterization and theme), and argue for the stronger one in a sustained, well-organized essay.

AP (650 words; Indiana 2023: 11-12.RC.1, 11-12.W.1): Write a literary argument in which you analyze how Mary Shelley uses characterization in Letter II to complicate the reader's understanding of loneliness and the desire for a friend. Develop a defensible thesis, select evidence purposefully, and explain how specific choices of diction and syntax create meaning.

College Freshman (1000 words; Indiana 2023: see unit standards): Situate Letter II within its historical and literary context and argue how the chapter's treatment of loneliness and the desire for a friend responds to that context. Engage with at least one secondary perspective (a critic, historian or the author's own statements), integrate quotations smoothly, and cite in MLA style.

College Sophomore (1250 words; Indiana 2023: see unit standards): Read Letter II alongside the conventions of its genre and period. Argue how the chapter's handling of loneliness and the desire for a friend follows or

bends those conventions, using the characterization as evidence, and test your reading against one published critic. Document two secondary sources in MLA.

College Junior (1500 words; Indiana 2023: see unit standards): Apply a named critical approach (for example formalist, historicist, feminist, psychoanalytic or ecocritical) to Letter II and its treatment of loneliness and the desire for a friend. State your method, show what it reveals in the chapter's characterization and theme, and identify where the text resists it.

College Senior (2000 words; Indiana 2023: see unit standards): Develop a research argument that reads Letter II as evidence for a larger claim about loneliness and the desire for a friend in Frankenstein. Connect close reading of the chapter to the whole novel, engage at least four scholarly sources, and state precisely where your reading departs from theirs (Chicago style).

Graduate / PhD (2500 words; Indiana 2023: see unit standards): Develop an original argument that reads Letter II as a hinge in the novel's larger treatment of loneliness and the desire for a friend. Position your reading within a named critical conversation (for example formalist, historicist, psychoanalytic, feminist or postcolonial approaches), account for the textual history where relevant, and articulate the stakes of your intervention for scholarship on Frankenstein.

SAT-style questions

1. *Some years ago, he loved a young Russian lady, of moderate fortune; and having amassed a considerable sum in prize-money, the father of the girl consented to the match.*

   As used in the text, what does the word “amassed” most nearly mean?

   A. gentleness

   B. an act of traveling by water

   C. keeps

   D. gathered or collected a large amount of

2. *How slowly the time passes here, encompassed as I am by frost and snow; yet a second step is taken towards my enterprise. I have hired a vessel, and am occupied in collecting my sailors; those whom I have already engaged, appear to be men on whom I can depend, and are certainly possessed of dauntless courage.*

   Which choice best states a central concern of “Letter II”?

   A. First experiences of the senses

   B. Isolation in the north

   C. Loneliness and the desire for a friend

   D. A letter, a secret and the wedding

SAT key: 1. D (gathered or collected a large amount of); 2. C (Loneliness and the desire for a friend)

Lesson 6: Letter III

Focus: confidence before danger

Objective: Students will analyze how tone / mood develops in “Letter III” by writing a claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph that cites at least 2 quotations from the section, and will score at least 80% on the section quiz.

Standards: CCSS RL.9-10.4, W.9-10.1, L.9-10.4 · IN 9-10.RC.12, 9-10.W.1, 9-10.RC.9, 9-10.RC.11

Teacher only · spoilers

A brief letter: Walton reports that he is safe and well advanced on his voyage. He is full of confidence and determination despite floating ice.

Background: Short letters between long ones create pacing and suspense, a technique common in epistolary fiction.

Significance: Walton's optimism makes the coming crisis feel more dramatic and ironic.

Lesson plan and lecture script (90 minutes)

0–8 min · Bell-ringer · You do (8 min)
Students write to the bell-ringer, then pair-share.
Why might Shelley include such a short, cheerful letter here? Write for five minutes. Starters: I think... because... / This connects to ambition and knowledge because....
Prompt: Why might Shelley include such a short, cheerful letter here?
Sentence starters: I think… because… · This connects to ambition and knowledge because…
Strong response: A strong response takes a position and anticipates this: the "determined heart and resolved will of man" sounds heroic but is the attitude the novel interrogates.

8–18 min · Vocabulary with etymology notes · I do (10 min)
Five key words in context, with verified word histories.
*Today's words: pathless — without paths; untraveled; tracing — following the course of; marking out; indicating — showing; pointing to; homeward — oriented toward home; incidents — a single distinct event. “tracing”: From Middle English trace, traas, from Old French trace "an outline, track, trace", from the verb (see below). “indicating”: Latin indicātus, perfect passive participle of indicō "to point out, indicate" (see -ate), from in- "in, to" + dicō "to declare, (originally) to point". See also diction and index. “homeward”: From Middle English homward, from Old English hāmweard, from Proto-Germanic *haimawarda, equivalent to home + ward. Cognate with Dutch heimwaarts, German heimwärts "homeward". “incidents”: Recorded since 1412, from Middle French incident, from Latin incidens, the present active participle of incidō "to happen, befall", itself from in- "on" + -cidō, the combining form of cadō "to fall".*
Words: pathless: without paths; untraveled · tracing: following the course of; marking out · indicating: showing; pointing to · homeward: oriented toward home · incidents: a single distinct event

18–28 min · Background and context · I do (10 min)
Mini-lecture (read or adapt the script).
Short letters between long ones create pacing and suspense, a technique common in epistolary fiction. Walton's optimism makes the coming crisis feel more dramatic and ironic. Tone / mood: Brief and confident; exclamations replace doubt. The shortness itself contrasts with the dangers implied. Foreshadowing: His confidence ("Success shall crown my endeavours") is dramatic irony in a novel framed as a warning. Characterization: Walton writes that his "swelling heart" pours itself out: he is excitable and self-dramatizing. Watch for sublime nature: Mountains, glaciers, storms and lakes reflect and sometimes soothe the characters' feelings; the sublime is both comfort and terror. In this chapter: "apparently firm of purpose; nor do the floating sheets of ice that continually pass us, indicating the dangers of the region towards" (Letter III, paragraph 1).

28–40 min · I do: modeled close reading · I do (12 min)
Model the close reading of the anchor quotation using the written think-aloud below.
I read the line once for meaning and once for craft. "success shall crown my endeavours" (Letter III, paragraph 4). "Crown" suggests royal triumph; the promise reads as hubris. That is tone / mood at work: Brief and confident; exclamations replace doubt. The shortness itself contrasts with the dangers implied.

> *success shall crown my endeavours* (Letter III, paragraph 4)

Think-aloud: I read the line once for meaning and once for craft. "success shall crown my endeavours" (Letter III, paragraph 4). "Crown" suggests royal triumph; the promise reads as hubris. That is tone / mood at work: Brief and confident; exclamations replace doubt. The shortness itself contrasts with the dangers implied.

40–55 min · We do: guided annotation · We do (15 min)
Guided analysis of a second quotation; expected answers given.
Ask: What words in this line stand out, and what do they suggest? Expected: A rhetorical question the novel answers: nature, death and conscience can. Look at the craft: His confidence ("Success shall crown my endeavours") is dramatic irony in a novel framed as a warning. Ask: How does this line connect to ambition and knowledge? Expected: The "determined heart and resolved will of man" sounds heroic but is the attitude the novel interrogates. (A rhetorical question the novel answers: nature, death and conscience can.)

> *What can stop the determined heart and resolved will of man* (Letter III, paragraph 4)

Ask: What words in this line stand out, and what do they suggest?
Expected answer: A rhetorical question the novel answers: nature, death and conscience can. Look at the craft: His confidence ("Success shall crown my endeavours") is dramatic irony in a novel framed as a warning.
Ask: How does this line connect to ambition and knowledge?
Expected answer: The "determined heart and resolved will of man" sounds heroic but is the attitude the novel interrogates. (A rhetorical question the novel answers: nature, death and conscience can.)

55–70 min · You do: independent annotation · You do (15 min)

Independent annotation and a claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph (exemplar given).

Annotate the chapter for tone / mood, foreshadowing (three marks with a margin note each), then write one claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph: what does this chapter suggest about confidence before danger? Then start your writing prompt at your assigned level (HS Sophomore: Analyze how Letter III develops the idea of confidence before danger. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of tone / mood and foreshadowing shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.) Exemplar: Walton's certainty sets up the novel's warning about human will. When the text says "What can stop the determined heart and resolved will of man" (Letter III, paragraph 4), it shows this directly. Asking "What can stop the determined heart and resolved will of man?" assumes nothing can; the rest of the book, beginning with the ice that traps his ship, shows that something always does.

Task: Annotate the chapter for tone / mood, foreshadowing (three marks with a margin note each), then write one claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph: what does this chapter suggest about confidence before danger? Then start your writing prompt at your assigned level (HS Sophomore: Analyze how Letter III develops the idea of confidence before danger. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of tone / mood and foreshadowing shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.)

Exemplar: Walton's certainty sets up the novel's warning about human will. When the text says "What can stop the determined heart and resolved will of man" (Letter III, paragraph 4), it shows this directly. Asking "What can stop the determined heart and resolved will of man?" assumes nothing can; the rest of the book, beginning with the ice that traps his ship, shows that something always does.

70–80 min · Discussion · We do (10 min)

Structured discussion from the 30 tiered questions, with facilitation notes.

Anchor question: Why might Shelley include such a short, cheerful letter here? Have students answer Walton's question as Victor might at the end of the book.

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Facilitation: Have students answer Walton's question as Victor might at the end of the book.

80–87 min · Exit ticket / chapter quiz · You do (7 min)

Chapter quiz in the app and an exit ticket (answer given).

Chapter quiz in the app, then: In one sentence, what does this chapter suggest about confidence before danger? Support it with one short quotation. Model answer: Walton's certainty sets up the novel's warning about human will. ("What can stop the determined heart and resolved will of man", Letter III, paragraph 4). Accept any defensible claim backed by a quotation from the chapter; the answer key for the quiz is in the Quiz section.

Exit ticket: In one sentence, what does this chapter suggest about confidence before danger? Support it with one short quotation.

Answer: Model answer: Walton's certainty sets up the novel's warning about human will. ("What can stop the determined heart and resolved will of man", Letter III, paragraph 4). Accept any defensible claim backed by a quotation from the chapter; the answer key for the quiz is in the Quiz section.

> **87–90 min · Closure · I do (3 min)**
> Summarize the lesson and preview the next reading.
> *Today we saw how tone / mood shapes confidence before danger. Key takeaway: the "determined heart and resolved will of man" sounds heroic but is the attitude the novel interrogates.*

Total: 90 minutes.

Teacher analysis (spoilers)

Literary elements

- **Tone / mood:** Brief and confident; exclamations replace doubt. The shortness itself contrasts with the dangers implied.
- **Foreshadowing:** His confidence ("Success shall crown my endeavours") is dramatic irony in a novel framed as a warning.
- **Characterization:** Walton writes that his "swelling heart" pours itself out: he is excitable and self-dramatizing.

Themes and how they develop

- **ambition and knowledge:** the "determined heart and resolved will of man" sounds heroic but is the attitude the novel interrogates.

Symbols and motifs

- **sublime nature:** Mountains, glaciers, storms and lakes reflect and sometimes soothe the characters' feelings; the sublime is both comfort and terror. In this chapter: “apparently firm of purpose; nor do the floating sheets of ice that continually pass us, indicating the dangers of the region towards” (Letter III, paragraph 1).

Key quotations (checked against the reading text)

- “success shall crown my endeavours” (Letter III, paragraph 4) "Crown" suggests royal triumph; the promise reads as hubris.
- “What can stop the determined heart and resolved will of man” (Letter III, paragraph 4) A rhetorical question the novel answers: nature, death and conscience can.
- “My swelling heart involuntarily pours itself out thus” (Letter III, paragraph 5) Walton admits his feelings run away with him, a trait he shares with Victor.

Model claim-evidence-reasoning

Claim: Walton's certainty sets up the novel's warning about human will.
Evidence: “What can stop the determined heart and resolved will of man” (Letter III, paragraph 4)
Reasoning: Asking "What can stop the determined heart and resolved will of man?" assumes nothing can; the rest of the book, beginning with the ice that traps his ship, shows that something always does.

Vocabulary with etymology notes

Word	Definition (in this sentence)	In context	Word history
pathless (adjective)	without paths; untraveled	*Thus far I have gone, tracing a secure way over the pathless seas: the very stars themselves being witnesses and testimonies of my triumph.*	
tracing (verb)	following the course of; marking out	*Thus far I have gone, tracing a secure way over the pathless seas: the very stars themselves being witnesses and testimonies of my triumph.*	"tracing": From Middle English trace, traas, from Old French trace "an outline, track, trace", from the verb (see below). (Wiktionary, https://en.wiktionary.org/wiki/trace#Etymology)
indicating (verb)	showing; pointing to	*I am, however, in good spirits: my men are bold, and apparently firm of purpose; nor do the floating sheets of ice that continually pass us, indicating the dangers of the region towards which we are advancing, appear to dismay them.*	"indicating": Latin indicātus, perfect passive participle of indicō "to point out, indicate" (see -ate), from in- "in, to" + dicō "to declare, (originally) to point". See also diction and index. (Wiktionary, https://en.wiktionary.org/wiki/indicate#Etymology)
homeward (adjective)	oriented toward home	*This letter will reach England by a merchantman now on its homeward voyage from Archangel; more fortunate than I, who may not see my native land, perhaps, for many years.*	"homeward": From Middle English homward, from Old English hāmweard, from Proto-Germanic *haimawarda, equivalent to home + ward. Cognate with Dutch heimwaarts, German heimwärts "homeward". (Wiktionary, https://en.wiktionary.org/wiki/homeward#Etymology)
incidents (noun)	a single distinct event	*No incidents have hitherto befallen us that would make a figure in a letter.*	"incidents": Recorded since 1412, from Middle French incident, from Latin incidens, the present active participle of incidō "to happen, befall", itself from in- "on" + -cidō, the combining form of cadō "to fall". (Wiktionary, https://en.wiktionary.org/wiki/incident#Etymology)
accidents (noun)	an unfortunate mishap; especially one causing damage or injury	*One or two stiff gales, and the springing of a leak, are accidents which experienced navigators scarcely remember to record; and I shall be well content if nothing worse happen to us during our voyage.*	

obedient (adjective)	dutifully complying with the commands or instructions of those in authority	*Why not still proceed over the untamed yet obedient element?*	“obedient”: From Middle English obedient, from Old French obedient, from Latin oboediēns, present active participle of oboediō "obey". (Wiktionary, https://en.wiktionary.org/wiki/obedient#Etymology)
floating (adjective)	drifting on water	*I am, however, in good spirits: my men are bold, and apparently firm of purpose; nor do the floating sheets of ice that continually pass us, indicating the dangers of the region towards which we are advancing, appear to dismay them.*	“floating”: By surface analysis, float + -ing. (Wiktionary, https://en.wiktionary.org/wiki/floating#Etymology)
prudent (adjective)	careful and sensible; marked by sound judgment	*I will be cool, persevering, and prudent.*	
advancing (verb)	move forward, also in the metaphorical sense	*I am, however, in good spirits: my men are bold, and apparently firm of purpose; nor do the floating sheets of ice that continually pass us, indicating the dangers of the region towards which we are advancing, appear to dismay them.*	

Discussion questions

1. Why might Shelley include such a short, cheerful letter here?
2. Where does tone / mood appear in this chapter, and what effect does it have? Point to one passage.
3. How does this chapter connect to the book's larger concern with the sublime power of nature?

Classroom discussion questions (30, tiered)

Wait time after every question (3 s for DOK 1, 5 s for DOK 2, 8 to 10 s for DOK 3 and 4); think-pair-share on DOK 3 and 4; answer each response with a follow-up probe; close with student-generated questions. Focus sets by rigor level: Middle School: 1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 6, 11, 12, 13, 14, 21, 22; HS Freshman: 1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 12, 13, 14, 15, 22, 23, 24; HS Sophomore: 1, 2, 3, 4, 13, 14, 15, 16, 17, 23, 24, 25; HS Junior: 1, 2, 3, 14, 15, 16, 17, 18, 24, 25, 26, 27; HS Senior: 1, 2, 3, 15, 16, 17, 18, 25, 26, 27, 28, 29; AP: 1, 2, 16, 17, 18, 19, 20, 26, 27, 28, 29, 30; College Freshman: 1, 2, 17, 18, 19, 20, 21, 22, 27, 28, 29, 30; College Sophomore: 1, 2, 11, 18, 19, 20, 21, 22, 23, 28, 29, 30; College Junior: 1, 11, 12, 19, 20, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 29, 30; College Senior: 1, 11, 12, 13, 20, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 26, 30; Graduate / PhD: 1, 11, 12, 13, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 26, 27, 28

Literal / recall

1. How does Walton feel in Letter III? [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · 7.RC.1, 7.CC.1, 9-10.RC.1] Look for: Confident and determined

2. What danger does he mention seeing? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · 7.RC.1, 7.CC.1, 9-10.RC.1] Look for: Floating sheets of ice
3. What is the main purpose of this letter? [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · 7.RC.1, 7.CC.1, 9-10.RC.1] Look for: To reassure Margaret he is safe
4. What does Walton's confidence create for the reader? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · 7.RC.1, 7.CC.1, 9-10.RC.1] Look for: Dramatic irony and suspense
5. Which word best describes Walton's attitude? [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · 7.RC.1, 7.CC.1, 9-10.RC.1] Look for: Resolute
6. Retell the three most important events of "Letter III" in order, in one sentence each. [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · 7.RC.1, 7.CC.1, 9-10.RC.1] Look for: A brief letter: Walton reports that he is safe and well advanced on his voyage. He is full of confidence and determination despite floating ice.
7. Which characters appear or are mentioned in "Letter III"? Name two and one thing each says or does. [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · 7.RC.1, 7.CC.1, 9-10.RC.1] Look for: Names and actions taken from the chapter; check against the teacher summary.
8. Where and when does "Letter III" take place? Point to the line that tells you. [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · 7.RC.1, 7.CC.1, 9-10.RC.1] Look for: A place/time detail quoted from the chapter.
9. Reread: "Thus far I have gone, tracing a secure way over the pathless seas: the very stars themselves being witnesses and testimonies of my triumph." What does "pathless" mean here, and what is literally happening in this line? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · 7.RC.1, 7.CC.1, 9-10.RC.1] Look for: pathless: without paths; untraveled.
10. Reread: "Thus far I have gone, tracing a secure way over the pathless seas: the very stars themselves being witnesses and testimonies of my triumph." What does "tracing" mean here, and what is literally happening in this line? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · 7.RC.1, 7.CC.1, 9-10.RC.1] Look for: tracing: following the course of; marking out.

Inferential / analytical

1. What does "Letter III" suggest about confidence before danger? State the inference and the line that supports it. [DOK 2 · thinkPairShare · wait 5 s · 7.RC.2, 7.CC.2, 9-10.RC.2] Look for: Walton's optimism makes the coming crisis feel more dramatic and ironic.
2. Find one example of tone / mood in this chapter. What does it reveal that a plain statement would not? [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · 7.RC.12, 7.CC.2, 9-10.RC.12] Look for: Look for word choices that reveal the narrator's attitude or the scene's feeling.
3. How does the foreshadowing in this chapter shape what we understand about confidence before danger? [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · 7.RC.3, 7.CC.2, 9-10.RC.3] Look for: Look for hints, warnings or images that point to later events.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Walton's certainty sets up the novel's warning about human will. Useful evidence: "success shall crown my endeavours" (Letter III, paragraph 4): "Crown" suggests royal triumph; the promise reads as hubris. On foreshadowing: His confidence ("Success shall crown my endeavours") is dramatic irony in a novel framed as a warning. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
4. In the passage that begins "No incidents have hitherto befallen us that would make a figure in a letter.", why might Shelley have chosen these particular words? Pick two and explain their connotations. [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · 7.RC.12, 7.CC.2, 9-10.RC.12] Look for: Diction analysis of two words in the anchor passage.

5. What causes the main turn in “Letter III”, and what effect is it likely to have on what follows? [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · 7.RC.3, 7.CC.2, 9-10.RC.1] Look for: A brief letter: Walton reports that he is safe and well advanced on his voyage. He is full of confidence and determination despite floating ice.
6. How does “Letter III” build on “Letter II”? Name one link of cause and effect. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · 7.RC.3, 7.CC.2, 9-10.RC.3] Look for: A causal or structural link between this and the previous chapter.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Walton's certainty sets up the novel's warning about human will. Useful evidence: “What can stop the determined heart and resolved will of man” (Letter III, paragraph 4): A rhetorical question the novel answers: nature, death and conscience can. Theme link: the "determined heart and resolved will of man" sounds heroic but is the attitude the novel interrogates. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
7. What can we infer about a character's motives from what they say and do here, as opposed to what they claim? [DOK 3 · followUp · wait 8 s · 7.RC.3, 7.CC.2, 9-10.RC.1] Look for: An inference about motive supported by a quoted line.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Walton's certainty sets up the novel's warning about human will. Useful evidence: “My swelling heart involuntarily pours itself out thus” (Letter III, paragraph 5): Walton admits his feelings run away with him, a trait he shares with Victor. On characterization: Walton writes that his "swelling heart" pours itself out: he is excitable and self-dramatizing. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
8. The bell-ringer asked: “Why might Shelley include such a short, cheerful letter here?” Now that we have read closely, how would you revise your first answer, and which line changed your mind? [DOK 2 · thinkPairShare · wait 5 s · 7.RC.2, 7.CC.2, 9-10.RC.2] Look for: A revised answer anchored in the text.
9. Where does setting appear, and how does it connect this chapter to the larger concern with the sublime power of nature? [DOK 3 · followUp · wait 8 s · 7.RC.3, 7.CC.2, 9-10.RC.1] Look for: Look for where and when events happen and how place shapes action or feeling.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Walton's certainty sets up the novel's warning about human will. Useful evidence: “success shall crown my endeavours” (Letter III, paragraph 4): "Crown" suggests royal triumph; the promise reads as hubris. Theme link: the "determined heart and resolved will of man" sounds heroic but is the attitude the novel interrogates. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
10. Background: Short letters between long ones create pacing and suspense, a technique common in epistolary fiction. How does knowing this change the way you read one moment in the chapter? [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · 7.RC.3, 7.CC.2, 9-10.RC.1] Look for: A specific moment reread in light of the context.

    Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Walton's certainty sets up the novel's warning about human will. Useful evidence: “What can stop the determined heart and resolved will of man” (Letter III, paragraph 4): A rhetorical question the novel answers: nature, death and conscience can. Theme link: the "determined heart and resolved will of man" sounds heroic but is the attitude the novel interrogates. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

Evaluative / synthesis / creative

1. A critic might argue: “Walton's optimism makes the coming crisis feel more dramatic and ironic.” How far do you agree? Take a stand and defend it with two lines from the chapter. [DOK 3 · fourCorners · wait 8 s · 7.RC.2, 7.CC.3, 9-10.RC.2] Look for: A defended position with evidence and one counterpoint.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Walton's certainty sets up the novel's warning about human will. Useful evidence: “My swelling heart involuntarily pours itself out thus” (Letter III, paragraph 5): Walton admits his feelings run away with him, a trait he shares with Victor. Theme link: the "determined heart and resolved will of man" sounds heroic but is the attitude the novel interrogates. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
2. Which character in this chapter acts most wisely, and which least? Judge them by a standard you name. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · 7.RC.3, 7.CC.3, 9-10.RC.1] Look for: An evaluation using an explicit criterion and evidence.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Walton's certainty sets up the novel's warning about human will. Useful evidence: “success shall crown my endeavours” (Letter III, paragraph 4): "Crown" suggests royal triumph; the promise reads as hubris. On characterization: Walton writes that his "swelling heart" pours itself out: he is excitable and self-dramatizing. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
3. Rewrite one moment of “Letter III” from the point of view of a different character. What does the new angle reveal or hide about confidence before danger? [DOK 4 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · 7.RC.1, 7.CC.3, 9-10.RC.1] Look for: A creative product with a rationale tied to the text.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Walton's certainty sets up the novel's warning about human will. Useful evidence: “What can stop the determined heart and resolved will of man” (Letter III, paragraph 4): A rhetorical question the novel answers: nature, death and conscience can. Theme link: the "determined heart and resolved will of man" sounds heroic but is the attitude the novel interrogates. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
4. Write three questions of your own about “Letter III”: one recall, one “why/how”, and one “should/what if”. Trade with a partner and answer theirs. [DOK 3 · studentGenerated · wait 8 s · 7.RC.2, 7.CC.3, 9-10.RC.2] Look for: Student-generated questions at three levels.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Walton's certainty sets up the novel's warning about human will. Useful evidence: “My swelling heart involuntarily pours itself out thus” (Letter III, paragraph 5): Walton admits his feelings run away with him, a trait he shares with Victor. Theme link: the "determined heart and resolved will of man" sounds heroic but is the attitude the novel interrogates. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
5. Connect this chapter to the costs of unchecked ambition: is the link strong or weak so far? What would Shelley need to show next to strengthen it? [DOK 4 · socraticCircle · wait 8 s · 7.RC.2, 7.CC.3, 9-10.RC.2] Look for: A judgment of thematic development across the work.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Walton's certainty sets up the novel's warning about human will. Useful evidence: “success shall crown my endeavours” (Letter III, paragraph 4): "Crown" suggests royal triumph; the promise reads as hubris. Theme link: the "determined heart and resolved will

of man" sounds heroic but is the attitude the novel interrogates. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

6. Is the tone / mood in this chapter effective, or does it feel heavy-handed? Evaluate it as a reader would in a review. [DOK 3 · fourCorners · wait 8 s · 7.RC.12, 7.CC.3, 9-10.RC.12] Look for: An evaluative judgment with criteria and evidence.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Walton's certainty sets up the novel's warning about human will. Useful evidence: “What can stop the determined heart and resolved will of man” (Letter III, paragraph 4): A rhetorical question the novel answers: nature, death and conscience can. On tone / mood: Brief and confident; exclamations replace doubt. The shortness itself contrasts with the dangers implied. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

7. Compare how “Letter III” treats confidence before danger with how another text, film or event you know treats a similar idea. What does Frankenstein see that the other misses? [DOK 4 · socraticCircle · wait 8 s · 7.RC.2, 7.CC.3, 9-10.RC.2] Look for: A cross-text synthesis.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Walton's certainty sets up the novel's warning about human will. Useful evidence: “My swelling heart involuntarily pours itself out thus” (Letter III, paragraph 5): Walton admits his feelings run away with him, a trait he shares with Victor. Theme link: the "determined heart and resolved will of man" sounds heroic but is the attitude the novel interrogates. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

8. Predict what “Letter IV” will bring, using two clues from this chapter. After reading, evaluate your prediction. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · 7.RC.3, 7.CC.3, 9-10.RC.3] Look for: A prediction or judgment justified with textual clues.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Walton's certainty sets up the novel's warning about human will. Useful evidence: “success shall crown my endeavours” (Letter III, paragraph 4): "Crown" suggests royal triumph; the promise reads as hubris. On foreshadowing: His confidence ("Success shall crown my endeavours") is dramatic irony in a novel framed as a warning. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

9. Design a one-paragraph modern adaptation of this chapter (setting, characters, conflict). What must stay the same for it to still be about confidence before danger? [DOK 4 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · 7.RC.2, 7.CC.3, 9-10.RC.2] Look for: A creative transfer that keeps the core idea.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Walton's certainty sets up the novel's warning about human will. Useful evidence: “What can stop the determined heart and resolved will of man” (Letter III, paragraph 4): A rhetorical question the novel answers: nature, death and conscience can. Theme link: the "determined heart and resolved will of man" sounds heroic but is the attitude the novel interrogates. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

10. What question would you most like to ask Mary Shelley about this chapter, and what answer do you think the text itself gives? [DOK 4 · studentGenerated · wait 8 s · 7.RC.2, 7.CC.3, 9-10.RC.2] Look for: A student-generated question answered from evidence.

    Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Walton's certainty sets up the novel's warning about human will. Useful evidence: “My swelling heart involuntarily pours itself out thus” (Letter III, paragraph 5): Walton admits his feelings run away with him, a trait he shares with Victor. Theme link: the

"determined heart and resolved will of man" sounds heroic but is the attitude the novel interrogates. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

Annotation focus

- **Tone / mood:** look for word choices that reveal the narrator's attitude or the scene's feeling (anchor passage in the We do segment)
- Also notice **Foreshadowing**: hints, warnings or images that point to later events
- Also notice **Setting**: where and when events happen and how place shapes action or feeling

Chapter quiz: item bank (all eleven rigor versions)

1. [mc · recall · DOK 1] In the line "I am, however, in good spirits: my men are bold, and apparently firm of purpose; nor do the floating sheets of ice that continually pass us, indicating the dangers of the region towards which we are advancing, appear to…", what does "indicating" most nearly mean?

   A. showing; pointing to

   B. shines faintly

   C. set free

   D. express strong disapproval of; deplore

   Key: A (showing; pointing to)

2. [fill · recall · DOK 1] Fill in the blank with the vocabulary word that fits: "Why not still proceed over the untamed yet _____ element?" Word bank: tracing, indicating, pathless, obedient

   Key: obedient

3. [fill · recall · DOK 1] Fill in the blank with the vocabulary word that fits: "I am, however, in good spirits: my men are bold, and apparently firm of purpose; nor do the _____ sheets of ice that continually pass us, indicating the dangers of the region towards which we are advancing, appear to dismay them." Word bank: tracing, pathless, indicating, floating

   Key: floating

4. [mc · recall · DOK 1] What danger does he mention seeing?

   A. Floating sheets of ice

   B. A whale attack

   C. A volcano

   D. A pirate ship

   Key: A (Floating sheets of ice)

5. [fill · recall · DOK 1] Fill in the blank with the vocabulary word that fits: "One or two stiff gales, and the springing of a leak, are _____ which experienced navigators scarcely remember to record; and I shall be well content if nothing worse happen to us during our voyage." Word bank: indicating, tracing, pathless, accidents

   Key: accidents

6. [fill · recall · DOK 1] Complete the quotation from Letter III, paragraph 5: "My swelling heart _____ pours itself out thus"

   Key: involuntarily

7. [mc · recall · DOK 1] How does Walton feel in Letter III?

   A. Confident and determined

   B. Ill and weak

   C. Terrified

   D. Ready to turn back

   Key: A (Confident and determined)

8. [fill · recall · DOK 1] Fill in the blank with the vocabulary word that fits: “No _____ have hitherto befallen us that would make a figure in a letter.” Word bank: tracing, indicating, incidents, pathless

   Key: incidents

9. [fill · recall · DOK 1] Complete the quotation from Letter III, paragraph 4: “What can stop the _____ heart and resolved will of man”

   Key: determined

10. [short · inference · DOK 2] What can you infer from this line? “What can stop the determined heart and resolved will of man” (Letter III, paragraph 4) Answer in two or three sentences with one detail.

    Sample answer: A rhetorical question the novel answers: nature, death and conscience can.

11. [mc · inference · DOK 2] What does this passage most clearly show? “success shall crown my endeavours” (Letter III, paragraph 4)

    A. Elizabeth is presented as a gift; useful for discussions of how women are treated in the novel.

    B. Places the book in real time and place; compare with the 1831 Introduction's fuller account.

    C. Victor's fear of consequences.

    D. "Crown" suggests royal triumph; the promise reads as hubris.

    Key: D ("Crown" suggests royal triumph; the promise reads as hubris.)

12. [mc · inference · DOK 2] What does this passage most clearly show? “My swelling heart involuntarily pours itself out thus” (Letter III, paragraph 5)

    A. Guilt imagined as hell.

    B. Blunt, short sentence in the father's letter.

    C. Walton admits his feelings run away with him, a trait he shares with Victor.

    D. The wish to belong.

    Key: C (Walton admits his feelings run away with him, a trait he shares with Victor.)

13. [mc · inference · DOK 2] Which choice best states a central concern of “Letter III”?

    A. Recovery and false peace

    B. A letter, a secret and the wedding

    C. Confidence before danger

    D. Language, knowledge and sorrow

    Key: C (Confidence before danger)

14. [short · analysis · DOK 3] Claim: Walton's certainty sets up the novel's warning about human will. Explain how this evidence supports the claim: “What can stop the determined heart and resolved will of man” (Letter III, paragraph 4).

    Sample answer: Asking "What can stop the determined heart and resolved will of man?" assumes nothing can; the rest of the book, beginning with the ice that traps his ship, shows that something always does.

15. [mc · analysis · DOK 3] Which literary element does this describe in “Letter III”? His confidence ("Success shall crown my endeavours") is dramatic irony in a novel framed as a warning.

    A. Conflict

    B. Foreshadowing

    C. Theme

    D. Point of view

    Key: B (Foreshadowing)

16. [short · synthesis · DOK 4] Close reading: how do the diction and syntax of “success shall crown my endeavours” (Letter III, paragraph 4) shape its meaning? Consider a second, competing reading.

    Sample answer: "Crown" suggests royal triumph; the promise reads as hubris.

17. [mc · recall · DOK 1] Which word best describes Walton's attitude?

    A. Regretful

    B. Resolute

    C. Indifferent

    D. Defeated

    Key: B (Resolute)

18. [mc · recall · DOK 1] In the line “Thus far I have gone, tracing a secure way over the pathless seas: the very stars themselves being witnesses and testimonies of my triumph.”, what does “pathless” most nearly mean?

    A. covered overhead like a canopy

    B. in a kind, well-meaning way

    C. hold spellbound

    D. without paths; untraveled

    Key: D (without paths; untraveled)

19. [mc · recall · DOK 1] In the line “This letter will reach England by a merchantman now on its homeward voyage from Archangel; more fortunate than I, who may not see my native land, perhaps, for many years.”, what does “homeward” most nearly mean?

    A. cause aversion in; offend the moral sense of

    B. longed for something strongly

    C. oriented toward home

    D. uselessness as a consequence of having no practical result

    Key: C (oriented toward home)

20. [short · inference · DOK 2] What can you infer from this line? “success shall crown my endeavours” (Letter III, paragraph 4) Answer in two or three sentences with one detail.

    Sample answer: "Crown" suggests royal triumph; the promise reads as hubris.

21. [mc · analysis · DOK 3] Which literary element does this describe in “Letter III”? Brief and confident; exclamations replace doubt. The shortness itself contrasts with the dangers implied.

    A. Plot

    B. Tone / mood

    C. Theme

    D. Metaphor

Key: B (Tone / mood)

22. [short · analysis · DOK 3] Analyze the word choice in “My swelling heart involuntarily pours itself out thus” (Letter III, paragraph 5). Pick two words and explain what they suggest.
    Sample answer: Walton admits his feelings run away with him, a trait he shares with Victor.
23. [short · synthesis · DOK 4] Evaluate this claim about the chapter: “Walton's certainty sets up the novel's warning about human will.” Is it fully persuasive? Argue with evidence, including a passage that complicates it.
    Sample answer: Asking "What can stop the determined heart and resolved will of man?" assumes nothing can; the rest of the book, beginning with the ice that traps his ship, shows that something always does.
24. [mc · recall · DOK 1] What does Walton's confidence create for the reader?
    A. Certainty of success
    B. Boredom
    C. Comedy
    D. Dramatic irony and suspense

    Key: D (Dramatic irony and suspense)
25. [mc · inference · DOK 2] What does this passage most clearly show? “What can stop the determined heart and resolved will of man” (Letter III, paragraph 4)
    A. Elizabeth's letter opens with domestic affection, recalling the Preface's stated aim.
    B. Benevolence repaid with treachery.
    C. A rhetorical question the novel answers: nature, death and conscience can.
    D. Milton allusion; the creature casts Victor as a God who failed.

    Key: C (A rhetorical question the novel answers: nature, death and conscience can.)
26. [short · synthesis · DOK 4] Synthesis: trace how ambition and knowledge develops from an earlier chapter to “Letter III”. Use one quotation from each.
    Sample answer: the "determined heart and resolved will of man" sounds heroic but is the attitude the novel interrogates.
27. [mc · recall · DOK 1] What is the main purpose of this letter?
    A. To ask for money
    B. To describe Victor
    C. To announce his marriage
    D. To reassure Margaret he is safe

    Key: D (To reassure Margaret he is safe)
28. [short · synthesis · DOK 4] Close reading: how do the diction and syntax of “What can stop the determined heart and resolved will of man” (Letter III, paragraph 4) shape its meaning? Consider a second, competing reading.
    Sample answer: A rhetorical question the novel answers: nature, death and conscience can.

Rigor version	Items (in order)	Mix
Middle School	1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 6, 7, 8, 9, 10, 11, 12, 13, 14, 15, 16	recall 9, inference 4, analysis 2, synthesis 1
HS Freshman	4, 1, 17, 18, 3, 5, 19, 7, 10, 11, 20, 13, 15, 21, 22, 23	recall 8, inference 4, analysis 3, synthesis 1
HS Sophomore	3, 19, 7, 24, 18, 6, 20, 13, 12, 11, 25, 22, 15, 21, 26, 23	recall 6, inference 5, analysis 3, synthesis 2

HS Junior	3, 8, 17, 7, 19, 25, 13, 12, 20, 11, 15, 14, 22, 21, 23, 16	recall 5, inference 5, analysis 4, synthesis 2
HS Senior	6, 3, 4, 27, 11, 13, 25, 20, 12, 22, 15, 21, 14, 28, 23, 26	recall 4, inference 5, analysis 4, synthesis 3
AP	8, 9, 27, 20, 12, 25, 13, 11, 14, 22, 15, 21, 28, 23, 16, 26	recall 3, inference 5, analysis 4, synthesis 4
College Freshman	5, 6, 18, 10, 20, 12, 25, 13, 21, 15, 14, 22, 16, 23, 28, 26	recall 3, inference 5, analysis 4, synthesis 4
College Sophomore	5, 8, 12, 20, 25, 10, 11, 13, 21, 14, 15, 22, 16, 23, 26, 28	recall 2, inference 6, analysis 4, synthesis 4
College Junior	8, 9, 25, 13, 10, 20, 12, 11, 14, 21, 22, 15, 26, 16, 28, 23	recall 2, inference 6, analysis 4, synthesis 4
College Senior	8, 5, 11, 20, 25, 10, 12, 13, 22, 15, 21, 14, 26, 28, 23, 16	recall 2, inference 6, analysis 4, synthesis 4
Graduate / PhD	8, 9, 12, 20, 13, 11, 25, 10, 15, 21, 14, 22, 28, 16, 23, 26	recall 2, inference 6, analysis 4, synthesis 4

Writing prompts (eleven rigor levels)

Middle School (250 words; Indiana 2023: 7.RC.12, 7.W.1): Supported track (work from the passage your teacher selects). In “Letter III,” how does Shelley show confidence before danger? Write a paragraph that states your claim, quotes two details from the passage, and explains how each detail supports your idea. Use the tone / mood you noticed as one piece of evidence.

HS Freshman (350 words; Indiana 2023: 9-10.RC.12, 9-10.W.1): In Letter III, how does Shelley develop the idea of confidence before danger? State a clear claim, support it with two or three quotations, and explain how the tone / mood in the chapter helps build that idea.

HS Sophomore (450 words; Indiana 2023: 9-10.RC.12, 9-10.W.1): Analyze how Letter III develops the idea of confidence before danger. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of tone / mood and foreshadowing shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.

HS Junior (550 words; Indiana 2023: 11-12.RC.3, 11-12.RC.1, 11-12.W.1): Analyze how the structure of Letter III (where it begins, turns and ends) and its tone / mood shape the reader's understanding of confidence before danger. Identify one place where the text leaves matters uncertain and explain how that uncertainty adds to its meaning.

HS Senior (600 words; Indiana 2023: 11-12.RC.13, 11-12.W.1): Two readers disagree about what Letter III suggests about confidence before danger. Lay out two plausible interpretations, weigh the evidence for each (including the chapter's tone / mood and foreshadowing), and argue for the stronger one in a sustained, well-organized essay.

AP (650 words; Indiana 2023: 11-12.RC.13, 11-12.W.1): Write a literary argument in which you analyze how Mary Shelley uses tone / mood in Letter III to complicate the reader's understanding of confidence before danger. Develop a defensible thesis, select evidence purposefully, and explain how specific choices of diction and syntax create meaning.

College Freshman (1000 words; Indiana 2023: see unit standards): Situate Letter III within its historical and literary context and argue how the chapter's treatment of confidence before danger responds to that context.

Engage with at least one secondary perspective (a critic, historian or the author's own statements), integrate quotations smoothly, and cite in MLA style.

College Sophomore (1250 words; Indiana 2023: see unit standards): Read Letter III alongside the conventions of its genre and period. Argue how the chapter's handling of confidence before danger follows or bends those conventions, using the tone / mood as evidence, and test your reading against one published critic. Document two secondary sources in MLA.

College Junior (1500 words; Indiana 2023: see unit standards): Apply a named critical approach (for example formalist, historicist, feminist, psychoanalytic or ecocritical) to Letter III and its treatment of confidence before danger. State your method, show what it reveals in the chapter's tone / mood and foreshadowing, and identify where the text resists it.

College Senior (2000 words; Indiana 2023: see unit standards): Develop a research argument that reads Letter III as evidence for a larger claim about confidence before danger in Frankenstein. Connect close reading of the chapter to the whole novel, engage at least four scholarly sources, and state precisely where your reading departs from theirs (Chicago style).

Graduate / PhD (2500 words; Indiana 2023: see unit standards): Develop an original argument that reads Letter III as a hinge in the novel's larger treatment of confidence before danger. Position your reading within a named critical conversation (for example formalist, historicist, psychoanalytic, feminist or postcolonial approaches), account for the textual history where relevant, and articulate the stakes of your intervention for scholarship on Frankenstein.

SAT-style questions

1. *I am, however, in good spirits: my men are bold, and apparently firm of purpose; nor do the floating sheets of ice that continually pass us, indicating the dangers of the region towards which we are advancing, appear to dismay them.*

   As used in the text, what does the word “indicating” most nearly mean?

   A. showing; pointing to

   B. drifting on water

   C. careful and sensible; marked by sound judgment

   D. move forward, also in the metaphorical sense

2. *No incidents have hitherto befallen us that would make a figure in a letter. One or two stiff gales, and the springing of a leak, are accidents which experienced navigators scarcely remember to record; and I shall be well content if nothing worse happen to us during our voyage.*

   Which choice best states a central concern of “Letter III”?

   A. Loss and leaving home

   B. Isolation in the north

   C. Injustice and the burden of silence

   D. Confidence before danger

SAT key: 1. A (showing; pointing to); 2. D (Confidence before danger)

Lesson 7: Letter IV

Focus: the meeting of two ambitious men

Objective: Students will analyze how foreshadowing develops in “Letter IV” by writing a claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph that cites at least 2 quotations from the section, and will score at least 80% on the section quiz.

Standards: CCSS RL.9-10.5, W.9-10.1, L.9-10.4 · IN 9-10.RC.3, 9-10.W.1, 9-10.RC.9, 9-10.RC.11

Teacher only · spoilers

Trapped in ice, Walton's crew sees a giant figure on a dog sled, and the next morning rescues a frozen, exhausted stranger: Victor Frankenstein. Victor recovers slowly, becomes Walton's friend, and, hearing of Walton's ambition, agrees to tell his own story as a warning.

Background: The frame (Walton) now opens into Victor's narrative, a 'story within a story' structure called a nested or frame narrative.

Significance: Victor's warning, 'Learn from me,' makes the whole novel a cautionary tale addressed to Walton and to the reader.

Lesson plan and lecture script (90 minutes)

> **0–8 min · Bell-ringer · You do (8 min)**
> Students write to the bell-ringer, then pair-share.
> *Victor says he will tell his story so Walton may learn from it. What lesson do you predict? Write for five minutes. Starters: I think... because... / This connects to ambition and knowledge because....*
> **Prompt:** Victor says he will tell his story so Walton may learn from it. What lesson do you predict?
> **Sentence starters:** I think… because… · This connects to ambition and knowledge because…
> **Strong response:** A strong response takes a position and anticipates this: Victor recognizes himself in Walton and warns him; the story becomes a cautionary tale told for a listener's benefit.

8–18 min · Vocabulary with etymology notes · I do (10 min)
Five key words in context, with verified word histories.
Today's words: capitulated — gave in; agreed to terms (here, bargained for his safety); tutored — taught; educated; telescopes — instruments that make distant objects look closer; rawness — cold, damp harshness; eventual — expected to follow in the indefinite future from causes already operating. “capitulated”: From Medieval Latin capitulare "to draw up under headings," from capitulum "little head, chapter," from caput "head"; hence arranging terms, then surrendering on terms. “tutored”: From Middle English tutour, from Old French tuteur (French tuteur), from Latin tūtor "a watcher, protector, guardian", from tueor "protect"; see tuition. “telescopes”: From tele- + -scope. From Latin tēlescopium, from Ancient Greek τηλεσκόπος *"far-seeing", from* τῆλε *"afar" +* σκοπέω *"to look at".*
Words: capitulated: gave in; agreed to terms (here, bargained for his safety) · tutored: taught; educated · telescopes: instruments that make distant objects look closer · rawness: cold, damp harshness · eventual: expected to follow in the indefinite future from causes already operating

18–28 min · Background and context · I do (10 min)
Mini-lecture (read or adapt the script).
The frame (Walton) now opens into Victor's narrative, a 'story within a story' structure called a nested or frame narrative. Victor's warning, 'Learn from me,' makes the whole novel a cautionary tale addressed to Walton and to the reader. Structure: Letter IV turns the frame: Walton meets Victor and becomes the listener. From here the story nests: Walton tells Victor's story, which will contain the creature's. Characterization: Victor appears ruined but eloquent; Walton instantly loves him. Watch Victor's warning speech, which is a teacher's speech. Imagery: The first glimpse is of a "being which had the shape of a man, but apparently of gigantic stature" on a dog-sledge: we see the creature before we know him. Watch for light and fire: Light stands for knowledge and fire for its double edge: warmth and burning. Victor seeks the "light" of discovery; the creature discovers fire and is burned by it. In this chapter: “In the morning, however, as soon as it was light, I went upon deck, and found all the sailors busy on” (Letter IV, paragraph 6).

28–40 min · I do: modeled close reading · I do (12 min)
Model the close reading of the anchor quotation using the written think-aloud below.
I read the line once for meaning and once for craft. “a being which had the shape of a man, but apparently of gigantic stature” (Letter IV, paragraph 3). Ambiguity ("shape of a man") makes the creature's humanity a question from his first appearance. That is structure at work: Letter IV turns the frame: Walton meets Victor and becomes the listener. From here the story nests: Walton tells Victor's story, which will contain the creature's.

> *a being which had the shape of a man, but apparently of gigantic stature (Letter IV, paragraph 3)*

Think-aloud: I read the line once for meaning and once for craft. “a being which had the shape of a man, but apparently of gigantic stature” (Letter IV, paragraph 3). Ambiguity ("shape of a man") makes the creature's humanity a question from his first appearance. That is structure at work: Letter IV turns the frame: Walton meets Victor and becomes the listener. From here the story nests: Walton tells Victor's story, which will contain the creature's.

40–55 min · We do: guided annotation · We do (15 min)
Guided analysis of a second quotation; expected answers given.
Ask: What words in this line stand out, and what do they suggest? Expected: The serpent recalls Genesis, where knowledge leads to the Fall; "sting" makes knowledge poisonous. This is the novel's central warning about ambition and knowledge. Ask: How does this line connect to ambition and knowledge? Expected: Victor recognizes himself in Walton and warns him; the story becomes a cautionary tale told for a listener's benefit. (The serpent alludes to Eden: knowledge as temptation and fall. Strong for a theme claim.)

> *You seek for knowledge and wisdom, as I once did; and I ardently hope that the gratification of your wishes may not be a serpent to sting you, as mine has been (Letter IV, paragraph 32)*

Ask: What words in this line stand out, and what do they suggest?
Expected answer: The serpent recalls Genesis, where knowledge leads to the Fall; "sting" makes knowledge poisonous. This is the novel's central warning about ambition and knowledge.
Ask: How does this line connect to ambition and knowledge?
Expected answer: Victor recognizes himself in Walton and warns him; the story becomes a cautionary tale told for a listener's benefit. (The serpent alludes to Eden: knowledge as temptation and fall. Strong for a theme claim.)

55–70 min · You do: independent annotation · You do (15 min)
Independent annotation and a claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph (exemplar given).
Annotate the chapter for structure, characterization (three marks with a margin note each), then write one claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph: what does this chapter suggest about the meeting of two ambitious men? Then start your writing prompt at your assigned level (HS Sophomore: Analyze how Letter IV develops the idea of the meeting of two ambitious men. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of foreshadowing and characterization shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.)
Exemplar: Victor frames his whole story as a warning against the kind of ambition Walton shows. When the text says "You seek for knowledge and wisdom, as I once did; and I ardently hope that the gratification of your wishes may not be a serpent to sting you, as mine has been" (Letter IV, paragraph 32), it shows this directly. By calling Walton's desire an "intoxicating draught" and hoping it will not be "a serpent to sting you," Victor links the pursuit of knowledge to addiction and to the biblical Fall, so everything he tells next is offered as a lesson.
Task: Annotate the chapter for structure, characterization (three marks with a margin note each), then write one claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph: what does this chapter suggest about the meeting of two ambitious men? Then start your writing prompt at your assigned level (HS Sophomore: Analyze how Letter IV develops the idea of the meeting of two ambitious men. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of foreshadowing and characterization shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.)
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70–80 min · Discussion · We do (10 min)
Structured discussion from the 30 tiered questions, with facilitation notes.
Anchor question: Victor says he will tell his story so Walton may learn from it. What lesson do you predict? Ask whether we should trust Victor as a narrator. He is telling the story to make a point; what might he leave out?
Anchor question: Victor says he will tell his story so Walton may learn from it. What lesson do you predict?
Facilitation: Ask whether we should trust Victor as a narrator. He is telling the story to make a point; what might he leave out?

80–87 min · Exit ticket / chapter quiz · You do (7 min)
Chapter quiz in the app and an exit ticket (answer given).
Chapter quiz in the app, then: In one sentence, what does this chapter suggest about the meeting of two ambitious men? Support it with one short quotation. Model answer: Victor frames his whole story as a warning against the kind of ambition Walton shows. ("You seek for knowledge and wisdom, as I once did; and I ardently hope that the gratification of your wishes may not be a serpent to sting you, as mine has been", Letter IV, paragraph 32). Accept any defensible claim backed by a quotation from the chapter; the answer key for the quiz is in the Quiz section.
Exit ticket: In one sentence, what does this chapter suggest about the meeting of two ambitious men? Support it with one short quotation.
Answer: Model answer: Victor frames his whole story as a warning against the kind of ambition Walton shows. ("You seek for knowledge and wisdom, as I once did; and I ardently hope that the gratification of your wishes may not be a serpent to sting you, as mine has been", Letter IV, paragraph 32). Accept any defensible claim backed by a quotation from the chapter; the answer key for the quiz is in the Quiz section.

87–90 min · Closure · I do (3 min)
Summarize the lesson and preview the next reading.
Today we saw how structure shapes the meeting of two ambitious men. Key takeaway: Victor recognizes himself in Walton and warns him; the story becomes a cautionary tale told for a listener's benefit.

Total: 90 minutes.

Teacher analysis (spoilers)

Literary elements

- **Structure:** Letter IV turns the frame: Walton meets Victor and becomes the listener. From here the story nests: Walton tells Victor's story, which will contain the creature's.
- **Characterization:** Victor appears ruined but eloquent; Walton instantly loves him. Watch Victor's warning speech, which is a teacher's speech.
- **Imagery:** The first glimpse is of a "being which had the shape of a man, but apparently of gigantic stature" on a dog-sledge: we see the creature before we know him.

Themes and how they develop

- **ambition and knowledge:** Victor recognizes himself in Walton and warns him; the story becomes a cautionary tale told for a listener's benefit.

Symbols and motifs

- **light and fire:** Light stands for knowledge and fire for its double edge: warmth and burning. Victor seeks the "light" of discovery; the creature discovers fire and is burned by it. In this chapter: “In the morning, however, as soon as it was light, I went upon deck, and found all the sailors busy on” (Letter IV, paragraph 6).
- **sublime nature:** Mountains, glaciers, storms and lakes reflect and sometimes soothe the characters' feelings; the sublime is both comfort and terror. In this chapter: “Last Monday (July 31st), we were nearly surrounded by ice, which closed in the ship on all sides, scarcely leaving her” (Letter IV, paragraph 2).

Key quotations (checked against the reading text)

- “a being which had the shape of a man, but apparently of gigantic stature” (Letter IV, paragraph 3) Ambiguity ("shape of a man") makes the creature's humanity a question from his first appearance.
- “Unhappy man! Do you share my madness? Have you drank also of the intoxicating draught” (Letter IV, paragraph 25) (The 1831 text prints "drank.") Victor calls ambition a drug ("intoxicating draught") and madness. Evidence for the novel's view of obsessive curiosity.
- “You seek for knowledge and wisdom, as I once did; and I ardently hope that the gratification of your wishes may not be a serpent to sting you, as mine has been” (Letter IV, paragraph 32) The serpent alludes to Eden: knowledge as temptation and fall. Strong for a theme claim.

Model claim-evidence-reasoning

Claim: Victor frames his whole story as a warning against the kind of ambition Walton shows.
Evidence: “You seek for knowledge and wisdom, as I once did; and I ardently hope that the gratification of your wishes may not be a serpent to sting you, as mine has been” (Letter IV, paragraph 32)
Reasoning: By calling Walton's desire an "intoxicating draught" and hoping it will not be "a serpent to sting you," Victor links the pursuit of knowledge to addiction and to the biblical Fall, so everything he tells next is offered as a lesson.

Vocabulary with etymology notes

Word	Definition (in this sentence)	In context	Word history
capitulated (verb)	gave in; agreed to terms (here, bargained for his safety)	*Margaret, if you had seen the man who thus capitulated for his safety, your surprise would have been boundless.*	“capitulated”: From Medieval Latin capitulare "to draw up under headings," from capitulum "little head, chapter," from caput "head"; hence arranging terms, then surrendering on terms. (Online Etymology Dictionary, https://www.etymonline.com/word/capitulate)
tutored (verb)	taught; educated	*You have been tutored and refined by books and retirement from the world, and you are, therefore, somewhat fastidious; but this only renders*	“tutored”: From Middle English tutour, from Old French tuteur (French tuteur), from Latin tūtor "a watcher, protector, guardian", from

		you the more fit to appreciate the extraordinary merits of this wonderful man.	tueor "protect"; see tuition. (Wiktionary, https://en.wiktionary.org/wiki/tutor#Etymology)
telescopes (noun)	instruments that make distant objects look closer	*We watched the rapid progress of the traveller with our telescopes, until he was lost among the distant inequalities of the ice.*	“telescopes”: From tele- + -scope. From Latin tēlescopium, from Ancient Greek τηλεσκόπος "far-seeing", from τῆλε "afar" + σκοπέω "to look at". (Wiktionary, https://en.wiktionary.org/wiki/telescope#Etymology)
rawness (noun)	cold, damp harshness	*He manifested the greatest eagerness to be upon deck, to watch for the sledge which had before appeared; but I have persuaded him to remain in the cabin, for he is far too weak to sustain the rawness of the atmosphere.*	
eventual (adjective)	expected to follow in the indefinite future from causes already operating	*He entered attentively into all my arguments in favour of my eventual success, and into every minute detail of the measures I had taken to secure it.*	
irradiated (verb)	lit up	*Even now, as I commence my task, his full-toned voice swells in my ears; his lustrous eyes dwell on me with all their melancholy sweetness; I see his thin hand raised in animation, while the lineaments of his face are irradiated by the soul within.*	“irradiated”: From Middle English irradiate "illuminated, shining", borrowed from Medieval Latin irradiātus, perfect passive participle of irradiō, from in- + radiō, from radius + -ō (further etymology uncertain; possibly ultimately from Proto-Indo-European *rehɪt- "beam; pole; post"). The adjective is attested earlier than the verb. (Wiktionary, https://en.wiktionary.org/wiki/irradiate#Etymology)
benevolently (adverb)	in a kind, well-meaning way	*“And yet you rescued me from a strange and perilous situation; you have benevolently restored me to life.”*	
conciliating (adjective)	friendly and trying to win good will	*Yet his manners are so conciliating and gentle, that the sailors are all interested in him, although they have had very little communication with him.*	“conciliating”: Borrowed from Latin conciliātus, perfect passive participle of conciliō "to unite", from concilium "council, meeting". (Wiktionary, https://en.wiktionary.org/wiki/conciliate#Etymology)

oppresses (verb)	come down on or keep down by unjust use of one's authority	*But he is generally melancholy and despairing; and sometimes he gnashes his teeth, as if impatient of the weight of woes that oppresses him.*	“oppresses”: From Middle English oppressen, from Old French oppresser, from Medieval Latin oppressare "to press against, oppress", frequentative of Latin opprimere, past participle oppressus "to press against, press together, oppress", from ob "against" + premere, past participle pressus "to press"; see press. (Wiktionary, https://en.wiktionary.org/wiki/oppress#Etymology)
trickle (verb)	to flow in drops	*At first I perceived that he tried to suppress his emotion; he placed his hands before his eyes; and my voice quivered and failed me, as I beheld tears trickle fast from between his fingers—a groan burst from his heaving breast.*	“trickle”: From Middle English triklen, likely a rebracketing (e.g. teres strikled > teerys trikled "tears trickled") of Middle English striklen "to trickle", equivalent to strike + -le. (Wiktionary, https://en.wiktionary.org/wiki/trickle#Etymology)

Discussion questions

1. Victor says he will tell his story so Walton may learn from it. What lesson do you predict?
2. Where does foreshadowing appear in this chapter, and what effect does it have? Point to one passage.
3. How does this chapter connect to the book's larger concern with the costs of unchecked ambition?

Classroom discussion questions (30, tiered)

Wait time after every question (3 s for DOK 1, 5 s for DOK 2, 8 to 10 s for DOK 3 and 4); think-pair-share on DOK 3 and 4; answer each response with a follow-up probe; close with student-generated questions. Focus sets by rigor level: Middle School: 1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 6, 11, 12, 13, 14, 21, 22; HS Freshman: 1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 12, 13, 14, 15, 22, 23, 24; HS Sophomore: 1, 2, 3, 4, 13, 14, 15, 16, 17, 23, 24, 25; HS Junior: 1, 2, 3, 14, 15, 16, 17, 18, 24, 25, 26, 27; HS Senior: 1, 2, 3, 15, 16, 17, 18, 25, 26, 27, 28, 29; AP: 1, 2, 16, 17, 18, 19, 20, 26, 27, 28, 29, 30; College Freshman: 1, 2, 17, 18, 19, 20, 21, 22, 27, 28, 29, 30; College Sophomore: 1, 2, 11, 18, 19, 20, 21, 22, 23, 28, 29, 30; College Junior: 1, 11, 12, 19, 20, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 29, 30; College Senior: 1, 11, 12, 13, 20, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 26, 30; Graduate / PhD: 1, 11, 12, 13, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 26, 27, 28

Literal / recall

1. What does the crew first see on the ice? [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · 7.RC.1, 7.CC.1, 9-10.RC.1] Look for: A gigantic figure on a dog sled
2. Who is rescued from the ice? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · 7.RC.1, 7.CC.1, 9-10.RC.1] Look for: Victor Frankenstein
3. Why does Victor decide to tell his story? [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · 7.RC.1, 7.CC.1, 9-10.RC.1] Look for: To warn Walton about dangerous ambition
4. How does Walton feel toward the stranger? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · 7.RC.1, 7.CC.1, 9-10.RC.1] Look for: He admires and loves him like a brother
5. What narrative structure begins here? [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · 7.RC.1, 7.CC.1, 9-10.RC.1] Look for: A frame narrative with a story within a story

6. Retell the three most important events of “Letter IV” in order, in one sentence each. [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · 7.RC.1, 7.CC.1, 9-10.RC.1] Look for: Trapped in ice, Walton's crew sees a giant figure on a dog sled, and the next morning rescues a frozen, exhausted stranger: Victor Frankenstein. Victor recovers slowly, becomes Walton's friend, and, hearing of Walton's ambition, agrees to tell his own story as a warning.
7. Which characters appear or are mentioned in “Letter IV”? Name two and one thing each says or does. [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · 7.RC.1, 7.CC.1, 9-10.RC.1] Look for: Names and actions taken from the chapter; check against the teacher summary.
8. Where and when does “Letter IV” take place? Point to the line that tells you. [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · 7.RC.1, 7.CC.1, 9-10.RC.1] Look for: A place/time detail quoted from the chapter.
9. Reread: “Margaret, if you had seen the man who thus capitulated for his safety, your surprise would have been boundless.” What does “capitulated” mean here, and what is literally happening in this line? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · 7.RC.1, 7.CC.1, 9-10.RC.1] Look for: capitulated: gave in; agreed to terms (here, bargained for his safety).
10. Reread: “You have been tutored and refined by books and retirement from the world, and you are, therefore, somewhat fastidious; but this only renders you the more fit to appreciate the extraordinary merits of this wonderful man.” What does “tutored” mean here, and what is literally happening in this line? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · 7.RC.1, 7.CC.1, 9-10.RC.1] Look for: tutored: taught; educated.

Inferential / analytical

1. What does “Letter IV” suggest about the meeting of two ambitious men? State the inference and the line that supports it. [DOK 2 · thinkPairShare · wait 5 s · 7.RC.2, 7.CC.2, 9-10.RC.2] Look for: Victor's warning, 'Learn from me,' makes the whole novel a cautionary tale addressed to Walton and to the reader.
2. Find one example of foreshadowing in this chapter. What does it reveal that a plain statement would not? [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · 7.RC.3, 7.CC.2, 9-10.RC.3] Look for: Look for hints, warnings or images that point to later events.
3. How does the characterization in this chapter shape what we understand about the meeting of two ambitious men? [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · 7.RC.3, 7.CC.2, 9-10.RC.1] Look for: Look for what characters say, do and think, and how others react to them.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Victor frames his whole story as a warning against the kind of ambition Walton shows. Useful evidence: “a being which had the shape of a man, but apparently of gigantic stature” (Letter IV, paragraph 3): Ambiguity ("shape of a man") makes the creature's humanity a question from his first appearance. On characterization: Victor appears ruined but eloquent; Walton instantly loves him. Watch Victor's warning speech, which is a teacher's speech. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
4. In the passage that begins “About two o’clock the mist cleared away, and we beheld, stretched out in every direction, vast and irregular plains of ice, which seemed to have no end.”, why might Shelley have chosen these particular words? Pick two and explain their connotations. [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · 7.RC.12, 7.CC.2, 9-10.RC.12] Look for: Diction analysis of two words in the anchor passage.
5. What causes the main turn in “Letter IV”, and what effect is it likely to have on what follows? [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · 7.RC.3, 7.CC.2, 9-10.RC.1] Look for: Trapped in ice, Walton's crew sees a giant figure on a dog sled, and the next morning rescues a frozen, exhausted stranger: Victor Frankenstein. Victor recovers slowly, becomes Walton's friend, and, hearing of Walton's ambition, agrees to tell his own story as a warning.

6. How does “Letter IV” build on “Letter III”? Name one link of cause and effect. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · 7.RC.3, 7.CC.2, 9-10.RC.3] Look for: A causal or structural link between this and the previous chapter.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Victor frames his whole story as a warning against the kind of ambition Walton shows. Useful evidence: “Unhappy man! Do you share my madness? Have you drank also of the intoxicating draught” (Letter IV, paragraph 25): (The 1831 text prints "drank.") Victor calls ambition a drug ("intoxicating draught") and madness. Evidence for the novel's view of obsessive curiosity. On structure: Letter IV turns the frame: Walton meets Victor and becomes the listener. From here the story nests: Walton tells Victor's story, which will contain the creature's. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
7. What can we infer about a character's motives from what they say and do here, as opposed to what they claim? [DOK 3 · followUp · wait 8 s · 7.RC.3, 7.CC.2, 9-10.RC.1] Look for: An inference about motive supported by a quoted line.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Victor frames his whole story as a warning against the kind of ambition Walton shows. Useful evidence: “You seek for knowledge and wisdom, as I once did; and I ardently hope that the gratification of your wishes may not be a serpent to sting you, as mine has been” (Letter IV, paragraph 32): The serpent alludes to Eden: knowledge as temptation and fall. Strong for a theme claim. On characterization: Victor appears ruined but eloquent; Walton instantly loves him. Watch Victor's warning speech, which is a teacher's speech. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
8. The bell-ringer asked: “Victor says he will tell his story so Walton may learn from it. What lesson do you predict?” Now that we have read closely, how would you revise your first answer, and which line changed your mind? [DOK 2 · thinkPairShare · wait 5 s · 7.RC.2, 7.CC.2, 9-10.RC.2] Look for: A revised answer anchored in the text.
9. Where does point of view appear, and how does it connect this chapter to the larger concern with the costs of unchecked ambition? [DOK 3 · followUp · wait 8 s · 7.RC.1, 7.CC.2, 9-10.RC.1] Look for: Look for who is telling the story and what that narrator can and cannot know.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Victor frames his whole story as a warning against the kind of ambition Walton shows. Useful evidence: “a being which had the shape of a man, but apparently of gigantic stature” (Letter IV, paragraph 3): Ambiguity ("shape of a man") makes the creature's humanity a question from his first appearance. Theme link: Victor recognizes himself in Walton and warns him; the story becomes a cautionary tale told for a listener's benefit. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
10. Background: The frame (Walton) now opens into Victor's narrative, a 'story within a story' structure called a nested or frame narrative. How does knowing this change the way you read one moment in the chapter? [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · 7.RC.3, 7.CC.2, 9-10.RC.1] Look for: A specific moment reread in light of the context.
    Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Victor frames his whole story as a warning against the kind of ambition Walton shows. Useful evidence: “Unhappy man! Do you share my madness? Have you drank also of the intoxicating draught” (Letter IV, paragraph 25): (The 1831 text prints "drank.") Victor calls ambition a drug ("intoxicating draught") and madness. Evidence for the novel's view of obsessive curiosity. Theme link: Victor recognizes himself in Walton and warns him; the story becomes a cautionary tale told for a listener's benefit. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

Evaluative / synthesis / creative

1. A critic might argue: “Victor's warning, 'Learn from me,' makes the whole novel a cautionary tale addressed to Walton and to the reader.” How far do you agree? Take a stand and defend it with two lines from the chapter. [DOK 3 · fourCorners · wait 8 s · 7.RC.2, 7.CC.3, 9-10.RC.2] Look for: A defended position with evidence and one counterpoint.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Victor frames his whole story as a warning against the kind of ambition Walton shows. Useful evidence: “You seek for knowledge and wisdom, as I once did; and I ardently hope that the gratification of your wishes may not be a serpent to sting you, as mine has been” (Letter IV, paragraph 32): The serpent alludes to Eden: knowledge as temptation and fall. Strong for a theme claim. Theme link: Victor recognizes himself in Walton and warns him; the story becomes a cautionary tale told for a listener's benefit. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
2. Which character in this chapter acts most wisely, and which least? Judge them by a standard you name. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · 7.RC.3, 7.CC.3, 9-10.RC.1] Look for: An evaluation using an explicit criterion and evidence.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Victor frames his whole story as a warning against the kind of ambition Walton shows. Useful evidence: “a being which had the shape of a man, but apparently of gigantic stature” (Letter IV, paragraph 3): Ambiguity ("shape of a man") makes the creature's humanity a question from his first appearance. On characterization: Victor appears ruined but eloquent; Walton instantly loves him. Watch Victor's warning speech, which is a teacher's speech. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
3. Rewrite one moment of “Letter IV” from the point of view of a different character. What does the new angle reveal or hide about the meeting of two ambitious men? [DOK 4 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · 7.RC.1, 7.CC.3, 9-10.RC.1] Look for: A creative product with a rationale tied to the text.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Victor frames his whole story as a warning against the kind of ambition Walton shows. Useful evidence: “Unhappy man! Do you share my madness? Have you drank also of the intoxicating draught” (Letter IV, paragraph 25): (The 1831 text prints "drank.") Victor calls ambition a drug ("intoxicating draught") and madness. Evidence for the novel's view of obsessive curiosity. Theme link: Victor recognizes himself in Walton and warns him; the story becomes a cautionary tale told for a listener's benefit. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
4. Write three questions of your own about “Letter IV”: one recall, one “why/how”, and one “should/what if”. Trade with a partner and answer theirs. [DOK 3 · studentGenerated · wait 8 s · 7.RC.2, 7.CC.3, 9-10.RC.2] Look for: Student-generated questions at three levels.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Victor frames his whole story as a warning against the kind of ambition Walton shows. Useful evidence: “You seek for knowledge and wisdom, as I once did; and I ardently hope that the gratification of your wishes may not be a serpent to sting you, as mine has been” (Letter IV, paragraph 32): The serpent alludes to Eden: knowledge as temptation and fall. Strong for a theme claim. Theme link: Victor recognizes himself in Walton and warns him; the story becomes a cautionary tale told for a listener's benefit. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
5. Connect this chapter to creation and responsibility: is the link strong or weak so far? What would Shelley need to show next to strengthen it? [DOK 4 · socraticCircle · wait 8 s · 7.RC.2, 7.CC.3, 9-10.RC.2] Look for: A

judgment of thematic development across the work.

Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Victor frames his whole story as a warning against the kind of ambition Walton shows. Useful evidence: “a being which had the shape of a man, but apparently of gigantic stature” (Letter IV, paragraph 3): Ambiguity ("shape of a man") makes the creature's humanity a question from his first appearance. Theme link: Victor recognizes himself in Walton and warns him; the story becomes a cautionary tale told for a listener's benefit. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

6. Is the foreshadowing in this chapter effective, or does it feel heavy-handed? Evaluate it as a reader would in a review. [DOK 3 · fourCorners · wait 8 s · 7.RC.3, 7.CC.3, 9-10.RC.3] Look for: An evaluative judgment with criteria and evidence.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Victor frames his whole story as a warning against the kind of ambition Walton shows. Useful evidence: “Unhappy man! Do you share my madness? Have you drank also of the intoxicating draught” (Letter IV, paragraph 25): (The 1831 text prints "drank.") Victor calls ambition a drug ("intoxicating draught") and madness. Evidence for the novel's view of obsessive curiosity. Theme link: Victor recognizes himself in Walton and warns him; the story becomes a cautionary tale told for a listener's benefit. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

7. Compare how “Letter IV” treats the meeting of two ambitious men with how another text, film or event you know treats a similar idea. What does Frankenstein see that the other misses? [DOK 4 · socraticCircle · wait 8 s · 7.RC.2, 7.CC.3, 9-10.RC.2] Look for: A cross-text synthesis.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Victor frames his whole story as a warning against the kind of ambition Walton shows. Useful evidence: “You seek for knowledge and wisdom, as I once did; and I ardently hope that the gratification of your wishes may not be a serpent to sting you, as mine has been” (Letter IV, paragraph 32): The serpent alludes to Eden: knowledge as temptation and fall. Strong for a theme claim. Theme link: Victor recognizes himself in Walton and warns him; the story becomes a cautionary tale told for a listener's benefit. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

8. Predict what “Chapter I” will bring, using two clues from this chapter. After reading, evaluate your prediction. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · 7.RC.3, 7.CC.3, 9-10.RC.3] Look for: A prediction or judgment justified with textual clues.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Victor frames his whole story as a warning against the kind of ambition Walton shows. Useful evidence: “a being which had the shape of a man, but apparently of gigantic stature” (Letter IV, paragraph 3): Ambiguity ("shape of a man") makes the creature's humanity a question from his first appearance. Theme link: Victor recognizes himself in Walton and warns him; the story becomes a cautionary tale told for a listener's benefit. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

9. Design a one-paragraph modern adaptation of this chapter (setting, characters, conflict). What must stay the same for it to still be about the meeting of two ambitious men? [DOK 4 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · 7.RC.2, 7.CC.3, 9-10.RC.2] Look for: A creative transfer that keeps the core idea.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Victor frames his whole story as a warning against the kind of ambition Walton shows. Useful evidence: “Unhappy man! Do you share my madness? Have you drank also of the intoxicating draught” (Letter IV, paragraph 25): (The 1831 text prints "drank.") Victor calls ambition a drug ("intoxicating draught") and madness. Evidence for the novel's view of obsessive

curiosity. Theme link: Victor recognizes himself in Walton and warns him; the story becomes a cautionary tale told for a listener's benefit. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

10. What question would you most like to ask Mary Shelley about this chapter, and what answer do you think the text itself gives? [DOK 4 · studentGenerated · wait 8 s · 7.RC.2, 7.CC.3, 9-10.RC.2] Look for: A student-generated question answered from evidence.
    Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Victor frames his whole story as a warning against the kind of ambition Walton shows. Useful evidence: "You seek for knowledge and wisdom, as I once did; and I ardently hope that the gratification of your wishes may not be a serpent to sting you, as mine has been" (Letter IV, paragraph 32): The serpent alludes to Eden: knowledge as temptation and fall. Strong for a theme claim. Theme link: Victor recognizes himself in Walton and warns him; the story becomes a cautionary tale told for a listener's benefit. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

Annotation focus

- **Foreshadowing:** look for hints, warnings or images that point to later events (anchor passage in the We do segment)
- Also notice **Characterization**: what characters say, do and think, and how others react to them
- Also notice **Point of view**: who is telling the story and what that narrator can and cannot know

Chapter quiz: item bank (all eleven rigor versions)

1. [fill · recall · DOK 1] Complete the quotation from Letter IV, paragraph 25: "Unhappy man! Do you share my madness? Have you drank also of the _____ draught"
   Key: intoxicating
2. [fill · recall · DOK 1] Fill in the blank with the vocabulary word that fits: "Even now, as I commence my task, his full-toned voice swells in my ears; his lustrous eyes dwell on me with all their melancholy sweetness; I see his thin hand raised in animation, while the lineaments of his face are _____ by the soul within." Word bank: tutored, telescopes, capitulated, irradiated
   Key: irradiated
3. [mc · recall · DOK 1] In the line "He manifested the greatest eagerness to be upon deck, to watch for the sledge which had before appeared; but I have persuaded him to remain in the cabin, for he is far too weak to sustain the rawness of the atmosphere.", what does "rawness" most nearly mean?
   A. a speech or piece of writing full of praise
   B. interlace by or as if by weaving
   C. cold, damp harshness
   D. cause aversion in; offend the moral sense of
   Key: C (cold, damp harshness)
4. [fill · recall · DOK 1] Fill in the blank with the vocabulary word that fits: ""And yet you rescued me from a strange and perilous situation; you have _____ restored me to life."" Word bank: benevolently, tutored, telescopes, capitulated
   Key: benevolently

5. [mc · recall · DOK 1] How does Walton feel toward the stranger?
   A. He admires and loves him like a brother
   B. He fears him
   C. He ignores him
   D. He distrusts him

   Key: A (He admires and loves him like a brother)

6. [mc · recall · DOK 1] Who is rescued from the ice?
   A. A Russian sailor
   B. Henry Clerval
   C. The creature
   D. Victor Frankenstein

   Key: D (Victor Frankenstein)

7. [fill · recall · DOK 1] Fill in the blank with the vocabulary word that fits: “He entered attentively into all my arguments in favour of my _____ success, and into every minute detail of the measures I had taken to secure it.” Word bank: tutored, telescopes, capitulated, eventual

   Key: eventual

8. [mc · recall · DOK 1] Why does Victor decide to tell his story?
   A. To confess a theft
   B. Because he is dying of fever
   C. To warn Walton about dangerous ambition
   D. To earn passage home

   Key: C (To warn Walton about dangerous ambition)

9. [mc · recall · DOK 1] In the line “You have been tutored and refined by books and retirement from the world, and you are, therefore, somewhat fastidious; but this only renders you the more fit to appreciate the extraordinary merits of this wonderful man.”, what does “tutored” most nearly mean?
   A. surrounded
   B. losing hope; discouraged
   C. get involved, so as to alter or hinder an action, or through force or threat of force
   D. taught; educated

   Key: D (taught; educated)

10. [short · inference · DOK 2] What can you infer from this line? “a being which had the shape of a man, but apparently of gigantic stature” (Letter IV, paragraph 3) Answer in two or three sentences with one detail.

    Sample answer: Ambiguity ("shape of a man") makes the creature's humanity a question from his first appearance.

11. [mc · inference · DOK 2] What does this passage most clearly show? “a being which had the shape of a man, but apparently of gigantic stature” (Letter IV, paragraph 3)
    A. The master has become the slave; a reversal the creature will state aloud in Chapter XX.
    B. Blunt, short sentence in the father's letter.
    C. Ambiguity ("shape of a man") makes the creature's humanity a question from his first appearance.
    D. The discovery itself, told without explanation; Victor withholds the secret.

    Key: C (Ambiguity ("shape of a man") makes the creature's humanity a question from his first appearance.)

12. [mc · inference · DOK 2] Which choice best states a central concern of “Letter IV”?

    A. Reading and identity

    B. The meeting of two ambitious men

    C. Delay and dread

    D. Language, knowledge and sorrow

    Key: B (The meeting of two ambitious men)

13. [mc · inference · DOK 2] What does this passage most clearly show? “Unhappy man! Do you share my madness? Have you drank also of the intoxicating draught” (Letter IV, paragraph 25)

    A. A rhetorical question the novel answers: nature, death and conscience can.

    B. Places the book in real time and place; compare with the 1831 Introduction's fuller account.

    C. (The 1831 text prints "drank.") Victor calls ambition a drug ("intoxicating draught") and madness. Evidence for the novel's view of obsessive curiosity.

    D. The stated moral purpose. Students can test whether the plot actually shows this, or shows what happens when domestic affection is withheld.

    Key: C ((The 1831 text prints "drank.") Victor calls ambition a drug ("intoxicating draught") and madness. Evidence for the novel's view of obsessive curiosity.)

14. [mc · analysis · DOK 3] Which literary element does this describe in “Letter IV”? Letter IV turns the frame: Walton meets Victor and becomes the listener. From here the story nests: Walton tells Victor's story, which will contain the creature's.

    A. Theme

    B. Conflict

    C. Structure

    D. Irony

    Key: C (Structure)

15. [short · analysis · DOK 3] Analyze the word choice in “You seek for knowledge and wisdom, as I once did; and I ardently hope that the gratification of your wishes may not be a serpent to sting you, as mine has been” (Letter IV, paragraph 32). Pick two words and explain what they suggest.

    Sample answer: The serpent alludes to Eden: knowledge as temptation and fall. Strong for a theme claim.

16. [short · synthesis · DOK 4] Close reading: how do the diction and syntax of “Unhappy man! Do you share my madness? Have you drank also of the intoxicating draught” (Letter IV, paragraph 25) shape its meaning? Consider a second, competing reading.

    Sample answer: (The 1831 text prints "drank.") Victor calls ambition a drug ("intoxicating draught") and madness. Evidence for the novel's view of obsessive curiosity.

17. [fill · recall · DOK 1] Fill in the blank with the vocabulary word that fits: “Yet his manners are so _____ and gentle, that the sailors are all interested in him, although they have had very little communication with him.” Word bank: telescopes, conciliating, capitulated, tutored

    Key: conciliating

18. [mc · recall · DOK 1] In the line “Margaret, if you had seen the man who thus capitulated for his safety, your surprise would have been boundless.”, what does “capitulated” most nearly mean?

    A. gradual healing (through rest) after sickness or injury

    B. only slightly; poorly

C. gave in; agreed to terms (here, bargained for his safety)

D. express strong disapproval of

Key: C (gave in; agreed to terms (here, bargained for his safety))

19. [mc · recall · DOK 1] In the line “We watched the rapid progress of the traveller with our telescopes, until he was lost among the distant inequalities of the ice.”, what does “telescopes” most nearly mean?

A. express strong disapproval of; deplore

B. gathered or collected a large amount of

C. starting again

D. instruments that make distant objects look closer

Key: D (instruments that make distant objects look closer)

20. [short · inference · DOK 2] What can you infer from this line? “Unhappy man! Do you share my madness? Have you drank also of the intoxicating draught” (Letter IV, paragraph 25) Answer in two or three sentences with one detail.

Sample answer: (The 1831 text prints "drank.") Victor calls ambition a drug ("intoxicating draught") and madness. Evidence for the novel's view of obsessive curiosity.

21. [mc · inference · DOK 2] What does this passage most clearly show? “You seek for knowledge and wisdom, as I once did; and I ardently hope that the gratification of your wishes may not be a serpent to sting you, as mine has been” (Letter IV, paragraph 32)

A. The serpent alludes to Eden: knowledge as temptation and fall. Strong for a theme claim.

B. Justine was pressured by her confessor; evidence about injustice and power.

C. Short and plain amid his long sentences: the emotional core of the letter.

D. A rhetorical question the novel answers: nature, death and conscience can.

Key: A (The serpent alludes to Eden: knowledge as temptation and fall. Strong for a theme claim.)

22. [short · analysis · DOK 3] Claim: Victor frames his whole story as a warning against the kind of ambition Walton shows. Explain how this evidence supports the claim: “You seek for knowledge and wisdom, as I once did; and I ardently hope that the gratification of your wishes may not be a serpent to sting you, as mine has been” (Letter IV, paragraph 32).

Sample answer: By calling Walton's desire an "intoxicating draught" and hoping it will not be "a serpent to sting you," Victor links the pursuit of knowledge to addiction and to the biblical Fall, so everything he tells next is offered as a lesson.

23. [mc · analysis · DOK 3] Which literary element does this describe in “Letter IV”? Victor appears ruined but eloquent; Walton instantly loves him. Watch Victor's warning speech, which is a teacher's speech.

A. Theme

B. Irony

C. Hyperbole

D. Characterization

Key: D (Characterization)

24. [short · synthesis · DOK 4] Close reading: how do the diction and syntax of “a being which had the shape of a man, but apparently of gigantic stature” (Letter IV, paragraph 3) shape its meaning? Consider a second, competing reading.

Sample answer: Ambiguity ("shape of a man") makes the creature's humanity a question from his first appearance.

25. [mc · recall · DOK 1] What does the crew first see on the ice?

    A. A gigantic figure on a dog sled

    B. A lost ship

    C. A fire

    D. A polar bear

    Key: A (A gigantic figure on a dog sled)

26. [fill · recall · DOK 1] Complete the quotation from Letter IV, paragraph 32: “You seek for knowledge and wisdom, as I once did; and I ardently hope that the _____ of your wishes may not be a serpent to sting you, as mine has been”

    Key: gratification

27. [short · synthesis · DOK 4] Synthesis: trace how ambition and knowledge develops from an earlier chapter to “Letter IV”. Use one quotation from each.

    Sample answer: Victor recognizes himself in Walton and warns him; the story becomes a cautionary tale told for a listener's benefit.

28. [mc · recall · DOK 1] What narrative structure begins here?

    A. A frame narrative with a story within a story

    B. A play

    C. A single third-person narrator

    D. A diary only

    Key: A (A frame narrative with a story within a story)

29. [short · synthesis · DOK 4] Evaluate this claim about the chapter: “Victor frames his whole story as a warning against the kind of ambition Walton shows.” Is it fully persuasive? Argue with evidence, including a passage that complicates it.

    Sample answer: By calling Walton's desire an "intoxicating draught" and hoping it will not be "a serpent to sting you," Victor links the pursuit of knowledge to addiction and to the biblical Fall, so everything he tells next is offered as a lesson.

30. [fill · recall · DOK 1] Complete the quotation from Letter IV, paragraph 3: “a being which had the shape of a man, but _____ of gigantic stature”

    Key: apparently

Rigor version	Items (in order)	Mix
Middle School	1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 6, 7, 8, 9, 10, 11, 12, 13, 14, 15, 16	recall 9, inference 4, analysis 2, synthesis 1
HS Freshman	8, 9, 17, 3, 1, 5, 18, 19, 20, 12, 21, 10, 15, 22, 23, 24	recall 8, inference 4, analysis 3, synthesis 1
HS Sophomore	8, 25, 3, 26, 19, 1, 20, 21, 11, 12, 10, 22, 15, 23, 24, 27	recall 6, inference 5, analysis 3, synthesis 2
HS Junior	4, 17, 1, 28, 18, 20, 10, 13, 12, 11, 15, 14, 23, 22, 16, 27	recall 5, inference 5, analysis 4, synthesis 2
HS Senior	7, 2, 28, 9, 11, 20, 10, 13, 12, 22, 23, 15, 14, 27, 24, 29	recall 4, inference 5, analysis 4, synthesis 3
AP	4, 2, 3, 10, 12, 21, 11, 13, 23, 14, 22, 15, 27, 16, 29, 24	recall 3, inference 5, analysis 4, synthesis 4
College Freshman	1, 7, 28, 10, 11, 21, 12, 13, 23, 15, 22, 14, 29, 16, 27, 24	recall 3, inference 5, analysis 4, synthesis 4
College Sophomore	7, 4, 21, 12, 13, 11, 20, 10, 22, 14, 15, 23, 16, 24, 27, 29	recall 2, inference 6, analysis 4, synthesis 4

College Junior	30, 2, 20, 21, 10, 13, 11, 12, 15, 22, 23, 14, 24, 16, 27, 29	recall 2, inference 6, analysis 4, synthesis 4
College Senior	2, 7, 13, 11, 10, 21, 12, 20, 23, 14, 22, 15, 29, 16, 27, 24	recall 2, inference 6, analysis 4, synthesis 4
Graduate / PhD	7, 30, 10, 13, 21, 20, 11, 12, 22, 14, 23, 15, 29, 24, 16, 27	recall 2, inference 6, analysis 4, synthesis 4

Writing prompts (eleven rigor levels)

Middle School (250 words; Indiana 2023: 7.RC.3, 7.W.1): Supported track (work from the passage your teacher selects). In “Letter IV,” how does Shelley show the meeting of two ambitious men? Write a paragraph that states your claim, quotes two details from the passage, and explains how each detail supports your idea. Use the foreshadowing you noticed as one piece of evidence.

HS Freshman (350 words; Indiana 2023: 9-10.RC.3, 9-10.W.1): In Letter IV, how does Shelley develop the idea of the meeting of two ambitious men? State a clear claim, support it with two or three quotations, and explain how the foreshadowing in the chapter helps build that idea.

HS Sophomore (450 words; Indiana 2023: 9-10.RC.3, 9-10.W.1): Analyze how Letter IV develops the idea of the meeting of two ambitious men. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of foreshadowing and characterization shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.

HS Junior (550 words; Indiana 2023: 11-12.RC.3, 11-12.RC.1, 11-12.W.1): Analyze how the structure of Letter IV (where it begins, turns and ends) and its foreshadowing shape the reader's understanding of the meeting of two ambitious men. Identify one place where the text leaves matters uncertain and explain how that uncertainty adds to its meaning.

HS Senior (600 words; Indiana 2023: 11-12.RC.3, 11-12.W.1): Two readers disagree about what Letter IV suggests about the meeting of two ambitious men. Lay out two plausible interpretations, weigh the evidence for each (including the chapter's foreshadowing and characterization), and argue for the stronger one in a sustained, well-organized essay.

AP (650 words; Indiana 2023: 11-12.RC.3, 11-12.W.1): Write a literary argument in which you analyze how Mary Shelley uses foreshadowing in Letter IV to complicate the reader's understanding of the meeting of two ambitious men. Develop a defensible thesis, select evidence purposefully, and explain how specific choices of diction and syntax create meaning.

College Freshman (1000 words; Indiana 2023: see unit standards): Situate Letter IV within its historical and literary context and argue how the chapter's treatment of the meeting of two ambitious men responds to that context. Engage with at least one secondary perspective (a critic, historian or the author's own statements), integrate quotations smoothly, and cite in MLA style.

College Sophomore (1250 words; Indiana 2023: see unit standards): Read Letter IV alongside the conventions of its genre and period. Argue how the chapter's handling of the meeting of two ambitious men follows or

bends those conventions, using the foreshadowing as evidence, and test your reading against one published critic. Document two secondary sources in MLA.

College Junior (1500 words; Indiana 2023: see unit standards): Apply a named critical approach (for example formalist, historicist, feminist, psychoanalytic or ecocritical) to Letter IV and its treatment of the meeting of two ambitious men. State your method, show what it reveals in the chapter's foreshadowing and characterization, and identify where the text resists it.

College Senior (2000 words; Indiana 2023: see unit standards): Develop a research argument that reads Letter IV as evidence for a larger claim about the meeting of two ambitious men in Frankenstein. Connect close reading of the chapter to the whole novel, engage at least four scholarly sources, and state precisely where your reading departs from theirs (Chicago style).

Graduate / PhD (2500 words; Indiana 2023: see unit standards): Develop an original argument that reads Letter IV as a hinge in the novel's larger treatment of the meeting of two ambitious men. Position your reading within a named critical conversation (for example formalist, historicist, psychoanalytic, feminist or postcolonial approaches), account for the textual history where relevant, and articulate the stakes of your intervention for scholarship on Frankenstein.

SAT-style questions

1. *We watched the rapid progress of the traveller with our telescopes, until he was lost among the distant inequalities of the ice.*

   As used in the text, what does the word “telescopes” most nearly mean?

   A. come down on or keep down by unjust use of one's authority

   B. instruments that make distant objects look closer

   C. to flow in drops

   D. friendly and trying to win good will

2. *About two o’clock the mist cleared away, and we beheld, stretched out in every direction, vast and irregular plains of ice, which seemed to have no end. Some of my comrades groaned, and my own mind began to grow watchful with anxious thoughts, when a strange sight suddenly attracted our attention, and diverted our solicitude from our own situation. We perceived a low carriage, fixed on a sledge and drawn by dogs, pass on towards the north, at the distance of half a mile: a being which had the shape of a man, but apparently of gigantic stature, sat in the sledge, and guided the dogs. We watched the rapid progress of the traveller with our telescopes, until he was lost among the distant inequalities of the ice.*

   Which choice best states a central concern of “Letter IV”?

   A. A privileged childhood and family love

   B. Grief, prison and return

   C. Destroying the companion

   D. The meeting of two ambitious men

SAT key: 1. B (instruments that make distant objects look closer); 2. D (The meeting of two ambitious men)

Lesson 8: Chapter I

Focus: a privileged childhood and family love

Objective: Students will analyze how characterization develops in “Chapter I” by writing a claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph that cites at least 2 quotations from the section, and will score at least 80% on the section quiz.

Standards: CCSS RL.9-10.3, W.9-10.1, L.9-10.4 · IN 9-10.RC.1, 9-10.W.1, 9-10.RC.9, 9-10.RC.11

Content note (gender and ownership): Elizabeth is given to Victor as a “pretty present”; name the language of possession and discuss how the novel treats women as objects of exchange.
Student preview: This chapter describes a girl being 'given' to a boy as a present. We will look critically at that language.
Suggested language: “What does it tell us that Elizabeth is described as a gift? Whose point of view is that?”

Teacher only · spoilers

Victor describes his Genevese family: his father Alphonse, his mother Caroline (rescued from poverty), and Elizabeth Lavenza, the orphaned daughter of a Milanese nobleman, found living with poor peasants near Lake Como and adopted by his mother, whom his mother gives him as a 'present.' His childhood is loving and protected.

Background: Geneva was an independent republic known for Calvinism and civic pride; Rousseau, a Genevan, influenced ideas of education and nature.

Significance: Victor's ideal upbringing contrasts sharply with the creature's abandonment, raising the nature-versus-nurture question.

Lesson plan and lecture script (90 minutes)

0–8 min · Bell-ringer · You do (8 min)
Students write to the bell-ringer, then pair-share.
How does Victor's childhood compare with what a newly created being might need? Write for five minutes. Starters: I think... because... / This connects to creation and responsibility because.... Content note before we start: This chapter describes a girl being 'given' to a boy as a present. We will look critically at that language.
Prompt: How does Victor's childhood compare with what a newly created being might need?
Sentence starters: I think… because… · This connects to creation and responsibility because…
Strong response: A strong response takes a position and anticipates this: The parents' "deep consciousness of what they owed towards the being to which they had given life" is the novel's standard of parental duty.

8–18 min · Vocabulary with etymology notes · I do (10 min)
Five key words in context, with verified word histories.
Today's words: foldings — folds or hollows (here, in the hills); vagrants — homeless wanderers; decreasing — becoming smaller or less; chamois — a small, agile mountain goat; dungeons — dark underground prison cells. "foldings": By surface analysis, fold + -ing. "decreasing": From Middle English decresen, alteration of discresen, from Anglo-Norman -, Old French descreistre (French: décroître), from Latin decrescere.
Words: foldings: folds or hollows (here, in the hills) · vagrants: homeless wanderers · decreasing: becoming smaller or less · chamois: a small, agile mountain goat · dungeons: dark underground prison cells

18–28 min · Background and context · I do (10 min)
Mini-lecture (read or adapt the script).
Geneva was an independent republic known for Calvinism and civic pride; Rousseau, a Genevan, influenced ideas of education and nature. Victor's ideal upbringing contrasts sharply with the creature's abandonment, raising the nature-versus-nurture question. Characterization: Victor describes an idyllic, privileged childhood: devoted parents, a beloved adopted sister. He stresses that he was given every care, which makes his later neglect of his creation glaring. Irony: He says his parents felt they owed him duties as their child; he will owe the same duties and refuse them. Setting: Geneva, a republic and a respectable family, creates a picture of order. Watch for Elizabeth as gift: Elizabeth is introduced as a "pretty present"; she is treated as a possession, a point students can examine.

28–40 min · I do: modeled close reading · I do (12 min)
Model the close reading of the anchor quotation using the written think-aloud below.
I read the line once for meaning and once for craft. "I am by birth a Genevese; and my family is one of the most distinguished of that republic" (Chapter I, paragraph 1). Opens with pride in lineage and status. That is characterization at work: Victor describes an idyllic, privileged childhood: devoted parents, a beloved adopted sister. He stresses that he was given every care, which makes his later neglect of his creation glaring.

> *I am by birth a Genevese; and my family is one of the most distinguished of that republic (Chapter I, paragraph 1)*

Think-aloud: I read the line once for meaning and once for craft. "I am by birth a Genevese; and my family is one of the most distinguished of that republic" (Chapter I, paragraph 1). Opens with pride in lineage and status. That is characterization at work: Victor describes an idyllic, privileged childhood: devoted parents, a beloved adopted sister. He stresses that he was given every care, which makes his later neglect of his creation glaring.

40–55 min · We do: guided annotation · We do (15 min)
Guided analysis of a second quotation; expected answers given.
Ask: What words in this line stand out, and what do they suggest? Expected: "Pretty present" makes Elizabeth an object given to Victor, and "mine" shows possessiveness. This links to responsibility: Victor receives care and possession but gives little. Ask: How does this line connect to creation and responsibility? Expected: The parents' "deep consciousness of what they owed towards the being to which they had given life" is the novel's standard of parental duty. (Elizabeth is presented as a gift; useful for discussions of how women are treated in the novel.)

> *I have a pretty present for my Victor (Chapter I, paragraph 11)*

Ask: What words in this line stand out, and what do they suggest?
Expected answer: "Pretty present" makes Elizabeth an object given to Victor, and "mine" shows possessiveness. This links to responsibility: Victor receives care and possession but gives little.
Ask: How does this line connect to creation and responsibility?
Expected answer: The parents' "deep consciousness of what they owed towards the being to which they had given life" is the novel's standard of parental duty. (Elizabeth is presented as a gift; useful for discussions of how women are treated in the novel.)

55–70 min · You do: independent annotation · You do (15 min)
Independent annotation and a claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph (exemplar given).
Annotate the chapter for characterization, irony (three marks with a margin note each), then write one claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph: what does this chapter suggest about a privileged childhood and family love? Then start your writing prompt at your assigned level (HS Sophomore: Analyze how Chapter I develops the idea of a privileged childhood and family love. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of characterization and setting shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.) Exemplar: Victor's loving upbringing sets the standard of care he later denies his creature. When the text says “I have a pretty present for my Victor” (Chapter I, paragraph 11), it shows this directly. He describes himself as the center of his parents' devotion and treats Elizabeth as his "present," showing that he received care as his due; when he refuses any care to his own creation, the contrast exposes his failure.
Task: Annotate the chapter for characterization, irony (three marks with a margin note each), then write one claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph: what does this chapter suggest about a privileged childhood and family love? Then start your writing prompt at your assigned level (HS Sophomore: Analyze how Chapter I develops the idea of a privileged childhood and family love. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of characterization and setting shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.)
Exemplar: Victor's loving upbringing sets the standard of care he later denies his creature. When the text says “I have a pretty present for my Victor” (Chapter I, paragraph 11), it shows this directly. He describes himself as the center of his parents' devotion and treats Elizabeth as his "present," showing that he received care as his due; when he refuses any care to his own creation, the contrast exposes his failure.

70–80 min · Discussion · We do (10 min)
Structured discussion from the 30 tiered questions, with facilitation notes.
Anchor question: How does Victor's childhood compare with what a newly created being might need? If students call Victor's childhood "perfect," ask what it taught him about being responsible for others.
Anchor question: How does Victor's childhood compare with what a newly created being might need?
Facilitation: If students call Victor's childhood "perfect," ask what it taught him about being responsible for others.

80–87 min · Exit ticket / chapter quiz · You do (7 min)
Chapter quiz in the app and an exit ticket (answer given).
Chapter quiz in the app, then: In one sentence, what does this chapter suggest about a privileged childhood and family love? Support it with one short quotation. Model answer: Victor's loving upbringing sets the standard of care he later denies his creature. ("I have a pretty present for my Victor", Chapter I, paragraph 11). Accept any defensible claim backed by a quotation from the chapter; the answer key for the quiz is in the Quiz section.
Exit ticket: In one sentence, what does this chapter suggest about a privileged childhood and family love? Support it with one short quotation.
Answer: Model answer: Victor's loving upbringing sets the standard of care he later denies his creature. ("I have a pretty present for my Victor", Chapter I, paragraph 11). Accept any defensible claim backed by a quotation from the chapter; the answer key for the quiz is in the Quiz section.

87–90 min · Closure · I do (3 min)
Summarize the lesson and preview the next reading.
Today we saw how characterization shapes a privileged childhood and family love. Key takeaway: The parents' "deep consciousness of what they owed towards the being to which they had given life" is the novel's standard of parental duty.

Total: 90 minutes.

Teacher analysis (spoilers)

Literary elements

- **Characterization:** Victor describes an idyllic, privileged childhood: devoted parents, a beloved adopted sister. He stresses that he was given every care, which makes his later neglect of his creation glaring.
- **Irony:** He says his parents felt they owed him duties as their child; he will owe the same duties and refuse them.
- **Setting:** Geneva, a republic and a respectable family, creates a picture of order.

Themes and how they develop

- **creation and responsibility:** The parents' "deep consciousness of what they owed towards the being to which they had given life" is the novel's standard of parental duty.

Symbols and motifs

- **Elizabeth as gift:** Elizabeth is introduced as a "pretty present"; she is treated as a possession, a point students can examine.

Key quotations (checked against the reading text)

- "I am by birth a Genevese; and my family is one of the most distinguished of that republic" (Chapter I, paragraph 1) Opens with pride in lineage and status.
- "I have a pretty present for my Victor" (Chapter I, paragraph 11) Elizabeth is presented as a gift; useful for discussions of how women are treated in the novel.
- "looked upon Elizabeth as mine—mine to protect, love, and cherish" (Chapter I, paragraph 11) Possessive language; evidence for a claim about Victor's self-centeredness.

Model claim-evidence-reasoning

Claim: Victor's loving upbringing sets the standard of care he later denies his creature.
Evidence: "I have a pretty present for my Victor" (Chapter I, paragraph 11)
Reasoning: He describes himself as the center of his parents' devotion and treats Elizabeth as his "present," showing that he received care as his due; when he refuses any care to his own creation, the contrast exposes his failure.

Vocabulary with etymology notes

Word	Definition (in this sentence)	In context	Word history
foldings (noun)	folds or hollows (here, in the hills)	*During one of their walks a poor cot in the foldings of a vale attracted their notice, as being singularly disconsolate, while the number of half-clothed children gathered about it, spoke of penury in its worst shape.*	"foldings": By surface analysis, fold + -ing. (Wiktionary, https://en.wiktionary.org/wiki/folding#Etymology)
vagrants (noun)	homeless wanderers	*The four others were dark-eyed, hardy little vagrants; this child was thin, and very fair.*	
decreasing (verb)	becoming smaller or less	*His daughter attended him with the greatest tenderness; but she saw with despair that their little fund was rapidly decreasing, and that there was no other prospect of support.*	"decreasing": From Middle English decresen, alteration of discresen, from Anglo-Norman -, Old French descreistre (French: décroître), from Latin decrescere. (Wiktionary, https://en.wiktionary.org/wiki/decrease#Etymology)
chamois (noun)	a small, agile mountain goat	*When my father returned from Milan, he found playing with me in the hall of our villa, a child fairer than pictured cherub—a creature who seemed to shed radiance from her*	

		looks, and whose form and motions were lighter than the chamois of the hills.	
dungeons (noun)	dark underground prison cells	*Whether he had died, or still lingered in the dungeons of Austria, was not known.*	
rambles (noun)	an aimless amble on a winding course	*I, their eldest child, was born at Naples, and as an infant accompanied them in their rambles.*	
interment (noun)	the ritual placing of a corpse in a grave	*He came like a protecting spirit to the poor girl, who committed herself to his care; and after the interment of his friend, he conducted her to Geneva, and placed her under the protection of a relation.*	"interment": From Old French enterrement "burial," from enterrer "to put in the earth" (Latin terra "earth"). (Online Etymology Dictionary, https://www.etymonline.com/word/interment)
pittance (noun)	an inadequate payment	*She procured plain work; she plaited straw; and by various means contrived to earn a pittance scarcely sufficient to support life.*	"pittance": From Middle English pitaunce, from Old French pitance, pitence, from Medieval Latin *pietāntia, from Latin pietās "piety". (Wiktionary, https://en.wiktionary.org/wiki/pittance#Etymology)
confiscated (verb)	take temporary possession of as a security, by legal authority	*His property was confiscated, his child became an orphan and a beggar.*	
deplored (verb)	express strong disapproval of	*He bitterly deplored the false pride which led his friend to a conduct so little worthy of the affection that united them.*	"deplored": From Middle French déplorer, from Old French deplorer, from Latin dēplōrāre]], from dē- + ploro + plōrāre; origin uncertain. (Wiktionary, https://en.wiktionary.org/wiki/deplore#Etymology)

Discussion questions

1. How does Victor's childhood compare with what a newly created being might need?
2. Where does characterization appear in this chapter, and what effect does it have? Point to one passage.
3. How does this chapter connect to the book's larger concern with creation and responsibility?

Classroom discussion questions (30, tiered)

Wait time after every question (3 s for DOK 1, 5 s for DOK 2, 8 to 10 s for DOK 3 and 4); think-pair-share on DOK 3 and 4; answer each response with a follow-up probe; close with student-generated questions. Focus sets by rigor level: Middle School: 1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 6, 11, 12, 13, 14, 21, 22; HS Freshman: 1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 12, 13, 14, 15, 22, 23, 24; HS Sophomore: 1, 2, 3, 4, 13, 14, 15, 16, 17, 23, 24, 25; HS Junior: 1, 2, 3, 14, 15, 16, 17, 18, 24, 25, 26, 27; HS Senior: 1, 2, 3, 15, 16, 17, 18, 25, 26, 27, 28, 29; AP: 1, 2, 16, 17, 18, 19, 20, 26, 27, 28, 29, 30; College Freshman: 1, 2, 17, 18, 19, 20, 21, 22, 27, 28, 29, 30; College Sophomore: 1, 2, 11, 18, 19, 20, 21, 22, 23, 28, 29, 30; College Junior: 1, 11, 12, 19, 20, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 29, 30; College Senior: 1, 11, 12, 13, 20, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 26, 30; Graduate / PhD: 1, 11, 12, 13, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 26, 27, 28

Literal / recall

1. Where is Victor's family from? [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · 7.RC.1, 7.CC.1, 9-10.RC.1] Look for: Geneva
2. How does Elizabeth join the family? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · 7.RC.1, 7.CC.1, 9-10.RC.1] Look for: An orphaned nobleman's daughter raised by poor peasants, she is adopted by Victor's mother
3. How does Victor's mother describe Elizabeth to him? [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · 7.RC.1, 7.CC.1, 9-10.RC.1] Look for: As a pretty present for him
4. What kind of childhood does Victor have? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · 7.RC.1, 7.CC.1, 9-10.RC.1] Look for: Loving and sheltered
5. Why is this childhood important to the novel? [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · 7.RC.1, 7.CC.1, 9-10.RC.1] Look for: It contrasts with the creature's abandonment
6. Retell the three most important events of "Chapter I" in order, in one sentence each. [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · 7.RC.1, 7.CC.1, 9-10.RC.1] Look for: Victor describes his Genevese family: his father Alphonse, his mother Caroline (rescued from poverty), and Elizabeth Lavenza, the orphaned daughter of a Milanese nobleman, found living with poor peasants near Lake Como and adopted by his mother, whom his mother gives him as a 'present.' His childhood is loving and protected.
7. Which characters appear or are mentioned in "Chapter I"? Name two and one thing each says or does. [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · 7.RC.1, 7.CC.1, 9-10.RC.1] Look for: Names and actions taken from the chapter; check against the teacher summary.
8. Where and when does "Chapter I" take place? Point to the line that tells you. [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · 7.RC.1, 7.CC.1, 9-10.RC.1] Look for: A place/time detail quoted from the chapter.
9. Reread: "During one of their walks a poor cot in the foldings of a vale attracted their notice, as being singularly disconsolate, while the number of half-clothed children gathered about it, spoke of penury in its worst shape." What does "foldings" mean here, and what is literally happening in this line? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · 7.RC.1, 7.CC.1, 9-10.RC.1] Look for: foldings: folds or hollows (here, in the hills).
10. Reread: "The four others were dark-eyed, hardy little vagrants; this child was thin, and very fair." What does "vagrants" mean here, and what is literally happening in this line? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · 7.RC.1, 7.CC.1, 9-10.RC.1] Look for: vagrants: homeless wanderers.

Inferential / analytical

1. What does "Chapter I" suggest about a privileged childhood and family love? State the inference and the line that supports it. [DOK 2 · thinkPairShare · wait 5 s · 7.RC.2, 7.CC.2, 9-10.RC.2] Look for: Victor's ideal upbringing contrasts sharply with the creature's abandonment, raising the nature-versus-nurture question.
2. Find one example of characterization in this chapter. What does it reveal that a plain statement would not? [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · 7.RC.3, 7.CC.2, 9-10.RC.1] Look for: Look for what characters say, do and think, and how others react to them.
3. How does the setting in this chapter shape what we understand about a privileged childhood and family love? [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · 7.RC.3, 7.CC.2, 9-10.RC.1] Look for: Look for where and when events happen and how place shapes action or feeling.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Victor's loving upbringing sets the standard of care he later denies his creature. Useful evidence: "I am by birth a Genevese; and my family is one of the most distinguished of that republic" (Chapter I, paragraph 1): Opens with pride in lineage and status. On setting:

Geneva, a republic and a respectable family, creates a picture of order. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

4. In the passage that begins “His daughter attended him with the greatest tenderness; but she saw with despair that their little fund was rapidly decreasing, and that there was no other prospect of support.”, why might Shelley have chosen these particular words? Pick two and explain their connotations. [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · 7.RC.12, 7.CC.2, 9-10.RC.12] Look for: Diction analysis of two words in the anchor passage.
5. What causes the main turn in “Chapter I”, and what effect is it likely to have on what follows? [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · 7.RC.3, 7.CC.2, 9-10.RC.1] Look for: Victor describes his Genevese family: his father Alphonse, his mother Caroline (rescued from poverty), and Elizabeth Lavenza, the orphaned daughter of a Milanese nobleman, found living with poor peasants near Lake Como and adopted by his mother, whom his mother gives him as a 'present.' His…
6. How does “Chapter I” build on “Letter IV”? Name one link of cause and effect. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · 7.RC.3, 7.CC.2, 9-10.RC.3] Look for: A causal or structural link between this and the previous chapter.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Victor's loving upbringing sets the standard of care he later denies his creature. Useful evidence: “I have a pretty present for my Victor” (Chapter I, paragraph 11): Elizabeth is presented as a gift; useful for discussions of how women are treated in the novel. Theme link: The parents' "deep consciousness of what they owed towards the being to which they had given life" is the novel's standard of parental duty. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
7. What can we infer about a character's motives from what they say and do here, as opposed to what they claim? [DOK 3 · followUp · wait 8 s · 7.RC.3, 7.CC.2, 9-10.RC.1] Look for: An inference about motive supported by a quoted line.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Victor's loving upbringing sets the standard of care he later denies his creature. Useful evidence: “looked upon Elizabeth as mine—mine to protect, love, and cherish” (Chapter I, paragraph 11): Possessive language; evidence for a claim about Victor's self-centeredness. On characterization: Victor describes an idyllic, privileged childhood: devoted parents, a beloved adopted sister. He stresses that he was given every care, which makes his later neglect of his creation glaring. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
8. The bell-ringer asked: “How does Victor's childhood compare with what a newly created being might need?” Now that we have read closely, how would you revise your first answer, and which line changed your mind? [DOK 2 · thinkPairShare · wait 5 s · 7.RC.2, 7.CC.2, 9-10.RC.2] Look for: A revised answer anchored in the text.
9. Where does foreshadowing appear, and how does it connect this chapter to the larger concern with creation and responsibility? [DOK 3 · followUp · wait 8 s · 7.RC.3, 7.CC.2, 9-10.RC.3] Look for: Look for hints, warnings or images that point to later events.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Victor's loving upbringing sets the standard of care he later denies his creature. Useful evidence: “I am by birth a Genevese; and my family is one of the most distinguished of that republic” (Chapter I, paragraph 1): Opens with pride in lineage and status. Theme link: The parents' "deep consciousness of what they owed towards the being to which they had given life" is the novel's standard of parental duty. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
10. Background: Geneva was an independent republic known for Calvinism and civic pride; Rousseau, a Genevan, influenced ideas of education and nature. How does knowing this change the way you read one

moment in the chapter? [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · 7.RC.3, 7.CC.2, 9-10.RC.1] Look for: A specific moment reread in light of the context.

Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Victor's loving upbringing sets the standard of care he later denies his creature. Useful evidence: “I have a pretty present for my Victor” (Chapter I, paragraph 11): Elizabeth is presented as a gift; useful for discussions of how women are treated in the novel. On setting: Geneva, a republic and a respectable family, creates a picture of order. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

Evaluative / synthesis / creative

1. A critic might argue: “Victor's ideal upbringing contrasts sharply with the creature's abandonment, raising the nature-versus-nurture question.” How far do you agree? Take a stand and defend it with two lines from the chapter. [DOK 3 · fourCorners · wait 8 s · 7.RC.2, 7.CC.3, 9-10.RC.2] Look for: A defended position with evidence and one counterpoint.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Victor's loving upbringing sets the standard of care he later denies his creature. Useful evidence: “looked upon Elizabeth as mine—mine to protect, love, and cherish” (Chapter I, paragraph 11): Possessive language; evidence for a claim about Victor's self-centeredness. Theme link: The parents' "deep consciousness of what they owed towards the being to which they had given life" is the novel's standard of parental duty. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
2. Which character in this chapter acts most wisely, and which least? Judge them by a standard you name. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · 7.RC.3, 7.CC.3, 9-10.RC.1] Look for: An evaluation using an explicit criterion and evidence.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Victor's loving upbringing sets the standard of care he later denies his creature. Useful evidence: “I am by birth a Genevese; and my family is one of the most distinguished of that republic” (Chapter I, paragraph 1): Opens with pride in lineage and status. On characterization: Victor describes an idyllic, privileged childhood: devoted parents, a beloved adopted sister. He stresses that he was given every care, which makes his later neglect of his creation glaring. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
3. Rewrite one moment of “Chapter I” from the point of view of a different character. What does the new angle reveal or hide about a privileged childhood and family love? [DOK 4 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · 7.RC.1, 7.CC.3, 9-10.RC.1] Look for: A creative product with a rationale tied to the text.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Victor's loving upbringing sets the standard of care he later denies his creature. Useful evidence: “I have a pretty present for my Victor” (Chapter I, paragraph 11): Elizabeth is presented as a gift; useful for discussions of how women are treated in the novel. Theme link: The parents' "deep consciousness of what they owed towards the being to which they had given life" is the novel's standard of parental duty. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
4. Write three questions of your own about “Chapter I”: one recall, one “why/how”, and one “should/what if”. Trade with a partner and answer theirs. [DOK 3 · studentGenerated · wait 8 s · 7.RC.2, 7.CC.3, 9-10.RC.2] Look for: Student-generated questions at three levels.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Victor's loving upbringing sets the standard of care he later denies his creature. Useful evidence: “looked upon Elizabeth as mine—mine to protect, love, and

cherish” (Chapter I, paragraph 11): Possessive language; evidence for a claim about Victor's self-centeredness. Theme link: The parents' "deep consciousness of what they owed towards the being to which they had given life" is the novel's standard of parental duty. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

5. Connect this chapter to isolation and the need for companionship: is the link strong or weak so far? What would Shelley need to show next to strengthen it? [DOK 4 · socraticCircle · wait 8 s · 7.RC.2, 7.CC.3, 9-10.RC.2] Look for: A judgment of thematic development across the work.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Victor's loving upbringing sets the standard of care he later denies his creature. Useful evidence: “I am by birth a Genevese; and my family is one of the most distinguished of that republic” (Chapter I, paragraph 1): Opens with pride in lineage and status. Theme link: The parents' "deep consciousness of what they owed towards the being to which they had given life" is the novel's standard of parental duty. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

6. Is the characterization in this chapter effective, or does it feel heavy-handed? Evaluate it as a reader would in a review. [DOK 3 · fourCorners · wait 8 s · 7.RC.3, 7.CC.3, 9-10.RC.1] Look for: An evaluative judgment with criteria and evidence.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Victor's loving upbringing sets the standard of care he later denies his creature. Useful evidence: “I have a pretty present for my Victor” (Chapter I, paragraph 11): Elizabeth is presented as a gift; useful for discussions of how women are treated in the novel. On characterization: Victor describes an idyllic, privileged childhood: devoted parents, a beloved adopted sister. He stresses that he was given every care, which makes his later neglect of his creation glaring. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

7. Compare how “Chapter I” treats a privileged childhood and family love with how another text, film or event you know treats a similar idea. What does Frankenstein see that the other misses? [DOK 4 · socraticCircle · wait 8 s · 7.RC.2, 7.CC.3, 9-10.RC.2] Look for: A cross-text synthesis.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Victor's loving upbringing sets the standard of care he later denies his creature. Useful evidence: “looked upon Elizabeth as mine—mine to protect, love, and cherish” (Chapter I, paragraph 11): Possessive language; evidence for a claim about Victor's self-centeredness. Theme link: The parents' "deep consciousness of what they owed towards the being to which they had given life" is the novel's standard of parental duty. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

8. Predict what “Chapter II” will bring, using two clues from this chapter. After reading, evaluate your prediction. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · 7.RC.3, 7.CC.3, 9-10.RC.3] Look for: A prediction or judgment justified with textual clues.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Victor's loving upbringing sets the standard of care he later denies his creature. Useful evidence: “I am by birth a Genevese; and my family is one of the most distinguished of that republic” (Chapter I, paragraph 1): Opens with pride in lineage and status. Theme link: The parents' "deep consciousness of what they owed towards the being to which they had given life" is the novel's standard of parental duty. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

9. Design a one-paragraph modern adaptation of this chapter (setting, characters, conflict). What must stay the same for it to still be about a privileged childhood and family love? [DOK 4 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s ·

7.RC.2, 7.CC.3, 9-10.RC.2] Look for: A creative transfer that keeps the core idea.

Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Victor's loving upbringing sets the standard of care he later denies his creature. Useful evidence: “I have a pretty present for my Victor” (Chapter I, paragraph 11): Elizabeth is presented as a gift; useful for discussions of how women are treated in the novel. Theme link: The parents' "deep consciousness of what they owed towards the being to which they had given life" is the novel's standard of parental duty. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

10. What question would you most like to ask Mary Shelley about this chapter, and what answer do you think the text itself gives? [DOK 4 · studentGenerated · wait 8 s · 7.RC.2, 7.CC.3, 9-10.RC.2] Look for: A student-generated question answered from evidence.

    Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Victor's loving upbringing sets the standard of care he later denies his creature. Useful evidence: “looked upon Elizabeth as mine—mine to protect, love, and cherish” (Chapter I, paragraph 11): Possessive language; evidence for a claim about Victor's self-centeredness. Theme link: The parents' "deep consciousness of what they owed towards the being to which they had given life" is the novel's standard of parental duty. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

Annotation focus

- **Characterization:** look for what characters say, do and think, and how others react to them (anchor passage in the We do segment)
- Also notice **Setting**: where and when events happen and how place shapes action or feeling
- Also notice **Foreshadowing**: hints, warnings or images that point to later events

Chapter quiz: item bank (all eleven rigor versions)

1. [fill · recall · DOK 1] Fill in the blank with the vocabulary word that fits: “He came like a protecting spirit to the poor girl, who committed herself to his care; and after the _____ of his friend, he conducted her to Geneva, and placed her under the protection of a relation.” Word bank: vagrants, foldings, decreasing, interment Key: interment
2. [mc · recall · DOK 1] In the line “The four others were dark-eyed, hardy little vagrants; this child was thin, and very fair.”, what does “vagrants” most nearly mean?

   A. being very thin

   B. an act of traveling by water

   C. an unrestrained expression of emotion

   D. homeless wanderers

   Key: D (homeless wanderers)
3. [mc · recall · DOK 1] How does Elizabeth join the family?

   A. An orphaned nobleman's daughter raised by poor peasants, she is adopted by Victor's mother

   B. She is Victor's sister by birth

   C. She is a cousin from England

   D. She is a servant

   Key: A (An orphaned nobleman's daughter raised by poor peasants, she is adopted by Victor's mother)

4. [fill · recall · DOK 1] Fill in the blank with the vocabulary word that fits: "I, their eldest child, was born at Naples, and as an infant accompanied them in their _____." Word bank: foldings, decreasing, rambles, vagrants
   Key: rambles
5. [mc · recall · DOK 1] How does Victor's mother describe Elizabeth to him?
   A. As his teacher
   B. As a pretty present for him
   C. As a dangerous stranger
   D. As a burden

   Key: B (As a pretty present for him)
6. [fill · recall · DOK 1] Complete the quotation from Chapter I, paragraph 11: "I have a pretty _____ for my Victor"
   Key: present
7. [mc · recall · DOK 1] In the line "His daughter attended him with the greatest tenderness; but she saw with despair that their little fund was rapidly decreasing, and that there was no other prospect of support.", what does "decreasing" most nearly mean?
   A. becoming smaller or less
   B. the quality of being loud
   C. to dull or stain the brightness of
   D. the usage or vocabulary that is characteristic of a specific group of people

   Key: A (becoming smaller or less)
8. [fill · recall · DOK 1] Complete the quotation from Chapter I, paragraph 11: "looked upon _____ as mine—mine to protect, love, and cherish"
   Key: Elizabeth
9. [fill · recall · DOK 1] Fill in the blank with the vocabulary word that fits: "She procured plain work; she plaited straw; and by various means contrived to earn a _____ scarcely sufficient to support life." Word bank: pittance, vagrants, decreasing, foldings
   Key: pittance
10. [mc · inference · DOK 2] What does this passage most clearly show? "I am by birth a Genevese; and my family is one of the most distinguished of that republic" (Chapter I, paragraph 1)
    A. Clerval's character; he loves nature directly.
    B. Revulsion at his labor.
    C. Opens with pride in lineage and status.
    D. Self-blame.

    Key: C (Opens with pride in lineage and status.)
11. [mc · inference · DOK 2] What does this passage most clearly show? "looked upon Elizabeth as mine—mine to protect, love, and cherish" (Chapter I, paragraph 11)
    A. Simile for knowledge that cannot be unlearned.
    B. Walton admits his feelings run away with him, a trait he shares with Victor.
    C. Possessive language; evidence for a claim about Victor's self-centeredness.
    D. The argument from isolation.

Key: C (Possessive language; evidence for a claim about Victor's self-centeredness.)

12. [mc · inference · DOK 2] Which choice best states a central concern of “Chapter I”?

    A. Loneliness and the desire for a friend

    B. A privileged childhood and family love

    C. First experiences of the senses

    D. Obsession and the discovery of life

    Key: B (A privileged childhood and family love)

13. [mc · inference · DOK 2] What does this passage most clearly show? “I have a pretty present for my Victor” (Chapter I, paragraph 11)

    A. The first words he learns: basic needs and the home.

    B. (The 1831 text prints "drank.") Victor calls ambition a drug ("intoxicating draught") and madness. Evidence for the novel's view of obsessive curiosity.

    C. Elizabeth's honest question.

    D. Elizabeth is presented as a gift; useful for discussions of how women are treated in the novel.

    Key: D (Elizabeth is presented as a gift; useful for discussions of how women are treated in the novel.)

14. [short · analysis · DOK 3] Claim: Victor's loving upbringing sets the standard of care he later denies his creature. Explain how this evidence supports the claim: “I have a pretty present for my Victor” (Chapter I, paragraph 11).

    Sample answer: He describes himself as the center of his parents' devotion and treats Elizabeth as his "present," showing that he received care as his due; when he refuses any care to his own creation, the contrast exposes his failure.

15. [short · analysis · DOK 3] Analyze the word choice in “looked upon Elizabeth as mine—mine to protect, love, and cherish” (Chapter I, paragraph 11). Pick two words and explain what they suggest.

    Sample answer: Possessive language; evidence for a claim about Victor's self-centeredness.

16. [short · synthesis · DOK 4] Close reading: how do the diction and syntax of “I have a pretty present for my Victor” (Chapter I, paragraph 11) shape its meaning? Consider a second, competing reading.

    Sample answer: Elizabeth is presented as a gift; useful for discussions of how women are treated in the novel.

17. [mc · recall · DOK 1] Where is Victor's family from?

    A. London

    B. Geneva

    C. Naples

    D. Paris

    Key: B (Geneva)

18. [mc · recall · DOK 1] Why is this childhood important to the novel?

    A. It introduces the North Pole

    B. It explains Walton's voyage

    C. It shows Victor's poverty

    D. It contrasts with the creature's abandonment

    Key: D (It contrasts with the creature's abandonment)

19. [mc · recall · DOK 1] What kind of childhood does Victor have?

    A. Spent at sea

B. Cruel and poor

C. Loving and sheltered

D. Lonely and neglected

Key: C (Loving and sheltered)

20. [fill · recall · DOK 1] Fill in the blank with the vocabulary word that fits: “Whether he had died, or still lingered in the _____ of Austria, was not known.” Word bank: dungeons, decreasing, foldings, vagrants
    Key: dungeons

21. [fill · recall · DOK 1] Complete the quotation from Chapter I, paragraph 1: “I am by birth a Genevese; and my family is one of the most _____ of that republic”
    Key: distinguished

22. [mc · recall · DOK 1] In the line “When my father returned from Milan, he found playing with me in the hall of our villa, a child fairer than pictured cherub—a creature who seemed to shed radiance from her looks, and whose form and motions were lighter…”, what does “chamois” most nearly mean?

    A. reject with contempt

    B. hilly or mountainous country

    C. a small, agile mountain goat

    D. broken into sharp pieces

    Key: C (a small, agile mountain goat)

23. [short · inference · DOK 2] What can you infer from this line? “I am by birth a Genevese; and my family is one of the most distinguished of that republic” (Chapter I, paragraph 1) Answer in two or three sentences with one detail.
    Sample answer: Opens with pride in lineage and status.

24. [mc · analysis · DOK 3] Which literary element does this describe in “Chapter I”? Victor describes an idyllic, privileged childhood: devoted parents, a beloved adopted sister. He stresses that he was given every care, which makes his later neglect of his creation glaring.

    A. Simile

    B. Structure

    C. Characterization

    D. Foreshadowing

    Key: C (Characterization)

25. [mc · analysis · DOK 3] Which literary element does this describe in “Chapter I”? He says his parents felt they owed him duties as their child; he will owe the same duties and refuse them.

    A. Characterization

    B. Conflict

    C. Simile

    D. Irony

    Key: D (Irony)

26. [short · synthesis · DOK 4] Evaluate this claim about the chapter: “Victor's loving upbringing sets the standard of care he later denies his creature.” Is it fully persuasive? Argue with evidence, including a passage that complicates it.

Sample answer: He describes himself as the center of his parents' devotion and treats Elizabeth as his "present," showing that he received care as his due; when he refuses any care to his own creation, the contrast exposes his failure.

27. [mc · analysis · DOK 3] In this chapter, which theme does the following most directly develop? The parents' "deep consciousness of what they owed towards the being to which they had given life" is the novel's standard of parental duty.

    A. Isolation and the need for companionship

    B. The costs of unchecked ambition

    C. Nature versus nurture

    D. Creation and responsibility

    Key: D (Creation and responsibility)

28. [short · synthesis · DOK 4] Close reading: how do the diction and syntax of “I am by birth a Genevese; and my family is one of the most distinguished of that republic” (Chapter I, paragraph 1) shape its meaning? Consider a second, competing reading.

    Sample answer: Opens with pride in lineage and status.

29. [short · inference · DOK 2] What can you infer from this line? “I have a pretty present for my Victor” (Chapter I, paragraph 11) Answer in two or three sentences with one detail.

    Sample answer: Elizabeth is presented as a gift; useful for discussions of how women are treated in the novel.

30. [short · synthesis · DOK 4] Synthesis: trace how creation and responsibility develops from an earlier chapter to “Chapter I”. Use one quotation from each.

    Sample answer: The parents' "deep consciousness of what they owed towards the being to which they had given life" is the novel's standard of parental duty.

Rigor version	Items (in order)	Mix
Middle School	1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 6, 7, 8, 9, 10, 11, 12, 13, 14, 15, 16	recall 9, inference 4, analysis 2, synthesis 1
HS Freshman	17, 5, 18, 19, 2, 20, 21, 22, 23, 11, 12, 13, 14, 24, 25, 26	recall 8, inference 4, analysis 3, synthesis 1
HS Sophomore	6, 20, 8, 4, 9, 7, 10, 11, 12, 23, 13, 27, 25, 15, 26, 28	recall 6, inference 5, analysis 3, synthesis 2
HS Junior	4, 6, 20, 8, 18, 11, 10, 23, 12, 29, 25, 27, 15, 24, 26, 30	recall 5, inference 5, analysis 4, synthesis 2
HS Senior	20, 4, 17, 7, 10, 29, 11, 13, 23, 15, 24, 14, 27, 28, 16, 30	recall 4, inference 5, analysis 4, synthesis 3
AP	20, 22, 1, 12, 29, 13, 10, 24, 27, 14, 15, 25, 16, 28, 30, 26	recall 3, inference 4, analysis 5, synthesis 4
College Freshman	4, 20, 7, 13, 29, 12, 23, 15, 27, 14, 25, 24, 16, 28, 30, 26	recall 3, inference 4, analysis 5, synthesis 4
College Sophomore	20, 4, 10, 12, 29, 11, 23, 15, 24, 25, 14, 27, 16, 28, 26, 30	recall 2, inference 5, analysis 5, synthesis 4
College Junior	20, 9, 12, 29, 13, 11, 23, 24, 27, 25, 15, 14, 28, 26, 30, 16	recall 2, inference 5, analysis 5, synthesis 4
College Senior		recall 2, inference 5, analysis 5, synthesis 4

	6, 20, 23, 29, 12, 11, 13, 14, 24, 15, 25, 27, 28, 26, 16, 30	
Graduate / PhD	20, 4, 29, 10, 23, 12, 11, 14, 24, 15, 25, 27, 30, 16, 26, 28	recall 2, inference 5, analysis 5, synthesis 4

Writing prompts (eleven rigor levels)

Middle School (250 words; Indiana 2023: 7.RC.3, 7.W.1): Supported track (work from the passage your teacher selects). In “Chapter I,” how does Shelley show a privileged childhood and family love? Write a paragraph that states your claim, quotes two details from the passage, and explains how each detail supports your idea. Use the characterization you noticed as one piece of evidence.

HS Freshman (350 words; Indiana 2023: 9-10.RC.1, 9-10.W.1): In Chapter I, how does Shelley develop the idea of a privileged childhood and family love? State a clear claim, support it with two or three quotations, and explain how the characterization in the chapter helps build that idea.

HS Sophomore (450 words; Indiana 2023: 9-10.RC.1, 9-10.W.1): Analyze how Chapter I develops the idea of a privileged childhood and family love. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of characterization and setting shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.

HS Junior (550 words; Indiana 2023: 11-12.RC.3, 11-12.RC.1, 11-12.W.1): Analyze how the structure of Chapter I (where it begins, turns and ends) and its characterization shape the reader's understanding of a privileged childhood and family love. Identify one place where the text leaves matters uncertain and explain how that uncertainty adds to its meaning.

HS Senior (600 words; Indiana 2023: 11-12.RC.1, 11-12.W.1): Two readers disagree about what Chapter I suggests about a privileged childhood and family love. Lay out two plausible interpretations, weigh the evidence for each (including the chapter's characterization and setting), and argue for the stronger one in a sustained, well-organized essay.

AP (650 words; Indiana 2023: 11-12.RC.1, 11-12.W.1): Write a literary argument in which you analyze how Mary Shelley uses characterization in Chapter I to complicate the reader's understanding of a privileged childhood and family love. Develop a defensible thesis, select evidence purposefully, and explain how specific choices of diction and syntax create meaning.

College Freshman (1000 words; Indiana 2023: see unit standards): Situate Chapter I within its historical and literary context and argue how the chapter's treatment of a privileged childhood and family love responds to that context. Engage with at least one secondary perspective (a critic, historian or the author's own statements), integrate quotations smoothly, and cite in MLA style.

College Sophomore (1250 words; Indiana 2023: see unit standards): Read Chapter I alongside the conventions of its genre and period. Argue how the chapter's handling of a privileged childhood and family love follows or bends those conventions, using the characterization as evidence, and test your reading against one published critic. Document two secondary sources in MLA.

College Junior (1500 words; Indiana 2023: see unit standards): Apply a named critical approach (for example formalist, historicist, feminist, psychoanalytic or ecocritical) to Chapter I and its treatment of a privileged childhood and family love. State your method, show what it reveals in the chapter's characterization and setting, and identify where the text resists it.

College Senior (2000 words; Indiana 2023: see unit standards): Develop a research argument that reads Chapter I as evidence for a larger claim about a privileged childhood and family love in Frankenstein. Connect close reading of the chapter to the whole novel, engage at least four scholarly sources, and state precisely where your reading departs from theirs (Chicago style).

Graduate / PhD (2500 words; Indiana 2023: see unit standards): Develop an original argument that reads Chapter I as a hinge in the novel's larger treatment of a privileged childhood and family love. Position your reading within a named critical conversation (for example formalist, historicist, psychoanalytic, feminist or postcolonial approaches), account for the textual history where relevant, and articulate the stakes of your intervention for scholarship on Frankenstein.

SAT-style questions

1. *His daughter attended him with the greatest tenderness; but she saw with despair that their little fund was rapidly decreasing, and that there was no other prospect of support.*

   As used in the text, what does the word “decreasing” most nearly mean?

   A. becoming smaller or less

   B. take temporary possession of as a security, by legal authority

   C. an inadequate payment

   D. express strong disapproval of

2. *His daughter attended him with the greatest tenderness; but she saw with despair that their little fund was rapidly decreasing, and that there was no other prospect of support. But Caroline Beaufort possessed a mind of an uncommon mould; and her courage rose to support her in her adversity. She procured plain work; she plaited straw; and by various means contrived to earn a pittance scarcely sufficient to support life.*

   Which choice best states a central concern of “Chapter I”?

   A. The origin of the novel and the idea of creation

   B. Loneliness and the desire for a friend

   C. The wedding night and its catastrophe

   D. A privileged childhood and family love

SAT key: 1. A (becoming smaller or less); 2. D (A privileged childhood and family love)

Lesson 9: Chapter II

Focus: the first spark of obsession

Objective: Students will analyze how foreshadowing develops in “Chapter II” by writing a claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph that cites at least 2 quotations from the section, and will score at least 80% on the section quiz.

Standards: CCSS RL.9-10.5, W.9-10.1, L.9-10.4 · IN 9-10.RC.3, 9-10.W.1, 9-10.RC.9, 9-10.RC.11

Teacher only · spoilers

Victor recalls his friend Henry Clerval and his own early fascination with the alchemists Cornelius Agrippa, Paracelsus and Albertus Magnus. A lightning strike that destroys an oak tree introduces him to electricity, and he briefly turns to mathematics before 'destiny' pulls him back.

Background: Agrippa and Paracelsus were Renaissance figures who mixed early science with magic. Lightning and electricity fascinated Enlightenment scientists like Benjamin Franklin.

Significance: Victor frames his life as fated, shifting responsibility away from his choices—a key point for discussion.

Lesson plan and lecture script (90 minutes)

0–8 min · Bell-ringer · You do (8 min)
Students write to the bell-ringer, then pair-share.
Victor blames 'destiny' for his fate. Do you agree, or did he choose? Write for five minutes. Starters: I think... because... / This connects to ambition and knowledge because....
Prompt: Victor blames 'destiny' for his fate. Do you agree, or did he choose?
Sentence starters: I think… because… · This connects to ambition and knowledge because…
Strong response: A strong response takes a position and anticipates this: the desire to learn "the secrets of heaven and earth" begins as wonder and becomes obsession.

8–18 min · Vocabulary with etymology notes · I do (10 min)
Five key words in context, with verified word histories.
Today's words: ligaments — ties or bonds that hold things together; disunion — disagreement; being divided; loudness — the quality of being loud; preceptors — teachers; dissect — to cut apart in order to examine closely. “ligaments”: From Middle English ligament, from Latin ligāmentum, from ligō "tie, bind". “disunion”: From Middle French désunion. “preceptors”: From Middle English preceptor, preceptur, from Latin praeceptor "commander; instructor", from the verb praecipiō + -or "-er: forming agent nouns", from prae- "pre-, fore-: before" + capiō "to take; to get, to take in, to understand". “dissect”: Latin dissectus past participle of dissecare "to cut asunder, cut up", from dis- "asunder" + secare "to cut"; see section.
Words: ligaments: ties or bonds that hold things together · disunion: disagreement; being divided · loudness: the quality of being loud · preceptors: teachers · dissect: to cut apart in order to examine closely

18–28 min · Background and context · I do (10 min)
Mini-lecture (read or adapt the script).
Agrippa and Paracelsus were Renaissance figures who mixed early science with magic. Lightning and electricity fascinated Enlightenment scientists like Benjamin Franklin. Victor frames his life as fated, shifting responsibility away from his choices—a key point for discussion. Foreshadowing: Victor repeatedly calls natural philosophy his "fate" and narrates with hindsight; the lightning-blasted oak predicts his ruin. Characterization: Curious and solitary, he reads outdated alchemists (Cornelius Agrippa, Paracelsus, Albertus Magnus) and is not corrected well: his father calls Agrippa "sad trash" without explaining why. Diction / vocabulary: Words like "divine," "secrets" and "fate" make science sound like a religion. Watch for the blasted oak: the tree destroyed by lightning foreshadows Victor's destruction by the power he studies.

28–40 min · I do: modeled close reading · I do (12 min)
Model the close reading of the anchor quotation using the written think-aloud below.
I read the line once for meaning and once for craft. "The world was to me a secret which I desired to divine" (Chapter II, paragraph 1). "Divine" means to discover by intuition and also suggests godlike power. That is foreshadowing at work: Victor repeatedly calls natural philosophy his "fate" and narrates with hindsight; the lightning-blasted oak predicts his ruin.

> *The world was to me a secret which I desired to divine* (Chapter II, paragraph 1)

Think-aloud: I read the line once for meaning and once for craft. "The world was to me a secret which I desired to divine" (Chapter II, paragraph 1). "Divine" means to discover by intuition and also suggests godlike power. That is foreshadowing at work: Victor repeatedly calls natural philosophy his "fate" and narrates with hindsight; the lightning-blasted oak predicts his ruin.

40–55 min · We do: guided annotation · We do (15 min)
Guided analysis of a second quotation; expected answers given.
Ask: What words in this line stand out, and what do they suggest? Expected: "Sad trash" dismisses without teaching. Victor blames this moment, which shows he looks for causes outside himself and connects to the theme of responsibility. Ask: How does this line connect to ambition and knowledge? Expected: The desire to learn "the secrets of heaven and earth" begins as wonder and becomes obsession. (Dismissal without explanation; Victor later blames this.)

> *My dear Victor, do not waste your time upon this; it is sad trash* (Chapter II, paragraph 7)

Ask: What words in this line stand out, and what do they suggest?
Expected answer: "Sad trash" dismisses without teaching. Victor blames this moment, which shows he looks for causes outside himself and connects to the theme of responsibility.
Ask: How does this line connect to ambition and knowledge?
Expected answer: The desire to learn "the secrets of heaven and earth" begins as wonder and becomes obsession. (Dismissal without explanation; Victor later blames this.)

55–70 min · You do: independent annotation · You do (15 min)

Independent annotation and a claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph (exemplar given).

Annotate the chapter for foreshadowing, characterization (three marks with a margin note each), then write one claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph: what does this chapter suggest about the first spark of obsession? Then start your writing prompt at your assigned level (HS Sophomore: Analyze how Chapter II develops the idea of the first spark of obsession. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of foreshadowing and characterization shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.) Exemplar: Victor describes his obsession as fate, which lets him avoid blame for his choices. When the text says "Natural philosophy is the genius that has regulated my fate" (Chapter II, paragraph 7), it shows this directly. Calling natural philosophy "the genius that has regulated my fate" makes science an outside force, and he blames his father's careless "sad trash" for not stopping him; readers can see a man explaining away his own will.

Task: Annotate the chapter for foreshadowing, characterization (three marks with a margin note each), then write one claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph: what does this chapter suggest about the first spark of obsession? Then start your writing prompt at your assigned level (HS Sophomore: Analyze how Chapter II develops the idea of the first spark of obsession. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of foreshadowing and characterization shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.)

Exemplar: Victor describes his obsession as fate, which lets him avoid blame for his choices. When the text says "Natural philosophy is the genius that has regulated my fate" (Chapter II, paragraph 7), it shows this directly. Calling natural philosophy "the genius that has regulated my fate" makes science an outside force, and he blames his father's careless "sad trash" for not stopping him; readers can see a man explaining away his own will.

70–80 min · Discussion · We do (10 min)

Structured discussion from the 30 tiered questions, with facilitation notes.

Anchor question: Victor blames 'destiny' for his fate. Do you agree, or did he choose? Ask: how much of Victor's fate is chosen? Have students list choices he makes in this chapter.

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80–87 min · Exit ticket / chapter quiz · You do (7 min)

Chapter quiz in the app and an exit ticket (answer given).

Chapter quiz in the app, then: In one sentence, what does this chapter suggest about the first spark of obsession? Support it with one short quotation. Model answer: Victor describes his obsession as fate, which lets him avoid blame for his choices. ("Natural philosophy is the genius that has regulated my fate", Chapter II, paragraph 7). Accept any defensible claim backed by a quotation from the chapter; the answer key for the quiz is in the Quiz section.

Exit ticket: In one sentence, what does this chapter suggest about the first spark of obsession? Support it with one short quotation.

Answer: Model answer: Victor describes his obsession as fate, which lets him avoid blame for his choices. ("Natural philosophy is the genius that has regulated my fate", Chapter II, paragraph 7). Accept any defensible claim backed by a quotation from the chapter; the answer key for the quiz is in the Quiz section.

> **87–90 min · Closure · I do (3 min)**
> Summarize the lesson and preview the next reading.
> *Today we saw how foreshadowing shapes the first spark of obsession. Key takeaway: the desire to learn "the secrets of heaven and earth" begins as wonder and becomes obsession.*

Total: 90 minutes.

Teacher analysis (spoilers)

Literary elements

- **Foreshadowing:** Victor repeatedly calls natural philosophy his "fate" and narrates with hindsight; the lightning-blasted oak predicts his ruin.
- **Characterization:** Curious and solitary, he reads outdated alchemists (Cornelius Agrippa, Paracelsus, Albertus Magnus) and is not corrected well: his father calls Agrippa "sad trash" without explaining why.
- **Diction / vocabulary:** Words like "divine," "secrets" and "fate" make science sound like a religion.

Themes and how they develop

- **ambition and knowledge:** the desire to learn "the secrets of heaven and earth" begins as wonder and becomes obsession.

Symbols and motifs

- **the blasted oak:** the tree destroyed by lightning foreshadows Victor's destruction by the power he studies.

Key quotations (checked against the reading text)

- “The world was to me a secret which I desired to divine” (Chapter II, paragraph 1) "Divine" means to discover by intuition and also suggests godlike power.
- “My dear Victor, do not waste your time upon this; it is sad trash” (Chapter II, paragraph 7) Dismissal without explanation; Victor later blames this.
- “Natural philosophy is the genius that has regulated my fate” (Chapter II, paragraph 7) Victor treats science as a spirit controlling him, shifting responsibility.

Model claim-evidence-reasoning

Claim: Victor describes his obsession as fate, which lets him avoid blame for his choices.
Evidence: “Natural philosophy is the genius that has regulated my fate” (Chapter II, paragraph 7)
Reasoning: Calling natural philosophy "the genius that has regulated my fate" makes science an outside force, and he blames his father's careless "sad trash" for not stopping him; readers can see a man explaining away his own will.

Vocabulary with etymology notes

Word	Definition (in this sentence)	In context	Word history

ligaments (noun)	ties or bonds that hold things together	*Thus strangely are our souls constructed, and by such slight ligaments are we bound to prosperity or ruin.*	"ligaments": From Middle English ligament, from Latin ligāmentum, from ligō "tie, bind". (Wiktionary, https://en.wiktionary.org/wiki/ligament#Etymology)
disunion (noun)	disagreement; being divided	*I need not say that we were strangers to any species of disunion or dispute.*	"disunion": From Middle French désunion. (Wiktionary, https://en.wiktionary.org/wiki/disunion#Etymology)
loudness (noun)	the quality of being loud	*It advanced from behind the mountains of Jura; and the thunder burst at once with frightful loudness from various quarters of the heavens.*	
preceptors (noun)	teachers	*Under the guidance of my new preceptors, I entered with the greatest diligence into the search of the philosopher's stone and the elixir of life; but the latter soon obtained my undivided attention.*	"preceptors": From Middle English preceptor, preceptur, from Latin praeceptor "commander; instructor", from the verb praecipiō + -or "-er: forming agent nouns", from prae- "pre-, fore-: before" + capiō "to take; to get, to take in, to understand". (Wiktionary, https://en.wiktionary.org/wiki/preceptor#Etymology)
dissect (verb)	to cut apart in order to examine closely	*He might dissect, anatomise, and give names; but, not to speak of a final cause, causes in their secondary and tertiary grades were utterly unknown to him.*	"dissect": Latin dissectus past participle of dissecare "to cut asunder, cut up", from dis- "asunder" + secare "to cut"; see section. (Wiktionary, https://en.wiktionary.org/wiki/dissect#Etymology)
relinquishing (verb)	part with a possession or right	*Her victory was announced by an unusual tranquillity and gladness of soul, which followed the relinquishing of my ancient and latterly tormenting studies.*	"relinquishing": From Latin relinquere "to leave behind," from re- "back" + linquere "to leave." (Online Etymology Dictionary, https://www.etymonline.com/word/relinquish)
unveiled (verb)	remove the veil from	*He had partially unveiled the face of Nature, but her immortal lineaments were still a wonder and a mystery.*	"unveiled": From Middle English unveiled, vnueylyd, equivalent to un- + veil + -ed. (Wiktionary, https://en.wiktionary.org/wiki/unveiled#Etymology)
invulnerable (adjective)	immune to attack; impregnable	*Wealth was an inferior object; but what glory would attend the discovery, if I could banish disease from the human frame, and render man invulnerable to any but a violent death!*	"invulnerable": From Middle French invulnérable, from Latin invulnerābilis, from vulnerābilis, from vulnerō "to wound", from vulnus "wound", equivalent to in + vulnerable. (Wiktionary, https://en.wiktionary.org/wiki/invulnerable#Etymology)

splintered (verb)	broken into sharp pieces	*It was not splintered by the shock, but entirely reduced to thin ribbons of wood.*	"splintered": From Middle English splenter, splinter, from Middle Dutch splinter, equivalent to splint + er. (Wiktionary, https://en.wiktionary.org/wiki/splinter#Etymology)
predilection (noun)	a predisposition in favor of something	*Natural philosophy is the genius that has regulated my fate; I desire, therefore, in this narration, to state those facts which led to my predilection for that science.*	

Discussion questions

1. Victor blames 'destiny' for his fate. Do you agree, or did he choose?
2. Where does foreshadowing appear in this chapter, and what effect does it have? Point to one passage.
3. How does this chapter connect to the book's larger concern with isolation and the need for companionship?

Classroom discussion questions (30, tiered)

Wait time after every question (3 s for DOK 1, 5 s for DOK 2, 8 to 10 s for DOK 3 and 4); think-pair-share on DOK 3 and 4; answer each response with a follow-up probe; close with student-generated questions. Focus sets by rigor level: Middle School: 1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 6, 11, 12, 13, 14, 21, 22; HS Freshman: 1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 12, 13, 14, 15, 22, 23, 24; HS Sophomore: 1, 2, 3, 4, 13, 14, 15, 16, 17, 23, 24, 25; HS Junior: 1, 2, 3, 14, 15, 16, 17, 18, 24, 25, 26, 27; HS Senior: 1, 2, 3, 15, 16, 17, 18, 25, 26, 27, 28, 29; AP: 1, 2, 16, 17, 18, 19, 20, 26, 27, 28, 29, 30; College Freshman: 1, 2, 17, 18, 19, 20, 21, 22, 27, 28, 29, 30; College Sophomore: 1, 2, 11, 18, 19, 20, 21, 22, 23, 28, 29, 30; College Junior: 1, 11, 12, 19, 20, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 29, 30; College Senior: 1, 11, 12, 13, 20, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 26, 30; Graduate / PhD: 1, 11, 12, 13, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 26, 27, 28

Literal / recall

1. Which author first fascinates Victor? [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · 7.RC.1, 7.CC.1, 9-10.RC.1] Look for: Cornelius Agrippa
2. What does Victor's father call Agrippa's work? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · 7.RC.1, 7.CC.1, 9-10.RC.1] Look for: Sad trash
3. What event introduces Victor to electricity? [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · 7.RC.1, 7.CC.1, 9-10.RC.1] Look for: Lightning destroying an oak tree
4. Who is Victor's closest childhood friend? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · 7.RC.1, 7.CC.1, 9-10.RC.1] Look for: Henry Clerval
5. What does Victor say governed his life? [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · 7.RC.1, 7.CC.1, 9-10.RC.1] Look for: Destiny
6. Retell the three most important events of "Chapter II" in order, in one sentence each. [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · 7.RC.1, 7.CC.1, 9-10.RC.1] Look for: Victor recalls his friend Henry Clerval and his own early fascination with the alchemists Cornelius Agrippa, Paracelsus and Albertus Magnus. A lightning strike that destroys an oak tree introduces him to electricity, and he briefly turns to mathematics before 'destiny' pulls him back.

7. Which characters appear or are mentioned in “Chapter II”? Name two and one thing each says or does. [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · 7.RC.1, 7.CC.1, 9-10.RC.1] Look for: Names and actions taken from the chapter; check against the teacher summary.
8. Where and when does “Chapter II” take place? Point to the line that tells you. [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · 7.RC.1, 7.CC.1, 9-10.RC.1] Look for: A place/time detail quoted from the chapter.
9. Reread: “Thus strangely are our souls constructed, and by such slight ligaments are we bound to prosperity or ruin.” What does “ligaments” mean here, and what is literally happening in this line? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · 7.RC.1, 7.CC.1, 9-10.RC.1] Look for: ligaments: ties or bonds that hold things together.
10. Reread: “I need not say that we were strangers to any species of disunion or dispute.” What does “disunion” mean here, and what is literally happening in this line? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · 7.RC.1, 7.CC.1, 9-10.RC.1] Look for: disunion: disagreement; being divided.

Inferential / analytical

1. What does “Chapter II” suggest about the first spark of obsession? State the inference and the line that supports it. [DOK 2 · thinkPairShare · wait 5 s · 7.RC.2, 7.CC.2, 9-10.RC.2] Look for: Victor frames his life as fated, shifting responsibility away from his choices—a key point for discussion.
2. Find one example of foreshadowing in this chapter. What does it reveal that a plain statement would not? [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · 7.RC.3, 7.CC.2, 9-10.RC.3] Look for: Look for hints, warnings or images that point to later events.
3. How does the characterization in this chapter shape what we understand about the first spark of obsession? [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · 7.RC.3, 7.CC.2, 9-10.RC.1] Look for: Look for what characters say, do and think, and how others react to them.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Victor describes his obsession as fate, which lets him avoid blame for his choices. Useful evidence: “The world was to me a secret which I desired to divine” (Chapter II, paragraph 1): "Divine" means to discover by intuition and also suggests godlike power. On characterization: Curious and solitary, he reads outdated alchemists (Cornelius Agrippa, Paracelsus, Albertus Magnus) and is not corrected well: his father calls Agrippa "sad trash" without explaining why. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
4. In the passage that begins “The untaught peasant beheld the elements around him, and was acquainted with their practical uses.”, why might Shelley have chosen these particular words? Pick two and explain their connotations. [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · 7.RC.12, 7.CC.2, 9-10.RC.12] Look for: Diction analysis of two words in the anchor passage.
5. What causes the main turn in “Chapter II”, and what effect is it likely to have on what follows? [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · 7.RC.3, 7.CC.2, 9-10.RC.1] Look for: Victor recalls his friend Henry Clerval and his own early fascination with the alchemists Cornelius Agrippa, Paracelsus and Albertus Magnus. A lightning strike that destroys an oak tree introduces him to electricity, and he briefly turns to mathematics before 'destiny' pulls him back.
6. How does “Chapter II” build on “Chapter I”? Name one link of cause and effect. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · 7.RC.3, 7.CC.2, 9-10.RC.3] Look for: A causal or structural link between this and the previous chapter.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Victor describes his obsession as fate, which lets him avoid blame for his choices. Useful evidence: “My dear Victor, do not waste your time upon this; it is sad trash” (Chapter II, paragraph 7): Dismissal without explanation; Victor later blames this. Theme link: the desire to learn "the secrets of heaven and earth" begins as wonder and becomes obsession. Credit any

position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

7. What can we infer about a character's motives from what they say and do here, as opposed to what they claim? [DOK 3 · followUp · wait 8 s · 7.RC.3, 7.CC.2, 9-10.RC.1] Look for: An inference about motive supported by a quoted line.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Victor describes his obsession as fate, which lets him avoid blame for his choices. Useful evidence: “Natural philosophy is the genius that has regulated my fate” (Chapter II, paragraph 7): Victor treats science as a spirit controlling him, shifting responsibility. On characterization: Curious and solitary, he reads outdated alchemists (Cornelius Agrippa, Paracelsus, Albertus Magnus) and is not corrected well: his father calls Agrippa "sad trash" without explaining why. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
8. The bell-ringer asked: “Victor blames 'destiny' for his fate. Do you agree, or did he choose?” Now that we have read closely, how would you revise your first answer, and which line changed your mind? [DOK 2 · thinkPairShare · wait 5 s · 7.RC.2, 7.CC.2, 9-10.RC.2] Look for: A revised answer anchored in the text.
9. Where does symbolism appear, and how does it connect this chapter to the larger concern with isolation and the need for companionship? [DOK 3 · followUp · wait 8 s · 7.RC.12, 7.CC.2, 9-10.RC.12] Look for: Look for objects, places or actions that stand for larger ideas.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Victor describes his obsession as fate, which lets him avoid blame for his choices. Useful evidence: “The world was to me a secret which I desired to divine” (Chapter II, paragraph 1): "Divine" means to discover by intuition and also suggests godlike power. Theme link: the desire to learn "the secrets of heaven and earth" begins as wonder and becomes obsession. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
10. Background: Agrippa and Paracelsus were Renaissance figures who mixed early science with magic. Lightning and electricity fascinated Enlightenment scientists like Benjamin Franklin. How does knowing this change the way you read one moment in the chapter? [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · 7.RC.3, 7.CC.2, 9-10.RC.1] Look for: A specific moment reread in light of the context.
    Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Victor describes his obsession as fate, which lets him avoid blame for his choices. Useful evidence: “My dear Victor, do not waste your time upon this; it is sad trash” (Chapter II, paragraph 7): Dismissal without explanation; Victor later blames this. Theme link: the desire to learn "the secrets of heaven and earth" begins as wonder and becomes obsession. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

Evaluative / synthesis / creative

1. A critic might argue: “Victor frames his life as fated, shifting responsibility away from his choices—a key point for discussion.” How far do you agree? Take a stand and defend it with two lines from the chapter. [DOK 3 · fourCorners · wait 8 s · 7.RC.2, 7.CC.3, 9-10.RC.2] Look for: A defended position with evidence and one counterpoint.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Victor describes his obsession as fate, which lets him avoid blame for his choices. Useful evidence: “Natural philosophy is the genius that has regulated my fate” (Chapter II, paragraph 7): Victor treats science as a spirit controlling him, shifting responsibility. Theme

link: the desire to learn "the secrets of heaven and earth" begins as wonder and becomes obsession. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

2. Which character in this chapter acts most wisely, and which least? Judge them by a standard you name. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · 7.RC.3, 7.CC.3, 9-10.RC.1] Look for: An evaluation using an explicit criterion and evidence.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Victor describes his obsession as fate, which lets him avoid blame for his choices. Useful evidence: “The world was to me a secret which I desired to divine” (Chapter II, paragraph 1): "Divine" means to discover by intuition and also suggests godlike power. On characterization: Curious and solitary, he reads outdated alchemists (Cornelius Agrippa, Paracelsus, Albertus Magnus) and is not corrected well: his father calls Agrippa "sad trash" without explaining why. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

3. Rewrite one moment of “Chapter II” from the point of view of a different character. What does the new angle reveal or hide about the first spark of obsession? [DOK 4 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · 7.RC.1, 7.CC.3, 9-10.RC.1] Look for: A creative product with a rationale tied to the text.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Victor describes his obsession as fate, which lets him avoid blame for his choices. Useful evidence: “My dear Victor, do not waste your time upon this; it is sad trash” (Chapter II, paragraph 7): Dismissal without explanation; Victor later blames this. Theme link: the desire to learn "the secrets of heaven and earth" begins as wonder and becomes obsession. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

4. Write three questions of your own about “Chapter II”: one recall, one “why/how”, and one “should/what if”. Trade with a partner and answer theirs. [DOK 3 · studentGenerated · wait 8 s · 7.RC.2, 7.CC.3, 9-10.RC.2] Look for: Student-generated questions at three levels.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Victor describes his obsession as fate, which lets him avoid blame for his choices. Useful evidence: “Natural philosophy is the genius that has regulated my fate” (Chapter II, paragraph 7): Victor treats science as a spirit controlling him, shifting responsibility. Theme link: the desire to learn "the secrets of heaven and earth" begins as wonder and becomes obsession. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

5. Connect this chapter to nature versus nurture: is the link strong or weak so far? What would Shelley need to show next to strengthen it? [DOK 4 · socraticCircle · wait 8 s · 7.RC.2, 7.CC.3, 9-10.RC.2] Look for: A judgment of thematic development across the work.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Victor describes his obsession as fate, which lets him avoid blame for his choices. Useful evidence: “The world was to me a secret which I desired to divine” (Chapter II, paragraph 1): "Divine" means to discover by intuition and also suggests godlike power. Theme link: the desire to learn "the secrets of heaven and earth" begins as wonder and becomes obsession. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

6. Is the foreshadowing in this chapter effective, or does it feel heavy-handed? Evaluate it as a reader would in a review. [DOK 3 · fourCorners · wait 8 s · 7.RC.3, 7.CC.3, 9-10.RC.3] Look for: An evaluative judgment with criteria and evidence.

Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Victor describes his obsession as fate, which lets him avoid blame for his choices. Useful evidence: “My dear Victor, do not waste your time upon this; it is sad trash” (Chapter II, paragraph 7): Dismissal without explanation; Victor later blames this. On foreshadowing: Victor repeatedly calls natural philosophy his "fate" and narrates with hindsight; the lightning-blasted oak predicts his ruin. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

7. Compare how “Chapter II” treats the first spark of obsession with how another text, film or event you know treats a similar idea. What does Frankenstein see that the other misses? [DOK 4 · socraticCircle · wait 8 s · 7.RC.2, 7.CC.3, 9-10.RC.2] Look for: A cross-text synthesis.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Victor describes his obsession as fate, which lets him avoid blame for his choices. Useful evidence: “Natural philosophy is the genius that has regulated my fate” (Chapter II, paragraph 7): Victor treats science as a spirit controlling him, shifting responsibility. Theme link: the desire to learn "the secrets of heaven and earth" begins as wonder and becomes obsession. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

8. Predict what “Chapter III” will bring, using two clues from this chapter. After reading, evaluate your prediction. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · 7.RC.3, 7.CC.3, 9-10.RC.3] Look for: A prediction or judgment justified with textual clues.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Victor describes his obsession as fate, which lets him avoid blame for his choices. Useful evidence: “The world was to me a secret which I desired to divine” (Chapter II, paragraph 1): "Divine" means to discover by intuition and also suggests godlike power. On foreshadowing: Victor repeatedly calls natural philosophy his "fate" and narrates with hindsight; the lightning-blasted oak predicts his ruin. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

9. Design a one-paragraph modern adaptation of this chapter (setting, characters, conflict). What must stay the same for it to still be about the first spark of obsession? [DOK 4 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · 7.RC.2, 7.CC.3, 9-10.RC.2] Look for: A creative transfer that keeps the core idea.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Victor describes his obsession as fate, which lets him avoid blame for his choices. Useful evidence: “My dear Victor, do not waste your time upon this; it is sad trash” (Chapter II, paragraph 7): Dismissal without explanation; Victor later blames this. Theme link: the desire to learn "the secrets of heaven and earth" begins as wonder and becomes obsession. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

10. What question would you most like to ask Mary Shelley about this chapter, and what answer do you think the text itself gives? [DOK 4 · studentGenerated · wait 8 s · 7.RC.2, 7.CC.3, 9-10.RC.2] Look for: A student-generated question answered from evidence.

    Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Victor describes his obsession as fate, which lets him avoid blame for his choices. Useful evidence: “Natural philosophy is the genius that has regulated my fate” (Chapter II, paragraph 7): Victor treats science as a spirit controlling him, shifting responsibility. Theme link: the desire to learn "the secrets of heaven and earth" begins as wonder and becomes obsession. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

Annotation focus

- **Foreshadowing:** look for hints, warnings or images that point to later events (anchor passage in the We do segment)
- Also notice **Characterization**: what characters say, do and think, and how others react to them
- Also notice **Symbolism**: objects, places or actions that stand for larger ideas

Chapter quiz: item bank (all eleven rigor versions)

1. [mc · recall · DOK 1] What does Victor's father call Agrippa's work?

   A. Sad trash

   B. A great adventure

   C. Brilliant science

   D. Holy truth

   Key: A (Sad trash)

2. [mc · recall · DOK 1] In the line "Thus strangely are our souls constructed, and by such slight ligaments are we bound to prosperity or ruin.", what does "ligaments" most nearly mean?

   A. killing large numbers of people

   B. ties or bonds that hold things together

   C. abundant wealth

   D. an elaborate analytical or explanatory essay or discussion

   Key: B (ties or bonds that hold things together)

3. [fill · recall · DOK 1] Fill in the blank with the vocabulary word that fits: "He had partially _____ the face of Nature, but her immortal lineaments were still a wonder and a mystery." Word bank: loudness, unveiled, disunion, ligaments

   Key: unveiled

4. [fill · recall · DOK 1] Fill in the blank with the vocabulary word that fits: "Her victory was announced by an unusual tranquillity and gladness of soul, which followed the _____ of my ancient and latterly tormenting studies." Word bank: loudness, ligaments, disunion, relinquishing

   Key: relinquishing

5. [mc · recall · DOK 1] Who is Victor's closest childhood friend?

   A. Henry Clerval

   B. M. Krempe

   C. Felix De Lacey

   D. Robert Walton

   Key: A (Henry Clerval)

6. [fill · recall · DOK 1] Fill in the blank with the vocabulary word that fits: "Wealth was an inferior object; but what glory would attend the discovery, if I could banish disease from the human frame, and render man _____ to any but a violent death!" Word bank: loudness, ligaments, invulnerable, disunion

   Key: invulnerable

7. [mc · recall · DOK 1] In the line “It advanced from behind the mountains of Jura; and the thunder burst at once with frightful loudness from various quarters of the heavens.”, what does “loudness” most nearly mean?

   A. the quality of being loud

   B. annoyances; worries

   C. a companion at play

   D. degrading; lowering in dignity

   Key: A (the quality of being loud)

8. [mc · recall · DOK 1] In the line “Under the guidance of my new preceptors, I entered with the greatest diligence into the search of the philosopher’s stone and the elixir of life; but the latter soon obtained my undivided attention.”, what does “preceptors” most nearly mean?

   A. teachers

   B. slowly; late

   C. tiredness and lack of energy

   D. fallen as a duty (on someone)

   Key: A (teachers)

9. [mc · recall · DOK 1] What does Victor say governed his life?

   A. Money

   B. Destiny

   C. His mother

   D. Religion

   Key: B (Destiny)

10. [mc · inference · DOK 2] What does this passage most clearly show? “Natural philosophy is the genius that has regulated my fate” (Chapter II, paragraph 7)

    A. Victor treats science as a spirit controlling him, shifting responsibility.

    B. Shelley presents herself as a parent of the book. Use this to connect author and character: both make something "hideous," but only one blesses it.

    C. Simile for knowledge that cannot be unlearned.

    D. Physical collapse.

    Key: A (Victor treats science as a spirit controlling him, shifting responsibility.)

11. [mc · inference · DOK 2] What does this passage most clearly show? “The world was to me a secret which I desired to divine” (Chapter II, paragraph 1)

    A. Mocking accusation.

    B. "Divine" means to discover by intuition and also suggests godlike power.

    C. The creature's first gesture is reaching; Victor's response is flight. Key evidence that the creature is abandoned before it acts.

    D. Milton allusion; the creature casts Victor as a God who failed.

    Key: B ("Divine" means to discover by intuition and also suggests godlike power.)

12. [mc · inference · DOK 2] Which choice best states a central concern of “Chapter II”?

    A. The first spark of obsession

B. The author's stated purpose

C. Ambition and the hunger for discovery

D. Horror at the moment of creation

Key: A (The first spark of obsession)

13. [short · inference · DOK 2] What can you infer from this line? “The world was to me a secret which I desired to divine” (Chapter II, paragraph 1) Answer in two or three sentences with one detail.
    Sample answer: "Divine" means to discover by intuition and also suggests godlike power.

14. [mc · analysis · DOK 3] Which literary element does this describe in “Chapter II”? Curious and solitary, he reads outdated alchemists (Cornelius Agrippa, Paracelsus, Albertus Magnus) and is not corrected well: his father calls Agrippa "sad trash" without explaining why.

    A. Theme

    B. Simile

    C. Characterization

    D. Irony

    Key: C (Characterization)

15. [short · analysis · DOK 3] Analyze the word choice in “Natural philosophy is the genius that has regulated my fate” (Chapter II, paragraph 7). Pick two words and explain what they suggest.
    Sample answer: Victor treats science as a spirit controlling him, shifting responsibility.

16. [short · synthesis · DOK 4] Close reading: how do the diction and syntax of “My dear Victor, do not waste your time upon this; it is sad trash” (Chapter II, paragraph 7) shape its meaning? Consider a second, competing reading.
    Sample answer: Dismissal without explanation; Victor later blames this.

17. [fill · recall · DOK 1] Complete the quotation from Chapter II, paragraph 7: “My dear _____, do not waste your time upon this; it is sad trash”
    Key: Victor

18. [fill · recall · DOK 1] Complete the quotation from Chapter II, paragraph 1: “The world was to me a secret which I _____ to divine”
    Key: desired

19. [fill · recall · DOK 1] Fill in the blank with the vocabulary word that fits: “He might _____, anatomise, and give names; but, not to speak of a final cause, causes in their secondary and tertiary grades were utterly unknown to him.” Word bank: ligaments, disunion, loudness, dissect
    Key: dissect

20. [mc · recall · DOK 1] In the line “I need not say that we were strangers to any species of disunion or dispute.”, what does “disunion” most nearly mean?

    A. disagreement; being divided

    B. to grant; to give

    C. come down on or keep down by unjust use of one's authority

    D. a vehicle mounted on runners and pulled by horses or dogs; for transportation over snow

    Key: A (disagreement; being divided)

21. [mc · inference · DOK 2] What does this passage most clearly show? “My dear Victor, do not waste your time upon this; it is sad trash” (Chapter II, paragraph 7)

    A. The turn from ambition to revulsion in one sentence.

    B. Dismissal without explanation; Victor later blames this.

    C. Revulsion at his labor.

    D. Fear and disgust pull against each other: the source of his delay.

    Key: B (Dismissal without explanation; Victor later blames this.)

22. [short · analysis · DOK 3] Claim: Victor describes his obsession as fate, which lets him avoid blame for his choices. Explain how this evidence supports the claim: “Natural philosophy is the genius that has regulated my fate” (Chapter II, paragraph 7).

    Sample answer: Calling natural philosophy "the genius that has regulated my fate" makes science an outside force, and he blames his father's careless "sad trash" for not stopping him; readers can see a man explaining away his own will.

23. [short · synthesis · DOK 4] Close reading: how do the diction and syntax of “The world was to me a secret which I desired to divine” (Chapter II, paragraph 1) shape its meaning? Consider a second, competing reading.

    Sample answer: "Divine" means to discover by intuition and also suggests godlike power.

24. [mc · recall · DOK 1] Which author first fascinates Victor?

    A. Shakespeare

    B. Cornelius Agrippa

    C. Isaac Newton

    D. Homer

    Key: B (Cornelius Agrippa)

25. [short · inference · DOK 2] What can you infer from this line? “My dear Victor, do not waste your time upon this; it is sad trash” (Chapter II, paragraph 7) Answer in two or three sentences with one detail.

    Sample answer: Dismissal without explanation; Victor later blames this.

26. [short · synthesis · DOK 4] Synthesis: trace how ambition and knowledge develops from an earlier chapter to “Chapter II”. Use one quotation from each.

    Sample answer: the desire to learn "the secrets of heaven and earth" begins as wonder and becomes obsession.

27. [mc · recall · DOK 1] What event introduces Victor to electricity?

    A. A storm at sea

    B. A fire in the house

    C. A shock from a machine

    D. Lightning destroying an oak tree

    Key: D (Lightning destroying an oak tree)

28. [mc · analysis · DOK 3] Which literary element does this describe in “Chapter II”? Victor repeatedly calls natural philosophy his "fate" and narrates with hindsight; the lightning-blasted oak predicts his ruin.

    A. Allusion

    B. Foreshadowing

    C. Imagery

    D. Simile

Key: B (Foreshadowing)

29. [short · synthesis · DOK 4] Evaluate this claim about the chapter: “Victor describes his obsession as fate, which lets him avoid blame for his choices.” Is it fully persuasive? Argue with evidence, including a passage that complicates it.
    Sample answer: Calling natural philosophy "the genius that has regulated my fate" makes science an outside force, and he blames his father's careless "sad trash" for not stopping him; readers can see a man explaining away his own will.
30. [fill · recall · DOK 1] Complete the quotation from Chapter II, paragraph 7: “Natural _____ is the genius that has regulated my fate”
    Key: philosophy

Rigor version	Items (in order)	Mix
Middle School	1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 6, 7, 8, 9, 10, 11, 12, 13, 14, 15, 16	recall 9, inference 4, analysis 2, synthesis 1
HS Freshman	1, 5, 17, 18, 19, 6, 8, 20, 13, 10, 21, 12, 15, 22, 14, 23	recall 8, inference 4, analysis 3, synthesis 1
HS Sophomore	2, 24, 18, 8, 19, 7, 25, 21, 13, 12, 11, 22, 15, 14, 23, 26	recall 6, inference 5, analysis 3, synthesis 2
HS Junior	1, 4, 6, 18, 27, 25, 13, 12, 11, 10, 28, 14, 22, 15, 29, 16	recall 5, inference 5, analysis 4, synthesis 2
HS Senior	9, 19, 30, 4, 12, 13, 11, 10, 21, 22, 14, 28, 15, 26, 23, 16	recall 4, inference 5, analysis 4, synthesis 3
AP	4, 19, 1, 21, 13, 11, 10, 12, 15, 22, 14, 28, 16, 26, 23, 29	recall 3, inference 5, analysis 4, synthesis 4
College Freshman	19, 4, 27, 25, 11, 12, 13, 21, 28, 15, 14, 22, 23, 26, 16, 29	recall 3, inference 5, analysis 4, synthesis 4
College Sophomore	4, 19, 12, 21, 25, 11, 13, 10, 28, 15, 22, 14, 16, 26, 23, 29	recall 2, inference 6, analysis 4, synthesis 4
College Junior	3, 17, 12, 13, 21, 11, 10, 25, 14, 28, 22, 15, 23, 16, 26, 29	recall 2, inference 6, analysis 4, synthesis 4
College Senior	19, 4, 11, 13, 10, 25, 21, 12, 28, 14, 15, 22, 29, 26, 23, 16	recall 2, inference 6, analysis 4, synthesis 4
Graduate / PhD	18, 19, 13, 11, 12, 10, 25, 21, 14, 28, 15, 22, 29, 23, 16, 26	recall 2, inference 6, analysis 4, synthesis 4

Writing prompts (eleven rigor levels)

Middle School (250 words; Indiana 2023: 7.RC.3, 7.W.1): Supported track (work from the passage your teacher selects). In “Chapter II,” how does Shelley show the first spark of obsession? Write a paragraph that states your claim, quotes two details from the passage, and explains how each detail supports your idea. Use the foreshadowing you noticed as one piece of evidence.

HS Freshman (350 words; Indiana 2023: 9-10.RC.3, 9-10.W.1): In Chapter II, how does Shelley develop the idea of the first spark of obsession? State a clear claim, support it with two or three quotations, and explain how the foreshadowing in the chapter helps build that idea.

HS Sophomore (450 words; Indiana 2023: 9-10.RC.3, 9-10.W.1): Analyze how Chapter II develops the idea of the first spark of obsession. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of foreshadowing and characterization shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.

HS Junior (550 words; Indiana 2023: 11-12.RC.3, 11-12.RC.1, 11-12.W.1): Analyze how the structure of Chapter II (where it begins, turns and ends) and its foreshadowing shape the reader's understanding of the first spark of obsession. Identify one place where the text leaves matters uncertain and explain how that uncertainty adds to its meaning.

HS Senior (600 words; Indiana 2023: 11-12.RC.3, 11-12.W.1): Two readers disagree about what Chapter II suggests about the first spark of obsession. Lay out two plausible interpretations, weigh the evidence for each (including the chapter's foreshadowing and characterization), and argue for the stronger one in a sustained, well-organized essay.

AP (650 words; Indiana 2023: 11-12.RC.3, 11-12.W.1): Write a literary argument in which you analyze how Mary Shelley uses foreshadowing in Chapter II to complicate the reader's understanding of the first spark of obsession. Develop a defensible thesis, select evidence purposefully, and explain how specific choices of diction and syntax create meaning.

College Freshman (1000 words; Indiana 2023: see unit standards): Situate Chapter II within its historical and literary context and argue how the chapter's treatment of the first spark of obsession responds to that context. Engage with at least one secondary perspective (a critic, historian or the author's own statements), integrate quotations smoothly, and cite in MLA style.

College Sophomore (1250 words; Indiana 2023: see unit standards): Read Chapter II alongside the conventions of its genre and period. Argue how the chapter's handling of the first spark of obsession follows or bends those conventions, using the foreshadowing as evidence, and test your reading against one published critic. Document two secondary sources in MLA.

College Junior (1500 words; Indiana 2023: see unit standards): Apply a named critical approach (for example formalist, historicist, feminist, psychoanalytic or ecocritical) to Chapter II and its treatment of the first spark of obsession. State your method, show what it reveals in the chapter's foreshadowing and characterization, and identify where the text resists it.

College Senior (2000 words; Indiana 2023: see unit standards): Develop a research argument that reads Chapter II as evidence for a larger claim about the first spark of obsession in Frankenstein. Connect close reading of the chapter to the whole novel, engage at least four scholarly sources, and state precisely where your reading departs from theirs (Chicago style).

Graduate / PhD (2500 words; Indiana 2023: see unit standards): Develop an original argument that reads Chapter II as a hinge in the novel's larger treatment of the first spark of obsession. Position your reading within a named critical conversation (for example formalist, historicist, psychoanalytic, feminist or postcolonial approaches), account for the textual history where relevant, and articulate the stakes of your intervention for scholarship on Frankenstein.

SAT-style questions

1. *It advanced from behind the mountains of Jura; and the thunder burst at once with frightful loudness from various quarters of the heavens.*

   As used in the text, what does the word "loudness" most nearly mean?

   A. immune to attack; impregnable
   B. the quality of being loud
   C. broken into sharp pieces
   D. a predisposition in favor of something

2. *The untaught peasant beheld the elements around him, and was acquainted with their practical uses. The most learned philosopher knew little more. He had partially unveiled the face of Nature, but her immortal lineaments were still a wonder and a mystery. He might dissect, anatomise, and give names; but, not to speak of a final cause, causes in their secondary and tertiary grades were utterly unknown to him. I had gazed upon the fortifications and impediments that seemed to keep human beings from entering the citadel of nature, and rashly and ignorantly I had repined.*

   Which choice best states a central concern of "Chapter II"?

   A. First experiences of the senses
   B. Delay and dread
   C. Isolation in the north
   D. The first spark of obsession

SAT key: 1. B (the quality of being loud); 2. D (The first spark of obsession)

Lesson 10: Chapter III

Focus: loss and leaving home

Objective: Students will analyze how foreshadowing develops in “Chapter III” by writing a claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph that cites at least 2 quotations from the section, and will score at least 80% on the section quiz.

Standards: CCSS RL.9-10.5, W.9-10.1, L.9-10.4 · IN 9-10.RC.3, 9-10.W.1, 9-10.RC.9, 9-10.RC.11

Teacher only · spoilers

Victor's mother dies of scarlet fever caught while nursing Elizabeth, and on her deathbed asks Victor and Elizabeth to marry. Victor leaves for the University of Ingolstadt, where M. Krempe scorns his alchemists and M. Waldman inspires him with modern chemistry.

Background: Ingolstadt (Bavaria) had a real university and was associated with the Illuminati, a secret society. Chemistry was rapidly changing in this era.

Significance: Grief and ambition merge; Waldman's speech about scientists who 'penetrate into the recesses of nature' ignites Victor's resolve.

Lesson plan and lecture script (90 minutes)

0–8 min · Bell-ringer · You do (8 min)
Students write to the bell-ringer, then pair-share.
How might his mother's death affect Victor's desire to conquer death? Write for five minutes. Starters: I think... because... / This connects to ambition and knowledge because....
Prompt: How might his mother's death affect Victor's desire to conquer death?
Sentence starters: I think… because… · This connects to ambition and knowledge because…
Strong response: A strong response takes a position and anticipates this: Waldman says modern scientists "penetrate into the recesses of nature"; Victor answers with a vow to go further.

8–18 min · Vocabulary with etymology notes · I do (10 min)
Five key words in context, with verified word histories.
Today's words: prepossess — to make someone feel favorably in advance; crucible — a heat-resistant container used for melting substances; residents — people who live in a place; fatiguing — tiring; chimeras — wild, impossible dreams or fantasies. “prepossess”: pre- "before" + possess: first "to occupy beforehand," later "to fill someone beforehand with a (favorable) feeling." “crucible”: From Latin crucibulum "night-lamp, metallurgic melting-pot", apparently a derivative of crux "cross", perhaps by analogy to thūribulum "censer" and suffix -bulum, or from crucio "to torment".
Words: prepossess: to make someone feel favorably in advance · crucible: a heat-resistant container used for melting substances · residents: people who live in a place · fatiguing: tiring · chimeras: wild, impossible dreams or fantasies

18–28 min · Background and context · I do (10 min)
Mini-lecture (read or adapt the script).
Ingolstadt (Bavaria) had a real university and was associated with the Illuminati, a secret society. Chemistry was rapidly changing in this era. Grief and ambition merge; Waldman's speech about scientists who 'penetrate into the recesses of nature' ignites Victor's resolve. Structure: The chapter turns on two losses: his mother's death and his departure for Ingolstadt. The mother's death is called "an omen." Characterization: Professors Krempe and Waldman pull him in opposite directions; Waldman's flattering vision of modern science wins him. Diction / vocabulary: The rhetoric of "pioneer," "unknown powers," "deepest mysteries of creation" shows Victor's ambition in his own voice. Watch for the mother's death: she dies nursing Elizabeth, an act of care; her loss leaves Victor to replace death with creation.

28–40 min · I do: modeled close reading · I do (12 min)
Model the close reading of the anchor quotation using the written think-aloud below.
I read the line once for meaning and once for craft. "the first misfortune of my life occurred" (Chapter III, paragraph 1). Narrated with hindsight; sets a pattern of suffering. That is structure at work: The chapter turns on two losses: his mother's death and his departure for Ingolstadt. The mother's death is called "an omen."

> *the first misfortune of my life occurred* (Chapter III, paragraph 1)

Think-aloud: I read the line once for meaning and once for craft. "the first misfortune of my life occurred" (Chapter III, paragraph 1). Narrated with hindsight; sets a pattern of suffering. That is structure at work: The chapter turns on two losses: his mother's death and his departure for Ingolstadt. The mother's death is called "an omen."

40–55 min · We do: guided annotation · We do (15 min)
Guided analysis of a second quotation; expected answers given.
Ask: What words in this line stand out, and what do they suggest? Expected: Repeating "more" shows escalating ambition; "pioneer" makes him a hero in his own story. This connects to ambition and the hunger to surpass every limit. Ask: How does this line connect to ambition and knowledge? Expected: Waldman says modern scientists "penetrate into the recesses of nature"; Victor answers with a vow to go further. (The heart of Victor's ambition: more than anyone before.)

> *more, far more, will I achieve* (Chapter III, paragraph 17)

Ask: What words in this line stand out, and what do they suggest?
Expected answer: Repeating "more" shows escalating ambition; "pioneer" makes him a hero in his own story. This connects to ambition and the hunger to surpass every limit.
Ask: How does this line connect to ambition and knowledge?
Expected answer: Waldman says modern scientists "penetrate into the recesses of nature"; Victor answers with a vow to go further. (The heart of Victor's ambition: more than anyone before.)

55–70 min · You do: independent annotation · You do (15 min)
Independent annotation and a claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph (exemplar given).
Annotate the chapter for structure, characterization (three marks with a margin note each), then write one claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph: what does this chapter suggest about loss and leaving home? Then start your writing prompt at your assigned level (HS Sophomore: Analyze how Chapter III develops the idea of loss and leaving home. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of foreshadowing and characterization shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.) Exemplar: Ingolstadt turns Victor's grief and curiosity into a vow to master life itself. When the text says “more, far more, will I achieve” (Chapter III, paragraph 17), it shows this directly. Right after his mother's death he hears Waldman praise modern science and vows "more, far more, will I achieve," showing ambition rushing to fill the space left by loss.
Task: Annotate the chapter for structure, characterization (three marks with a margin note each), then write one claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph: what does this chapter suggest about loss and leaving home? Then start your writing prompt at your assigned level (HS Sophomore: Analyze how Chapter III develops the idea of loss and leaving home. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of foreshadowing and characterization shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.)
Exemplar: Ingolstadt turns Victor's grief and curiosity into a vow to master life itself. When the text says “more, far more, will I achieve” (Chapter III, paragraph 17), it shows this directly. Right after his mother's death he hears Waldman praise modern science and vows "more, far more, will I achieve," showing ambition rushing to fill the space left by loss.

70–80 min · Discussion · We do (10 min)
Structured discussion from the 30 tiered questions, with facilitation notes.
Anchor question: How might his mother's death affect Victor's desire to conquer death? Some readers connect the mother's death with the decision to create life. Ask students whether the text supports that link.
Anchor question: How might his mother's death affect Victor's desire to conquer death?
Facilitation: Some readers connect the mother's death with the decision to create life. Ask students whether the text supports that link.

80–87 min · Exit ticket / chapter quiz · You do (7 min)
Chapter quiz in the app and an exit ticket (answer given).
Chapter quiz in the app, then: In one sentence, what does this chapter suggest about loss and leaving home? Support it with one short quotation. Model answer: Ingolstadt turns Victor's grief and curiosity into a vow to master life itself. (“more, far more, will I achieve”, Chapter III, paragraph 17). Accept any defensible claim backed by a quotation from the chapter; the answer key for the quiz is in the Quiz section.
Exit ticket: In one sentence, what does this chapter suggest about loss and leaving home? Support it with one short quotation.
Answer: Model answer: Ingolstadt turns Victor's grief and curiosity into a vow to master life itself. (“more, far more, will I achieve”, Chapter III, paragraph 17). Accept any defensible claim backed by a quotation from the chapter; the answer key for the quiz is in the Quiz section.

> **87–90 min · Closure · I do (3 min)**
> Summarize the lesson and preview the next reading.
> *Today we saw how structure shapes loss and leaving home. Key takeaway: Waldman says modern scientists "penetrate into the recesses of nature"; Victor answers with a vow to go further.*

Total: 90 minutes.

Teacher analysis (spoilers)

Literary elements

- **Structure:** The chapter turns on two losses: his mother's death and his departure for Ingolstadt. The mother's death is called "an omen."
- **Characterization:** Professors Krempe and Waldman pull him in opposite directions; Waldman's flattering vision of modern science wins him.
- **Diction / vocabulary:** The rhetoric of "pioneer," "unknown powers," "deepest mysteries of creation" shows Victor's ambition in his own voice.

Themes and how they develop

- **ambition and knowledge:** Waldman says modern scientists "penetrate into the recesses of nature"; Victor answers with a vow to go further.

Symbols and motifs

- **the mother's death:** she dies nursing Elizabeth, an act of care; her loss leaves Victor to replace death with creation.

Key quotations (checked against the reading text)

- “the first misfortune of my life occurred” (Chapter III, paragraph 1) Narrated with hindsight; sets a pattern of suffering.
- “promised impossibilities, and performed nothing” (Chapter III, paragraph 16) Waldman's contrast between old and modern science.
- “more, far more, will I achieve” (Chapter III, paragraph 17) The heart of Victor's ambition: more than anyone before.

Model claim-evidence-reasoning

> **Claim:** Ingolstadt turns Victor's grief and curiosity into a vow to master life itself.
> **Evidence:** “more, far more, will I achieve” (Chapter III, paragraph 17)
> **Reasoning:** Right after his mother's death he hears Waldman praise modern science and vows "more, far more, will I achieve," showing ambition rushing to fill the space left by loss.

Vocabulary with etymology notes

Word		In context	Word history

	Definition (in this sentence)		
prepossess (verb)	to make someone feel favorably in advance	*Krempe was a little squat man, with a gruff voice and a repulsive countenance; the teacher, therefore, did not prepossess me in favour of his pursuits.*	"prepossess": pre- "before" + possess: first "to occupy beforehand," later "to fill someone beforehand with a (favorable) feeling." (Online Etymology Dictionary, https://www.etymonline.com/word/prepossess)
crucible (noun)	a heat-resistant container used for melting substances	*But these philosophers, whose hands seem only made to dabble in dirt, and their eyes to pore over the microscope or crucible, have indeed performed miracles.*	"crucible": From Latin crucibulum "night-lamp, metallurgic melting-pot", apparently a derivative of crux "cross", perhaps by analogy to thūribulum "censer" and suffix -bulum, or from crucio "to torment". (Wiktionary, https://en.wiktionary.org/wiki/crucible#Etymology)
residents (noun)	people who live in a place	*Such were my reflections during the first two or three days of my residence at Ingolstadt, which were chiefly spent in becoming acquainted with the localities, and the principal residents in my new abode.*	
fatiguing (adjective)	tiring	*I had sufficient leisure for these and many other reflections during my journey to Ingolstadt, which was long and fatiguing.*	
chimeras (noun)	wild, impossible dreams or fantasies	*I was required to exchange chimeras of boundless grandeur for realities of little worth.*	
transmuted (verb)	changed into a different substance	*The modern masters promise very little; they know that metals cannot be transmuted, and that the elixir of life is a chimera.*	"transmuted": From Latin trānsmūtāre, from trans + mūtāre. (Wiktionary, https://en.wiktionary.org/wiki/transmute#Etymology)
panegyric (noun)	a speech or piece of writing full of praise	*After having made a few preparatory experiments, he concluded with a panegyric upon modern chemistry, the terms of which I shall never forget:—*	"panegyric": From French panégyrique, from Ancient Greek πανηγυρικός. (Wiktionary, https://en.wiktionary.org/wiki/panegyric#Etymology)

insurrection (noun)	organized opposition to authority; a conflict in which one faction tries to wrest control from another	*My internal being was in a state of insurrection and turmoil; I felt that order would thence arise, but I had no power to produce it.*	
commences (verb)	take the first step or steps in carrying out an action	*These are the reflections of the first days; but when the lapse of time proves the reality of the evil, then the actual bitterness of grief commences.*	“commences”: From Middle English commencen, comencen (also as contracted comsen, cumsen), from Anglo-Norman comencer, from Vulgar Latin *cominitiāre, formed from Latin com- + initiō (whence English initiate). (Wiktionary, https://en.wiktionary.org/wiki/commence#Etymology)
imbibed (verb)	take in, also metaphorically	*Good God! in what desert land have you lived, where no one was kind enough to inform you that these fancies, which you have so greedily imbibed, are a thousand years old, and as musty as they are ancient?*	

Discussion questions

1. How might his mother's death affect Victor's desire to conquer death?
2. Where does foreshadowing appear in this chapter, and what effect does it have? Point to one passage.
3. How does this chapter connect to the book's larger concern with nature versus nurture?

Classroom discussion questions (30, tiered)

Wait time after every question (3 s for DOK 1, 5 s for DOK 2, 8 to 10 s for DOK 3 and 4); think-pair-share on DOK 3 and 4; answer each response with a follow-up probe; close with student-generated questions. Focus sets by rigor level: Middle School: 1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 6, 11, 12, 13, 14, 21, 22; HS Freshman: 1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 12, 13, 14, 15, 22, 23, 24; HS Sophomore: 1, 2, 3, 4, 13, 14, 15, 16, 17, 23, 24, 25; HS Junior: 1, 2, 3, 14, 15, 16, 17, 18, 24, 25, 26, 27; HS Senior: 1, 2, 3, 15, 16, 17, 18, 25, 26, 27, 28, 29; AP: 1, 2, 16, 17, 18, 19, 20, 26, 27, 28, 29, 30; College Freshman: 1, 2, 17, 18, 19, 20, 21, 22, 27, 28, 29, 30; College Sophomore: 1, 2, 11, 18, 19, 20, 21, 22, 23, 28, 29, 30; College Junior: 1, 11, 12, 19, 20, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 29, 30; College Senior: 1, 11, 12, 13, 20, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 26, 30; Graduate / PhD: 1, 11, 12, 13, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 26, 27, 28

Literal / recall

1. How does Victor's mother die? [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · 7.RC.1, 7.CC.1, 9-10.RC.1] Look for: Scarlet fever caught nursing Elizabeth
2. What is her dying wish? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · 7.RC.1, 7.CC.1, 9-10.RC.1] Look for: That Victor and Elizabeth marry
3. Where does Victor go to university? [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · 7.RC.1, 7.CC.1, 9-10.RC.1] Look for: Ingolstadt
4. Which professor inspires Victor? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · 7.RC.1, 7.CC.1, 9-10.RC.1] Look for: M. Waldman

5. How does M. Krempe react to Victor's reading? [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · 7.RC.1, 7.CC.1, 9-10.RC.1] Look for: He scorns it as outdated nonsense
6. Retell the three most important events of "Chapter III" in order, in one sentence each. [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · 7.RC.1, 7.CC.1, 9-10.RC.1] Look for: Victor's mother dies of scarlet fever caught while nursing Elizabeth, and on her deathbed asks Victor and Elizabeth to marry. Victor leaves for the University of Ingolstadt, where M. Krempe scorns his alchemists and M. Waldman inspires him with modern chemistry.
7. Which characters appear or are mentioned in "Chapter III"? Name two and one thing each says or does. [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · 7.RC.1, 7.CC.1, 9-10.RC.1] Look for: Names and actions taken from the chapter; check against the teacher summary.
8. Where and when does "Chapter III" take place? Point to the line that tells you. [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · 7.RC.1, 7.CC.1, 9-10.RC.1] Look for: A place/time detail quoted from the chapter.
9. Reread: "Krempe was a little squat man, with a gruff voice and a repulsive countenance; the teacher, therefore, did not prepossess me in favour of his pursuits." What does "prepossess" mean here, and what is literally happening in this line? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · 7.RC.1, 7.CC.1, 9-10.RC.1] Look for: prepossess: to make someone feel favorably in advance.
10. Reread: "But these philosophers, whose hands seem only made to dabble in dirt, and their eyes to pore over the microscope or crucible, have indeed performed miracles." What does "crucible" mean here, and what is literally happening in this line? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · 7.RC.1, 7.CC.1, 9-10.RC.1] Look for: crucible: a heat-resistant container used for melting substances.

Inferential / analytical

1. What does "Chapter III" suggest about loss and leaving home? State the inference and the line that supports it. [DOK 2 · thinkPairShare · wait 5 s · 7.RC.2, 7.CC.2, 9-10.RC.2] Look for: Grief and ambition merge; Waldman's speech about scientists who 'penetrate into the recesses of nature' ignites Victor's resolve.
2. Find one example of foreshadowing in this chapter. What does it reveal that a plain statement would not? [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · 7.RC.3, 7.CC.2, 9-10.RC.3] Look for: Look for hints, warnings or images that point to later events.
3. How does the characterization in this chapter shape what we understand about loss and leaving home? [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · 7.RC.3, 7.CC.2, 9-10.RC.1] Look for: Look for what characters say, do and think, and how others react to them.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Ingolstadt turns Victor's grief and curiosity into a vow to master life itself. Useful evidence: "the first misfortune of my life occurred" (Chapter III, paragraph 1): Narrated with hindsight; sets a pattern of suffering. On characterization: Professors Krempe and Waldman pull him in opposite directions; Waldman's flattering vision of modern science wins him. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
4. In the passage that begins "I had sufficient leisure for these and many other reflections during my journey to Ingolstadt, which was long and fatiguing.", why might Shelley have chosen these particular words? Pick two and explain their connotations. [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · 7.RC.12, 7.CC.2, 9-10.RC.12] Look for: Diction analysis of two words in the anchor passage.
5. What causes the main turn in "Chapter III", and what effect is it likely to have on what follows? [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · 7.RC.3, 7.CC.2, 9-10.RC.1] Look for: Victor's mother dies of scarlet fever caught while nursing

Elizabeth, and on her deathbed asks Victor and Elizabeth to marry. Victor leaves for the University of Ingolstadt, where M. Krempe scorns his alchemists and M. Waldman inspires him with modern chemistry.

6. How does “Chapter III” build on “Chapter II”? Name one link of cause and effect. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · 7.RC.3, 7.CC.2, 9-10.RC.3] Look for: A causal or structural link between this and the previous chapter.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Ingolstadt turns Victor's grief and curiosity into a vow to master life itself. Useful evidence: “promised impossibilities, and performed nothing” (Chapter III, paragraph 16): Waldman's contrast between old and modern science. On structure: The chapter turns on two losses: his mother's death and his departure for Ingolstadt. The mother's death is called "an omen." Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
7. What can we infer about a character's motives from what they say and do here, as opposed to what they claim? [DOK 3 · followUp · wait 8 s · 7.RC.3, 7.CC.2, 9-10.RC.1] Look for: An inference about motive supported by a quoted line.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Ingolstadt turns Victor's grief and curiosity into a vow to master life itself. Useful evidence: “more, far more, will I achieve” (Chapter III, paragraph 17): The heart of Victor's ambition: more than anyone before. On characterization: Professors Krempe and Waldman pull him in opposite directions; Waldman's flattering vision of modern science wins him. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
8. The bell-ringer asked: “How might his mother's death affect Victor's desire to conquer death?” Now that we have read closely, how would you revise your first answer, and which line changed your mind? [DOK 2 · thinkPairShare · wait 5 s · 7.RC.2, 7.CC.2, 9-10.RC.2] Look for: A revised answer anchored in the text.
9. Where does tone / mood appear, and how does it connect this chapter to the larger concern with nature versus nurture? [DOK 3 · followUp · wait 8 s · 7.RC.12, 7.CC.2, 9-10.RC.12] Look for: Look for word choices that reveal the narrator's attitude or the scene's feeling.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Ingolstadt turns Victor's grief and curiosity into a vow to master life itself. Useful evidence: “the first misfortune of my life occurred” (Chapter III, paragraph 1): Narrated with hindsight; sets a pattern of suffering. Theme link: Waldman says modern scientists "penetrate into the recesses of nature"; Victor answers with a vow to go further. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
10. Background: Ingolstadt (Bavaria) had a real university and was associated with the Illuminati, a secret society. Chemistry was rapidly changing in this era. How does knowing this change the way you read one moment in the chapter? [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · 7.RC.3, 7.CC.2, 9-10.RC.1] Look for: A specific moment reread in light of the context.
    Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Ingolstadt turns Victor's grief and curiosity into a vow to master life itself. Useful evidence: “promised impossibilities, and performed nothing” (Chapter III, paragraph 16): Waldman's contrast between old and modern science. Theme link: Waldman says modern scientists "penetrate into the recesses of nature"; Victor answers with a vow to go further. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

Evaluative / synthesis / creative

1. A critic might argue: “Grief and ambition merge; Waldman's speech about scientists who 'penetrate into the recesses of nature' ignites Victor's resolve.” How far do you agree? Take a stand and defend it with two lines from the chapter. [DOK 3 · fourCorners · wait 8 s · 7.RC.2, 7.CC.3, 9-10.RC.2] Look for: A defended position with evidence and one counterpoint.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Ingolstadt turns Victor's grief and curiosity into a vow to master life itself. Useful evidence: “more, far more, will I achieve” (Chapter III, paragraph 17): The heart of Victor's ambition: more than anyone before. Theme link: Waldman says modern scientists "penetrate into the recesses of nature"; Victor answers with a vow to go further. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
2. Which character in this chapter acts most wisely, and which least? Judge them by a standard you name. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · 7.RC.3, 7.CC.3, 9-10.RC.1] Look for: An evaluation using an explicit criterion and evidence.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Ingolstadt turns Victor's grief and curiosity into a vow to master life itself. Useful evidence: “the first misfortune of my life occurred” (Chapter III, paragraph 1): Narrated with hindsight; sets a pattern of suffering. On characterization: Professors Krempe and Waldman pull him in opposite directions; Waldman's flattering vision of modern science wins him. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
3. Rewrite one moment of “Chapter III” from the point of view of a different character. What does the new angle reveal or hide about loss and leaving home? [DOK 4 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · 7.RC.1, 7.CC.3, 9-10.RC.1] Look for: A creative product with a rationale tied to the text.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Ingolstadt turns Victor's grief and curiosity into a vow to master life itself. Useful evidence: “promised impossibilities, and performed nothing” (Chapter III, paragraph 16): Waldman's contrast between old and modern science. Theme link: Waldman says modern scientists "penetrate into the recesses of nature"; Victor answers with a vow to go further. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
4. Write three questions of your own about “Chapter III”: one recall, one “why/how”, and one “should/what if”. Trade with a partner and answer theirs. [DOK 3 · studentGenerated · wait 8 s · 7.RC.2, 7.CC.3, 9-10.RC.2] Look for: Student-generated questions at three levels.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Ingolstadt turns Victor's grief and curiosity into a vow to master life itself. Useful evidence: “more, far more, will I achieve” (Chapter III, paragraph 17): The heart of Victor's ambition: more than anyone before. Theme link: Waldman says modern scientists "penetrate into the recesses of nature"; Victor answers with a vow to go further. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
5. Connect this chapter to the sublime power of nature: is the link strong or weak so far? What would Shelley need to show next to strengthen it? [DOK 4 · socraticCircle · wait 8 s · 7.RC.2, 7.CC.3, 9-10.RC.2] Look for: A judgment of thematic development across the work.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Ingolstadt turns Victor's grief and curiosity into a vow to master life itself. Useful evidence: “the first misfortune of my life occurred” (Chapter III, paragraph 1): Narrated with hindsight; sets a pattern of suffering. Theme link: Waldman says modern scientists

"penetrate into the recesses of nature"; Victor answers with a vow to go further. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

6. Is the foreshadowing in this chapter effective, or does it feel heavy-handed? Evaluate it as a reader would in a review. [DOK 3 · fourCorners · wait 8 s · 7.RC.3, 7.CC.3, 9-10.RC.3] Look for: An evaluative judgment with criteria and evidence.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Ingolstadt turns Victor's grief and curiosity into a vow to master life itself. Useful evidence: “promised impossibilities, and performed nothing” (Chapter III, paragraph 16): Waldman's contrast between old and modern science. Theme link: Waldman says modern scientists "penetrate into the recesses of nature"; Victor answers with a vow to go further. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

7. Compare how “Chapter III” treats loss and leaving home with how another text, film or event you know treats a similar idea. What does Frankenstein see that the other misses? [DOK 4 · socraticCircle · wait 8 s · 7.RC.2, 7.CC.3, 9-10.RC.2] Look for: A cross-text synthesis.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Ingolstadt turns Victor's grief and curiosity into a vow to master life itself. Useful evidence: “more, far more, will I achieve” (Chapter III, paragraph 17): The heart of Victor's ambition: more than anyone before. Theme link: Waldman says modern scientists "penetrate into the recesses of nature"; Victor answers with a vow to go further. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

8. Predict what “Chapter IV” will bring, using two clues from this chapter. After reading, evaluate your prediction. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · 7.RC.3, 7.CC.3, 9-10.RC.3] Look for: A prediction or judgment justified with textual clues.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Ingolstadt turns Victor's grief and curiosity into a vow to master life itself. Useful evidence: “the first misfortune of my life occurred” (Chapter III, paragraph 1): Narrated with hindsight; sets a pattern of suffering. Theme link: Waldman says modern scientists "penetrate into the recesses of nature"; Victor answers with a vow to go further. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

9. Design a one-paragraph modern adaptation of this chapter (setting, characters, conflict). What must stay the same for it to still be about loss and leaving home? [DOK 4 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · 7.RC.2, 7.CC.3, 9-10.RC.2] Look for: A creative transfer that keeps the core idea.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Ingolstadt turns Victor's grief and curiosity into a vow to master life itself. Useful evidence: “promised impossibilities, and performed nothing” (Chapter III, paragraph 16): Waldman's contrast between old and modern science. Theme link: Waldman says modern scientists "penetrate into the recesses of nature"; Victor answers with a vow to go further. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

10. What question would you most like to ask Mary Shelley about this chapter, and what answer do you think the text itself gives? [DOK 4 · studentGenerated · wait 8 s · 7.RC.2, 7.CC.3, 9-10.RC.2] Look for: A student-generated question answered from evidence.

    Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Ingolstadt turns Victor's grief and curiosity into a vow to master life itself. Useful evidence: “more, far more, will I achieve” (Chapter III, paragraph 17): The heart of Victor's ambition: more than anyone before. Theme link: Waldman says modern scientists "penetrate

into the recesses of nature"; Victor answers with a vow to go further. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

Annotation focus

- **Foreshadowing:** look for hints, warnings or images that point to later events (anchor passage in the We do segment)
- Also notice **Characterization**: what characters say, do and think, and how others react to them
- Also notice **Tone / mood**: word choices that reveal the narrator's attitude or the scene's feeling

Chapter quiz: item bank (all eleven rigor versions)

1. [mc · recall · DOK 1] In the line “I had sufficient leisure for these and many other reflections during my journey to Ingolstadt, which was long and fatiguing.”, what does “fatiguing” most nearly mean?

   A. make one's home in a particular place or community

   B. dutifully complying with the commands or instructions of those in authority

   C. in a kind, well-meaning way

   D. tiring

   Key: D (tiring)

2. [mc · recall · DOK 1] What is her dying wish?

   A. That Victor stay home

   B. That Victor become a priest

   C. That the family move

   D. That Victor and Elizabeth marry

   Key: D (That Victor and Elizabeth marry)

3. [fill · recall · DOK 1] Fill in the blank with the vocabulary word that fits: “My internal being was in a state of _____ and turmoil; I felt that order would thence arise, but I had no power to produce it.” Word bank: residents, insurrection, crucible, prepossess

   Key: insurrection

4. [mc · recall · DOK 1] How does M. Krempe react to Victor's reading?

   A. He praises it

   B. He gives Victor more alchemy books

   C. He scorns it as outdated nonsense

   D. He expels Victor

   Key: C (He scorns it as outdated nonsense)

5. [mc · recall · DOK 1] Where does Victor go to university?

   A. Paris

   B. Geneva

   C. Oxford

   D. Ingolstadt

   Key: D (Ingolstadt)

6. [mc · recall · DOK 1] In the line “Krempe was a little squat man, with a gruff voice and a repulsive countenance; the teacher, therefore, did not prepossess me in favour of his pursuits.”, what does “prepossess” most nearly mean?

   A. inhabit or live in; be an inhabitant of

   B. to make someone feel favorably in advance

   C. spoils; makes impure

   D. struck again and again

   Key: B (to make someone feel favorably in advance)

7. [fill · recall · DOK 1] Complete the quotation from Chapter III, paragraph 17: “more, far more, will I _____”

   Key: achieve

8. [mc · recall · DOK 1] How does Victor's mother die?

   A. Old age

   B. A carriage accident

   C. Scarlet fever caught nursing Elizabeth

   D. Drowning

   Key: C (Scarlet fever caught nursing Elizabeth)

9. [fill · recall · DOK 1] Fill in the blank with the vocabulary word that fits: “The modern masters promise very little; they know that metals cannot be _____, and that the elixir of life is a chimera.” Word bank: transmuted, crucible, residents, prepossess

   Key: transmuted

10. [mc · inference · DOK 2] Which choice best states a central concern of “Chapter III”?

    A. Loss and leaving home

    B. The author's stated purpose

    C. Obsession and the discovery of life

    D. A letter, a secret and the wedding

    Key: A (Loss and leaving home)

11. [mc · inference · DOK 2] What does this passage most clearly show? “the first misfortune of my life occurred” (Chapter III, paragraph 1)

    A. Narrated with hindsight; sets a pattern of suffering.

    B. The key threat; Victor assumes it targets himself.

    C. Guilt imagined as hell.

    D. Political education; links to Godwin.

    Key: A (Narrated with hindsight; sets a pattern of suffering.)

12. [short · inference · DOK 2] What can you infer from this line? “promised impossibilities, and performed nothing” (Chapter III, paragraph 16) Answer in two or three sentences with one detail.

    Sample answer: Waldman's contrast between old and modern science.

13. [short · inference · DOK 2] What can you infer from this line? “the first misfortune of my life occurred” (Chapter III, paragraph 1) Answer in two or three sentences with one detail.

    Sample answer: Narrated with hindsight; sets a pattern of suffering.

14. [short · analysis · DOK 3] Analyze the word choice in “more, far more, will I achieve” (Chapter III, paragraph 17). Pick two words and explain what they suggest.
    Sample answer: The heart of Victor's ambition: more than anyone before.
15. [short · analysis · DOK 3] Claim: Ingolstadt turns Victor's grief and curiosity into a vow to master life itself. Explain how this evidence supports the claim: “more, far more, will I achieve” (Chapter III, paragraph 17).
    Sample answer: Right after his mother's death he hears Waldman praise modern science and vows "more, far more, will I achieve," showing ambition rushing to fill the space left by loss.
16. [short · synthesis · DOK 4] Close reading: how do the diction and syntax of “promised impossibilities, and performed nothing” (Chapter III, paragraph 16) shape its meaning? Consider a second, competing reading.
    Sample answer: Waldman's contrast between old and modern science.
17. [fill · recall · DOK 1] Fill in the blank with the vocabulary word that fits: “After having made a few preparatory experiments, he concluded with a _____ upon modern chemistry, the terms of which I shall never forget: —” Word bank: panegyric, prepossess, crucible, residents
    Key: panegyric
18. [mc · recall · DOK 1] Which professor inspires Victor?
    A. Dr. Darwin
    B. M. Krempe
    C. M. Clerval
    D. M. Waldman

    Key: D (M. Waldman)
19. [mc · analysis · DOK 3] Which literary element does this describe in “Chapter III”? Professors Krempe and Waldman pull him in opposite directions; Waldman's flattering vision of modern science wins him.
    A. Characterization
    B. Metaphor
    C. Personification
    D. Conflict

    Key: A (Characterization)
20. [mc · analysis · DOK 3] Which literary element does this describe in “Chapter III”? The chapter turns on two losses: his mother's death and his departure for Ingolstadt. The mother's death is called "an omen."
    A. Structure
    B. Personification
    C. Imagery
    D. Setting

    Key: A (Structure)
21. [short · synthesis · DOK 4] Synthesis: trace how ambition and knowledge develops from an earlier chapter to “Chapter III”. Use one quotation from each.
    Sample answer: Waldman says modern scientists "penetrate into the recesses of nature"; Victor answers with a vow to go further.
22. [fill · recall · DOK 1] Complete the quotation from Chapter III, paragraph 1: “the first _____ of my life occurred”
    Key: misfortune

23. [mc · inference · DOK 2] What does this passage most clearly show? “more, far more, will I achieve” (Chapter III, paragraph 17)

    A. Echoes the "lifeless matter" of creation.

    B. Atmospheric recognition scene; the creature as shadow and double.

    C. Pathetic fallacy and anticlimax: "accomplishment" is followed by horror.

    D. The heart of Victor's ambition: more than anyone before.

    Key: D (The heart of Victor's ambition: more than anyone before.)

24. [mc · inference · DOK 2] What does this passage most clearly show? “promised impossibilities, and performed nothing” (Chapter III, paragraph 16)

    A. Guilt imagined as hell.

    B. Anguish and accusation.

    C. Waldman's contrast between old and modern science.

    D. Victor's lesson; partly retracted.

    Key: C (Waldman's contrast between old and modern science.)

25. [short · synthesis · DOK 4] Evaluate this claim about the chapter: “Ingolstadt turns Victor's grief and curiosity into a vow to master life itself.” Is it fully persuasive? Argue with evidence, including a passage that complicates it.

    Sample answer: Right after his mother's death he hears Waldman praise modern science and vows "more, far more, will I achieve," showing ambition rushing to fill the space left by loss.

26. [fill · recall · DOK 1] Fill in the blank with the vocabulary word that fits: “I was required to exchange _____ of boundless grandeur for realities of little worth.” Word bank: residents, crucible, chimeras, prepossess

    Key: chimeras

27. [mc · recall · DOK 1] In the line “Such were my reflections during the first two or three days of my residence at Ingolstadt, which were chiefly spent in becoming acquainted with the localities, and the principal residents in my new abode.”, what does “residents” most nearly mean?

    A. the manner in which someone utters a word

    B. people who live in a place

    C. cursing; expressions of hatred

    D. drifting on water

    Key: B (people who live in a place)

28. [short · synthesis · DOK 4] Close reading: how do the diction and syntax of “the first misfortune of my life occurred” (Chapter III, paragraph 1) shape its meaning? Consider a second, competing reading.

    Sample answer: Narrated with hindsight; sets a pattern of suffering.

29. [mc · recall · DOK 1] In the line “But these philosophers, whose hands seem only made to dabble in dirt, and their eyes to pore over the microscope or crucible, have indeed performed miracles.”, what does “crucible” most nearly mean?

    A. a heat-resistant container used for melting substances

    B. tiring

    C. people who live in a place

    D. to make someone feel favorably in advance

Key: A (a heat-resistant container used for melting substances)

Rigor version	Items (in order)	Mix
Middle School	1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 6, 7, 8, 9, 10, 11, 12, 13, 14, 15, 16	recall 9, inference 4, analysis 2, synthesis 1
HS Freshman	17, 5, 8, 1, 9, 4, 7, 18, 12, 13, 11, 10, 19, 15, 20, 21	recall 8, inference 4, analysis 3, synthesis 1
HS Sophomore	3, 22, 1, 18, 2, 9, 23, 12, 24, 11, 10, 15, 20, 19, 21, 25	recall 6, inference 5, analysis 3, synthesis 2
HS Junior	9, 26, 8, 27, 4, 10, 23, 11, 13, 12, 15, 19, 20, 14, 28, 16	recall 5, inference 5, analysis 4, synthesis 2
HS Senior	26, 9, 27, 5, 10, 24, 11, 23, 12, 20, 15, 14, 19, 28, 21, 25	recall 4, inference 5, analysis 4, synthesis 3
AP	22, 3, 29, 12, 23, 24, 11, 13, 20, 15, 19, 14, 16, 28, 21, 25	recall 3, inference 5, analysis 4, synthesis 4
College Freshman	8, 7, 26, 10, 11, 24, 23, 13, 15, 20, 19, 14, 16, 25, 28, 21	recall 3, inference 5, analysis 4, synthesis 4
College Sophomore	26, 22, 13, 24, 12, 23, 10, 11, 15, 14, 20, 19, 16, 21, 28, 25	recall 2, inference 6, analysis 4, synthesis 4
College Junior	22, 26, 12, 24, 11, 13, 10, 23, 19, 14, 15, 20, 16, 28, 25, 21	recall 2, inference 6, analysis 4, synthesis 4
College Senior	17, 26, 13, 12, 23, 10, 11, 24, 19, 20, 14, 15, 16, 21, 25, 28	recall 2, inference 6, analysis 4, synthesis 4
Graduate / PhD	26, 22, 11, 24, 13, 12, 10, 23, 14, 19, 20, 15, 16, 21, 25, 28	recall 2, inference 6, analysis 4, synthesis 4

Writing prompts (eleven rigor levels)

Middle School (250 words; Indiana 2023: 7.RC.3, 7.W.1): Supported track (work from the passage your teacher selects). In “Chapter III,” how does Shelley show loss and leaving home? Write a paragraph that states your claim, quotes two details from the passage, and explains how each detail supports your idea. Use the foreshadowing you noticed as one piece of evidence.

HS Freshman (350 words; Indiana 2023: 9-10.RC.3, 9-10.W.1): In Chapter III, how does Shelley develop the idea of loss and leaving home? State a clear claim, support it with two or three quotations, and explain how the foreshadowing in the chapter helps build that idea.

HS Sophomore (450 words; Indiana 2023: 9-10.RC.3, 9-10.W.1): Analyze how Chapter III develops the idea of loss and leaving home. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of foreshadowing and characterization shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.

HS Junior (550 words; Indiana 2023: 11-12.RC.3, 11-12.RC.1, 11-12.W.1): Analyze how the structure of Chapter III (where it begins, turns and ends) and its foreshadowing shape the reader's understanding of loss and leaving home. Identify one place where the text leaves matters uncertain and explain how that uncertainty adds to its meaning.

HS Senior (600 words; Indiana 2023: 11-12.RC.3, 11-12.W.1): Two readers disagree about what Chapter III suggests about loss and leaving home. Lay out two plausible interpretations, weigh the evidence for each (including the chapter's foreshadowing and characterization), and argue for the stronger one in a sustained, well-organized essay.

AP (650 words; Indiana 2023: 11-12.RC.3, 11-12.W.1): Write a literary argument in which you analyze how Mary Shelley uses foreshadowing in Chapter III to complicate the reader's understanding of loss and leaving home. Develop a defensible thesis, select evidence purposefully, and explain how specific choices of diction and syntax create meaning.

College Freshman (1000 words; Indiana 2023: see unit standards): Situate Chapter III within its historical and literary context and argue how the chapter's treatment of loss and leaving home responds to that context. Engage with at least one secondary perspective (a critic, historian or the author's own statements), integrate quotations smoothly, and cite in MLA style.

College Sophomore (1250 words; Indiana 2023: see unit standards): Read Chapter III alongside the conventions of its genre and period. Argue how the chapter's handling of loss and leaving home follows or bends those conventions, using the foreshadowing as evidence, and test your reading against one published critic. Document two secondary sources in MLA.

College Junior (1500 words; Indiana 2023: see unit standards): Apply a named critical approach (for example formalist, historicist, feminist, psychoanalytic or ecocritical) to Chapter III and its treatment of loss and leaving home. State your method, show what it reveals in the chapter's foreshadowing and characterization, and identify where the text resists it.

College Senior (2000 words; Indiana 2023: see unit standards): Develop a research argument that reads Chapter III as evidence for a larger claim about loss and leaving home in Frankenstein. Connect close reading of the chapter to the whole novel, engage at least four scholarly sources, and state precisely where your reading departs from theirs (Chicago style).

Graduate / PhD (2500 words; Indiana 2023: see unit standards): Develop an original argument that reads Chapter III as a hinge in the novel's larger treatment of loss and leaving home. Position your reading within a named critical conversation (for example formalist, historicist, psychoanalytic, feminist or postcolonial approaches), account for the textual history where relevant, and articulate the stakes of your intervention for scholarship on Frankenstein.

SAT-style questions

1. *Such were my reflections during the first two or three days of my residence at Ingolstadt, which were chiefly spent in becoming acquainted with the localities, and the principal residents in my new abode.*

As used in the text, what does the word "residents" most nearly mean?

A. organized opposition to authority; a conflict in which one faction tries to wrest control from another

B. people who live in a place

C. take in, also metaphorically

D. take the first step or steps in carrying out an action

2. *I had sufficient leisure for these and many other reflections during my journey to Ingolstadt, which was long and fatiguing. At length the high white steeple of the town met my eyes. I alighted, and was conducted to my solitary apartment, to spend the evening as I pleased.*

Which choice best states a central concern of "Chapter III"?

A. The first death and growing guilt

B. Loneliness and the desire for a friend

C. Loss and leaving home

D. Language, knowledge and sorrow

SAT key: 1. B (people who live in a place); 2. C (Loss and leaving home)

Lesson 11: Chapter IV

Focus: obsession and the discovery of life

Objective: Students will analyze how foreshadowing develops in “Chapter IV” by writing a claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph that cites at least 2 quotations from the section, and will score at least 80% on the section quiz.

Standards: CCSS RL.9-10.5, W.9-10.1, L.9-10.4 · IN 9-10.RC.3, 9-10.W.1, 9-10.RC.9, 9-10.RC.11

Content note (grave-robbing, dissection): Victor describes collecting body parts from charnel-houses and dissecting rooms. Keep the focus on ambition and ethics, not gore.
Student preview: This chapter describes Victor gathering materials from graves and dissecting rooms.
Suggested language: “What lines does Victor cross here, and does he notice them?”

Teacher only · spoilers

Victor works tirelessly, masters chemistry, and discovers the cause of life. Gathering materials from charnel houses and dissecting rooms, he neglects family and health for nearly two years as he builds a being of gigantic stature.

Background: Body-snatching to supply anatomy schools was a real scandal of the era. 'Natural philosophy' was the period term for science.

Significance: Victor withholds the secret from Walton, warning 'how dangerous is the acquirement of knowledge'—the novel's core moral caution.

Lesson plan and lecture script (90 minutes)

0–8 min · Bell-ringer · You do (8 min)
Students write to the bell-ringer, then pair-share.
Victor refuses to tell Walton how he created life. Why is this choice important? Write for five minutes. Starters: I think... because... / This connects to ambition and knowledge because.... Content note before we start: This chapter describes Victor gathering materials from graves and dissecting rooms.
Prompt: Victor refuses to tell Walton how he created life. Why is this choice important?
Sentence starters: I think… because… · This connects to ambition and knowledge because…
Strong response: A strong response takes a position and anticipates this: Victor fantasizes that "a new species would bless me as its creator," revealing the wish to be worshipped.

8–18 min · Vocabulary with etymology notes · I do (10 min)
Five key words in context, with verified word histories.
Today's words: procrastinate — to put off doing something; slaughterhouse — a building where animals are killed for meat; dissecting — used for cutting up bodies to study them; dabbled — dip a foot or hand briefly into a liquid; charnel — a vault or building where corpses or bones are deposited. “slaughterhouse”: From slaughter + house. “dissecting”: Latin dissectus past participle of dissecare "to cut asunder, cut up", from dis- "asunder" + secare "to cut"; see section.
Words: procrastinate: to put off doing something · slaughterhouse: a building where animals are killed for meat · dissecting: used for cutting up bodies to study them · dabbled: dip a foot or hand briefly into a liquid · charnel: a vault or building where corpses or bones are deposited

18–28 min · Background and context · I do (10 min)
Mini-lecture (read or adapt the script).
Body-snatching to supply anatomy schools was a real scandal of the era. 'Natural philosophy' was the period term for science. Victor withholds the secret from Walton, warning 'how dangerous is the acquirement of knowledge'—the novel's core moral caution. Point of view: Victor interrupts his story to address Walton directly: "Learn from me." The older Victor judges the younger. Imagery: Charnel-houses, dissecting rooms, pale cheeks: the work is described as unhealthy and secret. Structure: Two years compressed into one chapter; seasons pass unnoticed, showing how obsession erases ordinary life. Watch for light and fire: Light stands for knowledge and fire for its double edge: warmth and burning. Victor seeks the "light" of discovery; the creature discovers fire and is burned by it. In this chapter: “ardent and eager, that the stars often disappeared in the light of morning whilst I was yet engaged in my laboratory” (Chapter IV, paragraph 1).

28–40 min · I do: modeled close reading · I do (12 min)
Model the close reading of the anchor quotation using the written think-aloud below.
I read the line once for meaning and once for craft. “Learn from me, if not by my precepts, at least by my example, how dangerous is the acquirement of knowledge” (Chapter IV, paragraph 6). The novel's warning stated outright. That is point of view at work: Victor interrupts his story to address Walton directly: "Learn from me." The older Victor judges the younger.

> *Learn from me, if not by my precepts, at least by my example, how dangerous is the acquirement of knowledge (Chapter IV, paragraph 6)*

Think-aloud: I read the line once for meaning and once for craft. “Learn from me, if not by my precepts, at least by my example, how dangerous is the acquirement of knowledge” (Chapter IV, paragraph 6). The novel's warning stated outright. That is point of view at work: Victor interrupts his story to address Walton directly: "Learn from me." The older Victor judges the younger.

40–55 min · We do: guided annotation · We do (15 min)
Guided analysis of a second quotation; expected answers given.
Ask: What words in this line stand out, and what do they suggest? Expected: "Bless me" shows he wants gratitude and worship. "Creator and source" are words for God. This connects to ambition: he wants to play God without God's responsibility. Ask: How does this line connect to ambition and knowledge? Expected: Victor fantasizes that "a new species would bless me as its creator," revealing the wish to be worshipped. (Desire for glory, not care; evidence of selfish motives.)

> *A new species would bless me as its creator and source (Chapter IV, paragraph 8)*

Ask: What words in this line stand out, and what do they suggest?
Expected answer: "Bless me" shows he wants gratitude and worship. "Creator and source" are words for God. This connects to ambition: he wants to play God without God's responsibility.
Ask: How does this line connect to ambition and knowledge?
Expected answer: Victor fantasizes that "a new species would bless me as its creator," revealing the wish to be worshipped. (Desire for glory, not care; evidence of selfish motives.)

55–70 min · You do: independent annotation · You do (15 min)
Independent annotation and a claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph (exemplar given).
Annotate the chapter for point of view, imagery (three marks with a margin note each), then write one claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph: what does this chapter suggest about obsession and the discovery of life? Then start your writing prompt at your assigned level (HS Sophomore: Analyze how Chapter IV develops the idea of obsession and the discovery of life. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of foreshadowing and tone / mood shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.)
Exemplar: Victor's motive for creating life is the desire to be honored, not to care for what he creates. When the text says “A new species would bless me as its creator and source” (Chapter IV, paragraph 8), it shows this directly. He imagines a new species that "would bless me as its creator," which centers his own glory; nothing in his plans considers what the being will need.
Task: Annotate the chapter for point of view, imagery (three marks with a margin note each), then write one claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph: what does this chapter suggest about obsession and the discovery of life? Then start your writing prompt at your assigned level (HS Sophomore: Analyze how Chapter IV develops the idea of obsession and the discovery of life. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of foreshadowing and tone / mood shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.)
Exemplar: Victor's motive for creating life is the desire to be honored, not to care for what he creates. When the text says “A new species would bless me as its creator and source” (Chapter IV, paragraph 8), it shows this directly. He imagines a new species that "would bless me as its creator," which centers his own glory; nothing in his plans considers what the being will need.

70–80 min · Discussion · We do (10 min)
Structured discussion from the 30 tiered questions, with facilitation notes.
Anchor question: Victor refuses to tell Walton how he created life. Why is this choice important? Ask students to separate the older narrator's judgment from the younger Victor's actions in this chapter.
Anchor question: Victor refuses to tell Walton how he created life. Why is this choice important?
Facilitation: Ask students to separate the older narrator's judgment from the younger Victor's actions in this chapter.

80–87 min · Exit ticket / chapter quiz · You do (7 min)
Chapter quiz in the app and an exit ticket (answer given).
Chapter quiz in the app, then: In one sentence, what does this chapter suggest about obsession and the discovery of life? Support it with one short quotation. Model answer: Victor's motive for creating life is the desire to be honored, not to care for what he creates. ("A new species would bless me as its creator and source", Chapter IV, paragraph 8). Accept any defensible claim backed by a quotation from the chapter; the answer key for the quiz is in the Quiz section.
Exit ticket: In one sentence, what does this chapter suggest about obsession and the discovery of life? Support it with one short quotation.
Answer: Model answer: Victor's motive for creating life is the desire to be honored, not to care for what he creates. ("A new species would bless me as its creator and source", Chapter IV, paragraph 8). Accept any defensible claim backed by a quotation from the chapter; the answer key for the quiz is in the Quiz section.

87–90 min · Closure · I do (3 min)
Summarize the lesson and preview the next reading.
Today we saw how point of view shapes obsession and the discovery of life. Key takeaway: Victor fantasizes that "a new species would bless me as its creator," revealing the wish to be worshipped.

Total: 90 minutes.

Teacher analysis (spoilers)

Literary elements

- **Point of view:** Victor interrupts his story to address Walton directly: "Learn from me." The older Victor judges the younger.
- **Imagery:** Charnel-houses, dissecting rooms, pale cheeks: the work is described as unhealthy and secret.
- **Structure:** Two years compressed into one chapter; seasons pass unnoticed, showing how obsession erases ordinary life.

Themes and how they develop

- **ambition and knowledge:** Victor fantasizes that "a new species would bless me as its creator," revealing the wish to be worshipped.
- **isolation and companionship:** he neglects his family and friends; work cuts him off.

Symbols and motifs

- **light and fire:** Light stands for knowledge and fire for its double edge: warmth and burning. Victor seeks the "light" of discovery; the creature discovers fire and is burned by it. In this chapter: “ardent and eager, that the stars often disappeared in the light of morning whilst I was yet engaged in my laboratory” (Chapter IV, paragraph 1).
- **isolation:** Almost every narrator ends up alone; solitude is both the cost of ambition and the creature's suffering. In this chapter: “had directed their enquiries towards the same science, that I alone should be reserved to discover so astonishing a secret” (Chapter IV, paragraph 3).

Key quotations (checked against the reading text)

- “Learn from me, if not by my precepts, at least by my example, how dangerous is the acquirement of knowledge” (Chapter IV, paragraph 6) The novel's warning stated outright.
- “A new species would bless me as its creator and source” (Chapter IV, paragraph 8) Desire for glory, not care; evidence of selfish motives.
- “I became myself capable of bestowing animation upon lifeless matter” (Chapter IV, paragraph 4) The discovery itself, told without explanation; Victor withholds the secret.

Model claim-evidence-reasoning

Claim: Victor's motive for creating life is the desire to be honored, not to care for what he creates.
Evidence: “A new species would bless me as its creator and source” (Chapter IV, paragraph 8)
Reasoning: He imagines a new species that "would bless me as its creator," which centers his own glory; nothing in his plans considers what the being will need.

Vocabulary with etymology notes

Word	Definition (in this sentence)	In context	Word history
procrastinate (verb)	to put off doing something	*I wished, as it were, to procrastinate all that related to my feelings of affection until the great object, which swallowed up every habit of my nature, should be completed.*	
slaughterhouse (noun)	a building where animals are killed for meat	*The dissecting room and the slaughterhouse furnished many of my materials; and often did my human nature turn with loathing from my occupation, whilst, still urged on by an eagerness which perpetually*	“slaughterhouse”: From slaughter + house. (Wiktionary, https://en.wiktionary.org/wiki/slaughterhouse#Etymology)

		increased, I brought my work near to a conclusion.	
dissecting (adjective)	used for cutting up bodies to study them	*The dissecting room and the slaughterhouse furnished many of my materials; and often did my human nature turn with loathing from my occupation, whilst, still urged on by an eagerness which perpetually increased, I brought my work near to a conclusion.*	"dissecting": Latin dissectus past participle of dissecare "to cut asunder, cut up", from dis- "asunder" + secare "to cut"; see section. (Wiktionary, https://en.wiktionary.org/wiki/dissect#Etymology)
dabbled (verb)	dip a foot or hand briefly into a liquid	*Who shall conceive the horrors of my secret toil, as I dabbled among the unhallowed damps of the grave, or tortured the living animal to animate the lifeless clay?*	
charnel (noun)	a vault or building where corpses or bones are deposited	*Now I was led to examine the cause and progress of this decay, and forced to spend days and nights in vaults and charnel-houses.*	
disquieted (verb)	disturb in mind or make uneasy or cause to be worried or alarmed	*I knew my silence disquieted them; and I well remembered the words of my father: "I know that while you are pleased with yourself, you will think of us with affection, and we shall hear regularly from you.*	
abstruse (adjective)	difficult to penetrate; incomprehensible to one of ordinary understanding or knowledge	*In a thousand ways he smoothed for me the path of knowledge, and made the most abstruse enquiries clear and facile to my apprehension.*	
unguarded (adjective)	frank; careless about hiding feelings	*I will not lead you on, unguarded and ardent as I then was, to your*	

		destruction and infallible misery.	
vintage (noun)	a season's yield of wine from a vineyard	*It was a most beautiful season; never did the fields bestow a more plentiful harvest, or the vines yield a more luxuriant vintage: but my eyes were insensible to the charms of nature.*	“vintage”: From Middle English vendage, vyndage, from Anglo-Norman vendenge, from Old French vendage, vendenge (cognate with French vendange), from Latin vindēmia "a gathering of grapes, vintage", from vīnum "wine" + dēmō "take off or away, remove", from de "of; from, away from" + emō "take". (Wiktionary, https://en.wiktionary.org/wiki/vintage#Etymology)
physiology (noun)	the branch of the biological sciences dealing with the functioning of organisms	*I revolved these circumstances in my mind, and determined thenceforth to apply myself more particularly to those branches of natural philosophy which relate to physiology.*	

Discussion questions

1. Victor refuses to tell Walton how he created life. Why is this choice important?
2. Where does foreshadowing appear in this chapter, and what effect does it have? Point to one passage.
3. How does this chapter connect to the book's larger concern with the sublime power of nature?

Classroom discussion questions (30, tiered)

Wait time after every question (3 s for DOK 1, 5 s for DOK 2, 8 to 10 s for DOK 3 and 4); think-pair-share on DOK 3 and 4; answer each response with a follow-up probe; close with student-generated questions. Focus sets by rigor level: Middle School: 1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 6, 11, 12, 13, 14, 21, 22; HS Freshman: 1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 12, 13, 14, 15, 22, 23, 24; HS Sophomore: 1, 2, 3, 4, 13, 14, 15, 16, 17, 23, 24, 25; HS Junior: 1, 2, 3, 14, 15, 16, 17, 18, 24, 25, 26, 27; HS Senior: 1, 2, 3, 15, 16, 17, 18, 25, 26, 27, 28, 29; AP: 1, 2, 16, 17, 18, 19, 20, 26, 27, 28, 29, 30; College Freshman: 1, 2, 17, 18, 19, 20, 21, 22, 27, 28, 29, 30; College Sophomore: 1, 2, 11, 18, 19, 20, 21, 22, 23, 28, 29, 30; College Junior: 1, 11, 12, 19, 20, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 29, 30; College Senior: 1, 11, 12, 13, 20, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 26, 30; Graduate / PhD: 1, 11, 12, 13, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 26, 27, 28

Literal / recall

1. What does Victor discover? [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · 7.RC.1, 7.CC.1, 9-10.RC.1] Look for: The cause of generation and life
2. Where does Victor gather materials? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · 7.RC.1, 7.CC.1, 9-10.RC.1] Look for: Charnel houses and dissecting rooms
3. Why does Victor make the being gigantic? [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · 7.RC.1, 7.CC.1, 9-10.RC.1] Look for: The small parts were hard to work with
4. What happens to Victor's health and relationships? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · 7.RC.1, 7.CC.1, 9-10.RC.1] Look for: He neglects his family and grows ill and pale

5. What does Victor refuse to share with Walton? [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · 7.RC.1, 7.CC.1, 9-10.RC.1] Look for: The secret of how he created life
6. Retell the three most important events of "Chapter IV" in order, in one sentence each. [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · 7.RC.1, 7.CC.1, 9-10.RC.1] Look for: Victor works tirelessly, masters chemistry, and discovers the cause of life. Gathering materials from charnel houses and dissecting rooms, he neglects family and health for nearly two years as he builds a being of gigantic stature.
7. Which characters appear or are mentioned in "Chapter IV"? Name two and one thing each says or does. [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · 7.RC.1, 7.CC.1, 9-10.RC.1] Look for: Names and actions taken from the chapter; check against the teacher summary.
8. Where and when does "Chapter IV" take place? Point to the line that tells you. [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · 7.RC.1, 7.CC.1, 9-10.RC.1] Look for: A place/time detail quoted from the chapter.
9. Reread: "I wished, as it were, to procrastinate all that related to my feelings of affection until the great object, which swallowed up every habit of my nature, should be completed." What does "procrastinate" mean here, and what is literally happening in this line? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · 7.RC.1, 7.CC.1, 9-10.RC.1] Look for: procrastinate: to put off doing something.
10. Reread: "The dissecting room and the slaughterhouse furnished many of my materials; and often did my human nature turn with loathing from my occupation, whilst, still urged on by an eagerness which perpetually increased, I…" What does "slaughterhouse" mean here, and what is literally happening in this line? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · 7.RC.1, 7.CC.1, 9-10.RC.1] Look for: slaughterhouse: a building where animals are killed for meat.

Inferential / analytical

1. What does "Chapter IV" suggest about obsession and the discovery of life? State the inference and the line that supports it. [DOK 2 · thinkPairShare · wait 5 s · 7.RC.2, 7.CC.2, 9-10.RC.2] Look for: Victor withholds the secret from Walton, warning 'how dangerous is the acquirement of knowledge'—the novel's core moral caution.
2. Find one example of foreshadowing in this chapter. What does it reveal that a plain statement would not? [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · 7.RC.3, 7.CC.2, 9-10.RC.3] Look for: Look for hints, warnings or images that point to later events.
3. How does the tone / mood in this chapter shape what we understand about obsession and the discovery of life? [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · 7.RC.12, 7.CC.2, 9-10.RC.12] Look for: Look for word choices that reveal the narrator's attitude or the scene's feeling.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Victor's motive for creating life is the desire to be honored, not to care for what he creates. Useful evidence: "Learn from me, if not by my precepts, at least by my example, how dangerous is the acquirement of knowledge" (Chapter IV, paragraph 6): The novel's warning stated outright. Theme link: Victor fantasizes that "a new species would bless me as its creator," revealing the wish to be worshipped. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
4. In the passage that begins "I see by your eagerness, and the wonder and hope which your eyes express, my friend, that you expect to be informed of the secret with which I am acquainted; that cannot be:…", why might Shelley have chosen these particular words? Pick two and explain their connotations. [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · 7.RC.12, 7.CC.2, 9-10.RC.12] Look for: Diction analysis of two words in the anchor passage.
5. What causes the main turn in "Chapter IV", and what effect is it likely to have on what follows? [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · 7.RC.3, 7.CC.2, 9-10.RC.1] Look for: Victor works tirelessly, masters chemistry, and discovers the cause

of life. Gathering materials from charnel houses and dissecting rooms, he neglects family and health for nearly two years as he builds a being of gigantic stature.

6. How does “Chapter IV” build on “Chapter III”? Name one link of cause and effect. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · 7.RC.3, 7.CC.2, 9-10.RC.3] Look for: A causal or structural link between this and the previous chapter.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Victor's motive for creating life is the desire to be honored, not to care for what he creates. Useful evidence: “A new species would bless me as its creator and source” (Chapter IV, paragraph 8): Desire for glory, not care; evidence of selfish motives. On structure: Two years compressed into one chapter; seasons pass unnoticed, showing how obsession erases ordinary life. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
7. What can we infer about a character's motives from what they say and do here, as opposed to what they claim? [DOK 3 · followUp · wait 8 s · 7.RC.3, 7.CC.2, 9-10.RC.1] Look for: An inference about motive supported by a quoted line.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Victor's motive for creating life is the desire to be honored, not to care for what he creates. Useful evidence: “I became myself capable of bestowing animation upon lifeless matter” (Chapter IV, paragraph 4): The discovery itself, told without explanation; Victor withholds the secret. Theme link: Victor fantasizes that "a new species would bless me as its creator," revealing the wish to be worshipped. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
8. The bell-ringer asked: “Victor refuses to tell Walton how he created life. Why is this choice important?” Now that we have read closely, how would you revise your first answer, and which line changed your mind? [DOK 2 · thinkPairShare · wait 5 s · 7.RC.2, 7.CC.2, 9-10.RC.2] Look for: A revised answer anchored in the text.
9. Where does imagery appear, and how does it connect this chapter to the larger concern with the sublime power of nature? [DOK 3 · followUp · wait 8 s · 7.RC.12, 7.CC.2, 9-10.RC.12] Look for: Look for sensory details (sight, sound, cold, light) and what mood they create.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Victor's motive for creating life is the desire to be honored, not to care for what he creates. Useful evidence: “Learn from me, if not by my precepts, at least by my example, how dangerous is the acquirement of knowledge” (Chapter IV, paragraph 6): The novel's warning stated outright. On imagery: Charnel-houses, dissecting rooms, pale cheeks: the work is described as unhealthy and secret. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
10. Background: Body-snatching to supply anatomy schools was a real scandal of the era. 'Natural philosophy' was the period term for science. How does knowing this change the way you read one moment in the chapter? [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · 7.RC.3, 7.CC.2, 9-10.RC.1] Look for: A specific moment reread in light of the context.
    Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Victor's motive for creating life is the desire to be honored, not to care for what he creates. Useful evidence: “A new species would bless me as its creator and source” (Chapter IV, paragraph 8): Desire for glory, not care; evidence of selfish motives. Theme link: Victor fantasizes that "a new species would bless me as its creator," revealing the wish to be worshipped. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

Evaluative / synthesis / creative

1. A critic might argue: “Victor withholds the secret from Walton, warning 'how dangerous is the acquirement of knowledge'—the novel's core moral caution.” How far do you agree? Take a stand and defend it with two lines from the chapter. [DOK 3 · fourCorners · wait 8 s · 7.RC.2, 7.CC.3, 9-10.RC.2] Look for: A defended position with evidence and one counterpoint.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Victor's motive for creating life is the desire to be honored, not to care for what he creates. Useful evidence: “I became myself capable of bestowing animation upon lifeless matter” (Chapter IV, paragraph 4): The discovery itself, told without explanation; Victor withholds the secret. Theme link: he neglects his family and friends; work cuts him off. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
2. Which character in this chapter acts most wisely, and which least? Judge them by a standard you name. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · 7.RC.3, 7.CC.3, 9-10.RC.1] Look for: An evaluation using an explicit criterion and evidence.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Victor's motive for creating life is the desire to be honored, not to care for what he creates. Useful evidence: “Learn from me, if not by my precepts, at least by my example, how dangerous is the acquirement of knowledge” (Chapter IV, paragraph 6): The novel's warning stated outright. Theme link: Victor fantasizes that "a new species would bless me as its creator," revealing the wish to be worshipped. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
3. Rewrite one moment of “Chapter IV” from the point of view of a different character. What does the new angle reveal or hide about obsession and the discovery of life? [DOK 4 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · 7.RC.1, 7.CC.3, 9-10.RC.1] Look for: A creative product with a rationale tied to the text.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Victor's motive for creating life is the desire to be honored, not to care for what he creates. Useful evidence: “A new species would bless me as its creator and source” (Chapter IV, paragraph 8): Desire for glory, not care; evidence of selfish motives. On point of view: Victor interrupts his story to address Walton directly: "Learn from me." The older Victor judges the younger. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
4. Write three questions of your own about “Chapter IV”: one recall, one “why/how”, and one “should/what if”. Trade with a partner and answer theirs. [DOK 3 · studentGenerated · wait 8 s · 7.RC.2, 7.CC.3, 9-10.RC.2] Look for: Student-generated questions at three levels.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Victor's motive for creating life is the desire to be honored, not to care for what he creates. Useful evidence: “I became myself capable of bestowing animation upon lifeless matter” (Chapter IV, paragraph 4): The discovery itself, told without explanation; Victor withholds the secret. Theme link: Victor fantasizes that "a new species would bless me as its creator," revealing the wish to be worshipped. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
5. Connect this chapter to the costs of unchecked ambition: is the link strong or weak so far? What would Shelley need to show next to strengthen it? [DOK 4 · socraticCircle · wait 8 s · 7.RC.2, 7.CC.3, 9-10.RC.2] Look for: A judgment of thematic development across the work.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Victor's motive for creating life is the desire to be honored, not to care for what he creates. Useful evidence: “Learn from me, if not by my precepts, at least by

my example, how dangerous is the acquirement of knowledge” (Chapter IV, paragraph 6): The novel's warning stated outright. Theme link: he neglects his family and friends; work cuts him off. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

6. Is the foreshadowing in this chapter effective, or does it feel heavy-handed? Evaluate it as a reader would in a review. [DOK 3 · fourCorners · wait 8 s · 7.RC.3, 7.CC.3, 9-10.RC.3] Look for: An evaluative judgment with criteria and evidence.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Victor's motive for creating life is the desire to be honored, not to care for what he creates. Useful evidence: “A new species would bless me as its creator and source” (Chapter IV, paragraph 8): Desire for glory, not care; evidence of selfish motives. Theme link: Victor fantasizes that "a new species would bless me as its creator," revealing the wish to be worshipped. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

7. Compare how “Chapter IV” treats obsession and the discovery of life with how another text, film or event you know treats a similar idea. What does Frankenstein see that the other misses? [DOK 4 · socraticCircle · wait 8 s · 7.RC.2, 7.CC.3, 9-10.RC.2] Look for: A cross-text synthesis.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Victor's motive for creating life is the desire to be honored, not to care for what he creates. Useful evidence: “I became myself capable of bestowing animation upon lifeless matter” (Chapter IV, paragraph 4): The discovery itself, told without explanation; Victor withholds the secret. Theme link: he neglects his family and friends; work cuts him off. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

8. Predict what “Chapter V” will bring, using two clues from this chapter. After reading, evaluate your prediction. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · 7.RC.3, 7.CC.3, 9-10.RC.3] Look for: A prediction or judgment justified with textual clues.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Victor's motive for creating life is the desire to be honored, not to care for what he creates. Useful evidence: “Learn from me, if not by my precepts, at least by my example, how dangerous is the acquirement of knowledge” (Chapter IV, paragraph 6): The novel's warning stated outright. Theme link: Victor fantasizes that "a new species would bless me as its creator," revealing the wish to be worshipped. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

9. Design a one-paragraph modern adaptation of this chapter (setting, characters, conflict). What must stay the same for it to still be about obsession and the discovery of life? [DOK 4 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · 7.RC.2, 7.CC.3, 9-10.RC.2] Look for: A creative transfer that keeps the core idea.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Victor's motive for creating life is the desire to be honored, not to care for what he creates. Useful evidence: “A new species would bless me as its creator and source” (Chapter IV, paragraph 8): Desire for glory, not care; evidence of selfish motives. Theme link: he neglects his family and friends; work cuts him off. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

10. What question would you most like to ask Mary Shelley about this chapter, and what answer do you think the text itself gives? [DOK 4 · studentGenerated · wait 8 s · 7.RC.2, 7.CC.3, 9-10.RC.2] Look for: A student-generated question answered from evidence.

    Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Victor's motive for creating life is the desire to be

honored, not to care for what he creates. Useful evidence: “I became myself capable of bestowing animation upon lifeless matter” (Chapter IV, paragraph 4): The discovery itself, told without explanation; Victor withholds the secret. Theme link: Victor fantasizes that "a new species would bless me as its creator," revealing the wish to be worshipped. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

Annotation focus

- **Foreshadowing:** look for hints, warnings or images that point to later events (anchor passage in the We do segment)
- Also notice **Tone / mood**: word choices that reveal the narrator's attitude or the scene's feeling
- Also notice **Imagery**: sensory details (sight, sound, cold, light) and what mood they create

Chapter quiz: item bank (all eleven rigor versions)

1. [fill · recall · DOK 1] Complete the quotation from Chapter IV, paragraph 4: “I became myself capable of _____ animation upon lifeless matter”
   Key: bestowing
2. [fill · recall · DOK 1] Complete the quotation from Chapter IV, paragraph 6: “Learn from me, if not by my precepts, at least by my example, how dangerous is the _____ of knowledge”
   Key: acquirement
3. [fill · recall · DOK 1] Fill in the blank with the vocabulary word that fits: “Now I was led to examine the cause and progress of this decay, and forced to spend days and nights in vaults and _____-houses.” Word bank: dissecting, slaughterhouse, charnel, procrastinate
   Key: charnel
4. [fill · recall · DOK 1] Complete the quotation from Chapter IV, paragraph 8: “A new _____ would bless me as its creator and source”
   Key: species
5. [mc · recall · DOK 1] Where does Victor gather materials?
   A. The forest
   B. The market
   C. Charnel houses and dissecting rooms
   D. A church garden
   Key: C (Charnel houses and dissecting rooms)
6. [fill · recall · DOK 1] Fill in the blank with the vocabulary word that fits: “I will not lead you on, _____ and ardent as I then was, to your destruction and infallible misery.” Word bank: slaughterhouse, dissecting, unguarded, procrastinate
   Key: unguarded
7. [mc · recall · DOK 1] Why does Victor make the being gigantic?
   A. By accident
   B. To frighten enemies
   C. The small parts were hard to work with
   D. To make it strong for labor

Key: C (The small parts were hard to work with)

8. [fill · recall · DOK 1] Fill in the blank with the vocabulary word that fits: “In a thousand ways he smoothed for me the path of knowledge, and made the most _____ enquiries clear and facile to my apprehension.” Word bank: slaughterhouse, abstruse, procrastinate, dissecting

   Key: abstruse

9. [mc · recall · DOK 1] In the line “The dissecting room and the slaughterhouse furnished many of my materials; and often did my human nature turn with loathing from my occupation, whilst, still urged on by an eagerness which perpetually increased, I…”, what does “slaughterhouse” most nearly mean?

   A. a feeling of extreme emotional intensity
   B. a building where animals are killed for meat
   C. an exchange; a giving and receiving
   D. be persistent, refuse to stop

   Key: B (a building where animals are killed for meat)

10. [mc · inference · DOK 2] Which choice best states a central concern of “Chapter IV”?

    A. Loneliness and the desire for a friend
    B. Obsession and the discovery of life
    C. Delay and dread
    D. Confidence before danger

    Key: B (Obsession and the discovery of life)

11. [mc · inference · DOK 2] What does this passage most clearly show? “I became myself capable of bestowing animation upon lifeless matter” (Chapter IV, paragraph 4)

    A. The nurture argument in one line.
    B. The discovery itself, told without explanation; Victor withholds the secret.
    C. "Necessary": sympathy as a need like food.
    D. The creature's first gesture is reaching; Victor's response is flight. Key evidence that the creature is abandoned before it acts.

    Key: B (The discovery itself, told without explanation; Victor withholds the secret.)

12. [short · inference · DOK 2] What can you infer from this line? “Learn from me, if not by my precepts, at least by my example, how dangerous is the acquirement of knowledge” (Chapter IV, paragraph 6) Answer in two or three sentences with one detail.

    Sample answer: The novel's warning stated outright.

13. [mc · inference · DOK 2] What does this passage most clearly show? “A new species would bless me as its creator and source” (Chapter IV, paragraph 8)

    A. The heart of Victor's ambition: more than anyone before.
    B. Moral reasoning; strong evidence of his goodness.
    C. Desire for glory, not care; evidence of selfish motives.
    D. Dismissal without explanation; Victor later blames this.

    Key: C (Desire for glory, not care; evidence of selfish motives.)

14. [mc · analysis · DOK 3] Which literary element does this describe in “Chapter IV”? Victor interrupts his story to address Walton directly: "Learn from me." The older Victor judges the younger.

    A. Hyperbole

    B. Point of view

    C. Metaphor

    D. Personification

    Key: B (Point of view)

15. [short · analysis · DOK 3] Analyze the word choice in “I became myself capable of bestowing animation upon lifeless matter” (Chapter IV, paragraph 4). Pick two words and explain what they suggest.

    Sample answer: The discovery itself, told without explanation; Victor withholds the secret.

16. [short · synthesis · DOK 4] Close reading: how do the diction and syntax of “A new species would bless me as its creator and source” (Chapter IV, paragraph 8) shape its meaning? Consider a second, competing reading.

    Sample answer: Desire for glory, not care; evidence of selfish motives.

17. [mc · recall · DOK 1] In the line “Who shall conceive the horrors of my secret toil, as I dabbled among the unhallowed damps of the grave, or tortured the living animal to animate the lifeless clay?”, what does “dabbled” most nearly mean?

    A. dip a foot or hand briefly into a liquid

    B. to belong to or be connected with

    C. capture; being taken by force

    D. organized opposition to authority; a conflict in which one faction tries to wrest control from another

    Key: A (dip a foot or hand briefly into a liquid)

18. [mc · recall · DOK 1] In the line “I wished, as it were, to procrastinate all that related to my feelings of affection until the great object, which swallowed up every habit of my nature, should be completed.”, what does “procrastinate” most nearly mean?

    A. made easier

    B. to believe especially on uncertain or tentative grounds

    C. to put off doing something

    D. capable of or tending to change in form or quality or nature

    Key: C (to put off doing something)

19. [mc · recall · DOK 1] What does Victor discover?

    A. A route to the pole

    B. A cure for fever

    C. A new planet

    D. The cause of generation and life

    Key: D (The cause of generation and life)

20. [mc · recall · DOK 1] What does Victor refuse to share with Walton?

    A. His age

    B. The secret of how he created life

    C. The location of Geneva

D. His family's names

Key: B (The secret of how he created life)

21. [short · inference · DOK 2] What can you infer from this line? “A new species would bless me as its creator and source” (Chapter IV, paragraph 8) Answer in two or three sentences with one detail.
Sample answer: Desire for glory, not care; evidence of selfish motives.

22. [mc · inference · DOK 2] What does this passage most clearly show? “Learn from me, if not by my precepts, at least by my example, how dangerous is the acquirement of knowledge” (Chapter IV, paragraph 6)
A. Fire's double nature; symbol for knowledge and for the creature.
B. The novel's warning stated outright.
C. Victor's fear of consequences.
D. The key threat; Victor assumes it targets himself.
Key: B (The novel's warning stated outright.)

23. [short · analysis · DOK 3] Claim: Victor's motive for creating life is the desire to be honored, not to care for what he creates. Explain how this evidence supports the claim: “A new species would bless me as its creator and source” (Chapter IV, paragraph 8).
Sample answer: He imagines a new species that "would bless me as its creator," which centers his own glory; nothing in his plans considers what the being will need.

24. [mc · analysis · DOK 3] Which literary element does this describe in “Chapter IV”? Charnel-houses, dissecting rooms, pale cheeks: the work is described as unhealthy and secret.
A. Personification
B. Imagery
C. Allusion
D. Irony
Key: B (Imagery)

25. [short · synthesis · DOK 4] Close reading: how do the diction and syntax of “Learn from me, if not by my precepts, at least by my example, how dangerous is the acquirement of knowledge” (Chapter IV, paragraph 6) shape its meaning? Consider a second, competing reading.
Sample answer: The novel's warning stated outright.

26. [short · synthesis · DOK 4] Evaluate this claim about the chapter: “Victor's motive for creating life is the desire to be honored, not to care for what he creates.” Is it fully persuasive? Argue with evidence, including a passage that complicates it.
Sample answer: He imagines a new species that "would bless me as its creator," which centers his own glory; nothing in his plans considers what the being will need.

27. [short · synthesis · DOK 4] Synthesis: trace how ambition and knowledge develops from an earlier chapter to “Chapter IV”. Use one quotation from each.
Sample answer: Victor fantasizes that "a new species would bless me as its creator," revealing the wish to be worshipped.

28. [mc · recall · DOK 1] In the line “The dissecting room and the slaughterhouse furnished many of my materials; and often did my human nature turn with loathing from my occupation, whilst, still urged on by an eagerness which perpetually increased, I…”, what does “dissecting” most nearly mean?
A. increase
B. to block off

C. a defamatory or abusive word or phrase

D. used for cutting up bodies to study them

Key: D (used for cutting up bodies to study them)

29. [fill · recall · DOK 1] Fill in the blank with the vocabulary word that fits: "I knew my silence _____ them; and I well remembered the words of my father: "I know that while you are pleased with yourself, you will think of us with affection, and we shall hear regularly from you." Word bank: disquieted, slaughterhouse, dissecting, procrastinate

Key: disquieted

Rigor version	Items (in order)	Mix
Middle School	1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 6, 7, 8, 9, 10, 11, 12, 13, 14, 15, 16	recall 9, inference 4, analysis 2, synthesis 1
HS Freshman	17, 2, 18, 5, 6, 19, 1, 20, 21, 10, 22, 13, 23, 14, 24, 25	recall 8, inference 4, analysis 3, synthesis 1
HS Sophomore	5, 1, 3, 17, 18, 8, 12, 10, 22, 13, 21, 24, 15, 14, 26, 25	recall 6, inference 5, analysis 3, synthesis 2
HS Junior	3, 8, 7, 4, 1, 11, 21, 12, 22, 10, 14, 24, 15, 23, 27, 26	recall 5, inference 5, analysis 4, synthesis 2
HS Senior	28, 19, 8, 3, 13, 21, 11, 10, 22, 24, 23, 14, 15, 16, 27, 25	recall 4, inference 5, analysis 4, synthesis 3
AP	3, 2, 17, 21, 10, 13, 11, 22, 14, 24, 15, 23, 26, 27, 16, 25	recall 3, inference 5, analysis 4, synthesis 4
College Freshman	3, 8, 20, 22, 11, 13, 21, 12, 15, 24, 23, 14, 27, 26, 25, 16	recall 3, inference 5, analysis 4, synthesis 4
College Sophomore	3, 29, 13, 10, 21, 11, 12, 22, 15, 24, 23, 14, 27, 16, 26, 25	recall 2, inference 6, analysis 4, synthesis 4
College Junior	3, 29, 10, 12, 22, 13, 11, 21, 15, 23, 24, 14, 27, 25, 16, 26	recall 2, inference 6, analysis 4, synthesis 4
College Senior	3, 29, 12, 10, 13, 11, 22, 21, 23, 24, 14, 15, 16, 25, 26, 27	recall 2, inference 6, analysis 4, synthesis 4
Graduate / PhD	3, 29, 10, 13, 22, 21, 12, 11, 23, 15, 24, 14, 26, 25, 16, 27	recall 2, inference 6, analysis 4, synthesis 4

Writing prompts (eleven rigor levels)

Middle School (250 words; Indiana 2023: 7.RC.3, 7.W.1): Supported track (work from the passage your teacher selects). In "Chapter IV," how does Shelley show obsession and the discovery of life? Write a paragraph that states your claim, quotes two details from the passage, and explains how each detail supports your idea. Use the foreshadowing you noticed as one piece of evidence.

HS Freshman (350 words; Indiana 2023: 9-10.RC.3, 9-10.W.1): In Chapter IV, how does Shelley develop the idea of obsession and the discovery of life? State a clear claim, support it with two or three quotations, and explain how the foreshadowing in the chapter helps build that idea.

HS Sophomore (450 words; Indiana 2023: 9-10.RC.3, 9-10.W.1): Analyze how Chapter IV develops the idea of obsession and the discovery of life. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of foreshadowing and tone / mood shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.

HS Junior (550 words; Indiana 2023: 11-12.RC.3, 11-12.RC.1, 11-12.W.1): Analyze how the structure of Chapter IV (where it begins, turns and ends) and its foreshadowing shape the reader's understanding of obsession and

the discovery of life. Identify one place where the text leaves matters uncertain and explain how that uncertainty adds to its meaning.

HS Senior (600 words; Indiana 2023: 11-12.RC.3, 11-12.W.1): Two readers disagree about what Chapter IV suggests about obsession and the discovery of life. Lay out two plausible interpretations, weigh the evidence for each (including the chapter's foreshadowing and tone / mood), and argue for the stronger one in a sustained, well-organized essay.

AP (650 words; Indiana 2023: 11-12.RC.3, 11-12.W.1): Write a literary argument in which you analyze how Mary Shelley uses foreshadowing in Chapter IV to complicate the reader's understanding of obsession and the discovery of life. Develop a defensible thesis, select evidence purposefully, and explain how specific choices of diction and syntax create meaning.

College Freshman (1000 words; Indiana 2023: see unit standards): Situate Chapter IV within its historical and literary context and argue how the chapter's treatment of obsession and the discovery of life responds to that context. Engage with at least one secondary perspective (a critic, historian or the author's own statements), integrate quotations smoothly, and cite in MLA style.

College Sophomore (1250 words; Indiana 2023: see unit standards): Read Chapter IV alongside the conventions of its genre and period. Argue how the chapter's handling of obsession and the discovery of life follows or bends those conventions, using the foreshadowing as evidence, and test your reading against one published critic. Document two secondary sources in MLA.

College Junior (1500 words; Indiana 2023: see unit standards): Apply a named critical approach (for example formalist, historicist, feminist, psychoanalytic or ecocritical) to Chapter IV and its treatment of obsession and the discovery of life. State your method, show what it reveals in the chapter's foreshadowing and tone / mood, and identify where the text resists it.

College Senior (2000 words; Indiana 2023: see unit standards): Develop a research argument that reads Chapter IV as evidence for a larger claim about obsession and the discovery of life in Frankenstein. Connect close reading of the chapter to the whole novel, engage at least four scholarly sources, and state precisely where your reading departs from theirs (Chicago style).

Graduate / PhD (2500 words; Indiana 2023: see unit standards): Develop an original argument that reads Chapter IV as a hinge in the novel's larger treatment of obsession and the discovery of life. Position your reading within a named critical conversation (for example formalist, historicist, psychoanalytic, feminist or postcolonial approaches), account for the textual history where relevant, and articulate the stakes of your intervention for scholarship on Frankenstein.

SAT-style questions

1. *The dissecting room and the slaughterhouse furnished many of my materials; and often did my human nature turn with loathing from my occupation, whilst, still urged on by an eagerness which perpetually increased, I brought my work near to a conclusion.*

   As used in the text, what does the word “dissecting” most nearly mean?

   A. a season's yield of wine from a vineyard

B. frank; careless about hiding feelings

C. the branch of the biological sciences dealing with the functioning of organisms

D. used for cutting up bodies to study them

2. *I see by your eagerness, and the wonder and hope which your eyes express, my friend, that you expect to be informed of the secret with which I am acquainted; that cannot be: listen patiently until the end of my story, and you will easily perceive why I am reserved upon that subject. I will not lead you on, unguarded and ardent as I then was, to your destruction and infallible misery. Learn from me, if not by my precepts, at least by my example, how dangerous is the acquirement of knowledge, and how much happier that man is who believes his native town to be the world, than he who aspires to become greater than his nature will allow.*

Which choice best states a central concern of "Chapter IV"?

A. Learning compassion by watching

B. Reading and identity

C. Obsession and the discovery of life

D. The origin of the novel and the idea of creation

SAT key: 1. D (used for cutting up bodies to study them); 2. C (Obsession and the discovery of life)

Lesson 12: Chapter V

Focus: horror at the moment of creation

Objective: Students will analyze how imagery develops in “Chapter V” by writing a claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph that cites at least 2 quotations from the section, and will score at least 80% on the section quiz.

Standards: CCSS RL.9-10.4, W.9-10.1, L.9-10.4 · IN 9-10.RC.12, 9-10.W.1, 9-10.RC.9, 9-10.RC.11

Critical voice: “Our taste and our judgment alike revolt at this kind of writing, and the greater the ability with which it may be executed the worse it is -- it inculcates no lesson of conduct, manners, or morality; it cannot mend, and will not even amuse its readers, unless their taste have been deplorably vitiated -- it fatigues the feelings without interesting the understanding; it gratuitously harasses the heart, and wantonly adds to the store, already too great, of painful sensations.” (John Wilson Croker, critic, *Review of Frankenstein, The Quarterly Review 18 (January 1818), 379-385, p. 385*; public domain). Debate prompt: "Frankenstein inculcates no lesson." Students rebut Croker with evidence from Chapter V. *Objective:* Evaluate how the creation scene's language produces horror, and whether horror has a moral purpose. *Standards:* RL.11-12.4, W.11-12.1, 11-12.RC.13, 11-12.W.1

Teacher only · spoilers

On a dreary November night, the creature opens its 'dull yellow eye.' Horrified by its appearance, Victor flees, dreams of Elizabeth turning into his mother's corpse, and wakes to see the creature reaching toward him. He runs into the street, meets Clerval, and collapses into a long fever, nursed by Henry.

Background: Gothic novels used darkness, storms and nightmares to produce dread. The quoted lines from Coleridge's 'Ancient Mariner' reinforce Victor's guilt.

Significance: The irony is sharp: the being Victor labored to make is abandoned within minutes. The creature's outstretched hand may be a gesture of affection that Victor reads as threat.

Lesson plan and lecture script (90 minutes)

> **0–8 min · Bell-ringer · You do (8 min)**
> Students write to the bell-ringer, then pair-share.
> *Was the creature's first gesture threatening or loving? Use evidence. Write for five minutes. Starters: I think... because... / This connects to creation and responsibility because....*
> **Prompt:** Was the creature's first gesture threatening or loving? Use evidence.
> **Sentence starters:** I think… because… · This connects to creation and responsibility because…
> **Strong response:** A strong response takes a position and anticipates this: the moment of birth is the moment of abandonment.

8–18 min · Vocabulary with etymology notes · I do (10 min)
Five key words in context, with verified word histories.
*Today's words: agitates — upsets; disturbs; palpitated — beat fast and hard (of the heart); infusing — putting a quality or feeling into something; relapses — returns of an illness after improvement; lassitude — tiredness and lack of energy. “infusing”: From Middle English infusen, from Latin infusus, from infundo. “relapses”: From Latin relapsus, past participle of relabi "to slide back, fall back", from re- "back" + labi "to slip, slide, fall". “lassitude”: Borrowed from French lassitude, from Latin lassitūdō "faintness, weariness", from lassus "faint, weary", perhaps for *ladtus, and thus akin to English late.*
Words: agitates: upsets; disturbs · palpitated: beat fast and hard (of the heart) · infusing: putting a quality or feeling into something · relapses: returns of an illness after improvement · lassitude: tiredness and lack of energy

18–28 min · Background and context · I do (10 min)
Mini-lecture (read or adapt the script).
Gothic novels used darkness, storms and nightmares to produce dread. The quoted lines from Coleridge's 'Ancient Mariner' reinforce Victor's guilt. The irony is sharp: the being Victor labored to make is abandoned within minutes. The creature's outstretched hand may be a gesture of affection that Victor reads as threat. Imagery: The creation scene: a dreary night, rain, a dying candle, a "dull yellow eye." The details are few and precise, so the horror is in the response, not the science. Irony: He chose the creature's features "as beautiful," yet the result is hideous; the dream becomes a nightmare. Characterization: Victor flees twice, from the creature at his bed and from his responsibility, and calls it "the wretch." Watch for the outstretched hand: the creature reaches for him; Victor reads it as a threat. The gesture is the novel's image of rejected need.

28–40 min · I do: modeled close reading · I do (12 min)
Model the close reading of the anchor quotation using the written think-aloud below.
I read the line once for meaning and once for craft. “It was on a dreary night of November, that I beheld the accomplishment of my toils” (Chapter V, paragraph 1). Pathetic fallacy and anticlimax: "accomplishment" is followed by horror. That is imagery at work: The creation scene: a dreary night, rain, a dying candle, a "dull yellow eye." The details are few and precise, so the horror is in the response, not the science.

> *It was on a dreary night of November, that I beheld the accomplishment of my toils* (Chapter V, paragraph 1)

Think-aloud: I read the line once for meaning and once for craft. “It was on a dreary night of November, that I beheld the accomplishment of my toils” (Chapter V, paragraph 1). Pathetic fallacy and anticlimax: "accomplishment" is followed by horror. That is imagery at work: The creation scene: a dreary night, rain, a dying candle, a "dull yellow eye." The details are few and precise, so the horror is in the response, not the science.

40–55 min · We do: guided annotation · We do (15 min)
Guided analysis of a second quotation; expected answers given.
Ask: What words in this line stand out, and what do they suggest? Expected: "Seemingly" shows Victor is guessing; "detain" means to hold back, a child-like reach. He "escaped," treating his creation as a threat. This is the core of the responsibility theme. Ask: How does this line connect to creation and responsibility? Expected: The moment of birth is the moment of abandonment. (The creature's first gesture is reaching; Victor's response is flight. Key evidence that the creature is abandoned before it acts.)

> *one hand was stretched out, seemingly to detain me, but I escaped (Chapter V, paragraph 3)*

Ask: What words in this line stand out, and what do they suggest?
Expected answer: "Seemingly" shows Victor is guessing; "detain" means to hold back, a child-like reach. He "escaped," treating his creation as a threat. This is the core of the responsibility theme.
Ask: How does this line connect to creation and responsibility?
Expected answer: The moment of birth is the moment of abandonment. (The creature's first gesture is reaching; Victor's response is flight. Key evidence that the creature is abandoned before it acts.)

55–70 min · You do: independent annotation · You do (15 min)
Independent annotation and a claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph (exemplar given).
Annotate the chapter for imagery, irony (three marks with a margin note each), then write one claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph: what does this chapter suggest about horror at the moment of creation? Then start your writing prompt at your assigned level (HS Sophomore: Analyze how Chapter V develops the idea of horror at the moment of creation. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of imagery and tone / mood shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.) Exemplar: Victor abandons his creation at the moment it reaches for him, so the creature's later violence begins in neglect. When the text says “one hand was stretched out, seemingly to detain me, but I escaped” (Chapter V, paragraph 3), it shows this directly. The creature's "hand was stretched out, seemingly to detain me," a gesture of need, and Victor simply "escaped"; the word "seemingly" shows he does not know what it wants and does not stay to find out.
Task: Annotate the chapter for imagery, irony (three marks with a margin note each), then write one claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph: what does this chapter suggest about horror at the moment of creation? Then start your writing prompt at your assigned level (HS Sophomore: Analyze how Chapter V develops the idea of horror at the moment of creation. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of imagery and tone / mood shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.)
Exemplar: Victor abandons his creation at the moment it reaches for him, so the creature's later violence begins in neglect. When the text says “one hand was stretched out, seemingly to detain me, but I escaped” (Chapter V, paragraph 3), it shows this directly. The creature's "hand was stretched out, seemingly to detain me," a gesture of need, and Victor simply "escaped"; the word "seemingly" shows he does not know what it wants and does not stay to find out.

70–80 min · Discussion · We do (10 min)
Structured discussion from the 30 tiered questions, with facilitation notes.
Anchor question: Was the creature's first gesture threatening or loving? Use evidence. Ask: is Victor's horror understandable? Credit sympathy for Victor, but require students to explain what a responsible creator would have done.
Anchor question: Was the creature's first gesture threatening or loving? Use evidence.
Facilitation: Ask: is Victor's horror understandable? Credit sympathy for Victor, but require students to explain what a responsible creator would have done.

80–87 min · Exit ticket / chapter quiz · You do (7 min)
Chapter quiz in the app and an exit ticket (answer given).
Chapter quiz in the app, then: In one sentence, what does this chapter suggest about horror at the moment of creation? Support it with one short quotation. Model answer: Victor abandons his creation at the moment it reaches for him, so the creature's later violence begins in neglect. ("one hand was stretched out, seemingly to detain me, but I escaped", Chapter V, paragraph 3). Accept any defensible claim backed by a quotation from the chapter; the answer key for the quiz is in the Quiz section.
Exit ticket: In one sentence, what does this chapter suggest about horror at the moment of creation? Support it with one short quotation.
Answer: Model answer: Victor abandons his creation at the moment it reaches for him, so the creature's later violence begins in neglect. ("one hand was stretched out, seemingly to detain me, but I escaped", Chapter V, paragraph 3). Accept any defensible claim backed by a quotation from the chapter; the answer key for the quiz is in the Quiz section.

87–90 min · Closure · I do (3 min)
Summarize the lesson and preview the next reading.
Today we saw how imagery shapes horror at the moment of creation. Key takeaway: the moment of birth is the moment of abandonment.

Total: 90 minutes.

Teacher analysis (spoilers)

Literary elements

- **Imagery:** The creation scene: a dreary night, rain, a dying candle, a "dull yellow eye." The details are few and precise, so the horror is in the response, not the science.
- **Irony:** He chose the creature's features "as beautiful," yet the result is hideous; the dream becomes a nightmare.
- **Characterization:** Victor flees twice, from the creature at his bed and from his responsibility, and calls it "the wretch."

Themes and how they develop

- **creation and responsibility:** the moment of birth is the moment of abandonment.

Symbols and motifs

- **the outstretched hand:** the creature reaches for him; Victor reads it as a threat. The gesture is the novel's image of rejected need.

Key quotations (checked against the reading text)

- “It was on a dreary night of November, that I beheld the accomplishment of my toils” (Chapter V, paragraph 1) Pathetic fallacy and anticlimax: "accomplishment" is followed by horror.
- “the beauty of the dream vanished, and breathless horror and disgust filled my heart” (Chapter V, paragraph 3) The turn from ambition to revulsion in one sentence.
- “one hand was stretched out, seemingly to detain me, but I escaped” (Chapter V, paragraph 3) The creature's first gesture is reaching; Victor's response is flight. Key evidence that the creature is abandoned before it acts.

Model claim-evidence-reasoning

Claim: Victor abandons his creation at the moment it reaches for him, so the creature's later violence begins in neglect.
Evidence: “one hand was stretched out, seemingly to detain me, but I escaped” (Chapter V, paragraph 3)
Reasoning: The creature's "hand was stretched out, seemingly to detain me," a gesture of need, and Victor simply "escaped"; the word "seemingly" shows he does not know what it wants and does not stay to find out.

Vocabulary with etymology notes

Word	Definition (in this sentence)	In context	Word history
agitates (verb)	upsets; disturbs	*“Compose yourself,” said Clerval, who observed my change of colour, “I will not mention it, if it agitates you; but your father and cousin would be very happy if they received a letter from you in your own handwriting.*	
palpitated (verb)	beat fast and hard (of the heart)	*My heart palpitated in the sickness of fear; and I hurried on with irregular steps, not daring to look about me:—*	
infusing (verb)	putting a quality or feeling into something	*I had worked hard for nearly two years, for the sole purpose of infusing life into an inanimate body.*	“infusing”: From Middle English infusen, from Latin infusus, from infundo. (Wiktionary, https://en.wiktionary.org/wiki/infuse#Etymology)

relapses (noun)	returns of an illness after improvement	*By very slow degrees, and with frequent relapses, that alarmed and grieved my friend, I recovered.*	“relapses”: From Latin relapsus, past participle of relabi "to slide back, fall back", from re- "back" + labi "to slip, slide, fall". (Wiktionary, https://en.wiktionary.org/wiki/relapse#Etymology)
lassitude (noun)	tiredness and lack of energy	*At length lassitude succeeded to the tumult I had before endured; and I threw myself on the bed in my clothes, endeavouring to seek a few moments of forgetfulness.*	“lassitude”: Borrowed from French lassitude, from Latin lassitūdō "faintness, weariness", from lassus "faint, weary", perhaps for *ladtus, and thus akin to English late. (Wiktionary, https://en.wiktionary.org/wiki/lassitude#Etymology)
convalescence (noun)	gradual healing (through rest) after sickness or injury	*It was a divine spring; and the season contributed greatly to my convalescence.*	“convalescence”: Borrowed from Middle French convalescence, from Late Latin convalēscentia "regaining of health", from Latin convalēscēn(t-)s, present participle of convalēscere "to become strong or well"; see convalesce. (Wiktionary, https://en.wiktionary.org/wiki/convalescence#Etymology)
alighting (verb)	to come to rest, settle	*“My dear Frankenstein,” exclaimed he, “how glad I am to see you! how fortunate that you should be here at the very moment of my alighting!”*	“alighting”: From Middle English alighten "to descend from a place: to dismount, get off; to descend to a place: to arrive or stop (at a place); to land; to drop; to attack; of lightning: to strike; to leap on to, mount; to descend in rank; to cause (someone) to lose rank; to come forth, spring from; to alleviate, relieve; (Christianity) of Jesus: to come down to earth from heaven, become incarnate; to descend (Wiktionary, https://en.wiktionary.org/wiki/alight#Etymology)
unbounded (adjective)	seemingly boundless in amount, number, degree, or especially extent	*But I was in reality very ill; and surely nothing but the unbounded and unremitting attentions of my friend could have restored me to life.*	
wildness (noun)	a feeling of extreme emotional intensity	*Clerval at first attributed my unusual spirits to joy on his arrival; but when he observed me more attentively, he saw a wildness in my eyes for which he could not account; and my loud, unrestrained, heartless laughter,*	

		frightened and astonished him.	
bedchamber (noun)	a room used primarily for sleeping	*Unable to endure the aspect of the being I had created, I rushed out of the room, and continued a long time traversing my bedchamber, unable to compose my mind to sleep.*	"bedchamber": From Middle English bedchambre, bedchaumbre, equivalent to bed + chamber. (Wiktionary, https://en.wiktionary.org/wiki/bedchamber#Etymology)

Discussion questions

1. Was the creature's first gesture threatening or loving? Use evidence.
2. Where does imagery appear in this chapter, and what effect does it have? Point to one passage.
3. How does this chapter connect to the book's larger concern with the costs of unchecked ambition?

Classroom discussion questions (30, tiered)

Wait time after every question (3 s for DOK 1, 5 s for DOK 2, 8 to 10 s for DOK 3 and 4); think-pair-share on DOK 3 and 4; answer each response with a follow-up probe; close with student-generated questions. Focus sets by rigor level: Middle School: 1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 6, 11, 12, 13, 14, 21, 22; HS Freshman: 1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 12, 13, 14, 15, 22, 23, 24; HS Sophomore: 1, 2, 3, 4, 13, 14, 15, 16, 17, 23, 24, 25; HS Junior: 1, 2, 3, 14, 15, 16, 17, 18, 24, 25, 26, 27; HS Senior: 1, 2, 3, 15, 16, 17, 18, 25, 26, 27, 28, 29; AP: 1, 2, 16, 17, 18, 19, 20, 26, 27, 28, 29, 30; College Freshman: 1, 2, 17, 18, 19, 20, 21, 22, 27, 28, 29, 30; College Sophomore: 1, 2, 11, 18, 19, 20, 21, 22, 23, 28, 29, 30; College Junior: 1, 11, 12, 19, 20, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 29, 30; College Senior: 1, 11, 12, 13, 20, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 26, 30; Graduate / PhD: 1, 11, 12, 13, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 26, 27, 28

Literal / recall

1. What month does the creature come to life? [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · 7.RC.1, 7.CC.1, 9-10.RC.1] Look for: November
2. What first feature of the creature does Victor describe? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · 7.RC.1, 7.CC.1, 9-10.RC.1] Look for: Its dull yellow eye
3. What does Victor dream after fleeing? [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · 7.RC.1, 7.CC.1, 9-10.RC.1] Look for: Elizabeth turns into his dead mother's corpse
4. Who arrives in Ingolstadt and nurses Victor? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · 7.RC.1, 7.CC.1, 9-10.RC.1] Look for: Henry Clerval
5. What is ironic about this chapter? [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · 7.RC.1, 7.CC.1, 9-10.RC.1] Look for: Victor abandons the being he worked years to create
6. Retell the three most important events of "Chapter V" in order, in one sentence each. [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · 7.RC.1, 7.CC.1, 9-10.RC.1] Look for: On a dreary November night, the creature opens its 'dull yellow eye.' Horrified by its appearance, Victor flees, dreams of Elizabeth turning into his mother's corpse, and wakes to see the creature reaching toward him. He runs into the street, meets Clerval, and collapses into a long fever, nursed by Henry.
7. Which characters appear or are mentioned in "Chapter V"? Name two and one thing each says or does. [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · 7.RC.1, 7.CC.1, 9-10.RC.1] Look for: Names and actions taken from the chapter; check against the teacher summary.

8. Where and when does “Chapter V” take place? Point to the line that tells you. [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · 7.RC.1, 7.CC.1, 9-10.RC.1] Look for: A place/time detail quoted from the chapter.
9. Reread: ““Compose yourself,” said Clerval, who observed my change of colour, “I will not mention it, if it agitates you; but your father and cousin would be very happy if they received a letter from you in your own handwriting.” What does “agitates” mean here, and what is literally happening in this line? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · 7.RC.1, 7.CC.1, 9-10.RC.1] Look for: agitates: upsets; disturbs.
10. Reread: “My heart palpitated in the sickness of fear; and I hurried on with irregular steps, not daring to look about me:—” What does “palpitated” mean here, and what is literally happening in this line? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · 7.RC.1, 7.CC.1, 9-10.RC.1] Look for: palpitated: beat fast and hard (of the heart).

Inferential / analytical

1. What does “Chapter V” suggest about horror at the moment of creation? State the inference and the line that supports it. [DOK 2 · thinkPairShare · wait 5 s · 7.RC.2, 7.CC.2, 9-10.RC.2] Look for: The irony is sharp: the being Victor labored to make is abandoned within minutes. The creature's outstretched hand may be a gesture of affection that Victor reads as threat.
2. Find one example of imagery in this chapter. What does it reveal that a plain statement would not? [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · 7.RC.12, 7.CC.2, 9-10.RC.12] Look for: Look for sensory details (sight, sound, cold, light) and what mood they create.
3. How does the tone / mood in this chapter shape what we understand about horror at the moment of creation? [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · 7.RC.12, 7.CC.2, 9-10.RC.12] Look for: Look for word choices that reveal the narrator's attitude or the scene's feeling.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Victor abandons his creation at the moment it reaches for him, so the creature's later violence begins in neglect. Useful evidence: “It was on a dreary night of November, that I beheld the accomplishment of my toils” (Chapter V, paragraph 1): Pathetic fallacy and anticlimax: "accomplishment" is followed by horror. Theme link: the moment of birth is the moment of abandonment. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
4. In the passage that begins “I continued walking in this manner for some time, endeavouring, by bodily exercise, to ease the load that weighed upon my mind.”, why might Shelley have chosen these particular words? Pick two and explain their connotations. [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · 7.RC.12, 7.CC.2, 9-10.RC.12] Look for: Diction analysis of two words in the anchor passage.
5. What causes the main turn in “Chapter V”, and what effect is it likely to have on what follows? [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · 7.RC.3, 7.CC.2, 9-10.RC.1] Look for: On a dreary November night, the creature opens its 'dull yellow eye.' Horrified by its appearance, Victor flees, dreams of Elizabeth turning into his mother's corpse, and wakes to see the creature reaching toward him. He runs into the street, meets Clerval, and collapses into a long fever, nursed…
6. How does “Chapter V” build on “Chapter IV”? Name one link of cause and effect. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · 7.RC.3, 7.CC.2, 9-10.RC.3] Look for: A causal or structural link between this and the previous chapter.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Victor abandons his creation at the moment it reaches for him, so the creature's later violence begins in neglect. Useful evidence: “the beauty of the dream vanished, and breathless horror and disgust filled my heart” (Chapter V, paragraph 3): The turn from ambition to revulsion in one sentence. Theme link: the moment of birth is the moment of abandonment. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

7. What can we infer about a character's motives from what they say and do here, as opposed to what they claim? [DOK 3 · followUp · wait 8 s · 7.RC.3, 7.CC.2, 9-10.RC.1] Look for: An inference about motive supported by a quoted line.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Victor abandons his creation at the moment it reaches for him, so the creature's later violence begins in neglect. Useful evidence: “one hand was stretched out, seemingly to detain me, but I escaped” (Chapter V, paragraph 3): The creature's first gesture is reaching; Victor's response is flight. Key evidence that the creature is abandoned before it acts. On characterization: Victor flees twice, from the creature at his bed and from his responsibility, and calls it "the wretch." Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
8. The bell-ringer asked: “Was the creature's first gesture threatening or loving? Use evidence.” Now that we have read closely, how would you revise your first answer, and which line changed your mind? [DOK 2 · thinkPairShare · wait 5 s · 7.RC.2, 7.CC.2, 9-10.RC.2] Look for: A revised answer anchored in the text.
9. Where does irony appear, and how does it connect this chapter to the larger concern with the costs of unchecked ambition? [DOK 3 · followUp · wait 8 s · 7.RC.1, 7.CC.2, 9-10.RC.1] Look for: Look for gaps between what characters expect or say and what is true.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Victor abandons his creation at the moment it reaches for him, so the creature's later violence begins in neglect. Useful evidence: “It was on a dreary night of November, that I beheld the accomplishment of my toils” (Chapter V, paragraph 1): Pathetic fallacy and anticlimax: "accomplishment" is followed by horror. On irony: He chose the creature's features "as beautiful," yet the result is hideous; the dream becomes a nightmare. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
10. Background: Gothic novels used darkness, storms and nightmares to produce dread. The quoted lines from Coleridge's 'Ancient Mariner' reinforce Victor's guilt. How does knowing this change the way you read one moment in the chapter? [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · 7.RC.3, 7.CC.2, 9-10.RC.1] Look for: A specific moment reread in light of the context.
    Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Victor abandons his creation at the moment it reaches for him, so the creature's later violence begins in neglect. Useful evidence: “the beauty of the dream vanished, and breathless horror and disgust filled my heart” (Chapter V, paragraph 3): The turn from ambition to revulsion in one sentence. Theme link: the moment of birth is the moment of abandonment. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

Evaluative / synthesis / creative

1. A critic might argue: “The irony is sharp: the being Victor labored to make is abandoned within minutes. The creature's outstretched hand may be a gesture of affection that Victor reads as threat.” How far do you agree? Take a stand and defend it with two lines from the chapter. [DOK 3 · fourCorners · wait 8 s · 7.RC.2, 7.CC.3, 9-10.RC.2] Look for: A defended position with evidence and one counterpoint.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Victor abandons his creation at the moment it reaches for him, so the creature's later violence begins in neglect. Useful evidence: “one hand was stretched out, seemingly to detain me, but I escaped” (Chapter V, paragraph 3): The creature's first gesture is reaching; Victor's response is flight. Key evidence that the creature is abandoned before it acts. Theme link: the

moment of birth is the moment of abandonment. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

2. Which character in this chapter acts most wisely, and which least? Judge them by a standard you name. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · 7.RC.3, 7.CC.3, 9-10.RC.1] Look for: An evaluation using an explicit criterion and evidence.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Victor abandons his creation at the moment it reaches for him, so the creature's later violence begins in neglect. Useful evidence: “It was on a dreary night of November, that I beheld the accomplishment of my toils” (Chapter V, paragraph 1): Pathetic fallacy and anticlimax: "accomplishment" is followed by horror. On characterization: Victor flees twice, from the creature at his bed and from his responsibility, and calls it "the wretch." Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

3. Rewrite one moment of “Chapter V” from the point of view of a different character. What does the new angle reveal or hide about horror at the moment of creation? [DOK 4 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · 7.RC.1, 7.CC.3, 9-10.RC.1] Look for: A creative product with a rationale tied to the text.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Victor abandons his creation at the moment it reaches for him, so the creature's later violence begins in neglect. Useful evidence: “the beauty of the dream vanished, and breathless horror and disgust filled my heart” (Chapter V, paragraph 3): The turn from ambition to revulsion in one sentence. Theme link: the moment of birth is the moment of abandonment. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

4. Write three questions of your own about “Chapter V”: one recall, one “why/how”, and one “should/what if”. Trade with a partner and answer theirs. [DOK 3 · studentGenerated · wait 8 s · 7.RC.2, 7.CC.3, 9-10.RC.2] Look for: Student-generated questions at three levels.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Victor abandons his creation at the moment it reaches for him, so the creature's later violence begins in neglect. Useful evidence: “one hand was stretched out, seemingly to detain me, but I escaped” (Chapter V, paragraph 3): The creature's first gesture is reaching; Victor's response is flight. Key evidence that the creature is abandoned before it acts. Theme link: the moment of birth is the moment of abandonment. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

5. Connect this chapter to creation and responsibility: is the link strong or weak so far? What would Shelley need to show next to strengthen it? [DOK 4 · socraticCircle · wait 8 s · 7.RC.2, 7.CC.3, 9-10.RC.2] Look for: A judgment of thematic development across the work.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Victor abandons his creation at the moment it reaches for him, so the creature's later violence begins in neglect. Useful evidence: “It was on a dreary night of November, that I beheld the accomplishment of my toils” (Chapter V, paragraph 1): Pathetic fallacy and anticlimax: "accomplishment" is followed by horror. Theme link: the moment of birth is the moment of abandonment. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

6. Is the imagery in this chapter effective, or does it feel heavy-handed? Evaluate it as a reader would in a review. [DOK 3 · fourCorners · wait 8 s · 7.RC.12, 7.CC.3, 9-10.RC.12] Look for: An evaluative judgment with criteria and evidence.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Victor abandons his creation at the moment it reaches for him, so the creature's later violence begins in neglect. Useful evidence: “the beauty of the dream

vanished, and breathless horror and disgust filled my heart” (Chapter V, paragraph 3): The turn from ambition to revulsion in one sentence. On imagery: The creation scene: a dreary night, rain, a dying candle, a "dull yellow eye." The details are few and precise, so the horror is in the response, not the science. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

7. Compare how “Chapter V” treats horror at the moment of creation with how another text, film or event you know treats a similar idea. What does Frankenstein see that the other misses? [DOK 4 · socraticCircle · wait 8 s · 7.RC.2, 7.CC.3, 9-10.RC.2] Look for: A cross-text synthesis.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Victor abandons his creation at the moment it reaches for him, so the creature's later violence begins in neglect. Useful evidence: “one hand was stretched out, seemingly to detain me, but I escaped” (Chapter V, paragraph 3): The creature's first gesture is reaching; Victor's response is flight. Key evidence that the creature is abandoned before it acts. Theme link: the moment of birth is the moment of abandonment. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

8. Predict what “Chapter VI” will bring, using two clues from this chapter. After reading, evaluate your prediction. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · 7.RC.3, 7.CC.3, 9-10.RC.3] Look for: A prediction or judgment justified with textual clues.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Victor abandons his creation at the moment it reaches for him, so the creature's later violence begins in neglect. Useful evidence: “It was on a dreary night of November, that I beheld the accomplishment of my toils” (Chapter V, paragraph 1): Pathetic fallacy and anticlimax: "accomplishment" is followed by horror. Theme link: the moment of birth is the moment of abandonment. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

9. Design a one-paragraph modern adaptation of this chapter (setting, characters, conflict). What must stay the same for it to still be about horror at the moment of creation? [DOK 4 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · 7.RC.2, 7.CC.3, 9-10.RC.2] Look for: A creative transfer that keeps the core idea.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Victor abandons his creation at the moment it reaches for him, so the creature's later violence begins in neglect. Useful evidence: “the beauty of the dream vanished, and breathless horror and disgust filled my heart” (Chapter V, paragraph 3): The turn from ambition to revulsion in one sentence. Theme link: the moment of birth is the moment of abandonment. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

10. What question would you most like to ask Mary Shelley about this chapter, and what answer do you think the text itself gives? [DOK 4 · studentGenerated · wait 8 s · 7.RC.2, 7.CC.3, 9-10.RC.2] Look for: A student-generated question answered from evidence.

    Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Victor abandons his creation at the moment it reaches for him, so the creature's later violence begins in neglect. Useful evidence: “one hand was stretched out, seemingly to detain me, but I escaped” (Chapter V, paragraph 3): The creature's first gesture is reaching; Victor's response is flight. Key evidence that the creature is abandoned before it acts. Theme link: the moment of birth is the moment of abandonment. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

Annotation focus

- **Imagery:** look for sensory details (sight, sound, cold, light) and what mood they create (anchor passage in the We do segment)
- Also notice **Tone / mood**: word choices that reveal the narrator's attitude or the scene's feeling
- Also notice **Irony**: gaps between what characters expect or say and what is true

Chapter quiz: item bank (all eleven rigor versions)

1. [fill · recall · DOK 1] Complete the quotation from Chapter V, paragraph 1: “It was on a dreary night of November, that I beheld the _____ of my toils”
   Key: accomplishment
2. [fill · recall · DOK 1] Complete the quotation from Chapter V, paragraph 3: “the beauty of the dream vanished, and _____ horror and disgust filled my heart”
   Key: breathless
3. [mc · recall · DOK 1] In the line “I had worked hard for nearly two years, for the sole purpose of infusing life into an inanimate body.”, what does “infusing” most nearly mean?
   A. without paths; untraveled
   B. take the first step or steps in carrying out an action
   C. putting a quality or feeling into something
   D. the branch of the biological sciences dealing with the functioning of organisms
   Key: C (putting a quality or feeling into something)
4. [fill · recall · DOK 1] Fill in the blank with the vocabulary word that fits: “But I was in reality very ill; and surely nothing but the _____ and unremitting attentions of my friend could have restored me to life.” Word bank: agitates, palpitated, infusing, unbounded
   Key: unbounded
5. [mc · recall · DOK 1] Who arrives in Ingolstadt and nurses Victor?
   A. Alphonse
   B. Henry Clerval
   C. Walton
   D. Elizabeth
   Key: B (Henry Clerval)
6. [fill · recall · DOK 1] Complete the quotation from Chapter V, paragraph 3: “one hand was _____ out, seemingly to detain me, but I escaped”
   Key: stretched
7. [mc · recall · DOK 1] In the line ““Compose yourself,” said Clerval, who observed my change of colour, “I will not mention it, if it agitates you; but your father and cousin would be very happy if they received a letter from you in your own handwriting.”, what does “agitates” most nearly mean?
   A. upsets; disturbs
   B. turn on or around an axis or a center
   C. gathered or collected a large amount of
   D. varied in color or appearance

Key: A (upsets; disturbs)

8. [fill · recall · DOK 1] Fill in the blank with the vocabulary word that fits: “It was a divine spring; and the season contributed greatly to my _____.” Word bank: convalescence, palpitated, infusing, agitates

   Key: convalescence

9. [fill · recall · DOK 1] Fill in the blank with the vocabulary word that fits: ““My dear Frankenstein,” exclaimed he, “how glad I am to see you! how fortunate that you should be here at the very moment of my _____!”” Word bank: infusing, alighting, agitates, palpitated

   Key: alighting

10. [mc · inference · DOK 2] What does this passage most clearly show? “It was on a dreary night of November, that I beheld the accomplishment of my toils” (Chapter V, paragraph 1)

    A. Self-blame.

    B. Blunt, short sentence in the father's letter.

    C. Pathetic fallacy and anticlimax: "accomplishment" is followed by horror.

    D. The serpent alludes to Eden: knowledge as temptation and fall. Strong for a theme claim.

    Key: C (Pathetic fallacy and anticlimax: "accomplishment" is followed by horror.)

11. [short · inference · DOK 2] What can you infer from this line? “the beauty of the dream vanished, and breathless horror and disgust filled my heart” (Chapter V, paragraph 3) Answer in two or three sentences with one detail.

    Sample answer: The turn from ambition to revulsion in one sentence.

12. [mc · inference · DOK 2] What does this passage most clearly show? “one hand was stretched out, seemingly to detain me, but I escaped” (Chapter V, paragraph 3)

    A. Physical collapse.

    B. The creature's first gesture is reaching; Victor's response is flight. Key evidence that the creature is abandoned before it acts.

    C. The creature's longing for release.

    D. Total despair; in the next chapter it becomes a vow of revenge.

    Key: B (The creature's first gesture is reaching; Victor's response is flight. Key evidence that the creature is abandoned before it acts.)

13. [mc · inference · DOK 2] What does this passage most clearly show? “the beauty of the dream vanished, and breathless horror and disgust filled my heart” (Chapter V, paragraph 3)

    A. Physical collapse.

    B. The creature will ask for exactly this. Evidence that the need for companionship is universal in the novel.

    C. Waldman's contrast between old and modern science.

    D. The turn from ambition to revulsion in one sentence.

    Key: D (The turn from ambition to revulsion in one sentence.)

14. [mc · analysis · DOK 3] In this chapter, which theme does the following most directly develop? The moment of birth is the moment of abandonment.

    A. The costs of unchecked ambition

    B. Creation and responsibility

    C. Nature versus nurture

D. Isolation and the need for companionship

Key: B (Creation and responsibility)

15. [mc · analysis · DOK 3] Which literary element does this describe in “Chapter V”? He chose the creature's features "as beautiful," yet the result is hideous; the dream becomes a nightmare.

    A. Hyperbole

    B. Imagery

    C. Irony

    D. Setting

    Key: C (Irony)

16. [short · synthesis · DOK 4] Synthesis: trace how creation and responsibility develops from an earlier chapter to “Chapter V”. Use one quotation from each.

    Sample answer: the moment of birth is the moment of abandonment.

17. [mc · recall · DOK 1] What does Victor dream after fleeing?

    A. He is crowned king

    B. He is drowning

    C. Elizabeth turns into his dead mother's corpse

    D. He sails north

    Key: C (Elizabeth turns into his dead mother's corpse)

18. [mc · recall · DOK 1] What first feature of the creature does Victor describe?

    A. Its dull yellow eye

    B. Its voice

    C. Its hands

    D. Its smile

    Key: A (Its dull yellow eye)

19. [mc · recall · DOK 1] What is ironic about this chapter?

    A. Victor abandons the being he worked years to create

    B. Victor is happy

    C. The creature is tiny

    D. Clerval is a scientist

    Key: A (Victor abandons the being he worked years to create)

20. [mc · recall · DOK 1] In the line “By very slow degrees, and with frequent relapses, that alarmed and grieved my friend, I recovered.”, what does “relapses” most nearly mean?

    A. returns of an illness after improvement

    B. not engaged in a gainful occupation

    C. focused; concentrated (British spelling)

    D. only slightly; poorly

    Key: A (returns of an illness after improvement)

21. [fill · recall · DOK 1] Fill in the blank with the vocabulary word that fits: “At length _____ succeeded to the tumult I had before endured; and I threw myself on the bed in my clothes, endeavouring to seek a few

moments of forgetfulness.” Word bank: agitates, lassitude, palpitated, infusing

Key: lassitude

22. [mc · inference · DOK 2] Which choice best states a central concern of “Chapter V”?

    A. Recovery and false peace

    B. The wedding night and its catastrophe

    C. Horror at the moment of creation

    D. Loneliness and the desire for a friend

    Key: C (Horror at the moment of creation)

23. [short · analysis · DOK 3] Claim: Victor abandons his creation at the moment it reaches for him, so the creature's later violence begins in neglect. Explain how this evidence supports the claim: “one hand was stretched out, seemingly to detain me, but I escaped” (Chapter V, paragraph 3).

    Sample answer: The creature's "hand was stretched out, seemingly to detain me," a gesture of need, and Victor simply "escaped"; the word "seemingly" shows he does not know what it wants and does not stay to find out.

24. [mc · analysis · DOK 3] Which literary element does this describe in “Chapter V”? The creation scene: a dreary night, rain, a dying candle, a "dull yellow eye." The details are few and precise, so the horror is in the response, not the science.

    A. Imagery

    B. Metaphor

    C. Alliteration

    D. Diction / vocabulary

    Key: A (Imagery)

25. [short · synthesis · DOK 4] Close reading: how do the diction and syntax of “the beauty of the dream vanished, and breathless horror and disgust filled my heart” (Chapter V, paragraph 3) shape its meaning? Consider a second, competing reading.

    Sample answer: The turn from ambition to revulsion in one sentence.

26. [short · inference · DOK 2] What can you infer from this line? “It was on a dreary night of November, that I beheld the accomplishment of my toils” (Chapter V, paragraph 1) Answer in two or three sentences with one detail.

    Sample answer: Pathetic fallacy and anticlimax: "accomplishment" is followed by horror.

27. [short · synthesis · DOK 4] Close reading: how do the diction and syntax of “It was on a dreary night of November, that I beheld the accomplishment of my toils” (Chapter V, paragraph 1) shape its meaning? Consider a second, competing reading.

    Sample answer: Pathetic fallacy and anticlimax: "accomplishment" is followed by horror.

28. [mc · recall · DOK 1] What month does the creature come to life?

    A. December

    B. March

    C. November

    D. June

    Key: C (November)

29. [short · analysis · DOK 3] Analyze the word choice in “one hand was stretched out, seemingly to detain me, but I escaped” (Chapter V, paragraph 3). Pick two words and explain what they suggest.

Sample answer: The creature's first gesture is reaching; Victor's response is flight. Key evidence that the creature is abandoned before it acts.

30. [short · synthesis · DOK 4] Evaluate this claim about the chapter: “Victor abandons his creation at the moment it reaches for him, so the creature's later violence begins in neglect.” Is it fully persuasive? Argue with evidence, including a passage that complicates it.
    Sample answer: The creature's "hand was stretched out, seemingly to detain me," a gesture of need, and Victor simply "escaped"; the word "seemingly" shows he does not know what it wants and does not stay to find out.

Rigor version	Items (in order)	Mix
Middle School	1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 6, 7, 8, 9, 10, 11, 12, 13, 14, 15, 16	recall 9, inference 4, analysis 2, synthesis 1
HS Freshman	17, 18, 19, 20, 21, 6, 3, 9, 11, 22, 13, 10, 23, 24, 14, 25	recall 8, inference 4, analysis 3, synthesis 1
HS Sophomore	20, 21, 19, 1, 8, 18, 22, 10, 13, 11, 26, 23, 24, 14, 27, 16	recall 6, inference 5, analysis 3, synthesis 2
HS Junior	21, 2, 17, 18, 28, 22, 11, 26, 10, 13, 14, 29, 23, 24, 25, 16	recall 5, inference 5, analysis 4, synthesis 2
HS Senior	21, 3, 5, 6, 22, 13, 12, 10, 26, 23, 24, 14, 15, 25, 30, 16	recall 4, inference 5, analysis 4, synthesis 3
AP	19, 9, 2, 12, 13, 26, 10, 24, 15, 23, 14, 29, 16, 30, 27, 25	recall 3, inference 4, analysis 5, synthesis 4
College Freshman	21, 1, 7, 10, 26, 22, 13, 24, 14, 15, 29, 23, 30, 16, 25, 27	recall 3, inference 4, analysis 5, synthesis 4
College Sophomore	21, 8, 11, 26, 13, 12, 10, 29, 15, 23, 24, 14, 30, 27, 25, 16	recall 2, inference 5, analysis 5, synthesis 4
College Junior	9, 21, 11, 12, 22, 26, 10, 15, 29, 23, 14, 24, 30, 25, 27, 16	recall 2, inference 5, analysis 5, synthesis 4
College Senior	21, 8, 26, 22, 10, 11, 12, 14, 23, 29, 24, 15, 16, 25, 27, 30	recall 2, inference 5, analysis 5, synthesis 4
Graduate / PhD	1, 21, 11, 12, 13, 26, 10, 24, 29, 23, 15, 14, 27, 30, 25, 16	recall 2, inference 5, analysis 5, synthesis 4

Writing prompts (eleven rigor levels)

Middle School (250 words; Indiana 2023: 7.RC.12, 7.W.1): Supported track (work from the passage your teacher selects). In “Chapter V,” how does Shelley show horror at the moment of creation? Write a paragraph that states your claim, quotes two details from the passage, and explains how each detail supports your idea. Use the imagery you noticed as one piece of evidence.

HS Freshman (350 words; Indiana 2023: 9-10.RC.12, 9-10.W.1): In Chapter V, how does Shelley develop the idea of horror at the moment of creation? State a clear claim, support it with two or three quotations, and explain how the imagery in the chapter helps build that idea.

HS Sophomore (450 words; Indiana 2023: 9-10.RC.12, 9-10.W.1): Analyze how Chapter V develops the idea of horror at the moment of creation. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of imagery and tone / mood shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.

HS Junior (550 words; Indiana 2023: 11-12.RC.3, 11-12.RC.1, 11-12.W.1): Analyze how the structure of Chapter V (where it begins, turns and ends) and its imagery shape the reader's understanding of horror at the moment of creation. Identify one place where the text leaves matters uncertain and explain how that uncertainty adds to its meaning.

HS Senior (600 words; Indiana 2023: 11-12.RC.13, 11-12.W.1): Two readers disagree about what Chapter V suggests about horror at the moment of creation. Lay out two plausible interpretations, weigh the evidence for each (including the chapter's imagery and tone / mood), and argue for the stronger one in a sustained, well-organized essay.

AP (650 words; Indiana 2023: 11-12.RC.13, 11-12.W.1): Write a literary argument in which you analyze how Mary Shelley uses imagery in Chapter V to complicate the reader's understanding of horror at the moment of creation. Develop a defensible thesis, select evidence purposefully, and explain how specific choices of diction and syntax create meaning.

College Freshman (1000 words; Indiana 2023: see unit standards): Situate Chapter V within its historical and literary context and argue how the chapter's treatment of horror at the moment of creation responds to that context. Engage with at least one secondary perspective (a critic, historian or the author's own statements), integrate quotations smoothly, and cite in MLA style.

College Sophomore (1250 words; Indiana 2023: see unit standards): Read Chapter V alongside the conventions of its genre and period. Argue how the chapter's handling of horror at the moment of creation follows or bends those conventions, using the imagery as evidence, and test your reading against one published critic. Document two secondary sources in MLA.

College Junior (1500 words; Indiana 2023: see unit standards): Apply a named critical approach (for example formalist, historicist, feminist, psychoanalytic or ecocritical) to Chapter V and its treatment of horror at the moment of creation. State your method, show what it reveals in the chapter's imagery and tone / mood, and identify where the text resists it.

College Senior (2000 words; Indiana 2023: see unit standards): Develop a research argument that reads Chapter V as evidence for a larger claim about horror at the moment of creation in Frankenstein. Connect close reading of the chapter to the whole novel, engage at least four scholarly sources, and state precisely where your reading departs from theirs (Chicago style).

Graduate / PhD (2500 words; Indiana 2023: see unit standards): Develop an original argument that reads Chapter V as a hinge in the novel's larger treatment of horror at the moment of creation. Position your reading within a named critical conversation (for example formalist, historicist, psychoanalytic, feminist or postcolonial approaches), account for the textual history where relevant, and articulate the stakes of your intervention for scholarship on Frankenstein.

SAT-style questions

1. *I had worked hard for nearly two years, for the sole purpose of infusing life into an inanimate body.*

   As used in the text, what does the word "infusing" most nearly mean?

   A. a feeling of extreme emotional intensity
   B. seemingly boundless in amount, number, degree, or especially extent
   C. a room used primarily for sleeping
   D. putting a quality or feeling into something

2. *I continued walking in this manner for some time, endeavouring, by bodily exercise, to ease the load that weighed upon my mind. I traversed the streets, without any clear conception of where I was, or what I was doing. My heart palpitated in the sickness of fear; and I hurried on with irregular steps, not daring to look about me:—*

   Which choice best states a central concern of "Chapter V"?

   A. Horror at the moment of creation
   B. Destroying the companion
   C. Despair and the sublime
   D. First experiences of the senses

SAT key: 1. D (putting a quality or feeling into something); 2. A (Horror at the moment of creation)

Lesson 13: Chapter VI

Focus: recovery and false peace

Objective: Students will analyze how setting develops in “Chapter VI” by writing a claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph that cites at least 2 quotations from the section, and will score at least 80% on the section quiz.

Standards: CCSS RL.9-10.3, W.9-10.1, L.9-10.4 · IN 9-10.RC.1, 9-10.W.1, 9-10.RC.9, 9-10.RC.11

Teacher only · spoilers

Recovering, Victor reads a letter from Elizabeth telling of home and of Justine Moritz, a servant girl who became part of the family. Victor now hates natural philosophy. He and Clerval study languages and take a restorative walking tour.

Background: Romantic writers believed nature could heal the mind, a theme in Wordsworth's poetry.

Significance: The calm before tragedy: Justine's introduction sets up her later fate.

Lesson plan and lecture script (90 minutes)

0–8 min · Bell-ringer · You do (8 min)
Students write to the bell-ringer, then pair-share.
Why does Shelley introduce Justine through a cheerful letter? Write for five minutes. Starters: I think... because... / This connects to isolation and companionship because....
Prompt: Why does Shelley introduce Justine through a cheerful letter?
Sentence starters: I think… because… · This connects to isolation and companionship because…
Strong response: A strong response takes a position and anticipates this: Clerval shows what companionship gives: Victor says a selfish pursuit had "cramped and narrowed" him.

8–18 min · Vocabulary with etymology notes · I do (10 min)
Five key words in context, with verified word histories.
Today's words: salubrious — healthy; good for the body; congratulatory — expressing congratulations; encomiums — speeches or remarks of high praise; vacillating — be undecided about something; waver between conflicting positions or courses of action; devolved — fallen as a duty (on someone). “salubrious”: From Latin salūbris "healthy" ous. “encomiums”: From Latin encōmium "praise, eulogy", from Ancient Greek ἐγκώμιον *"laudatory ode, praise", from* ἐγκώμιος *"of or pertaining to the victor", from* κῶμος *"festival, revel, ode". “vacillating”: From Latin vacillātum, supine form of vacillō "sway, waver". By surface analysis, la:vacillō + -ate.*
Words: salubrious: healthy; good for the body · congratulatory: expressing congratulations · encomiums: speeches or remarks of high praise · vacillating: be undecided about something; waver between conflicting positions or courses of action · devolved: fallen as a duty (on someone)

18–28 min · Background and context · I do (10 min)
Mini-lecture (read or adapt the script).
Romantic writers believed nature could heal the mind, a theme in Wordsworth's poetry. The calm before tragedy: Justine's introduction sets up her later fate. Characterization: Clerval arrives and nurses Victor through months of fever: friendship as care, the opposite of Victor's conduct. Irony: Victor recovers into a "false peace" while the creature is out in the world, unseen. Setting: Spring and nature restore him; Shelley uses nature as healer. Watch for light and fire: Light stands for knowledge and fire for its double edge: warmth and burning. Victor seeks the "light" of discovery; the creature discovers fire and is burned by it. In this chapter: "read their writings, life appears to consist in a warm sun and a garden of roses—in the smiles and frowns of a" (Chapter VI, paragraph 18).

28–40 min · I do: modeled close reading · I do (12 min)
Model the close reading of the anchor quotation using the written think-aloud below.
I read the line once for meaning and once for craft. "I became the same happy creature who, a few years ago, loved and beloved by all, had no sorrow or care" (Chapter VI, paragraph 21). Restoration that the reader suspects cannot last. That is characterization at work: Clerval arrives and nurses Victor through months of fever: friendship as care, the opposite of Victor's conduct.

> *I became the same happy creature who, a few years ago, loved and beloved by all, had no sorrow or care (Chapter VI, paragraph 21)*

Think-aloud: I read the line once for meaning and once for craft. "I became the same happy creature who, a few years ago, loved and beloved by all, had no sorrow or care" (Chapter VI, paragraph 21). Restoration that the reader suspects cannot last. That is characterization at work: Clerval arrives and nurses Victor through months of fever: friendship as care, the opposite of Victor's conduct.

40–55 min · We do: guided annotation · We do (15 min)
Guided analysis of a second quotation; expected answers given.
Ask: What words in this line stand out, and what do they suggest? Expected: "Cramped and narrowed" versus "warmed and opened": the contrast shows isolation shrinking a person and friendship restoring him, the theme of companionship. Ask: How does this line connect to isolation and companionship? Expected: Clerval shows what companionship gives: Victor says a selfish pursuit had "cramped and narrowed" him. (Victor names his work "selfish": a rare admission and strong evidence.)

> *A selfish pursuit had cramped and narrowed me, until your gentleness and affection warmed and opened my senses (Chapter VI, paragraph 21)*

Ask: What words in this line stand out, and what do they suggest?
Expected answer: "Cramped and narrowed" versus "warmed and opened": the contrast shows isolation shrinking a person and friendship restoring him, the theme of companionship.
Ask: How does this line connect to isolation and companionship?
Expected answer: Clerval shows what companionship gives: Victor says a selfish pursuit had "cramped and narrowed" him. (Victor names his work "selfish": a rare admission and strong evidence.)

55–70 min · You do: independent annotation · You do (15 min)
Independent annotation and a claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph (exemplar given).
Annotate the chapter for characterization, irony (three marks with a margin note each), then write one claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph: what does this chapter suggest about recovery and false peace? Then start your writing prompt at your assigned level (HS Sophomore: Analyze how Chapter VI develops the idea of recovery and false peace. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of setting and tone / mood shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.) Exemplar: Clerval's nursing shows the care the novel values, and it highlights Victor's failure to give it. When the text says "A selfish pursuit had cramped and narrowed me, until your gentleness and affection warmed and opened my senses" (Chapter VI, paragraph 21), it shows this directly. Victor credits Clerval's "gentleness and affection" for curing what a "selfish pursuit" had done, so he knows what care is; he has simply not given it to his creation.
Task: Annotate the chapter for characterization, irony (three marks with a margin note each), then write one claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph: what does this chapter suggest about recovery and false peace? Then start your writing prompt at your assigned level (HS Sophomore: Analyze how Chapter VI develops the idea of recovery and false peace. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of setting and tone / mood shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.)
Exemplar: Clerval's nursing shows the care the novel values, and it highlights Victor's failure to give it. When the text says "A selfish pursuit had cramped and narrowed me, until your gentleness and affection warmed and opened my senses" (Chapter VI, paragraph 21), it shows this directly. Victor credits Clerval's "gentleness and affection" for curing what a "selfish pursuit" had done, so he knows what care is; he has simply not given it to his creation.

70–80 min · Discussion · We do (10 min)
Structured discussion from the 30 tiered questions, with facilitation notes.
Anchor question: Why does Shelley introduce Justine through a cheerful letter? Ask: what is Victor not telling Clerval, and why?
Anchor question: Why does Shelley introduce Justine through a cheerful letter?
Facilitation: Ask: what is Victor not telling Clerval, and why?

80–87 min · Exit ticket / chapter quiz · You do (7 min)
Chapter quiz in the app and an exit ticket (answer given).
Chapter quiz in the app, then: In one sentence, what does this chapter suggest about recovery and false peace? Support it with one short quotation. Model answer: Clerval's nursing shows the care the novel values, and it highlights Victor's failure to give it. ("A selfish pursuit had cramped and narrowed me, until your gentleness and affection warmed and opened my senses", Chapter VI, paragraph 21). Accept any defensible claim backed by a quotation from the chapter; the answer key for the quiz is in the Quiz section.
Exit ticket: In one sentence, what does this chapter suggest about recovery and false peace? Support it with one short quotation.
Answer: Model answer: Clerval's nursing shows the care the novel values, and it highlights Victor's failure to give it. ("A selfish pursuit had cramped and narrowed me, until your gentleness and affection warmed and opened my senses", Chapter VI, paragraph 21). Accept any defensible claim backed by a quotation from the chapter; the answer key for the quiz is in the Quiz section.

> **87–90 min · Closure · I do (3 min)**
> Summarize the lesson and preview the next reading.
> *Today we saw how characterization shapes recovery and false peace. Key takeaway: Clerval shows what companionship gives: Victor says a selfish pursuit had "cramped and narrowed" him.*

Total: 90 minutes.

Teacher analysis (spoilers)

Literary elements

- **Characterization:** Clerval arrives and nurses Victor through months of fever: friendship as care, the opposite of Victor's conduct.
- **Irony:** Victor recovers into a "false peace" while the creature is out in the world, unseen.
- **Setting:** Spring and nature restore him; Shelley uses nature as healer.

Themes and how they develop

- **isolation and companionship:** Clerval shows what companionship gives: Victor says a selfish pursuit had "cramped and narrowed" him.

Symbols and motifs

- **light and fire:** Light stands for knowledge and fire for its double edge: warmth and burning. Victor seeks the "light" of discovery; the creature discovers fire and is burned by it. In this chapter: “read their writings, life appears to consist in a warm sun and a garden of roses—in the smiles and frowns of a” (Chapter VI, paragraph 18).
- **sublime nature:** Mountains, glaciers, storms and lakes reflect and sometimes soothe the characters' feelings; the sublime is both comfort and terror. In this chapter: “the open air, climbing the hills or rowing on the lake. I fear that he will become an idler, unless we yield” (Chapter VI, paragraph 4).

Key quotations (checked against the reading text)

- “A selfish pursuit had cramped and narrowed me, until your gentleness and affection warmed and opened my senses” (Chapter VI, paragraph 21) Victor names his work "selfish": a rare admission and strong evidence.
- “I became the same happy creature who, a few years ago, loved and beloved by all, had no sorrow or care” (Chapter VI, paragraph 21) Restoration that the reader suspects cannot last.
- “dear Victor” (Chapter VI, paragraph 3) Elizabeth's letter opens with domestic affection, recalling the Preface's stated aim.

Model claim-evidence-reasoning

Claim: Clerval's nursing shows the care the novel values, and it highlights Victor's failure to give it.
Evidence: “A selfish pursuit had cramped and narrowed me, until your gentleness and affection warmed and opened my senses” (Chapter VI, paragraph 21)

Reasoning: Victor credits Clerval's "gentleness and affection" for curing what a "selfish pursuit" had done, so he knows what care is; he has simply not given it to his creation.

Vocabulary with etymology notes

Word	Definition (in this sentence)	In context	Word history
salubrious (adjective)	healthy; good for the body	*We passed a fortnight in these perambulations: my health and spirits had long been restored, and they gained additional strength from the salubrious air I breathed, the natural incidents of our progress, and the conversation of my friend.*	"salubrious": From Latin salūbris "healthy" ous. (Wiktionary, https://en.wiktionary.org/wiki/salubrious#Etymology)
congratulatory (adjective)	expressing congratulations	*The pretty Miss Mansfield has already received the congratulatory visits on her approaching marriage with a young Englishman, John Melbourne, Esq.*	
encomiums (noun)	speeches or remarks of high praise	*Krempe was not equally docile; and in my condition at that time, of almost insupportable sensitiveness, his harsh blunt encomiums gave me even more pain than the benevolent approbation of M.*	"encomiums": From Latin encōmium "praise, eulogy", from Ancient Greek ἐγκώμιον "laudatory ode, praise", from ἐγκώμιος "of or pertaining to the victor", from κῶμος "festival, revel, ode". (Wiktionary, https://en.wiktionary.org/wiki/encomium#Etymology)
vacillating (verb)	be undecided about something; waver between conflicting positions or courses of action	*The poor woman was very vacillating in her repentance.*	"vacillating": From Latin vacillātum, supine form of vacillō "sway, waver". By surface analysis, la:vacillō + -ate. (Wiktionary, https://en.wiktionary.org/wiki/vacillate#Etymology)
devolved (verb)	fallen as a duty (on someone)	*I figure to myself that the task of attending on your sick bed has devolved on some mercenary old nurse, who could never guess your wishes, nor minister to them with the care and affection of your poor cousin.*	

dialects (noun)	the usage or vocabulary that is characteristic of a specific group of people	*I did not, like him, attempt a critical knowledge of their dialects, for I did not contemplate making any other use of them than temporary amusement.*	
alleging (verb)	giving as a reason	*Clerval, whose eyes and feelings were always quick in discerning the sensations of others, declined the subject, alleging, in excuse, his total ignorance; and the conversation took a more general turn.*	“alleging”: From Middle English aleggen, perhaps from Old French alleguer, or from Anglo-Norman aleger, the form perhaps from Old French esligier "to acquit", from Medieval Latin *exlītigāre "to clear at law", from Latin ex "out" + līt̆igō "sue at law", but the meaning from Old French alleguer, from Latin allēgāre "send on a mission, depute; relate, mention, adduce", from ad "to" + lēgō "send". See also al-#Et (Wiktionary, https://en.wiktionary.org/wiki/allege#Etymology)
dimples (noun)	small hollows in the cheeks, seen when smiling	*When he smiles, two little dimples appear on each cheek, which are rosy with health.*	
retarded (verb)	cause to move more slowly or operate at a slower rate	*Summer passed away in these occupations, and my return to Geneva was fixed for the latter end of autumn; but being delayed by several accidents, winter and snow arrived, the roads were deemed impassable, and my journey was retarded until the ensuing spring.*	
diffident (adjective)	showing modest reserve	*Young men should be diffident of themselves, you know, M.*	

Discussion questions

1. Why does Shelley introduce Justine through a cheerful letter?
2. Where does setting appear in this chapter, and what effect does it have? Point to one passage.
3. How does this chapter connect to the book's larger concern with creation and responsibility?

Classroom discussion questions (30, tiered)

Wait time after every question (3 s for DOK 1, 5 s for DOK 2, 8 to 10 s for DOK 3 and 4); think-pair-share on DOK 3 and 4; answer each response with a follow-up probe; close with student-generated questions. Focus sets by rigor level: Middle School: 1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 6, 11, 12, 13, 14, 21, 22; HS Freshman: 1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 12, 13, 14, 15, 22, 23, 24; HS Sophomore: 1, 2, 3, 4, 13, 14, 15, 16, 17, 23,

24, 25; HS Junior: 1, 2, 3, 14, 15, 16, 17, 18, 24, 25, 26, 27; HS Senior: 1, 2, 3, 15, 16, 17, 18, 25, 26, 27, 28, 29; AP: 1, 2, 16, 17, 18, 19, 20, 26, 27, 28, 29, 30; College Freshman: 1, 2, 17, 18, 19, 20, 21, 22, 27, 28, 29, 30; College Sophomore: 1, 2, 11, 18, 19, 20, 21, 22, 23, 28, 29, 30; College Junior: 1, 11, 12, 19, 20, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 29, 30; College Senior: 1, 11, 12, 13, 20, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 26, 30; Graduate / PhD: 1, 11, 12, 13, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 26, 27, 28

Literal / recall

1. Who writes to Victor during his recovery? [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · 7.RC.1, 7.CC.1, 9-10.RC.1] Look for: Elizabeth
2. Who is Justine Moritz? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · 7.RC.1, 7.CC.1, 9-10.RC.1] Look for: A girl who became a servant and part of the family
3. How does Victor now feel about natural philosophy? [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · 7.RC.1, 7.CC.1, 9-10.RC.1] Look for: He cannot bear it
4. What does Clerval study? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · 7.RC.1, 7.CC.1, 9-10.RC.1] Look for: Oriental languages
5. What restores Victor's spirits? [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · 7.RC.1, 7.CC.1, 9-10.RC.1] Look for: A walking tour in nature with Clerval
6. Retell the three most important events of "Chapter VI" in order, in one sentence each. [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · 7.RC.1, 7.CC.1, 9-10.RC.1] Look for: Recovering, Victor reads a letter from Elizabeth telling of home and of Justine Moritz, a servant girl who became part of the family. Victor now hates natural philosophy. He and Clerval study languages and take a restorative walking tour.
7. Which characters appear or are mentioned in "Chapter VI"? Name two and one thing each says or does. [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · 7.RC.1, 7.CC.1, 9-10.RC.1] Look for: Names and actions taken from the chapter; check against the teacher summary.
8. Where and when does "Chapter VI" take place? Point to the line that tells you. [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · 7.RC.1, 7.CC.1, 9-10.RC.1] Look for: A place/time detail quoted from the chapter.
9. Reread: "We passed a fortnight in these perambulations: my health and spirits had long been restored, and they gained additional strength from the salubrious air I breathed, the natural incidents of our progress, and the…" What does "salubrious" mean here, and what is literally happening in this line? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · 7.RC.1, 7.CC.1, 9-10.RC.1] Look for: salubrious: healthy; good for the body.
10. Reread: "The pretty Miss Mansfield has already received the congratulatory visits on her approaching marriage with a young Englishman, John Melbourne, Esq." What does "congratulatory" mean here, and what is literally happening in this line? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · 7.RC.1, 7.CC.1, 9-10.RC.1] Look for: congratulatory: expressing congratulations.

Inferential / analytical

1. What does "Chapter VI" suggest about recovery and false peace? State the inference and the line that supports it. [DOK 2 · thinkPairShare · wait 5 s · 7.RC.2, 7.CC.2, 9-10.RC.2] Look for: The calm before tragedy: Justine's introduction sets up her later fate.
2. Find one example of setting in this chapter. What does it reveal that a plain statement would not? [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · 7.RC.3, 7.CC.2, 9-10.RC.1] Look for: Look for where and when events happen and how place shapes action or feeling.
3. How does the tone / mood in this chapter shape what we understand about recovery and false peace? [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · 7.RC.12, 7.CC.2, 9-10.RC.12] Look for: Look for word choices that reveal the narrator's

attitude or the scene's feeling.

Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Clerval's nursing shows the care the novel values, and it highlights Victor's failure to give it. Useful evidence: “A selfish pursuit had cramped and narrowed me, until your gentleness and affection warmed and opened my senses” (Chapter VI, paragraph 21): Victor names his work "selfish": a rare admission and strong evidence. Theme link: Clerval shows what companionship gives: Victor says a selfish pursuit had "cramped and narrowed" him. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

4. In the passage that begins ““I must say also a few words to you, my dear cousin, of little darling William.”, why might Shelley have chosen these particular words? Pick two and explain their connotations. [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · 7.RC.12, 7.CC.2, 9-10.RC.12] Look for: Diction analysis of two words in the anchor passage.
5. What causes the main turn in “Chapter VI”, and what effect is it likely to have on what follows? [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · 7.RC.3, 7.CC.2, 9-10.RC.1] Look for: Recovering, Victor reads a letter from Elizabeth telling of home and of Justine Moritz, a servant girl who became part of the family. Victor now hates natural philosophy. He and Clerval study languages and take a restorative walking tour.
6. How does “Chapter VI” build on “Chapter V”? Name one link of cause and effect. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · 7.RC.3, 7.CC.2, 9-10.RC.3] Look for: A causal or structural link between this and the previous chapter.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Clerval's nursing shows the care the novel values, and it highlights Victor's failure to give it. Useful evidence: “I became the same happy creature who, a few years ago, loved and beloved by all, had no sorrow or care” (Chapter VI, paragraph 21): Restoration that the reader suspects cannot last. Theme link: Clerval shows what companionship gives: Victor says a selfish pursuit had "cramped and narrowed" him. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
7. What can we infer about a character's motives from what they say and do here, as opposed to what they claim? [DOK 3 · followUp · wait 8 s · 7.RC.3, 7.CC.2, 9-10.RC.1] Look for: An inference about motive supported by a quoted line.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Clerval's nursing shows the care the novel values, and it highlights Victor's failure to give it. Useful evidence: “dear Victor” (Chapter VI, paragraph 3): Elizabeth's letter opens with domestic affection, recalling the Preface's stated aim. On characterization: Clerval arrives and nurses Victor through months of fever: friendship as care, the opposite of Victor's conduct. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
8. The bell-ringer asked: “Why does Shelley introduce Justine through a cheerful letter?” Now that we have read closely, how would you revise your first answer, and which line changed your mind? [DOK 2 · thinkPairShare · wait 5 s · 7.RC.2, 7.CC.2, 9-10.RC.2] Look for: A revised answer anchored in the text.
9. Where does characterization appear, and how does it connect this chapter to the larger concern with creation and responsibility? [DOK 3 · followUp · wait 8 s · 7.RC.3, 7.CC.2, 9-10.RC.1] Look for: Look for what characters say, do and think, and how others react to them.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Clerval's nursing shows the care the novel values, and it highlights Victor's failure to give it. Useful evidence: “A selfish pursuit had cramped and narrowed me, until your gentleness and affection warmed and opened my senses” (Chapter VI, paragraph 21): Victor names his work "selfish": a rare admission and strong evidence. On characterization: Clerval arrives and nurses Victor through months of fever: friendship as care, the opposite of Victor's conduct. Credit any

position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

10. Background: Romantic writers believed nature could heal the mind, a theme in Wordsworth's poetry. How does knowing this change the way you read one moment in the chapter? [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · 7.RC.3, 7.CC.2, 9-10.RC.1] Look for: A specific moment reread in light of the context.
    Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Clerval's nursing shows the care the novel values, and it highlights Victor's failure to give it. Useful evidence: “I became the same happy creature who, a few years ago, loved and beloved by all, had no sorrow or care” (Chapter VI, paragraph 21): Restoration that the reader suspects cannot last. On setting: Spring and nature restore him; Shelley uses nature as healer. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

Evaluative / synthesis / creative

1. A critic might argue: “The calm before tragedy: Justine's introduction sets up her later fate.” How far do you agree? Take a stand and defend it with two lines from the chapter. [DOK 3 · fourCorners · wait 8 s · 7.RC.2, 7.CC.3, 9-10.RC.2] Look for: A defended position with evidence and one counterpoint.
    Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Clerval's nursing shows the care the novel values, and it highlights Victor's failure to give it. Useful evidence: “dear Victor” (Chapter VI, paragraph 3): Elizabeth's letter opens with domestic affection, recalling the Preface's stated aim. Theme link: Clerval shows what companionship gives: Victor says a selfish pursuit had "cramped and narrowed" him. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
2. Which character in this chapter acts most wisely, and which least? Judge them by a standard you name. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · 7.RC.3, 7.CC.3, 9-10.RC.1] Look for: An evaluation using an explicit criterion and evidence.
    Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Clerval's nursing shows the care the novel values, and it highlights Victor's failure to give it. Useful evidence: “A selfish pursuit had cramped and narrowed me, until your gentleness and affection warmed and opened my senses” (Chapter VI, paragraph 21): Victor names his work "selfish": a rare admission and strong evidence. On characterization: Clerval arrives and nurses Victor through months of fever: friendship as care, the opposite of Victor's conduct. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
3. Rewrite one moment of “Chapter VI” from the point of view of a different character. What does the new angle reveal or hide about recovery and false peace? [DOK 4 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · 7.RC.1, 7.CC.3, 9-10.RC.1] Look for: A creative product with a rationale tied to the text.
    Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Clerval's nursing shows the care the novel values, and it highlights Victor's failure to give it. Useful evidence: “I became the same happy creature who, a few years ago, loved and beloved by all, had no sorrow or care” (Chapter VI, paragraph 21): Restoration that the reader suspects cannot last. Theme link: Clerval shows what companionship gives: Victor says a selfish pursuit had "cramped and narrowed" him. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
4. Write three questions of your own about “Chapter VI”: one recall, one “why/how”, and one “should/what if”. Trade with a partner and answer theirs. [DOK 3 · studentGenerated · wait 8 s · 7.RC.2, 7.CC.3, 9-10.RC.2] Look

for: Student-generated questions at three levels.

Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Clerval's nursing shows the care the novel values, and it highlights Victor's failure to give it. Useful evidence: “dear Victor” (Chapter VI, paragraph 3): Elizabeth's letter opens with domestic affection, recalling the Preface's stated aim. Theme link: Clerval shows what companionship gives: Victor says a selfish pursuit had "cramped and narrowed" him. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

5. Connect this chapter to isolation and the need for companionship: is the link strong or weak so far? What would Shelley need to show next to strengthen it? [DOK 4 · socraticCircle · wait 8 s · 7.RC.2, 7.CC.3, 9-10.RC.2] Look for: A judgment of thematic development across the work.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Clerval's nursing shows the care the novel values, and it highlights Victor's failure to give it. Useful evidence: “A selfish pursuit had cramped and narrowed me, until your gentleness and affection warmed and opened my senses” (Chapter VI, paragraph 21): Victor names his work "selfish": a rare admission and strong evidence. Theme link: Clerval shows what companionship gives: Victor says a selfish pursuit had "cramped and narrowed" him. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

6. Is the setting in this chapter effective, or does it feel heavy-handed? Evaluate it as a reader would in a review. [DOK 3 · fourCorners · wait 8 s · 7.RC.3, 7.CC.3, 9-10.RC.1] Look for: An evaluative judgment with criteria and evidence.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Clerval's nursing shows the care the novel values, and it highlights Victor's failure to give it. Useful evidence: “I became the same happy creature who, a few years ago, loved and beloved by all, had no sorrow or care” (Chapter VI, paragraph 21): Restoration that the reader suspects cannot last. On setting: Spring and nature restore him; Shelley uses nature as healer. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

7. Compare how “Chapter VI” treats recovery and false peace with how another text, film or event you know treats a similar idea. What does Frankenstein see that the other misses? [DOK 4 · socraticCircle · wait 8 s · 7.RC.2, 7.CC.3, 9-10.RC.2] Look for: A cross-text synthesis.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Clerval's nursing shows the care the novel values, and it highlights Victor's failure to give it. Useful evidence: “dear Victor” (Chapter VI, paragraph 3): Elizabeth's letter opens with domestic affection, recalling the Preface's stated aim. Theme link: Clerval shows what companionship gives: Victor says a selfish pursuit had "cramped and narrowed" him. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

8. Predict what “Chapter VII” will bring, using two clues from this chapter. After reading, evaluate your prediction. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · 7.RC.3, 7.CC.3, 9-10.RC.3] Look for: A prediction or judgment justified with textual clues.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Clerval's nursing shows the care the novel values, and it highlights Victor's failure to give it. Useful evidence: “A selfish pursuit had cramped and narrowed me, until your gentleness and affection warmed and opened my senses” (Chapter VI, paragraph 21): Victor names his work "selfish": a rare admission and strong evidence. Theme link: Clerval shows what companionship gives: Victor says a selfish pursuit had "cramped and narrowed" him. Credit any position

that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

9. Design a one-paragraph modern adaptation of this chapter (setting, characters, conflict). What must stay the same for it to still be about recovery and false peace? [DOK 4 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · 7.RC.2, 7.CC.3, 9-10.RC.2] Look for: A creative transfer that keeps the core idea.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Clerval's nursing shows the care the novel values, and it highlights Victor's failure to give it. Useful evidence: “I became the same happy creature who, a few years ago, loved and beloved by all, had no sorrow or care” (Chapter VI, paragraph 21): Restoration that the reader suspects cannot last. Theme link: Clerval shows what companionship gives: Victor says a selfish pursuit had "cramped and narrowed" him. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

10. What question would you most like to ask Mary Shelley about this chapter, and what answer do you think the text itself gives? [DOK 4 · studentGenerated · wait 8 s · 7.RC.2, 7.CC.3, 9-10.RC.2] Look for: A student-generated question answered from evidence.

    Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Clerval's nursing shows the care the novel values, and it highlights Victor's failure to give it. Useful evidence: “dear Victor” (Chapter VI, paragraph 3): Elizabeth's letter opens with domestic affection, recalling the Preface's stated aim. Theme link: Clerval shows what companionship gives: Victor says a selfish pursuit had "cramped and narrowed" him. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

Annotation focus

- **Setting:** look for where and when events happen and how place shapes action or feeling (anchor passage in the We do segment)
- Also notice **Tone / mood**: word choices that reveal the narrator's attitude or the scene's feeling
- Also notice **Characterization**: what characters say, do and think, and how others react to them

Chapter quiz: item bank (all eleven rigor versions)

1. [fill · recall · DOK 1] Complete the quotation from Chapter VI, paragraph 21: “I became the same happy _____ who, a few years ago, loved and beloved by all, had no sorrow or care”
   Key: creature
2. [fill · recall · DOK 1] Fill in the blank with the vocabulary word that fits: “I did not, like him, attempt a critical knowledge of their _____, for I did not contemplate making any other use of them than temporary amusement.” Word bank: congratulatory, salubrious, dialects, encomiums
   Key: dialects
3. [fill · recall · DOK 1] Fill in the blank with the vocabulary word that fits: “Clerval, whose eyes and feelings were always quick in discerning the sensations of others, declined the subject, _____, in excuse, his total ignorance; and the conversation took a more general turn.” Word bank: encomiums, alleging, congratulatory, salubrious
   Key: alleging
4. [mc · recall · DOK 1] Who is Justine Moritz?

   A. A professor

B. An innkeeper

C. Victor's sister

D. A girl who became a servant and part of the family

Key: D (A girl who became a servant and part of the family)

5. [mc · recall · DOK 1] What does Clerval study?

A. Oriental languages

B. Astronomy

C. Medicine

D. Chemistry

Key: A (Oriental languages)

6. [mc · recall · DOK 1] What restores Victor's spirits?

A. A party

B. A sea voyage

C. A walking tour in nature with Clerval

D. A new experiment

Key: C (A walking tour in nature with Clerval)

7. [mc · recall · DOK 1] In the line "Krempe was not equally docile; and in my condition at that time, of almost insupportable sensitiveness, his harsh blunt encomiums gave me even more pain than the benevolent approbation of M.", what does "encomiums" most nearly mean?

A. to make changes; to introduce something new

B. speeches or remarks of high praise

C. give an incentive for action

D. cannot be removed or erased

Key: B (speeches or remarks of high praise)

8. [fill · recall · DOK 1] Fill in the blank with the vocabulary word that fits: "I figure to myself that the task of attending on your sick bed has _____ on some mercenary old nurse, who could never guess your wishes, nor minister to them with the care and affection of your poor cousin." Word bank: salubrious, congratulatory, devolved, encomiums

Key: devolved

9. [mc · recall · DOK 1] In the line "We passed a fortnight in these perambulations: my health and spirits had long been restored, and they gained additional strength from the salubrious air I breathed, the natural incidents of our progress, and the…", what does "salubrious" most nearly mean?

A. a building where animals are killed for meat

B. tempted; attracted

C. healthy; good for the body

D. the act of dismounting (a horse or bike etc.)

Key: C (healthy; good for the body)

10. [mc · inference · DOK 2] Which choice best states a central concern of "Chapter VI"?

A. Isolation in the north

B. Recovery and false peace

C. Learning compassion by watching

D. Loneliness and the desire for a friend

Key: B (Recovery and false peace)

11. [short · inference · DOK 2] What can you infer from this line? “A selfish pursuit had cramped and narrowed me, until your gentleness and affection warmed and opened my senses” (Chapter VI, paragraph 21) Answer in two or three sentences with one detail.

    Sample answer: Victor names his work "selfish": a rare admission and strong evidence.

12. [mc · inference · DOK 2] What does this passage most clearly show? “I became the same happy creature who, a few years ago, loved and beloved by all, had no sorrow or care” (Chapter VI, paragraph 21)

    A. The first sentence already contains a warning (his sister's "evil forebodings"). Strong evidence for foreshadowing.

    B. Political education; links to Godwin.

    C. Restoration that the reader suspects cannot last.

    D. The master has become the slave; a reversal the creature will state aloud in Chapter XX.

    Key: C (Restoration that the reader suspects cannot last.)

13. [mc · inference · DOK 2] What does this passage most clearly show? “A selfish pursuit had cramped and narrowed me, until your gentleness and affection warmed and opened my senses” (Chapter VI, paragraph 21)

    A. Victor names his work "selfish": a rare admission and strong evidence.

    B. Psychological insight into grief and guilt.

    C. An allusion that promises he will not offend against nature; readers who know Coleridge sense danger.

    D. The nurture argument in one line.

    Key: A (Victor names his work "selfish": a rare admission and strong evidence.)

14. [short · analysis · DOK 3] Claim: Clerval's nursing shows the care the novel values, and it highlights Victor's failure to give it. Explain how this evidence supports the claim: “A selfish pursuit had cramped and narrowed me, until your gentleness and affection warmed and opened my senses” (Chapter VI, paragraph 21).

    Sample answer: Victor credits Clerval's "gentleness and affection" for curing what a "selfish pursuit" had done, so he knows what care is; he has simply not given it to his creation.

15. [short · analysis · DOK 3] Analyze the word choice in “dear Victor” (Chapter VI, paragraph 3). Pick two words and explain what they suggest.

    Sample answer: Elizabeth's letter opens with domestic affection, recalling the Preface's stated aim.

16. [short · synthesis · DOK 4] Close reading: how do the diction and syntax of “A selfish pursuit had cramped and narrowed me, until your gentleness and affection warmed and opened my senses” (Chapter VI, paragraph 21) shape its meaning? Consider a second, competing reading.

    Sample answer: Victor names his work "selfish": a rare admission and strong evidence.

17. [mc · recall · DOK 1] How does Victor now feel about natural philosophy?

    A. He teaches it

    B. He is indifferent

    C. He loves it more

    D. He cannot bear it

Key: D (He cannot bear it)

18. [mc · recall · DOK 1] In the line “The pretty Miss Mansfield has already received the congratulatory visits on her approaching marriage with a young Englishman, John Melbourne, Esq.”, what does “congratulatory” most nearly mean?

    A. combine into one

    B. folds or hollows (here, in the hills)

    C. expressing congratulations

    D. make sense of; assign a meaning to

    Key: C (expressing congratulations)

19. [fill · recall · DOK 1] Fill in the blank with the vocabulary word that fits: “When he smiles, two little _____ appear on each cheek, which are rosy with health.” Word bank: dimples, congratulatory, encomiums, salubrious

    Key: dimples

20. [fill · recall · DOK 1] Complete the quotation from Chapter VI, paragraph 21: “A selfish pursuit had cramped and narrowed me, until your _____ and affection warmed and opened my senses”

    Key: gentleness

21. [short · inference · DOK 2] What can you infer from this line? “I became the same happy creature who, a few years ago, loved and beloved by all, had no sorrow or care” (Chapter VI, paragraph 21) Answer in two or three sentences with one detail.

    Sample answer: Restoration that the reader suspects cannot last.

22. [mc · inference · DOK 2] What does this passage most clearly show? “dear Victor” (Chapter VI, paragraph 3)

    A. Narrated with hindsight; sets a pattern of suffering.

    B. (The 1831 text prints "drank.") Victor calls ambition a drug ("intoxicating draught") and madness. Evidence for the novel's view of obsessive curiosity.

    C. Elizabeth's letter opens with domestic affection, recalling the Preface's stated aim.

    D. Biblical image of hell (Isaiah, Mark): remorse as eternal torment.

    Key: C (Elizabeth's letter opens with domestic affection, recalling the Preface's stated aim.)

23. [mc · analysis · DOK 3] Which literary element does this describe in “Chapter VI”? Clerval arrives and nurses Victor through months of fever: friendship as care, the opposite of Victor's conduct.

    A. Structure

    B. Alliteration

    C. Point of view

    D. Characterization

    Key: D (Characterization)

24. [mc · analysis · DOK 3] Which literary element does this describe in “Chapter VI”? Victor recovers into a "false peace" while the creature is out in the world, unseen.

    A. Alliteration

    B. Hyperbole

    C. Irony

    D. Foreshadowing

    Key: C (Irony)

25. [short · synthesis · DOK 4] Synthesis: trace how isolation and companionship develops from an earlier chapter to “Chapter VI”. Use one quotation from each.

    Sample answer: Clerval shows what companionship gives: Victor says a selfish pursuit had "cramped and narrowed" him.

26. [mc · recall · DOK 1] Who writes to Victor during his recovery?

    A. Walton

    B. Krempe

    C. His mother

    D. Elizabeth

    Key: D (Elizabeth)

27. [short · synthesis · DOK 4] Close reading: how do the diction and syntax of “I became the same happy creature who, a few years ago, loved and beloved by all, had no sorrow or care” (Chapter VI, paragraph 21) shape its meaning? Consider a second, competing reading.

    Sample answer: Restoration that the reader suspects cannot last.

28. [short · synthesis · DOK 4] Evaluate this claim about the chapter: “Clerval's nursing shows the care the novel values, and it highlights Victor's failure to give it.” Is it fully persuasive? Argue with evidence, including a passage that complicates it.

    Sample answer: Victor credits Clerval's "gentleness and affection" for curing what a "selfish pursuit" had done, so he knows what care is; he has simply not given it to his creation.

Rigor version	Items (in order)	Mix
Middle School	1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 6, 7, 8, 9, 10, 11, 12, 13, 14, 15, 16	recall 9, inference 4, analysis 2, synthesis 1
HS Freshman	5, 17, 2, 4, 8, 18, 19, 20, 11, 21, 13, 22, 14, 23, 24, 25	recall 8, inference 4, analysis 3, synthesis 1
HS Sophomore	20, 8, 4, 18, 26, 9, 10, 12, 21, 11, 13, 15, 24, 23, 27, 25	recall 6, inference 5, analysis 3, synthesis 2
HS Junior	1, 2, 18, 9, 19, 21, 13, 11, 12, 22, 24, 15, 23, 14, 16, 28	recall 5, inference 5, analysis 4, synthesis 2
HS Senior	2, 20, 17, 3, 11, 22, 10, 12, 13, 23, 14, 24, 15, 27, 28, 25	recall 4, inference 5, analysis 4, synthesis 3
AP	20, 8, 18, 10, 21, 12, 22, 13, 15, 24, 14, 23, 25, 28, 16, 27	recall 3, inference 5, analysis 4, synthesis 4
College Freshman	8, 3, 9, 21, 22, 11, 10, 12, 24, 15, 23, 14, 28, 16, 27, 25	recall 3, inference 5, analysis 4, synthesis 4
College Sophomore	8, 2, 13, 22, 11, 12, 10, 21, 24, 14, 23, 15, 27, 16, 28, 25	recall 2, inference 6, analysis 4, synthesis 4
College Junior	8, 2, 12, 11, 22, 21, 13, 10, 24, 23, 14, 15, 16, 27, 25, 28	recall 2, inference 6, analysis 4, synthesis 4
College Senior	8, 2, 22, 13, 12, 11, 21, 10, 24, 14, 23, 15, 27, 16, 25, 28	recall 2, inference 6, analysis 4, synthesis 4
Graduate / PhD	8, 2, 21, 11, 12, 13, 10, 22, 15, 23, 14, 24, 16, 28, 25, 27	recall 2, inference 6, analysis 4, synthesis 4

Writing prompts (eleven rigor levels)

Middle School (250 words; Indiana 2023: 7.RC.3, 7.W.1): Supported track (work from the passage your teacher selects). In “Chapter VI,” how does Shelley show recovery and false peace? Write a paragraph that states your claim, quotes two details from the passage, and explains how each detail supports your idea. Use the setting you noticed as one piece of evidence.

HS Freshman (350 words; Indiana 2023: 9-10.RC.1, 9-10.W.1): In Chapter VI, how does Shelley develop the idea of recovery and false peace? State a clear claim, support it with two or three quotations, and explain how the setting in the chapter helps build that idea.

HS Sophomore (450 words; Indiana 2023: 9-10.RC.1, 9-10.W.1): Analyze how Chapter VI develops the idea of recovery and false peace. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of setting and tone / mood shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.

HS Junior (550 words; Indiana 2023: 11-12.RC.3, 11-12.RC.1, 11-12.W.1): Analyze how the structure of Chapter VI (where it begins, turns and ends) and its setting shape the reader's understanding of recovery and false peace. Identify one place where the text leaves matters uncertain and explain how that uncertainty adds to its meaning.

HS Senior (600 words; Indiana 2023: 11-12.RC.1, 11-12.W.1): Two readers disagree about what Chapter VI suggests about recovery and false peace. Lay out two plausible interpretations, weigh the evidence for each (including the chapter's setting and tone / mood), and argue for the stronger one in a sustained, well-organized essay.

AP (650 words; Indiana 2023: 11-12.RC.1, 11-12.W.1): Write a literary argument in which you analyze how Mary Shelley uses setting in Chapter VI to complicate the reader's understanding of recovery and false peace. Develop a defensible thesis, select evidence purposefully, and explain how specific choices of diction and syntax create meaning.

College Freshman (1000 words; Indiana 2023: see unit standards): Situate Chapter VI within its historical and literary context and argue how the chapter's treatment of recovery and false peace responds to that context. Engage with at least one secondary perspective (a critic, historian or the author's own statements), integrate quotations smoothly, and cite in MLA style.

College Sophomore (1250 words; Indiana 2023: see unit standards): Read Chapter VI alongside the conventions of its genre and period. Argue how the chapter's handling of recovery and false peace follows or bends those conventions, using the setting as evidence, and test your reading against one published critic. Document two secondary sources in MLA.

College Junior (1500 words; Indiana 2023: see unit standards): Apply a named critical approach (for example formalist, historicist, feminist, psychoanalytic or ecocritical) to Chapter VI and its treatment of recovery and false peace. State your method, show what it reveals in the chapter's setting and tone / mood, and identify where the text resists it.

College Senior (2000 words; Indiana 2023: see unit standards): Develop a research argument that reads Chapter VI as evidence for a larger claim about recovery and false peace in Frankenstein. Connect close reading of the chapter to the whole novel, engage at least four scholarly sources, and state precisely where your reading departs from theirs (Chicago style).

Graduate / PhD (2500 words; Indiana 2023: see unit standards): Develop an original argument that reads Chapter VI as a hinge in the novel's larger treatment of recovery and false peace. Position your reading within a named critical conversation (for example formalist, historicist, psychoanalytic, feminist or postcolonial approaches), account for the textual history where relevant, and articulate the stakes of your intervention for scholarship on Frankenstein.

SAT-style questions

1. *Krempe was not equally docile; and in my condition at that time, of almost insupportable sensitiveness, his harsh blunt encomiums gave me even more pain than the benevolent approbation of M.*

   As used in the text, what does the word “encomiums” most nearly mean?

   A. speeches or remarks of high praise

   B. cause to move more slowly or operate at a slower rate

   C. showing modest reserve

   D. small hollows in the cheeks, seen when smiling

2. *“I must say also a few words to you, my dear cousin, of little darling William. I wish you could see him; he is very tall of his age, with sweet laughing blue eyes, dark eyelashes, and curling hair. When he smiles, two little dimples appear on each cheek, which are rosy with health. He has already had one or two little wives, but Louisa Biron is his favourite, a pretty little girl of five years of age.*

   Which choice best states a central concern of “Chapter VI”?

   A. Rejection and the turn to revenge

   B. Language, knowledge and sorrow

   C. The demand for a companion

   D. Recovery and false peace

SAT key: 1. A (speeches or remarks of high praise); 2. D (Recovery and false peace)

Lesson 14: Chapter VII

Focus: the first death and growing guilt

Objective: Students will analyze how foreshadowing develops in "Chapter VII" by writing a claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph that cites at least 2 quotations from the section, and will score at least 80% on the section quiz.

Standards: CCSS RL.9-10.5, W.9-10.1, L.9-10.4 · IN 9-10.RC.3, 9-10.W.1, 9-10.RC.9, 9-10.RC.11

Content note (murder of a child): William, a young child, is found murdered. Some students may have experienced loss; allow a pass on reading aloud.
Student preview: This chapter reports the murder of a young child.
Suggested language: "How does the family's grief shape what happens next?"

Teacher only · spoilers

A letter from his father reports that Victor's youngest brother, William, has been murdered. Returning to Geneva during a storm, Victor glimpses the creature near the spot and becomes certain it is the killer. He learns that Justine has been accused because William's locket was found on her.

Background: The Alps and storms are classic sublime settings—vast nature that inspires awe and fear.

Significance: Victor's silence begins here: he knows the truth but says nothing, making him complicit.

Lesson plan and lecture script (90 minutes)

0–8 min · Bell-ringer · You do (8 min)
Students write to the bell-ringer, then pair-share.
Should Victor tell the authorities what he knows? Why does he stay silent? Write for five minutes. Starters: I think... because... / This connects to creation and responsibility because.... Content note before we start: This chapter reports the murder of a young child.
Prompt: Should Victor tell the authorities what he knows? Why does he stay silent?
Sentence starters: I think… because… · This connects to creation and responsibility because…
Strong response: A strong response takes a position and anticipates this: the first death caused (indirectly) by Victor's creation.

8–18 min · Vocabulary with etymology notes · I do (10 min)
Five key words in context, with verified word histories.
Today's words: cabriolet — a light two-wheeled carriage pulled by one horse; prognosticate — to predict; to be a sign of; scaling — climbing; desolating — causing great grief or ruin; festering — infected and full of pus. "desolating": From Middle English desolat(e). See Etymology 2 and -ate for more.
Words: cabriolet: a light two-wheeled carriage pulled by one horse · prognosticate: to predict; to be a sign of · scaling: climbing · desolating: causing great grief or ruin · festering: infected and full of pus

18–28 min · Background and context · I do (10 min)
Mini-lecture (read or adapt the script).
The Alps and storms are classic sublime settings—vast nature that inspires awe and fear. Victor's silence begins here: he knows the truth but says nothing, making him complicit. Plot: William's murder (told in a letter), Victor's return to Geneva, the glimpse of the creature in the storm, and Justine's arrest. Setting: The thunderstorm over the Alps is sublime and reveals the creature by lightning. Irony: Victor knows who the murderer is but remains silent while Justine is accused. Watch for lightning: as in Chapter II, lightning reveals destructive power; here it shows Victor the creature.

28–40 min · I do: modeled close reading · I do (12 min)
Model the close reading of the anchor quotation using the written think-aloud below.
I read the line once for meaning and once for craft. "William is dead" (Chapter VII, paragraph 4). Blunt, short sentence in the father's letter. That is plot at work: William's murder (told in a letter), Victor's return to Geneva, the glimpse of the creature in the storm, and Justine's arrest.

> *William is dead* (Chapter VII, paragraph 4)

Think-aloud: I read the line once for meaning and once for craft. "William is dead" (Chapter VII, paragraph 4). Blunt, short sentence in the father's letter. That is plot at work: William's murder (told in a letter), Victor's return to Geneva, the glimpse of the creature in the storm, and Justine's arrest.

40–55 min · We do: guided annotation · We do (15 min)
Guided analysis of a second quotation; expected answers given.
Ask: What words in this line stand out, and what do they suggest? Expected: He assumes the killer cannot be human because of how the creature looks, judging by appearance. This connects to guilt and responsibility: he knows the truth and stays silent. Ask: How does this line connect to creation and responsibility? Expected: The first death caused (indirectly) by Victor's creation. (Victor concludes guilt from appearance, as others will judge the creature.)

> *Nothing in human shape could have destroyed that fair child* (Chapter VII, paragraph 29)

Ask: What words in this line stand out, and what do they suggest?
Expected answer: He assumes the killer cannot be human because of how the creature looks, judging by appearance. This connects to guilt and responsibility: he knows the truth and stays silent.
Ask: How does this line connect to creation and responsibility?
Expected answer: The first death caused (indirectly) by Victor's creation. (Victor concludes guilt from appearance, as others will judge the creature.)

55–70 min · You do: independent annotation · You do (15 min)

Independent annotation and a claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph (exemplar given).

Annotate the chapter for plot, setting (three marks with a margin note each), then write one claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph: what does this chapter suggest about the first death and growing guilt? Then start your writing prompt at your assigned level (HS Sophomore: Analyze how Chapter VII develops the idea of the first death and growing guilt. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of foreshadowing and imagery shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.) Exemplar: Victor's silence after recognizing the creature makes him complicit in the injustice that follows. When the text says "Nothing in human shape could have destroyed that fair child" (Chapter VII, paragraph 29), it shows this directly. He decides that "nothing in human shape could have destroyed that fair child," so he is certain who did it, yet he lets Justine be accused rather than reveal his secret.

Task: Annotate the chapter for plot, setting (three marks with a margin note each), then write one claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph: what does this chapter suggest about the first death and growing guilt? Then start your writing prompt at your assigned level (HS Sophomore: Analyze how Chapter VII develops the idea of the first death and growing guilt. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of foreshadowing and imagery shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.)

Exemplar: Victor's silence after recognizing the creature makes him complicit in the injustice that follows. When the text says "Nothing in human shape could have destroyed that fair child" (Chapter VII, paragraph 29), it shows this directly. He decides that "nothing in human shape could have destroyed that fair child," so he is certain who did it, yet he lets Justine be accused rather than reveal his secret.

70–80 min · Discussion · We do (10 min)

Structured discussion from the 30 tiered questions, with facilitation notes.

Anchor question: Should Victor tell the authorities what he knows? Why does he stay silent? Ask whether Victor's silence is cowardice or a reasonable fear of being thought mad. Require evidence.

Anchor question: Should Victor tell the authorities what he knows? Why does he stay silent?

Facilitation: Ask whether Victor's silence is cowardice or a reasonable fear of being thought mad. Require evidence.

80–87 min · Exit ticket / chapter quiz · You do (7 min)

Chapter quiz in the app and an exit ticket (answer given).

Chapter quiz in the app, then: In one sentence, what does this chapter suggest about the first death and growing guilt? Support it with one short quotation. Model answer: Victor's silence after recognizing the creature makes him complicit in the injustice that follows. ("Nothing in human shape could have destroyed that fair child", Chapter VII, paragraph 29). Accept any defensible claim backed by a quotation from the chapter; the answer key for the quiz is in the Quiz section.

Exit ticket: In one sentence, what does this chapter suggest about the first death and growing guilt? Support it with one short quotation.

Answer: Model answer: Victor's silence after recognizing the creature makes him complicit in the injustice that follows. ("Nothing in human shape could have destroyed that fair child", Chapter VII, paragraph 29). Accept any defensible claim backed by a quotation from the chapter; the answer key for the quiz is in the Quiz section.

> **87–90 min · Closure · I do (3 min)**
> Summarize the lesson and preview the next reading.
> *Today we saw how plot shapes the first death and growing guilt. Key takeaway: the first death caused (indirectly) by Victor's creation.*

Total: 90 minutes.

Teacher analysis (spoilers)

Literary elements

- **Plot:** William's murder (told in a letter), Victor's return to Geneva, the glimpse of the creature in the storm, and Justine's arrest.
- **Setting:** The thunderstorm over the Alps is sublime and reveals the creature by lightning.
- **Irony:** Victor knows who the murderer is but remains silent while Justine is accused.

Themes and how they develop

- **creation and responsibility:** the first death caused (indirectly) by Victor's creation.

Symbols and motifs

- **lightning:** as in Chapter II, lightning reveals destructive power; here it shows Victor the creature.

Key quotations (checked against the reading text)

- "William is dead" (Chapter VII, paragraph 4) Blunt, short sentence in the father's letter.
- "Nothing in human shape could have destroyed that fair child" (Chapter VII, paragraph 29) Victor concludes guilt from appearance, as others will judge the creature.
- "I perceived in the gloom a figure which stole from behind a clump of trees near me" (Chapter VII, paragraph 29) Atmospheric recognition scene; the creature as shadow and double.

Model claim-evidence-reasoning

> **Claim:** Victor's silence after recognizing the creature makes him complicit in the injustice that follows.
> **Evidence:** "Nothing in human shape could have destroyed that fair child" (Chapter VII, paragraph 29)
> **Reasoning:** He decides that "nothing in human shape could have destroyed that fair child," so he is certain who did it, yet he lets Justine be accused rather than reveal his secret.

Vocabulary with etymology notes

Word	Definition (in this sentence)	In context	Word history
cabriolet (noun)	a light two-wheeled carriage pulled by one horse	*But now, as soon as the horses arrived, I hurried into a cabriolet, and bade farewell to my friend.*	

prognosticate (verb)	to predict; to be a sign of	*Is this to prognosticate peace, or to mock at my unhappiness?"*	
scaling (verb)	climbing	*Who could arrest a creature capable of scaling the overhanging sides of Mont Salêve?*	
desolating (adjective)	causing great grief or ruin	*One sudden and desolating change had taken place; but a thousand little circumstances might have by degrees worked other alterations, which, although they were done more tranquilly, might not be the less decisive.*	"desolating": From Middle English desolat(e). See Etymology 2 and -ate for more. (Wiktionary, https://en.wiktionary.org/wiki/desolate#Etymology)
festering (adjective)	infected and full of pus	*"Come, Victor; not brooding thoughts of vengeance against the assassin, but with feelings of peace and gentleness, that will heal, instead of festering, the wounds of our minds.*	
indelible (adjective)	cannot be removed or erased	*Six years had elapsed, passed as a dream but for one indelible trace, and I stood in the same place where I had last embraced my father before my departure for Ingolstadt.*	"indelible": From Latin indēlēbilis "indestructible". By surface analysis, in-#Etymology_3 + delible. (Wiktionary, https://en.wiktionary.org/wiki/indelible#Etymology)
carnage (noun)	the savage and excessive killing of many people	*I had turned loose into the world a depraved wretch, whose delight was in carnage and misery; had he not murdered my brother?*	
ravings (noun)	declaiming wildly	*I well knew that if any other had communicated such a relation to me, I should have looked upon it as the ravings of insanity.*	
credited (verb)	believed	*Besides, the strange nature of the animal would elude all pursuit, even if I were so far credited as to persuade my relatives to commence it.*	"credited": From Latin credere "to trust in". (Wiktionary, https://en.wiktionary.org/wiki/credited#Etymology)
assassin (noun)	a murderer	*"Come, Victor; not brooding thoughts of vengeance against the assassin, but with feelings of peace and gentleness, that will heal, instead of festering, the wounds of our minds.*	"assassin": From either French assassin or Italian assassino, from Arabic **أَسَاسِيِّين** "people who are faithful to the foundation [of the faith]" and the folkloric etymology Arabic **حَشَّاشِين** "hashish users; low-lives".

			(Wiktionary, https://en.wiktionary.org/wiki/assassin#Etymology)

Discussion questions

1. Should Victor tell the authorities what he knows? Why does he stay silent?
2. Where does foreshadowing appear in this chapter, and what effect does it have? Point to one passage.
3. How does this chapter connect to the book's larger concern with isolation and the need for companionship?

Classroom discussion questions (30, tiered)

Wait time after every question (3 s for DOK 1, 5 s for DOK 2, 8 to 10 s for DOK 3 and 4); think-pair-share on DOK 3 and 4; answer each response with a follow-up probe; close with student-generated questions. Focus sets by rigor level: Middle School: 1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 6, 11, 12, 13, 14, 21, 22; HS Freshman: 1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 12, 13, 14, 15, 22, 23, 24; HS Sophomore: 1, 2, 3, 4, 13, 14, 15, 16, 17, 23, 24, 25; HS Junior: 1, 2, 3, 14, 15, 16, 17, 18, 24, 25, 26, 27; HS Senior: 1, 2, 3, 15, 16, 17, 18, 25, 26, 27, 28, 29; AP: 1, 2, 16, 17, 18, 19, 20, 26, 27, 28, 29, 30; College Freshman: 1, 2, 17, 18, 19, 20, 21, 22, 27, 28, 29, 30; College Sophomore: 1, 2, 11, 18, 19, 20, 21, 22, 23, 28, 29, 30; College Junior: 1, 11, 12, 19, 20, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 29, 30; College Senior: 1, 11, 12, 13, 20, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 26, 30; Graduate / PhD: 1, 11, 12, 13, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 26, 27, 28

Literal / recall

1. Who has been murdered? [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · 7.RC.1, 7.CC.1, 9-10.RC.1] Look for: William, Victor's youngest brother
2. What weather greets Victor near Geneva? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · 7.RC.1, 7.CC.1, 9-10.RC.1] Look for: A violent thunderstorm
3. What does the lightning reveal? [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · 7.RC.1, 7.CC.1, 9-10.RC.1] Look for: The creature on the mountainside
4. Who is accused of the murder? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · 7.RC.1, 7.CC.1, 9-10.RC.1] Look for: Justine Moritz
5. What evidence was found on the accused? [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · 7.RC.1, 7.CC.1, 9-10.RC.1] Look for: The miniature portrait (locket) William wore
6. Retell the three most important events of “Chapter VII” in order, in one sentence each. [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · 7.RC.1, 7.CC.1, 9-10.RC.1] Look for: A letter from his father reports that Victor's youngest brother, William, has been murdered. Returning to Geneva during a storm, Victor glimpses the creature near the spot and becomes certain it is the killer. He learns that Justine has been accused because William's locket was found on her.
7. Which characters appear or are mentioned in “Chapter VII”? Name two and one thing each says or does. [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · 7.RC.1, 7.CC.1, 9-10.RC.1] Look for: Names and actions taken from the chapter; check against the teacher summary.
8. Where and when does “Chapter VII” take place? Point to the line that tells you. [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · 7.RC.1, 7.CC.1, 9-10.RC.1] Look for: A place/time detail quoted from the chapter.
9. Reread: “But now, as soon as the horses arrived, I hurried into a cabriolet, and bade farewell to my friend.” What does “cabriolet” mean here, and what is literally happening in this line? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · 7.RC.1, 7.CC.1, 9-10.RC.1] Look for: cabriolet: a light two-wheeled carriage pulled by one horse.
10. Reread: “Is this to prognosticate peace, or to mock at my unhappiness?”” What does “prognosticate” mean here, and what is literally happening in this line? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · 7.RC.1, 7.CC.1, 9-10.RC.1] Look for: prognosticate: to predict; to be a sign of.

Inferential / analytical

1. What does “Chapter VII” suggest about the first death and growing guilt? State the inference and the line that supports it. [DOK 2 · thinkPairShare · wait 5 s · 7.RC.2, 7.CC.2, 9-10.RC.2] Look for: Victor's silence begins here: he knows the truth but says nothing, making him complicit.
2. Find one example of foreshadowing in this chapter. What does it reveal that a plain statement would not? [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · 7.RC.3, 7.CC.2, 9-10.RC.3] Look for: Look for hints, warnings or images that point to later events.
3. How does the imagery in this chapter shape what we understand about the first death and growing guilt? [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · 7.RC.12, 7.CC.2, 9-10.RC.12] Look for: Look for sensory details (sight, sound, cold, light) and what mood they create.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Victor's silence after recognizing the creature makes him complicit in the injustice that follows. Useful evidence: “William is dead” (Chapter VII, paragraph 4): Blunt, short sentence in the father's letter. Theme link: the first death caused (indirectly) by Victor's creation. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
4. In the passage that begins ““Come, Victor; not brooding thoughts of vengeance against the assassin, but with feelings of peace and gentleness, that will heal, instead of festering, the wounds of our minds.”, why might Shelley have chosen these particular words? Pick two and explain their connotations. [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · 7.RC.12, 7.CC.2, 9-10.RC.12] Look for: Diction analysis of two words in the anchor passage.
5. What causes the main turn in “Chapter VII”, and what effect is it likely to have on what follows? [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · 7.RC.3, 7.CC.2, 9-10.RC.1] Look for: A letter from his father reports that Victor's youngest brother, William, has been murdered. Returning to Geneva during a storm, Victor glimpses the creature near the spot and becomes certain it is the killer. He learns that Justine has been accused because William's locket was found on her.
6. How does “Chapter VII” build on “Chapter VI”? Name one link of cause and effect. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · 7.RC.3, 7.CC.2, 9-10.RC.3] Look for: A causal or structural link between this and the previous chapter.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Victor's silence after recognizing the creature makes him complicit in the injustice that follows. Useful evidence: “Nothing in human shape could have destroyed that fair child” (Chapter VII, paragraph 29): Victor concludes guilt from appearance, as others will judge the creature. Theme link: the first death caused (indirectly) by Victor's creation. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
7. What can we infer about a character's motives from what they say and do here, as opposed to what they claim? [DOK 3 · followUp · wait 8 s · 7.RC.3, 7.CC.2, 9-10.RC.1] Look for: An inference about motive supported by a quoted line.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Victor's silence after recognizing the creature makes him complicit in the injustice that follows. Useful evidence: “I perceived in the gloom a figure which stole from behind a clump of trees near me” (Chapter VII, paragraph 29): Atmospheric recognition scene; the creature as shadow and double. Theme link: the first death caused (indirectly) by Victor's creation. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
8. The bell-ringer asked: “Should Victor tell the authorities what he knows? Why does he stay silent?” Now that we have read closely, how would you revise your first answer, and which line changed your mind? [DOK 2 · thinkPairShare · wait 5 s · 7.RC.2, 7.CC.2, 9-10.RC.2] Look for: A revised answer anchored in the text.

9. Where does irony appear, and how does it connect this chapter to the larger concern with isolation and the need for companionship? [DOK 3 · followUp · wait 8 s · 7.RC.1, 7.CC.2, 9-10.RC.1] Look for: Look for gaps between what characters expect or say and what is true.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Victor's silence after recognizing the creature makes him complicit in the injustice that follows. Useful evidence: “William is dead” (Chapter VII, paragraph 4): Blunt, short sentence in the father's letter. On irony: Victor knows who the murderer is but remains silent while Justine is accused. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
10. Background: The Alps and storms are classic sublime settings—vast nature that inspires awe and fear. How does knowing this change the way you read one moment in the chapter? [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · 7.RC.3, 7.CC.2, 9-10.RC.1] Look for: A specific moment reread in light of the context.
    Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Victor's silence after recognizing the creature makes him complicit in the injustice that follows. Useful evidence: “Nothing in human shape could have destroyed that fair child” (Chapter VII, paragraph 29): Victor concludes guilt from appearance, as others will judge the creature. On setting: The thunderstorm over the Alps is sublime and reveals the creature by lightning. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

Evaluative / synthesis / creative

1. A critic might argue: “Victor's silence begins here: he knows the truth but says nothing, making him complicit.” How far do you agree? Take a stand and defend it with two lines from the chapter. [DOK 3 · fourCorners · wait 8 s · 7.RC.2, 7.CC.3, 9-10.RC.2] Look for: A defended position with evidence and one counterpoint.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Victor's silence after recognizing the creature makes him complicit in the injustice that follows. Useful evidence: “I perceived in the gloom a figure which stole from behind a clump of trees near me” (Chapter VII, paragraph 29): Atmospheric recognition scene; the creature as shadow and double. Theme link: the first death caused (indirectly) by Victor's creation. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
2. Which character in this chapter acts most wisely, and which least? Judge them by a standard you name. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · 7.RC.3, 7.CC.3, 9-10.RC.1] Look for: An evaluation using an explicit criterion and evidence.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Victor's silence after recognizing the creature makes him complicit in the injustice that follows. Useful evidence: “William is dead” (Chapter VII, paragraph 4): Blunt, short sentence in the father's letter. Theme link: the first death caused (indirectly) by Victor's creation. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
3. Rewrite one moment of “Chapter VII” from the point of view of a different character. What does the new angle reveal or hide about the first death and growing guilt? [DOK 4 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · 7.RC.1, 7.CC.3, 9-10.RC.1] Look for: A creative product with a rationale tied to the text.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Victor's silence after recognizing the creature makes him complicit in the injustice that follows. Useful evidence: “Nothing in human shape could have destroyed that fair child” (Chapter VII, paragraph 29): Victor concludes guilt from appearance, as others will judge

the creature. Theme link: the first death caused (indirectly) by Victor's creation. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

4. Write three questions of your own about “Chapter VII”: one recall, one “why/how”, and one “should/what if”. Trade with a partner and answer theirs. [DOK 3 · studentGenerated · wait 8 s · 7.RC.2, 7.CC.3, 9-10.RC.2] Look for: Student-generated questions at three levels.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Victor's silence after recognizing the creature makes him complicit in the injustice that follows. Useful evidence: “I perceived in the gloom a figure which stole from behind a clump of trees near me” (Chapter VII, paragraph 29): Atmospheric recognition scene; the creature as shadow and double. Theme link: the first death caused (indirectly) by Victor's creation. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

5. Connect this chapter to nature versus nurture: is the link strong or weak so far? What would Shelley need to show next to strengthen it? [DOK 4 · socraticCircle · wait 8 s · 7.RC.2, 7.CC.3, 9-10.RC.2] Look for: A judgment of thematic development across the work.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Victor's silence after recognizing the creature makes him complicit in the injustice that follows. Useful evidence: “William is dead” (Chapter VII, paragraph 4): Blunt, short sentence in the father's letter. Theme link: the first death caused (indirectly) by Victor's creation. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

6. Is the foreshadowing in this chapter effective, or does it feel heavy-handed? Evaluate it as a reader would in a review. [DOK 3 · fourCorners · wait 8 s · 7.RC.3, 7.CC.3, 9-10.RC.3] Look for: An evaluative judgment with criteria and evidence.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Victor's silence after recognizing the creature makes him complicit in the injustice that follows. Useful evidence: “Nothing in human shape could have destroyed that fair child” (Chapter VII, paragraph 29): Victor concludes guilt from appearance, as others will judge the creature. Theme link: the first death caused (indirectly) by Victor's creation. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

7. Compare how “Chapter VII” treats the first death and growing guilt with how another text, film or event you know treats a similar idea. What does Frankenstein see that the other misses? [DOK 4 · socraticCircle · wait 8 s · 7.RC.2, 7.CC.3, 9-10.RC.2] Look for: A cross-text synthesis.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Victor's silence after recognizing the creature makes him complicit in the injustice that follows. Useful evidence: “I perceived in the gloom a figure which stole from behind a clump of trees near me” (Chapter VII, paragraph 29): Atmospheric recognition scene; the creature as shadow and double. Theme link: the first death caused (indirectly) by Victor's creation. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

8. Predict what “Chapter VIII” will bring, using two clues from this chapter. After reading, evaluate your prediction. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · 7.RC.3, 7.CC.3, 9-10.RC.3] Look for: A prediction or judgment justified with textual clues.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Victor's silence after recognizing the creature makes him complicit in the injustice that follows. Useful evidence: “William is dead” (Chapter VII, paragraph 4): Blunt, short sentence in the father's letter. Theme link: the first death caused (indirectly) by Victor's

creation. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

9. Design a one-paragraph modern adaptation of this chapter (setting, characters, conflict). What must stay the same for it to still be about the first death and growing guilt? [DOK 4 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · 7.RC.2, 7.CC.3, 9-10.RC.2] Look for: A creative transfer that keeps the core idea.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Victor's silence after recognizing the creature makes him complicit in the injustice that follows. Useful evidence: “Nothing in human shape could have destroyed that fair child” (Chapter VII, paragraph 29): Victor concludes guilt from appearance, as others will judge the creature. Theme link: the first death caused (indirectly) by Victor's creation. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

10. What question would you most like to ask Mary Shelley about this chapter, and what answer do you think the text itself gives? [DOK 4 · studentGenerated · wait 8 s · 7.RC.2, 7.CC.3, 9-10.RC.2] Look for: A student-generated question answered from evidence.

    Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Victor's silence after recognizing the creature makes him complicit in the injustice that follows. Useful evidence: “I perceived in the gloom a figure which stole from behind a clump of trees near me” (Chapter VII, paragraph 29): Atmospheric recognition scene; the creature as shadow and double. Theme link: the first death caused (indirectly) by Victor's creation. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

Annotation focus

- **Foreshadowing:** look for hints, warnings or images that point to later events (anchor passage in the We do segment)
- Also notice **Imagery**: sensory details (sight, sound, cold, light) and what mood they create
- Also notice **Irony**: gaps between what characters expect or say and what is true

Chapter quiz: item bank (all eleven rigor versions)

1. [fill · recall · DOK 1] Complete the quotation from Chapter VII, paragraph 29: “Nothing in human shape could have _____ that fair child”

   Key: destroyed

2. [mc · recall · DOK 1] In the line “But now, as soon as the horses arrived, I hurried into a cabriolet, and bade farewell to my friend.”, what does “cabriolet” most nearly mean?

   A. a light two-wheeled carriage pulled by one horse

   B. not having enough money to pay for necessities

   C. an elaborate analytical or explanatory essay or discussion

   D. convert code into ordinary language

   Key: A (a light two-wheeled carriage pulled by one horse)

3. [mc · recall · DOK 1] What does the lightning reveal?

   A. A burning house

   B. The creature on the mountainside

   C. Justine

   D. A ship

Key: B (The creature on the mountainside)

4. [fill · recall · DOK 1] Fill in the blank with the vocabulary word that fits: "Six years had elapsed, passed as a dream but for one _____ trace, and I stood in the same place where I had last embraced my father before my departure for Ingolstadt." Word bank: scaling, indelible, cabriolet, prognosticate

   Key: indelible

5. [fill · recall · DOK 1] Fill in the blank with the vocabulary word that fits: "I had turned loose into the world a depraved wretch, whose delight was in _____ and misery; had he not murdered my brother?" Word bank: scaling, prognosticate, cabriolet, carnage

   Key: carnage

6. [fill · recall · DOK 1] Fill in the blank with the vocabulary word that fits: ""Come, Victor; not brooding thoughts of vengeance against the assassin, but with feelings of peace and gentleness, that will heal, instead of _____, the wounds of our minds." Word bank: festering, cabriolet, scaling, prognosticate

   Key: festering

7. [mc · recall · DOK 1] In the line "Is this to prognosticate peace, or to mock at my unhappiness?"", what does "prognosticate" most nearly mean?

   A. adjusted in tone

   B. teachers

   C. to predict; to be a sign of

   D. regular court sessions held in English counties (until 1971)

   Key: C (to predict; to be a sign of)

8. [mc · recall · DOK 1] What evidence was found on the accused?

   A. A letter

   B. The miniature portrait (locket) William wore

   C. Blood

   D. A knife

   Key: B (The miniature portrait (locket) William wore)

9. [fill · recall · DOK 1] Fill in the blank with the vocabulary word that fits: "I well knew that if any other had communicated such a relation to me, I should have looked upon it as the _____ of insanity." Word bank: scaling, prognosticate, cabriolet, ravings

   Key: ravings

10. [mc · inference · DOK 2] What does this passage most clearly show? "Nothing in human shape could have destroyed that fair child" (Chapter VII, paragraph 29)

    A. Victor concludes guilt from appearance, as others will judge the creature.

    B. Fear and disgust pull against each other: the source of his delay.

    C. The creature will ask for exactly this. Evidence that the need for companionship is universal in the novel.

    D. Narrated with hindsight; sets a pattern of suffering.

    Key: A (Victor concludes guilt from appearance, as others will judge the creature.)

11. [mc · inference · DOK 2] What does this passage most clearly show? "I perceived in the gloom a figure which stole from behind a clump of trees near me" (Chapter VII, paragraph 29)

    A. Isolation through allusion.

B. Victor's fear of consequences.

C. Atmospheric recognition scene; the creature as shadow and double.

D. Dismissal without explanation; Victor later blames this.

Key: C (Atmospheric recognition scene; the creature as shadow and double.)

12. [mc · inference · DOK 2] Which choice best states a central concern of "Chapter VII"?

A. The first death and growing guilt

B. The origin of the novel and the idea of creation

C. Injustice and exile

D. Grief, prison and return

Key: A (The first death and growing guilt)

13. [short · inference · DOK 2] What can you infer from this line? "Nothing in human shape could have destroyed that fair child" (Chapter VII, paragraph 29) Answer in two or three sentences with one detail.

Sample answer: Victor concludes guilt from appearance, as others will judge the creature.

14. [mc · analysis · DOK 3] In this chapter, which theme does the following most directly develop? The first death caused (indirectly) by Victor's creation.

A. The costs of unchecked ambition

B. Nature versus nurture

C. Isolation and the need for companionship

D. Creation and responsibility

Key: D (Creation and responsibility)

15. [short · analysis · DOK 3] Claim: Victor's silence after recognizing the creature makes him complicit in the injustice that follows. Explain how this evidence supports the claim: "Nothing in human shape could have destroyed that fair child" (Chapter VII, paragraph 29).

Sample answer: He decides that "nothing in human shape could have destroyed that fair child," so he is certain who did it, yet he lets Justine be accused rather than reveal his secret.

16. [short · synthesis · DOK 4] Close reading: how do the diction and syntax of "William is dead" (Chapter VII, paragraph 4) shape its meaning? Consider a second, competing reading.

Sample answer: Blunt, short sentence in the father's letter.

17. [mc · recall · DOK 1] What weather greets Victor near Geneva?

A. A blizzard

B. A violent thunderstorm

C. Fog

D. A heatwave

Key: B (A violent thunderstorm)

18. [fill · recall · DOK 1] Complete the quotation from Chapter VII, paragraph 29: "I _____ in the gloom a figure which stole from behind a clump of trees near me"

Key: perceived

19. [mc · recall · DOK 1] In the line "Who could arrest a creature capable of scaling the overhanging sides of Mont Salêve?", what does "scaling" most nearly mean?

A. spreading out

B. climbing

C. seemingly boundless in amount, number, degree, or especially extent

D. cursing; expressions of hatred

Key: B (climbing)

20. [mc · inference · DOK 2] What does this passage most clearly show? “William is dead” (Chapter VII, paragraph 4)

A. Elizabeth sees what Victor hides; his guilt shows on his face.

B. An allusion that promises he will not offend against nature; readers who know Coleridge sense danger.

C. Blunt, short sentence in the father's letter.

D. Milton's Satan: the hell is internal.

Key: C (Blunt, short sentence in the father's letter.)

21. [mc · analysis · DOK 3] Which literary element does this describe in “Chapter VII”? The thunderstorm over the Alps is sublime and reveals the creature by lightning.

A. Allusion

B. Theme

C. Tone / mood

D. Setting

Key: D (Setting)

22. [short · analysis · DOK 3] Analyze the word choice in “I perceived in the gloom a figure which stole from behind a clump of trees near me” (Chapter VII, paragraph 29). Pick two words and explain what they suggest.

Sample answer: Atmospheric recognition scene; the creature as shadow and double.

23. [mc · recall · DOK 1] Who has been murdered?

A. Alphonse

B. Elizabeth

C. Clerval

D. William, Victor's youngest brother

Key: D (William, Victor's youngest brother)

24. [short · inference · DOK 2] What can you infer from this line? “William is dead” (Chapter VII, paragraph 4) Answer in two or three sentences with one detail.

Sample answer: Blunt, short sentence in the father's letter.

25. [short · synthesis · DOK 4] Close reading: how do the diction and syntax of “Nothing in human shape could have destroyed that fair child” (Chapter VII, paragraph 29) shape its meaning? Consider a second, competing reading.

Sample answer: Victor concludes guilt from appearance, as others will judge the creature.

26. [short · synthesis · DOK 4] Synthesis: trace how creation and responsibility develops from an earlier chapter to “Chapter VII”. Use one quotation from each.

Sample answer: the first death caused (indirectly) by Victor's creation.

27. [mc · recall · DOK 1] Who is accused of the murder?

A. Elizabeth

B. Ernest

C. Clerval

D. Justine Moritz

Key: D (Justine Moritz)

28. [mc · recall · DOK 1] In the line “One sudden and desolating change had taken place; but a thousand little circumstances might have by degrees worked other alterations, which, although they were done more tranquilly, might not be the less decisive.”, what does “desolating” most nearly mean?

A. poorly educated; unable to read well

B. difficult to solve or alleviate

C. frightened; made fearful

D. causing great grief or ruin

Key: D (causing great grief or ruin)

29. [short · synthesis · DOK 4] Evaluate this claim about the chapter: “Victor's silence after recognizing the creature makes him complicit in the injustice that follows.” Is it fully persuasive? Argue with evidence, including a passage that complicates it.

Sample answer: He decides that "nothing in human shape could have destroyed that fair child," so he is certain who did it, yet he lets Justine be accused rather than reveal his secret.

30. [mc · analysis · DOK 3] Which literary element does this describe in “Chapter VII”? William's murder (told in a letter), Victor's return to Geneva, the glimpse of the creature in the storm, and Justine's arrest.

A. Characterization

B. Irony

C. Personification

D. Plot

Key: D (Plot)

Rigor version	Items (in order)	Mix
Middle School	1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 6, 7, 8, 9, 10, 11, 12, 13, 14, 15, 16	recall 9, inference 4, analysis 2, synthesis 1
HS Freshman	1, 6, 17, 18, 9, 7, 19, 2, 13, 20, 11, 12, 14, 21, 22, 16	recall 8, inference 4, analysis 3, synthesis 1
HS Sophomore	17, 18, 9, 1, 7, 23, 24, 20, 13, 10, 12, 14, 21, 15, 25, 26	recall 6, inference 5, analysis 3, synthesis 2
HS Junior	27, 18, 28, 19, 5, 11, 24, 20, 10, 13, 14, 22, 21, 15, 25, 16	recall 5, inference 5, analysis 4, synthesis 2
HS Senior	19, 1, 9, 27, 12, 20, 11, 13, 10, 22, 21, 14, 15, 26, 29, 16	recall 4, inference 5, analysis 4, synthesis 3
AP	9, 3, 4, 20, 10, 11, 13, 30, 14, 22, 21, 15, 16, 29, 26, 25	recall 3, inference 4, analysis 5, synthesis 4
College Freshman	6, 4, 3, 13, 10, 24, 11, 22, 21, 14, 30, 15, 16, 25, 26, 29	recall 3, inference 4, analysis 5, synthesis 4
College Sophomore	6, 4, 20, 13, 10, 12, 24, 22, 15, 21, 14, 30, 16, 26, 29, 25	recall 2, inference 5, analysis 5, synthesis 4
College Junior	6, 4, 12, 24, 11, 13, 10, 14, 22, 30, 15, 21, 26, 16, 25, 29	recall 2, inference 5, analysis 5, synthesis 4
College Senior	6, 4, 11, 20, 13, 12, 10, 14, 30, 21, 15, 22, 29, 26, 25, 16	recall 2, inference 5, analysis 5, synthesis 4
Graduate / PhD	6, 4, 20, 12, 11, 10, 24, 15, 30, 22, 21, 14, 16, 29, 26, 25	recall 2, inference 5, analysis 5, synthesis 4

Writing prompts (eleven rigor levels)

Middle School (250 words; Indiana 2023: 7.RC.3, 7.W.1): Supported track (work from the passage your teacher selects). In “Chapter VII,” how does Shelley show the first death and growing guilt? Write a paragraph that states your claim, quotes two details from the passage, and explains how each detail supports your idea. Use the foreshadowing you noticed as one piece of evidence.

HS Freshman (350 words; Indiana 2023: 9-10.RC.3, 9-10.W.1): In Chapter VII, how does Shelley develop the idea of the first death and growing guilt? State a clear claim, support it with two or three quotations, and explain how the foreshadowing in the chapter helps build that idea.

HS Sophomore (450 words; Indiana 2023: 9-10.RC.3, 9-10.W.1): Analyze how Chapter VII develops the idea of the first death and growing guilt. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of foreshadowing and imagery shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.

HS Junior (550 words; Indiana 2023: 11-12.RC.3, 11-12.RC.1, 11-12.W.1): Analyze how the structure of Chapter VII (where it begins, turns and ends) and its foreshadowing shape the reader's understanding of the first death and growing guilt. Identify one place where the text leaves matters uncertain and explain how that uncertainty adds to its meaning.

HS Senior (600 words; Indiana 2023: 11-12.RC.3, 11-12.W.1): Two readers disagree about what Chapter VII suggests about the first death and growing guilt. Lay out two plausible interpretations, weigh the evidence for each (including the chapter's foreshadowing and imagery), and argue for the stronger one in a sustained, well-organized essay.

AP (650 words; Indiana 2023: 11-12.RC.3, 11-12.W.1): Write a literary argument in which you analyze how Mary Shelley uses foreshadowing in Chapter VII to complicate the reader's understanding of the first death and growing guilt. Develop a defensible thesis, select evidence purposefully, and explain how specific choices of diction and syntax create meaning.

College Freshman (1000 words; Indiana 2023: see unit standards): Situate Chapter VII within its historical and literary context and argue how the chapter's treatment of the first death and growing guilt responds to that context. Engage with at least one secondary perspective (a critic, historian or the author's own statements), integrate quotations smoothly, and cite in MLA style.

College Sophomore (1250 words; Indiana 2023: see unit standards): Read Chapter VII alongside the conventions of its genre and period. Argue how the chapter's handling of the first death and growing guilt follows or bends those conventions, using the foreshadowing as evidence, and test your reading against one published critic. Document two secondary sources in MLA.

College Junior (1500 words; Indiana 2023: see unit standards): Apply a named critical approach (for example formalist, historicist, feminist, psychoanalytic or ecocritical) to Chapter VII and its treatment of the first death and growing guilt. State your method, show what it reveals in the chapter's foreshadowing and imagery, and identify where the text resists it.

College Senior (2000 words; Indiana 2023: see unit standards): Develop a research argument that reads Chapter VII as evidence for a larger claim about the first death and growing guilt in Frankenstein. Connect close reading of the chapter to the whole novel, engage at least four scholarly sources, and state precisely where your reading departs from theirs (Chicago style).

Graduate / PhD (2500 words; Indiana 2023: see unit standards): Develop an original argument that reads Chapter VII as a hinge in the novel's larger treatment of the first death and growing guilt. Position your reading within a named critical conversation (for example formalist, historicist, psychoanalytic, feminist or postcolonial approaches), account for the textual history where relevant, and articulate the stakes of your intervention for scholarship on Frankenstein.

SAT-style questions

1. *Who could arrest a creature capable of scaling the overhanging sides of Mont Salêve?*

   As used in the text, what does the word “scaling” most nearly mean?

   A. a murderer

   B. climbing

   C. declaiming wildly

   D. believed

2. *“Come, Victor; not brooding thoughts of vengeance against the assassin, but with feelings of peace and gentleness, that will heal, instead of festering, the wounds of our minds. Enter the house of mourning, my friend, but with kindness and affection for those who love you, and not with hatred for your enemies.*

   Which choice best states a central concern of “Chapter VII”?

   A. First experiences of the senses

   B. The final reckoning

   C. Obsession and the discovery of life

   D. The first death and growing guilt

SAT key: 1. B (climbing); 2. D (The first death and growing guilt)

Lesson 15: Chapter VIII

Focus: injustice and the burden of silence

Objective: Students will analyze how irony develops in “Chapter VIII” by writing a claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph that cites at least 2 quotations from the section, and will score at least 80% on the section quiz.

Standards: CCSS RL.9-10.6, W.9-10.1, L.9-10.4 · IN 9-10.RC.1, 9-10.W.1, 9-10.RC.9, 9-10.RC.11

Critical voice: “It does not appear that Frankenstein attempted to avert her fate, by communicating his horrible secret; but, indeed, who would have given him credit, or in what manner could he have supported his tale?” (Walter Scott (attrib.), novelist and critic, *"Remarks on Frankenstein, or the Modern Prometheus; A Novel," Blackwood's Edinburgh Magazine 2:12 (March 1818), p. 617*; public domain). Socratic seminar: Scott half-excuses Victor. Is silence justified when no one would believe the truth? Students weigh Victor's own reasoning in Chapter VIII. *Objective:* Analyze Victor's silence during Justine's trial and the theme of injustice. *Standards:* RL.11-12.3, 11-12.RC.1

Content note (wrongful execution, coerced confession): Justine is pressured into a false confession and executed. Frame it as injustice and discuss how institutions fail the vulnerable.
Student preview: An innocent character is pressured to confess and is executed.
Suggested language: “Why does Justine confess to something she did not do? Who is responsible?”

Teacher only · spoilers

Justine is tried. Though innocent, she confesses under pressure from her confessor, who threatened her with damnation, and is executed. Elizabeth defends her eloquently; Victor suffers privately but does not speak.

Background: Courts of the time could convict on circumstantial evidence; religious confession carried enormous social pressure.

Significance: Justice fails, showing how society punishes the vulnerable while the guilty (Victor, indirectly) remain free.

Lesson plan and lecture script (90 minutes)

0–8 min · Bell-ringer · You do (8 min)
Students write to the bell-ringer, then pair-share.
Who is responsible for Justine's death? Rank the characters and defend your order. Write for five minutes. Starters: I think... because... / This connects to creation and responsibility because.... Content note before we start: An innocent character is pressured to confess and is executed.
Prompt: Who is responsible for Justine's death? Rank the characters and defend your order.
Sentence starters: I think… because… · This connects to creation and responsibility because…
Strong response: A strong response takes a position and anticipates this: guilt without action: Victor feels remorse but does not act.

8–18 min · Vocabulary with etymology notes · I do (10 min)
Five key words in context, with verified word histories.
Today's words: tarnish — to dull or stain the brightness of; consoles — comforts in a time of sadness; unmingled — pure; not mixed with anything else; playfellow — a companion at play; gnashed — grind together, of teeth. "consoles": From Latin consolari "to comfort," from com- (intensive) + solari "to comfort." "unmingled": From un + mingled. "playfellow": From play + fellow.
Words: tarnish: to dull or stain the brightness of · consoles: comforts in a time of sadness · unmingled: pure; not mixed with anything else · playfellow: a companion at play · gnashed: grind together, of teeth

18–28 min · Background and context · I do (10 min)
Mini-lecture (read or adapt the script).
Courts of the time could convict on circumstantial evidence; religious confession carried enormous social pressure. Justice fails, showing how society punishes the vulnerable while the guilty (Victor, indirectly) remain free. Irony: Justine's false confession and execution: the court reaches the wrong verdict by correct procedure. Characterization: Elizabeth defends Justine eloquently; Justine accepts death with dignity; Victor suffers internally and says nothing. Tone / mood: Bitter and self-accusing: Victor calls himself the true murderer. Watch for light and fire: Light stands for knowledge and fire for its double edge: warmth and burning. Victor seeks the "light" of discovery; the creature discovers fire and is burned by it. In this chapter: "that he said I was. He threatened excommunication and hell fire in my last moments, if I continued obdurate. Dear lady, I" (Chapter VIII, paragraph 22).

28–40 min · I do: modeled close reading · I do (12 min)
Model the close reading of the anchor quotation using the written think-aloud below.
I read the line once for meaning and once for craft. "I did confess; but I confessed a lie" (Chapter VIII, paragraph 22). Justine was pressured by her confessor; evidence about injustice and power. That is irony at work: Justine's false confession and execution: the court reaches the wrong verdict by correct procedure.

> *I did confess; but I confessed a lie* (Chapter VIII, paragraph 22)

Think-aloud: I read the line once for meaning and once for craft. "I did confess; but I confessed a lie" (Chapter VIII, paragraph 22). Justine was pressured by her confessor; evidence about injustice and power. That is irony at work: Justine's false confession and execution: the court reaches the wrong verdict by correct procedure.

40–55 min · We do: guided annotation · We do (15 min)
Guided analysis of a second quotation; expected answers given.
Ask: What words in this line stand out, and what do they suggest? Expected: Victor makes Justine's death about his suffering: a striking self-centeredness. Look at the craft: Elizabeth defends Justine eloquently; Justine accepts death with dignity; Victor suffers internally and says nothing. Ask: How does this line connect to creation and responsibility? Expected: Guilt without action: Victor feels remorse but does not act. (Victor makes Justine's death about his suffering: a striking self-centeredness.)

> *The tortures of the accused did not equal mine (Chapter VIII, paragraph 11)*

Ask: What words in this line stand out, and what do they suggest?
Expected answer: Victor makes Justine's death about his suffering: a striking self-centeredness. Look at the craft: Elizabeth defends Justine eloquently; Justine accepts death with dignity; Victor suffers internally and says nothing.
Ask: How does this line connect to creation and responsibility?
Expected answer: Guilt without action: Victor feels remorse but does not act. (Victor makes Justine's death about his suffering: a striking self-centeredness.)

55–70 min · You do: independent annotation · You do (15 min)
Independent annotation and a claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph (exemplar given).
Annotate the chapter for irony, characterization (three marks with a margin note each), then write one claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph: what does this chapter suggest about injustice and the burden of silence? Then start your writing prompt at your assigned level (HS Sophomore: Analyze how Chapter VIII develops the idea of injustice and the burden of silence. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of irony and characterization shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.) Exemplar: Victor turns Justine's tragedy into a story about his own pain, which shows his self-absorption. When the text says "The tortures of the accused did not equal mine" (Chapter VIII, paragraph 11), it shows this directly. He claims "the tortures of the accused did not equal mine," even though she is the one executed, so his remorse becomes another form of self-focus rather than action.
Task: Annotate the chapter for irony, characterization (three marks with a margin note each), then write one claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph: what does this chapter suggest about injustice and the burden of silence? Then start your writing prompt at your assigned level (HS Sophomore: Analyze how Chapter VIII develops the idea of injustice and the burden of silence. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of irony and characterization shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.)
Exemplar: Victor turns Justine's tragedy into a story about his own pain, which shows his self-absorption. When the text says “The tortures of the accused did not equal mine” (Chapter VIII, paragraph 11), it shows this directly. He claims "the tortures of the accused did not equal mine," even though she is the one executed, so his remorse becomes another form of self-focus rather than action.

70–80 min · Discussion · We do (10 min)
Structured discussion from the 30 tiered questions, with facilitation notes.
Anchor question: Who is responsible for Justine's death? Rank the characters and defend your order. Expect strong reactions. Ask: what could Victor have done, and what would it have cost him?
Anchor question: Who is responsible for Justine's death? Rank the characters and defend your order.
Facilitation: Expect strong reactions. Ask: what could Victor have done, and what would it have cost him?

80–87 min · Exit ticket / chapter quiz · You do (7 min)
Chapter quiz in the app and an exit ticket (answer given).
Chapter quiz in the app, then: In one sentence, what does this chapter suggest about injustice and the burden of silence? Support it with one short quotation. Model answer: Victor turns Justine's tragedy into a story about his own pain, which shows his self-absorption. ("The tortures of the accused did not equal mine", Chapter VIII, paragraph 11). Accept any defensible claim backed by a quotation from the chapter; the answer key for the quiz is in the Quiz section.
Exit ticket: In one sentence, what does this chapter suggest about injustice and the burden of silence? Support it with one short quotation.
Answer: Model answer: Victor turns Justine's tragedy into a story about his own pain, which shows his self-absorption. ("The tortures of the accused did not equal mine", Chapter VIII, paragraph 11). Accept any defensible claim backed by a quotation from the chapter; the answer key for the quiz is in the Quiz section.

87–90 min · Closure · I do (3 min)
Summarize the lesson and preview the next reading.
Today we saw how irony shapes injustice and the burden of silence. Key takeaway: guilt without action: Victor feels remorse but does not act.

Total: 90 minutes.

Teacher analysis (spoilers)

Literary elements

- **Irony:** Justine's false confession and execution: the court reaches the wrong verdict by correct procedure.
- **Characterization:** Elizabeth defends Justine eloquently; Justine accepts death with dignity; Victor suffers internally and says nothing.
- **Tone / mood:** Bitter and self-accusing: Victor calls himself the true murderer.

Themes and how they develop

- **creation and responsibility:** guilt without action: Victor feels remorse but does not act.

Symbols and motifs

- **light and fire:** Light stands for knowledge and fire for its double edge: warmth and burning. Victor seeks the "light" of discovery; the creature discovers fire and is burned by it. In this chapter: "that he said

I was. He threatened excommunication and hell fire in my last moments, if I continued obdurate. Dear lady, I" (Chapter VIII, paragraph 22).

- **naming the creature:** Victor never names his creation; the words he uses (wretch, daemon, fiend, monster) show his rejection and shape the reader's view. In this chapter: "I believed in her innocence; I knew it. Could the daemon, who had (I did not for a minute doubt) murdered my" (Chapter VIII, paragraph 11).

Key quotations (checked against the reading text)

- "I did confess; but I confessed a lie" (Chapter VIII, paragraph 22) Justine was pressured by her confessor; evidence about injustice and power.
- "The tortures of the accused did not equal mine" (Chapter VIII, paragraph 11) Victor makes Justine's death about his suffering: a striking self-centeredness.
- "the never-dying worm alive in my bosom" (Chapter VIII, paragraph 29) Biblical image of hell (Isaiah, Mark): remorse as eternal torment.

Model claim-evidence-reasoning

Claim: Victor turns Justine's tragedy into a story about his own pain, which shows his self-absorption.
Evidence: "The tortures of the accused did not equal mine" (Chapter VIII, paragraph 11)
Reasoning: He claims "the tortures of the accused did not equal mine," even though she is the one executed, so his remorse becomes another form of self-focus rather than action.

Vocabulary with etymology notes

Word	Definition (in this sentence)	In context	Word history
tarnish (verb)	to dull or stain the brightness of	*Elizabeth also wept, and was unhappy; but hers also was the misery of innocence, which, like a cloud that passes over the fair moon, for a while hides but cannot tarnish its brightness.*	
consoles (verb)	comforts in a time of sadness	*I soon shall see you again in heaven, where we shall all be happy; and that consoles me, going as I am to suffer ignominy and death."*	"consoles": From Latin consolari "to comfort," from com- (intensive) + solari "to comfort." (Online Etymology Dictionary, https://www.etymonline.com/word/console)
unmingled (adjective)	pure; not mixed with anything else	*I passed a night of unmingled wretchedness.*	"unmingled": From un + mingled. (Wiktionary, https://en.wiktionary.org/wiki/unmingled#Etymology)
playfellow (noun)	a companion at play		"playfellow": From play + fellow. (Wiktionary, https://

		You shall not die!—You, my playfellow, my companion, my sister, perish on the scaffold!	en.wiktionary.org/wiki/playfellow#Etymology)
gnashed (verb)	grind together, of teeth	*I gnashed my teeth, and ground them together, uttering a groan that came from my inmost soul.*	
heartrending (adjective)	causing or marked by grief or anguish	*Elizabeth's heartrending eloquence failed to move the judges from their settled conviction in the criminality of the saintly sufferer.*	"heartrending": From heart + rending. (Wiktionary, https://en.wiktionary.org/wiki/heartrending#Etymology)
removes (noun)	degree of figurative distance or separation; or	*It removes more than half my misfortune; and I feel as if I could die in peace, now that my innocence is acknowledged by you, dear lady, and your cousin."*	
distrusted (verb)	regard as untrustworthy; regard with suspicion; have no faith or confidence in	*"Oh, Justine! forgive me for having for one moment distrusted you.*	"distrusted": From dis + trust, alteration of the earlier term wantrust. (Wiktionary, https://en.wiktionary.org/wiki/distrust#Etymology)
excommunication (noun)	the state of being excommunicated	*He threatened excommunication and hell fire in my last moments, if I continued obdurate.*	
subscribed (verb)	offer to buy, as of stocks and shares	*In an evil hour I subscribed to a lie; and now only am I truly miserable."*	

Discussion questions

1. Who is responsible for Justine's death? Rank the characters and defend your order.
2. Where does irony appear in this chapter, and what effect does it have? Point to one passage.
3. How does this chapter connect to the book's larger concern with nature versus nurture?

Classroom discussion questions (30, tiered)

Wait time after every question (3 s for DOK 1, 5 s for DOK 2, 8 to 10 s for DOK 3 and 4); think-pair-share on DOK 3 and 4; answer each response with a follow-up probe; close with student-generated questions. Focus sets by rigor level: Middle School: 1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 6, 11, 12, 13, 14, 21, 22; HS Freshman: 1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 12, 13, 14, 15, 22, 23, 24; HS Sophomore: 1, 2, 3, 4, 13, 14, 15, 16, 17, 23, 24, 25; HS Junior: 1, 2, 3, 14, 15, 16, 17, 18, 24, 25, 26, 27; HS Senior: 1, 2, 3, 15, 16, 17, 18, 25, 26, 27, 28, 29; AP: 1, 2, 16, 17, 18, 19, 20, 26, 27, 28, 29, 30; College Freshman: 1, 2, 17, 18, 19, 20, 21, 22, 27, 28, 29, 30; College Sophomore: 1, 2, 11, 18, 19, 20, 21, 22, 23, 28, 29, 30; College Junior: 1, 11, 12, 19, 20, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 29, 30; College Senior: 1, 11, 12, 13, 20, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 26, 30; Graduate / PhD: 1, 11, 12, 13, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 26, 27, 28

Literal / recall

1. What happens at Justine's trial? [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · 7.RC.1, 7.CC.1, 9-10.RC.1] Look for: She is convicted and condemned
2. Why does Justine confess falsely? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · 7.RC.1, 7.CC.1, 9-10.RC.1] Look for: Her confessor threatened her with damnation
3. Who speaks publicly for Justine? [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · 7.RC.1, 7.CC.1, 9-10.RC.1] Look for: Elizabeth
4. How does Victor respond? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · 7.RC.1, 7.CC.1, 9-10.RC.1] Look for: He suffers in silence
5. What theme does the trial highlight? [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · 7.RC.1, 7.CC.1, 9-10.RC.1] Look for: The failure of justice
6. Retell the three most important events of "Chapter VIII" in order, in one sentence each. [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · 7.RC.1, 7.CC.1, 9-10.RC.1] Look for: Justine is tried. Though innocent, she confesses under pressure from her confessor, who threatened her with damnation, and is executed. Elizabeth defends her eloquently; Victor suffers privately but does not speak.
7. Which characters appear or are mentioned in "Chapter VIII"? Name two and one thing each says or does. [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · 7.RC.1, 7.CC.1, 9-10.RC.1] Look for: Names and actions taken from the chapter; check against the teacher summary.
8. Where and when does "Chapter VIII" take place? Point to the line that tells you. [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · 7.RC.1, 7.CC.1, 9-10.RC.1] Look for: A place/time detail quoted from the chapter.
9. Reread: "Elizabeth also wept, and was unhappy; but hers also was the misery of innocence, which, like a cloud that passes over the fair moon, for a while hides but cannot tarnish its brightness." What does "tarnish" mean here, and what is literally happening in this line? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · 7.RC.1, 7.CC.1, 9-10.RC.1] Look for: tarnish: to dull or stain the brightness of.
10. Reread: "I soon shall see you again in heaven, where we shall all be happy; and that consoles me, going as I am to suffer ignominy and death."" What does "consoles" mean here, and what is literally happening in this line? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · 7.RC.1, 7.CC.1, 9-10.RC.1] Look for: consoles: comforts in a time of sadness.

Inferential / analytical

1. What does "Chapter VIII" suggest about injustice and the burden of silence? State the inference and the line that supports it. [DOK 2 · thinkPairShare · wait 5 s · 7.RC.2, 7.CC.2, 9-10.RC.2] Look for: Justice fails, showing how society punishes the vulnerable while the guilty (Victor, indirectly) remain free.
2. Find one example of irony in this chapter. What does it reveal that a plain statement would not? [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · 7.RC.1, 7.CC.2, 9-10.RC.1] Look for: Look for gaps between what characters expect or say and what is true.
3. How does the characterization in this chapter shape what we understand about injustice and the burden of silence? [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · 7.RC.3, 7.CC.2, 9-10.RC.1] Look for: Look for what characters say, do and think, and how others react to them.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Victor turns Justine's tragedy into a story about his own pain, which shows his self-absorption. Useful evidence: "I did confess; but I confessed a lie" (Chapter VIII, paragraph 22): Justine was pressured by her confessor; evidence about injustice and power. On characterization: Elizabeth defends Justine eloquently; Justine accepts death with dignity; Victor suffers

internally and says nothing. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

4. In the passage that begins “I passed a night of unmingled wretchedness.”, why might Shelley have chosen these particular words? Pick two and explain their connotations. [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · 7.RC.12, 7.CC.2, 9-10.RC.12] Look for: Diction analysis of two words in the anchor passage.
5. What causes the main turn in “Chapter VIII”, and what effect is it likely to have on what follows? [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · 7.RC.3, 7.CC.2, 9-10.RC.1] Look for: Justine is tried. Though innocent, she confesses under pressure from her confessor, who threatened her with damnation, and is executed. Elizabeth defends her eloquently; Victor suffers privately but does not speak.
6. How does “Chapter VIII” build on “Chapter VII”? Name one link of cause and effect. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · 7.RC.3, 7.CC.2, 9-10.RC.3] Look for: A causal or structural link between this and the previous chapter.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Victor turns Justine's tragedy into a story about his own pain, which shows his self-absorption. Useful evidence: “The tortures of the accused did not equal mine” (Chapter VIII, paragraph 11): Victor makes Justine's death about his suffering: a striking self-centeredness. Theme link: guilt without action: Victor feels remorse but does not act. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
7. What can we infer about a character's motives from what they say and do here, as opposed to what they claim? [DOK 3 · followUp · wait 8 s · 7.RC.3, 7.CC.2, 9-10.RC.1] Look for: An inference about motive supported by a quoted line.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Victor turns Justine's tragedy into a story about his own pain, which shows his self-absorption. Useful evidence: “the never-dying worm alive in my bosom” (Chapter VIII, paragraph 29): Biblical image of hell (Isaiah, Mark): remorse as eternal torment. On characterization: Elizabeth defends Justine eloquently; Justine accepts death with dignity; Victor suffers internally and says nothing. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
8. The bell-ringer asked: “Who is responsible for Justine's death? Rank the characters and defend your order.” Now that we have read closely, how would you revise your first answer, and which line changed your mind? [DOK 2 · thinkPairShare · wait 5 s · 7.RC.2, 7.CC.2, 9-10.RC.2] Look for: A revised answer anchored in the text.
9. Where does theme appear, and how does it connect this chapter to the larger concern with nature versus nurture? [DOK 3 · followUp · wait 8 s · 7.RC.2, 7.CC.2, 9-10.RC.2] Look for: Look for statements or moments that connect to the book's big ideas.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Victor turns Justine's tragedy into a story about his own pain, which shows his self-absorption. Useful evidence: “I did confess; but I confessed a lie” (Chapter VIII, paragraph 22): Justine was pressured by her confessor; evidence about injustice and power. Theme link: guilt without action: Victor feels remorse but does not act. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
10. Background: Courts of the time could convict on circumstantial evidence; religious confession carried enormous social pressure. How does knowing this change the way you read one moment in the chapter? [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · 7.RC.3, 7.CC.2, 9-10.RC.1] Look for: A specific moment reread in light of the context.

    Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Victor turns Justine's tragedy into a story about his own pain, which shows his self-absorption. Useful evidence: “The tortures of the accused did not equal mine” (Chapter VIII, paragraph 11): Victor makes Justine's death about his suffering: a striking self-centeredness.

Theme link: guilt without action: Victor feels remorse but does not act. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

Evaluative / synthesis / creative

1. A critic might argue: "Justice fails, showing how society punishes the vulnerable while the guilty (Victor, indirectly) remain free." How far do you agree? Take a stand and defend it with two lines from the chapter. [DOK 3 · fourCorners · wait 8 s · 7.RC.2, 7.CC.3, 9-10.RC.2] Look for: A defended position with evidence and one counterpoint.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Victor turns Justine's tragedy into a story about his own pain, which shows his self-absorption. Useful evidence: "the never-dying worm alive in my bosom" (Chapter VIII, paragraph 29): Biblical image of hell (Isaiah, Mark): remorse as eternal torment. Theme link: guilt without action: Victor feels remorse but does not act. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
2. Which character in this chapter acts most wisely, and which least? Judge them by a standard you name. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · 7.RC.3, 7.CC.3, 9-10.RC.1] Look for: An evaluation using an explicit criterion and evidence.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Victor turns Justine's tragedy into a story about his own pain, which shows his self-absorption. Useful evidence: "I did confess; but I confessed a lie" (Chapter VIII, paragraph 22): Justine was pressured by her confessor; evidence about injustice and power. On characterization: Elizabeth defends Justine eloquently; Justine accepts death with dignity; Victor suffers internally and says nothing. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
3. Rewrite one moment of "Chapter VIII" from the point of view of a different character. What does the new angle reveal or hide about injustice and the burden of silence? [DOK 4 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · 7.RC.1, 7.CC.3, 9-10.RC.1] Look for: A creative product with a rationale tied to the text.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Victor turns Justine's tragedy into a story about his own pain, which shows his self-absorption. Useful evidence: "The tortures of the accused did not equal mine" (Chapter VIII, paragraph 11): Victor makes Justine's death about his suffering: a striking self-centeredness. Theme link: guilt without action: Victor feels remorse but does not act. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
4. Write three questions of your own about "Chapter VIII": one recall, one "why/how", and one "should/what if". Trade with a partner and answer theirs. [DOK 3 · studentGenerated · wait 8 s · 7.RC.2, 7.CC.3, 9-10.RC.2] Look for: Student-generated questions at three levels.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Victor turns Justine's tragedy into a story about his own pain, which shows his self-absorption. Useful evidence: "the never-dying worm alive in my bosom" (Chapter VIII, paragraph 29): Biblical image of hell (Isaiah, Mark): remorse as eternal torment. Theme link: guilt without action: Victor feels remorse but does not act. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
5. Connect this chapter to the sublime power of nature: is the link strong or weak so far? What would Shelley need to show next to strengthen it? [DOK 4 · socraticCircle · wait 8 s · 7.RC.2, 7.CC.3, 9-10.RC.2] Look for: A judgment of thematic development across the work.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Victor turns Justine's tragedy into a story about his own pain, which shows his self-absorption. Useful evidence: "I did confess; but I confessed a lie" (Chapter VIII,

paragraph 22): Justine was pressured by her confessor; evidence about injustice and power. Theme link: guilt without action: Victor feels remorse but does not act. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

6. Is the irony in this chapter effective, or does it feel heavy-handed? Evaluate it as a reader would in a review. [DOK 3 · fourCorners · wait 8 s · 7.RC.1, 7.CC.3, 9-10.RC.1] Look for: An evaluative judgment with criteria and evidence.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Victor turns Justine's tragedy into a story about his own pain, which shows his self-absorption. Useful evidence: “The tortures of the accused did not equal mine” (Chapter VIII, paragraph 11): Victor makes Justine's death about his suffering: a striking self-centeredness. On irony: Justine's false confession and execution: the court reaches the wrong verdict by correct procedure. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
7. Compare how “Chapter VIII” treats injustice and the burden of silence with how another text, film or event you know treats a similar idea. What does Frankenstein see that the other misses? [DOK 4 · socraticCircle · wait 8 s · 7.RC.2, 7.CC.3, 9-10.RC.2] Look for: A cross-text synthesis.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Victor turns Justine's tragedy into a story about his own pain, which shows his self-absorption. Useful evidence: “the never-dying worm alive in my bosom” (Chapter VIII, paragraph 29): Biblical image of hell (Isaiah, Mark): remorse as eternal torment. Theme link: guilt without action: Victor feels remorse but does not act. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
8. Predict what “Chapter IX” will bring, using two clues from this chapter. After reading, evaluate your prediction. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · 7.RC.3, 7.CC.3, 9-10.RC.3] Look for: A prediction or judgment justified with textual clues.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Victor turns Justine's tragedy into a story about his own pain, which shows his self-absorption. Useful evidence: “I did confess; but I confessed a lie” (Chapter VIII, paragraph 22): Justine was pressured by her confessor; evidence about injustice and power. Theme link: guilt without action: Victor feels remorse but does not act. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
9. Design a one-paragraph modern adaptation of this chapter (setting, characters, conflict). What must stay the same for it to still be about injustice and the burden of silence? [DOK 4 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · 7.RC.2, 7.CC.3, 9-10.RC.2] Look for: A creative transfer that keeps the core idea.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Victor turns Justine's tragedy into a story about his own pain, which shows his self-absorption. Useful evidence: “The tortures of the accused did not equal mine” (Chapter VIII, paragraph 11): Victor makes Justine's death about his suffering: a striking self-centeredness. Theme link: guilt without action: Victor feels remorse but does not act. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
10. What question would you most like to ask Mary Shelley about this chapter, and what answer do you think the text itself gives? [DOK 4 · studentGenerated · wait 8 s · 7.RC.2, 7.CC.3, 9-10.RC.2] Look for: A student-generated question answered from evidence.
    Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Victor turns Justine's tragedy into a story about his own pain, which shows his self-absorption. Useful evidence: “the never-dying worm alive in my bosom” (Chapter VIII, paragraph 29): Biblical image of hell (Isaiah, Mark): remorse as eternal torment. Theme link: guilt without action: Victor feels remorse but does not act. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

Annotation focus

- **Irony:** look for gaps between what characters expect or say and what is true (anchor passage in the We do segment)
- Also notice **Characterization**: what characters say, do and think, and how others react to them
- Also notice **Theme**: statements or moments that connect to the book's big ideas

Chapter quiz: item bank (all eleven rigor versions)

1. [fill · recall · DOK 1] Fill in the blank with the vocabulary word that fits: ""Oh, Justine! forgive me for having for one moment _____ you." Word bank: distrusted, tarnish, unmingled, consoles
   Key: distrusted
2. [mc · recall · DOK 1] What happens at Justine's trial?
   A. The trial is cancelled
   B. She is freed
   C. She escapes
   D. She is convicted and condemned
   Key: D (She is convicted and condemned)
3. [mc · recall · DOK 1] How does Victor respond?
   A. He suffers in silence
   B. He confesses
   C. He leaves Geneva
   D. He accuses Ernest
   Key: A (He suffers in silence)
4. [fill · recall · DOK 1] Complete the quotation from Chapter VIII, paragraph 11: "The _____ of the accused did not equal mine"
   Key: tortures
5. [mc · recall · DOK 1] Who speaks publicly for Justine?
   A. Victor
   B. Alphonse
   C. Elizabeth
   D. Clerval
   Key: C (Elizabeth)
6. [fill · recall · DOK 1] Fill in the blank with the vocabulary word that fits: "Elizabeth's _____ eloquence failed to move the judges from their settled conviction in the criminality of the saintly sufferer." Word bank: tarnish, heartrending, consoles, unmingled
   Key: heartrending
7. [mc · recall · DOK 1] Why does Justine confess falsely?
   A. She wanted to protect Victor
   B. She was bribed
   C. Her confessor threatened her with damnation
   D. She forgot

Key: C (Her confessor threatened her with damnation)

8. [fill · recall · DOK 1] Complete the quotation from Chapter VIII, paragraph 22: “I did confess; but I _____ a lie”

   Key: confessed

9. [mc · recall · DOK 1] What theme does the trial highlight?

   A. The joy of law
   B. The power of science
   C. The love of travel
   D. The failure of justice

   Key: D (The failure of justice)

10. [mc · inference · DOK 2] What does this passage most clearly show? “The tortures of the accused did not equal mine” (Chapter VIII, paragraph 11)

    A. Shelley presents herself as a parent of the book. Use this to connect author and character: both make something "hideous," but only one blesses it.
    B. A rhetorical question the novel answers: nature, death and conscience can.
    C. Milton allusion; the creature casts Victor as a God who failed.
    D. Victor makes Justine's death about his suffering: a striking self-centeredness.

    Key: D (Victor makes Justine's death about his suffering: a striking self-centeredness.)

11. [mc · inference · DOK 2] Which choice best states a central concern of “Chapter VIII”?

    A. Ambition and the hunger for discovery
    B. Language, knowledge and sorrow
    C. Injustice and the burden of silence
    D. Confrontation between creator and creation

    Key: C (Injustice and the burden of silence)

12. [mc · inference · DOK 2] What does this passage most clearly show? “I did confess; but I confessed a lie” (Chapter VIII, paragraph 22)

    A. Fire's double nature; symbol for knowledge and for the creature.
    B. The heart of Victor's ambition: more than anyone before.
    C. Justine was pressured by her confessor; evidence about injustice and power.
    D. "Satiate" (fully satisfy) and "ardent" reveal appetite-like ambition. Use for a claim about the dangers of curiosity.

    Key: C (Justine was pressured by her confessor; evidence about injustice and power.)

13. [short · inference · DOK 2] What can you infer from this line? “I did confess; but I confessed a lie” (Chapter VIII, paragraph 22) Answer in two or three sentences with one detail.

    Sample answer: Justine was pressured by her confessor; evidence about injustice and power.

14. [mc · analysis · DOK 3] Which literary element does this describe in “Chapter VIII”? Elizabeth defends Justine eloquently; Justine accepts death with dignity; Victor suffers internally and says nothing.

    A. Diction / vocabulary
    B. Characterization
    C. Personification
    D. Hyperbole

Key: B (Characterization)

15. [mc · analysis · DOK 3] In this chapter, which theme does the following most directly develop? Guilt without action: Victor feels remorse but does not act.

    A. The costs of unchecked ambition

    B. Nature versus nurture

    C. Creation and responsibility

    D. Isolation and the need for companionship

    Key: C (Creation and responsibility)

16. [short · synthesis · DOK 4] Evaluate this claim about the chapter: “Victor turns Justine's tragedy into a story about his own pain, which shows his self-absorption.” Is it fully persuasive? Argue with evidence, including a passage that complicates it.

    Sample answer: He claims "the tortures of the accused did not equal mine," even though she is the one executed, so his remorse becomes another form of self-focus rather than action.

17. [mc · recall · DOK 1] In the line “I passed a night of unmingled wretchedness.”, what does “unmingled” most nearly mean?

    A. losing hope; discouraged

    B. pure; not mixed with anything else

    C. a heavy rain

    D. healthy; good for the body

    Key: B (pure; not mixed with anything else)

18. [fill · recall · DOK 1] Fill in the blank with the vocabulary word that fits: “I _____ my teeth, and ground them together, uttering a groan that came from my inmost soul.” Word bank: consoles, tarnish, unmingled, gnashed

    Key: gnashed

19. [mc · recall · DOK 1] In the line “You shall not die!—You, my playfellow, my companion, my sister, perish on the scaffold!”, what does “playfellow” most nearly mean?

    A. strained by asking too much of

    B. set free

    C. tiredness and lack of energy

    D. a companion at play

    Key: D (a companion at play)

20. [fill · recall · DOK 1] Fill in the blank with the vocabulary word that fits: “It _____ more than half my misfortune; and I feel as if I could die in peace, now that my innocence is acknowledged by you, dear lady, and your cousin.”” Word bank: consoles, removes, tarnish, unmingled

    Key: removes

21. [mc · inference · DOK 2] What does this passage most clearly show? “the never-dying worm alive in my bosom” (Chapter VIII, paragraph 29)

    A. Biblical image of hell (Isaiah, Mark): remorse as eternal torment.

    B. The creature reverses the master-slave relationship.

    C. "Divine" means to discover by intuition and also suggests godlike power.

    D. Physical collapse.

Key: A (Biblical image of hell (Isaiah, Mark): remorse as eternal torment.)

22. [short · analysis · DOK 3] Analyze the word choice in “the never-dying worm alive in my bosom” (Chapter VIII, paragraph 29). Pick two words and explain what they suggest.
    Sample answer: Biblical image of hell (Isaiah, Mark): remorse as eternal torment.

23. [mc · recall · DOK 1] In the line “Elizabeth also wept, and was unhappy; but hers also was the misery of innocence, which, like a cloud that passes over the fair moon, for a while hides but cannot tarnish its brightness.”, what does “tarnish” most nearly mean?
    A. to dull or stain the brightness of
    B. cold, damp harshness
    C. the quality of being loud
    D. combine into one

    Key: A (to dull or stain the brightness of)

24. [short · inference · DOK 2] What can you infer from this line? “The tortures of the accused did not equal mine” (Chapter VIII, paragraph 11) Answer in two or three sentences with one detail.
    Sample answer: Victor makes Justine's death about his suffering: a striking self-centeredness.

25. [mc · analysis · DOK 3] Which literary element does this describe in “Chapter VIII”? Justine's false confession and execution: the court reaches the wrong verdict by correct procedure.
    A. Structure
    B. Irony
    C. Point of view
    D. Metaphor

    Key: B (Irony)

26. [short · synthesis · DOK 4] Close reading: how do the diction and syntax of “The tortures of the accused did not equal mine” (Chapter VIII, paragraph 11) shape its meaning? Consider a second, competing reading.
    Sample answer: Victor makes Justine's death about his suffering: a striking self-centeredness.

27. [short · synthesis · DOK 4] Close reading: how do the diction and syntax of “I did confess; but I confessed a lie” (Chapter VIII, paragraph 22) shape its meaning? Consider a second, competing reading.
    Sample answer: Justine was pressured by her confessor; evidence about injustice and power.

28. [short · analysis · DOK 3] Claim: Victor turns Justine's tragedy into a story about his own pain, which shows his self-absorption. Explain how this evidence supports the claim: “The tortures of the accused did not equal mine” (Chapter VIII, paragraph 11).
    Sample answer: He claims "the tortures of the accused did not equal mine," even though she is the one executed, so his remorse becomes another form of self-focus rather than action.

29. [short · synthesis · DOK 4] Synthesis: trace how creation and responsibility develops from an earlier chapter to “Chapter VIII”. Use one quotation from each.
    Sample answer: guilt without action: Victor feels remorse but does not act.

Rigor version	Items (in order)	Mix
Middle School	1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 6, 7, 8, 9, 10, 11, 12, 13, 14, 15, 16	recall 9, inference 4, analysis 2, synthesis 1
HS Freshman	8, 17, 18, 2, 9, 19, 3, 20, 12, 21, 11, 10, 14, 15, 22, 16	recall 8, inference 4, analysis 3, synthesis 1

HS Sophomore	19, 1, 18, 23, 20, 17, 13, 10, 21, 12, 24, 15, 25, 14, 16, 26	recall 6, inference 5, analysis 3, synthesis 2
HS Junior	2, 19, 4, 1, 7, 12, 13, 10, 21, 24, 15, 25, 14, 22, 16, 27	recall 5, inference 5, analysis 4, synthesis 2
HS Senior	18, 4, 7, 17, 11, 24, 21, 10, 12, 14, 22, 15, 28, 29, 26, 16	recall 4, inference 5, analysis 4, synthesis 3
AP	18, 6, 9, 10, 13, 12, 21, 22, 15, 25, 28, 14, 26, 29, 27, 16	recall 3, inference 4, analysis 5, synthesis 4
College Freshman	18, 6, 2, 11, 13, 12, 10, 25, 15, 22, 28, 14, 29, 16, 27, 26	recall 3, inference 4, analysis 5, synthesis 4
College Sophomore	4, 18, 24, 12, 13, 21, 10, 15, 22, 28, 14, 25, 16, 29, 27, 26	recall 2, inference 5, analysis 5, synthesis 4
College Junior	18, 6, 11, 13, 21, 10, 12, 14, 22, 28, 25, 15, 16, 26, 29, 27	recall 2, inference 5, analysis 5, synthesis 4
College Senior	20, 18, 11, 13, 12, 24, 10, 22, 15, 14, 28, 25, 26, 16, 27, 29	recall 2, inference 5, analysis 5, synthesis 4
Graduate / PhD	18, 6, 12, 24, 21, 11, 10, 15, 14, 22, 28, 25, 27, 26, 16, 29	recall 2, inference 5, analysis 5, synthesis 4

Writing prompts (eleven rigor levels)

Middle School (250 words; Indiana 2023: 7.RC.1, 7.W.1): Supported track (work from the passage your teacher selects). In “Chapter VIII,” how does Shelley show injustice and the burden of silence? Write a paragraph that states your claim, quotes two details from the passage, and explains how each detail supports your idea. Use the irony you noticed as one piece of evidence.

HS Freshman (350 words; Indiana 2023: 9-10.RC.1, 9-10.W.1): In Chapter VIII, how does Shelley develop the idea of injustice and the burden of silence? State a clear claim, support it with two or three quotations, and explain how the irony in the chapter helps build that idea.

HS Sophomore (450 words; Indiana 2023: 9-10.RC.1, 9-10.W.1): Analyze how Chapter VIII develops the idea of injustice and the burden of silence. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of irony and characterization shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.

HS Junior (550 words; Indiana 2023: 11-12.RC.3, 11-12.RC.1, 11-12.W.1): Analyze how the structure of Chapter VIII (where it begins, turns and ends) and its irony shape the reader's understanding of injustice and the burden of silence. Identify one place where the text leaves matters uncertain and explain how that uncertainty adds to its meaning. Distinguish what is directly stated from what is really meant.

HS Senior (600 words; Indiana 2023: 11-12.RC.1, 11-12.W.1): Two readers disagree about what Chapter VIII suggests about injustice and the burden of silence. Lay out two plausible interpretations, weigh the evidence for each (including the chapter's irony and characterization), and argue for the stronger one in a sustained, well-organized essay. Distinguish what is directly stated from what is really meant.

AP (650 words; Indiana 2023: 11-12.RC.1, 11-12.W.1): Write a literary argument in which you analyze how Mary Shelley uses irony in Chapter VIII to complicate the reader's understanding of injustice and the burden of silence. Develop a defensible thesis, select evidence purposefully, and explain how specific choices of diction and syntax create meaning.

College Freshman (1000 words; Indiana 2023: see unit standards): Situate Chapter VIII within its historical and literary context and argue how the chapter's treatment of injustice and the burden of silence responds to that context. Engage with at least one secondary perspective (a critic, historian or the author's own statements), integrate quotations smoothly, and cite in MLA style.

College Sophomore (1250 words; Indiana 2023: see unit standards): Read Chapter VIII alongside the conventions of its genre and period. Argue how the chapter's handling of injustice and the burden of silence follows or bends those conventions, using the irony as evidence, and test your reading against one published critic. Document two secondary sources in MLA.

College Junior (1500 words; Indiana 2023: see unit standards): Apply a named critical approach (for example formalist, historicist, feminist, psychoanalytic or ecocritical) to Chapter VIII and its treatment of injustice and the burden of silence. State your method, show what it reveals in the chapter's irony and characterization, and identify where the text resists it.

College Senior (2000 words; Indiana 2023: see unit standards): Develop a research argument that reads Chapter VIII as evidence for a larger claim about injustice and the burden of silence in Frankenstein. Connect close reading of the chapter to the whole novel, engage at least four scholarly sources, and state precisely where your reading departs from theirs (Chicago style).

Graduate / PhD (2500 words; Indiana 2023: see unit standards): Develop an original argument that reads Chapter VIII as a hinge in the novel's larger treatment of injustice and the burden of silence. Position your reading within a named critical conversation (for example formalist, historicist, psychoanalytic, feminist or postcolonial approaches), account for the textual history where relevant, and articulate the stakes of your intervention for scholarship on Frankenstein.

SAT-style questions

1. *I passed a night of unmingled wretchedness.*

   As used in the text, what does the word “unmingled” most nearly mean?

   A. offer to buy, as of stocks and shares

   B. the state of being excommunicated

   C. pure; not mixed with anything else

   D. regard as untrustworthy; regard with suspicion; have no faith or confidence in

2. *I passed a night of unmingled wretchedness. In the morning I went to the court; my lips and throat were parched. I dared not ask the fatal question; but I was known, and the officer guessed the cause of my visit. The ballots had been thrown; they were all black, and Justine was condemned.*

   Which choice best states a central concern of “Chapter VIII”?

   A. Horror at the moment of creation

   B. Reading and identity

C. Isolation in the north

D. Injustice and the burden of silence

SAT key: 1. C (pure; not mixed with anything else); 2. D (Injustice and the burden of silence)

Lesson 16: Chapter IX

Focus: despair and the sublime

Objective: Students will analyze how setting develops in “Chapter IX” by writing a claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph that cites at least 2 quotations from the section, and will score at least 80% on the section quiz.

Standards: CCSS RL.9-10.3, W.9-10.1, L.9-10.4 · IN 9-10.RC.1, 9-10.W.1, 9-10.RC.9, 9-10.RC.11

Content note (suicidal thoughts): Victor contemplates ending his life. Use the safe-messaging script; the quiz item is worded as what his despair leads him to contemplate.
Student preview: Victor feels deep despair in this chapter and thinks about ending his life. If this topic is hard for you, you can talk to me or a counselor.
Suggested language: “What pulls Victor back? How does the landscape affect his despair?”
Safe messaging: Discuss the character's despair and what the text does with it; do not dwell on methods. Before the lesson, remind students that support is available and how to reach the counselor. Check in privately with any student who seems affected and follow your school's referral protocol. **Share with students:** If you or someone you know is struggling or thinking about suicide, call or text 988 (Suicide & Crisis Lifeline, U.S.) or talk with a school counselor today. Let a counselor know in advance that this chapter is being taught.

Teacher only · spoilers

Tormented by guilt, Victor considers suicide. His family withdraws to Belrive. Victor journeys into the Alps toward Chamounix, where the majesty of mountains, glaciers and Mont Blanc offers temporary relief.

Background: The Vale of Chamounix and Mont Blanc were Romantic pilgrimage sites; Percy Shelley wrote 'Mont Blanc' (1816).

Significance: The sublime landscape mirrors Victor's mind: grand, cold and overwhelming.

Lesson plan and lecture script (90 minutes)

0–8 min · Bell-ringer · You do (8 min)
Students write to the bell-ringer, then pair-share.
How does the mountain landscape reflect Victor's feelings? Write for five minutes. Starters: I think... because... / This connects to the sublime because.... Content note before we start: Victor feels deep despair in this chapter and thinks about ending his life. If this topic is hard for you, you can talk to me or a counselor. If you or someone you know is struggling or thinking about suicide, call or text 988 (Suicide & Crisis Lifeline, U.S.) or talk with a school counselor today.
Prompt: How does the mountain landscape reflect Victor's feelings?
Sentence starters: I think… because… · This connects to the sublime because…
Strong response: A strong response takes a position and anticipates this: nature offers temporary relief from guilt.

8–18 min · Vocabulary with etymology notes · I do (10 min)
Five key words in context, with verified word histories.
Today's words: overhangs — sticks out over; hangs over; lulling — calming; making sleepy; glaciers — huge slow-moving masses of ice; perpetrate — perform an act, usually with a negative connotation; avalanche — a slide of large masses of snow and ice and mud down a mountain. "overhangs": From Old English oferhangan, corresponding to over + hang. "perpetrate": From Middle English perpetrat "committed, perpetrated", from Latin perpetrātus, past participle of perpetrāre "to carry through".
Words: overhangs: sticks out over; hangs over · lulling: calming; making sleepy · glaciers: huge slow-moving masses of ice · perpetrate: perform an act, usually with a negative connotation · avalanche: a slide of large masses of snow and ice and mud down a mountain

18–28 min · Background and context · I do (10 min)
Mini-lecture (read or adapt the script).
The Vale of Chamounix and Mont Blanc were Romantic pilgrimage sites; Percy Shelley wrote 'Mont Blanc' (1816). The sublime landscape mirrors Victor's mind: grand, cold and overwhelming. Setting: The valley of Chamounix and Mont Blanc: the sublime landscape calms but cannot cure him. Tone / mood: Despair; Victor considers suicide in the lake but thinks of his family. Imagery: Glaciers, torrents, "awful and majestic" peaks dwarf human grief. Watch for sublime nature: Mountains, glaciers, storms and lakes reflect and sometimes soothe the characters' feelings; the sublime is both comfort and terror. In this chapter: "at ten o'clock, and the impossibility of remaining on the lake after that hour, had rendered our residence within the walls of" (Chapter IX, paragraph 5).

28–40 min · I do: modeled close reading · I do (12 min)
Model the close reading of the anchor quotation using the written think-aloud below.
I read the line once for meaning and once for craft. "Nothing is more painful to the human mind, than, after the feelings have been worked up by a quick succession of events, the dead calmness of inaction and certainty which follows" (Chapter IX, paragraph 1). Psychological insight into grief and guilt. That is setting at work: The valley of Chamounix and Mont Blanc: the sublime landscape calms but cannot cure him.

> *Nothing is more painful to the human mind, than, after the feelings have been worked up by a quick succession of events, the dead calmness of inaction and certainty which follows* (Chapter IX, paragraph 1)

Think-aloud: I read the line once for meaning and once for craft. "Nothing is more painful to the human mind, than, after the feelings have been worked up by a quick succession of events, the dead calmness of inaction and certainty which follows" (Chapter IX, paragraph 1). Psychological insight into grief and guilt. That is setting at work: The valley of Chamounix and Mont Blanc: the sublime landscape calms but cannot cure him.

40–55 min · We do: guided annotation · We do (15 min)
Guided analysis of a second quotation; expected answers given.
Ask: What words in this line stand out, and what do they suggest? Expected: Elizabeth reads "despair" and "revenge" in his face: the secret he keeps is visible to those who love him. Link: guilt isolates him even at home, and the trip to Chamounix is an attempt to escape it. Ask: How does this line connect to the sublime? Expected: Nature offers temporary relief from guilt. (Elizabeth sees what Victor hides; his guilt shows on his face.)

> *There is an expression of despair, and sometimes of revenge, in your countenance, that makes me tremble (Chapter IX, paragraph 9)*

Ask: What words in this line stand out, and what do they suggest?
Expected answer: Elizabeth reads "despair" and "revenge" in his face: the secret he keeps is visible to those who love him. Link: guilt isolates him even at home, and the trip to Chamounix is an attempt to escape it.
Ask: How does this line connect to the sublime?
Expected answer: Nature offers temporary relief from guilt. (Elizabeth sees what Victor hides; his guilt shows on his face.)

55–70 min · You do: independent annotation · You do (15 min)
Independent annotation and a claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph (exemplar given).
Annotate the chapter for setting, tone / mood (three marks with a margin note each), then write one claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph: what does this chapter suggest about despair and the sublime? Then start your writing prompt at your assigned level (HS Sophomore: Analyze how Chapter IX develops the idea of despair and the sublime. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of setting and imagery shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.) Exemplar: After the executions, Victor's guilt paralyzes him rather than moving him to act. When the text says “Nothing is more painful to the human mind, than, after the feelings have been worked up by a quick succession of events, the dead calmness of inaction and certainty which follows” (Chapter IX, paragraph 1), it shows this directly. He describes "the dead calmness of inaction and certainty" as the most painful state of mind, and his remorse becomes "a hell of intense tortures"; suffering replaces confession, so guilt leads nowhere.
Task: Annotate the chapter for setting, tone / mood (three marks with a margin note each), then write one claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph: what does this chapter suggest about despair and the sublime? Then start your writing prompt at your assigned level (HS Sophomore: Analyze how Chapter IX develops the idea of despair and the sublime. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of setting and imagery shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.)
Exemplar: After the executions, Victor's guilt paralyzes him rather than moving him to act. When the text says “Nothing is more painful to the human mind, than, after the feelings have been worked up by a quick succession of events, the dead calmness of inaction and certainty which follows” (Chapter IX, paragraph 1), it shows this directly. He describes "the dead calmness of inaction and certainty" as the most painful state of mind, and his remorse becomes "a hell of intense tortures"; suffering replaces confession, so guilt leads nowhere.

70–80 min · Discussion · We do (10 min)
Structured discussion from the 30 tiered questions, with facilitation notes.
Anchor question: How does the mountain landscape reflect Victor's feelings? Connect to Romanticism: what did these writers believe nature could do for people? Does the novel agree?
Anchor question: How does the mountain landscape reflect Victor's feelings?
Facilitation: Connect to Romanticism: what did these writers believe nature could do for people? Does the novel agree?

80–87 min · Exit ticket / chapter quiz · You do (7 min)
Chapter quiz in the app and an exit ticket (answer given).
Chapter quiz in the app, then: In one sentence, what does this chapter suggest about despair and the sublime? Support it with one short quotation. Model answer: After the executions, Victor's guilt paralyzes him rather than moving him to act. ("Nothing is more painful to the human mind, than, after the feelings have been worked up by a quick succession of events, the dead calmness of inaction and certa", Chapter IX, paragraph 1). Accept any defensible claim backed by a quotation from the chapter; the answer key for the quiz is in the Quiz section.
Exit ticket: In one sentence, what does this chapter suggest about despair and the sublime? Support it with one short quotation.
Answer: Model answer: After the executions, Victor's guilt paralyzes him rather than moving him to act. ("Nothing is more painful to the human mind, than, after the feelings have been worked up by a quick succession of events, the dead calmness of inaction and certa", Chapter IX, paragraph 1). Accept any defensible claim backed by a quotation from the chapter; the answer key for the quiz is in the Quiz section.

87–90 min · Closure · I do (3 min)
Summarize the lesson and preview the next reading.
Today we saw how setting shapes despair and the sublime. Key takeaway: nature offers temporary relief from guilt.

Total: 90 minutes.

Teacher analysis (spoilers)

Literary elements

- **Setting:** The valley of Chamounix and Mont Blanc: the sublime landscape calms but cannot cure him.
- **Tone / mood:** Despair; Victor considers suicide in the lake but thinks of his family.
- **Imagery:** Glaciers, torrents, "awful and majestic" peaks dwarf human grief.

Themes and how they develop

- **the sublime:** nature offers temporary relief from guilt.

Symbols and motifs

- **sublime nature:** Mountains, glaciers, storms and lakes reflect and sometimes soothe the characters' feelings; the sublime is both comfort and terror. In this chapter: "at ten o'clock, and the impossibility of remaining on the lake after that hour, had rendered our residence within the walls of" (Chapter IX, paragraph 5).

- **naming the creature:** Victor never names his creation; the words he uses (wretch, daemon, fiend, monster) show his rejection and shape the reader's view. In this chapter: “leave them exposed and unprotected to the malice of the fiend whom I had let loose among them” (Chapter IX, paragraph 5).

Key quotations (checked against the reading text)

- “Nothing is more painful to the human mind, than, after the feelings have been worked up by a quick succession of events, the dead calmness of inaction and certainty which follows” (Chapter IX, paragraph 1) Psychological insight into grief and guilt.
- “There is an expression of despair, and sometimes of revenge, in your countenance, that makes me tremble” (Chapter IX, paragraph 9) Elizabeth sees what Victor hides; his guilt shows on his face.
- “I was seized by remorse and the sense of guilt, which hurried me away to a hell of intense tortures” (Chapter IX, paragraph 1) Guilt imagined as hell.

Model claim-evidence-reasoning

Claim: After the executions, Victor's guilt paralyzes him rather than moving him to act.
Evidence: “Nothing is more painful to the human mind, than, after the feelings have been worked up by a quick succession of events, the dead calmness of inaction and certainty which follows” (Chapter IX, paragraph 1)
Reasoning: He describes "the dead calmness of inaction and certainty" as the most painful state of mind, and his remorse becomes "a hell of intense tortures"; suffering replaces confession, so guilt leads nowhere.

Vocabulary with etymology notes

Word	Definition (in this sentence)	In context	Word history
overhangs (verb)	sticks out over; hangs over	*I passed the bridge of Pélissier, where the ravine, which the river forms, opened before me, and I began to ascend the mountain that overhangs it.*	“overhangs”: From Old English oferhangan, corresponding to over + hang. (Wiktionary, https://en.wiktionary.org/wiki/overhang#Etymology)
lulling (adjective)	calming; making sleepy	*The same lulling sounds acted as a lullaby to my too keen sensations: when I placed my head upon my pillow, sleep crept over me; I felt it as it came, and blessed the giver of oblivion.*	
glaciers (noun)	huge slow-moving masses of ice	*Immense glaciers approached the road; I heard the rumbling thunder of the falling avalanche, and marked the smoke of its passage.*	
perpetrate (verb)	perform an act, usually with a	*I had been the author of unalterable evils; and I lived in daily fear, lest the monster whom*	“perpetrate”: From Middle English perpetrat "committed, perpetrated", from Latin perpetrātus, past participle of perpetrāre "to

	negative connotation	*I had created should perpetrate some new wickedness.*	carry through". (Wiktionary, https://en.wiktionary.org/wiki/perpetrate#Etymology)
avalanche (noun)	a slide of large masses of snow and ice and mud down a mountain	*Immense glaciers approached the road; I heard the rumbling thunder of the falling avalanche, and marked the smoke of its passage.*	
ephemeral (noun)	anything short-lived, as an insect that lives only for a day in its winged form	*It was during an access of this kind that I suddenly left my home, and bending my steps towards the near Alpine valleys, sought in the magnificence, the eternity of such scenes, to forget myself and my ephemeral, because human, sorrows.*	“ephemeral”: From New Latin ephemerus, from Ancient Greek ἐφήμερος, the more common form of ἐφημέριος "of, for, or during the day, living or lasting but for a day, short-lived, temporary", from ἐπί "on" + ἡμέρα "day". (Wiktionary, https://en.wiktionary.org/wiki/ephemeral#Etymology)
revisit (verb)	visit again	*At these moments I wept bitterly, and wished that peace would revisit my mind only that I might afford them consolation and happiness.*	“revisit”: From Middle English revisite, from Middle French revisiter and Latin revīsitāre. By surface analysis, re- + visit. (Wiktionary, https://en.wiktionary.org/wiki/revisit#Etymology)
thirsted (verb)	longed for something strongly	*I had begun life with benevolent intentions, and thirsted for the moment when I should put them in practice, and make myself useful to my fellow-beings.*	
assassinated (verb)	murder; especially of socially prominent persons	*William and Justine were assassinated, and the murderer escapes; he walks about the world free, and perhaps respected.*	“assassinated”: From assassin + -ate, after Middle French assassiner. (Wiktionary, https://en.wiktionary.org/wiki/assassinate#Etymology)
desponding (adjective)	losing hope; discouraged	*Elizabeth was sad and desponding; she no longer took delight in her ordinary occupations; all pleasure seemed to her sacrilege toward the dead; eternal woe and tears she then thought was the just tribute she should pay to innocence so blasted and destroyed.*	“desponding”: From Latin despondere "to give up, lose heart," from de- "away" + spondere "to promise." (Online Etymology Dictionary, https://www.etymonline.com/word/despond)

Discussion questions

1. How does the mountain landscape reflect Victor's feelings?
2. Where does setting appear in this chapter, and what effect does it have? Point to one passage.
3. How does this chapter connect to the book's larger concern with the sublime power of nature?

Classroom discussion questions (30, tiered)

Wait time after every question (3 s for DOK 1, 5 s for DOK 2, 8 to 10 s for DOK 3 and 4); think-pair-share on DOK 3 and 4; answer each response with a follow-up probe; close with student-generated questions. Focus sets by rigor level: Middle School: 1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 6, 11, 12, 13, 14, 21, 22; HS Freshman: 1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 12, 13, 14, 15, 22, 23, 24; HS Sophomore: 1, 2, 3, 4, 13, 14, 15, 16, 17, 23, 24, 25; HS Junior: 1, 2, 3, 14, 15, 16, 17, 18, 24, 25, 26, 27; HS Senior: 1, 2, 3, 15, 16, 17, 18, 25, 26, 27, 28, 29; AP: 1, 2, 16, 17, 18, 19, 20, 26, 27, 28, 29, 30; College Freshman: 1, 2, 17, 18, 19, 20, 21, 22, 27, 28, 29, 30; College Sophomore: 1, 2, 11, 18, 19, 20, 21, 22, 23, 28, 29, 30; College Junior: 1, 11, 12, 19, 20, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 29, 30; College Senior: 1, 11, 12, 13, 20, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 26, 30; Graduate / PhD: 1, 11, 12, 13, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 26, 27, 28

Literal / recall

1. What does Victor's despair lead him to contemplate? [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · 7.RC.1, 7.CC.1, 9-10.RC.1] Look for: Ending his own life
2. Where does Victor travel for relief? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · 7.RC.1, 7.CC.1, 9-10.RC.1] Look for: The Alps near Chamounix
3. Which mountain dominates the scenery? [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · 7.RC.1, 7.CC.1, 9-10.RC.1] Look for: Mont Blanc
4. What literary idea describes the overwhelming landscape? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · 7.RC.1, 7.CC.1, 9-10.RC.1] Look for: The sublime
5. What effect does nature have on Victor? [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · 7.RC.1, 7.CC.1, 9-10.RC.1] Look for: It soothes him for a time
6. Retell the three most important events of "Chapter IX" in order, in one sentence each. [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · 7.RC.1, 7.CC.1, 9-10.RC.1] Look for: Tormented by guilt, Victor considers suicide. His family withdraws to Belrive. Victor journeys into the Alps toward Chamounix, where the majesty of mountains, glaciers and Mont Blanc offers temporary relief.
7. Which characters appear or are mentioned in "Chapter IX"? Name two and one thing each says or does. [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · 7.RC.1, 7.CC.1, 9-10.RC.1] Look for: Names and actions taken from the chapter; check against the teacher summary.
8. Where and when does "Chapter IX" take place? Point to the line that tells you. [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · 7.RC.1, 7.CC.1, 9-10.RC.1] Look for: A place/time detail quoted from the chapter.
9. Reread: "I passed the bridge of Pélissier, where the ravine, which the river forms, opened before me, and I began to ascend the mountain that overhangs it." What does "overhangs" mean here, and what is literally happening in this line? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · 7.RC.1, 7.CC.1, 9-10.RC.1] Look for: overhangs: sticks out over; hangs over.
10. Reread: "The same lulling sounds acted as a lullaby to my too keen sensations: when I placed my head upon my pillow, sleep crept over me; I felt it as it came, and blessed the giver of oblivion." What does "lulling" mean here, and what is literally happening in this line? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · 7.RC.1, 7.CC.1, 9-10.RC.1] Look for: lulling: calming; making sleepy.

Inferential / analytical

1. What does "Chapter IX" suggest about despair and the sublime? State the inference and the line that supports it. [DOK 2 · thinkPairShare · wait 5 s · 7.RC.2, 7.CC.2, 9-10.RC.2] Look for: The sublime landscape mirrors Victor's mind: grand, cold and overwhelming.

2. Find one example of setting in this chapter. What does it reveal that a plain statement would not? [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · 7.RC.3, 7.CC.2, 9-10.RC.1] Look for: Look for where and when events happen and how place shapes action or feeling.
3. How does the imagery in this chapter shape what we understand about despair and the sublime? [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · 7.RC.12, 7.CC.2, 9-10.RC.12] Look for: Look for sensory details (sight, sound, cold, light) and what mood they create.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: After the executions, Victor's guilt paralyzes him rather than moving him to act. Useful evidence: “Nothing is more painful to the human mind, than, after the feelings have been worked up by a quick succession of events, the dead calmness of inaction and certainty which follows” (Chapter IX, paragraph 1): Psychological insight into grief and guilt. On imagery: Glaciers, torrents, "awful and majestic" peaks dwarf human grief. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
4. In the passage that begins “Our house was the house of mourning.”, why might Shelley have chosen these particular words? Pick two and explain their connotations. [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · 7.RC.12, 7.CC.2, 9-10.RC.12] Look for: Diction analysis of two words in the anchor passage.
5. What causes the main turn in “Chapter IX”, and what effect is it likely to have on what follows? [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · 7.RC.3, 7.CC.2, 9-10.RC.1] Look for: Tormented by guilt, Victor considers suicide. His family withdraws to Belrive. Victor journeys into the Alps toward Chamounix, where the majesty of mountains, glaciers and Mont Blanc offers temporary relief.
6. How does “Chapter IX” build on “Chapter VIII”? Name one link of cause and effect. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · 7.RC.3, 7.CC.2, 9-10.RC.3] Look for: A causal or structural link between this and the previous chapter.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: After the executions, Victor's guilt paralyzes him rather than moving him to act. Useful evidence: “There is an expression of despair, and sometimes of revenge, in your countenance, that makes me tremble” (Chapter IX, paragraph 9): Elizabeth sees what Victor hides; his guilt shows on his face. Theme link: nature offers temporary relief from guilt. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
7. What can we infer about a character's motives from what they say and do here, as opposed to what they claim? [DOK 3 · followUp · wait 8 s · 7.RC.3, 7.CC.2, 9-10.RC.1] Look for: An inference about motive supported by a quoted line.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: After the executions, Victor's guilt paralyzes him rather than moving him to act. Useful evidence: “I was seized by remorse and the sense of guilt, which hurried me away to a hell of intense tortures” (Chapter IX, paragraph 1): Guilt imagined as hell. Theme link: nature offers temporary relief from guilt. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
8. The bell-ringer asked: “How does the mountain landscape reflect Victor's feelings?” Now that we have read closely, how would you revise your first answer, and which line changed your mind? [DOK 2 · thinkPairShare · wait 5 s · 7.RC.2, 7.CC.2, 9-10.RC.2] Look for: A revised answer anchored in the text.
9. Where does tone / mood appear, and how does it connect this chapter to the larger concern with the sublime power of nature? [DOK 3 · followUp · wait 8 s · 7.RC.12, 7.CC.2, 9-10.RC.12] Look for: Look for word choices that reveal the narrator's attitude or the scene's feeling.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: After the executions, Victor's guilt paralyzes him rather than moving him to act. Useful evidence: “Nothing is more painful to the human mind, than, after the feelings have been worked up by a quick succession of events, the dead calmness of inaction and certainty

which follows" (Chapter IX, paragraph 1): Psychological insight into grief and guilt. On tone / mood: Despair; Victor considers suicide in the lake but thinks of his family. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

10. Background: The Vale of Chamounix and Mont Blanc were Romantic pilgrimage sites; Percy Shelley wrote 'Mont Blanc' (1816). How does knowing this change the way you read one moment in the chapter? [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · 7.RC.3, 7.CC.2, 9-10.RC.1] Look for: A specific moment reread in light of the context.
    Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: After the executions, Victor's guilt paralyzes him rather than moving him to act. Useful evidence: "There is an expression of despair, and sometimes of revenge, in your countenance, that makes me tremble" (Chapter IX, paragraph 9): Elizabeth sees what Victor hides; his guilt shows on his face. On setting: The valley of Chamounix and Mont Blanc: the sublime landscape calms but cannot cure him. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

Evaluative / synthesis / creative

1. A critic might argue: "The sublime landscape mirrors Victor's mind: grand, cold and overwhelming." How far do you agree? Take a stand and defend it with two lines from the chapter. [DOK 3 · fourCorners · wait 8 s · 7.RC.2, 7.CC.3, 9-10.RC.2] Look for: A defended position with evidence and one counterpoint.
    Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: After the executions, Victor's guilt paralyzes him rather than moving him to act. Useful evidence: "I was seized by remorse and the sense of guilt, which hurried me away to a hell of intense tortures" (Chapter IX, paragraph 1): Guilt imagined as hell. Theme link: nature offers temporary relief from guilt. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
2. Which character in this chapter acts most wisely, and which least? Judge them by a standard you name. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · 7.RC.3, 7.CC.3, 9-10.RC.1] Look for: An evaluation using an explicit criterion and evidence.
    Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: After the executions, Victor's guilt paralyzes him rather than moving him to act. Useful evidence: "Nothing is more painful to the human mind, than, after the feelings have been worked up by a quick succession of events, the dead calmness of inaction and certainty which follows" (Chapter IX, paragraph 1): Psychological insight into grief and guilt. Theme link: nature offers temporary relief from guilt. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
3. Rewrite one moment of "Chapter IX" from the point of view of a different character. What does the new angle reveal or hide about despair and the sublime? [DOK 4 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · 7.RC.1, 7.CC.3, 9-10.RC.1] Look for: A creative product with a rationale tied to the text.
    Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: After the executions, Victor's guilt paralyzes him rather than moving him to act. Useful evidence: "There is an expression of despair, and sometimes of revenge, in your countenance, that makes me tremble" (Chapter IX, paragraph 9): Elizabeth sees what Victor hides; his guilt shows on his face. Theme link: nature offers temporary relief from guilt. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
4. Write three questions of your own about "Chapter IX": one recall, one "why/how", and one "should/what if". Trade with a partner and answer theirs. [DOK 3 · studentGenerated · wait 8 s · 7.RC.2, 7.CC.3, 9-10.RC.2] Look for: Student-generated questions at three levels.
    Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: After the executions, Victor's guilt paralyzes him rather

than moving him to act. Useful evidence: “I was seized by remorse and the sense of guilt, which hurried me away to a hell of intense tortures” (Chapter IX, paragraph 1): Guilt imagined as hell. Theme link: nature offers temporary relief from guilt. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

5. Connect this chapter to the costs of unchecked ambition: is the link strong or weak so far? What would Shelley need to show next to strengthen it? [DOK 4 · socraticCircle · wait 8 s · 7.RC.2, 7.CC.3, 9-10.RC.2] Look for: A judgment of thematic development across the work.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: After the executions, Victor's guilt paralyzes him rather than moving him to act. Useful evidence: “Nothing is more painful to the human mind, than, after the feelings have been worked up by a quick succession of events, the dead calmness of inaction and certainty which follows” (Chapter IX, paragraph 1): Psychological insight into grief and guilt. Theme link: nature offers temporary relief from guilt. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

6. Is the setting in this chapter effective, or does it feel heavy-handed? Evaluate it as a reader would in a review. [DOK 3 · fourCorners · wait 8 s · 7.RC.3, 7.CC.3, 9-10.RC.1] Look for: An evaluative judgment with criteria and evidence.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: After the executions, Victor's guilt paralyzes him rather than moving him to act. Useful evidence: “There is an expression of despair, and sometimes of revenge, in your countenance, that makes me tremble” (Chapter IX, paragraph 9): Elizabeth sees what Victor hides; his guilt shows on his face. On setting: The valley of Chamounix and Mont Blanc: the sublime landscape calms but cannot cure him. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

7. Compare how “Chapter IX” treats despair and the sublime with how another text, film or event you know treats a similar idea. What does Frankenstein see that the other misses? [DOK 4 · socraticCircle · wait 8 s · 7.RC.2, 7.CC.3, 9-10.RC.2] Look for: A cross-text synthesis.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: After the executions, Victor's guilt paralyzes him rather than moving him to act. Useful evidence: “I was seized by remorse and the sense of guilt, which hurried me away to a hell of intense tortures” (Chapter IX, paragraph 1): Guilt imagined as hell. Theme link: nature offers temporary relief from guilt. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

8. Predict what “Chapter X” will bring, using two clues from this chapter. After reading, evaluate your prediction. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · 7.RC.3, 7.CC.3, 9-10.RC.3] Look for: A prediction or judgment justified with textual clues.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: After the executions, Victor's guilt paralyzes him rather than moving him to act. Useful evidence: “Nothing is more painful to the human mind, than, after the feelings have been worked up by a quick succession of events, the dead calmness of inaction and certainty which follows” (Chapter IX, paragraph 1): Psychological insight into grief and guilt. Theme link: nature offers temporary relief from guilt. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

9. Design a one-paragraph modern adaptation of this chapter (setting, characters, conflict). What must stay the same for it to still be about despair and the sublime? [DOK 4 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · 7.RC.2, 7.CC.3, 9-10.RC.2] Look for: A creative transfer that keeps the core idea.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: After the executions, Victor's guilt paralyzes him rather

than moving him to act. Useful evidence: “There is an expression of despair, and sometimes of revenge, in your countenance, that makes me tremble” (Chapter IX, paragraph 9): Elizabeth sees what Victor hides; his guilt shows on his face. Theme link: nature offers temporary relief from guilt. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

10. What question would you most like to ask Mary Shelley about this chapter, and what answer do you think the text itself gives? [DOK 4 · studentGenerated · wait 8 s · 7.RC.2, 7.CC.3, 9-10.RC.2] Look for: A student-generated question answered from evidence.

    Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: After the executions, Victor's guilt paralyzes him rather than moving him to act. Useful evidence: “I was seized by remorse and the sense of guilt, which hurried me away to a hell of intense tortures” (Chapter IX, paragraph 1): Guilt imagined as hell. Theme link: nature offers temporary relief from guilt. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

Annotation focus

- **Setting:** look for where and when events happen and how place shapes action or feeling (anchor passage in the We do segment)
- Also notice **Imagery**: sensory details (sight, sound, cold, light) and what mood they create
- Also notice **Tone / mood**: word choices that reveal the narrator's attitude or the scene's feeling

Chapter quiz: item bank (all eleven rigor versions)

1. [mc · recall · DOK 1] In the line “I had been the author of unalterable evils; and I lived in daily fear, lest the monster whom I had created should perpetrate some new wickedness.”, what does “perpetrate” most nearly mean?

   A. perform an act, usually with a negative connotation

   B. annoyances; worries

   C. to dull or stain the brightness of

   D. varied in color or appearance

   Key: A (perform an act, usually with a negative connotation)

2. [mc · recall · DOK 1] Which mountain dominates the scenery?

   A. Mont Blanc

   B. Vesuvius

   C. Ben Nevis

   D. Everest

   Key: A (Mont Blanc)

3. [fill · recall · DOK 1] Complete the quotation from Chapter IX, paragraph 1: “I was seized by remorse and the sense of guilt, which hurried me away to a hell of intense _____”

   Key: tortures

4. [mc · recall · DOK 1] In the line “Immense glaciers approached the road; I heard the rumbling thunder of the falling avalanche, and marked the smoke of its passage.”, what does “glaciers” most nearly mean?

   A. to grant; to give

   B. made loved or liked

C. loud, deep sounds

D. huge slow-moving masses of ice

Key: D (huge slow-moving masses of ice)

5. [fill · recall · DOK 1] Complete the quotation from Chapter IX, paragraph 9: “There is an expression of despair, and sometimes of revenge, in your _____, that makes me tremble”

   Key: countenance

6. [mc · recall · DOK 1] What literary idea describes the overwhelming landscape?

   A. The sublime

   B. Satire

   C. Pastoral comedy

   D. Allegory

   Key: A (The sublime)

7. [fill · recall · DOK 1] Fill in the blank with the vocabulary word that fits: “I had begun life with benevolent intentions, and _____ for the moment when I should put them in practice, and make myself useful to my fellow-beings.” Word bank: thirsted, glaciers, overhangs, lulling

   Key: thirsted

8. [fill · recall · DOK 1] Fill in the blank with the vocabulary word that fits: “It was during an access of this kind that I suddenly left my home, and bending my steps towards the near Alpine valleys, sought in the magnificence, the eternity of such scenes, to forget myself and my _____, because human, sorrows.” Word bank: lulling, ephemeral, overhangs, glaciers

   Key: ephemeral

9. [mc · recall · DOK 1] What does Victor's despair lead him to contemplate?

   A. Moving to England

   B. Ending his own life

   C. Marrying at once

   D. Becoming a monk

   Key: B (Ending his own life)

10. [mc · inference · DOK 2] Which choice best states a central concern of “Chapter IX”?

    A. Despair and the sublime

    B. The final reckoning

    C. Ambition and the hunger for discovery

    D. Injustice and the burden of silence

    Key: A (Despair and the sublime)

11. [mc · inference · DOK 2] What does this passage most clearly show? “There is an expression of despair, and sometimes of revenge, in your countenance, that makes me tremble” (Chapter IX, paragraph 9)

    A. The master has become the slave; a reversal the creature will state aloud in Chapter XX.

    B. Moral reasoning; strong evidence of his goodness.

    C. Elizabeth sees what Victor hides; his guilt shows on his face.

    D. Justine was pressured by her confessor; evidence about injustice and power.

    Key: C (Elizabeth sees what Victor hides; his guilt shows on his face.)

12. [mc · inference · DOK 2] What does this passage most clearly show? “I was seized by remorse and the sense of guilt, which hurried me away to a hell of intense tortures” (Chapter IX, paragraph 1)
    A. His education; each book shapes him.
    B. Victor's fear of consequences.
    C. The serpent alludes to Eden: knowledge as temptation and fall. Strong for a theme claim.
    D. Guilt imagined as hell.

    Key: D (Guilt imagined as hell.)

13. [short · inference · DOK 2] What can you infer from this line? “Nothing is more painful to the human mind, than, after the feelings have been worked up by a quick succession of events, the dead calmness of inaction and certainty which follows” (Chapter IX, paragraph 1) Answer in two or three sentences with one detail.
    Sample answer: Psychological insight into grief and guilt.

14. [mc · analysis · DOK 3] Which literary element does this describe in “Chapter IX”? The valley of Chamounix and Mont Blanc: the sublime landscape calms but cannot cure him.
    A. Alliteration
    B. Setting
    C. Personification
    D. Metaphor

    Key: B (Setting)

15. [short · analysis · DOK 3] Claim: After the executions, Victor's guilt paralyzes him rather than moving him to act. Explain how this evidence supports the claim: “Nothing is more painful to the human mind, than, after the feelings have been worked up by a quick succession of events, the dead calmness of inaction and certainty which follows” (Chapter IX, paragraph 1).
    Sample answer: He describes "the dead calmness of inaction and certainty" as the most painful state of mind, and his remorse becomes "a hell of intense tortures"; suffering replaces confession, so guilt leads nowhere.

16. [short · synthesis · DOK 4] Close reading: how do the diction and syntax of “There is an expression of despair, and sometimes of revenge, in your countenance, that makes me tremble” (Chapter IX, paragraph 9) shape its meaning? Consider a second, competing reading.
    Sample answer: Elizabeth sees what Victor hides; his guilt shows on his face.

17. [mc · recall · DOK 1] Where does Victor travel for relief?
    A. The coast of Italy
    B. The Alps near Chamounix
    C. Ingolstadt
    D. London

    Key: B (The Alps near Chamounix)

18. [mc · recall · DOK 1] In the line “I passed the bridge of Pélissier, where the ravine, which the river forms, opened before me, and I began to ascend the mountain that overhangs it.”, what does “overhangs” most nearly mean?
    A. causing or marked by grief or anguish
    B. sticks out over; hangs over
    C. disturb in mind or make uneasy or cause to be worried or alarmed
    D. annoyances; worries

Key: B (sticks out over; hangs over)

19. [fill · recall · DOK 1] Fill in the blank with the vocabulary word that fits: “At these moments I wept bitterly, and wished that peace would _____ my mind only that I might afford them consolation and happiness.”
    Word bank: lulling, glaciers, revisit, overhangs
    Key: revisit
20. [mc · recall · DOK 1] What effect does nature have on Victor?
    A. It bores him
    B. It makes him ill
    C. It angers him
    D. It soothes him for a time
    Key: D (It soothes him for a time)
21. [short · inference · DOK 2] What can you infer from this line? “There is an expression of despair, and sometimes of revenge, in your countenance, that makes me tremble” (Chapter IX, paragraph 9) Answer in two or three sentences with one detail.
    Sample answer: Elizabeth sees what Victor hides; his guilt shows on his face.
22. [mc · analysis · DOK 3] Which literary element does this describe in “Chapter IX”? Despair; Victor considers suicide in the lake but thinks of his family.
    A. Symbolism
    B. Setting
    C. Tone / mood
    D. Imagery
    Key: C (Tone / mood)
23. [short · analysis · DOK 3] Analyze the word choice in “I was seized by remorse and the sense of guilt, which hurried me away to a hell of intense tortures” (Chapter IX, paragraph 1). Pick two words and explain what they suggest.
    Sample answer: Guilt imagined as hell.
24. [short · synthesis · DOK 4] Close reading: how do the diction and syntax of “Nothing is more painful to the human mind, than, after the feelings have been worked up by a quick succession of events, the dead calmness of inaction and certainty which follows” (Chapter IX, paragraph 1) shape its meaning? Consider a second, competing reading.
    Sample answer: Psychological insight into grief and guilt.
25. [mc · inference · DOK 2] What does this passage most clearly show? “Nothing is more painful to the human mind, than, after the feelings have been worked up by a quick succession of events, the dead calmness of inaction and certainty which follows” (Chapter IX, paragraph 1)
    A. Victor's lesson; partly retracted.
    B. Psychological insight into grief and guilt.
    C. Isolation through allusion.
    D. Mocking accusation.
    Key: B (Psychological insight into grief and guilt.)
26. [short · synthesis · DOK 4] Evaluate this claim about the chapter: “After the executions, Victor's guilt paralyzes him rather than moving him to act.” Is it fully persuasive? Argue with evidence, including a passage that

complicates it.

Sample answer: He describes "the dead calmness of inaction and certainty" as the most painful state of mind, and his remorse becomes "a hell of intense tortures"; suffering replaces confession, so guilt leads nowhere.

27. [mc · recall · DOK 1] In the line “The same lulling sounds acted as a lullaby to my too keen sensations: when I placed my head upon my pillow, sleep crept over me; I felt it as it came, and blessed the giver of oblivion.”, what does “lulling” most nearly mean?

    A. changed into a different substance

    B. a feeling of evil to come

    C. foster the growth of

    D. calming; making sleepy

    Key: D (calming; making sleepy)

28. [fill · recall · DOK 1] Fill in the blank with the vocabulary word that fits: “Immense glaciers approached the road; I heard the rumbling thunder of the falling _____, and marked the smoke of its passage.” Word bank: avalanche, glaciers, lulling, overhangs

    Key: avalanche

29. [short · synthesis · DOK 4] Synthesis: trace how the sublime develops from an earlier chapter to “Chapter IX”. Use one quotation from each.

    Sample answer: nature offers temporary relief from guilt.

30. [fill · recall · DOK 1] Complete the quotation from Chapter IX, paragraph 1: “Nothing is more painful to the human mind, than, after the feelings have been worked up by a quick _____ of events, the dead calmness of inaction and certainty which follows”

    Key: succession

Rigor version	Items (in order)	Mix
Middle School	1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 6, 7, 8, 9, 10, 11, 12, 13, 14, 15, 16	recall 9, inference 4, analysis 2, synthesis 1
HS Freshman	17, 18, 5, 19, 9, 20, 7, 6, 11, 21, 13, 10, 14, 22, 23, 24	recall 8, inference 4, analysis 3, synthesis 1
HS Sophomore	20, 5, 6, 17, 2, 7, 10, 21, 11, 25, 13, 22, 15, 14, 26, 24	recall 6, inference 5, analysis 3, synthesis 2
HS Junior	9, 7, 3, 6, 27, 12, 13, 21, 11, 25, 23, 14, 15, 22, 26, 24	recall 5, inference 5, analysis 4, synthesis 2
HS Senior	3, 28, 1, 6, 11, 12, 25, 21, 13, 23, 14, 22, 15, 26, 16, 24	recall 4, inference 5, analysis 4, synthesis 3
AP	28, 9, 8, 21, 13, 12, 10, 11, 22, 15, 23, 14, 16, 24, 26, 29	recall 3, inference 5, analysis 4, synthesis 4
College Freshman	28, 7, 6, 12, 11, 25, 21, 13, 23, 14, 15, 22, 26, 29, 24, 16	recall 3, inference 5, analysis 4, synthesis 4
College Sophomore	28, 8, 12, 11, 21, 13, 10, 25, 14, 23, 15, 22, 26, 24, 29, 16	recall 2, inference 6, analysis 4, synthesis 4
College Junior	28, 8, 21, 10, 12, 11, 13, 25, 22, 23, 15, 14, 16, 26, 24, 29	

		recall 2, inference 6, analysis 4, synthesis 4
College Senior	5, 30, 10, 13, 11, 12, 21, 25, 23, 22, 14, 15, 24, 29, 26, 16	recall 2, inference 6, analysis 4, synthesis 4
Graduate / PhD	30, 28, 13, 11, 25, 12, 10, 21, 14, 22, 15, 23, 24, 26, 16, 29	recall 2, inference 6, analysis 4, synthesis 4

Writing prompts (eleven rigor levels)

Middle School (250 words; Indiana 2023: 7.RC.3, 7.W.1): Supported track (work from the passage your teacher selects). In “Chapter IX,” how does Shelley show despair and the sublime? Write a paragraph that states your claim, quotes two details from the passage, and explains how each detail supports your idea. Use the setting you noticed as one piece of evidence.

HS Freshman (350 words; Indiana 2023: 9-10.RC.1, 9-10.W.1): In Chapter IX, how does Shelley develop the idea of despair and the sublime? State a clear claim, support it with two or three quotations, and explain how the setting in the chapter helps build that idea.

HS Sophomore (450 words; Indiana 2023: 9-10.RC.1, 9-10.W.1): Analyze how Chapter IX develops the idea of despair and the sublime. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of setting and imagery shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.

HS Junior (550 words; Indiana 2023: 11-12.RC.3, 11-12.RC.1, 11-12.W.1): Analyze how the structure of Chapter IX (where it begins, turns and ends) and its setting shape the reader's understanding of despair and the sublime. Identify one place where the text leaves matters uncertain and explain how that uncertainty adds to its meaning.

HS Senior (600 words; Indiana 2023: 11-12.RC.1, 11-12.W.1): Two readers disagree about what Chapter IX suggests about despair and the sublime. Lay out two plausible interpretations, weigh the evidence for each (including the chapter's setting and imagery), and argue for the stronger one in a sustained, well-organized essay.

AP (650 words; Indiana 2023: 11-12.RC.1, 11-12.W.1): Write a literary argument in which you analyze how Mary Shelley uses setting in Chapter IX to complicate the reader's understanding of despair and the sublime. Develop a defensible thesis, select evidence purposefully, and explain how specific choices of diction and syntax create meaning.

College Freshman (1000 words; Indiana 2023: see unit standards): Situate Chapter IX within its historical and literary context and argue how the chapter's treatment of despair and the sublime responds to that context. Engage with at least one secondary perspective (a critic, historian or the author's own statements), integrate quotations smoothly, and cite in MLA style.

College Sophomore (1250 words; Indiana 2023: see unit standards): Read Chapter IX alongside the conventions of its genre and period. Argue how the chapter's handling of despair and the sublime follows or bends those conventions, using the setting as evidence, and test your reading against one published critic. Document two secondary sources in MLA.

College Junior (1500 words; Indiana 2023: see unit standards): Apply a named critical approach (for example formalist, historicist, feminist, psychoanalytic or ecocritical) to Chapter IX and its treatment of despair and the sublime. State your method, show what it reveals in the chapter's setting and imagery, and identify where the text resists it.

College Senior (2000 words; Indiana 2023: see unit standards): Develop a research argument that reads Chapter IX as evidence for a larger claim about despair and the sublime in Frankenstein. Connect close reading of the chapter to the whole novel, engage at least four scholarly sources, and state precisely where your reading departs from theirs (Chicago style).

Graduate / PhD (2500 words; Indiana 2023: see unit standards): Develop an original argument that reads Chapter IX as a hinge in the novel's larger treatment of despair and the sublime. Position your reading within a named critical conversation (for example formalist, historicist, psychoanalytic, feminist or postcolonial approaches), account for the textual history where relevant, and articulate the stakes of your intervention for scholarship on Frankenstein.

SAT-style questions

1. *Immense glaciers approached the road; I heard the rumbling thunder of the falling avalanche, and marked the smoke of its passage.*

   As used in the text, what does the word “glaciers” most nearly mean?

   A. losing hope; discouraged

   B. huge slow-moving masses of ice

   C. longed for something strongly

   D. murder; especially of socially prominent persons

2. *Our house was the house of mourning. My father’s health was deeply shaken by the horror of the recent events. Elizabeth was sad and desponding; she no longer took delight in her ordinary occupations; all pleasure seemed to her sacrilege toward the dead; eternal woe and tears she then thought was the just tribute she should pay to innocence so blasted and destroyed. She was no longer that happy creature, who in earlier youth wandered with me on the banks of the lake, and talked with ecstasy of our future prospects. The first of those sorrows which are sent to wean us from the earth, had visited her, and its dimming influence quenched her dearest smiles.*

   Which choice best states a central concern of “Chapter IX”?

   A. A privileged childhood and family love

   B. The demand for a companion

   C. Rejection and the turn to revenge

   D. Despair and the sublime

SAT key: 1. B (huge slow-moving masses of ice); 2. D (Despair and the sublime)

Lesson 17: Chapter X

Focus: confrontation between creator and creation

Objective: Students will analyze how allusion develops in “Chapter X” by writing a claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph that cites at least 2 quotations from the section, and will score at least 80% on the section quiz.

Standards: CCSS RL.9-10.9, W.9-10.1, L.9-10.4 · IN 9-10.RC.1, 9-10.W.1, 9-10.RC.9, 9-10.RC.11

Critical voice: “The encounter and argument between Frankenstein and the Being on the sea of ice, almost approaches, in effect, to the expostulation of Caleb Williams with Falkland.” (Percy Bysshe Shelley, poet, *"On 'Frankenstein'" (written c.1817; pub. The Athenaeum, 10 Nov 1832), in The Prose Works of Percy Bysshe Shelley (1880), paragraph 3*; public domain). Context mini-lesson: Godwin (Mary Shelley's father) wrote Caleb Williams, about a servant persecuted by his master. Who has power in the glacier scene, and how does the creature argue like a wronged servant? *Objective:* Analyze the confrontation between creator and creation on the Mer de Glace. *Standards:* RL.11-12.3, 11-12.RC.1

Teacher only · spoilers

On the glacier Montanvert, the creature approaches. Victor curses it; the creature answers eloquently, reminding Victor of his duties: 'I ought to be thy Adam, but I am rather the fallen angel.' He asks Victor to hear his story, and Victor follows him to a hut.

Background: Milton's Paradise Lost shapes the creature's self-understanding—God and Adam, Satan the outcast.

Significance: The creature's eloquence overturns expectations of a mindless monster and shifts our sympathies.

Lesson plan and lecture script (90 minutes)

> **0–8 min · Bell-ringer · You do (8 min)**
> Students write to the bell-ringer, then pair-share.
> *The creature says, 'I was benevolent and good; misery made me a fiend.' Do you believe him? Write for five minutes. Starters: I think... because... / This connects to nature and nurture because....*
> **Prompt:** The creature says, 'I was benevolent and good; misery made me a fiend.' Do you believe him?
> **Sentence starters:** I think… because… · This connects to nature and nurture because…
> **Strong response:** A strong response takes a position and anticipates this: "I was benevolent and good; misery made me a fiend": the novel's clearest statement of the argument.

8–18 min · Vocabulary with etymology notes · I do (10 min)
Five key words in context, with verified word histories.
Today's words: pollutes — spoils; makes impure; commiserate — to feel or show pity for; inspiriting — encouraging; filling with spirit; diabolically — as a devil; in an evil manner; overlooks — a high place affording a good view. "pollutes": From Middle English polluten, borrowed from Latin pollūtum, from pollūtus "no longer virgin", "unchaste", perfect passive participle of polluō "soil", "defile", "dishonor". "commiserate": From commiserātus, the perfect passive participle of commiseror. "inspiriting": From Middle English inspiriten, equivalent to in + spirit.
Words: pollutes: spoils; makes impure · commiserate: to feel or show pity for · inspiriting: encouraging; filling with spirit · diabolically: as a devil; in an evil manner · overlooks: a high place affording a good view

18–28 min · Background and context · I do (10 min)
Mini-lecture (read or adapt the script).
Milton's Paradise Lost shapes the creature's self-understanding—God and Adam, Satan the outcast. The creature's eloquence overturns expectations of a mindless monster and shifts our sympathies. Structure: The creature speaks: the novel's center. Victor's narrative gives way to the creature's for six chapters. Allusion: "I ought to be thy Adam; but I am rather the fallen angel": Paradise Lost frames the creature as both Adam and Satan. Characterization: The creature is eloquent, reasoned and grieving, the opposite of what Victor and the reader expect. Watch for light and fire: Light stands for knowledge and fire for its double edge: warmth and burning. Victor seeks the "light" of discovery; the creature discovers fire and is burned by it. In this chapter: "and allowed it to soar from the obscure world to light and joy. The sight of the awful and majestic in nature" (Chapter X, paragraph 2).

28–40 min · I do: modeled close reading · I do (12 min)
Model the close reading of the anchor quotation using the written think-aloud below.
I read the line once for meaning and once for craft. "I was benevolent and good; misery made me a fiend. Make me happy, and I shall again be virtuous" (Chapter X, paragraph 12). The nurture argument in one line. That is structure at work: The creature speaks: the novel's center. Victor's narrative gives way to the creature's for six chapters.

> *I was benevolent and good; misery made me a fiend. Make me happy, and I shall again be virtuous (Chapter X, paragraph 12)*

Think-aloud: I read the line once for meaning and once for craft. "I was benevolent and good; misery made me a fiend. Make me happy, and I shall again be virtuous" (Chapter X, paragraph 12). The nurture argument in one line. That is structure at work: The creature speaks: the novel's center. Victor's narrative gives way to the creature's for six chapters.

40–55 min · We do: guided annotation · We do (15 min)
Guided analysis of a second quotation; expected answers given.
Ask: What words in this line stand out, and what do they suggest? Expected: Adam was cherished by his creator; the fallen angel was cast out. The creature says he should be like Adam but is treated like Satan. This connects to responsibility and to nature versus nurture. Ask: How does this line connect to nature and nurture? Expected: "I was benevolent and good; misery made me a fiend": the novel's clearest statement of the argument. (Milton allusion; the creature casts Victor as a God who failed.)

> *I ought to be thy Adam; but I am rather the fallen angel* *(Chapter X, paragraph 12)*

Ask: What words in this line stand out, and what do they suggest?
Expected answer: Adam was cherished by his creator; the fallen angel was cast out. The creature says he should be like Adam but is treated like Satan. This connects to responsibility and to nature versus nurture.
Ask: How does this line connect to nature and nurture?
Expected answer: "I was benevolent and good; misery made me a fiend": the novel's clearest statement of the argument. (Milton allusion; the creature casts Victor as a God who failed.)

55–70 min · You do: independent annotation · You do (15 min)
Independent annotation and a claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph (exemplar given).
Annotate the chapter for structure, allusion (three marks with a margin note each), then write one claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph: what does this chapter suggest about confrontation between creator and creation? Then start your writing prompt at your assigned level (HS Sophomore: Analyze how Chapter X develops the idea of confrontation between creator and creation. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of allusion and characterization shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.) Exemplar: The creature argues that his evil was made, not born, and the novel gives him the eloquence to make the case. When the text says “I was benevolent and good; misery made me a fiend. Make me happy, and I shall again be virtuous” (Chapter X, paragraph 12), it shows this directly. He says, "I was benevolent and good; misery made me a fiend," placing the cause of his violence in his treatment, and asks Victor to "make me happy" so that he may be "virtuous" again.
Task: Annotate the chapter for structure, allusion (three marks with a margin note each), then write one claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph: what does this chapter suggest about confrontation between creator and creation? Then start your writing prompt at your assigned level (HS Sophomore: Analyze how Chapter X develops the idea of confrontation between creator and creation. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of allusion and characterization shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.)
Exemplar: The creature argues that his evil was made, not born, and the novel gives him the eloquence to make the case. When the text says “I was benevolent and good; misery made me a fiend. Make me happy, and I shall again be virtuous” (Chapter X, paragraph 12), it shows this directly. He says, "I was benevolent and good; misery made me a fiend," placing the cause of his violence in his treatment, and asks Victor to "make me happy" so that he may be "virtuous" again.

70–80 min · Discussion · We do (10 min)
Structured discussion from the 30 tiered questions, with facilitation notes.
Anchor question: The creature says, 'I was benevolent and good; misery made me a fiend.' Do you believe him? Hold a quick four-corners: do you believe the creature's claim? Students must cite a line.
Anchor question: The creature says, 'I was benevolent and good; misery made me a fiend.' Do you believe him?
Facilitation: Hold a quick four-corners: do you believe the creature's claim? Students must cite a line.

80–87 min · Exit ticket / chapter quiz · You do (7 min)
Chapter quiz in the app and an exit ticket (answer given).
Chapter quiz in the app, then: In one sentence, what does this chapter suggest about confrontation between creator and creation? Support it with one short quotation. Model answer: The creature argues that his evil was made, not born, and the novel gives him the eloquence to make the case. ("I was benevolent and good; misery made me a fiend. Make me happy, and I shall again be virtuous", Chapter X, paragraph 12). Accept any defensible claim backed by a quotation from the chapter; the answer key for the quiz is in the Quiz section.
Exit ticket: In one sentence, what does this chapter suggest about confrontation between creator and creation? Support it with one short quotation.
Answer: Model answer: The creature argues that his evil was made, not born, and the novel gives him the eloquence to make the case. ("I was benevolent and good; misery made me a fiend. Make me happy, and I shall again be virtuous", Chapter X, paragraph 12). Accept any defensible claim backed by a quotation from the chapter; the answer key for the quiz is in the Quiz section.

87–90 min · Closure · I do (3 min)
Summarize the lesson and preview the next reading.
Today we saw how structure shapes confrontation between creator and creation. Key takeaway: "I was benevolent and good; misery made me a fiend": the novel's clearest statement of the argument.

Total: 90 minutes.

Teacher analysis (spoilers)

Literary elements

- **Structure:** The creature speaks: the novel's center. Victor's narrative gives way to the creature's for six chapters.
- **Allusion:** "I ought to be thy Adam; but I am rather the fallen angel": Paradise Lost frames the creature as both Adam and Satan.
- **Characterization:** The creature is eloquent, reasoned and grieving, the opposite of what Victor and the reader expect.

Themes and how they develop

- **nature and nurture:** "I was benevolent and good; misery made me a fiend": the novel's clearest statement of the argument.

Symbols and motifs

- **light and fire:** Light stands for knowledge and fire for its double edge: warmth and burning. Victor seeks the "light" of discovery; the creature discovers fire and is burned by it. In this chapter: “and allowed it to soar from the obscure world to light and joy. The sight of the awful and majestic in nature” (Chapter X, paragraph 2).
- **sublime nature:** Mountains, glaciers, storms and lakes reflect and sometimes soothe the characters' feelings; the sublime is both comfort and terror. In this chapter: “sources of the Arveiron, which take their rise in a glacier, that with slow pace is advancing down from the summit of” (Chapter X, paragraph 1).

Key quotations (checked against the reading text)

- “I ought to be thy Adam; but I am rather the fallen angel” (Chapter X, paragraph 12) Milton allusion; the creature casts Victor as a God who failed.
- “I was benevolent and good; misery made me a fiend. Make me happy, and I shall again be virtuous” (Chapter X, paragraph 12) The nurture argument in one line.
- “Remember, that I am thy creature” (Chapter X, paragraph 12) Claims a relationship and a duty.

Model claim-evidence-reasoning

Claim: The creature argues that his evil was made, not born, and the novel gives him the eloquence to make the case.
Evidence: “I was benevolent and good; misery made me a fiend. Make me happy, and I shall again be virtuous” (Chapter X, paragraph 12)
Reasoning: He says, "I was benevolent and good; misery made me a fiend," placing the cause of his violence in his treatment, and asks Victor to "make me happy" so that he may be "virtuous" again.

Vocabulary with etymology notes

Word	Definition (in this sentence)	In context	Word history
pollutes (verb)	spoils; makes impure	*We rise; one wand’ring thought pollutes the day.*	“pollutes”: From Middle English polluten, borrowed from Latin pollūtum, from pollūtus "no longer virgin", "unchaste", perfect passive participle of polluō "soil", "defile", "dishonor". (Wiktionary, https://en.wiktionary.org/wiki/pollute#Etymology)
commiserate (verb)	to feel or show pity for	*Listen to my tale: when you have heard that, abandon or commiserate me, as you shall judge that I deserve.*	“commiserate”: From commiserātus, the perfect passive participle of commiseror. (Wiktionary, https://en.wiktionary.org/wiki/commiserate#Etymology)
inspiriting (adjective)	encouraging; filling with spirit	*All of soul-inspiriting fled with sleep, and dark melancholy clouded every thought.*	“inspiriting”: From Middle English inspiriten, equivalent to in + spirit. (Wiktionary, https://en.wiktionary.org/wiki/inspirit#Etymology)

diabolically (adverb)	as a devil; in an evil manner	*Begone, vile insect! or rather, stay, that I may trample you to dust! and, oh! that I could, with the extinction of your miserable existence, restore those victims whom you have so diabolically murdered!"*	
overlooks (noun)	a high place affording a good view	*For some time I sat upon the rock that overlooks the sea of ice.*	
implores (verb)	call upon in supplication; entreat	*Will no entreaties cause thee to turn a favourable eye upon thy creature, who implores thy goodness and compassion?*	
illuminate (verb)	make lighter or brighter	*The sun is yet high in the heavens; before it descends to hide itself behind yon snowy precipices, and illuminate another world, you will have heard my story, and can decide.*	"illuminate": From Middle English illuminaten, borrowed from Latin illūmināt̆us, perfect passive participle of illūminō "lighten, light up, show off" (see -ate for more), from in + lūminō, from lūmen "light". Cognate with Old English lȳman "to glow, shine". More at leam. (Wiktionary, https://en.wiktionary.org/wiki/illuminate#Etymology)
barricade (verb)	to block off	*I stood beside the sources of the Arveiron, which take their rise in a glacier, that with slow pace is advancing down from the summit of the hills, to barricade the valley.*	"barricade": The noun is borrowed from French barricade, or an assimilation of the earlier barricado to the French form. The verb is from the noun or French barricader. (Wiktionary, https://en.wiktionary.org/wiki/barricade#Etymology)
interspersed (verb)	place at intervals in or among	*The surface is very uneven, rising like the waves of a troubled sea, descending low, and interspersed by rifts that sink deep.*	"interspersed": From Latin interspergō, interspersus. (Wiktionary, https://en.wiktionary.org/wiki/intersperse#Etymology)
surmount (verb)	get on top of; deal with successfully	*The ascent is precipitous, but the path is cut into continual and short windings, which enable you to surmount the perpendicularity of the mountain.*	

Discussion questions

1. The creature says, 'I was benevolent and good; misery made me a fiend.' Do you believe him?
2. Where does allusion appear in this chapter, and what effect does it have? Point to one passage.

3. How does this chapter connect to the book's larger concern with the costs of unchecked ambition?

Classroom discussion questions (30, tiered)

Wait time after every question (3 s for DOK 1, 5 s for DOK 2, 8 to 10 s for DOK 3 and 4); think-pair-share on DOK 3 and 4; answer each response with a follow-up probe; close with student-generated questions. Focus sets by rigor level: Middle School: 1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 6, 11, 12, 13, 14, 21, 22; HS Freshman: 1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 12, 13, 14, 15, 22, 23, 24; HS Sophomore: 1, 2, 3, 4, 13, 14, 15, 16, 17, 23, 24, 25; HS Junior: 1, 2, 3, 14, 15, 16, 17, 18, 24, 25, 26, 27; HS Senior: 1, 2, 3, 15, 16, 17, 18, 25, 26, 27, 28, 29; AP: 1, 2, 16, 17, 18, 19, 20, 26, 27, 28, 29, 30; College Freshman: 1, 2, 17, 18, 19, 20, 21, 22, 27, 28, 29, 30; College Sophomore: 1, 2, 11, 18, 19, 20, 21, 22, 23, 28, 29, 30; College Junior: 1, 11, 12, 19, 20, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 29, 30; College Senior: 1, 11, 12, 13, 20, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 26, 30; Graduate / PhD: 1, 11, 12, 13, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 26, 27, 28

Literal / recall

1. Where does Victor meet the creature? [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · 7.RC.1, 7.CC.1, 9-10.RC.1] Look for: On the glacier at Montanvert
2. How does the creature speak? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · 7.RC.1, 7.CC.1, 9-10.RC.1] Look for: Eloquently and persuasively
3. Which work does the creature allude to? [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · 7.RC.1, 7.CC.1, 9-10.RC.1] Look for: Paradise Lost
4. What does the creature ask of Victor? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · 7.RC.1, 7.CC.1, 9-10.RC.1] Look for: To listen to his story
5. What is ironic about the creature's speech? [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · 7.RC.1, 7.CC.1, 9-10.RC.1] Look for: The 'monster' is more reasonable than his creator
6. Retell the three most important events of “Chapter X” in order, in one sentence each. [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · 7.RC.1, 7.CC.1, 9-10.RC.1] Look for: On the glacier Montanvert, the creature approaches. Victor curses it; the creature answers eloquently, reminding Victor of his duties: 'I ought to be thy Adam, but I am rather the fallen angel.' He asks Victor to hear his story, and Victor follows him to a hut.
7. Which characters appear or are mentioned in “Chapter X”? Name two and one thing each says or does. [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · 7.RC.1, 7.CC.1, 9-10.RC.1] Look for: Names and actions taken from the chapter; check against the teacher summary.
8. Where and when does “Chapter X” take place? Point to the line that tells you. [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · 7.RC.1, 7.CC.1, 9-10.RC.1] Look for: A place/time detail quoted from the chapter.
9. Reread: “We rise; one wand’ring thought pollutes the day.” What does “pollutes” mean here, and what is literally happening in this line? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · 7.RC.1, 7.CC.1, 9-10.RC.1] Look for: pollutes: spoils; makes impure.
10. Reread: “Listen to my tale: when you have heard that, abandon or commiserate me, as you shall judge that I deserve.” What does “commiserate” mean here, and what is literally happening in this line? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · 7.RC.1, 7.CC.1, 9-10.RC.1] Look for: commiserate: to feel or show pity for.

Inferential / analytical

1. What does “Chapter X” suggest about confrontation between creator and creation? State the inference and the line that supports it. [DOK 2 · thinkPairShare · wait 5 s · 7.RC.2, 7.CC.2, 9-10.RC.2] Look for: The creature's eloquence overturns expectations of a mindless monster and shifts our sympathies.

2. Find one example of allusion in this chapter. What does it reveal that a plain statement would not? [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · 7.RC.2, 7.CC.2, 9-10.RC.1] Look for: Look for references to other books, myths, history or religion.
3. How does the characterization in this chapter shape what we understand about confrontation between creator and creation? [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · 7.RC.3, 7.CC.2, 9-10.RC.1] Look for: Look for what characters say, do and think, and how others react to them.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The creature argues that his evil was made, not born, and the novel gives him the eloquence to make the case. Useful evidence: “I ought to be thy Adam; but I am rather the fallen angel” (Chapter X, paragraph 12): Milton allusion; the creature casts Victor as a God who failed. On characterization: The creature is eloquent, reasoned and grieving, the opposite of what Victor and the reader expect. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
4. In the passage that begins “We rest; a dream has power to poison sleep.”, why might Shelley have chosen these particular words? Pick two and explain their connotations. [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · 7.RC.12, 7.CC.2, 9-10.RC.12] Look for: Diction analysis of two words in the anchor passage.
5. What causes the main turn in “Chapter X”, and what effect is it likely to have on what follows? [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · 7.RC.3, 7.CC.2, 9-10.RC.1] Look for: On the glacier Montanvert, the creature approaches. Victor curses it; the creature answers eloquently, reminding Victor of his duties: 'I ought to be thy Adam, but I am rather the fallen angel.' He asks Victor to hear his story, and Victor follows him to a hut.
6. How does “Chapter X” build on “Chapter IX”? Name one link of cause and effect. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · 7.RC.3, 7.CC.2, 9-10.RC.3] Look for: A causal or structural link between this and the previous chapter.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The creature argues that his evil was made, not born, and the novel gives him the eloquence to make the case. Useful evidence: “I was benevolent and good; misery made me a fiend. Make me happy, and I shall again be virtuous” (Chapter X, paragraph 12): The nurture argument in one line. On structure: The creature speaks: the novel's center. Victor's narrative gives way to the creature's for six chapters. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
7. What can we infer about a character's motives from what they say and do here, as opposed to what they claim? [DOK 3 · followUp · wait 8 s · 7.RC.3, 7.CC.2, 9-10.RC.1] Look for: An inference about motive supported by a quoted line.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The creature argues that his evil was made, not born, and the novel gives him the eloquence to make the case. Useful evidence: “Remember, that I am thy creature” (Chapter X, paragraph 12): Claims a relationship and a duty. On characterization: The creature is eloquent, reasoned and grieving, the opposite of what Victor and the reader expect. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
8. The bell-ringer asked: “The creature says, 'I was benevolent and good; misery made me a fiend.' Do you believe him?” Now that we have read closely, how would you revise your first answer, and which line changed your mind? [DOK 2 · thinkPairShare · wait 5 s · 7.RC.2, 7.CC.2, 9-10.RC.2] Look for: A revised answer anchored in the text.
9. Where does irony appear, and how does it connect this chapter to the larger concern with the costs of unchecked ambition? [DOK 3 · followUp · wait 8 s · 7.RC.1, 7.CC.2, 9-10.RC.1] Look for: Look for gaps between what characters expect or say and what is true.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The creature argues that his evil was made, not born,

and the novel gives him the eloquence to make the case. Useful evidence: “I ought to be thy Adam; but I am rather the fallen angel” (Chapter X, paragraph 12): Milton allusion; the creature casts Victor as a God who failed. Theme link: "I was benevolent and good; misery made me a fiend": the novel's clearest statement of the argument. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

10. Background: Milton's Paradise Lost shapes the creature's self-understanding—God and Adam, Satan the outcast. How does knowing this change the way you read one moment in the chapter? [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · 7.RC.3, 7.CC.2, 9-10.RC.1] Look for: A specific moment reread in light of the context.
    Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The creature argues that his evil was made, not born, and the novel gives him the eloquence to make the case. Useful evidence: “I was benevolent and good; misery made me a fiend. Make me happy, and I shall again be virtuous” (Chapter X, paragraph 12): The nurture argument in one line. Theme link: "I was benevolent and good; misery made me a fiend": the novel's clearest statement of the argument. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

Evaluative / synthesis / creative

1. A critic might argue: “The creature's eloquence overturns expectations of a mindless monster and shifts our sympathies.” How far do you agree? Take a stand and defend it with two lines from the chapter. [DOK 3 · fourCorners · wait 8 s · 7.RC.2, 7.CC.3, 9-10.RC.2] Look for: A defended position with evidence and one counterpoint.
    Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The creature argues that his evil was made, not born, and the novel gives him the eloquence to make the case. Useful evidence: “Remember, that I am thy creature” (Chapter X, paragraph 12): Claims a relationship and a duty. Theme link: "I was benevolent and good; misery made me a fiend": the novel's clearest statement of the argument. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
2. Which character in this chapter acts most wisely, and which least? Judge them by a standard you name. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · 7.RC.3, 7.CC.3, 9-10.RC.1] Look for: An evaluation using an explicit criterion and evidence.
    Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The creature argues that his evil was made, not born, and the novel gives him the eloquence to make the case. Useful evidence: “I ought to be thy Adam; but I am rather the fallen angel” (Chapter X, paragraph 12): Milton allusion; the creature casts Victor as a God who failed. On characterization: The creature is eloquent, reasoned and grieving, the opposite of what Victor and the reader expect. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
3. Rewrite one moment of “Chapter X” from the point of view of a different character. What does the new angle reveal or hide about confrontation between creator and creation? [DOK 4 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · 7.RC.1, 7.CC.3, 9-10.RC.1] Look for: A creative product with a rationale tied to the text.
    Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The creature argues that his evil was made, not born, and the novel gives him the eloquence to make the case. Useful evidence: “I was benevolent and good; misery made me a fiend. Make me happy, and I shall again be virtuous” (Chapter X, paragraph 12): The nurture argument in one line. Theme link: "I was benevolent and good; misery made me a fiend": the novel's clearest statement of the argument. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

4. Write three questions of your own about “Chapter X”: one recall, one “why/how”, and one “should/what if”. Trade with a partner and answer theirs. [DOK 3 · studentGenerated · wait 8 s · 7.RC.2, 7.CC.3, 9-10.RC.2] Look for: Student-generated questions at three levels.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The creature argues that his evil was made, not born, and the novel gives him the eloquence to make the case. Useful evidence: “Remember, that I am thy creature” (Chapter X, paragraph 12): Claims a relationship and a duty. Theme link: "I was benevolent and good; misery made me a fiend": the novel's clearest statement of the argument. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

5. Connect this chapter to creation and responsibility: is the link strong or weak so far? What would Shelley need to show next to strengthen it? [DOK 4 · socraticCircle · wait 8 s · 7.RC.2, 7.CC.3, 9-10.RC.2] Look for: A judgment of thematic development across the work.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The creature argues that his evil was made, not born, and the novel gives him the eloquence to make the case. Useful evidence: “I ought to be thy Adam; but I am rather the fallen angel” (Chapter X, paragraph 12): Milton allusion; the creature casts Victor as a God who failed. Theme link: "I was benevolent and good; misery made me a fiend": the novel's clearest statement of the argument. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

6. Is the allusion in this chapter effective, or does it feel heavy-handed? Evaluate it as a reader would in a review. [DOK 3 · fourCorners · wait 8 s · 7.RC.2, 7.CC.3, 9-10.RC.1] Look for: An evaluative judgment with criteria and evidence.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The creature argues that his evil was made, not born, and the novel gives him the eloquence to make the case. Useful evidence: “I was benevolent and good; misery made me a fiend. Make me happy, and I shall again be virtuous” (Chapter X, paragraph 12): The nurture argument in one line. On allusion: "I ought to be thy Adam; but I am rather the fallen angel": Paradise Lost frames the creature as both Adam and Satan. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

7. Compare how “Chapter X” treats confrontation between creator and creation with how another text, film or event you know treats a similar idea. What does Frankenstein see that the other misses? [DOK 4 · socraticCircle · wait 8 s · 7.RC.2, 7.CC.3, 9-10.RC.2] Look for: A cross-text synthesis.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The creature argues that his evil was made, not born, and the novel gives him the eloquence to make the case. Useful evidence: “Remember, that I am thy creature” (Chapter X, paragraph 12): Claims a relationship and a duty. Theme link: "I was benevolent and good; misery made me a fiend": the novel's clearest statement of the argument. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

8. Predict what “Chapter XI” will bring, using two clues from this chapter. After reading, evaluate your prediction. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · 7.RC.3, 7.CC.3, 9-10.RC.3] Look for: A prediction or judgment justified with textual clues.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The creature argues that his evil was made, not born, and the novel gives him the eloquence to make the case. Useful evidence: “I ought to be thy Adam; but I am rather the fallen angel” (Chapter X, paragraph 12): Milton allusion; the creature casts Victor as a God who failed. Theme link: "I was benevolent and good; misery made me a fiend": the novel's clearest statement of the argument. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

9. Design a one-paragraph modern adaptation of this chapter (setting, characters, conflict). What must stay the same for it to still be about confrontation between creator and creation? [DOK 4 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · 7.RC.2, 7.CC.3, 9-10.RC.2] Look for: A creative transfer that keeps the core idea.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The creature argues that his evil was made, not born, and the novel gives him the eloquence to make the case. Useful evidence: “I was benevolent and good; misery made me a fiend. Make me happy, and I shall again be virtuous” (Chapter X, paragraph 12): The nurture argument in one line. Theme link: "I was benevolent and good; misery made me a fiend": the novel's clearest statement of the argument. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
10. What question would you most like to ask Mary Shelley about this chapter, and what answer do you think the text itself gives? [DOK 4 · studentGenerated · wait 8 s · 7.RC.2, 7.CC.3, 9-10.RC.2] Look for: A student-generated question answered from evidence.
    Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The creature argues that his evil was made, not born, and the novel gives him the eloquence to make the case. Useful evidence: “Remember, that I am thy creature” (Chapter X, paragraph 12): Claims a relationship and a duty. Theme link: "I was benevolent and good; misery made me a fiend": the novel's clearest statement of the argument. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

Annotation focus

- **Allusion:** look for references to other books, myths, history or religion (anchor passage in the We do segment)
- Also notice **Characterization**: what characters say, do and think, and how others react to them
- Also notice **Irony**: gaps between what characters expect or say and what is true

Chapter quiz: item bank (all eleven rigor versions)

1. [mc · recall · DOK 1] In the line “We rise; one wand’ring thought pollutes the day.”, what does “pollutes” most nearly mean?
   A. spoils; makes impure
   B. to put off doing something
   C. repeating
   D. not engaged in a gainful occupation

   Key: A (spoils; makes impure)
2. [mc · recall · DOK 1] In the line “Begone, vile insect! or rather, stay, that I may trample you to dust! and, oh! that I could, with the extinction of your miserable existence, restore those victims whom you have so diabolically murdered!””, what does “diabolically” most nearly mean?
   A. fill to satisfaction
   B. lingered; hung about
   C. looking at closely; examining
   D. as a devil; in an evil manner

   Key: D (as a devil; in an evil manner)

3. [fill · recall · DOK 1] Complete the quotation from Chapter X, paragraph 12: "I was _____ and good; misery made me a fiend. Make me happy, and I shall again be virtuous"
   Key: benevolent
4. [mc · recall · DOK 1] Which work does the creature allude to?
   A. Hamlet
   B. Robinson Crusoe
   C. Paradise Lost
   D. The Odyssey
   Key: C (Paradise Lost)
5. [mc · recall · DOK 1] In the line "All of soul-inspiriting fled with sleep, and dark melancholy clouded every thought.", what does "inspiriting" most nearly mean?
   A. encouraging; filling with spirit
   B. get involved, so as to alter or hinder an action, or through force or threat of force
   C. dotted; spotted
   D. careful and persistent
   Key: A (encouraging; filling with spirit)
6. [mc · recall · DOK 1] In the line "Listen to my tale: when you have heard that, abandon or commiserate me, as you shall judge that I deserve.", what does "commiserate" most nearly mean?
   A. careful and persistent
   B. to grant; to give
   C. to feel or show pity for
   D. a vault or building where corpses or bones are deposited
   Key: C (to feel or show pity for)
7. [mc · recall · DOK 1] How does the creature speak?
   A. In grunts
   B. Only in German
   C. Eloquently and persuasively
   D. Not at all
   Key: C (Eloquently and persuasively)
8. [fill · recall · DOK 1] Complete the quotation from Chapter X, paragraph 12: "_____, that I am thy creature"
   Key: Remember
9. [fill · recall · DOK 1] Fill in the blank with the vocabulary word that fits: "I stood beside the sources of the Arveiron, which take their rise in a glacier, that with slow pace is advancing down from the summit of the hills, to _____ the valley." Word bank: pollutes, inspiriting, barricade, commiserate
   Key: barricade
10. [short · inference · DOK 2] What can you infer from this line? "I ought to be thy Adam; but I am rather the fallen angel" (Chapter X, paragraph 12) Answer in two or three sentences with one detail.
    Sample answer: Milton allusion; the creature casts Victor as a God who failed.
11. [short · inference · DOK 2] What can you infer from this line? "I was benevolent and good; misery made me a fiend. Make me happy, and I shall again be virtuous" (Chapter X, paragraph 12) Answer in two or three

sentences with one detail.

Sample answer: The nurture argument in one line.

12. [mc · inference · DOK 2] Which choice best states a central concern of “Chapter X”?

    A. The origin of the novel and the idea of creation

    B. The demand for a companion

    C. Confrontation between creator and creation

    D. Delay and dread

    Key: C (Confrontation between creator and creation)

13. [mc · inference · DOK 2] What does this passage most clearly show? “Remember, that I am thy creature” (Chapter X, paragraph 12)

    A. "Unhallowed" means unholy, and "thing" refuses the creation a name. Students can use this to argue that the novel judges the act of creation as a transgression from its first image.

    B. A newborn's memory; invites sympathy.

    C. Claims a relationship and a duty.

    D. A question of identity.

    Key: C (Claims a relationship and a duty.)

14. [short · analysis · DOK 3] Claim: The creature argues that his evil was made, not born, and the novel gives him the eloquence to make the case. Explain how this evidence supports the claim: “I was benevolent and good; misery made me a fiend. Make me happy, and I shall again be virtuous” (Chapter X, paragraph 12).

    Sample answer: He says, "I was benevolent and good; misery made me a fiend," placing the cause of his violence in his treatment, and asks Victor to "make me happy" so that he may be "virtuous" again.

15. [mc · analysis · DOK 3] Which literary element does this describe in “Chapter X”? The creature speaks: the novel's center. Victor's narrative gives way to the creature's for six chapters.

    A. Hyperbole

    B. Structure

    C. Personification

    D. Plot

    Key: B (Structure)

16. [short · synthesis · DOK 4] Close reading: how do the diction and syntax of “I ought to be thy Adam; but I am rather the fallen angel” (Chapter X, paragraph 12) shape its meaning? Consider a second, competing reading.

    Sample answer: Milton allusion; the creature casts Victor as a God who failed.

17. [fill · recall · DOK 1] Fill in the blank with the vocabulary word that fits: “For some time I sat upon the rock that _____ the sea of ice.” Word bank: overlooks, inspiriting, pollutes, commiserate

    Key: overlooks

18. [fill · recall · DOK 1] Fill in the blank with the vocabulary word that fits: “Will no entreaties cause thee to turn a favourable eye upon thy creature, who _____ thy goodness and compassion?” Word bank: commiserate, pollutes, implores, inspiriting

    Key: implores

19. [fill · recall · DOK 1] Complete the quotation from Chapter X, paragraph 12: “I ought to be thy Adam; but I am _____ the fallen angel”

    Key: rather

20. [mc · recall · DOK 1] Where does Victor meet the creature?

    A. On the glacier at Montanvert

    B. In a church

    C. In Geneva

    D. On Walton's ship

    Key: A (On the glacier at Montanvert)

21. [fill · recall · DOK 1] Fill in the blank with the vocabulary word that fits: “The sun is yet high in the heavens; before it descends to hide itself behind yon snowy precipices, and _____ another world, you will have heard my story, and can decide.” Word bank: commiserate, inspiriting, illuminate, pollutes

    Key: illuminate

22. [mc · recall · DOK 1] What is ironic about the creature's speech?

    A. He agrees with Victor

    B. He is afraid of ice

    C. The 'monster' is more reasonable than his creator

    D. He is silent

    Key: C (The 'monster' is more reasonable than his creator)

23. [mc · inference · DOK 2] What does this passage most clearly show? “I was benevolent and good; misery made me a fiend. Make me happy, and I shall again be virtuous” (Chapter X, paragraph 12)

    A. Total despair; in the next chapter it becomes a vow of revenge.

    B. The nurture argument in one line.

    C. Psychological insight into grief and guilt.

    D. Pathetic fallacy and anticlimax: "accomplishment" is followed by horror.

    Key: B (The nurture argument in one line.)

24. [short · analysis · DOK 3] Analyze the word choice in “Remember, that I am thy creature” (Chapter X, paragraph 12). Pick two words and explain what they suggest.

    Sample answer: Claims a relationship and a duty.

25. [short · synthesis · DOK 4] Evaluate this claim about the chapter: “The creature argues that his evil was made, not born, and the novel gives him the eloquence to make the case.” Is it fully persuasive? Argue with evidence, including a passage that complicates it.

    Sample answer: He says, "I was benevolent and good; misery made me a fiend," placing the cause of his violence in his treatment, and asks Victor to "make me happy" so that he may be "virtuous" again.

26. [mc · recall · DOK 1] What does the creature ask of Victor?

    A. To give him money

    B. To fight him

    C. To leave Europe

    D. To listen to his story

    Key: D (To listen to his story)

27. [mc · analysis · DOK 3] Which literary element does this describe in “Chapter X”? "I ought to be thy Adam; but I am rather the fallen angel": Paradise Lost frames the creature as both Adam and Satan.

    A. Allusion

    B. Plot

    C. Theme

    D. Diction / vocabulary

    Key: A (Allusion)

28. [short · synthesis · DOK 4] Synthesis: trace how nature and nurture develops from an earlier chapter to “Chapter X”. Use one quotation from each.

    Sample answer: "I was benevolent and good; misery made me a fiend": the novel's clearest statement of the argument.

29. [short · synthesis · DOK 4] Close reading: how do the diction and syntax of “I was benevolent and good; misery made me a fiend. Make me happy, and I shall again be virtuous” (Chapter X, paragraph 12) shape its meaning? Consider a second, competing reading.

    Sample answer: The nurture argument in one line.

30. [mc · inference · DOK 2] What does this passage most clearly show? “I ought to be thy Adam; but I am rather the fallen angel” (Chapter X, paragraph 12)

    A. Ambiguity ("shape of a man") makes the creature's humanity a question from his first appearance.

    B. The novel's warning stated outright.

    C. A newborn's memory; invites sympathy.

    D. Milton allusion; the creature casts Victor as a God who failed.

    Key: D (Milton allusion; the creature casts Victor as a God who failed.)

Rigor version	Items (in order)	Mix
Middle School	1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 6, 7, 8, 9, 10, 11, 12, 13, 14, 15, 16	recall 9, inference 4, analysis 2, synthesis 1
HS Freshman	17, 18, 19, 1, 20, 9, 21, 22, 12, 13, 23, 11, 24, 14, 15, 25	recall 8, inference 4, analysis 3, synthesis 1
HS Sophomore	17, 18, 22, 20, 9, 26, 11, 12, 10, 13, 23, 15, 14, 27, 28, 29	recall 6, inference 5, analysis 3, synthesis 2
HS Junior	26, 9, 2, 3, 1, 23, 30, 12, 10, 13, 24, 15, 27, 14, 29, 28	recall 5, inference 5, analysis 4, synthesis 2
HS Senior	3, 17, 20, 5, 13, 11, 12, 23, 30, 14, 15, 24, 27, 16, 29, 25	recall 4, inference 5, analysis 4, synthesis 3
AP	17, 18, 3, 13, 30, 23, 11, 12, 15, 27, 14, 24, 16, 28, 25, 29	recall 3, inference 5, analysis 4, synthesis 4
College Freshman	5, 17, 8, 12, 11, 10, 23, 30, 14, 15, 24, 27, 16, 29, 28, 25	recall 3, inference 5, analysis 4, synthesis 4
College Sophomore	17, 18, 30, 23, 13, 11, 10, 12, 15, 14, 24, 27, 29, 28, 16, 25	recall 2, inference 6, analysis 4, synthesis 4
College Junior	17, 8, 13, 11, 10, 30, 23, 12, 24, 27, 14, 15, 28, 25, 16, 29	recall 2, inference 6, analysis 4, synthesis 4

College Senior	18, 17, 10, 11, 23, 13, 30, 12, 27, 15, 14, 24, 25, 28, 29, 16	recall 2, inference 6, analysis 4, synthesis 4
Graduate / PhD	17, 18, 13, 12, 23, 30, 11, 10, 27, 14, 15, 24, 16, 28, 25, 29	recall 2, inference 6, analysis 4, synthesis 4

Writing prompts (eleven rigor levels)

Middle School (250 words; Indiana 2023: 7.RC.2, 7.W.1): Supported track (work from the passage your teacher selects). In “Chapter X,” how does Shelley show confrontation between creator and creation? Write a paragraph that states your claim, quotes two details from the passage, and explains how each detail supports your idea. Use the allusion you noticed as one piece of evidence.

HS Freshman (350 words; Indiana 2023: 9-10.RC.1, 9-10.W.1): In Chapter X, how does Shelley develop the idea of confrontation between creator and creation? State a clear claim, support it with two or three quotations, and explain how the allusion in the chapter helps build that idea.

HS Sophomore (450 words; Indiana 2023: 9-10.RC.1, 9-10.W.1): Analyze how Chapter X develops the idea of confrontation between creator and creation. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of allusion and characterization shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.

HS Junior (550 words; Indiana 2023: 11-12.RC.3, 11-12.RC.1, 11-12.W.1): Analyze how the structure of Chapter X (where it begins, turns and ends) and its allusion shape the reader's understanding of confrontation between creator and creation. Identify one place where the text leaves matters uncertain and explain how that uncertainty adds to its meaning.

HS Senior (600 words; Indiana 2023: 11-12.RC.4, 11-12.W.1): Two readers disagree about what Chapter X suggests about confrontation between creator and creation. Lay out two plausible interpretations, weigh the evidence for each (including the chapter's allusion and characterization), and argue for the stronger one in a sustained, well-organized essay.

AP (650 words; Indiana 2023: 11-12.RC.4, 11-12.W.1): Write a literary argument in which you analyze how Mary Shelley uses allusion in Chapter X to complicate the reader's understanding of confrontation between creator and creation. Develop a defensible thesis, select evidence purposefully, and explain how specific choices of diction and syntax create meaning.

College Freshman (1000 words; Indiana 2023: see unit standards): Situate Chapter X within its historical and literary context and argue how the chapter's treatment of confrontation between creator and creation responds to that context. Engage with at least one secondary perspective (a critic, historian or the author's own statements), integrate quotations smoothly, and cite in MLA style.

College Sophomore (1250 words; Indiana 2023: see unit standards): Read Chapter X alongside the conventions of its genre and period. Argue how the chapter's handling of confrontation between creator and creation follows or bends those conventions, using the allusion as evidence, and test your reading against one published critic. Document two secondary sources in MLA.

College Junior (1500 words; Indiana 2023: see unit standards): Apply a named critical approach (for example formalist, historicist, feminist, psychoanalytic or ecocritical) to Chapter X and its treatment of confrontation between creator and creation. State your method, show what it reveals in the chapter's allusion and characterization, and identify where the text resists it.

College Senior (2000 words; Indiana 2023: see unit standards): Develop a research argument that reads Chapter X as evidence for a larger claim about confrontation between creator and creation in Frankenstein. Connect close reading of the chapter to the whole novel, engage at least four scholarly sources, and state precisely where your reading departs from theirs (Chicago style).

Graduate / PhD (2500 words; Indiana 2023: see unit standards): Develop an original argument that reads Chapter X as a hinge in the novel's larger treatment of confrontation between creator and creation. Position your reading within a named critical conversation (for example formalist, historicist, psychoanalytic, feminist or postcolonial approaches), account for the textual history where relevant, and articulate the stakes of your intervention for scholarship on Frankenstein.

SAT-style questions

1. *All of soul-inspiriting fled with sleep, and dark melancholy clouded every thought.*

   As used in the text, what does the word “inspiriting” most nearly mean?

   A. encouraging; filling with spirit

   B. to block off

   C. get on top of; deal with successfully

   D. place at intervals in or among

2. *We rest; a dream has power to poison sleep. We rise; one wand’ring thought pollutes the day. We feel, conceive, or reason; laugh or weep, Embrace fond woe, or cast our cares away; It is the same: for, be it joy or sorrow, The path of its departure still is free. Man’s yesterday may ne’er be like his morrow; Nought may endure but mutability!*

   Which choice best states a central concern of “Chapter X”?

   A. Loneliness and the desire for a friend

   B. Horror at the moment of creation

   C. Confrontation between creator and creation

   D. Obsession and the discovery of life

SAT key: 1. A (encouraging; filling with spirit); 2. C (Confrontation between creator and creation)

Lesson 18: Chapter XI

Focus: first experiences of the senses

Objective: Students will analyze how point of view develops in “Chapter XI” by writing a claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph that cites at least 2 quotations from the section, and will score at least 80% on the section quiz.

Standards: CCSS RL.9-10.6, W.9-10.1, L.9-10.4 · IN 9-10.RC.1, 9-10.W.1, 9-10.RC.9, 9-10.RC.11

Critical voice: “The result is, this monster, who was at first, according to his own account, but a harmless monster, becomes ferocious and malignant, in consequence of finding all his approaches to human society repelled with injurious violence and offensive marks of disgust.” (Walter Scott (attrib.), novelist and critic, *"Remarks on Frankenstein, or the Modern Prometheus; A Novel," Blackwood's Edinburgh Magazine 2:12 (March 1818), p. 618*; public domain). Cause-and-effect chart: log each "approach to human society" in Chapters XI-XVI and the response it meets. Does the evidence support Scott's summary? *Objective:* Analyze the creature's first encounters with humans and the cause of his change. *Standards:* RL.11-12.3, 11-12.RC.1

Teacher only · spoilers

The creature narrates his first days: confusion of senses, cold, hunger, the discovery of fire, and the joy of moonlight and birdsong. Villagers attack him, and he shelters in a hovel beside a cottage.

Background: Philosophers like Locke argued that the mind begins as a 'blank slate' shaped by experience.

Significance: The creature's innocence makes society's violence toward him shocking and central to the nature-nurture debate.

Lesson plan and lecture script (90 minutes)

> **0–8 min · Bell-ringer · You do (8 min)**
> Students write to the bell-ringer, then pair-share.
> *What does the creature learn from fire—both good and painful? Write for five minutes. Starters: I think... because... / This connects to nature and nurture because....*
> **Prompt:** What does the creature learn from fire—both good and painful?
> **Sentence starters:** I think… because… · This connects to nature and nurture because…
> **Strong response:** A strong response takes a position and anticipates this: he begins innocent; humans attack him on sight.

8–18 min · Vocabulary with etymology notes · I do (10 min)
Five key words in context, with verified word histories.
Today's words: debilitated — weakened; canopied — covered overhead like a canopy; incommoded — troubled; inconvenienced; purloined — make off with belongings of others; blackbird — any bird of the family Icteridae whose male is black or predominantly black. “debilitated”: From debilitatus, the past passive participle of Latin dēbilitō "to weaken, debilitate", from the adjective dēbilis "weak", itself from de- + habilis. Equivalent to dēbilitō + -ate. “blackbird”: From Middle English blakebird, blacbrid "ouzel; Eurasian blackbird", equivalent to black + bird.
Words: debilitated: weakened · canopied: covered overhead like a canopy · incommoded: troubled; inconvenienced · purloined: make off with belongings of others · blackbird: any bird of the family Icteridae whose male is black or predominantly black

18–28 min · Background and context · I do (10 min)
Mini-lecture (read or adapt the script).
Philosophers like Locke argued that the mind begins as a 'blank slate' shaped by experience. The creature's innocence makes society's violence toward him shocking and central to the nature-nurture debate. Point of view: The creature narrates his first days: confused senses, light and dark, hunger and cold. Imagery: Sensory discovery (the moon, birdsong, fire) told with the wonder of a newborn. Irony: Fire both warms and burns; "how strange... that the same cause should produce such opposite effects!" foreshadows his own nature. Watch for fire: the Promethean gift: warmth and pain together.

28–40 min · I do: modeled close reading · I do (12 min)
Model the close reading of the anchor quotation using the written think-aloud below.
I read the line once for meaning and once for craft. “It is with considerable difficulty that I remember the original era of my being” (Chapter XI, paragraph 1). A newborn's memory; invites sympathy. That is point of view at work: The creature narrates his first days: confused senses, light and dark, hunger and cold.

> *It is with considerable difficulty that I remember the original era of my being* (Chapter XI, paragraph 1)

Think-aloud: I read the line once for meaning and once for craft. “It is with considerable difficulty that I remember the original era of my being” (Chapter XI, paragraph 1). A newborn's memory; invites sympathy. That is point of view at work: The creature narrates his first days: confused senses, light and dark, hunger and cold.

40–55 min · We do: guided annotation · We do (15 min)
Guided analysis of a second quotation; expected answers given.
Ask: What words in this line stand out, and what do they suggest? Expected: Fire warms and burns: the "same cause" with "opposite effects." It symbolizes knowledge and creation, which can help or hurt. It links to the creature's own double nature. Ask: How does this line connect to nature and nurture? Expected: He begins innocent; humans attack him on sight. (Fire's double nature; symbol for knowledge and for the creature.)

> *How strange, I thought, that the same cause should produce such opposite effects* (Chapter XI, paragraph 6)

Ask: What words in this line stand out, and what do they suggest?
Expected answer: Fire warms and burns: the "same cause" with "opposite effects." It symbolizes knowledge and creation, which can help or hurt. It links to the creature's own double nature.
Ask: How does this line connect to nature and nurture?
Expected answer: He begins innocent; humans attack him on sight. (Fire's double nature; symbol for knowledge and for the creature.)

55–70 min · You do: independent annotation · You do (15 min)
Independent annotation and a claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph (exemplar given).
Annotate the chapter for point of view, imagery (three marks with a margin note each), then write one claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph: what does this chapter suggest about first experiences of the senses? Then start your writing prompt at your assigned level (HS Sophomore: Analyze how Chapter XI develops the idea of first experiences of the senses. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of point of view and imagery shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.) Exemplar: The creature begins as an innocent who meets violence before he commits any. When the text says “It is with considerable difficulty that I remember the original era of my being” (Chapter XI, paragraph 1), it shows this directly. He remembers "considerable difficulty" in understanding his first sensations, a newborn's helplessness, and the villagers' response to his approach is that "some fled, some attacked me," so hostility comes from them.
Task: Annotate the chapter for point of view, imagery (three marks with a margin note each), then write one claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph: what does this chapter suggest about first experiences of the senses? Then start your writing prompt at your assigned level (HS Sophomore: Analyze how Chapter XI develops the idea of first experiences of the senses. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of point of view and imagery shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.)
Exemplar: The creature begins as an innocent who meets violence before he commits any. When the text says “It is with considerable difficulty that I remember the original era of my being” (Chapter XI, paragraph 1), it shows this directly. He remembers "considerable difficulty" in understanding his first sensations, a newborn's helplessness, and the villagers' response to his approach is that "some fled, some attacked me," so hostility comes from them.

70–80 min · Discussion · We do (10 min)
Structured discussion from the 30 tiered questions, with facilitation notes.
Anchor question: What does the creature learn from fire—both good and painful? Ask students to compare the creature's first days with Victor's childhood in Chapter I.
Anchor question: What does the creature learn from fire—both good and painful?
Facilitation: Ask students to compare the creature's first days with Victor's childhood in Chapter I.

80–87 min · Exit ticket / chapter quiz · You do (7 min)
Chapter quiz in the app and an exit ticket (answer given).
Chapter quiz in the app, then: In one sentence, what does this chapter suggest about first experiences of the senses? Support it with one short quotation. Model answer: The creature begins as an innocent who meets violence before he commits any. ("It is with considerable difficulty that I remember the original era of my being", Chapter XI, paragraph 1). Accept any defensible claim backed by a quotation from the chapter; the answer key for the quiz is in the Quiz section.
Exit ticket: In one sentence, what does this chapter suggest about first experiences of the senses? Support it with one short quotation.
Answer: Model answer: The creature begins as an innocent who meets violence before he commits any. ("It is with considerable difficulty that I remember the original era of my being", Chapter XI, paragraph 1). Accept any defensible claim backed by a quotation from the chapter; the answer key for the quiz is in the Quiz section.

87–90 min · Closure · I do (3 min)
Summarize the lesson and preview the next reading.
Today we saw how point of view shapes first experiences of the senses. Key takeaway: he begins innocent; humans attack him on sight.

Total: 90 minutes.

Teacher analysis (spoilers)

Literary elements

- **Point of view:** The creature narrates his first days: confused senses, light and dark, hunger and cold.
- **Imagery:** Sensory discovery (the moon, birdsong, fire) told with the wonder of a newborn.
- **Irony:** Fire both warms and burns; "how strange... that the same cause should produce such opposite effects!" foreshadows his own nature.

Themes and how they develop

- **nature and nurture:** he begins innocent; humans attack him on sight.

Symbols and motifs

- **fire:** the Promethean gift: warmth and pain together.

Key quotations (checked against the reading text)

- "It is with considerable difficulty that I remember the original era of my being" (Chapter XI, paragraph 1) A newborn's memory; invites sympathy.
- "How strange, I thought, that the same cause should produce such opposite effects" (Chapter XI, paragraph 6) Fire's double nature; symbol for knowledge and for the creature.
- "some fled, some attacked me" (Chapter XI, paragraph 10) Human violence comes first.

Model claim-evidence-reasoning

Claim: The creature begins as an innocent who meets violence before he commits any.
Evidence: "It is with considerable difficulty that I remember the original era of my being" (Chapter XI, paragraph 1)
Reasoning: He remembers "considerable difficulty" in understanding his first sensations, a newborn's helplessness, and the villagers' response to his approach is that "some fled, some attacked me," so hostility comes from them.

Vocabulary with etymology notes

Word	Definition (in this sentence)	In context	Word history
debilitated (adjective)	weakened	*He turned on hearing a noise; and, perceiving me, shrieked loudly, and, quitting the hut, ran across the fields with a speed of which his debilitated form hardly appeared capable.*	"debilitated": From debilitatus, the past passive participle of Latin dēbilitō "to weaken, debilitate", from the adjective dēbilis "weak", itself from de- + habilis. Equivalent to dēbilitō + -ate. (Wiktionary, https://en.wiktionary.org/wiki/debilitate#Etymology)
canopied (verb)	covered overhead like a canopy	*I began also to observe, with greater accuracy, the forms that surrounded me, and to perceive the boundaries of the radiant roof of light which canopied me.*	
incommoded (verb)	troubled; inconvenienced	*As she walked along, seemingly incommoded by the burden, a young man met her, whose countenance expressed a deeper despondence.*	
purloined (verb)	make off with belongings of others	*I had first, however, provided for my sustenance for that day, by a loaf of coarse bread, which I purloined, and a cup with which I could drink, more conveniently than from my hand, of the pure water which flowed by my retreat.*	

blackbird (noun)	any bird of the family Icteridae whose male is black or predominantly black	*I found that the sparrow uttered none but harsh notes, whilst those of the blackbird and thrush were sweet and enticing.*	“blackbird”: From Middle English blakebird, blacbrid "ouzel; Eurasian blackbird", equivalent to black + bird. (Wiktionary, https://en.wiktionary.org/wiki/blackbird#Etymology)
wearying (verb)	exhaust or get tired through overuse or great strain or stress	*The light became more and more oppressive to me; and, the heat wearying me as I walked, I sought a place where I could receive shade.*	
enticed (verb)	tempted; attracted	*The silver hair and benevolent countenance of the aged cottager won my reverence, while the gentle manners of the girl enticed my love.*	
carpeted (verb)	covered as if with a carpet	*“Having thus arranged my dwelling, and carpeted it with clean straw, I retired; for I saw the figure of a man at a distance, and I remembered too well my treatment the night before, to trust myself in his power.*	
intercepted (verb)	seize on its way	*I was delighted when I first discovered that a pleasant sound, which often saluted my ears, proceeded from the throats of the little winged animals who had often intercepted the light from my eyes.*	“intercepted”: Borrowed from Latin interceptum, past participle of intercipiō. (Wiktionary, https://en.wiktionary.org/wiki/intercept#Etymology)
assuage (verb)	cause to be more favorably inclined; gain the good will of	*“Food, however, became scarce; and I often spent the whole day searching in vain for a few acorns to assuage the pangs of hunger.*	“assuage”: From Middle English aswagen, from Old French asuagier "to appease, to calm", from Vulgar Latin *assuāviō "to sweeten, to butter up, to calm", derived from Latin ad- + suāvis "sweet" + -iō. (Wiktionary, https://en.wiktionary.org/wiki/assuage#Etymology)

Discussion questions

1. What does the creature learn from fire—both good and painful?
2. Where does point of view appear in this chapter, and what effect does it have? Point to one passage.
3. How does this chapter connect to the book's larger concern with creation and responsibility?

Classroom discussion questions (30, tiered)

Wait time after every question (3 s for DOK 1, 5 s for DOK 2, 8 to 10 s for DOK 3 and 4); think-pair-share on DOK 3 and 4; answer each response with a follow-up probe; close with student-generated questions. Focus sets by rigor level: Middle School: 1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 6, 11, 12, 13, 14, 21, 22; HS Freshman: 1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 12, 13, 14, 15, 22, 23, 24; HS Sophomore: 1, 2, 3, 4, 13, 14, 15, 16, 17, 23, 24, 25; HS Junior: 1, 2, 3, 14, 15, 16, 17, 18, 24, 25, 26, 27; HS Senior: 1, 2, 3, 15, 16, 17, 18, 25, 26, 27, 28, 29; AP: 1, 2, 16, 17, 18, 19, 20, 26, 27, 28, 29, 30; College Freshman: 1, 2, 17, 18, 19, 20, 21, 22, 27, 28, 29, 30; College Sophomore: 1, 2, 11, 18, 19, 20, 21, 22, 23, 28, 29, 30; College Junior: 1, 11, 12, 19, 20, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 29, 30; College Senior: 1, 11, 12, 13, 20, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 26, 30; Graduate / PhD: 1, 11, 12, 13, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 26, 27, 28

Literal / recall

1. Who narrates this chapter? [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · 7.RC.1, 7.CC.1, 9-10.RC.1] Look for: The creature
2. What does the creature discover that both warms and burns? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · 7.RC.1, 7.CC.1, 9-10.RC.1] Look for: Fire
3. How do villagers react to him? [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · 7.RC.1, 7.CC.1, 9-10.RC.1] Look for: They attack him
4. Where does he take shelter? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · 7.RC.1, 7.CC.1, 9-10.RC.1] Look for: A hovel attached to a cottage
5. What pleases him in nature? [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · 7.RC.1, 7.CC.1, 9-10.RC.1] Look for: Moonlight and birdsong
6. Retell the three most important events of "Chapter XI" in order, in one sentence each. [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · 7.RC.1, 7.CC.1, 9-10.RC.1] Look for: The creature narrates his first days: confusion of senses, cold, hunger, the discovery of fire, and the joy of moonlight and birdsong. Villagers attack him, and he shelters in a hovel beside a cottage.
7. Which characters appear or are mentioned in "Chapter XI"? Name two and one thing each says or does. [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · 7.RC.1, 7.CC.1, 9-10.RC.1] Look for: Names and actions taken from the chapter; check against the teacher summary.
8. Where and when does "Chapter XI" take place? Point to the line that tells you. [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · 7.RC.1, 7.CC.1, 9-10.RC.1] Look for: A place/time detail quoted from the chapter.
9. Reread: "He turned on hearing a noise; and, perceiving me, shrieked loudly, and, quitting the hut, ran across the fields with a speed of which his debilitated form hardly appeared capable." What does "debilitated" mean here, and what is literally happening in this line? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · 7.RC.1, 7.CC.1, 9-10.RC.1] Look for: debilitated: weakened.
10. Reread: "I began also to observe, with greater accuracy, the forms that surrounded me, and to perceive the boundaries of the radiant roof of light which canopied me." What does "canopied" mean here, and what is literally happening in this line? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · 7.RC.1, 7.CC.1, 9-10.RC.1] Look for: canopied: covered overhead like a canopy.

Inferential / analytical

1. What does "Chapter XI" suggest about first experiences of the senses? State the inference and the line that supports it. [DOK 2 · thinkPairShare · wait 5 s · 7.RC.2, 7.CC.2, 9-10.RC.2] Look for: The creature's innocence makes society's violence toward him shocking and central to the nature-nurture debate.

2. Find one example of point of view in this chapter. What does it reveal that a plain statement would not? [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · 7.RC.1, 7.CC.2, 9-10.RC.1] Look for: Look for who is telling the story and what that narrator can and cannot know.
3. How does the imagery in this chapter shape what we understand about first experiences of the senses? [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · 7.RC.12, 7.CC.2, 9-10.RC.12] Look for: Look for sensory details (sight, sound, cold, light) and what mood they create.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The creature begins as an innocent who meets violence before he commits any. Useful evidence: “It is with considerable difficulty that I remember the original era of my being” (Chapter XI, paragraph 1): A newborn's memory; invites sympathy. On imagery: Sensory discovery (the moon, birdsong, fire) told with the wonder of a newborn. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
4. In the passage that begins ““The moon had disappeared from the night, and again, with a lessened form, showed itself, while I still remained in the forest.”, why might Shelley have chosen these particular words? Pick two and explain their connotations. [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · 7.RC.12, 7.CC.2, 9-10.RC.12] Look for: Diction analysis of two words in the anchor passage.
5. What causes the main turn in “Chapter XI”, and what effect is it likely to have on what follows? [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · 7.RC.3, 7.CC.2, 9-10.RC.1] Look for: The creature narrates his first days: confusion of senses, cold, hunger, the discovery of fire, and the joy of moonlight and birdsong. Villagers attack him, and he shelters in a hovel beside a cottage.
6. How does “Chapter XI” build on “Chapter X”? Name one link of cause and effect. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · 7.RC.3, 7.CC.2, 9-10.RC.3] Look for: A causal or structural link between this and the previous chapter.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The creature begins as an innocent who meets violence before he commits any. Useful evidence: “How strange, I thought, that the same cause should produce such opposite effects” (Chapter XI, paragraph 6): Fire's double nature; symbol for knowledge and for the creature. Theme link: he begins innocent; humans attack him on sight. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
7. What can we infer about a character's motives from what they say and do here, as opposed to what they claim? [DOK 3 · followUp · wait 8 s · 7.RC.3, 7.CC.2, 9-10.RC.1] Look for: An inference about motive supported by a quoted line.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The creature begins as an innocent who meets violence before he commits any. Useful evidence: “some fled, some attacked me” (Chapter XI, paragraph 10): Human violence comes first. Theme link: he begins innocent; humans attack him on sight. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
8. The bell-ringer asked: “What does the creature learn from fire—both good and painful?” Now that we have read closely, how would you revise your first answer, and which line changed your mind? [DOK 2 · thinkPairShare · wait 5 s · 7.RC.2, 7.CC.2, 9-10.RC.2] Look for: A revised answer anchored in the text.
9. Where does characterization appear, and how does it connect this chapter to the larger concern with creation and responsibility? [DOK 3 · followUp · wait 8 s · 7.RC.3, 7.CC.2, 9-10.RC.1] Look for: Look for what characters say, do and think, and how others react to them.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The creature begins as an innocent who meets violence before he commits any. Useful evidence: “It is with considerable difficulty that I remember the original era of my being” (Chapter XI, paragraph 1): A newborn's memory; invites sympathy. Theme link: he begins

innocent; humans attack him on sight. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

10. Background: Philosophers like Locke argued that the mind begins as a 'blank slate' shaped by experience. How does knowing this change the way you read one moment in the chapter? [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · 7.RC.3, 7.CC.2, 9-10.RC.1] Look for: A specific moment reread in light of the context.
    Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The creature begins as an innocent who meets violence before he commits any. Useful evidence: “How strange, I thought, that the same cause should produce such opposite effects” (Chapter XI, paragraph 6): Fire's double nature; symbol for knowledge and for the creature. Theme link: he begins innocent; humans attack him on sight. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

Evaluative / synthesis / creative

1. A critic might argue: “The creature's innocence makes society's violence toward him shocking and central to the nature-nurture debate.” How far do you agree? Take a stand and defend it with two lines from the chapter. [DOK 3 · fourCorners · wait 8 s · 7.RC.2, 7.CC.3, 9-10.RC.2] Look for: A defended position with evidence and one counterpoint.
    Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The creature begins as an innocent who meets violence before he commits any. Useful evidence: “some fled, some attacked me” (Chapter XI, paragraph 10): Human violence comes first. Theme link: he begins innocent; humans attack him on sight. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
2. Which character in this chapter acts most wisely, and which least? Judge them by a standard you name. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · 7.RC.3, 7.CC.3, 9-10.RC.1] Look for: An evaluation using an explicit criterion and evidence.
    Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The creature begins as an innocent who meets violence before he commits any. Useful evidence: “It is with considerable difficulty that I remember the original era of my being” (Chapter XI, paragraph 1): A newborn's memory; invites sympathy. Theme link: he begins innocent; humans attack him on sight. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
3. Rewrite one moment of “Chapter XI” from the point of view of a different character. What does the new angle reveal or hide about first experiences of the senses? [DOK 4 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · 7.RC.1, 7.CC.3, 9-10.RC.1] Look for: A creative product with a rationale tied to the text.
    Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The creature begins as an innocent who meets violence before he commits any. Useful evidence: “How strange, I thought, that the same cause should produce such opposite effects” (Chapter XI, paragraph 6): Fire's double nature; symbol for knowledge and for the creature. On point of view: The creature narrates his first days: confused senses, light and dark, hunger and cold. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
4. Write three questions of your own about “Chapter XI”: one recall, one “why/how”, and one “should/what if”. Trade with a partner and answer theirs. [DOK 3 · studentGenerated · wait 8 s · 7.RC.2, 7.CC.3, 9-10.RC.2] Look for: Student-generated questions at three levels.
    Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The creature begins as an innocent who meets violence before he commits any. Useful evidence: “some fled, some attacked me” (Chapter XI, paragraph 10): Human

violence comes first. Theme link: he begins innocent; humans attack him on sight. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

5. Connect this chapter to isolation and the need for companionship: is the link strong or weak so far? What would Shelley need to show next to strengthen it? [DOK 4 · socraticCircle · wait 8 s · 7.RC.2, 7.CC.3, 9-10.RC.2] Look for: A judgment of thematic development across the work.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The creature begins as an innocent who meets violence before he commits any. Useful evidence: “It is with considerable difficulty that I remember the original era of my being” (Chapter XI, paragraph 1): A newborn's memory; invites sympathy. Theme link: he begins innocent; humans attack him on sight. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

6. Is the point of view in this chapter effective, or does it feel heavy-handed? Evaluate it as a reader would in a review. [DOK 3 · fourCorners · wait 8 s · 7.RC.1, 7.CC.3, 9-10.RC.1] Look for: An evaluative judgment with criteria and evidence.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The creature begins as an innocent who meets violence before he commits any. Useful evidence: “How strange, I thought, that the same cause should produce such opposite effects” (Chapter XI, paragraph 6): Fire's double nature; symbol for knowledge and for the creature. On point of view: The creature narrates his first days: confused senses, light and dark, hunger and cold. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

7. Compare how “Chapter XI” treats first experiences of the senses with how another text, film or event you know treats a similar idea. What does Frankenstein see that the other misses? [DOK 4 · socraticCircle · wait 8 s · 7.RC.2, 7.CC.3, 9-10.RC.2] Look for: A cross-text synthesis.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The creature begins as an innocent who meets violence before he commits any. Useful evidence: “some fled, some attacked me” (Chapter XI, paragraph 10): Human violence comes first. Theme link: he begins innocent; humans attack him on sight. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

8. Predict what “Chapter XII” will bring, using two clues from this chapter. After reading, evaluate your prediction. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · 7.RC.3, 7.CC.3, 9-10.RC.3] Look for: A prediction or judgment justified with textual clues.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The creature begins as an innocent who meets violence before he commits any. Useful evidence: “It is with considerable difficulty that I remember the original era of my being” (Chapter XI, paragraph 1): A newborn's memory; invites sympathy. Theme link: he begins innocent; humans attack him on sight. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

9. Design a one-paragraph modern adaptation of this chapter (setting, characters, conflict). What must stay the same for it to still be about first experiences of the senses? [DOK 4 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · 7.RC.2, 7.CC.3, 9-10.RC.2] Look for: A creative transfer that keeps the core idea.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The creature begins as an innocent who meets violence before he commits any. Useful evidence: “How strange, I thought, that the same cause should produce such opposite effects” (Chapter XI, paragraph 6): Fire's double nature; symbol for knowledge and for the creature. Theme link: he begins innocent; humans attack him on sight. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

10. What question would you most like to ask Mary Shelley about this chapter, and what answer do you think the text itself gives? [DOK 4 · studentGenerated · wait 8 s · 7.RC.2, 7.CC.3, 9-10.RC.2] Look for: A student-generated question answered from evidence.
    Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The creature begins as an innocent who meets violence before he commits any. Useful evidence: "some fled, some attacked me" (Chapter XI, paragraph 10): Human violence comes first. Theme link: he begins innocent; humans attack him on sight. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

Annotation focus

- **Point of view:** look for who is telling the story and what that narrator can and cannot know (anchor passage in the We do segment)
- Also notice **Imagery**: sensory details (sight, sound, cold, light) and what mood they create
- Also notice **Characterization**: what characters say, do and think, and how others react to them

Chapter quiz: item bank (all eleven rigor versions)

1. [fill · recall · DOK 1] Fill in the blank with the vocabulary word that fits: "The light became more and more oppressive to me; and, the heat _____ me as I walked, I sought a place where I could receive shade." Word bank: canopied, incommoded, wearying, debilitated
   Key: wearying
2. [fill · recall · DOK 1] Fill in the blank with the vocabulary word that fits: "The silver hair and benevolent countenance of the aged cottager won my reverence, while the gentle manners of the girl _____ my love." Word bank: enticed, debilitated, incommoded, canopied
   Key: enticed
3. [fill · recall · DOK 1] Fill in the blank with the vocabulary word that fits: "I found that the sparrow uttered none but harsh notes, whilst those of the _____ and thrush were sweet and enticing." Word bank: incommoded, debilitated, blackbird, canopied
   Key: blackbird
4. [fill · recall · DOK 1] Fill in the blank with the vocabulary word that fits: ""Having thus arranged my dwelling, and _____ it with clean straw, I retired; for I saw the figure of a man at a distance, and I remembered too well my treatment the night before, to trust myself in his power." Word bank: carpeted, canopied, incommoded, debilitated
   Key: carpeted
5. [mc · recall · DOK 1] In the line "As she walked along, seemingly incommoded by the burden, a young man met her, whose countenance expressed a deeper despondence.", what does "incommoded" most nearly mean?
   A. impossible to overcome
   B. hesitated because of a moral doubt
   C. troubled; inconvenienced
   D. an elaborate analytical or explanatory essay or discussion
   Key: C (troubled; inconvenienced)

6. [mc · recall · DOK 1] In the line “I began also to observe, with greater accuracy, the forms that surrounded me, and to perceive the boundaries of the radiant roof of light which canopied me.”, what does “canopied” most nearly mean?
   A. showing; pointing to
   B. the savage and excessive killing of many people
   C. believed
   D. covered overhead like a canopy

   Key: D (covered overhead like a canopy)
7. [mc · recall · DOK 1] Who narrates this chapter?
   A. Elizabeth
   B. Walton
   C. Victor
   D. The creature

   Key: D (The creature)
8. [fill · recall · DOK 1] Complete the quotation from Chapter XI, paragraph 1: “It is with _____ difficulty that I remember the original era of my being”

   Key: considerable
9. [mc · recall · DOK 1] How do villagers react to him?
   A. They welcome him
   B. They ignore him
   C. They attack him
   D. They worship him

   Key: C (They attack him)
10. [short · inference · DOK 2] What can you infer from this line? “How strange, I thought, that the same cause should produce such opposite effects” (Chapter XI, paragraph 6) Answer in two or three sentences with one detail.

    Sample answer: Fire's double nature; symbol for knowledge and for the creature.
11. [mc · inference · DOK 2] What does this passage most clearly show? “some fled, some attacked me” (Chapter XI, paragraph 10)
    A. The first sentence already contains a warning (his sister's "evil forebodings"). Strong evidence for foreshadowing.
    B. Psychological insight into grief and guilt.
    C. Victor makes Justine's death about his suffering: a striking self-centeredness.
    D. Human violence comes first.

    Key: D (Human violence comes first.)
12. [short · inference · DOK 2] What can you infer from this line? “It is with considerable difficulty that I remember the original era of my being” (Chapter XI, paragraph 1) Answer in two or three sentences with one detail.

    Sample answer: A newborn's memory; invites sympathy.

13. [mc · inference · DOK 2] What does this passage most clearly show? “It is with considerable difficulty that I remember the original era of my being” (Chapter XI, paragraph 1)

    A. Revulsion at his labor.

    B. Shelley's theory of creativity: you build from existing materials, as Victor builds from old bones. Good evidence for a claim about the novel's self-awareness.

    C. A newborn's memory; invites sympathy.

    D. Victor's lesson; partly retracted.

    Key: C (A newborn's memory; invites sympathy.)

14. [mc · analysis · DOK 3] Which literary element does this describe in “Chapter XI”? The creature narrates his first days: confused senses, light and dark, hunger and cold.

    A. Structure

    B. Theme

    C. Foreshadowing

    D. Point of view

    Key: D (Point of view)

15. [short · analysis · DOK 3] Claim: The creature begins as an innocent who meets violence before he commits any. Explain how this evidence supports the claim: “It is with considerable difficulty that I remember the original era of my being” (Chapter XI, paragraph 1).

    Sample answer: He remembers "considerable difficulty" in understanding his first sensations, a newborn's helplessness, and the villagers' response to his approach is that "some fled, some attacked me," so hostility comes from them.

16. [short · synthesis · DOK 4] Close reading: how do the diction and syntax of “It is with considerable difficulty that I remember the original era of my being” (Chapter XI, paragraph 1) shape its meaning? Consider a second, competing reading.

    Sample answer: A newborn's memory; invites sympathy.

17. [mc · recall · DOK 1] In the line “He turned on hearing a noise; and, perceiving me, shrieked loudly, and, quitting the hut, ran across the fields with a speed of which his debilitated form hardly appeared capable.”, what does “debilitated” most nearly mean?

    A. repeating

    B. capture; being taken by force

    C. lit up

    D. weakened

    Key: D (weakened)

18. [fill · recall · DOK 1] Complete the quotation from Chapter XI, paragraph 6: “How strange, I thought, that the same cause should produce such _____ effects”

    Key: opposite

19. [mc · recall · DOK 1] What does the creature discover that both warms and burns?

    A. Iron

    B. Water

    C. Snow

    D. Fire

Key: D (Fire)

20. [mc · recall · DOK 1] Where does he take shelter?

    A. A castle

    B. A cave in the Alps

    C. A hovel attached to a cottage

    D. A church

    Key: C (A hovel attached to a cottage)

21. [mc · inference · DOK 2] What does this passage most clearly show? “How strange, I thought, that the same cause should produce such opposite effects” (Chapter XI, paragraph 6)

    A. Fire's double nature; symbol for knowledge and for the creature.

    B. Places the book in real time and place; compare with the 1831 Introduction's fuller account.

    C. Victor treats science as a spirit controlling him, shifting responsibility.

    D. The isolation of work.

    Key: A (Fire's double nature; symbol for knowledge and for the creature.)

22. [mc · analysis · DOK 3] Which literary element does this describe in “Chapter XI”? Sensory discovery (the moon, birdsong, fire) told with the wonder of a newborn.

    A. Point of view

    B. Imagery

    C. Personification

    D. Conflict

    Key: B (Imagery)

23. [short · synthesis · DOK 4] Synthesis: trace how nature and nurture develops from an earlier chapter to “Chapter XI”. Use one quotation from each.

    Sample answer: he begins innocent; humans attack him on sight.

24. [mc · recall · DOK 1] What pleases him in nature?

    A. Moonlight and birdsong

    B. Thunder

    C. Machines

    D. Crowded towns

    Key: A (Moonlight and birdsong)

25. [mc · inference · DOK 2] Which choice best states a central concern of “Chapter XI”?

    A. Delay and dread

    B. A letter, a secret and the wedding

    C. Obsession and the discovery of life

    D. First experiences of the senses

    Key: D (First experiences of the senses)

26. [short · synthesis · DOK 4] Evaluate this claim about the chapter: “The creature begins as an innocent who meets violence before he commits any.” Is it fully persuasive? Argue with evidence, including a passage that complicates it.

Sample answer: He remembers "considerable difficulty" in understanding his first sensations, a newborn's helplessness, and the villagers' response to his approach is that "some fled, some attacked me," so hostility comes from them.

27. [short · analysis · DOK 3] Analyze the word choice in “some fled, some attacked me” (Chapter XI, paragraph 10). Pick two words and explain what they suggest.
    Sample answer: Human violence comes first.
28. [short · synthesis · DOK 4] Close reading: how do the diction and syntax of “How strange, I thought, that the same cause should produce such opposite effects” (Chapter XI, paragraph 6) shape its meaning? Consider a second, competing reading.
    Sample answer: Fire's double nature; symbol for knowledge and for the creature.

Rigor version	Items (in order)	Mix
Middle School	1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 6, 7, 8, 9, 10, 11, 12, 13, 14, 15, 16	recall 9, inference 4, analysis 2, synthesis 1
HS Freshman	17, 3, 1, 18, 5, 8, 19, 20, 21, 11, 12, 10, 22, 15, 14, 23	recall 8, inference 4, analysis 3, synthesis 1
HS Sophomore	24, 19, 9, 2, 8, 6, 21, 13, 25, 10, 11, 22, 14, 15, 26, 16	recall 6, inference 5, analysis 3, synthesis 2
HS Junior	3, 5, 6, 17, 2, 12, 25, 11, 10, 13, 27, 22, 15, 14, 26, 16	recall 5, inference 5, analysis 4, synthesis 2
HS Senior	8, 18, 2, 9, 10, 25, 13, 21, 12, 22, 14, 15, 27, 26, 28, 23	recall 4, inference 5, analysis 4, synthesis 3
AP	3, 1, 20, 21, 11, 12, 13, 10, 22, 14, 15, 27, 26, 28, 16, 23	recall 3, inference 5, analysis 4, synthesis 4
College Freshman	8, 1, 20, 12, 11, 10, 21, 13, 27, 14, 15, 22, 28, 16, 26, 23	recall 3, inference 5, analysis 4, synthesis 4
College Sophomore	18, 3, 21, 13, 12, 11, 10, 25, 14, 27, 15, 22, 16, 26, 28, 23	recall 2, inference 6, analysis 4, synthesis 4
College Junior	3, 1, 10, 13, 11, 25, 12, 21, 27, 14, 22, 15, 23, 26, 16, 28	recall 2, inference 6, analysis 4, synthesis 4
College Senior	1, 3, 21, 10, 25, 13, 12, 11, 22, 27, 14, 15, 23, 28, 26, 16	recall 2, inference 6, analysis 4, synthesis 4
Graduate / PhD	4, 3, 10, 12, 11, 13, 25, 21, 22, 14, 27, 15, 28, 23, 16, 26	recall 2, inference 6, analysis 4, synthesis 4

Writing prompts (eleven rigor levels)

Middle School (250 words; Indiana 2023: 7.RC.1, 7.W.1): Supported track (work from the passage your teacher selects). In “Chapter XI,” how does Shelley show first experiences of the senses? Write a paragraph that states your claim, quotes two details from the passage, and explains how each detail supports your idea. Use the point of view you noticed as one piece of evidence.

HS Freshman (350 words; Indiana 2023: 9-10.RC.1, 9-10.W.1): In Chapter XI, how does Shelley develop the idea of first experiences of the senses? State a clear claim, support it with two or three quotations, and explain how the point of view in the chapter helps build that idea.

HS Sophomore (450 words; Indiana 2023: 9-10.RC.1, 9-10.W.1): Analyze how Chapter XI develops the idea of first experiences of the senses. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of point of view and imagery shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.

HS Junior (550 words; Indiana 2023: 11-12.RC.3, 11-12.RC.1, 11-12.W.1): Analyze how the structure of Chapter XI (where it begins, turns and ends) and its point of view shape the reader's understanding of first experiences

of the senses. Identify one place where the text leaves matters uncertain and explain how that uncertainty adds to its meaning. Distinguish what is directly stated from what is really meant.

HS Senior (600 words; Indiana 2023: 11-12.RC.1, 11-12.W.1): Two readers disagree about what Chapter XI suggests about first experiences of the senses. Lay out two plausible interpretations, weigh the evidence for each (including the chapter's point of view and imagery), and argue for the stronger one in a sustained, well-organized essay. Distinguish what is directly stated from what is really meant.

AP (650 words; Indiana 2023: 11-12.RC.1, 11-12.W.1): Write a literary argument in which you analyze how Mary Shelley uses point of view in Chapter XI to complicate the reader's understanding of first experiences of the senses. Develop a defensible thesis, select evidence purposefully, and explain how specific choices of diction and syntax create meaning.

College Freshman (1000 words; Indiana 2023: see unit standards): Situate Chapter XI within its historical and literary context and argue how the chapter's treatment of first experiences of the senses responds to that context. Engage with at least one secondary perspective (a critic, historian or the author's own statements), integrate quotations smoothly, and cite in MLA style.

College Sophomore (1250 words; Indiana 2023: see unit standards): Read Chapter XI alongside the conventions of its genre and period. Argue how the chapter's handling of first experiences of the senses follows or bends those conventions, using the point of view as evidence, and test your reading against one published critic. Document two secondary sources in MLA.

College Junior (1500 words; Indiana 2023: see unit standards): Apply a named critical approach (for example formalist, historicist, feminist, psychoanalytic or ecocritical) to Chapter XI and its treatment of first experiences of the senses. State your method, show what it reveals in the chapter's point of view and imagery, and identify where the text resists it.

College Senior (2000 words; Indiana 2023: see unit standards): Develop a research argument that reads Chapter XI as evidence for a larger claim about first experiences of the senses in Frankenstein. Connect close reading of the chapter to the whole novel, engage at least four scholarly sources, and state precisely where your reading departs from theirs (Chicago style).

Graduate / PhD (2500 words; Indiana 2023: see unit standards): Develop an original argument that reads Chapter XI as a hinge in the novel's larger treatment of first experiences of the senses. Position your reading within a named critical conversation (for example formalist, historicist, psychoanalytic, feminist or postcolonial approaches), account for the textual history where relevant, and articulate the stakes of your intervention for scholarship on Frankenstein.

SAT-style questions

1. *As she walked along, seemingly incommoded by the burden, a young man met her, whose countenance expressed a deeper despondence.*

   As used in the text, what does the word “incommoded” most nearly mean?

   A. covered as if with a carpet

   B. seize on its way

C. troubled; inconvenienced

D. cause to be more favorably inclined; gain the good will of

2. *"The moon had disappeared from the night, and again, with a lessened form, showed itself, while I still remained in the forest. My sensations had, by this time, become distinct, and my mind received every day additional ideas. My eyes became accustomed to the light, and to perceive objects in their right forms; I distinguished the insect from the herb, and, by degrees, one herb from another. I found that the sparrow uttered none but harsh notes, whilst those of the blackbird and thrush were sweet and enticing.*

Which choice best states a central concern of "Chapter XI"?

A. Delay and dread

B. The first spark of obsession

C. Loneliness and the desire for a friend

D. First experiences of the senses

SAT key: 1. C (troubled; inconvenienced); 2. D (First experiences of the senses)

Lesson 19: Chapter XII

Focus: learning compassion by watching

Objective: Students will analyze how characterization develops in “Chapter XII” by writing a claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph that cites at least 2 quotations from the section, and will score at least 80% on the section quiz.

Standards: CCSS RL.9-10.3, W.9-10.1, L.9-10.4 · IN 9-10.RC.1, 9-10.W.1, 9-10.RC.9, 9-10.RC.11

Teacher only · spoilers

Hidden, the creature observes the De Lacey family: the blind old father, Felix and Agatha. Seeing their poverty, he stops stealing their food and secretly gathers firewood for them. He begins to understand speech. Catching sight of his reflection in a pool, he is horrified at his own appearance.

Background: The cottage represents the domestic ideal praised in the Preface.

Significance: The creature's kindness shows his capacity for virtue before rejection hardens him.

Lesson plan and lecture script (90 minutes)

0–8 min · Bell-ringer · You do (8 min)
Students write to the bell-ringer, then pair-share.
What does the creature's secret help reveal about his nature? Write for five minutes. Starters: I think... because... / This connects to nature and nurture because....
Prompt: What does the creature's secret help reveal about his nature?
Sentence starters: I think… because… · This connects to nature and nurture because…
Strong response: A strong response takes a position and anticipates this: he learns virtue by watching virtue.

8–18 min · Vocabulary with etymology notes · I do (10 min)
Five key words in context, with verified word histories.
Today's words: exhilarated — filled with energy and excitement; arbiters — people with the power to decide; execration — cursing; expressions of hatred; endeared — made loved or liked; enhanced — increase. “arbiters”: From Middle English arbiter, arbytour, arbitre, from Old French arbitre, from Latin arbiter "a witness, judge, literally one who goes to see". “execration”: From Latin execrātiō.
Words: exhilarated: filled with energy and excitement · arbiters: people with the power to decide · execration: cursing; expressions of hatred · endeared: made loved or liked · enhanced: increase

18–28 min · Background and context · I do (10 min)
Mini-lecture (read or adapt the script).
The cottage represents the domestic ideal praised in the Preface. The creature's kindness shows his capacity for virtue before rejection hardens him. Characterization: From the hovel, the creature watches the De Lacey family and learns sympathy: he stops stealing their food when he realizes it hurts them. Point of view: He observes without being seen, like a reader; we learn about human kindness through his eyes. Imagery: His reflection in the pool: the first time he sees himself as others do. Watch for light and fire: Light stands for knowledge and fire for its double edge: warmth and burning. Victor seeks the "light" of discovery; the creature discovers fire and is burned by it. In this chapter: "The cottagers arose the next morning before the sun. The young woman arranged the cottage, and prepared the food; and" (Chapter XII, paragraph 2).

28–40 min · I do: modeled close reading · I do (12 min)
Model the close reading of the anchor quotation using the written think-aloud below.
I read the line once for meaning and once for craft. "how was I terrified, when I viewed myself in a transparent pool" (Chapter XII, paragraph 13). Self-horror learned from others' standards of beauty. That is characterization at work: From the hovel, the creature watches the De Lacey family and learns sympathy: he stops stealing their food when he realizes it hurts them.

> *how was I terrified, when I viewed myself in a transparent pool* (Chapter XII, paragraph 13)

Think-aloud: I read the line once for meaning and once for craft. "how was I terrified, when I viewed myself in a transparent pool" (Chapter XII, paragraph 13). Self-horror learned from others' standards of beauty. That is characterization at work: From the hovel, the creature watches the De Lacey family and learns sympathy: he stops stealing their food when he realizes it hurts them.

40–55 min · We do: guided annotation · We do (15 min)
Guided analysis of a second quotation; expected answers given.
Ask: What words in this line stand out, and what do they suggest? Expected: He stops stealing because it hurts them: empathy and self-control. This connects to nature versus nurture: watching good people teaches him goodness. Ask: How does this line connect to nature and nurture? Expected: He learns virtue by watching virtue. (Moral reasoning; strong evidence of his goodness.)

> *when I found that in doing this I inflicted pain on the cottagers, I abstained* (Chapter XII, paragraph 6)

Ask: What words in this line stand out, and what do they suggest?
Expected answer: He stops stealing because it hurts them: empathy and self-control. This connects to nature versus nurture: watching good people teaches him goodness.
Ask: How does this line connect to nature and nurture?
Expected answer: He learns virtue by watching virtue. (Moral reasoning; strong evidence of his goodness.)

55–70 min · You do: independent annotation · You do (15 min)
Independent annotation and a claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph (exemplar given).
Annotate the chapter for characterization, point of view (three marks with a margin note each), then write one claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph: what does this chapter suggest about learning compassion by watching? Then start your writing prompt at your assigned level (HS Sophomore: Analyze how Chapter XII develops the idea of learning compassion by watching. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of characterization and setting shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.) Exemplar: The creature develops compassion through observation, proving the capacity for goodness Victor never gave him credit for. When the text says "when I found that in doing this I inflicted pain on the cottagers, I abstained" (Chapter XII, paragraph 6), it shows this directly. When he realizes that stealing "inflicted pain on the cottagers," he "abstained," choosing others' welfare over his own hunger without being taught.
Task: Annotate the chapter for characterization, point of view (three marks with a margin note each), then write one claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph: what does this chapter suggest about learning compassion by watching? Then start your writing prompt at your assigned level (HS Sophomore: Analyze how Chapter XII develops the idea of learning compassion by watching. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of characterization and setting shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.)
Exemplar: The creature develops compassion through observation, proving the capacity for goodness Victor never gave him credit for. When the text says "when I found that in doing this I inflicted pain on the cottagers, I abstained" (Chapter XII, paragraph 6), it shows this directly. When he realizes that stealing "inflicted pain on the cottagers," he "abstained," choosing others' welfare over his own hunger without being taught.

70–80 min · Discussion · We do (10 min)
Structured discussion from the 30 tiered questions, with facilitation notes.
Anchor question: What does the creature's secret help reveal about his nature? Ask: why does Shelley make the creature learn language from a family rather than a book?
Anchor question: What does the creature's secret help reveal about his nature?
Facilitation: Ask: why does Shelley make the creature learn language from a family rather than a book?

80–87 min · Exit ticket / chapter quiz · You do (7 min)
Chapter quiz in the app and an exit ticket (answer given).
Chapter quiz in the app, then: In one sentence, what does this chapter suggest about learning compassion by watching? Support it with one short quotation. Model answer: The creature develops compassion through observation, proving the capacity for goodness Victor never gave him credit for. ("when I found that in doing this I inflicted pain on the cottagers, I abstained", Chapter XII, paragraph 6). Accept any defensible claim backed by a quotation from the chapter; the answer key for the quiz is in the Quiz section.
Exit ticket: In one sentence, what does this chapter suggest about learning compassion by watching? Support it with one short quotation.
Answer: Model answer: The creature develops compassion through observation, proving the capacity for goodness Victor never gave him credit for. ("when I found that in doing this I inflicted pain on the cottagers, I abstained", Chapter XII, paragraph 6). Accept any defensible claim backed by a quotation from the chapter; the answer key for the quiz is in the Quiz section.

> **87–90 min · Closure · I do (3 min)**
> Summarize the lesson and preview the next reading.
> *Today we saw how characterization shapes learning compassion by watching. Key takeaway: he learns virtue by watching virtue.*

Total: 90 minutes.

Teacher analysis (spoilers)

Literary elements

- **Characterization:** From the hovel, the creature watches the De Lacey family and learns sympathy: he stops stealing their food when he realizes it hurts them.
- **Point of view:** He observes without being seen, like a reader; we learn about human kindness through his eyes.
- **Imagery:** His reflection in the pool: the first time he sees himself as others do.

Themes and how they develop

- **nature and nurture:** he learns virtue by watching virtue.

Symbols and motifs

- **light and fire:** Light stands for knowledge and fire for its double edge: warmth and burning. Victor seeks the "light" of discovery; the creature discovers fire and is burned by it. In this chapter: “The cottagers arose the next morning before the sun. The young woman arranged the cottage, and prepared the food; and” (Chapter XII, paragraph 2).
- **naming the creature:** Victor never names his creation; the words he uses (wretch, daemon, fiend, monster) show his rejection and shape the reader's view. In this chapter: “I became fully convinced that I was in reality the monster that I am, I was filled with the bitterest sensations of” (Chapter XII, paragraph 13).

Key quotations (checked against the reading text)

- “when I found that in doing this I inflicted pain on the cottagers, I abstained” (Chapter XII, paragraph 6) Moral reasoning; strong evidence of his goodness.
- “how was I terrified, when I viewed myself in a transparent pool” (Chapter XII, paragraph 13) Self-horror learned from others' standards of beauty.
- “fire,’ ‘milk,’ ‘bread,’ and ‘wood” (Chapter XII, paragraph 9) The first words he learns: basic needs and the home.

Model claim-evidence-reasoning

Claim: The creature develops compassion through observation, proving the capacity for goodness Victor never gave him credit for.
Evidence: “when I found that in doing this I inflicted pain on the cottagers, I abstained” (Chapter XII, paragraph 6)

Reasoning: When he realizes that stealing "inflicted pain on the cottagers," he "abstained," choosing others' welfare over his own hunger without being taught.

Vocabulary with etymology notes

Word	Definition (in this sentence)	In context	Word history
exhilarated (verb)	filled with energy and excitement	*"These thoughts exhilarated me, and led me to apply with fresh ardour to the acquiring the art of language.*	
arbiters (noun)	people with the power to decide	*I looked upon them as superior beings, who would be the arbiters of my future destiny.*	"arbiters": From Middle English arbiter, arbytour, arbitre, from Old French arbitre, from Latin arbiter "a witness, judge, literally one who goes to see". (Wiktionary, https://en.wiktionary.org/wiki/arbiter#Etymology)
execration (noun)	cursing; expressions of hatred	*It was as the ass and the lapdog; yet surely the gentle ass whose intentions were affectionate, although his manners were rude, deserved better treatment than blows and execration.*	"execration": From Latin execrātiō. (Wiktionary, https://en.wiktionary.org/wiki/execration#Etymology)
endeared (verb)	made loved or liked	*The gentle manners and beauty of the cottagers greatly endeared them to me: when they were unhappy, I felt depressed; when they rejoiced, I sympathised in their joys.*	
enhanced (verb)	increase	*I saw few human beings beside them; and if any other happened to enter the cottage, their harsh manners and rude gait only enhanced to me the superior accomplishments of my friends.*	
pronunciation (noun)	the manner in which someone utters a word	*Their pronunciation was quick; and the words they uttered, not having any apparent connection with visible objects, I was unable to discover any clue by which I could unravel the mystery of their reference.*	

cultivating (verb)	foster the growth of	*I observed, with pleasure, that he did not go to the forest that day, but spent it in repairing the cottage, and cultivating the garden.*	
starlight (noun)	the light of the stars	*When they had retired to rest, if there was any moon, or the night was starlight, I went into the woods, and collected my own food and fuel for the cottage.*	“starlight”: From star + light. (Wiktionary, https://en.wiktionary.org/wiki/starlight#Etymology)
conjectured (verb)	to believe especially on uncertain or tentative grounds	*I conjectured, therefore, that he found on the paper signs for speech which he understood, and I ardently longed to comprehend these also; but how was that possible, when I did not even understand the sounds for which they stood as signs?*	“conjectured”: From Old French -, from Latin coniectūra "a guess", from coniectus, perfect passive participle of cōniciō "throw or cast together; guess", from con- "together" + iaciō "throw, hurl"; see jet. Compare adjective, eject, inject, project, reject, subject, object, trajectory, deject, abject, surjection, bijection, interject. (Wiktionary, https://en.wiktionary.org/wiki/conjecture#Etymology)
communicating (verb)	transmit information	*I found that these people possessed a method of communicating their experience and feelings to one another by articulate sounds.*	

Discussion questions

1. What does the creature's secret help reveal about his nature?
2. Where does characterization appear in this chapter, and what effect does it have? Point to one passage.
3. How does this chapter connect to the book's larger concern with isolation and the need for companionship?

Classroom discussion questions (30, tiered)

Wait time after every question (3 s for DOK 1, 5 s for DOK 2, 8 to 10 s for DOK 3 and 4); think-pair-share on DOK 3 and 4; answer each response with a follow-up probe; close with student-generated questions. Focus sets by rigor level: Middle School: 1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 6, 11, 12, 13, 14, 21, 22; HS Freshman: 1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 12, 13, 14, 15, 22, 23, 24; HS Sophomore: 1, 2, 3, 4, 13, 14, 15, 16, 17, 23, 24, 25; HS Junior: 1, 2, 3, 14, 15, 16, 17, 18, 24, 25, 26, 27; HS Senior: 1, 2, 3, 15, 16, 17, 18, 25, 26, 27, 28, 29; AP: 1, 2, 16, 17, 18, 19, 20, 26, 27, 28, 29, 30; College Freshman: 1, 2, 17, 18, 19, 20, 21, 22, 27, 28, 29, 30; College Sophomore: 1, 2, 11, 18, 19, 20, 21, 22, 23, 28, 29, 30; College Junior: 1, 11, 12, 19, 20, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 29, 30; College Senior: 1, 11, 12, 13, 20, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 26, 30; Graduate / PhD: 1, 11, 12, 13, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 26, 27, 28

Literal / recall

1. Whom does the creature observe? [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · 7.RC.1, 7.CC.1, 9-10.RC.1] Look for: The De Lacey family

2. Which family member is blind? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · 7.RC.1, 7.CC.1, 9-10.RC.1] Look for: The old father
3. Why does the creature stop taking their food? [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · 7.RC.1, 7.CC.1, 9-10.RC.1] Look for: He realizes they are poor
4. What does the creature see in a clear pool? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · 7.RC.1, 7.CC.1, 9-10.RC.1] Look for: His own frightening reflection
5. What does he begin to learn? [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · 7.RC.1, 7.CC.1, 9-10.RC.1] Look for: Language
6. Retell the three most important events of "Chapter XII" in order, in one sentence each. [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · 7.RC.1, 7.CC.1, 9-10.RC.1] Look for: Hidden, the creature observes the De Lacey family: the blind old father, Felix and Agatha. Seeing their poverty, he stops stealing their food and secretly gathers firewood for them. He begins to understand speech. Catching sight of his reflection in a pool, he is horrified at his own appearance.
7. Which characters appear or are mentioned in "Chapter XII"? Name two and one thing each says or does. [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · 7.RC.1, 7.CC.1, 9-10.RC.1] Look for: Names and actions taken from the chapter; check against the teacher summary.
8. Where and when does "Chapter XII" take place? Point to the line that tells you. [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · 7.RC.1, 7.CC.1, 9-10.RC.1] Look for: A place/time detail quoted from the chapter.
9. Reread: ""These thoughts exhilarated me, and led me to apply with fresh ardour to the acquiring the art of language." What does "exhilarated" mean here, and what is literally happening in this line? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · 7.RC.1, 7.CC.1, 9-10.RC.1] Look for: exhilarated: filled with energy and excitement.
10. Reread: "I looked upon them as superior beings, who would be the arbiters of my future destiny." What does "arbiters" mean here, and what is literally happening in this line? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · 7.RC.1, 7.CC.1, 9-10.RC.1] Look for: arbiters: people with the power to decide.

Inferential / analytical

1. What does "Chapter XII" suggest about learning compassion by watching? State the inference and the line that supports it. [DOK 2 · thinkPairShare · wait 5 s · 7.RC.2, 7.CC.2, 9-10.RC.2] Look for: The creature's kindness shows his capacity for virtue before rejection hardens him.
2. Find one example of characterization in this chapter. What does it reveal that a plain statement would not? [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · 7.RC.3, 7.CC.2, 9-10.RC.1] Look for: Look for what characters say, do and think, and how others react to them.
3. How does the setting in this chapter shape what we understand about learning compassion by watching? [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · 7.RC.3, 7.CC.2, 9-10.RC.1] Look for: Look for where and when events happen and how place shapes action or feeling.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The creature develops compassion through observation, proving the capacity for goodness Victor never gave him credit for. Useful evidence: "when I found that in doing this I inflicted pain on the cottagers, I abstained" (Chapter XII, paragraph 6): Moral reasoning; strong evidence of his goodness. Theme link: he learns virtue by watching virtue. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
4. In the passage that begins ""I remember, the first time that I did this, the young woman, when she opened the door in the morning, appeared greatly astonished on seeing a great pile of wood on the outside.", why might Shelley have chosen these particular words? Pick two and explain their connotations. [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · 7.RC.12, 7.CC.2, 9-10.RC.12] Look for: Diction analysis of two words in the anchor passage.

5. What causes the main turn in “Chapter XII”, and what effect is it likely to have on what follows? [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · 7.RC.3, 7.CC.2, 9-10.RC.1] Look for: Hidden, the creature observes the De Lacey family: the blind old father, Felix and Agatha. Seeing their poverty, he stops stealing their food and secretly gathers firewood for them. He begins to understand speech. Catching sight of his reflection in a pool, he is horrified at his own appearance.
6. How does “Chapter XII” build on “Chapter XI”? Name one link of cause and effect. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · 7.RC.3, 7.CC.2, 9-10.RC.3] Look for: A causal or structural link between this and the previous chapter.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The creature develops compassion through observation, proving the capacity for goodness Victor never gave him credit for. Useful evidence: “how was I terrified, when I viewed myself in a transparent pool” (Chapter XII, paragraph 13): Self-horror learned from others' standards of beauty. Theme link: he learns virtue by watching virtue. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
7. What can we infer about a character's motives from what they say and do here, as opposed to what they claim? [DOK 3 · followUp · wait 8 s · 7.RC.3, 7.CC.2, 9-10.RC.1] Look for: An inference about motive supported by a quoted line.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The creature develops compassion through observation, proving the capacity for goodness Victor never gave him credit for. Useful evidence: “fire,’ ‘milk,’ ‘bread,’ and ‘wood” (Chapter XII, paragraph 9): The first words he learns: basic needs and the home. On characterization: From the hovel, the creature watches the De Lacey family and learns sympathy: he stops stealing their food when he realizes it hurts them. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
8. The bell-ringer asked: “What does the creature's secret help reveal about his nature?” Now that we have read closely, how would you revise your first answer, and which line changed your mind? [DOK 2 · thinkPairShare · wait 5 s · 7.RC.2, 7.CC.2, 9-10.RC.2] Look for: A revised answer anchored in the text.
9. Where does theme appear, and how does it connect this chapter to the larger concern with isolation and the need for companionship? [DOK 3 · followUp · wait 8 s · 7.RC.2, 7.CC.2, 9-10.RC.2] Look for: Look for statements or moments that connect to the book's big ideas.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The creature develops compassion through observation, proving the capacity for goodness Victor never gave him credit for. Useful evidence: “when I found that in doing this I inflicted pain on the cottagers, I abstained” (Chapter XII, paragraph 6): Moral reasoning; strong evidence of his goodness. Theme link: he learns virtue by watching virtue. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
10. Background: The cottage represents the domestic ideal praised in the Preface. How does knowing this change the way you read one moment in the chapter? [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · 7.RC.3, 7.CC.2, 9-10.RC.1] Look for: A specific moment reread in light of the context.
    Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The creature develops compassion through observation, proving the capacity for goodness Victor never gave him credit for. Useful evidence: “how was I terrified, when I viewed myself in a transparent pool” (Chapter XII, paragraph 13): Self-horror learned from others' standards of beauty. Theme link: he learns virtue by watching virtue. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

Evaluative / synthesis / creative

1. A critic might argue: "The creature's kindness shows his capacity for virtue before rejection hardens him." How far do you agree? Take a stand and defend it with two lines from the chapter. [DOK 3 · fourCorners · wait 8 s · 7.RC.2, 7.CC.3, 9-10.RC.2] Look for: A defended position with evidence and one counterpoint.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The creature develops compassion through observation, proving the capacity for goodness Victor never gave him credit for. Useful evidence: "fire,' 'milk,' 'bread,' and 'wood" (Chapter XII, paragraph 9): The first words he learns: basic needs and the home. Theme link: he learns virtue by watching virtue. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
2. Which character in this chapter acts most wisely, and which least? Judge them by a standard you name. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · 7.RC.3, 7.CC.3, 9-10.RC.1] Look for: An evaluation using an explicit criterion and evidence.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The creature develops compassion through observation, proving the capacity for goodness Victor never gave him credit for. Useful evidence: "when I found that in doing this I inflicted pain on the cottagers, I abstained" (Chapter XII, paragraph 6): Moral reasoning; strong evidence of his goodness. On characterization: From the hovel, the creature watches the De Lacey family and learns sympathy: he stops stealing their food when he realizes it hurts them. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
3. Rewrite one moment of "Chapter XII" from the point of view of a different character. What does the new angle reveal or hide about learning compassion by watching? [DOK 4 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · 7.RC.1, 7.CC.3, 9-10.RC.1] Look for: A creative product with a rationale tied to the text.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The creature develops compassion through observation, proving the capacity for goodness Victor never gave him credit for. Useful evidence: "how was I terrified, when I viewed myself in a transparent pool" (Chapter XII, paragraph 13): Self-horror learned from others' standards of beauty. On point of view: He observes without being seen, like a reader; we learn about human kindness through his eyes. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
4. Write three questions of your own about "Chapter XII": one recall, one "why/how", and one "should/what if". Trade with a partner and answer theirs. [DOK 3 · studentGenerated · wait 8 s · 7.RC.2, 7.CC.3, 9-10.RC.2] Look for: Student-generated questions at three levels.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The creature develops compassion through observation, proving the capacity for goodness Victor never gave him credit for. Useful evidence: "fire,' 'milk,' 'bread,' and 'wood" (Chapter XII, paragraph 9): The first words he learns: basic needs and the home. Theme link: he learns virtue by watching virtue. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
5. Connect this chapter to nature versus nurture: is the link strong or weak so far? What would Shelley need to show next to strengthen it? [DOK 4 · socraticCircle · wait 8 s · 7.RC.2, 7.CC.3, 9-10.RC.2] Look for: A judgment of thematic development across the work.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The creature develops compassion through observation, proving the capacity for goodness Victor never gave him credit for. Useful evidence: "when I found that in doing this I inflicted pain on the cottagers, I abstained" (Chapter XII, paragraph 6): Moral reasoning; strong evidence of his goodness. Theme link: he learns virtue by watching virtue. Credit any

position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

6. Is the characterization in this chapter effective, or does it feel heavy-handed? Evaluate it as a reader would in a review. [DOK 3 · fourCorners · wait 8 s · 7.RC.3, 7.CC.3, 9-10.RC.1] Look for: An evaluative judgment with criteria and evidence.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The creature develops compassion through observation, proving the capacity for goodness Victor never gave him credit for. Useful evidence: “how was I terrified, when I viewed myself in a transparent pool” (Chapter XII, paragraph 13): Self-horror learned from others' standards of beauty. On characterization: From the hovel, the creature watches the De Lacey family and learns sympathy: he stops stealing their food when he realizes it hurts them. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

7. Compare how “Chapter XII” treats learning compassion by watching with how another text, film or event you know treats a similar idea. What does Frankenstein see that the other misses? [DOK 4 · socraticCircle · wait 8 s · 7.RC.2, 7.CC.3, 9-10.RC.2] Look for: A cross-text synthesis.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The creature develops compassion through observation, proving the capacity for goodness Victor never gave him credit for. Useful evidence: “fire,’ ‘milk,’ ‘bread,’ and ‘wood” (Chapter XII, paragraph 9): The first words he learns: basic needs and the home. Theme link: he learns virtue by watching virtue. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

8. Predict what “Chapter XIII” will bring, using two clues from this chapter. After reading, evaluate your prediction. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · 7.RC.3, 7.CC.3, 9-10.RC.3] Look for: A prediction or judgment justified with textual clues.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The creature develops compassion through observation, proving the capacity for goodness Victor never gave him credit for. Useful evidence: “when I found that in doing this I inflicted pain on the cottagers, I abstained” (Chapter XII, paragraph 6): Moral reasoning; strong evidence of his goodness. Theme link: he learns virtue by watching virtue. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

9. Design a one-paragraph modern adaptation of this chapter (setting, characters, conflict). What must stay the same for it to still be about learning compassion by watching? [DOK 4 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · 7.RC.2, 7.CC.3, 9-10.RC.2] Look for: A creative transfer that keeps the core idea.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The creature develops compassion through observation, proving the capacity for goodness Victor never gave him credit for. Useful evidence: “how was I terrified, when I viewed myself in a transparent pool” (Chapter XII, paragraph 13): Self-horror learned from others' standards of beauty. Theme link: he learns virtue by watching virtue. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

10. What question would you most like to ask Mary Shelley about this chapter, and what answer do you think the text itself gives? [DOK 4 · studentGenerated · wait 8 s · 7.RC.2, 7.CC.3, 9-10.RC.2] Look for: A student-generated question answered from evidence.

    Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The creature develops compassion through observation, proving the capacity for goodness Victor never gave him credit for. Useful evidence: “fire,’

'milk,' 'bread,' and 'wood" (Chapter XII, paragraph 9): The first words he learns: basic needs and the home. Theme link: he learns virtue by watching virtue. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

Annotation focus

- **Characterization:** look for what characters say, do and think, and how others react to them (anchor passage in the We do segment)
- Also notice **Setting**: where and when events happen and how place shapes action or feeling
- Also notice **Theme**: statements or moments that connect to the book's big ideas

Chapter quiz: item bank (all eleven rigor versions)

1. [mc · recall · DOK 1] Whom does the creature observe?

   A. The Frankensteins

   B. Villagers in Geneva

   C. The De Lacey family

   D. Walton's crew

   Key: C (The De Lacey family)

2. [fill · recall · DOK 1] Complete the quotation from Chapter XII, paragraph 6: "when I found that in doing this I _____ pain on the cottagers, I abstained"

   Key: inflicted

3. [fill · recall · DOK 1] Complete the quotation from Chapter XII, paragraph 13: "how was I terrified, when I viewed myself in a _____ pool"

   Key: transparent

4. [fill · recall · DOK 1] Fill in the blank with the vocabulary word that fits: "When they had retired to rest, if there was any moon, or the night was _____, I went into the woods, and collected my own food and fuel for the cottage." Word bank: starlight, exhilarated, execration, arbiters

   Key: starlight

5. [mc · recall · DOK 1] What does the creature see in a clear pool?

   A. A fish

   B. Victor

   C. His own frightening reflection

   D. The moon only

   Key: C (His own frightening reflection)

6. [fill · recall · DOK 1] Fill in the blank with the vocabulary word that fits: "I observed, with pleasure, that he did not go to the forest that day, but spent it in repairing the cottage, and _____ the garden." Word bank: arbiters, execration, exhilarated, cultivating

   Key: cultivating

7. [mc · recall · DOK 1] In the line "The gentle manners and beauty of the cottagers greatly endeared them to me: when they were unhappy, I felt depressed; when they rejoiced, I sympathised in their joys.", what does "endeared" most nearly mean?

   A. made loved or liked

B. accompanied by bloodshed

C. not engaged in a gainful occupation

D. cold, damp harshness

Key: A (made loved or liked)

8. [fill · recall · DOK 1] Fill in the blank with the vocabulary word that fits: “I saw few human beings beside them; and if any other happened to enter the cottage, their harsh manners and rude gait only _____ to me the superior accomplishments of my friends.” Word bank: arbiters, exhilarated, execration, enhanced

   Key: enhanced

9. [mc · recall · DOK 1] In the line “I looked upon them as superior beings, who would be the arbiters of my future destiny.”, what does “arbiters” most nearly mean?

   A. people with the power to decide

   B. in a kind, well-meaning way

   C. set free

   D. the state of being excommunicated

   Key: A (people with the power to decide)

10. [short · inference · DOK 2] What can you infer from this line? “how was I terrified, when I viewed myself in a transparent pool” (Chapter XII, paragraph 13) Answer in two or three sentences with one detail.

    Sample answer: Self-horror learned from others' standards of beauty.

11. [mc · inference · DOK 2] What does this passage most clearly show? “fire,’ ‘milk,’ ‘bread,’ and ‘wood” (Chapter XII, paragraph 9)

    A. The argument from isolation.

    B. Blunt, short sentence in the father's letter.

    C. Victor concludes guilt from appearance, as others will judge the creature.

    D. The first words he learns: basic needs and the home.

    Key: D (The first words he learns: basic needs and the home.)

12. [mc · inference · DOK 2] Which choice best states a central concern of “Chapter XII”?

    A. A letter, a secret and the wedding

    B. Horror at the moment of creation

    C. Learning compassion by watching

    D. Loneliness and the desire for a friend

    Key: C (Learning compassion by watching)

13. [mc · inference · DOK 2] What does this passage most clearly show? “how was I terrified, when I viewed myself in a transparent pool” (Chapter XII, paragraph 13)

    A. Felix's sense of justice; it echoes Justine's trial.

    B. His education; each book shapes him.

    C. Isolation through allusion.

    D. Self-horror learned from others' standards of beauty.

    Key: D (Self-horror learned from others' standards of beauty.)

14. [short · analysis · DOK 3] Analyze the word choice in “fire,’ ‘milk,’ ‘bread,’ and ‘wood” (Chapter XII, paragraph 9). Pick two words and explain what they suggest.
    Sample answer: The first words he learns: basic needs and the home.
15. [mc · analysis · DOK 3] Which literary element does this describe in “Chapter XII”? He observes without being seen, like a reader; we learn about human kindness through his eyes.
    A. Simile
    B. Plot
    C. Point of view
    D. Alliteration

    Key: C (Point of view)
16. [short · synthesis · DOK 4] Close reading: how do the diction and syntax of “how was I terrified, when I viewed myself in a transparent pool” (Chapter XII, paragraph 13) shape its meaning? Consider a second, competing reading.
    Sample answer: Self-horror learned from others' standards of beauty.
17. [mc · recall · DOK 1] In the line “It was as the ass and the lapdog; yet surely the gentle ass whose intentions were affectionate, although his manners were rude, deserved better treatment than blows and execration.”, what does “execration” most nearly mean?
    A. a high place affording a good view
    B. hold spellbound
    C. covered as if with a carpet
    D. cursing; expressions of hatred

    Key: D (cursing; expressions of hatred)
18. [mc · recall · DOK 1] Why does the creature stop taking their food?
    A. He realizes they are poor
    B. He finds better food
    C. They lock it up
    D. He gets caught

    Key: A (He realizes they are poor)
19. [fill · recall · DOK 1] Fill in the blank with the vocabulary word that fits: “Their _____ was quick; and the words they uttered, not having any apparent connection with visible objects, I was unable to discover any clue by which I could unravel the mystery of their reference.” Word bank: arbiters, execration, exhilarated, pronunciation
    Key: pronunciation
20. [mc · recall · DOK 1] In the line ““These thoughts exhilarated me, and led me to apply with fresh ardour to the acquiring the art of language.”, what does “exhilarated” most nearly mean?
    A. instruments that make distant objects look closer
    B. set free from chains; released
    C. causing or able to cause nausea
    D. filled with energy and excitement

    Key: D (filled with energy and excitement)

21. [short · inference · DOK 2] What can you infer from this line? “when I found that in doing this I inflicted pain on the cottagers, I abstained” (Chapter XII, paragraph 6) Answer in two or three sentences with one detail.
    Sample answer: Moral reasoning; strong evidence of his goodness.
22. [mc · inference · DOK 2] What does this passage most clearly show? “when I found that in doing this I inflicted pain on the cottagers, I abstained” (Chapter XII, paragraph 6)
    A. "Satiate" (fully satisfy) and "ardent" reveal appetite-like ambition. Use for a claim about the dangers of curiosity.
    B. The first sentence already contains a warning (his sister's "evil forebodings"). Strong evidence for foreshadowing.
    C. Simile for knowledge that cannot be unlearned.
    D. Moral reasoning; strong evidence of his goodness.

    Key: D (Moral reasoning; strong evidence of his goodness.)
23. [short · analysis · DOK 3] Claim: The creature develops compassion through observation, proving the capacity for goodness Victor never gave him credit for. Explain how this evidence supports the claim: “when I found that in doing this I inflicted pain on the cottagers, I abstained” (Chapter XII, paragraph 6).
    Sample answer: When he realizes that stealing "inflicted pain on the cottagers," he "abstained," choosing others' welfare over his own hunger without being taught.
24. [mc · analysis · DOK 3] Which literary element does this describe in “Chapter XII”? From the hovel, the creature watches the De Lacey family and learns sympathy: he stops stealing their food when he realizes it hurts them.
    A. Characterization
    B. Point of view
    C. Tone / mood
    D. Setting

    Key: A (Characterization)
25. [short · synthesis · DOK 4] Close reading: how do the diction and syntax of “when I found that in doing this I inflicted pain on the cottagers, I abstained” (Chapter XII, paragraph 6) shape its meaning? Consider a second, competing reading.
    Sample answer: Moral reasoning; strong evidence of his goodness.
26. [short · synthesis · DOK 4] Synthesis: trace how nature and nurture develops from an earlier chapter to “Chapter XII”. Use one quotation from each.
    Sample answer: he learns virtue by watching virtue.
27. [mc · recall · DOK 1] What does he begin to learn?
    A. Swimming
    B. Chemistry
    C. Language
    D. Music

    Key: C (Language)
28. [mc · recall · DOK 1] Which family member is blind?
    A. Agatha
    B. Safie

C. Felix

D. The old father

Key: D (The old father)

29. [short · synthesis · DOK 4] Evaluate this claim about the chapter: “The creature develops compassion through observation, proving the capacity for goodness Victor never gave him credit for.” Is it fully persuasive? Argue with evidence, including a passage that complicates it.
Sample answer: When he realizes that stealing "inflicted pain on the cottagers," he "abstained," choosing others' welfare over his own hunger without being taught.

Rigor version	Items (in order)	Mix
Middle School	1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 6, 7, 8, 9, 10, 11, 12, 13, 14, 15, 16	recall 9, inference 4, analysis 2, synthesis 1
HS Freshman	7, 2, 17, 18, 19, 20, 3, 4, 21, 11, 10, 22, 23, 24, 14, 25	recall 8, inference 4, analysis 3, synthesis 1
HS Sophomore	18, 3, 7, 17, 19, 4, 12, 21, 13, 22, 10, 24, 23, 14, 25, 26	recall 6, inference 5, analysis 3, synthesis 2
HS Junior	9, 8, 27, 19, 28, 11, 21, 22, 10, 12, 15, 24, 23, 14, 26, 16	recall 5, inference 5, analysis 4, synthesis 2
HS Senior	8, 7, 28, 3, 12, 22, 21, 13, 10, 24, 14, 15, 23, 16, 25, 26	recall 4, inference 5, analysis 4, synthesis 3
AP	19, 8, 5, 10, 11, 22, 13, 12, 14, 23, 24, 15, 26, 16, 25, 29	recall 3, inference 5, analysis 4, synthesis 4
College Freshman	27, 8, 2, 13, 21, 11, 10, 22, 24, 23, 14, 15, 26, 16, 29, 25	recall 3, inference 5, analysis 4, synthesis 4
College Sophomore	8, 19, 21, 13, 22, 11, 12, 10, 15, 14, 24, 23, 29, 16, 25, 26	recall 2, inference 6, analysis 4, synthesis 4
College Junior	19, 8, 13, 11, 10, 12, 22, 21, 15, 24, 23, 14, 26, 25, 29, 16	recall 2, inference 6, analysis 4, synthesis 4
College Senior	8, 19, 11, 22, 12, 10, 21, 13, 23, 14, 24, 15, 29, 25, 26, 16	recall 2, inference 6, analysis 4, synthesis 4
Graduate / PhD	8, 19, 12, 13, 22, 21, 11, 10, 15, 14, 24, 23, 29, 26, 16, 25	recall 2, inference 6, analysis 4, synthesis 4

Writing prompts (eleven rigor levels)

Middle School (250 words; Indiana 2023: 7.RC.3, 7.W.1): Supported track (work from the passage your teacher selects). In “Chapter XII,” how does Shelley show learning compassion by watching? Write a paragraph that states your claim, quotes two details from the passage, and explains how each detail supports your idea. Use the characterization you noticed as one piece of evidence.

HS Freshman (350 words; Indiana 2023: 9-10.RC.1, 9-10.W.1): In Chapter XII, how does Shelley develop the idea of learning compassion by watching? State a clear claim, support it with two or three quotations, and explain how the characterization in the chapter helps build that idea.

HS Sophomore (450 words; Indiana 2023: 9-10.RC.1, 9-10.W.1): Analyze how Chapter XII develops the idea of learning compassion by watching. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of characterization and setting shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.

HS Junior (550 words; Indiana 2023: 11-12.RC.3, 11-12.RC.1, 11-12.W.1): Analyze how the structure of Chapter XII (where it begins, turns and ends) and its characterization shape the reader's understanding of learning

compassion by watching. Identify one place where the text leaves matters uncertain and explain how that uncertainty adds to its meaning.

HS Senior (600 words; Indiana 2023: 11-12.RC.1, 11-12.W.1): Two readers disagree about what Chapter XII suggests about learning compassion by watching. Lay out two plausible interpretations, weigh the evidence for each (including the chapter's characterization and setting), and argue for the stronger one in a sustained, well-organized essay.

AP (650 words; Indiana 2023: 11-12.RC.1, 11-12.W.1): Write a literary argument in which you analyze how Mary Shelley uses characterization in Chapter XII to complicate the reader's understanding of learning compassion by watching. Develop a defensible thesis, select evidence purposefully, and explain how specific choices of diction and syntax create meaning.

College Freshman (1000 words; Indiana 2023: see unit standards): Situate Chapter XII within its historical and literary context and argue how the chapter's treatment of learning compassion by watching responds to that context. Engage with at least one secondary perspective (a critic, historian or the author's own statements), integrate quotations smoothly, and cite in MLA style.

College Sophomore (1250 words; Indiana 2023: see unit standards): Read Chapter XII alongside the conventions of its genre and period. Argue how the chapter's handling of learning compassion by watching follows or bends those conventions, using the characterization as evidence, and test your reading against one published critic. Document two secondary sources in MLA.

College Junior (1500 words; Indiana 2023: see unit standards): Apply a named critical approach (for example formalist, historicist, feminist, psychoanalytic or ecocritical) to Chapter XII and its treatment of learning compassion by watching. State your method, show what it reveals in the chapter's characterization and setting, and identify where the text resists it.

College Senior (2000 words; Indiana 2023: see unit standards): Develop a research argument that reads Chapter XII as evidence for a larger claim about learning compassion by watching in Frankenstein. Connect close reading of the chapter to the whole novel, engage at least four scholarly sources, and state precisely where your reading departs from theirs (Chicago style).

Graduate / PhD (2500 words; Indiana 2023: see unit standards): Develop an original argument that reads Chapter XII as a hinge in the novel's larger treatment of learning compassion by watching. Position your reading within a named critical conversation (for example formalist, historicist, psychoanalytic, feminist or postcolonial approaches), account for the textual history where relevant, and articulate the stakes of your intervention for scholarship on Frankenstein.

SAT-style questions

1. *It was as the ass and the lapdog; yet surely the gentle ass whose intentions were affectionate, although his manners were rude, deserved better treatment than blows and execration.*

   As used in the text, what does the word “execration” most nearly mean?

   A. transmit information

   B. the light of the stars

C. cursing; expressions of hatred

D. to believe especially on uncertain or tentative grounds

2. *"I remember, the first time that I did this, the young woman, when she opened the door in the morning, appeared greatly astonished on seeing a great pile of wood on the outside. She uttered some words in a loud voice, and the youth joined her, who also expressed surprise. I observed, with pleasure, that he did not go to the forest that day, but spent it in repairing the cottage, and cultivating the garden.*

Which choice best states a central concern of "Chapter XII"?

A. Reading and identity

B. Grief, prison and return

C. Learning compassion by watching

D. Despair and the sublime

SAT key: 1. C (cursing; expressions of hatred); 2. C (Learning compassion by watching)

Lesson 20: Chapter XIII

Focus: language, knowledge and sorrow

Objective: Students will analyze how allusion develops in “Chapter XIII” by writing a claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph that cites at least 2 quotations from the section, and will score at least 80% on the section quiz.

Standards: CCSS RL.9-10.9, W.9-10.1, L.9-10.4 · IN 9-10.RC.1, 9-10.W.1, 9-10.RC.9, 9-10.RC.11

Content note (Orientalist portrayal): Safie and her father (“the Turk”) are portrayed through European stereotypes about Muslims and the East. Name the stereotype and ask whose view the narrative takes.
Student preview: This chapter uses stereotypes about people from the Middle East. We will look at them critically.
Suggested language: “How is Safie's father described, and by whom? What stereotype is at work?”

Teacher only · spoilers

Spring comes, and Safie, an Arabian woman beloved by Felix, arrives. As Felix teaches her using Volney's 'Ruins of Empires,' the creature learns language and history alongside her. He learns of wealth, rank and injustice, realizes he has no family, money or name, and asks, 'What was I?' Knowledge deepens his misery.

Background: Volney's 'Ruins of Empires' (1791) was a radical history critiquing tyranny and religion; debates about property and rank reflect revolutionary thought after 1789.

Significance: Language opens knowledge and pain together, echoing Victor's own discovery that knowledge can isolate.

Lesson plan and lecture script (90 minutes)

0–8 min · Bell-ringer · You do (8 min)
Students write to the bell-ringer, then pair-share.
The creature wishes he could forget what he learned. Is knowledge always good? Write for five minutes. Starters: I think... because... / This connects to ambition and knowledge because.... Content note before we start: This chapter uses stereotypes about people from the Middle East. We will look at them critically.
Prompt: The creature wishes he could forget what he learned. Is knowledge always good?
Sentence starters: I think… because… · This connects to ambition and knowledge because…
Strong response: A strong response takes a position and anticipates this: "Of what a strange nature is knowledge!": knowledge as a burden.

8–18 min · Vocabulary with etymology notes · I do (10 min)
Five key words in context, with verified word histories.
Today's words: narrations — stories; accounts of events; recommencing — starting again; dissipates — makes disappear; scatters; degenerating — grow worse; disowned — prevent deliberately (as by making a will) from inheriting. "narrations": From Middle French narration, from Old French narracion, from Latin narrātiō. By surface analysis, la:narrāre + -ate + -ion. "recommencing": From Middle French recommencer, from Old French recommencier, equivalent to re- + commence. "degenerating": Latin dēgenerātus. See -ate for more.
Words: narrations: stories; accounts of events · recommencing: starting again · dissipates: makes disappear; scatters · degenerating: grow worse · disowned: prevent deliberately (as by making a will) from inheriting

18–28 min · Background and context · I do (10 min)
Mini-lecture (read or adapt the script).
Volney's 'Ruins of Empires' (1791) was a radical history critiquing tyranny and religion; debates about property and rank reflect revolutionary thought after 1789. Language opens knowledge and pain together, echoing Victor's own discovery that knowledge can isolate. Characterization: Learning history and social order, the creature realizes he has no place: no money, family or name. Diction / vocabulary: Abstract nouns (property, wealth, poverty, rank) enter his vocabulary; knowledge brings grief. Structure: Safie arrives and learns French alongside him; her lessons are his. Watch for light and fire: Light stands for knowledge and fire for its double edge: warmth and burning. Victor seeks the "light" of discovery; the creature discovers fire and is burned by it. In this chapter: "diffused gladness through the cottage, dispelling their sorrow as the sun dissipates the morning mists. Felix seemed peculiarly happy, and with smiles" (Chapter XIII, paragraph 6).

28–40 min · I do: modeled close reading · I do (12 min)
Model the close reading of the anchor quotation using the written think-aloud below.
I read the line once for meaning and once for craft. "I heard of the division of property, of immense wealth and squalid poverty; of rank, descent, and noble blood" (Chapter XIII, paragraph 16). Political education; links to Godwin. That is characterization at work: Learning history and social order, the creature realizes he has no place: no money, family or name.

> *I heard of the division of property, of immense wealth and squalid poverty; of rank, descent, and noble blood (Chapter XIII, paragraph 16)*

Think-aloud: I read the line once for meaning and once for craft. "I heard of the division of property, of immense wealth and squalid poverty; of rank, descent, and noble blood" (Chapter XIII, paragraph 16). Political education; links to Godwin. That is characterization at work: Learning history and social order, the creature realizes he has no place: no money, family or name.

40–55 min · We do: guided annotation · We do (15 min)
Guided analysis of a second quotation; expected answers given.
Ask: What words in this line stand out, and what do they suggest? Expected: A lichen cannot be scraped off a rock; knowledge clings in the same way. This connects to the theme of knowledge: for Victor and the creature, knowing is irreversible and painful. Ask: How does this line connect to ambition and knowledge? Expected: "Of what a strange nature is knowledge!": knowledge as a burden. (Simile for knowledge that cannot be unlearned.)

> *Of what a strange nature is knowledge! It clings to the mind, when it has once seized on it, like a lichen on the rock (Chapter XIII, paragraph 19)*

Ask: What words in this line stand out, and what do they suggest?
Expected answer: A lichen cannot be scraped off a rock; knowledge clings in the same way. This connects to the theme of knowledge: for Victor and the creature, knowing is irreversible and painful.
Ask: How does this line connect to ambition and knowledge?
Expected answer: "Of what a strange nature is knowledge!": knowledge as a burden. (Simile for knowledge that cannot be unlearned.)

55–70 min · You do: independent annotation · You do (15 min)
Independent annotation and a claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph (exemplar given).
Annotate the chapter for characterization, diction / vocabulary (three marks with a margin note each), then write one claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph: what does this chapter suggest about language, knowledge and sorrow? Then start your writing prompt at your assigned level (HS Sophomore: Analyze how Chapter XIII develops the idea of language, knowledge and sorrow. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of allusion and theme shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.)
Exemplar: For the creature, knowledge brings not power but a painful awareness of exclusion. When the text says “I heard of the division of property, of immense wealth and squalid poverty; of rank, descent, and noble blood” (Chapter XIII, paragraph 16), it shows this directly. Learning of "rank, descent, and noble blood" leads him straight to "And what was I?", because society's categories leave no place for him.
Task: Annotate the chapter for characterization, diction / vocabulary (three marks with a margin note each), then write one claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph: what does this chapter suggest about language, knowledge and sorrow? Then start your writing prompt at your assigned level (HS Sophomore: Analyze how Chapter XIII develops the idea of language, knowledge and sorrow. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of allusion and theme shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.)
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70–80 min · Discussion · We do (10 min)
Structured discussion from the 30 tiered questions, with facilitation notes.
Anchor question: The creature wishes he could forget what he learned. Is knowledge always good? Compare with Victor: does knowledge harm everyone in this book?
Anchor question: The creature wishes he could forget what he learned. Is knowledge always good?
Facilitation: Compare with Victor: does knowledge harm everyone in this book?

80–87 min · Exit ticket / chapter quiz · You do (7 min)
Chapter quiz in the app and an exit ticket (answer given).
Chapter quiz in the app, then: In one sentence, what does this chapter suggest about language, knowledge and sorrow? Support it with one short quotation. Model answer: For the creature, knowledge brings not power but a painful awareness of exclusion. ("I heard of the division of property, of immense wealth and squalid poverty; of rank, descent, and noble blood", Chapter XIII, paragraph 16). Accept any defensible claim backed by a quotation from the chapter; the answer key for the quiz is in the Quiz section.
Exit ticket: In one sentence, what does this chapter suggest about language, knowledge and sorrow? Support it with one short quotation.
Answer: Model answer: For the creature, knowledge brings not power but a painful awareness of exclusion. ("I heard of the division of property, of immense wealth and squalid poverty; of rank, descent, and noble blood", Chapter XIII, paragraph 16). Accept any defensible claim backed by a quotation from the chapter; the answer key for the quiz is in the Quiz section.

87–90 min · Closure · I do (3 min)
Summarize the lesson and preview the next reading.
Today we saw how characterization shapes language, knowledge and sorrow. Key takeaway: "Of what a strange nature is knowledge!": knowledge as a burden.

Total: 90 minutes.

Teacher analysis (spoilers)

Literary elements

- **Characterization:** Learning history and social order, the creature realizes he has no place: no money, family or name.
- **Diction / vocabulary:** Abstract nouns (property, wealth, poverty, rank) enter his vocabulary; knowledge brings grief.
- **Structure:** Safie arrives and learns French alongside him; her lessons are his.

Themes and how they develop

- **ambition and knowledge:** "Of what a strange nature is knowledge!": knowledge as a burden.

Symbols and motifs

- **light and fire:** Light stands for knowledge and fire for its double edge: warmth and burning. Victor seeks the "light" of discovery; the creature discovers fire and is burned by it. In this chapter: "diffused

gladness through the cottage, dispelling their sorrow as the sun dissipates the morning mists. Felix seemed peculiarly happy, and with smiles" (Chapter XIII, paragraph 6).

- **naming the creature:** Victor never names his creation; the words he uses (wretch, daemon, fiend, monster) show his rejection and shape the reader's view. In this chapter: "and heard of none like me. Was I then a monster, a blot upon the earth, from which all men fled, and" (Chapter XIII, paragraph 17).

Key quotations (checked against the reading text)

- "Of what a strange nature is knowledge! It clings to the mind, when it has once seized on it, like a lichen on the rock" (Chapter XIII, paragraph 19) Simile for knowledge that cannot be unlearned.
- "I heard of the division of property, of immense wealth and squalid poverty; of rank, descent, and noble blood" (Chapter XIII, paragraph 16) Political education; links to Godwin.
- "And what was I" (Chapter XIII, paragraph 17) A question of identity.

Model claim-evidence-reasoning

Claim: For the creature, knowledge brings not power but a painful awareness of exclusion.
Evidence: "I heard of the division of property, of immense wealth and squalid poverty; of rank, descent, and noble blood" (Chapter XIII, paragraph 16)
Reasoning: Learning of "rank, descent, and noble blood" leads him straight to "And what was I?", because society's categories leave no place for him.

Vocabulary with etymology notes

Word	Definition (in this sentence)	In context	Word history
narrations (noun)	stories; accounts of events	*"These wonderful narrations inspired me with strange feelings.*	"narrations": From Middle French narration, from Old French narracion, from Latin narrātiō. By surface analysis, la:narrāre + -ate + -ion. (Wiktionary, https://en.wiktionary.org/wiki/narration#Etymology)
recommencing (verb)	starting again	*Felix replied in a cheerful accent, and the old man was recommencing his music, when someone tapped at the door.*	"recommencing": From Middle French recommencer, from Old French recommencier, equivalent to re- + commence. (Wiktionary, https://en.wiktionary.org/wiki/recommence#Etymology)
dissipates (verb)	makes disappear; scatters	*They made many signs which I did not comprehend; but I saw that her presence diffused gladness through the cottage, dispelling their sorrow as the sun dissipates the morning mists.*	
degenerating (verb)	grow worse	*I heard of the slothful Asiatics; of the stupendous genius and mental*	"degenerating": Latin dēgenerātus. See -ate for more. (Wiktionary, https://

		activity of the Grecians; of the wars and wonderful virtue of the early Romans—of their subsequent degenerating—of the decline of that mighty empire; of chivalry, Christianity, and kings.	en.wiktionary.org/wiki/degenerate#Etymology)
disowned (verb)	prevent deliberately (as by making a will) from inheriting	*Was I then a monster, a blot upon the earth, from which all men fled, and whom all men disowned?*	
wondrously (adverb)	extremely well	*Her hair of a shining raven black, and curiously braided; her eyes were dark, but gentle, although animated; her features of a regular proportion, and her complexion wondrously fair, each cheek tinged with a lovely pink.*	
hideously (adverb)	in a hideous manner	*I was, besides, endued with a figure hideously deformed and loathsome; I was not even of the same nature as man.*	"hideously": From Middle English hidously; equivalent to hideous + ly. (Wiktionary, https://en.wiktionary.org/wiki/hideously#Etymology)
enraptured (verb)	hold spellbound	*The old man appeared enraptured, and said some words, which Agatha endeavoured to explain to Safie, and by which he appeared to wish to express that she bestowed on him the greatest delight by her music.*	
braided (verb)	make by braiding or interlacing	*Her hair of a shining raven black, and curiously braided; her eyes were dark, but gentle, although animated; her features of a regular proportion, and her complexion wondrously fair, each cheek tinged with a lovely pink.*	
dismount (noun)	the act of dismounting (a horse or bike etc.)	*He assisted her to dismount, and dismissing her guide, conducted her into the cottage.*	

Discussion questions

1. The creature wishes he could forget what he learned. Is knowledge always good?
2. Where does allusion appear in this chapter, and what effect does it have? Point to one passage.
3. How does this chapter connect to the book's larger concern with nature versus nurture?

Classroom discussion questions (30, tiered)

Wait time after every question (3 s for DOK 1, 5 s for DOK 2, 8 to 10 s for DOK 3 and 4); think-pair-share on DOK 3 and 4; answer each response with a follow-up probe; close with student-generated questions. Focus sets by rigor level: Middle School: 1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 6, 11, 12, 13, 14, 21, 22; HS Freshman: 1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 12, 13, 14, 15, 22, 23, 24; HS Sophomore: 1, 2, 3, 4, 13, 14, 15, 16, 17, 23, 24, 25; HS Junior: 1, 2, 3, 14, 15, 16, 17, 18, 24, 25, 26, 27; HS Senior: 1, 2, 3, 15, 16, 17, 18, 25, 26, 27, 28, 29; AP: 1, 2, 16, 17, 18, 19, 20, 26, 27, 28, 29, 30; College Freshman: 1, 2, 17, 18, 19, 20, 21, 22, 27, 28, 29, 30; College Sophomore: 1, 2, 11, 18, 19, 20, 21, 22, 23, 28, 29, 30; College Junior: 1, 11, 12, 19, 20, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 29, 30; College Senior: 1, 11, 12, 13, 20, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 26, 30; Graduate / PhD: 1, 11, 12, 13, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 26, 27, 28

Literal / recall

1. Who arrives at the cottage? [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · 7.RC.1, 7.CC.1, 9-10.RC.1] Look for: Safie
2. How does Safie's arrival help the creature? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · 7.RC.1, 7.CC.1, 9-10.RC.1] Look for: He learns language as she is taught
3. Which book does Felix read to Safie? [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · 7.RC.1, 7.CC.1, 9-10.RC.1] Look for: Ruins of Empires
4. What question does the creature ask himself? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · 7.RC.1, 7.CC.1, 9-10.RC.1] Look for: What was I?
5. How does knowledge affect him? [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · 7.RC.1, 7.CC.1, 9-10.RC.1] Look for: It increases his sorrow
6. Retell the three most important events of “Chapter XIII” in order, in one sentence each. [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · 7.RC.1, 7.CC.1, 9-10.RC.1] Look for: Spring comes, and Safie, an Arabian woman beloved by Felix, arrives. As Felix teaches her using Volney's 'Ruins of Empires,' the creature learns language and history alongside her. He learns of wealth, rank and injustice, realizes he has no family, money or name, and asks, 'What was I?' Knowledge deepens his misery.
7. Which characters appear or are mentioned in “Chapter XIII”? Name two and one thing each says or does. [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · 7.RC.1, 7.CC.1, 9-10.RC.1] Look for: Names and actions taken from the chapter; check against the teacher summary.
8. Where and when does “Chapter XIII” take place? Point to the line that tells you. [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · 7.RC.1, 7.CC.1, 9-10.RC.1] Look for: A place/time detail quoted from the chapter.
9. Reread: ““These wonderful narrations inspired me with strange feelings.” What does “narrations” mean here, and what is literally happening in this line? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · 7.RC.1, 7.CC.1, 9-10.RC.1] Look for: narrations: stories; accounts of events.
10. Reread: “Felix replied in a cheerful accent, and the old man was recommencing his music, when someone tapped at the door.” What does “recommencing” mean here, and what is literally happening in this line? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · 7.RC.1, 7.CC.1, 9-10.RC.1] Look for: recommencing: starting again.

Inferential / analytical

1. What does “Chapter XIII” suggest about language, knowledge and sorrow? State the inference and the line that supports it. [DOK 2 · thinkPairShare · wait 5 s · 7.RC.2, 7.CC.2, 9-10.RC.2] Look for: Language opens knowledge and pain together, echoing Victor's own discovery that knowledge can isolate.
2. Find one example of allusion in this chapter. What does it reveal that a plain statement would not? [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · 7.RC.2, 7.CC.2, 9-10.RC.1] Look for: Look for references to other books, myths, history or religion.

3. How does the theme in this chapter shape what we understand about language, knowledge and sorrow? [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · 7.RC.2, 7.CC.2, 9-10.RC.2] Look for: Look for statements or moments that connect to the book's big ideas.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: For the creature, knowledge brings not power but a painful awareness of exclusion. Useful evidence: “Of what a strange nature is knowledge! It clings to the mind, when it has once seized on it, like a lichen on the rock” (Chapter XIII, paragraph 19): Simile for knowledge that cannot be unlearned. Theme link: "Of what a strange nature is knowledge!": knowledge as a burden. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
4. In the passage that begins ““It was on one of these days, when my cottagers periodically rested from labour—the old man played on his guitar, and the children listened to him—that I observed the countenance…”, why might Shelley have chosen these particular words? Pick two and explain their connotations. [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · 7.RC.12, 7.CC.2, 9-10.RC.12] Look for: Diction analysis of two words in the anchor passage.
5. What causes the main turn in “Chapter XIII”, and what effect is it likely to have on what follows? [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · 7.RC.3, 7.CC.2, 9-10.RC.1] Look for: Spring comes, and Safie, an Arabian woman beloved by Felix, arrives. As Felix teaches her using Volney's 'Ruins of Empires,' the creature learns language and history alongside her. He learns of wealth, rank and injustice, realizes he has no family, money or name, and asks, 'What was I?' Knowledge…
6. How does “Chapter XIII” build on “Chapter XII”? Name one link of cause and effect. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · 7.RC.3, 7.CC.2, 9-10.RC.3] Look for: A causal or structural link between this and the previous chapter.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: For the creature, knowledge brings not power but a painful awareness of exclusion. Useful evidence: “I heard of the division of property, of immense wealth and squalid poverty; of rank, descent, and noble blood” (Chapter XIII, paragraph 16): Political education; links to Godwin. On structure: Safie arrives and learns French alongside him; her lessons are his. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
7. What can we infer about a character's motives from what they say and do here, as opposed to what they claim? [DOK 3 · followUp · wait 8 s · 7.RC.3, 7.CC.2, 9-10.RC.1] Look for: An inference about motive supported by a quoted line.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: For the creature, knowledge brings not power but a painful awareness of exclusion. Useful evidence: “And what was I” (Chapter XIII, paragraph 17): A question of identity. On characterization: Learning history and social order, the creature realizes he has no place: no money, family or name. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
8. The bell-ringer asked: “The creature wishes he could forget what he learned. Is knowledge always good?” Now that we have read closely, how would you revise your first answer, and which line changed your mind? [DOK 2 · thinkPairShare · wait 5 s · 7.RC.2, 7.CC.2, 9-10.RC.2] Look for: A revised answer anchored in the text.
9. Where does irony appear, and how does it connect this chapter to the larger concern with nature versus nurture? [DOK 3 · followUp · wait 8 s · 7.RC.1, 7.CC.2, 9-10.RC.1] Look for: Look for gaps between what characters expect or say and what is true.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: For the creature, knowledge brings not power but a painful awareness of exclusion. Useful evidence: “Of what a strange nature is knowledge! It clings to the mind, when it has once seized on it, like a lichen on the rock” (Chapter XIII, paragraph 19): Simile for knowledge that cannot be unlearned. Theme link: "Of what a strange nature is knowledge!": knowledge as

a burden. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

10. Background: Volney's 'Ruins of Empires' (1791) was a radical history critiquing tyranny and religion; debates about property and rank reflect revolutionary thought after 1789. How does knowing this change the way you read one moment in the chapter? [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · 7.RC.3, 7.CC.2, 9-10.RC.1] Look for: A specific moment reread in light of the context.

    Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: For the creature, knowledge brings not power but a painful awareness of exclusion. Useful evidence: “I heard of the division of property, of immense wealth and squalid poverty; of rank, descent, and noble blood” (Chapter XIII, paragraph 16): Political education; links to Godwin. Theme link: "Of what a strange nature is knowledge!": knowledge as a burden. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

Evaluative / synthesis / creative

1. A critic might argue: “Language opens knowledge and pain together, echoing Victor's own discovery that knowledge can isolate.” How far do you agree? Take a stand and defend it with two lines from the chapter. [DOK 3 · fourCorners · wait 8 s · 7.RC.2, 7.CC.3, 9-10.RC.2] Look for: A defended position with evidence and one counterpoint.

    Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: For the creature, knowledge brings not power but a painful awareness of exclusion. Useful evidence: “And what was I” (Chapter XIII, paragraph 17): A question of identity. Theme link: "Of what a strange nature is knowledge!": knowledge as a burden. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

2. Which character in this chapter acts most wisely, and which least? Judge them by a standard you name. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · 7.RC.3, 7.CC.3, 9-10.RC.1] Look for: An evaluation using an explicit criterion and evidence.

    Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: For the creature, knowledge brings not power but a painful awareness of exclusion. Useful evidence: “Of what a strange nature is knowledge! It clings to the mind, when it has once seized on it, like a lichen on the rock” (Chapter XIII, paragraph 19): Simile for knowledge that cannot be unlearned. On characterization: Learning history and social order, the creature realizes he has no place: no money, family or name. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

3. Rewrite one moment of “Chapter XIII” from the point of view of a different character. What does the new angle reveal or hide about language, knowledge and sorrow? [DOK 4 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · 7.RC.1, 7.CC.3, 9-10.RC.1] Look for: A creative product with a rationale tied to the text.

    Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: For the creature, knowledge brings not power but a painful awareness of exclusion. Useful evidence: “I heard of the division of property, of immense wealth and squalid poverty; of rank, descent, and noble blood” (Chapter XIII, paragraph 16): Political education; links to Godwin. Theme link: "Of what a strange nature is knowledge!": knowledge as a burden. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

4. Write three questions of your own about “Chapter XIII”: one recall, one “why/how”, and one “should/what if”. Trade with a partner and answer theirs. [DOK 3 · studentGenerated · wait 8 s · 7.RC.2, 7.CC.3, 9-10.RC.2] Look

for: Student-generated questions at three levels.

Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: For the creature, knowledge brings not power but a painful awareness of exclusion. Useful evidence: “And what was I” (Chapter XIII, paragraph 17): A question of identity. Theme link: "Of what a strange nature is knowledge!": knowledge as a burden. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

5. Connect this chapter to the sublime power of nature: is the link strong or weak so far? What would Shelley need to show next to strengthen it? [DOK 4 · socraticCircle · wait 8 s · 7.RC.2, 7.CC.3, 9-10.RC.2] Look for: A judgment of thematic development across the work.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: For the creature, knowledge brings not power but a painful awareness of exclusion. Useful evidence: “Of what a strange nature is knowledge! It clings to the mind, when it has once seized on it, like a lichen on the rock” (Chapter XIII, paragraph 19): Simile for knowledge that cannot be unlearned. Theme link: "Of what a strange nature is knowledge!": knowledge as a burden. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

6. Is the allusion in this chapter effective, or does it feel heavy-handed? Evaluate it as a reader would in a review. [DOK 3 · fourCorners · wait 8 s · 7.RC.2, 7.CC.3, 9-10.RC.1] Look for: An evaluative judgment with criteria and evidence.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: For the creature, knowledge brings not power but a painful awareness of exclusion. Useful evidence: “I heard of the division of property, of immense wealth and squalid poverty; of rank, descent, and noble blood” (Chapter XIII, paragraph 16): Political education; links to Godwin. Theme link: "Of what a strange nature is knowledge!": knowledge as a burden. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

7. Compare how “Chapter XIII” treats language, knowledge and sorrow with how another text, film or event you know treats a similar idea. What does Frankenstein see that the other misses? [DOK 4 · socraticCircle · wait 8 s · 7.RC.2, 7.CC.3, 9-10.RC.2] Look for: A cross-text synthesis.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: For the creature, knowledge brings not power but a painful awareness of exclusion. Useful evidence: “And what was I” (Chapter XIII, paragraph 17): A question of identity. Theme link: "Of what a strange nature is knowledge!": knowledge as a burden. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

8. Predict what “Chapter XIV” will bring, using two clues from this chapter. After reading, evaluate your prediction. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · 7.RC.3, 7.CC.3, 9-10.RC.3] Look for: A prediction or judgment justified with textual clues.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: For the creature, knowledge brings not power but a painful awareness of exclusion. Useful evidence: “Of what a strange nature is knowledge! It clings to the mind, when it has once seized on it, like a lichen on the rock” (Chapter XIII, paragraph 19): Simile for knowledge that cannot be unlearned. Theme link: "Of what a strange nature is knowledge!": knowledge as a burden. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

9. Design a one-paragraph modern adaptation of this chapter (setting, characters, conflict). What must stay the same for it to still be about language, knowledge and sorrow? [DOK 4 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · 7.RC.2,

7.CC.3, 9-10.RC.2] Look for: A creative transfer that keeps the core idea.

Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: For the creature, knowledge brings not power but a painful awareness of exclusion. Useful evidence: “I heard of the division of property, of immense wealth and squalid poverty; of rank, descent, and noble blood” (Chapter XIII, paragraph 16): Political education; links to Godwin. Theme link: "Of what a strange nature is knowledge!": knowledge as a burden. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

10. What question would you most like to ask Mary Shelley about this chapter, and what answer do you think the text itself gives? [DOK 4 · studentGenerated · wait 8 s · 7.RC.2, 7.CC.3, 9-10.RC.2] Look for: A student-generated question answered from evidence.

    Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: For the creature, knowledge brings not power but a painful awareness of exclusion. Useful evidence: “And what was I” (Chapter XIII, paragraph 17): A question of identity. Theme link: "Of what a strange nature is knowledge!": knowledge as a burden. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

Annotation focus

- **Allusion:** look for references to other books, myths, history or religion (anchor passage in the We do segment)
- Also notice **Theme**: statements or moments that connect to the book's big ideas
- Also notice **Irony**: gaps between what characters expect or say and what is true

Chapter quiz: item bank (all eleven rigor versions)

1. [fill · recall · DOK 1] Fill in the blank with the vocabulary word that fits: “Her hair of a shining raven black, and curiously braided; her eyes were dark, but gentle, although animated; her features of a regular proportion, and her complexion _____ fair, each cheek tinged with a lovely pink.” Word bank: narrations, recommencing, dissipates, wondrously

   Key: wondrously

2. [mc · recall · DOK 1] What question does the creature ask himself?

   A. Who is Walton?

   B. What was I?

   C. Where is Geneva?

   D. Why is it cold?

   Key: B (What was I?)

3. [mc · recall · DOK 1] How does Safie's arrival help the creature?

   A. She feeds him

   B. She brings him chemistry books

   C. He learns language as she is taught

   D. She befriends him

   Key: C (He learns language as she is taught)

4. [mc · recall · DOK 1] In the line ““These wonderful narrations inspired me with strange feelings.”, what does “narrations” most nearly mean?

   A. beats; throbs (of the heart)

   B. stories; accounts of events

   C. adjusted in tone

   D. jailers (British spelling)

   Key: B (stories; accounts of events)

5. [fill · recall · DOK 1] Fill in the blank with the vocabulary word that fits: “I was, besides, endued with a figure _____ deformed and loathsome; I was not even of the same nature as man.” Word bank: hideously, dissipates, narrations, recommencing

   Key: hideously

6. [mc · recall · DOK 1] In the line “Felix replied in a cheerful accent, and the old man was recommencing his music, when someone tapped at the door.”, what does “recommencing” most nearly mean?

   A. starting again

   B. visit again

   C. a slide of large masses of snow and ice and mud down a mountain

   D. the area in which something exists or lives

   Key: A (starting again)

7. [mc · recall · DOK 1] Who arrives at the cottage?

   A. Elizabeth

   B. Safie

   C. Clerval

   D. Justine

   Key: B (Safie)

8. [mc · recall · DOK 1] In the line “They made many signs which I did not comprehend; but I saw that her presence diffused gladness through the cottage, dispelling their sorrow as the sun dissipates the morning mists.”, what does “dissipates” most nearly mean?

   A. place at intervals in or among

   B. makes disappear; scatters

   C. a companion at play

   D. drifting on water

   Key: B (makes disappear; scatters)

9. [fill · recall · DOK 1] Complete the quotation from Chapter XIII, paragraph 16: “I heard of the _____ of property, of immense wealth and squalid poverty; of rank, descent, and noble blood”

   Key: division

10. [mc · inference · DOK 2] Which choice best states a central concern of “Chapter XIII”?

    A. Language, knowledge and sorrow

    B. Loss and leaving home

    C. Despair and the sublime

    D. Isolation in the north

Key: A (Language, knowledge and sorrow)

11. [short · inference · DOK 2] What can you infer from this line? “Of what a strange nature is knowledge! It clings to the mind, when it has once seized on it, like a lichen on the rock” (Chapter XIII, paragraph 19) Answer in two or three sentences with one detail.
    Sample answer: Simile for knowledge that cannot be unlearned.
12. [mc · inference · DOK 2] What does this passage most clearly show? “I heard of the division of property, of immense wealth and squalid poverty; of rank, descent, and noble blood” (Chapter XIII, paragraph 16)
    A. Political education; links to Godwin.
    B. The creature's longing for release.
    C. Possessive language; evidence for a claim about Victor's self-centeredness.
    D. The discovery itself, told without explanation; Victor withholds the secret.

    Key: A (Political education; links to Godwin.)
13. [mc · inference · DOK 2] What does this passage most clearly show? “Of what a strange nature is knowledge! It clings to the mind, when it has once seized on it, like a lichen on the rock” (Chapter XIII, paragraph 19)
    A. Blunt, short sentence in the father's letter.
    B. Simile for knowledge that cannot be unlearned.
    C. The wish to belong.
    D. The argument from isolation.

    Key: B (Simile for knowledge that cannot be unlearned.)
14. [mc · analysis · DOK 3] Which literary element does this describe in “Chapter XIII”? Abstract nouns (property, wealth, poverty, rank) enter his vocabulary; knowledge brings grief.
    A. Diction / vocabulary
    B. Structure
    C. Imagery
    D. Metaphor

    Key: A (Diction / vocabulary)
15. [short · analysis · DOK 3] Analyze the word choice in “And what was I” (Chapter XIII, paragraph 17). Pick two words and explain what they suggest.
    Sample answer: A question of identity.
16. [short · synthesis · DOK 4] Close reading: how do the diction and syntax of “Of what a strange nature is knowledge! It clings to the mind, when it has once seized on it, like a lichen on the rock” (Chapter XIII, paragraph 19) shape its meaning? Consider a second, competing reading.
    Sample answer: Simile for knowledge that cannot be unlearned.
17. [mc · recall · DOK 1] In the line “I heard of the slothful Asiatics; of the stupendous genius and mental activity of the Grecians; of the wars and wonderful virtue of the early Romans—of their subsequent degenerating —of the decline of that mighty empire;…”, what does “degenerating” most nearly mean?
    A. express strong disapproval of
    B. grow worse
    C. tiring
    D. dip a foot or hand briefly into a liquid

Key: B (grow worse)

18. [fill · recall · DOK 1] Complete the quotation from Chapter XIII, paragraph 19: “Of what a strange nature is _____! It clings to the mind, when it has once seized on it, like a lichen on the rock”

    Key: knowledge

19. [mc · recall · DOK 1] Which book does Felix read to Safie?

    A. The Bible

    B. Plutarch's Lives

    C. Paradise Lost

    D. Ruins of Empires

    Key: D (Ruins of Empires)

20. [mc · inference · DOK 2] What does this passage most clearly show? “And what was I” (Chapter XIII, paragraph 17)

    A. A newborn's memory; invites sympathy.

    B. A question of identity.

    C. Isolation through allusion.

    D. Self-horror learned from others' standards of beauty.

    Key: B (A question of identity.)

21. [short · inference · DOK 2] What can you infer from this line? “I heard of the division of property, of immense wealth and squalid poverty; of rank, descent, and noble blood” (Chapter XIII, paragraph 16) Answer in two or three sentences with one detail.

    Sample answer: Political education; links to Godwin.

22. [short · analysis · DOK 3] Claim: For the creature, knowledge brings not power but a painful awareness of exclusion. Explain how this evidence supports the claim: “I heard of the division of property, of immense wealth and squalid poverty; of rank, descent, and noble blood” (Chapter XIII, paragraph 16).

    Sample answer: Learning of "rank, descent, and noble blood" leads him straight to "And what was I?", because society's categories leave no place for him.

23. [short · synthesis · DOK 4] Close reading: how do the diction and syntax of “I heard of the division of property, of immense wealth and squalid poverty; of rank, descent, and noble blood” (Chapter XIII, paragraph 16) shape its meaning? Consider a second, competing reading.

    Sample answer: Political education; links to Godwin.

24. [short · synthesis · DOK 4] Synthesis: trace how ambition and knowledge develops from an earlier chapter to “Chapter XIII”. Use one quotation from each.

    Sample answer: "Of what a strange nature is knowledge!": knowledge as a burden.

25. [fill · recall · DOK 1] Fill in the blank with the vocabulary word that fits: “The old man appeared _____, and said some words, which Agatha endeavoured to explain to Safie, and by which he appeared to wish to express that she bestowed on him the greatest delight by her music.” Word bank: recommencing, enraptured, narrations, dissipates

    Key: enraptured

26. [mc · analysis · DOK 3] Which literary element does this describe in “Chapter XIII”? Learning history and social order, the creature realizes he has no place: no money, family or name.

    A. Diction / vocabulary

B. Simile

C. Personification

D. Characterization

Key: D (Characterization)

27. [fill · recall · DOK 1] Fill in the blank with the vocabulary word that fits: “Was I then a monster, a blot upon the earth, from which all men fled, and whom all men _____?” Word bank: dissipates, narrations, recommencing, disowned

Key: disowned

28. [mc · recall · DOK 1] How does knowledge affect him?

A. It cures his loneliness

B. It makes him rich

C. It makes him content

D. It increases his sorrow

Key: D (It increases his sorrow)

29. [short · synthesis · DOK 4] Evaluate this claim about the chapter: “For the creature, knowledge brings not power but a painful awareness of exclusion.” Is it fully persuasive? Argue with evidence, including a passage that complicates it.

Sample answer: Learning of "rank, descent, and noble blood" leads him straight to "And what was I?", because society's categories leave no place for him.

Rigor version	Items (in order)	Mix
Middle School	1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 6, 7, 8, 9, 10, 11, 12, 13, 14, 15, 16	recall 9, inference 4, analysis 2, synthesis 1
HS Freshman	17, 18, 7, 4, 2, 19, 5, 1, 20, 13, 21, 10, 22, 15, 14, 23	recall 8, inference 4, analysis 3, synthesis 1
HS Sophomore	7, 18, 5, 1, 8, 6, 20, 13, 11, 10, 21, 15, 22, 14, 16, 24	recall 6, inference 5, analysis 3, synthesis 2
HS Junior	18, 6, 25, 4, 3, 12, 13, 20, 11, 21, 15, 22, 14, 26, 16, 24	recall 5, inference 5, analysis 4, synthesis 2
HS Senior	7, 4, 1, 25, 13, 10, 21, 20, 11, 15, 22, 26, 14, 16, 24, 23	recall 4, inference 5, analysis 4, synthesis 3
AP	27, 28, 25, 21, 20, 10, 13, 11, 14, 15, 26, 22, 24, 29, 23, 16	recall 3, inference 5, analysis 4, synthesis 4
College Freshman	7, 18, 27, 13, 21, 20, 11, 10, 26, 14, 15, 22, 23, 24, 29, 16	recall 3, inference 5, analysis 4, synthesis 4
College Sophomore	25, 27, 20, 12, 13, 21, 10, 11, 22, 14, 26, 15, 24, 29, 23, 16	recall 2, inference 6, analysis 4, synthesis 4
College Junior	25, 27, 21, 10, 13, 20, 12, 11, 22, 26, 15, 14, 23, 24, 29, 16	recall 2, inference 6, analysis 4, synthesis 4
College Senior	1, 27, 20, 12, 21, 10, 11, 13, 22, 26, 14, 15, 16, 23, 29, 24	recall 2, inference 6, analysis 4, synthesis 4

Graduate / PhD	27, 1, 11, 21, 10, 20, 12, 13, 15, 22, 26, 14, 29, 16, 24, 23	recall 2, inference 6, analysis 4, synthesis 4

Writing prompts (eleven rigor levels)

Middle School (250 words; Indiana 2023: 7.RC.2, 7.W.1): Supported track (work from the passage your teacher selects). In “Chapter XIII,” how does Shelley show language, knowledge and sorrow? Write a paragraph that states your claim, quotes two details from the passage, and explains how each detail supports your idea. Use the allusion you noticed as one piece of evidence.

HS Freshman (350 words; Indiana 2023: 9-10.RC.1, 9-10.W.1): In Chapter XIII, how does Shelley develop the idea of language, knowledge and sorrow? State a clear claim, support it with two or three quotations, and explain how the allusion in the chapter helps build that idea.

HS Sophomore (450 words; Indiana 2023: 9-10.RC.1, 9-10.W.1): Analyze how Chapter XIII develops the idea of language, knowledge and sorrow. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of allusion and theme shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.

HS Junior (550 words; Indiana 2023: 11-12.RC.3, 11-12.RC.1, 11-12.W.1): Analyze how the structure of Chapter XIII (where it begins, turns and ends) and its allusion shape the reader's understanding of language, knowledge and sorrow. Identify one place where the text leaves matters uncertain and explain how that uncertainty adds to its meaning.

HS Senior (600 words; Indiana 2023: 11-12.RC.4, 11-12.W.1): Two readers disagree about what Chapter XIII suggests about language, knowledge and sorrow. Lay out two plausible interpretations, weigh the evidence for each (including the chapter's allusion and theme), and argue for the stronger one in a sustained, well-organized essay.

AP (650 words; Indiana 2023: 11-12.RC.4, 11-12.W.1): Write a literary argument in which you analyze how Mary Shelley uses allusion in Chapter XIII to complicate the reader's understanding of language, knowledge and sorrow. Develop a defensible thesis, select evidence purposefully, and explain how specific choices of diction and syntax create meaning.

College Freshman (1000 words; Indiana 2023: see unit standards): Situate Chapter XIII within its historical and literary context and argue how the chapter's treatment of language, knowledge and sorrow responds to that context. Engage with at least one secondary perspective (a critic, historian or the author's own statements), integrate quotations smoothly, and cite in MLA style.

College Sophomore (1250 words; Indiana 2023: see unit standards): Read Chapter XIII alongside the conventions of its genre and period. Argue how the chapter's handling of language, knowledge and sorrow follows or bends those conventions, using the allusion as evidence, and test your reading against one published critic. Document two secondary sources in MLA.

College Junior (1500 words; Indiana 2023: see unit standards): Apply a named critical approach (for example formalist, historicist, feminist, psychoanalytic or ecocritical) to Chapter XIII and its treatment of language,

knowledge and sorrow. State your method, show what it reveals in the chapter's allusion and theme, and identify where the text resists it.

College Senior (2000 words; Indiana 2023: see unit standards): Develop a research argument that reads Chapter XIII as evidence for a larger claim about language, knowledge and sorrow in Frankenstein. Connect close reading of the chapter to the whole novel, engage at least four scholarly sources, and state precisely where your reading departs from theirs (Chicago style).

Graduate / PhD (2500 words; Indiana 2023: see unit standards): Develop an original argument that reads Chapter XIII as a hinge in the novel's larger treatment of language, knowledge and sorrow. Position your reading within a named critical conversation (for example formalist, historicist, psychoanalytic, feminist or postcolonial approaches), account for the textual history where relevant, and articulate the stakes of your intervention for scholarship on Frankenstein.

SAT-style questions

1. *They made many signs which I did not comprehend; but I saw that her presence diffused gladness through the cottage, dispelling their sorrow as the sun dissipates the morning mists.*

   As used in the text, what does the word “dissipates” most nearly mean?

   A. the act of dismounting (a horse or bike etc.)

   B. makes disappear; scatters

   C. make by braiding or interlacing

   D. hold spellbound

2. *“It was on one of these days, when my cottagers periodically rested from labour—the old man played on his guitar, and the children listened to him—that I observed the countenance of Felix was melancholy beyond expression; he sighed frequently; and once his father paused in his music, and I conjectured by his manner that he enquired the cause of his son’s sorrow. Felix replied in a cheerful accent, and the old man was recommencing his music, when someone tapped at the door.*

   Which choice best states a central concern of “Chapter XIII”?

   A. Injustice and the burden of silence

   B. Isolation in the north

   C. The first spark of obsession

   D. Language, knowledge and sorrow

SAT key: 1. B (makes disappear; scatters); 2. D (Language, knowledge and sorrow)

Lesson 21: Chapter XIV

Focus: injustice and exile

Objective: Students will analyze how plot develops in “Chapter XIV” by writing a claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph that cites at least 2 quotations from the section, and will score at least 80% on the section quiz.

Standards: CCSS RL.9-10.3, W.9-10.1, L.9-10.4 · IN 9-10.RC.1, 9-10.W.1, 9-10.RC.9, 9-10.RC.11

Content note (Orientalist portrayal): The De Lacey story continues the stereotyped portrait of Safie's father; contrast it with Safie's own agency.
Student preview: The chapter continues stereotypes about Safie's father.
Suggested language: “Does Safie fit the stereotype the narrator applies to her father?”

Teacher only · spoilers

The creature learns the De Laceys' history: Felix helped Safie's father, a Turkish merchant, escape unjust execution in Paris; the merchant betrayed them, and the family lost wealth and was exiled. Safie fled to find Felix.

Background: The story reflects prejudices and politics of 18th-century France and attitudes toward the Ottoman world.

Significance: Injustice repeats across the book; the virtuous suffer, and betrayal is common.

Lesson plan and lecture script (90 minutes)

0–8 min · Bell-ringer · You do (8 min)
Students write to the bell-ringer, then pair-share.
How does the De Laceys' story parallel the creature's own situation? Write for five minutes. Starters: I think... because... / This connects to isolation and companionship because.... Content note before we start: The chapter continues stereotypes about Safie's father.
Prompt: How does the De Laceys' story parallel the creature's own situation?
Sentence starters: I think… because… · This connects to isolation and companionship because…
Strong response: A strong response takes a position and anticipates this: the De Laceys, poor and exiled, still have each other; the creature has no one.

8–18 min · Vocabulary with etymology notes · I do (10 min)
Five key words in context, with verified word histories.
Today's words: facilitated — made easier; reiterating — repeating; expostulate — to argue earnestly with someone to change their mind; passports — any authorization to pass or go somewhere; noisome — causing or able to cause nausea. “facilitated”: Anglicisation of French faciliter "facilitate" through -ate, ultimately from Latin facilis. “reiterating”: Early 15th century, from Late Latin reiteratus, past participle of reiterare "to repeat" from re- + itero from iterum "again". “expostulate”: From Latin expostulare "to demand urgently, remonstrate," from ex- + postulare "to demand." “passports”: From French passeport, from passer + port. Compare portpass. Equivalent to pass + port. “noisome”: From Middle English noysom; equivalent to noy + some<id:adjectival> (short for annoy, from an(n)oien, enoien from Anglo-Norman - anuier, from Old French enuier (French ennuyer), from Late Latin inodiare, from in- + odium "hate").
Words: facilitated: made easier · reiterating: repeating · expostulate: to argue earnestly with someone to change their mind · passports: any authorization to pass or go somewhere · noisome: causing or able to cause nausea

18–28 min · Background and context · I do (10 min)
Mini-lecture (read or adapt the script).
The story reflects prejudices and politics of 18th-century France and attitudes toward the Ottoman world. Injustice repeats across the book; the virtuous suffer, and betrayal is common. Structure: An embedded story within the creature's story (the De Laceys and Safie), a third layer of narration. Characterization: Felix's rescue of Safie's father, the father's betrayal, and the family's exile show virtue punished. Conflict: Injustice by a state and by a self-interested man. Watch for light and fire: Light stands for knowledge and fire for its double edge: warmth and burning. Victor seeks the "light" of discovery; the creature discovers fire and is burned by it. In this chapter: “the truth of my tale; but at present, as the sun is already far declined, I shall only have time to repeat” (Chapter XIV, paragraph 7).

28–40 min · I do: modeled close reading · I do (12 min)
Model the close reading of the anchor quotation using the written think-aloud below.
I read the line once for meaning and once for craft. “The father of Safie had been the cause of their ruin” (Chapter XIV, paragraph 3). Benevolence repaid with treachery. That is structure at work: An embedded story within the creature's story (the De Laceys and Safie), a third layer of narration.

> *The father of Safie had been the cause of their ruin* *(Chapter XIV, paragraph 3)*

Think-aloud: I read the line once for meaning and once for craft. “The father of Safie had been the cause of their ruin” (Chapter XIV, paragraph 3). Benevolence repaid with treachery. That is structure at work: An embedded story within the creature's story (the De Laceys and Safie), a third layer of narration.

40–55 min · We do: guided annotation · We do (15 min)
Guided analysis of a second quotation; expected answers given.
Ask: What words in this line stand out, and what do they suggest? Expected: The family is ruined by the man they helped; ingratitude and injustice. This parallels Justine's trial and prepares the creature's rejection. Ask: How does this line connect to isolation and companionship? Expected: The De Laceys, poor and exiled, still have each other; the creature has no one. (Felix's sense of justice; it echoes Justine's trial.)

> *Felix had accidentally been present at the trial; his horror and indignation were uncontrollable, when he heard the decision of the court* (Chapter XIV, paragraph 4)

Ask: What words in this line stand out, and what do they suggest?
Expected answer: The family is ruined by the man they helped; ingratitude and injustice. This parallels Justine's trial and prepares the creature's rejection.
Ask: How does this line connect to isolation and companionship?
Expected answer: The De Laceys, poor and exiled, still have each other; the creature has no one. (Felix's sense of justice; it echoes Justine's trial.)

55–70 min · You do: independent annotation · You do (15 min)
Independent annotation and a claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph (exemplar given).
Annotate the chapter for structure, characterization (three marks with a margin note each), then write one claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph: what does this chapter suggest about injustice and exile? Then start your writing prompt at your assigned level (HS Sophomore: Analyze how Chapter XIV develops the idea of injustice and exile. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of plot and characterization shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.) Exemplar: The De Lacey history shows that even good people suffer injustice, preparing the creature, and the reader, for his own rejection. When the text says "The father of Safie had been the cause of their ruin" (Chapter XIV, paragraph 3), it shows this directly. The family's ruin comes from helping the man whose daughter Felix loves, since "the father of Safie had been the cause of their ruin"; goodness here is no protection.
Task: Annotate the chapter for structure, characterization (three marks with a margin note each), then write one claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph: what does this chapter suggest about injustice and exile? Then start your writing prompt at your assigned level (HS Sophomore: Analyze how Chapter XIV develops the idea of injustice and exile. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of plot and characterization shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.)
Exemplar: The De Lacey history shows that even good people suffer injustice, preparing the creature, and the reader, for his own rejection. When the text says "The father of Safie had been the cause of their ruin" (Chapter XIV, paragraph 3), it shows this directly. The family's ruin comes from helping the man whose daughter Felix loves, since "the father of Safie had been the cause of their ruin"; goodness here is no protection.

70–80 min · Discussion · We do (10 min)
Structured discussion from the 30 tiered questions, with facilitation notes.
Anchor question: How does the De Laceys' story parallel the creature's own situation? Ask why Shelley includes a story within a story here. What does it add?
Anchor question: How does the De Laceys' story parallel the creature's own situation?
Facilitation: Ask why Shelley includes a story within a story here. What does it add?

80–87 min · Exit ticket / chapter quiz · You do (7 min)
Chapter quiz in the app and an exit ticket (answer given).
Chapter quiz in the app, then: In one sentence, what does this chapter suggest about injustice and exile? Support it with one short quotation. Model answer: The De Lacey history shows that even good people suffer injustice, preparing the creature, and the reader, for his own rejection. ("The father of Safie had been the cause of their ruin", Chapter XIV, paragraph 3). Accept any defensible claim backed by a quotation from the chapter; the answer key for the quiz is in the Quiz section.
Exit ticket: In one sentence, what does this chapter suggest about injustice and exile? Support it with one short quotation.
Answer: Model answer: The De Lacey history shows that even good people suffer injustice, preparing the creature, and the reader, for his own rejection. ("The father of Safie had been the cause of their ruin", Chapter XIV, paragraph 3). Accept any defensible claim backed by a quotation from the chapter; the answer key for the quiz is in the Quiz section.

87–90 min · Closure · I do (3 min)
Summarize the lesson and preview the next reading.
Today we saw how structure shapes injustice and exile. Key takeaway: the De Laceys, poor and exiled, still have each other; the creature has no one.

Total: 90 minutes.

Teacher analysis (spoilers)

Literary elements

- **Structure:** An embedded story within the creature's story (the De Laceys and Safie), a third layer of narration.
- **Characterization:** Felix's rescue of Safie's father, the father's betrayal, and the family's exile show virtue punished.
- **Conflict:** Injustice by a state and by a self-interested man.

Themes and how they develop

- **isolation and companionship:** the De Laceys, poor and exiled, still have each other; the creature has no one.

Symbols and motifs

- **light and fire:** Light stands for knowledge and fire for its double edge: warmth and burning. Victor seeks the "light" of discovery; the creature discovers fire and is burned by it. In this chapter: “the truth of my tale; but at present, as the sun is already far declined, I shall only have time to repeat” (Chapter XIV, paragraph 7).
- **isolation:** Almost every narrator ends up alone; solitude is both the cost of ambition and the creature's suffering. In this chapter: “When alone, Safie resolved in her own mind the plan of conduct that” (Chapter XIV, paragraph 19).

Key quotations (checked against the reading text)

- “The father of Safie had been the cause of their ruin” (Chapter XIV, paragraph 3) Benevolence repaid with treachery.
- “Felix had accidentally been present at the trial; his horror and indignation were uncontrollable, when he heard the decision of the court” (Chapter XIV, paragraph 4) Felix's sense of justice; it echoes Justine's trial.
- “Felix soon learned that the treacherous Turk, for whom he and his family endured such unheard-of oppression” (Chapter XIV, paragraph 15) Ingratitude repays virtue; the word "treacherous" carries the creature's (and the narrative's) judgment.

Model claim-evidence-reasoning

Claim: The De Lacey history shows that even good people suffer injustice, preparing the creature, and the reader, for his own rejection.
Evidence: “The father of Safie had been the cause of their ruin” (Chapter XIV, paragraph 3)
Reasoning: The family's ruin comes from helping the man whose daughter Felix loves, since "the father of Safie had been the cause of their ruin"; goodness here is no protection.

Vocabulary with etymology notes

Word	Definition (in this sentence)	In context	Word history
facilitated (verb)	made easier	*His plans were facilitated by the news which arrived from Paris.*	“facilitated”: Anglicisation of French faciliter "facilitate" through -ate, ultimately from Latin facilis. (Wiktionary, https://en.wiktionary.org/wiki/facilitate#Etymology)
reiterating (verb)	repeating	*The generous nature of Safie was outraged by this command; she attempted to expostulate with her father, but he left her angrily, reiterating his tyrannical mandate.*	“reiterating”: Early 15th century, from Late Latin reiteratus, past participle of reiterare "to repeat" from re- + itero from iterum "again". (Wiktionary, https://en.wiktionary.org/wiki/reiterate#Etymology)

expostulate (verb)	to argue earnestly with someone to change their mind	*The generous nature of Safie was outraged by this command; she attempted to expostulate with her father, but he left her angrily, reiterating his tyrannical mandate.*	“expostulate”: From Latin expostulare "to demand urgently, remonstrate," from ex- + postulare "to demand." (Online Etymology Dictionary, https://www.etymonline.com/word/expostulate)
passports (noun)	any authorization to pass or go somewhere	*Felix had procured passports in the name of his father, sister, and himself.*	“passports”: From French passeport, from passer + port. Compare portpass. Equivalent to pass + port. (Wiktionary, https://en.wiktionary.org/wiki/passport#Etymology)
noisome (adjective)	causing or able to cause nausea	*His blind and aged father, and his gentle sister, lay in a noisome dungeon, while he enjoyed the free air, and the society of her whom he loved.*	“noisome”: From Middle English noysom; equivalent to noy + some<id:adjectival> (short for annoy, from an(n)oien, enoien from Anglo-Norman - anuier, from Old French enuier (French ennuyer), from Late Latin inodiare, from in- + odium "hate"). (Wiktionary, https://en.wiktionary.org/wiki/noisome#Etymology)
affluence (noun)	abundant wealth	*He was descended from a good family in France, where he had lived for many years in affluence, respected by his superiors, and beloved by his equals.*	“affluence”: From Old French affluence, from Latin affluentia. (Wiktionary, https://en.wiktionary.org/wiki/affluence#Etymology)
mandate (noun)	a document giving an official instruction or command	*The generous nature of Safie was outraged by this command; she attempted to expostulate with her father, but he left her angrily, reiterating his tyrannical mandate.*	
spurned (verb)	reject with contempt	*The young girl spoke in high and enthusiastic terms of her mother, who, born in freedom, spurned the bondage to which she was now reduced.*	“spurned”: From Middle English spurnen, spornen, from Old English spurnan "to strike against, kick, spurn, reject; stumble", from Proto-Germanic *spurnaną "to tread, kick, knock out", from Proto-Indo-European *sperH-. (Wiktionary, https://en.wiktionary.org/wiki/spurn#Etymology)
uncontrollable (adjective)	difficult to solve or alleviate	*“Felix had accidentally been present at the trial; his horror and indignation were uncontrollable, when he*	

		heard the decision of the court.	
revolved (verb)	turn on or around an axis or a center	*He revolved a thousand plans by which he should be enabled to prolong the deceit until it might be no longer necessary, and secretly to take his daughter with him when he departed.*	

Discussion questions

1. How does the De Laceys' story parallel the creature's own situation?
2. Where does plot appear in this chapter, and what effect does it have? Point to one passage.
3. How does this chapter connect to the book's larger concern with the sublime power of nature?

Classroom discussion questions (30, tiered)

Wait time after every question (3 s for DOK 1, 5 s for DOK 2, 8 to 10 s for DOK 3 and 4); think-pair-share on DOK 3 and 4; answer each response with a follow-up probe; close with student-generated questions. Focus sets by rigor level: Middle School: 1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 6, 11, 12, 13, 14, 21, 22; HS Freshman: 1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 12, 13, 14, 15, 22, 23, 24; HS Sophomore: 1, 2, 3, 4, 13, 14, 15, 16, 17, 23, 24, 25; HS Junior: 1, 2, 3, 14, 15, 16, 17, 18, 24, 25, 26, 27; HS Senior: 1, 2, 3, 15, 16, 17, 18, 25, 26, 27, 28, 29; AP: 1, 2, 16, 17, 18, 19, 20, 26, 27, 28, 29, 30; College Freshman: 1, 2, 17, 18, 19, 20, 21, 22, 27, 28, 29, 30; College Sophomore: 1, 2, 11, 18, 19, 20, 21, 22, 23, 28, 29, 30; College Junior: 1, 11, 12, 19, 20, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 29, 30; College Senior: 1, 11, 12, 13, 20, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 26, 30; Graduate / PhD: 1, 11, 12, 13, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 26, 27, 28

Literal / recall

1. Why were the De Laceys exiled? [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · 7.RC.1, 7.CC.1, 9-10.RC.1] Look for: Felix helped a Turkish merchant escape
2. Who betrayed them? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · 7.RC.1, 7.CC.1, 9-10.RC.1] Look for: Safie's father
3. Where did these events take place? [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · 7.RC.1, 7.CC.1, 9-10.RC.1] Look for: Paris
4. How does Safie show courage? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · 7.RC.1, 7.CC.1, 9-10.RC.1] Look for: She travels alone to find Felix
5. What larger pattern does this story show? [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · 7.RC.1, 7.CC.1, 9-10.RC.1] Look for: The virtuous often suffer injustice
6. Retell the three most important events of “Chapter XIV” in order, in one sentence each. [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · 7.RC.1, 7.CC.1, 9-10.RC.1] Look for: The creature learns the De Laceys' history: Felix helped Safie's father, a Turkish merchant, escape unjust execution in Paris; the merchant betrayed them, and the family lost wealth and was exiled. Safie fled to find Felix.
7. Which characters appear or are mentioned in “Chapter XIV”? Name two and one thing each says or does. [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · 7.RC.1, 7.CC.1, 9-10.RC.1] Look for: Names and actions taken from the chapter; check against the teacher summary.
8. Where and when does “Chapter XIV” take place? Point to the line that tells you. [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · 7.RC.1, 7.CC.1, 9-10.RC.1] Look for: A place/time detail quoted from the chapter.

9. Reread: “His plans were facilitated by the news which arrived from Paris.” What does “facilitated” mean here, and what is literally happening in this line? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · 7.RC.1, 7.CC.1, 9-10.RC.1] Look for: facilitated: made easier.
10. Reread: “The generous nature of Safie was outraged by this command; she attempted to expostulate with her father, but he left her angrily, reiterating his tyrannical mandate.” What does “reiterating” mean here, and what is literally happening in this line? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · 7.RC.1, 7.CC.1, 9-10.RC.1] Look for: reiterating: repeating.

Inferential / analytical

1. What does “Chapter XIV” suggest about injustice and exile? State the inference and the line that supports it. [DOK 2 · thinkPairShare · wait 5 s · 7.RC.2, 7.CC.2, 9-10.RC.2] Look for: Injustice repeats across the book; the virtuous suffer, and betrayal is common.
2. Find one example of plot in this chapter. What does it reveal that a plain statement would not? [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · 7.RC.3, 7.CC.2, 9-10.RC.1] Look for: Look for key events and the causes linking them.
3. How does the characterization in this chapter shape what we understand about injustice and exile? [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · 7.RC.3, 7.CC.2, 9-10.RC.1] Look for: Look for what characters say, do and think, and how others react to them.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The De Lacey history shows that even good people suffer injustice, preparing the creature, and the reader, for his own rejection. Useful evidence: “The father of Safie had been the cause of their ruin” (Chapter XIV, paragraph 3): Benevolence repaid with treachery. On characterization: Felix's rescue of Safie's father, the father's betrayal, and the family's exile show virtue punished. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
4. In the passage that begins ““The name of the old man was De Lacey.”, why might Shelley have chosen these particular words? Pick two and explain their connotations. [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · 7.RC.12, 7.CC.2, 9-10.RC.12] Look for: Diction analysis of two words in the anchor passage.
5. What causes the main turn in “Chapter XIV”, and what effect is it likely to have on what follows? [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · 7.RC.3, 7.CC.2, 9-10.RC.1] Look for: The creature learns the De Laceys' history: Felix helped Safie's father, a Turkish merchant, escape unjust execution in Paris; the merchant betrayed them, and the family lost wealth and was exiled. Safie fled to find Felix.
6. How does “Chapter XIV” build on “Chapter XIII”? Name one link of cause and effect. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · 7.RC.3, 7.CC.2, 9-10.RC.3] Look for: A causal or structural link between this and the previous chapter.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The De Lacey history shows that even good people suffer injustice, preparing the creature, and the reader, for his own rejection. Useful evidence: “Felix had accidentally been present at the trial; his horror and indignation were uncontrollable, when he heard the decision of the court” (Chapter XIV, paragraph 4): Felix's sense of justice; it echoes Justine's trial. On structure: An embedded story within the creature's story (the De Laceys and Safie), a third layer of narration. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
7. What can we infer about a character's motives from what they say and do here, as opposed to what they claim? [DOK 3 · followUp · wait 8 s · 7.RC.3, 7.CC.2, 9-10.RC.1] Look for: An inference about motive supported by a quoted line.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The De Lacey history shows that even good people

suffer injustice, preparing the creature, and the reader, for his own rejection. Useful evidence: “Felix soon learned that the treacherous Turk, for whom he and his family endured such unheard-of oppression” (Chapter XIV, paragraph 15): Ingratitude repays virtue; the word "treacherous" carries the creature's (and the narrative's) judgment. On characterization: Felix's rescue of Safie's father, the father's betrayal, and the family's exile show virtue punished. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

8. The bell-ringer asked: “How does the De Laceys' story parallel the creature's own situation?” Now that we have read closely, how would you revise your first answer, and which line changed your mind? [DOK 2 · thinkPairShare · wait 5 s · 7.RC.2, 7.CC.2, 9-10.RC.2] Look for: A revised answer anchored in the text.
9. Where does irony appear, and how does it connect this chapter to the larger concern with the sublime power of nature? [DOK 3 · followUp · wait 8 s · 7.RC.1, 7.CC.2, 9-10.RC.1] Look for: Look for gaps between what characters expect or say and what is true.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The De Lacey history shows that even good people suffer injustice, preparing the creature, and the reader, for his own rejection. Useful evidence: “The father of Safie had been the cause of their ruin” (Chapter XIV, paragraph 3): Benevolence repaid with treachery. Theme link: the De Laceys, poor and exiled, still have each other; the creature has no one. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
10. Background: The story reflects prejudices and politics of 18th-century France and attitudes toward the Ottoman world. How does knowing this change the way you read one moment in the chapter? [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · 7.RC.3, 7.CC.2, 9-10.RC.1] Look for: A specific moment reread in light of the context.
    Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The De Lacey history shows that even good people suffer injustice, preparing the creature, and the reader, for his own rejection. Useful evidence: “Felix had accidentally been present at the trial; his horror and indignation were uncontrollable, when he heard the decision of the court” (Chapter XIV, paragraph 4): Felix's sense of justice; it echoes Justine's trial. Theme link: the De Laceys, poor and exiled, still have each other; the creature has no one. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

Evaluative / synthesis / creative

1. A critic might argue: “Injustice repeats across the book; the virtuous suffer, and betrayal is common.” How far do you agree? Take a stand and defend it with two lines from the chapter. [DOK 3 · fourCorners · wait 8 s · 7.RC.2, 7.CC.3, 9-10.RC.2] Look for: A defended position with evidence and one counterpoint.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The De Lacey history shows that even good people suffer injustice, preparing the creature, and the reader, for his own rejection. Useful evidence: “Felix soon learned that the treacherous Turk, for whom he and his family endured such unheard-of oppression” (Chapter XIV, paragraph 15): Ingratitude repays virtue; the word "treacherous" carries the creature's (and the narrative's) judgment. Theme link: the De Laceys, poor and exiled, still have each other; the creature has no one. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
2. Which character in this chapter acts most wisely, and which least? Judge them by a standard you name. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · 7.RC.3, 7.CC.3, 9-10.RC.1] Look for: An evaluation using an explicit criterion and evidence.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The De Lacey history shows that even good people

suffer injustice, preparing the creature, and the reader, for his own rejection. Useful evidence: “The father of Safie had been the cause of their ruin” (Chapter XIV, paragraph 3): Benevolence repaid with treachery. On characterization: Felix's rescue of Safie's father, the father's betrayal, and the family's exile show virtue punished. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

3. Rewrite one moment of “Chapter XIV” from the point of view of a different character. What does the new angle reveal or hide about injustice and exile? [DOK 4 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · 7.RC.1, 7.CC.3, 9-10.RC.1] Look for: A creative product with a rationale tied to the text.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The De Lacey history shows that even good people suffer injustice, preparing the creature, and the reader, for his own rejection. Useful evidence: “Felix had accidentally been present at the trial; his horror and indignation were uncontrollable, when he heard the decision of the court” (Chapter XIV, paragraph 4): Felix's sense of justice; it echoes Justine's trial. Theme link: the De Laceys, poor and exiled, still have each other; the creature has no one. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

4. Write three questions of your own about “Chapter XIV”: one recall, one “why/how”, and one “should/what if”. Trade with a partner and answer theirs. [DOK 3 · studentGenerated · wait 8 s · 7.RC.2, 7.CC.3, 9-10.RC.2] Look for: Student-generated questions at three levels.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The De Lacey history shows that even good people suffer injustice, preparing the creature, and the reader, for his own rejection. Useful evidence: “Felix soon learned that the treacherous Turk, for whom he and his family endured such unheard-of oppression” (Chapter XIV, paragraph 15): Ingratitude repays virtue; the word "treacherous" carries the creature's (and the narrative's) judgment. Theme link: the De Laceys, poor and exiled, still have each other; the creature has no one. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

5. Connect this chapter to the costs of unchecked ambition: is the link strong or weak so far? What would Shelley need to show next to strengthen it? [DOK 4 · socraticCircle · wait 8 s · 7.RC.2, 7.CC.3, 9-10.RC.2] Look for: A judgment of thematic development across the work.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The De Lacey history shows that even good people suffer injustice, preparing the creature, and the reader, for his own rejection. Useful evidence: “The father of Safie had been the cause of their ruin” (Chapter XIV, paragraph 3): Benevolence repaid with treachery. Theme link: the De Laceys, poor and exiled, still have each other; the creature has no one. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

6. Is the plot in this chapter effective, or does it feel heavy-handed? Evaluate it as a reader would in a review. [DOK 3 · fourCorners · wait 8 s · 7.RC.3, 7.CC.3, 9-10.RC.1] Look for: An evaluative judgment with criteria and evidence.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The De Lacey history shows that even good people suffer injustice, preparing the creature, and the reader, for his own rejection. Useful evidence: “Felix had accidentally been present at the trial; his horror and indignation were uncontrollable, when he heard the decision of the court” (Chapter XIV, paragraph 4): Felix's sense of justice; it echoes Justine's trial. Theme link: the De Laceys, poor and exiled, still have each other; the creature has no one. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

7. Compare how “Chapter XIV” treats injustice and exile with how another text, film or event you know treats a similar idea. What does Frankenstein see that the other misses? [DOK 4 · socraticCircle · wait 8 s ·

7.RC.2, 7.CC.3, 9-10.RC.2] Look for: A cross-text synthesis.

Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The De Lacey history shows that even good people suffer injustice, preparing the creature, and the reader, for his own rejection. Useful evidence: “Felix soon learned that the treacherous Turk, for whom he and his family endured such unheard-of oppression” (Chapter XIV, paragraph 15): Ingratitude repays virtue; the word "treacherous" carries the creature's (and the narrative's) judgment. Theme link: the De Laceys, poor and exiled, still have each other; the creature has no one. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

8. Predict what “Chapter XV” will bring, using two clues from this chapter. After reading, evaluate your prediction. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · 7.RC.3, 7.CC.3, 9-10.RC.3] Look for: A prediction or judgment justified with textual clues.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The De Lacey history shows that even good people suffer injustice, preparing the creature, and the reader, for his own rejection. Useful evidence: “The father of Safie had been the cause of their ruin” (Chapter XIV, paragraph 3): Benevolence repaid with treachery. Theme link: the De Laceys, poor and exiled, still have each other; the creature has no one. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

9. Design a one-paragraph modern adaptation of this chapter (setting, characters, conflict). What must stay the same for it to still be about injustice and exile? [DOK 4 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · 7.RC.2, 7.CC.3, 9-10.RC.2] Look for: A creative transfer that keeps the core idea.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The De Lacey history shows that even good people suffer injustice, preparing the creature, and the reader, for his own rejection. Useful evidence: “Felix had accidentally been present at the trial; his horror and indignation were uncontrollable, when he heard the decision of the court” (Chapter XIV, paragraph 4): Felix's sense of justice; it echoes Justine's trial. Theme link: the De Laceys, poor and exiled, still have each other; the creature has no one. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

10. What question would you most like to ask Mary Shelley about this chapter, and what answer do you think the text itself gives? [DOK 4 · studentGenerated · wait 8 s · 7.RC.2, 7.CC.3, 9-10.RC.2] Look for: A student-generated question answered from evidence.

    Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The De Lacey history shows that even good people suffer injustice, preparing the creature, and the reader, for his own rejection. Useful evidence: “Felix soon learned that the treacherous Turk, for whom he and his family endured such unheard-of oppression” (Chapter XIV, paragraph 15): Ingratitude repays virtue; the word "treacherous" carries the creature's (and the narrative's) judgment. Theme link: the De Laceys, poor and exiled, still have each other; the creature has no one. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

Annotation focus

- **Plot:** look for key events and the causes linking them (anchor passage in the We do segment)
- Also notice **Characterization**: what characters say, do and think, and how others react to them
- Also notice **Irony**: gaps between what characters expect or say and what is true

Chapter quiz: item bank (all eleven rigor versions)

1. [fill · recall · DOK 1] Fill in the blank with the vocabulary word that fits: "The young girl spoke in high and enthusiastic terms of her mother, who, born in freedom, _____ the bondage to which she was now reduced." Word bank: expostulate, facilitated, spurned, reiterating
   Key: spurned
2. [mc · recall · DOK 1] In the line "The generous nature of Safie was outraged by this command; she attempted to expostulate with her father, but he left her angrily, reiterating his tyrannical mandate.", what does "reiterating" most nearly mean?
   A. repeating
   B. part with a possession or right
   C. cause to move more slowly or operate at a slower rate
   D. get involved, so as to alter or hinder an action, or through force or threat of force
   Key: A (repeating)
3. [fill · recall · DOK 1] Complete the quotation from Chapter XIV, paragraph 15: "Felix soon learned that the _____ Turk, for whom he and his family endured such unheard-of oppression"
   Key: treacherous
4. [mc · recall · DOK 1] In the line "His plans were facilitated by the news which arrived from Paris.", what does "facilitated" most nearly mean?
   A. made easier
   B. folds or hollows (here, in the hills)
   C. difficult to penetrate; incomprehensible to one of ordinary understanding or knowledge
   D. jailers who keep the keys
   Key: A (made easier)
5. [fill · recall · DOK 1] Complete the quotation from Chapter XIV, paragraph 4: "Felix had accidentally been present at the trial; his horror and indignation were _____, when he heard the decision of the court"
   Key: uncontrollable
6. [fill · recall · DOK 1] Fill in the blank with the vocabulary word that fits: "He was descended from a good family in France, where he had lived for many years in _____, respected by his superiors, and beloved by his equals." Word bank: affluence, reiterating, expostulate, facilitated
   Key: affluence
7. [fill · recall · DOK 1] Fill in the blank with the vocabulary word that fits: "The generous nature of Safie was outraged by this command; she attempted to expostulate with her father, but he left her angrily, reiterating his tyrannical _____." Word bank: reiterating, expostulate, facilitated, mandate
   Key: mandate
8. [mc · recall · DOK 1] In the line "Felix had procured passports in the name of his father, sister, and himself.", what does "passports" most nearly mean?
   A. a sloping gallery with seats for spectators (as in an operating room or theater)
   B. to speed up; to hasten
   C. any authorization to pass or go somewhere
   D. impossible to overcome
   Key: C (any authorization to pass or go somewhere)

9. [fill · recall · DOK 1] Complete the quotation from Chapter XIV, paragraph 3: “The _____ of Safie had been the cause of their ruin”

   Key: father

10. [short · inference · DOK 2] What can you infer from this line? “The father of Safie had been the cause of their ruin” (Chapter XIV, paragraph 3) Answer in two or three sentences with one detail.

    Sample answer: Benevolence repaid with treachery.

11. [short · inference · DOK 2] What can you infer from this line? “Felix had accidentally been present at the trial; his horror and indignation were uncontrollable, when he heard the decision of the court” (Chapter XIV, paragraph 4) Answer in two or three sentences with one detail.

    Sample answer: Felix's sense of justice; it echoes Justine's trial.

12. [mc · inference · DOK 2] What does this passage most clearly show? “Felix had accidentally been present at the trial; his horror and indignation were uncontrollable, when he heard the decision of the court” (Chapter XIV, paragraph 4)

    A. The turn from ambition to revulsion in one sentence.

    B. Felix's sense of justice; it echoes Justine's trial.

    C. Isolation through allusion.

    D. Milton allusion; the creature casts Victor as a God who failed.

    Key: B (Felix's sense of justice; it echoes Justine's trial.)

13. [mc · inference · DOK 2] What does this passage most clearly show? “The father of Safie had been the cause of their ruin” (Chapter XIV, paragraph 3)

    A. Milton allusion; the creature casts Victor as a God who failed.

    B. Benevolence repaid with treachery.

    C. Short and plain amid his long sentences: the emotional core of the letter.

    D. Psychological insight into grief and guilt.

    Key: B (Benevolence repaid with treachery.)

14. [short · analysis · DOK 3] Analyze the word choice in “Felix soon learned that the treacherous Turk, for whom he and his family endured such unheard-of oppression” (Chapter XIV, paragraph 15). Pick two words and explain what they suggest.

    Sample answer: Ingratitude repays virtue; the word "treacherous" carries the creature's (and the narrative's) judgment.

15. [mc · analysis · DOK 3] Which literary element does this describe in “Chapter XIV”? An embedded story within the creature's story (the De Laceys and Safie), a third layer of narration.

    A. Structure

    B. Metaphor

    C. Plot

    D. Setting

    Key: A (Structure)

16. [short · synthesis · DOK 4] Close reading: how do the diction and syntax of “The father of Safie had been the cause of their ruin” (Chapter XIV, paragraph 3) shape its meaning? Consider a second, competing reading.

    Sample answer: Benevolence repaid with treachery.

17. [mc · recall · DOK 1] What larger pattern does this story show?

    A. Crime is always punished

B. The virtuous often suffer injustice

C. Wealth guarantees happiness

D. Travel is safe

Key: B (The virtuous often suffer injustice)

18. [mc · recall · DOK 1] Who betrayed them?

A. Agatha

B. Safie's father

C. Safie

D. Victor

Key: B (Safie's father)

19. [mc · recall · DOK 1] How does Safie show courage?

A. She runs a business

B. She fights soldiers

C. She becomes a judge

D. She travels alone to find Felix

Key: D (She travels alone to find Felix)

20. [mc · inference · DOK 2] Which choice best states a central concern of “Chapter XIV”?

A. Despair and the sublime

B. Learning compassion by watching

C. Ambition and the hunger for discovery

D. Injustice and exile

Key: D (Injustice and exile)

21. [mc · inference · DOK 2] What does this passage most clearly show? “Felix soon learned that the treacherous Turk, for whom he and his family endured such unheard-of oppression” (Chapter XIV, paragraph 15)

A. Metaphor tying his ruin to the blasted oak.

B. The wish to belong.

C. Restoration that the reader suspects cannot last.

D. Ingratitude repays virtue; the word "treacherous" carries the creature's (and the narrative's) judgment.

Key: D (Ingratitude repays virtue; the word "treacherous" carries the creature's (and the narrative's) judgment.)

22. [short · analysis · DOK 3] Claim: The De Lacey history shows that even good people suffer injustice, preparing the creature, and the reader, for his own rejection. Explain how this evidence supports the claim: “The father of Safie had been the cause of their ruin” (Chapter XIV, paragraph 3).

Sample answer: The family's ruin comes from helping the man whose daughter Felix loves, since "the father of Safie had been the cause of their ruin"; goodness here is no protection.

23. [mc · analysis · DOK 3] Which literary element does this describe in “Chapter XIV”? Felix's rescue of Safie's father, the father's betrayal, and the family's exile show virtue punished.

A. Symbolism

B. Characterization

C. Theme

D. Personification

Key: B (Characterization)

24. [short · synthesis · DOK 4] Synthesis: trace how isolation and companionship develops from an earlier chapter to “Chapter XIV”. Use one quotation from each.
    Sample answer: the De Laceys, poor and exiled, still have each other; the creature has no one.

25. [mc · recall · DOK 1] In the line “The generous nature of Safie was outraged by this command; she attempted to expostulate with her father, but he left her angrily, reiterating his tyrannical mandate.”, what does “expostulate” most nearly mean?
    A. to argue earnestly with someone to change their mind
    B. to rise and fall; to change often
    C. covered overhead like a canopy
    D. without paths; untraveled
    Key: A (to argue earnestly with someone to change their mind)

26. [short · synthesis · DOK 4] Evaluate this claim about the chapter: “The De Lacey history shows that even good people suffer injustice, preparing the creature, and the reader, for his own rejection.” Is it fully persuasive? Argue with evidence, including a passage that complicates it.
    Sample answer: The family's ruin comes from helping the man whose daughter Felix loves, since "the father of Safie had been the cause of their ruin"; goodness here is no protection.

27. [mc · recall · DOK 1] Why were the De Laceys exiled?
    A. Felix helped a Turkish merchant escape
    B. They were scientists
    C. They insulted the king
    D. They stole money
    Key: A (Felix helped a Turkish merchant escape)

28. [short · synthesis · DOK 4] Close reading: how do the diction and syntax of “Felix had accidentally been present at the trial; his horror and indignation were uncontrollable, when he heard the decision of the court” (Chapter XIV, paragraph 4) shape its meaning? Consider a second, competing reading.
    Sample answer: Felix's sense of justice; it echoes Justine's trial.

29. [fill · recall · DOK 1] Fill in the blank with the vocabulary word that fits: “His blind and aged father, and his gentle sister, lay in a _____ dungeon, while he enjoyed the free air, and the society of her whom he loved.”
    Word bank: noisome, reiterating, expostulate, facilitated
    Key: noisome

30. [mc · recall · DOK 1] Where did these events take place?
    A. Ingolstadt
    B. London
    C. Paris
    D. Constantinople
    Key: C (Paris)

Rigor version	Items (in order)	Mix
Middle School	1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 6, 7, 8, 9, 10, 11, 12, 13, 14, 15, 16	recall 9, inference 4, analysis 2, synthesis 1
HS Freshman	17, 5, 7, 2, 8, 18, 6, 19, 20, 12, 21, 11, 22, 14, 23, 24	recall 8, inference 4, analysis 3, synthesis 1

HS Sophomore	7, 25, 8, 9, 3, 2, 13, 20, 11, 12, 10, 22, 15, 14, 24, 26	recall 6, inference 5, analysis 3, synthesis 2
HS Junior	19, 5, 2, 27, 6, 12, 13, 20, 11, 21, 14, 15, 23, 22, 26, 24	recall 5, inference 5, analysis 4, synthesis 2
HS Senior	6, 5, 7, 18, 11, 20, 13, 21, 10, 22, 15, 14, 23, 28, 24, 26	recall 4, inference 5, analysis 4, synthesis 3
AP	29, 1, 30, 12, 20, 21, 10, 13, 23, 14, 15, 22, 28, 24, 16, 26	recall 3, inference 5, analysis 4, synthesis 4
College Freshman	6, 29, 27, 10, 11, 13, 12, 21, 23, 14, 15, 22, 28, 26, 24, 16	recall 3, inference 5, analysis 4, synthesis 4
College Sophomore	29, 7, 13, 20, 11, 12, 10, 21, 23, 14, 22, 15, 28, 16, 24, 26	recall 2, inference 6, analysis 4, synthesis 4
College Junior	6, 29, 10, 21, 12, 20, 11, 13, 15, 14, 22, 23, 16, 28, 24, 26	recall 2, inference 6, analysis 4, synthesis 4
College Senior	29, 1, 11, 10, 20, 12, 13, 21, 14, 22, 23, 15, 24, 28, 26, 16	recall 2, inference 6, analysis 4, synthesis 4
Graduate / PhD	1, 29, 12, 21, 20, 10, 13, 11, 14, 15, 22, 23, 24, 26, 16, 28	recall 2, inference 6, analysis 4, synthesis 4

Writing prompts (eleven rigor levels)

Middle School (250 words; Indiana 2023: 7.RC.3, 7.W.1): Supported track (work from the passage your teacher selects). In “Chapter XIV,” how does Shelley show injustice and exile? Write a paragraph that states your claim, quotes two details from the passage, and explains how each detail supports your idea. Use the plot you noticed as one piece of evidence.

HS Freshman (350 words; Indiana 2023: 9-10.RC.1, 9-10.W.1): In Chapter XIV, how does Shelley develop the idea of injustice and exile? State a clear claim, support it with two or three quotations, and explain how the plot in the chapter helps build that idea.

HS Sophomore (450 words; Indiana 2023: 9-10.RC.1, 9-10.W.1): Analyze how Chapter XIV develops the idea of injustice and exile. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of plot and characterization shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.

HS Junior (550 words; Indiana 2023: 11-12.RC.3, 11-12.RC.1, 11-12.W.1): Analyze how the structure of Chapter XIV (where it begins, turns and ends) and its plot shape the reader's understanding of injustice and exile. Identify one place where the text leaves matters uncertain and explain how that uncertainty adds to its meaning.

HS Senior (600 words; Indiana 2023: 11-12.RC.1, 11-12.W.1): Two readers disagree about what Chapter XIV suggests about injustice and exile. Lay out two plausible interpretations, weigh the evidence for each (including the chapter's plot and characterization), and argue for the stronger one in a sustained, well-organized essay.

AP (650 words; Indiana 2023: 11-12.RC.1, 11-12.W.1): Write a literary argument in which you analyze how Mary Shelley uses plot in Chapter XIV to complicate the reader's understanding of injustice and exile. Develop a defensible thesis, select evidence purposefully, and explain how specific choices of diction and syntax create meaning.

College Freshman (1000 words; Indiana 2023: see unit standards): Situate Chapter XIV within its historical and literary context and argue how the chapter's treatment of injustice and exile responds to that context. Engage with at least one secondary perspective (a critic, historian or the author's own statements), integrate quotations smoothly, and cite in MLA style.

College Sophomore (1250 words; Indiana 2023: see unit standards): Read Chapter XIV alongside the conventions of its genre and period. Argue how the chapter's handling of injustice and exile follows or bends those conventions, using the plot as evidence, and test your reading against one published critic. Document two secondary sources in MLA.

College Junior (1500 words; Indiana 2023: see unit standards): Apply a named critical approach (for example formalist, historicist, feminist, psychoanalytic or ecocritical) to Chapter XIV and its treatment of injustice and exile. State your method, show what it reveals in the chapter's plot and characterization, and identify where the text resists it.

College Senior (2000 words; Indiana 2023: see unit standards): Develop a research argument that reads Chapter XIV as evidence for a larger claim about injustice and exile in Frankenstein. Connect close reading of the chapter to the whole novel, engage at least four scholarly sources, and state precisely where your reading departs from theirs (Chicago style).

Graduate / PhD (2500 words; Indiana 2023: see unit standards): Develop an original argument that reads Chapter XIV as a hinge in the novel's larger treatment of injustice and exile. Position your reading within a named critical conversation (for example formalist, historicist, psychoanalytic, feminist or postcolonial approaches), account for the textual history where relevant, and articulate the stakes of your intervention for scholarship on Frankenstein.

SAT-style questions

1. *The generous nature of Safie was outraged by this command; she attempted to expostulate with her father, but he left her angrily, reiterating his tyrannical mandate.*

   As used in the text, what does the word “expostulate” most nearly mean?

   A. reject with contempt

   B. turn on or around an axis or a center

   C. difficult to solve or alleviate

   D. to argue earnestly with someone to change their mind

2. *“The name of the old man was De Lacey. He was descended from a good family in France, where he had lived for many years in affluence, respected by his superiors, and beloved by his equals. His son was bred in the service of his country; and Agatha had ranked with ladies of the highest distinction. A few months before my arrival, they had lived in a large and luxurious city, called Paris, surrounded by friends, and possessed of every enjoyment which virtue, refinement of intellect, or taste, accompanied by a moderate fortune, could afford.*

Which choice best states a central concern of "Chapter XIV"?

A. First experiences of the senses

B. A letter, a secret and the wedding

C. Injustice and exile

D. Loneliness and the desire for a friend

SAT key: 1. D (to argue earnestly with someone to change their mind); 2. C (Injustice and exile)

Lesson 22: Chapter XV

Focus: reading and identity

Objective: Students will analyze how allusion develops in “Chapter XV” by writing a claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph that cites at least 2 quotations from the section, and will score at least 80% on the section quiz.

Standards: CCSS RL.9-10.9, W.9-10.1, L.9-10.4 · IN 9-10.RC.1, 9-10.W.1, 9-10.RC.9, 9-10.RC.11

Critical voice: “That he should have not only learned to speak, but to read, and, for aught we know, to write -- that he should have become acquainted with Werter, with Plutarch's Lives, and with Paradise Lost, by listening through a hole in a wall, seems as unlikely as that he should have acquired, in the same way, the problems of Euclid, or the art of book-keeping by single and double entry.” (Walter Scott (attrib.), novelist and critic, *"Remarks on Frankenstein, or the Modern Prometheus; A Novel," Blackwood's Edinburgh Magazine 2:12 (March 1818), p. 619*; public domain). Essay lens: Scott calls the self-education improbable. Argue why Shelley needs the creature to be eloquent anyway (what would the novel lose if he could not speak?). *Objective:* Analyze how reading (Paradise Lost, Plutarch, Werter) shapes the creature's identity, and the plausibility of his education. *Standards:* RL.11-12.3, RL.11-12.5, 11-12.RC.1, 11-12.RC.3

Critical voice: “The scene between the Being and the blind De Lacey in the cottage, is one of the most profound and extraordinary instances of pathos that we ever recollect.” (Percy Bysshe Shelley, poet, *"On 'Frankenstein'" (written c.1817; pub. The Athenaeum, 10 Nov 1832), in The Prose Works of Percy Bysshe Shelley (1880), paragraph 3*; public domain). Close reading: why make De Lacey blind? Students explain how blindness lets the creature be judged by his words alone, and what happens when sight returns with Felix. *Objective:* Analyze the De Lacey scene as the turning point in the creature's hope for acceptance. *Standards:* RL.11-12.3, 11-12.RC.1

Teacher only · spoilers

The creature finds Paradise Lost, Plutarch's Lives and The Sorrows of Young Werther, and reads Victor's laboratory journal, which describes his creation with disgust. He reveals himself to the blind old De Lacey, who is kind, but Felix, Agatha and Safie return, and Felix strikes him and drives him away.

Background: Each book shapes him: Werther teaches feeling, Plutarch virtue and heroism, Milton his place in creation.

Significance: He identifies with both Adam and Satan; the De Laceys' rejection is the turning point from benevolence to rage.

Lesson plan and lecture script (90 minutes)

0–8 min · Bell-ringer · You do (8 min)
Students write to the bell-ringer, then pair-share.
Why does the creature compare himself to both Adam and Satan? Write for five minutes. Starters: I think... because... / This connects to nature and nurture because....
Prompt: Why does the creature compare himself to both Adam and Satan?
Sentence starters: I think… because… · This connects to nature and nurture because…
Strong response: A strong response takes a position and anticipates this: rejection is based on sight; the blind man alone judges him by his words.

8–18 min · Vocabulary with etymology notes · I do (10 min)
Five key words in context, with verified word histories.
Today's words: massacring — killing large numbers of people; undeceiving — showing someone the truth; freeing from a false belief; instigate — to urge on; to provoke; unformed — not having form or shape; disquisitions — an elaborate analytical or explanatory essay or discussion. "massacring": 1580, from Middle French massacre, from Old French macacre, marcacre, macecre, macecle "slaughterhouse, butchery", usually thought to be deverbal from Old French macecrer, macecler "to slaughter", though the noun seems to be attested somewhat earlier. It is also found in Medieval Latin mazacrium "massacre, slaughter, killing", also "the head of a newly killed stag". Further origin disputed: "instigate": Latin īnstīgātus, perfect passive participle of īnstīgō "to instigate", see -ate. "disquisitions": Borrowed from French disquisition "disquisition", from Latin disquīsītiō "inquiry, investigation", from disquīrō "to investigate" (from dis- + quaerō "to look for, seek; to inquire, question") + -tiō.
Words: massacring: killing large numbers of people · undeceiving: showing someone the truth; freeing from a false belief · instigate: to urge on; to provoke · unformed: not having form or shape · disquisitions: an elaborate analytical or explanatory essay or discussion

18–28 min · Background and context · I do (10 min)
Mini-lecture (read or adapt the script).
Each book shapes him: Werther teaches feeling, Plutarch virtue and heroism, Milton his place in creation. He identifies with both Adam and Satan; the De Laceys' rejection is the turning point from benevolence to rage. Allusion: The three books he finds (Paradise Lost, Plutarch's Lives, The Sorrows of Werter) give him models of a creator, of public virtue and of feeling. Characterization: He identifies with both Adam and Satan, and reads Victor's journal about his own creation. Irony: Old De Lacey, blind, welcomes him; the family, seeing him, attacks. Watch for blindness: De Lacey's blindness lets him see the creature truly.

28–40 min · I do: modeled close reading · I do (12 min)
Model the close reading of the anchor quotation using the written think-aloud below.
I read the line once for meaning and once for craft. "Paradise Lost, a volume of Plutarch's Lives, and the Sorrows of Werther" (Chapter XV, paragraph 3). His education; each book shapes him. That is allusion at work: The three books he finds (Paradise Lost, Plutarch's Lives, The Sorrows of Werter) give him models of a creator, of public virtue and of feeling.

> *Paradise Lost, a volume of Plutarch's Lives, and the Sorrows of Werther (Chapter XV, paragraph 3)*

Think-aloud: I read the line once for meaning and once for craft. "Paradise Lost, a volume of Plutarch's Lives, and the Sorrows of Werther" (Chapter XV, paragraph 3). His education; each book shapes him. That is allusion at work: The three books he finds (Paradise Lost, Plutarch's Lives, The Sorrows of Werter) give him models of a creator, of public virtue and of feeling.

40–55 min · We do: guided annotation · We do (15 min)
Guided analysis of a second quotation; expected answers given.
Ask: What words in this line stand out, and what do they suggest? Expected: Adam had Eve and God; the creature has "no link" to anyone. The allusion intensifies isolation and connects to companionship. Ask: How does this line connect to nature and nurture? Expected: Rejection is based on sight; the blind man alone judges him by his words. (Isolation through allusion.)

> *Like Adam, I was apparently united by no link to any other being in existence (Chapter XV, paragraph 7)*

Ask: What words in this line stand out, and what do they suggest?
Expected answer: Adam had Eve and God; the creature has "no link" to anyone. The allusion intensifies isolation and connects to companionship.
Ask: How does this line connect to nature and nurture?
Expected answer: Rejection is based on sight; the blind man alone judges him by his words. (Isolation through allusion.)

55–70 min · You do: independent annotation · You do (15 min)

Independent annotation and a claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph (exemplar given).

Annotate the chapter for allusion, characterization (three marks with a margin note each), then write one claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph: what does this chapter suggest about reading and identity? Then start your writing prompt at your assigned level (HS Sophomore: Analyze how Chapter XV develops the idea of reading and identity. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of allusion and characterization shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.) Exemplar: The creature's rejection by the De Laceys proves that appearance, not character, condemns him. When the text says "Paradise Lost, a volume of Plutarch's Lives, and the Sorrows of Werther" (Chapter XV, paragraph 3), it shows this directly. Old De Lacey, who is blind, responds kindly to his words, but the family sees him and attacks; the scene shows that only someone who cannot see him can judge him fairly.

Task: Annotate the chapter for allusion, characterization (three marks with a margin note each), then write one claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph: what does this chapter suggest about reading and identity? Then start your writing prompt at your assigned level (HS Sophomore: Analyze how Chapter XV develops the idea of reading and identity. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of allusion and characterization shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.)

Exemplar: The creature's rejection by the De Laceys proves that appearance, not character, condemns him. When the text says "Paradise Lost, a volume of Plutarch's Lives, and the Sorrows of Werther" (Chapter XV, paragraph 3), it shows this directly. Old De Lacey, who is blind, responds kindly to his words, but the family sees him and attacks; the scene shows that only someone who cannot see him can judge him fairly.

70–80 min · Discussion · We do (10 min)

Structured discussion from the 30 tiered questions, with facilitation notes.

Anchor question: Why does the creature compare himself to both Adam and Satan? The blind man scene often moves students strongly. Allow emotion, then ask about Shelley's choice to make him blind.

Anchor question: Why does the creature compare himself to both Adam and Satan?

Facilitation: The blind man scene often moves students strongly. Allow emotion, then ask about Shelley's choice to make him blind.

80–87 min · Exit ticket / chapter quiz · You do (7 min)
Chapter quiz in the app and an exit ticket (answer given).
Chapter quiz in the app, then: In one sentence, what does this chapter suggest about reading and identity? Support it with one short quotation. Model answer: The creature's rejection by the De Laceys proves that appearance, not character, condemns him. ("Paradise Lost, a volume of Plutarch's Lives, and the Sorrows of Werther", Chapter XV, paragraph 3). Accept any defensible claim backed by a quotation from the chapter; the answer key for the quiz is in the Quiz section.
Exit ticket: In one sentence, what does this chapter suggest about reading and identity? Support it with one short quotation.
Answer: Model answer: The creature's rejection by the De Laceys proves that appearance, not character, condemns him. ("Paradise Lost, a volume of Plutarch's Lives, and the Sorrows of Werther", Chapter XV, paragraph 3). Accept any defensible claim backed by a quotation from the chapter; the answer key for the quiz is in the Quiz section.

87–90 min · Closure · I do (3 min)
Summarize the lesson and preview the next reading.
Today we saw how allusion shapes reading and identity. Key takeaway: rejection is based on sight; the blind man alone judges him by his words.

Total: 90 minutes.

Teacher analysis (spoilers)

Literary elements

- **Allusion:** The three books he finds (Paradise Lost, Plutarch's Lives, The Sorrows of Werter) give him models of a creator, of public virtue and of feeling.
- **Characterization:** He identifies with both Adam and Satan, and reads Victor's journal about his own creation.
- **Irony:** Old De Lacey, blind, welcomes him; the family, seeing him, attacks.

Themes and how they develop

- **nature and nurture:** rejection is based on sight; the blind man alone judges him by his words.

Symbols and motifs

- **blindness:** De Lacey's blindness lets him see the creature truly.

Key quotations (checked against the reading text)

- "Paradise Lost, a volume of Plutarch's Lives, and the Sorrows of Werther" (Chapter XV, paragraph 3) His education; each book shapes him.
- "Like Adam, I was apparently united by no link to any other being in existence" (Chapter XV, paragraph 7) Isolation through allusion.

- "Hateful day when I received life" (Chapter XV, paragraph 8) The creature curses his own birth, echoing Job.

Model claim-evidence-reasoning

Claim: The creature's rejection by the De Laceys proves that appearance, not character, condemns him.
Evidence: "Paradise Lost, a volume of Plutarch's Lives, and the Sorrows of Werther" (Chapter XV, paragraph 3)
Reasoning: Old De Lacey, who is blind, responds kindly to his words, but the family sees him and attacks; the scene shows that only someone who cannot see him can judge him fairly.

Vocabulary with etymology notes

Word	Definition (in this sentence)	In context	Word history
massacring (verb)	killing large numbers of people	*I read of men concerned in public affairs, governing or massacring their species.*	"massacring": 1580, from Middle French massacre, from Old French macacre, marcacre, macecre, macecle "slaughterhouse, butchery", usually thought to be deverbal from Old French macecrer, macecler "to slaughter", though the noun seems to be attested somewhat earlier. It is also found in Medieval Latin mazacrium "massacre, slaughter, killing", also "the head of a newly killed stag". Further origin disputed: (Wiktionary, https://en.wiktionary.org/wiki/massacre#Etymology)
undeceiving (verb)	showing someone the truth; freeing from a false belief	*"The old man paused, and then continued, 'If you will unreservedly confide to me the particulars of your tale, I perhaps may be of use in undeceiving them.*	
instigate (verb)	to urge on; to provoke	*" 'Heaven forbid! even if you were really criminal; for that can only drive you to desperation, and not instigate you to virtue.*	"instigate": Latin īnstīgātus, perfect passive participle of īnstīgō "to instigate", see -ate. (Wiktionary, https://en.wiktionary.org/wiki/instigate#Etymology)
unformed (adjective)	not having form or shape	*I sympathised with, and partly understood them, but I was unformed in mind; I was dependent on none, and related to none. 'The path of my departure was free'; and there was*	

		none to lament my annihilation.	
disquisitions (noun)	an elaborate analytical or explanatory essay or discussion	*The disquisitions upon death and suicide were calculated to fill me with wonder.*	“disquisitions”: Borrowed from French disquisition "disquisition", from Latin disquīsītiō "inquiry, investigation", from disquīrō "to investigate" (from dis- + quaerō "to look for, seek; to inquire, question") + -tiō. (Wiktionary, https://en.wiktionary.org/wiki/disquisition#Etymology)
decipher (verb)	convert code into ordinary language	*At first I had neglected them; but now that I was able to decipher the characters in which they were written, I began to study them with diligence.*	“decipher”: As decypher, but not retaining the y from the Old French - etyma of cipher (cyfre, cyffre); the i spelling tends to be preferred etymologically, being consistent with its cognates, the French déchiffrer and the Italian decifrare, and with their common ancestor, the Medieval Latin cifra, cifera, ciphra. By surface analysis, de- + cipher. (Wiktionary, https://en.wiktionary.org/wiki/decipher#Etymology)
persuades (verb)	win approval or support for	*I am blind, and cannot judge of your countenance, but there is something in your words, which persuades me that you are sincere.*	“persuades”: From Latin persuādeō "to persuade". Cognate to for, sweet. (Wiktionary, https://en.wiktionary.org/wiki/persuade#Etymology)
deprecate (verb)	express strong disapproval of; deplore	*I learned, from the views of social life which it developed, to admire their virtues, and to deprecate the vices of mankind.*	
antelope (noun)	a fast, graceful animal with horns, like a deer	*I could have torn him limb from limb, as the lion rends the antelope.*	
decreased (verb)	decrease in size, extent, or range	*Their happiness was not decreased by the absence of summer.*	“decreased”: From Middle English decresen, alteration of discresen, from Anglo-Norman -, Old French descreistre (French: décroître), from Latin decrescere. (Wiktionary, https://en.wiktionary.org/wiki/decrease#Etymology)

Discussion questions

1. Why does the creature compare himself to both Adam and Satan?
2. Where does allusion appear in this chapter, and what effect does it have? Point to one passage.
3. How does this chapter connect to the book's larger concern with the costs of unchecked ambition?

Classroom discussion questions (30, tiered)

Wait time after every question (3 s for DOK 1, 5 s for DOK 2, 8 to 10 s for DOK 3 and 4); think-pair-share on DOK 3 and 4; answer each response with a follow-up probe; close with student-generated questions. Focus sets by rigor level: Middle School: 1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 6, 11, 12, 13, 14, 21, 22; HS Freshman: 1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 12, 13, 14, 15, 22, 23, 24; HS Sophomore: 1, 2, 3, 4, 13, 14, 15, 16, 17, 23, 24, 25; HS Junior: 1, 2, 3, 14, 15, 16, 17, 18, 24, 25, 26, 27; HS Senior: 1, 2, 3, 15, 16, 17, 18, 25, 26, 27, 28, 29; AP: 1, 2, 16, 17, 18, 19, 20, 26, 27, 28, 29, 30; College Freshman: 1, 2, 17, 18, 19, 20, 21, 22, 27, 28, 29, 30; College Sophomore: 1, 2, 11, 18, 19, 20, 21, 22, 23, 28, 29, 30; College Junior: 1, 11, 12, 19, 20, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 29, 30; College Senior: 1, 11, 12, 13, 20, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 26, 30; Graduate / PhD: 1, 11, 12, 13, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 26, 27, 28

Literal / recall

1. Which book is NOT among those he finds? [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · 7.RC.1, 7.CC.1, 9-10.RC.1] Look for: Robinson Crusoe
2. What document does he discover in his clothing? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · 7.RC.1, 7.CC.1, 9-10.RC.1] Look for: Victor's laboratory journal
3. Which character in Milton does he feel most like? [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · 7.RC.1, 7.CC.1, 9-10.RC.1] Look for: Satan, the outcast
4. Why does he choose the blind father first? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · 7.RC.1, 7.CC.1, 9-10.RC.1] Look for: He cannot judge by appearance
5. What does Felix do when he finds the creature with his father? [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · 7.RC.1, 7.CC.1, 9-10.RC.1] Look for: Strikes him and drives him away
6. Retell the three most important events of “Chapter XV” in order, in one sentence each. [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · 7.RC.1, 7.CC.1, 9-10.RC.1] Look for: The creature finds Paradise Lost, Plutarch's Lives and The Sorrows of Young Werther, and reads Victor's laboratory journal, which describes his creation with disgust. He reveals himself to the blind old De Lacey, who is kind, but Felix, Agatha and Safie return, and Felix strikes him and drives him away.
7. Which characters appear or are mentioned in “Chapter XV”? Name two and one thing each says or does. [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · 7.RC.1, 7.CC.1, 9-10.RC.1] Look for: Names and actions taken from the chapter; check against the teacher summary.
8. Where and when does “Chapter XV” take place? Point to the line that tells you. [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · 7.RC.1, 7.CC.1, 9-10.RC.1] Look for: A place/time detail quoted from the chapter.
9. Reread: “I read of men concerned in public affairs, governing or massacring their species.” What does “massacring” mean here, and what is literally happening in this line? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · 7.RC.1, 7.CC.1, 9-10.RC.1] Look for: massacring: killing large numbers of people.
10. Reread: ““The old man paused, and then continued, ‘If you will unreservedly confide to me the particulars of your tale, I perhaps may be of use in undeceiving them.” What does “undeceiving” mean here, and what is literally happening in this line? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · 7.RC.1, 7.CC.1, 9-10.RC.1] Look for: undeceiving: showing someone the truth; freeing from a false belief.

Inferential / analytical

1. What does “Chapter XV” suggest about reading and identity? State the inference and the line that supports it. [DOK 2 · thinkPairShare · wait 5 s · 7.RC.2, 7.CC.2, 9-10.RC.2] Look for: He identifies with both Adam and Satan; the De Laceys' rejection is the turning point from benevolence to rage.

2. Find one example of allusion in this chapter. What does it reveal that a plain statement would not? [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · 7.RC.2, 7.CC.2, 9-10.RC.1] Look for: Look for references to other books, myths, history or religion.
3. How does the characterization in this chapter shape what we understand about reading and identity? [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · 7.RC.3, 7.CC.2, 9-10.RC.1] Look for: Look for what characters say, do and think, and how others react to them.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The creature's rejection by the De Laceys proves that appearance, not character, condemns him. Useful evidence: “Paradise Lost, a volume of Plutarch’s Lives, and the Sorrows of Werther” (Chapter XV, paragraph 3): His education; each book shapes him. On characterization: He identifies with both Adam and Satan, and reads Victor's journal about his own creation. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
4. In the passage that begins ““As I read, however, I applied much personally to my own feelings and condition.”, why might Shelley have chosen these particular words? Pick two and explain their connotations. [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · 7.RC.12, 7.CC.2, 9-10.RC.12] Look for: Diction analysis of two words in the anchor passage.
5. What causes the main turn in “Chapter XV”, and what effect is it likely to have on what follows? [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · 7.RC.3, 7.CC.2, 9-10.RC.1] Look for: The creature finds Paradise Lost, Plutarch's Lives and The Sorrows of Young Werther, and reads Victor's laboratory journal, which describes his creation with disgust. He reveals himself to the blind old De Lacey, who is kind, but Felix, Agatha and Safie return, and Felix strikes him and drives him…
6. How does “Chapter XV” build on “Chapter XIV”? Name one link of cause and effect. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · 7.RC.3, 7.CC.2, 9-10.RC.3] Look for: A causal or structural link between this and the previous chapter.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The creature's rejection by the De Laceys proves that appearance, not character, condemns him. Useful evidence: “Like Adam, I was apparently united by no link to any other being in existence” (Chapter XV, paragraph 7): Isolation through allusion. Theme link: rejection is based on sight; the blind man alone judges him by his words. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
7. What can we infer about a character's motives from what they say and do here, as opposed to what they claim? [DOK 3 · followUp · wait 8 s · 7.RC.3, 7.CC.2, 9-10.RC.1] Look for: An inference about motive supported by a quoted line.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The creature's rejection by the De Laceys proves that appearance, not character, condemns him. Useful evidence: “Hateful day when I received life” (Chapter XV, paragraph 8): The creature curses his own birth, echoing Job. On characterization: He identifies with both Adam and Satan, and reads Victor's journal about his own creation. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
8. The bell-ringer asked: “Why does the creature compare himself to both Adam and Satan?” Now that we have read closely, how would you revise your first answer, and which line changed your mind? [DOK 2 · thinkPairShare · wait 5 s · 7.RC.2, 7.CC.2, 9-10.RC.2] Look for: A revised answer anchored in the text.
9. Where does theme appear, and how does it connect this chapter to the larger concern with the costs of unchecked ambition? [DOK 3 · followUp · wait 8 s · 7.RC.2, 7.CC.2, 9-10.RC.2] Look for: Look for statements or moments that connect to the book's big ideas.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The creature's rejection by the De Laceys proves that appearance, not character, condemns him. Useful evidence: “Paradise Lost, a volume of Plutarch’s Lives, and the Sorrows of Werther” (Chapter XV, paragraph 3): His education; each book shapes him. Theme

link: rejection is based on sight; the blind man alone judges him by his words. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

10. Background: Each book shapes him: Werther teaches feeling, Plutarch virtue and heroism, Milton his place in creation. How does knowing this change the way you read one moment in the chapter? [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · 7.RC.3, 7.CC.2, 9-10.RC.1] Look for: A specific moment reread in light of the context.
    Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The creature's rejection by the De Laceys proves that appearance, not character, condemns him. Useful evidence: “Like Adam, I was apparently united by no link to any other being in existence” (Chapter XV, paragraph 7): Isolation through allusion. Theme link: rejection is based on sight; the blind man alone judges him by his words. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

Evaluative / synthesis / creative

1. A critic might argue: “He identifies with both Adam and Satan; the De Laceys' rejection is the turning point from benevolence to rage.” How far do you agree? Take a stand and defend it with two lines from the chapter. [DOK 3 · fourCorners · wait 8 s · 7.RC.2, 7.CC.3, 9-10.RC.2] Look for: A defended position with evidence and one counterpoint.
    Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The creature's rejection by the De Laceys proves that appearance, not character, condemns him. Useful evidence: “Hateful day when I received life” (Chapter XV, paragraph 8): The creature curses his own birth, echoing Job. Theme link: rejection is based on sight; the blind man alone judges him by his words. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
2. Which character in this chapter acts most wisely, and which least? Judge them by a standard you name. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · 7.RC.3, 7.CC.3, 9-10.RC.1] Look for: An evaluation using an explicit criterion and evidence.
    Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The creature's rejection by the De Laceys proves that appearance, not character, condemns him. Useful evidence: “Paradise Lost, a volume of Plutarch’s Lives, and the Sorrows of Werther” (Chapter XV, paragraph 3): His education; each book shapes him. On characterization: He identifies with both Adam and Satan, and reads Victor's journal about his own creation. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
3. Rewrite one moment of “Chapter XV” from the point of view of a different character. What does the new angle reveal or hide about reading and identity? [DOK 4 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · 7.RC.1, 7.CC.3, 9-10.RC.1] Look for: A creative product with a rationale tied to the text.
    Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The creature's rejection by the De Laceys proves that appearance, not character, condemns him. Useful evidence: “Like Adam, I was apparently united by no link to any other being in existence” (Chapter XV, paragraph 7): Isolation through allusion. Theme link: rejection is based on sight; the blind man alone judges him by his words. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
4. Write three questions of your own about “Chapter XV”: one recall, one “why/how”, and one “should/what if”. Trade with a partner and answer theirs. [DOK 3 · studentGenerated · wait 8 s · 7.RC.2, 7.CC.3, 9-10.RC.2] Look for: Student-generated questions at three levels.
    Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The creature's rejection by the De Laceys proves that appearance, not character, condemns him. Useful evidence: “Hateful day when I received life” (Chapter XV,

paragraph 8): The creature curses his own birth, echoing Job. Theme link: rejection is based on sight; the blind man alone judges him by his words. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

5. Connect this chapter to creation and responsibility: is the link strong or weak so far? What would Shelley need to show next to strengthen it? [DOK 4 · socraticCircle · wait 8 s · 7.RC.2, 7.CC.3, 9-10.RC.2] Look for: A judgment of thematic development across the work.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The creature's rejection by the De Laceys proves that appearance, not character, condemns him. Useful evidence: “Paradise Lost, a volume of Plutarch’s Lives, and the Sorrows of Werther” (Chapter XV, paragraph 3): His education; each book shapes him. Theme link: rejection is based on sight; the blind man alone judges him by his words. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

6. Is the allusion in this chapter effective, or does it feel heavy-handed? Evaluate it as a reader would in a review. [DOK 3 · fourCorners · wait 8 s · 7.RC.2, 7.CC.3, 9-10.RC.1] Look for: An evaluative judgment with criteria and evidence.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The creature's rejection by the De Laceys proves that appearance, not character, condemns him. Useful evidence: “Like Adam, I was apparently united by no link to any other being in existence” (Chapter XV, paragraph 7): Isolation through allusion. On allusion: The three books he finds (Paradise Lost, Plutarch's Lives, The Sorrows of Werter) give him models of a creator, of public virtue and of feeling. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

7. Compare how “Chapter XV” treats reading and identity with how another text, film or event you know treats a similar idea. What does Frankenstein see that the other misses? [DOK 4 · socraticCircle · wait 8 s · 7.RC.2, 7.CC.3, 9-10.RC.2] Look for: A cross-text synthesis.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The creature's rejection by the De Laceys proves that appearance, not character, condemns him. Useful evidence: “Hateful day when I received life” (Chapter XV, paragraph 8): The creature curses his own birth, echoing Job. Theme link: rejection is based on sight; the blind man alone judges him by his words. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

8. Predict what “Chapter XVI” will bring, using two clues from this chapter. After reading, evaluate your prediction. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · 7.RC.3, 7.CC.3, 9-10.RC.3] Look for: A prediction or judgment justified with textual clues.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The creature's rejection by the De Laceys proves that appearance, not character, condemns him. Useful evidence: “Paradise Lost, a volume of Plutarch’s Lives, and the Sorrows of Werther” (Chapter XV, paragraph 3): His education; each book shapes him. Theme link: rejection is based on sight; the blind man alone judges him by his words. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

9. Design a one-paragraph modern adaptation of this chapter (setting, characters, conflict). What must stay the same for it to still be about reading and identity? [DOK 4 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · 7.RC.2, 7.CC.3, 9-10.RC.2] Look for: A creative transfer that keeps the core idea.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The creature's rejection by the De Laceys proves that appearance, not character, condemns him. Useful evidence: “Like Adam, I was apparently united by no link to any other being in existence” (Chapter XV, paragraph 7): Isolation through allusion. Theme link:

rejection is based on sight; the blind man alone judges him by his words. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

10. What question would you most like to ask Mary Shelley about this chapter, and what answer do you think the text itself gives? [DOK 4 · studentGenerated · wait 8 s · 7.RC.2, 7.CC.3, 9-10.RC.2] Look for: A student-generated question answered from evidence.

    Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The creature's rejection by the De Laceys proves that appearance, not character, condemns him. Useful evidence: “Hateful day when I received life” (Chapter XV, paragraph 8): The creature curses his own birth, echoing Job. Theme link: rejection is based on sight; the blind man alone judges him by his words. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

Annotation focus

- **Allusion:** look for references to other books, myths, history or religion (anchor passage in the We do segment)
- Also notice **Characterization**: what characters say, do and think, and how others react to them
- Also notice **Theme**: statements or moments that connect to the book's big ideas

Chapter quiz: item bank (all eleven rigor versions)

1. [mc · recall · DOK 1] In the line “” ‘Heaven forbid! even if you were really criminal; for that can only drive you to desperation, and not instigate you to virtue.”, what does “instigate” most nearly mean?

   A. wet with drops, as of dew or tears

   B. cause to start burning

   C. to urge on; to provoke

   D. to rise and fall; to change often

   Key: C (to urge on; to provoke)

2. [fill · recall · DOK 1] Complete the quotation from Chapter XV, paragraph 3: “_____ Lost, a volume of Plutarch’s Lives, and the Sorrows of Werther”

   Key: Paradise

3. [mc · recall · DOK 1] Which character in Milton does he feel most like?

   A. Michael

   B. Eve

   C. Satan, the outcast

   D. Gabriel

   Key: C (Satan, the outcast)

4. [mc · recall · DOK 1] In the line “I sympathised with, and partly understood them, but I was unformed in mind; I was dependent on none, and related to none. ‘The path of my departure was free’; and there was none to lament my annihilation.”, what does “unformed” most nearly mean?

   A. a feeling of evil to come

   B. weakened

   C. not having form or shape

   D. focused; concentrated (British spelling)

Key: C (not having form or shape)

5. [mc · recall · DOK 1] What does Felix do when he finds the creature with his father?
   A. Strikes him and drives him away
   B. Calls for a doctor
   C. Shakes his hand
   D. Invites him to dinner

   Key: A (Strikes him and drives him away)

6. [mc · recall · DOK 1] Why does he choose the blind father first?
   A. He cannot judge by appearance
   B. He is the strongest
   C. He speaks German
   D. He has money

   Key: A (He cannot judge by appearance)

7. [fill · recall · DOK 1] Fill in the blank with the vocabulary word that fits: “At first I had neglected them; but now that I was able to _____ the characters in which they were written, I began to study them with diligence.” Word bank: undeceiving, massacring, decipher, instigate

   Key: decipher

8. [fill · recall · DOK 1] Complete the quotation from Chapter XV, paragraph 7: “Like Adam, I was _____ united by no link to any other being in existence”

   Key: apparently

9. [mc · recall · DOK 1] Which book is NOT among those he finds?
   A. The Sorrows of Young Werther
   B. Robinson Crusoe
   C. Paradise Lost
   D. Plutarch's Lives

   Key: B (Robinson Crusoe)

10. [mc · inference · DOK 2] What does this passage most clearly show? “Like Adam, I was apparently united by no link to any other being in existence” (Chapter XV, paragraph 7)
    A. "Satiate" (fully satisfy) and "ardent" reveal appetite-like ambition. Use for a claim about the dangers of curiosity.
    B. Isolation through allusion.
    C. Claims a relationship and a duty.
    D. Victor concludes guilt from appearance, as others will judge the creature.

    Key: B (Isolation through allusion.)

11. [mc · inference · DOK 2] What does this passage most clearly show? “Hateful day when I received life” (Chapter XV, paragraph 8)
    A. The creature curses his own birth, echoing Job.
    B. Echoes the "lifeless matter" of creation.
    C. Narrated with hindsight; sets a pattern of suffering.
    D. Milton allusion; the creature casts Victor as a God who failed.

Key: A (The creature curses his own birth, echoing Job.)

12. [mc · inference · DOK 2] Which choice best states a central concern of "Chapter XV"?

    A. Recovery and false peace

    B. First experiences of the senses

    C. Confrontation between creator and creation

    D. Reading and identity

    Key: D (Reading and identity)

13. [short · inference · DOK 2] What can you infer from this line? "Like Adam, I was apparently united by no link to any other being in existence" (Chapter XV, paragraph 7) Answer in two or three sentences with one detail.

    Sample answer: Isolation through allusion.

14. [mc · analysis · DOK 3] Which literary element does this describe in "Chapter XV"? He identifies with both Adam and Satan, and reads Victor's journal about his own creation.

    A. Diction / vocabulary

    B. Characterization

    C. Conflict

    D. Allusion

    Key: B (Characterization)

15. [short · analysis · DOK 3] Claim: The creature's rejection by the De Laceys proves that appearance, not character, condemns him. Explain how this evidence supports the claim: "Paradise Lost, a volume of Plutarch's Lives, and the Sorrows of Werther" (Chapter XV, paragraph 3).

    Sample answer: Old De Lacey, who is blind, responds kindly to his words, but the family sees him and attacks; the scene shows that only someone who cannot see him can judge him fairly.

16. [short · synthesis · DOK 4] Close reading: how do the diction and syntax of "Paradise Lost, a volume of Plutarch's Lives, and the Sorrows of Werther" (Chapter XV, paragraph 3) shape its meaning? Consider a second, competing reading.

    Sample answer: His education; each book shapes him.

17. [fill · recall · DOK 1] Complete the quotation from Chapter XV, paragraph 8: "Hateful day when I _____ life"

    Key: received

18. [mc · recall · DOK 1] In the line ""The old man paused, and then continued, 'If you will unreservedly confide to me the particulars of your tale, I perhaps may be of use in undeceiving them.", what does "undeceiving" most nearly mean?

    A. causing or marked by grief or anguish

    B. showing someone the truth; freeing from a false belief

    C. not having enough money to pay for necessities

    D. to come to rest, settle

    Key: B (showing someone the truth; freeing from a false belief)

19. [fill · recall · DOK 1] Fill in the blank with the vocabulary word that fits: "The _____ upon death and suicide were calculated to fill me with wonder." Word bank: disquisitions, instigate, massacring, undeceiving

    Key: disquisitions

20. [short · inference · DOK 2] What can you infer from this line? “Paradise Lost, a volume of Plutarch’s Lives, and the Sorrows of Werther” (Chapter XV, paragraph 3) Answer in two or three sentences with one detail.
    Sample answer: His education; each book shapes him.

21. [mc · inference · DOK 2] What does this passage most clearly show? “Paradise Lost, a volume of Plutarch’s Lives, and the Sorrows of Werther” (Chapter XV, paragraph 3)
    A. Biblical image of hell (Isaiah, Mark): remorse as eternal torment.
    B. Victor concludes guilt from appearance, as others will judge the creature.
    C. His education; each book shapes him.
    D. Ingratitude repays virtue; the word "treacherous" carries the creature's (and the narrative's) judgment.
    Key: C (His education; each book shapes him.)

22. [short · analysis · DOK 3] Analyze the word choice in “Hateful day when I received life” (Chapter XV, paragraph 8). Pick two words and explain what they suggest.
    Sample answer: The creature curses his own birth, echoing Job.

23. [short · synthesis · DOK 4] Synthesis: trace how nature and nurture develops from an earlier chapter to “Chapter XV”. Use one quotation from each.
    Sample answer: rejection is based on sight; the blind man alone judges him by his words.

24. [mc · recall · DOK 1] In the line “I read of men concerned in public affairs, governing or massacring their species.”, what does “massacring” most nearly mean?
    A. brought back to life or strength; revived
    B. killing large numbers of people
    C. to thicken or freeze (here, with horror)
    D. healthy; good for the body
    Key: B (killing large numbers of people)

25. [mc · analysis · DOK 3] Which literary element does this describe in “Chapter XV”? The three books he finds (Paradise Lost, Plutarch's Lives, The Sorrows of Werter) give him models of a creator, of public virtue and of feeling.
    A. Allusion
    B. Simile
    C. Tone / mood
    D. Structure
    Key: A (Allusion)

26. [short · synthesis · DOK 4] Close reading: how do the diction and syntax of “Like Adam, I was apparently united by no link to any other being in existence” (Chapter XV, paragraph 7) shape its meaning? Consider a second, competing reading.
    Sample answer: Isolation through allusion.

27. [short · synthesis · DOK 4] Evaluate this claim about the chapter: “The creature's rejection by the De Laceys proves that appearance, not character, condemns him.” Is it fully persuasive? Argue with evidence, including a passage that complicates it.
    Sample answer: Old De Lacey, who is blind, responds kindly to his words, but the family sees him and attacks; the scene shows that only someone who cannot see him can judge him fairly.

28. [mc · recall · DOK 1] What document does he discover in his clothing?

    A. A letter from Elizabeth

    B. Victor's laboratory journal

    C. A will

    D. A map

    Key: B (Victor's laboratory journal)

29. [fill · recall · DOK 1] Fill in the blank with the vocabulary word that fits: “I am blind, and cannot judge of your countenance, but there is something in your words, which _____ me that you are sincere.” Word bank: instigate, persuades, undeceiving, massacring

    Key: persuades

Rigor version	Items (in order)	Mix
Middle School	1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 6, 7, 8, 9, 10, 11, 12, 13, 14, 15, 16	recall 9, inference 4, analysis 2, synthesis 1
HS Freshman	3, 17, 9, 18, 7, 19, 2, 8, 13, 12, 20, 21, 22, 14, 15, 23	recall 8, inference 4, analysis 3, synthesis 1
HS Sophomore	19, 24, 5, 8, 1, 18, 21, 20, 10, 12, 13, 25, 14, 22, 16, 23	recall 6, inference 5, analysis 3, synthesis 2
HS Junior	19, 7, 4, 18, 24, 20, 11, 21, 10, 12, 15, 14, 25, 22, 23, 16	recall 5, inference 5, analysis 4, synthesis 2
HS Senior	19, 7, 6, 1, 12, 13, 21, 11, 10, 15, 22, 25, 14, 26, 27, 23	recall 4, inference 5, analysis 4, synthesis 3
AP	19, 28, 8, 11, 20, 10, 13, 12, 22, 25, 14, 15, 27, 16, 26, 23	recall 3, inference 5, analysis 4, synthesis 4
College Freshman	8, 29, 9, 21, 20, 12, 13, 10, 25, 15, 22, 14, 23, 27, 26, 16	recall 3, inference 5, analysis 4, synthesis 4
College Sophomore	17, 19, 12, 10, 20, 21, 11, 13, 14, 25, 22, 15, 16, 26, 23, 27	recall 2, inference 6, analysis 4, synthesis 4
College Junior	2, 19, 13, 21, 12, 20, 11, 10, 25, 22, 15, 14, 27, 26, 16, 23	recall 2, inference 6, analysis 4, synthesis 4
College Senior	19, 7, 21, 13, 11, 20, 10, 12, 15, 22, 25, 14, 26, 16, 27, 23	recall 2, inference 6, analysis 4, synthesis 4
Graduate / PhD	19, 7, 20, 10, 13, 12, 21, 11, 15, 22, 25, 14, 23, 26, 16, 27	recall 2, inference 6, analysis 4, synthesis 4

Writing prompts (eleven rigor levels)

Middle School (250 words; Indiana 2023: 7.RC.2, 7.W.1): Supported track (work from the passage your teacher selects). In “Chapter XV,” how does Shelley show reading and identity? Write a paragraph that states your claim, quotes two details from the passage, and explains how each detail supports your idea. Use the allusion you noticed as one piece of evidence.

HS Freshman (350 words; Indiana 2023: 9-10.RC.1, 9-10.W.1): In Chapter XV, how does Shelley develop the idea of reading and identity? State a clear claim, support it with two or three quotations, and explain how the allusion in the chapter helps build that idea.

HS Sophomore (450 words; Indiana 2023: 9-10.RC.1, 9-10.W.1): Analyze how Chapter XV develops the idea of reading and identity. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of allusion and characterization shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.

HS Junior (550 words; Indiana 2023: 11-12.RC.3, 11-12.RC.1, 11-12.W.1): Analyze how the structure of Chapter XV (where it begins, turns and ends) and its allusion shape the reader's understanding of reading and identity. Identify one place where the text leaves matters uncertain and explain how that uncertainty adds to its meaning.

HS Senior (600 words; Indiana 2023: 11-12.RC.4, 11-12.W.1): Two readers disagree about what Chapter XV suggests about reading and identity. Lay out two plausible interpretations, weigh the evidence for each (including the chapter's allusion and characterization), and argue for the stronger one in a sustained, well-organized essay.

AP (650 words; Indiana 2023: 11-12.RC.4, 11-12.W.1): Write a literary argument in which you analyze how Mary Shelley uses allusion in Chapter XV to complicate the reader's understanding of reading and identity. Develop a defensible thesis, select evidence purposefully, and explain how specific choices of diction and syntax create meaning.

College Freshman (1000 words; Indiana 2023: see unit standards): Situate Chapter XV within its historical and literary context and argue how the chapter's treatment of reading and identity responds to that context. Engage with at least one secondary perspective (a critic, historian or the author's own statements), integrate quotations smoothly, and cite in MLA style.

College Sophomore (1250 words; Indiana 2023: see unit standards): Read Chapter XV alongside the conventions of its genre and period. Argue how the chapter's handling of reading and identity follows or bends those conventions, using the allusion as evidence, and test your reading against one published critic. Document two secondary sources in MLA.

College Junior (1500 words; Indiana 2023: see unit standards): Apply a named critical approach (for example formalist, historicist, feminist, psychoanalytic or ecocritical) to Chapter XV and its treatment of reading and identity. State your method, show what it reveals in the chapter's allusion and characterization, and identify where the text resists it.

College Senior (2000 words; Indiana 2023: see unit standards): Develop a research argument that reads Chapter XV as evidence for a larger claim about reading and identity in Frankenstein. Connect close reading of the chapter to the whole novel, engage at least four scholarly sources, and state precisely where your reading departs from theirs (Chicago style).

Graduate / PhD (2500 words; Indiana 2023: see unit standards): Develop an original argument that reads Chapter XV as a hinge in the novel's larger treatment of reading and identity. Position your reading within a

named critical conversation (for example formalist, historicist, psychoanalytic, feminist or postcolonial approaches), account for the textual history where relevant, and articulate the stakes of your intervention for scholarship on Frankenstein.

SAT-style questions

1. *" 'Heaven forbid! even if you were really criminal; for that can only drive you to desperation, and not instigate you to virtue.*

   As used in the text, what does the word "instigate" most nearly mean?

   A. to urge on; to provoke

   B. decrease in size, extent, or range

   C. express strong disapproval of; deplore

   D. a fast, graceful animal with horns, like a deer

2. *"As I read, however, I applied much personally to my own feelings and condition. I found myself similar, yet at the same time strangely unlike to the beings concerning whom I read, and to whose conversation I was a listener. I sympathised with, and partly understood them, but I was unformed in mind; I was dependent on none, and related to none. 'The path of my departure was free'; and there was none to lament my annihilation. My person was hideous, and my stature gigantic? What did this mean? Who was I? What was I? Whence did I come? What was my destination? These questions continually recurred, but I was unable to solve them.*

   Which choice best states a central concern of "Chapter XV"?

   A. First experiences of the senses

   B. Rejection and the turn to revenge

   C. Reading and identity

   D. Ambition and the hunger for discovery

SAT key: 1. A (to urge on; to provoke); 2. C (Reading and identity)

Lesson 23: Chapter XVI

Focus: rejection and the turn to revenge

Objective: Students will analyze how irony develops in “Chapter XVI” by writing a claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph that cites at least 2 quotations from the section, and will score at least 80% on the section quiz.

Standards: CCSS RL.9-10.6, W.9-10.1, L.9-10.4 · IN 9-10.RC.1, 9-10.W.1, 9-10.RC.9, 9-10.RC.11

Critical voice: “Treat a person ill, and he will become wicked. Requite affection with scorn;—let one being be selected, for whatever cause, as the refuse of his kind—divide him, a social being, from society, and you impose upon him the irresistible obligations—malevolence and selfishness.” (Percy Bysshe Shelley, poet, *"On 'Frankenstein'" (written c.1817; pub. The Athenaeum, 10 Nov 1832), in The Prose Works of Percy Bysshe Shelley (1880), paragraph 2*; public domain). Claim-evidence-reasoning: Percy Shelley calls this "the direct moral of the book." Students test it against the creature's burning of the cottage in Chapter XVI and decide whether it excuses him. *Objective:* Determine the novel's central theme as the creature turns to revenge. *Standards:* RL.11-12.2, 11-12.RC.1

Content note (murder of a child): The creature recounts strangling William. Keep discussion on responsibility and rejection, not the act itself.
Student preview: The creature describes killing a child.
Suggested language: “What does the creature say led him to this point? Do you accept his account?”

Teacher only · spoilers

The De Laceys abandon the cottage. Enraged, the creature burns it and heads for Geneva, guided by Victor's journal. He saves a drowning girl but is shot. Near Geneva he meets William, learns he is a Frankenstein, kills him, and plants the portrait on the sleeping Justine.

Background: This chapter retells Chapter VII's events from the other side—a key structural mirror.

Significance: His turn to violence complicates sympathy: rejection explains but does not excuse his crimes.

Lesson plan and lecture script (90 minutes)

0–8 min · Bell-ringer · You do (8 min)
Students write to the bell-ringer, then pair-share.
Does the creature's suffering excuse what he does to William and Justine? Write for five minutes. Starters: I think... because... / This connects to nature and nurture because.... Content note before we start: The creature describes killing a child.
Prompt: Does the creature's suffering excuse what he does to William and Justine?
Sentence starters: I think… because… · This connects to nature and nurture because…
Strong response: A strong response takes a position and anticipates this: repeated cruelty turns his benevolence into vengeance.

8–18 min · Vocabulary with etymology notes · I do (10 min)
Five key words in context, with verified word histories.
Today's words: imprecate — to call down (curses) on; bedewed — wet with drops, as of dew or tears; underwood — small trees and bushes growing under taller trees; sanguinary — accompanied by bloodshed; extracting — remove, usually with some force or effort; also used in an abstract sense. “imprecate”: Latin imprecātus, perfect active participle of imprecor "to invoke (good or evil) upon, pray to, call upon" (see -ate), from in- "upon" + precor "to pray". “bedewed”: From Middle English bidewen, bideawen; equivalent to be + dew. Cognate with Dutch bedauwen "to bedew", German betauen "to bedew". “sanguinary”: From Middle English sanguinarie, from Latin sanguinārius. “extracting”: Borrowed from Latin extractum, neuter perfect passive participle of extrahō, from ex- + trahō.
Words: imprecate: to call down (curses) on · bedewed: wet with drops, as of dew or tears · underwood: small trees and bushes growing under taller trees · sanguinary: accompanied by bloodshed · extracting: remove, usually with some force or effort; also used in an abstract sense

18–28 min · Background and context · I do (10 min)
Mini-lecture (read or adapt the script).
This chapter retells Chapter VII's events from the other side—a key structural mirror. His turn to violence complicates sympathy: rejection explains but does not excuse his crimes. Characterization: The creature's turn: he burns the cottage, swears war on humanity, and kills William when the boy names Frankenstein. Allusion: "I, like the arch-fiend, bore a hell within me": Satan again. Irony: He saves a drowning girl and is shot for it. Watch for light and fire: Light stands for knowledge and fire for its double edge: warmth and burning. Victor seeks the "light" of discovery; the creature discovers fire and is burned by it. In this chapter: “The sun rose; I heard the voices of men, and knew that it” (Chapter XVI, paragraph 4).

28–40 min · I do: modeled close reading · I do (12 min)
Model the close reading of the anchor quotation using the written think-aloud below.
I read the line once for meaning and once for craft. “Cursed, cursed creator! Why did I live” (Chapter XVI, paragraph 1). Anguish and accusation. That is characterization at work: The creature's turn: he burns the cottage, swears war on humanity, and kills William when the boy names Frankenstein.

> *Cursed, cursed creator! Why did I live* *(Chapter XVI, paragraph 1)*

Think-aloud: I read the line once for meaning and once for craft. “Cursed, cursed creator! Why did I live” (Chapter XVI, paragraph 1). Anguish and accusation. That is characterization at work: The creature's turn: he burns the cottage, swears war on humanity, and kills William when the boy names Frankenstein.

40–55 min · We do: guided annotation · We do (15 min)
Guided analysis of a second quotation; expected answers given.
Ask: What words in this line stand out, and what do they suggest? Expected: The arch-fiend is Satan; the hell is within. This shows his suffering is now part of him, linking to nurture: what was done to him becomes who he is. Ask: How does this line connect to nature and nurture? Expected: Repeated cruelty turns his benevolence into vengeance. (Milton's Satan: the hell is internal.)

> *I, like the archfiend, bore a hell within me (Chapter XVI, paragraph 2)*

Ask: What words in this line stand out, and what do they suggest?
Expected answer: The arch-fiend is Satan; the hell is within. This shows his suffering is now part of him, linking to nurture: what was done to him becomes who he is.
Ask: How does this line connect to nature and nurture?
Expected answer: Repeated cruelty turns his benevolence into vengeance. (Milton's Satan: the hell is internal.)

55–70 min · You do: independent annotation · You do (15 min)
Independent annotation and a claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph (exemplar given).
Annotate the chapter for characterization, allusion (three marks with a margin note each), then write one claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph: what does this chapter suggest about rejection and the turn to revenge? Then start your writing prompt at your assigned level (HS Sophomore: Analyze how Chapter XVI develops the idea of rejection and the turn to revenge. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of irony and characterization shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.) Exemplar: The creature's violence is a response to repeated cruelty, though it is still his choice. When the text says “This was then the reward of my benevolence” (Chapter XVI, paragraph 20), it shows this directly. After he saves a girl and is shot, he asks bitterly whether "this was then the reward of my benevolence," and soon he bears "a hell within me"; the novel traces how injustice breeds hatred while still making him kill William by his own will.
Task: Annotate the chapter for characterization, allusion (three marks with a margin note each), then write one claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph: what does this chapter suggest about rejection and the turn to revenge? Then start your writing prompt at your assigned level (HS Sophomore: Analyze how Chapter XVI develops the idea of rejection and the turn to revenge. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of irony and characterization shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.)
Exemplar: The creature's violence is a response to repeated cruelty, though it is still his choice. When the text says “This was then the reward of my benevolence” (Chapter XVI, paragraph 20), it shows this directly. After he saves a girl and is shot, he asks bitterly whether "this was then the reward of my benevolence," and soon he bears "a hell within me"; the novel traces how injustice breeds hatred while still making him kill William by his own will.

70–80 min · Discussion · We do (10 min)
Structured discussion from the 30 tiered questions, with facilitation notes.
Anchor question: Does the creature's suffering excuse what he does to William and Justine? Push past "it's not his fault": does the novel excuse William's murder? How can we hold both sympathy and judgment?
Anchor question: Does the creature's suffering excuse what he does to William and Justine?
Facilitation: Push past "it's not his fault": does the novel excuse William's murder? How can we hold both sympathy and judgment?

80–87 min · Exit ticket / chapter quiz · You do (7 min)
Chapter quiz in the app and an exit ticket (answer given).
Chapter quiz in the app, then: In one sentence, what does this chapter suggest about rejection and the turn to revenge? Support it with one short quotation. Model answer: The creature's violence is a response to repeated cruelty, though it is still his choice. ("This was then the reward of my benevolence", Chapter XVI, paragraph 20). Accept any defensible claim backed by a quotation from the chapter; the answer key for the quiz is in the Quiz section.
Exit ticket: In one sentence, what does this chapter suggest about rejection and the turn to revenge? Support it with one short quotation.
Answer: Model answer: The creature's violence is a response to repeated cruelty, though it is still his choice. ("This was then the reward of my benevolence", Chapter XVI, paragraph 20). Accept any defensible claim backed by a quotation from the chapter; the answer key for the quiz is in the Quiz section.

87–90 min · Closure · I do (3 min)
Summarize the lesson and preview the next reading.
Today we saw how characterization shapes rejection and the turn to revenge. Key takeaway: repeated cruelty turns his benevolence into vengeance.

Total: 90 minutes.

Teacher analysis (spoilers)

Literary elements

- **Characterization:** The creature's turn: he burns the cottage, swears war on humanity, and kills William when the boy names Frankenstein.
- **Allusion:** "I, like the arch-fiend, bore a hell within me": Satan again.
- **Irony:** He saves a drowning girl and is shot for it.

Themes and how they develop

- **nature and nurture:** repeated cruelty turns his benevolence into vengeance.

Symbols and motifs

- **light and fire:** Light stands for knowledge and fire for its double edge: warmth and burning. Victor seeks the "light" of discovery; the creature discovers fire and is burned by it. In this chapter: "The sun rose; I heard the voices of men, and knew that it" (Chapter XVI, paragraph 4).

- **sublime nature:** Mountains, glaciers, storms and lakes reflect and sometimes soothe the characters' feelings; the sublime is both comfort and terror. In this chapter: “or the prospect of the sun setting behind the stupendous mountains of Jura” (Chapter XVI, paragraph 24).

Key quotations (checked against the reading text)

- “Cursed, cursed creator! Why did I live” (Chapter XVI, paragraph 1) Anguish and accusation.
- “I, like the archfiend, bore a hell within me” (Chapter XVI, paragraph 2) Milton's Satan: the hell is internal.
- “This was then the reward of my benevolence” (Chapter XVI, paragraph 20) Shot after a rescue; bitter irony.

Model claim-evidence-reasoning

Claim: The creature's violence is a response to repeated cruelty, though it is still his choice.
Evidence: “This was then the reward of my benevolence” (Chapter XVI, paragraph 20)
Reasoning: After he saves a girl and is shot, he asks bitterly whether "this was then the reward of my benevolence," and soon he bears "a hell within me"; the novel traces how injustice breeds hatred while still making him kill William by his own will.

Vocabulary with etymology notes

Word	Definition (in this sentence)	In context	Word history
imprecate (verb)	to call down (curses) on	*Oh, earth! how often did I imprecate curses on the cause of my being!*	“imprecate”: Latin imprecātus, perfect active participle of imprecor "to invoke (good or evil) upon, pray to, call upon" (see -ate), from in- "upon" + precor "to pray". (Wiktionary, https://en.wiktionary.org/wiki/imprecate#Etymology)
bedewed (verb)	wet with drops, as of dew or tears	*Soft tears again bedewed my cheeks, and I even raised my humid eyes with thankfulness towards the blessed sun which bestowed such joy upon me.*	“bedewed”: From Middle English bidewen, bideawen; equivalent to be + dew. Cognate with Dutch bedauwen "to bedew", German betauen "to bedew". (Wiktionary, https://en.wiktionary.org/wiki/bedew#Etymology)
underwood (noun)	small trees and bushes growing under taller trees	*Accordingly I hid myself in some thick underwood, determining to devote the ensuing hours to reflection on my situation.*	
sanguinary (adjective)	accompanied by bloodshed	*Thanks to the lessons of Felix and the sanguinary laws of man, I had learned now to work mischief.*	“sanguinary”: From Middle English sanguinarie, from Latin sanguinārius. (Wiktionary, https://en.wiktionary.org/wiki/sanguinary#Etymology)
extracting (verb)	remove, usually with some force or effort;	*The ball had entered my shoulder, and I knew not*	“extracting”: Borrowed from Latin extractum, neuter perfect passive participle

	also used in an abstract sense	*whether it had remained there or passed through; at any rate I had no means of extracting it.*	of extrahō, from ex- + trahō. (Wiktionary, https://en.wiktionary.org/wiki/extract#Etymology)
epithets (noun)	a defamatory or abusive word or phrase	*"The child still struggled, and loaded me with epithets which carried despair to my heart; I grasped his throat to silence him, and in a moment he lay dead at my feet.*	
obstructed (verb)	hinder or prevent the progress or accomplishment of	*I was like a wild beast that had broken the toils; destroying the objects that obstructed me, and ranging through the wood with a stag-like swiftness.*	"obstructed": From Latin - past participle stem obstruct- "blocked up", from verb obstruere, from ob "against" + struere "pile up, build". (Wiktionary, https://en.wiktionary.org/wiki/obstruct#Etymology)
apprehending (verb)	get the meaning of something	*I trembled violently, apprehending some dreadful misfortune.*	
enkindled (verb)	cause to start burning	*The nearer I approached to your habitation, the more deeply did I feel the spirit of revenge enkindled in my heart.*	
imparting (verb)	transmit (knowledge or skills)	*Here, I thought, is one of those whose joy-imparting smiles are bestowed on all but me.*	"imparting": From Middle English imparten, borrowed from Middle French impartir, empartir, from Late Latin impartiō, impertiō, from im- "in" + Latin partiō "divide". (Wiktionary, https://en.wiktionary.org/wiki/impart#Etymology)

Discussion questions

1. Does the creature's suffering excuse what he does to William and Justine?
2. Where does irony appear in this chapter, and what effect does it have? Point to one passage.
3. How does this chapter connect to the book's larger concern with creation and responsibility?

Classroom discussion questions (30, tiered)

Wait time after every question (3 s for DOK 1, 5 s for DOK 2, 8 to 10 s for DOK 3 and 4); think-pair-share on DOK 3 and 4; answer each response with a follow-up probe; close with student-generated questions. Focus sets by rigor level: Middle School: 1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 6, 11, 12, 13, 14, 21, 22; HS Freshman: 1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 12, 13, 14, 15, 22, 23, 24; HS Sophomore: 1, 2, 3, 4, 13, 14, 15, 16, 17, 23, 24, 25; HS Junior: 1, 2, 3, 14, 15, 16, 17, 18, 24, 25, 26, 27; HS Senior: 1, 2, 3, 15, 16, 17, 18, 25, 26, 27, 28, 29; AP: 1, 2, 16, 17, 18, 19, 20, 26, 27, 28, 29, 30; College Freshman: 1, 2, 17, 18, 19, 20, 21, 22, 27, 28, 29, 30; College Sophomore: 1, 2, 11, 18, 19, 20, 21, 22,

23, 28, 29, 30; College Junior: 1, 11, 12, 19, 20, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 29, 30; College Senior: 1, 11, 12, 13, 20, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 26, 30; Graduate / PhD: 1, 11, 12, 13, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 26, 27, 28

Literal / recall

1. Where does the creature travel after the De Laceys leave? [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · 7.RC.1, 7.CC.1, 9-10.RC.1] Look for: Toward Geneva
2. What does the family do after the encounter? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · 7.RC.1, 7.CC.1, 9-10.RC.1] Look for: Abandon the cottage
3. What does the creature do to the cottage? [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · 7.RC.1, 7.CC.1, 9-10.RC.1] Look for: Burns it
4. What happens after he saves a drowning girl? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · 7.RC.1, 7.CC.1, 9-10.RC.1] Look for: He is shot
5. Why does he kill William? [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · 7.RC.1, 7.CC.1, 9-10.RC.1] Look for: He learns the boy is a Frankenstein
6. Retell the three most important events of "Chapter XVI" in order, in one sentence each. [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · 7.RC.1, 7.CC.1, 9-10.RC.1] Look for: The De Laceys abandon the cottage. Enraged, the creature burns it and heads for Geneva, guided by Victor's journal. He saves a drowning girl but is shot. Near Geneva he meets William, learns he is a Frankenstein, kills him, and plants the portrait on the sleeping Justine.
7. Which characters appear or are mentioned in "Chapter XVI"? Name two and one thing each says or does. [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · 7.RC.1, 7.CC.1, 9-10.RC.1] Look for: Names and actions taken from the chapter; check against the teacher summary.
8. Where and when does "Chapter XVI" take place? Point to the line that tells you. [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · 7.RC.1, 7.CC.1, 9-10.RC.1] Look for: A place/time detail quoted from the chapter.
9. Reread: "Oh, earth! how often did I imprecate curses on the cause of my being!" What does "imprecate" mean here, and what is literally happening in this line? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · 7.RC.1, 7.CC.1, 9-10.RC.1] Look for: imprecate: to call down (curses) on.
10. Reread: "Soft tears again bedewed my cheeks, and I even raised my humid eyes with thankfulness towards the blessed sun which bestowed such joy upon me." What does "bedewed" mean here, and what is literally happening in this line? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · 7.RC.1, 7.CC.1, 9-10.RC.1] Look for: bedewed: wet with drops, as of dew or tears.

Inferential / analytical

1. What does "Chapter XVI" suggest about rejection and the turn to revenge? State the inference and the line that supports it. [DOK 2 · thinkPairShare · wait 5 s · 7.RC.2, 7.CC.2, 9-10.RC.2] Look for: His turn to violence complicates sympathy: rejection explains but does not excuse his crimes.
2. Find one example of irony in this chapter. What does it reveal that a plain statement would not? [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · 7.RC.1, 7.CC.2, 9-10.RC.1] Look for: Look for gaps between what characters expect or say and what is true.
3. How does the characterization in this chapter shape what we understand about rejection and the turn to revenge? [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · 7.RC.3, 7.CC.2, 9-10.RC.1] Look for: Look for what characters say, do and think, and how others react to them.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The creature's violence is a response to repeated cruelty,

though it is still his choice. Useful evidence: “Cursed, cursed creator! Why did I live” (Chapter XVI, paragraph 1): Anguish and accusation. On characterization: The creature's turn: he burns the cottage, swears war on humanity, and kills William when the boy names Frankenstein. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

4. In the passage that begins ““When night came, I quitted my retreat, and wandered in the wood; and now, no longer restrained by the fear of discovery, I gave vent to my anguish in fearful howlings.”, why might Shelley have chosen these particular words? Pick two and explain their connotations. [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · 7.RC.12, 7.CC.2, 9-10.RC.12] Look for: Diction analysis of two words in the anchor passage.
5. What causes the main turn in “Chapter XVI”, and what effect is it likely to have on what follows? [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · 7.RC.3, 7.CC.2, 9-10.RC.1] Look for: The De Laceys abandon the cottage. Enraged, the creature burns it and heads for Geneva, guided by Victor's journal. He saves a drowning girl but is shot. Near Geneva he meets William, learns he is a Frankenstein, kills him, and plants the portrait on the sleeping Justine.
6. How does “Chapter XVI” build on “Chapter XV”? Name one link of cause and effect. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · 7.RC.3, 7.CC.2, 9-10.RC.3] Look for: A causal or structural link between this and the previous chapter.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The creature's violence is a response to repeated cruelty, though it is still his choice. Useful evidence: “I, like the archfiend, bore a hell within me” (Chapter XVI, paragraph 2): Milton's Satan: the hell is internal. Theme link: repeated cruelty turns his benevolence into vengeance. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
7. What can we infer about a character's motives from what they say and do here, as opposed to what they claim? [DOK 3 · followUp · wait 8 s · 7.RC.3, 7.CC.2, 9-10.RC.1] Look for: An inference about motive supported by a quoted line.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The creature's violence is a response to repeated cruelty, though it is still his choice. Useful evidence: “This was then the reward of my benevolence” (Chapter XVI, paragraph 20): Shot after a rescue; bitter irony. On characterization: The creature's turn: he burns the cottage, swears war on humanity, and kills William when the boy names Frankenstein. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
8. The bell-ringer asked: “Does the creature's suffering excuse what he does to William and Justine?” Now that we have read closely, how would you revise your first answer, and which line changed your mind? [DOK 2 · thinkPairShare · wait 5 s · 7.RC.2, 7.CC.2, 9-10.RC.2] Look for: A revised answer anchored in the text.
9. Where does foreshadowing appear, and how does it connect this chapter to the larger concern with creation and responsibility? [DOK 3 · followUp · wait 8 s · 7.RC.3, 7.CC.2, 9-10.RC.3] Look for: Look for hints, warnings or images that point to later events.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The creature's violence is a response to repeated cruelty, though it is still his choice. Useful evidence: “Cursed, cursed creator! Why did I live” (Chapter XVI, paragraph 1): Anguish and accusation. Theme link: repeated cruelty turns his benevolence into vengeance. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
10. Background: This chapter retells Chapter VII's events from the other side—a key structural mirror. How does knowing this change the way you read one moment in the chapter? [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · 7.RC.3, 7.CC.2, 9-10.RC.1] Look for: A specific moment reread in light of the context.
    Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The creature's violence is a response to repeated cruelty,

though it is still his choice. Useful evidence: “I, like the archfiend, bore a hell within me” (Chapter XVI, paragraph 2): Milton's Satan: the hell is internal. Theme link: repeated cruelty turns his benevolence into vengeance. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

Evaluative / synthesis / creative

1. A critic might argue: “His turn to violence complicates sympathy: rejection explains but does not excuse his crimes.” How far do you agree? Take a stand and defend it with two lines from the chapter. [DOK 3 · fourCorners · wait 8 s · 7.RC.2, 7.CC.3, 9-10.RC.2] Look for: A defended position with evidence and one counterpoint.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The creature's violence is a response to repeated cruelty, though it is still his choice. Useful evidence: “This was then the reward of my benevolence” (Chapter XVI, paragraph 20): Shot after a rescue; bitter irony. Theme link: repeated cruelty turns his benevolence into vengeance. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
2. Which character in this chapter acts most wisely, and which least? Judge them by a standard you name. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · 7.RC.3, 7.CC.3, 9-10.RC.1] Look for: An evaluation using an explicit criterion and evidence.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The creature's violence is a response to repeated cruelty, though it is still his choice. Useful evidence: “Cursed, cursed creator! Why did I live” (Chapter XVI, paragraph 1): Anguish and accusation. On characterization: The creature's turn: he burns the cottage, swears war on humanity, and kills William when the boy names Frankenstein. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
3. Rewrite one moment of “Chapter XVI” from the point of view of a different character. What does the new angle reveal or hide about rejection and the turn to revenge? [DOK 4 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · 7.RC.1, 7.CC.3, 9-10.RC.1] Look for: A creative product with a rationale tied to the text.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The creature's violence is a response to repeated cruelty, though it is still his choice. Useful evidence: “I, like the archfiend, bore a hell within me” (Chapter XVI, paragraph 2): Milton's Satan: the hell is internal. Theme link: repeated cruelty turns his benevolence into vengeance. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
4. Write three questions of your own about “Chapter XVI”: one recall, one “why/how”, and one “should/what if”. Trade with a partner and answer theirs. [DOK 3 · studentGenerated · wait 8 s · 7.RC.2, 7.CC.3, 9-10.RC.2] Look for: Student-generated questions at three levels.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The creature's violence is a response to repeated cruelty, though it is still his choice. Useful evidence: “This was then the reward of my benevolence” (Chapter XVI, paragraph 20): Shot after a rescue; bitter irony. Theme link: repeated cruelty turns his benevolence into vengeance. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
5. Connect this chapter to isolation and the need for companionship: is the link strong or weak so far? What would Shelley need to show next to strengthen it? [DOK 4 · socraticCircle · wait 8 s · 7.RC.2, 7.CC.3, 9-10.RC.2] Look for: A judgment of thematic development across the work.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The creature's violence is a response to repeated cruelty, though it is still his choice. Useful evidence: “Cursed, cursed creator! Why did I live” (Chapter XVI,

paragraph 1): Anguish and accusation. Theme link: repeated cruelty turns his benevolence into vengeance. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

6. Is the irony in this chapter effective, or does it feel heavy-handed? Evaluate it as a reader would in a review. [DOK 3 · fourCorners · wait 8 s · 7.RC.1, 7.CC.3, 9-10.RC.1] Look for: An evaluative judgment with criteria and evidence.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The creature's violence is a response to repeated cruelty, though it is still his choice. Useful evidence: “I, like the archfiend, bore a hell within me” (Chapter XVI, paragraph 2): Milton's Satan: the hell is internal. On irony: He saves a drowning girl and is shot for it. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
7. Compare how “Chapter XVI” treats rejection and the turn to revenge with how another text, film or event you know treats a similar idea. What does Frankenstein see that the other misses? [DOK 4 · socraticCircle · wait 8 s · 7.RC.2, 7.CC.3, 9-10.RC.2] Look for: A cross-text synthesis.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The creature's violence is a response to repeated cruelty, though it is still his choice. Useful evidence: “This was then the reward of my benevolence” (Chapter XVI, paragraph 20): Shot after a rescue; bitter irony. Theme link: repeated cruelty turns his benevolence into vengeance. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
8. Predict what “Chapter XVII” will bring, using two clues from this chapter. After reading, evaluate your prediction. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · 7.RC.3, 7.CC.3, 9-10.RC.3] Look for: A prediction or judgment justified with textual clues.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The creature's violence is a response to repeated cruelty, though it is still his choice. Useful evidence: “Cursed, cursed creator! Why did I live” (Chapter XVI, paragraph 1): Anguish and accusation. Theme link: repeated cruelty turns his benevolence into vengeance. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
9. Design a one-paragraph modern adaptation of this chapter (setting, characters, conflict). What must stay the same for it to still be about rejection and the turn to revenge? [DOK 4 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · 7.RC.2, 7.CC.3, 9-10.RC.2] Look for: A creative transfer that keeps the core idea.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The creature's violence is a response to repeated cruelty, though it is still his choice. Useful evidence: “I, like the archfiend, bore a hell within me” (Chapter XVI, paragraph 2): Milton's Satan: the hell is internal. Theme link: repeated cruelty turns his benevolence into vengeance. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
10. What question would you most like to ask Mary Shelley about this chapter, and what answer do you think the text itself gives? [DOK 4 · studentGenerated · wait 8 s · 7.RC.2, 7.CC.3, 9-10.RC.2] Look for: A student-generated question answered from evidence.
    Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The creature's violence is a response to repeated cruelty, though it is still his choice. Useful evidence: “This was then the reward of my benevolence” (Chapter XVI, paragraph 20): Shot after a rescue; bitter irony. Theme link: repeated cruelty turns his benevolence into vengeance. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

Annotation focus

- **Irony:** look for gaps between what characters expect or say and what is true (anchor passage in the We do segment)
- Also notice **Characterization**: what characters say, do and think, and how others react to them
- Also notice **Foreshadowing**: hints, warnings or images that point to later events

Chapter quiz: item bank (all eleven rigor versions)

1. [mc · recall · DOK 1] Where does the creature travel after the De Laceys leave?

   A. To London

   B. To Ingolstadt

   C. To the North Pole

   D. Toward Geneva

   Key: D (Toward Geneva)

2. [fill · recall · DOK 1] Fill in the blank with the vocabulary word that fits: ""The child still struggled, and loaded me with _____ which carried despair to my heart; I grasped his throat to silence him, and in a moment he lay dead at my feet." Word bank: imprecate, underwood, bedewed, epithets

   Key: epithets

3. [mc · recall · DOK 1] In the line "Thanks to the lessons of Felix and the sanguinary laws of man, I had learned now to work mischief.", what does "sanguinary" most nearly mean?

   A. increase

   B. lingered; hung about

   C. a companion at play

   D. accompanied by bloodshed

   Key: D (accompanied by bloodshed)

4. [mc · recall · DOK 1] Why does he kill William?

   A. For food

   B. He learns the boy is a Frankenstein

   C. William attacked him

   D. By accident

   Key: B (He learns the boy is a Frankenstein)

5. [fill · recall · DOK 1] Complete the quotation from Chapter XVI, paragraph 1: "Cursed, cursed _____! Why did I live"

   Key: creator

6. [fill · recall · DOK 1] Fill in the blank with the vocabulary word that fits: "I trembled violently, _____ some dreadful misfortune." Word bank: imprecate, underwood, bedewed, apprehending

   Key: apprehending

7. [mc · recall · DOK 1] What happens after he saves a drowning girl?

   A. He is thanked

   B. He is adopted

   C. He is hired

D. He is shot

Key: D (He is shot)

8. [mc · recall · DOK 1] In the line “Oh, earth! how often did I imprecate curses on the cause of my being!”, what does “imprecate” most nearly mean?

   A. to feel or show pity for

   B. be conducive to

   C. healthy; good for the body

   D. to call down (curses) on

   Key: D (to call down (curses) on)

9. [mc · recall · DOK 1] In the line “Accordingly I hid myself in some thick underwood, determining to devote the ensuing hours to reflection on my situation.”, what does “underwood” most nearly mean?

   A. murder; especially of socially prominent persons

   B. offer to buy, as of stocks and shares

   C. small trees and bushes growing under taller trees

   D. a very large seabird of the southern oceans

   Key: C (small trees and bushes growing under taller trees)

10. [mc · inference · DOK 2] What does this passage most clearly show? “This was then the reward of my benevolence” (Chapter XVI, paragraph 20)

    A. Justine was pressured by her confessor; evidence about injustice and power.

    B. Total despair; in the next chapter it becomes a vow of revenge.

    C. Shot after a rescue; bitter irony.

    D. (The 1831 text prints "drank.") Victor calls ambition a drug ("intoxicating draught") and madness. Evidence for the novel's view of obsessive curiosity.

    Key: C (Shot after a rescue; bitter irony.)

11. [short · inference · DOK 2] What can you infer from this line? “Cursed, cursed creator! Why did I live” (Chapter XVI, paragraph 1) Answer in two or three sentences with one detail.

    Sample answer: Anguish and accusation.

12. [mc · inference · DOK 2] What does this passage most clearly show? “Cursed, cursed creator! Why did I live” (Chapter XVI, paragraph 1)

    A. Despair.

    B. The first sentence already contains a warning (his sister's "evil forebodings"). Strong evidence for foreshadowing.

    C. An allusion that promises he will not offend against nature; readers who know Coleridge sense danger.

    D. Anguish and accusation.

    Key: D (Anguish and accusation.)

13. [mc · inference · DOK 2] Which choice best states a central concern of “Chapter XVI”?

    A. The demand for a companion

    B. Rejection and the turn to revenge

    C. The origin of the novel and the idea of creation

    D. Loss and leaving home

Key: B (Rejection and the turn to revenge)

14. [mc · analysis · DOK 3] Which literary element does this describe in “Chapter XVI”? The creature's turn: he burns the cottage, swears war on humanity, and kills William when the boy names Frankenstein.
    A. Setting
    B. Theme
    C. Plot
    D. Characterization

    Key: D (Characterization)

15. [mc · analysis · DOK 3] Which literary element does this describe in “Chapter XVI”? "I, like the arch-fiend, bore a hell within me": Satan again.
    A. Setting
    B. Irony
    C. Symbolism
    D. Allusion

    Key: D (Allusion)

16. [short · synthesis · DOK 4] Synthesis: trace how nature and nurture develops from an earlier chapter to “Chapter XVI”. Use one quotation from each.

    Sample answer: repeated cruelty turns his benevolence into vengeance.

17. [fill · recall · DOK 1] Fill in the blank with the vocabulary word that fits: “The ball had entered my shoulder, and I knew not whether it had remained there or passed through; at any rate I had no means of _____ it.”

    Word bank: bedewed, underwood, imprecate, extracting

    Key: extracting

18. [mc · recall · DOK 1] What does the creature do to the cottage?
    A. Burns it
    B. Lives in it with them
    C. Repairs it
    D. Sells it

    Key: A (Burns it)

19. [fill · recall · DOK 1] Complete the quotation from Chapter XVI, paragraph 2: “I, like the _____, bore a hell within me”

    Key: archfiend

20. [mc · recall · DOK 1] What does the family do after the encounter?
    A. Abandon the cottage
    B. Search for him to apologize
    C. Hire guards
    D. Move into Geneva

    Key: A (Abandon the cottage)

21. [mc · recall · DOK 1] In the line “Soft tears again bedewed my cheeks, and I even raised my humid eyes with thankfulness towards the blessed sun which bestowed such joy upon me.”, what does “bedewed” most nearly mean?

    A. without paths; untraveled

    B. grow worse

    C. wet with drops, as of dew or tears

    D. dark underground prison cells

    Key: C (wet with drops, as of dew or tears)

22. [fill · recall · DOK 1] Complete the quotation from Chapter XVI, paragraph 20: “This was then the reward of my _____”

    Key: benevolence

23. [mc · inference · DOK 2] What does this passage most clearly show? “I, like the archfiend, bore a hell within me” (Chapter XVI, paragraph 2)

    A. Milton's Satan: the hell is internal.

    B. Shelley presents herself as a parent of the book. Use this to connect author and character: both make something "hideous," but only one blesses it.

    C. The creature will ask for exactly this. Evidence that the need for companionship is universal in the novel.

    D. Justine was pressured by her confessor; evidence about injustice and power.

    Key: A (Milton's Satan: the hell is internal.)

24. [short · inference · DOK 2] What can you infer from this line? “I, like the archfiend, bore a hell within me” (Chapter XVI, paragraph 2) Answer in two or three sentences with one detail.

    Sample answer: Milton's Satan: the hell is internal.

25. [short · analysis · DOK 3] Analyze the word choice in “This was then the reward of my benevolence” (Chapter XVI, paragraph 20). Pick two words and explain what they suggest.

    Sample answer: Shot after a rescue; bitter irony.

26. [short · synthesis · DOK 4] Close reading: how do the diction and syntax of “Cursed, cursed creator! Why did I live” (Chapter XVI, paragraph 1) shape its meaning? Consider a second, competing reading.

    Sample answer: Anguish and accusation.

27. [fill · recall · DOK 1] Fill in the blank with the vocabulary word that fits: “I was like a wild beast that had broken the toils; destroying the objects that _____ me, and ranging through the wood with a stag-like swiftness.” Word bank: imprecate, underwood, bedewed, obstructed

    Key: obstructed

28. [short · synthesis · DOK 4] Close reading: how do the diction and syntax of “I, like the archfiend, bore a hell within me” (Chapter XVI, paragraph 2) shape its meaning? Consider a second, competing reading.

    Sample answer: Milton's Satan: the hell is internal.

29. [short · synthesis · DOK 4] Evaluate this claim about the chapter: “The creature's violence is a response to repeated cruelty, though it is still his choice.” Is it fully persuasive? Argue with evidence, including a passage that complicates it.

    Sample answer: After he saves a girl and is shot, he asks bitterly whether "this was then the reward of my benevolence," and soon he bears "a hell within me"; the novel traces how injustice breeds hatred while still making him kill William by his own will.

30. [short · analysis · DOK 3] Claim: The creature's violence is a response to repeated cruelty, though it is still his choice. Explain how this evidence supports the claim: “This was then the reward of my benevolence” (Chapter XVI, paragraph 20).
    Sample answer: After he saves a girl and is shot, he asks bitterly whether "this was then the reward of my benevolence," and soon he bears "a hell within me"; the novel traces how injustice breeds hatred while still making him kill William by his own will.

Rigor version	Items (in order)	Mix
Middle School	1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 6, 7, 8, 9, 10, 11, 12, 13, 14, 15, 16	recall 9, inference 4, analysis 2, synthesis 1
HS Freshman	17, 18, 4, 19, 20, 2, 21, 22, 23, 11, 24, 12, 25, 14, 15, 26	recall 8, inference 4, analysis 3, synthesis 1
HS Sophomore	17, 7, 18, 9, 27, 21, 13, 11, 24, 12, 23, 25, 14, 15, 28, 29	recall 6, inference 5, analysis 3, synthesis 2
HS Junior	19, 4, 21, 6, 5, 23, 11, 13, 24, 10, 25, 30, 15, 14, 29, 16	recall 5, inference 5, analysis 4, synthesis 2
HS Senior	17, 3, 19, 7, 24, 12, 11, 13, 23, 30, 14, 15, 25, 16, 29, 28	recall 4, inference 5, analysis 4, synthesis 3
AP	27, 20, 17, 12, 11, 24, 23, 10, 15, 25, 30, 14, 29, 16, 26, 28	recall 3, inference 5, analysis 4, synthesis 4
College Freshman	17, 1, 5, 11, 24, 13, 10, 23, 14, 15, 25, 30, 26, 16, 28, 29	recall 3, inference 5, analysis 4, synthesis 4
College Sophomore	27, 17, 10, 24, 12, 13, 11, 23, 15, 14, 30, 25, 26, 28, 29, 16	recall 2, inference 6, analysis 4, synthesis 4
College Junior	17, 2, 12, 11, 13, 23, 10, 24, 15, 30, 25, 14, 16, 29, 28, 26	recall 2, inference 6, analysis 4, synthesis 4
College Senior	5, 2, 24, 12, 13, 10, 11, 23, 14, 30, 25, 15, 16, 29, 28, 26	recall 2, inference 6, analysis 4, synthesis 4
Graduate / PhD	6, 22, 13, 12, 11, 23, 24, 10, 15, 14, 30, 25, 26, 28, 16, 29	recall 2, inference 6, analysis 4, synthesis 4

Writing prompts (eleven rigor levels)

Middle School (250 words; Indiana 2023: 7.RC.1, 7.W.1): Supported track (work from the passage your teacher selects). In “Chapter XVI,” how does Shelley show rejection and the turn to revenge? Write a paragraph that states your claim, quotes two details from the passage, and explains how each detail supports your idea. Use the irony you noticed as one piece of evidence.

HS Freshman (350 words; Indiana 2023: 9-10.RC.1, 9-10.W.1): In Chapter XVI, how does Shelley develop the idea of rejection and the turn to revenge? State a clear claim, support it with two or three quotations, and explain how the irony in the chapter helps build that idea.

HS Sophomore (450 words; Indiana 2023: 9-10.RC.1, 9-10.W.1): Analyze how Chapter XVI develops the idea of rejection and the turn to revenge. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of irony and characterization shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.

HS Junior (550 words; Indiana 2023: 11-12.RC.3, 11-12.RC.1, 11-12.W.1): Analyze how the structure of Chapter XVI (where it begins, turns and ends) and its irony shape the reader's understanding of rejection and the turn to revenge. Identify one place where the text leaves matters uncertain and explain how that uncertainty adds to its meaning. Distinguish what is directly stated from what is really meant.

HS Senior (600 words; Indiana 2023: 11-12.RC.1, 11-12.W.1): Two readers disagree about what Chapter XVI suggests about rejection and the turn to revenge. Lay out two plausible interpretations, weigh the evidence for each (including the chapter's irony and characterization), and argue for the stronger one in a sustained, well-organized essay. Distinguish what is directly stated from what is really meant.

AP (650 words; Indiana 2023: 11-12.RC.1, 11-12.W.1): Write a literary argument in which you analyze how Mary Shelley uses irony in Chapter XVI to complicate the reader's understanding of rejection and the turn to revenge. Develop a defensible thesis, select evidence purposefully, and explain how specific choices of diction and syntax create meaning.

College Freshman (1000 words; Indiana 2023: see unit standards): Situate Chapter XVI within its historical and literary context and argue how the chapter's treatment of rejection and the turn to revenge responds to that context. Engage with at least one secondary perspective (a critic, historian or the author's own statements), integrate quotations smoothly, and cite in MLA style.

College Sophomore (1250 words; Indiana 2023: see unit standards): Read Chapter XVI alongside the conventions of its genre and period. Argue how the chapter's handling of rejection and the turn to revenge follows or bends those conventions, using the irony as evidence, and test your reading against one published critic. Document two secondary sources in MLA.

College Junior (1500 words; Indiana 2023: see unit standards): Apply a named critical approach (for example formalist, historicist, feminist, psychoanalytic or ecocritical) to Chapter XVI and its treatment of rejection and the turn to revenge. State your method, show what it reveals in the chapter's irony and characterization, and identify where the text resists it.

College Senior (2000 words; Indiana 2023: see unit standards): Develop a research argument that reads Chapter XVI as evidence for a larger claim about rejection and the turn to revenge in Frankenstein. Connect close reading of the chapter to the whole novel, engage at least four scholarly sources, and state precisely where your reading departs from theirs (Chicago style).

Graduate / PhD (2500 words; Indiana 2023: see unit standards): Develop an original argument that reads Chapter XVI as a hinge in the novel's larger treatment of rejection and the turn to revenge. Position your reading within a named critical conversation (for example formalist, historicist, psychoanalytic, feminist or postcolonial approaches), account for the textual history where relevant, and articulate the stakes of your intervention for scholarship on Frankenstein.

SAT-style questions

1. *Accordingly I hid myself in some thick underwood, determining to devote the ensuing hours to reflection on my situation.*

   As used in the text, what does the word "underwood" most nearly mean?

   A. small trees and bushes growing under taller trees
   B. cause to start burning
   C. get the meaning of something
   D. transmit (knowledge or skills)

2. *"When night came, I quitted my retreat, and wandered in the wood; and now, no longer restrained by the fear of discovery, I gave vent to my anguish in fearful howlings. I was like a wild beast that had broken the toils; destroying the objects that obstructed me, and ranging through the wood with a stag-like swiftness. O! what a miserable night I passed! the cold stars shone in mockery, and the bare trees waved their branches above me: now and then the sweet voice of a bird burst forth amidst the universal stillness. All, save I, were at rest or in enjoyment: I, like the archfiend, bore a hell within me; and, finding myself unsympathised with, wished to tear up the trees, spread havoc and destruction around me, and then to have sat down and enjoyed the ruin.*

   Which choice best states a central concern of "Chapter XVI"?

   A. Rejection and the turn to revenge
   B. Obsession and the discovery of life
   C. Delay and dread
   D. First experiences of the senses

SAT key: 1. A (small trees and bushes growing under taller trees); 2. A (Rejection and the turn to revenge)

Lesson 24: Chapter XVII

Focus: the demand for a companion

Objective: Students will analyze how theme develops in “Chapter XVII” by writing a claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph that cites at least 2 quotations from the section, and will score at least 80% on the section quiz.

Standards: CCSS RL.9-10.2, W.9-10.1, L.9-10.4 · IN 9-10.RC.2, 9-10.W.1, 9-10.RC.9, 9-10.RC.11

Teacher only · spoilers

The creature demands a female companion as wretched as himself, promising to withdraw to South America. Moved and afraid, Victor agrees.

Background: Debates on whether humans have natural rights to companionship and happiness echo Enlightenment philosophy.

Significance: This bargain is the hinge of the plot; Victor's later choice will decide everyone's fate.

Lesson plan and lecture script (90 minutes)

0–8 min · Bell-ringer · You do (8 min)
Students write to the bell-ringer, then pair-share.
Is the creature's request fair? What risks does Victor consider? Write for five minutes. Starters: I think... because... / This connects to isolation and companionship because....
Prompt: Is the creature's request fair? What risks does Victor consider?
Sentence starters: I think… because… · This connects to isolation and companionship because…
Strong response: A strong response takes a position and anticipates this: the plea for a companion is the novel's most direct statement of the need for love.

8–18 min · Vocabulary with etymology notes · I do (10 min)
Five key words in context, with verified word histories.
*Today's words: insurmountable — impossible to overcome; concede — to grant; to give; trifled — treated lightly; toyed with; protectors — a person who cares for persons or property; sickened — cause aversion in; offend the moral sense of. “concede”: From Middle English, from Old French conceder, from Latin concēdō "give way, yield", from con- "wholly" + cēdō "to yield, give way, to go, grant", from Proto-Indo-European *ked- "to go, yield". “trifled”: From Middle English trefle,trifel,trifle,triful,trufful,truyfle "false or idle tale; nonsense; playful activity; something unimportant", from Old French trufle "mockery", a byform of trufe, truffe "deception", of uncertain origin.*
Words: insurmountable: impossible to overcome · concede: to grant; to give · trifled: treated lightly; toyed with · protectors: a person who cares for persons or property · sickened: cause aversion in; offend the moral sense of

18–28 min · Background and context · I do (10 min)
Mini-lecture (read or adapt the script).
Debates on whether humans have natural rights to companionship and happiness echo Enlightenment philosophy. This bargain is the hinge of the plot; Victor's later choice will decide everyone's fate. Characterization: The creature demands a female companion and argues like a lawyer; Victor wavers between horror and pity. Conflict: Creator versus creation, argument versus revulsion. Diction / vocabulary: "Chain of existence": he wants to belong to the social web. Watch for light and fire: Light stands for knowledge and fire for its double edge: warmth and burning. Victor seeks the "light" of discovery; the creature discovers fire and is burned by it. In this chapter: "fare. We shall make our bed of dried leaves; the sun will shine on us as on man, and will ripen our" (Chapter XVII, paragraph 9).

28–40 min · I do: modeled close reading · I do (12 min)
Model the close reading of the anchor quotation using the written think-aloud below.
I read the line once for meaning and once for craft. "You must create a female for me, with whom I can live in the interchange of those sympathies necessary for my being" (Chapter XVII, paragraph 2). "Necessary": sympathy as a need like food. That is characterization at work: The creature demands a female companion and argues like a lawyer; Victor wavers between horror and pity.

> *You must create a female for me, with whom I can live in the interchange of those sympathies necessary for my being* (Chapter XVII, paragraph 2)

Think-aloud: I read the line once for meaning and once for craft. "You must create a female for me, with whom I can live in the interchange of those sympathies necessary for my being" (Chapter XVII, paragraph 2). "Necessary": sympathy as a need like food. That is characterization at work: The creature demands a female companion and argues like a lawyer; Victor wavers between horror and pity.

40–55 min · We do: guided annotation · We do (15 min)
Guided analysis of a second quotation; expected answers given.
Ask: What words in this line stand out, and what do they suggest? Expected: The "chain of existence" is a web of relationships; "excluded" shows he is outside it. Connects to companionship. Ask: How does this line connect to isolation and companionship? Expected: The plea for a companion is the novel's most direct statement of the need for love. (The wish to belong.)

> *I shall feel the affections of a sensitive being, and become linked to the chain of existence and events, from which I am now excluded* (Chapter XVII, paragraph 14)

Ask: What words in this line stand out, and what do they suggest?
Expected answer: The "chain of existence" is a web of relationships; "excluded" shows he is outside it. Connects to companionship.
Ask: How does this line connect to isolation and companionship?
Expected answer: The plea for a companion is the novel's most direct statement of the need for love. (The wish to belong.)

55–70 min · You do: independent annotation · You do (15 min)
Independent annotation and a claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph (exemplar given).
Annotate the chapter for characterization, conflict (three marks with a margin note each), then write one claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph: what does this chapter suggest about the demand for a companion? Then start your writing prompt at your assigned level (HS Sophomore: Analyze how Chapter XVII develops the idea of the demand for a companion. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of theme and characterization shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.) Exemplar: The creature's demand rests on the novel's claim that companionship is a basic need. When the text says "If I have no ties and no affections, hatred and vice must be my portion" (Chapter XVII, paragraph 14), it shows this directly. He calls sympathy "necessary for my being" and warns that without "ties" and "affections" he must turn to "hatred and vice," linking moral life to belonging.
Task: Annotate the chapter for characterization, conflict (three marks with a margin note each), then write one claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph: what does this chapter suggest about the demand for a companion? Then start your writing prompt at your assigned level (HS Sophomore: Analyze how Chapter XVII develops the idea of the demand for a companion. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of theme and characterization shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.)
Exemplar: The creature's demand rests on the novel's claim that companionship is a basic need. When the text says "If I have no ties and no affections, hatred and vice must be my portion" (Chapter XVII, paragraph 14), it shows this directly. He calls sympathy "necessary for my being" and warns that without "ties" and "affections" he must turn to "hatred and vice," linking moral life to belonging.

70–80 min · Discussion · We do (10 min)
Structured discussion from the 30 tiered questions, with facilitation notes.
Anchor question: Is the creature's request fair? What risks does Victor consider? Debate: should Victor agree? Require students to weigh the risks Victor names.
Anchor question: Is the creature's request fair? What risks does Victor consider?
Facilitation: Debate: should Victor agree? Require students to weigh the risks Victor names.

80–87 min · Exit ticket / chapter quiz · You do (7 min)
Chapter quiz in the app and an exit ticket (answer given).
Chapter quiz in the app, then: In one sentence, what does this chapter suggest about the demand for a companion? Support it with one short quotation. Model answer: The creature's demand rests on the novel's claim that companionship is a basic need. ("If I have no ties and no affections, hatred and vice must be my portion", Chapter XVII, paragraph 14). Accept any defensible claim backed by a quotation from the chapter; the answer key for the quiz is in the Quiz section.
Exit ticket: In one sentence, what does this chapter suggest about the demand for a companion? Support it with one short quotation.
Answer: Model answer: The creature's demand rests on the novel's claim that companionship is a basic need. ("If I have no ties and no affections, hatred and vice must be my portion", Chapter XVII, paragraph 14). Accept any defensible claim backed by a quotation from the chapter; the answer key for the quiz is in the Quiz section.

> **87–90 min · Closure · I do (3 min)**
> Summarize the lesson and preview the next reading.
> *Today we saw how characterization shapes the demand for a companion. Key takeaway: the plea for a companion is the novel's most direct statement of the need for love.*

Total: 90 minutes.

Teacher analysis (spoilers)

Literary elements

- **Characterization:** The creature demands a female companion and argues like a lawyer; Victor wavers between horror and pity.
- **Conflict:** Creator versus creation, argument versus revulsion.
- **Diction / vocabulary:** "Chain of existence": he wants to belong to the social web.

Themes and how they develop

- **isolation and companionship:** the plea for a companion is the novel's most direct statement of the need for love.

Symbols and motifs

- **light and fire:** Light stands for knowledge and fire for its double edge: warmth and burning. Victor seeks the "light" of discovery; the creature discovers fire and is burned by it. In this chapter: “fare. We shall make our bed of dried leaves; the sun will shine on us as on man, and will ripen our” (Chapter XVII, paragraph 9).
- **sublime nature:** Mountains, glaciers, storms and lakes reflect and sometimes soothe the characters' feelings; the sublime is both comfort and terror. In this chapter: “any change in my sentiments. I saw him descend the mountain with greater speed than the flight of an eagle, and quickly” (Chapter XVII, paragraph 18).

Key quotations (checked against the reading text)

- “You must create a female for me, with whom I can live in the interchange of those sympathies necessary for my being” (Chapter XVII, paragraph 2) "Necessary": sympathy as a need like food.
- “If I have no ties and no affections, hatred and vice must be my portion” (Chapter XVII, paragraph 14) The argument from isolation.
- “I shall feel the affections of a sensitive being, and become linked to the chain of existence and events, from which I am now excluded” (Chapter XVII, paragraph 14) The wish to belong.

Model claim-evidence-reasoning

Claim: The creature's demand rests on the novel's claim that companionship is a basic need.
Evidence: “If I have no ties and no affections, hatred and vice must be my portion” (Chapter XVII, paragraph 14)

Reasoning: He calls sympathy "necessary for my being" and warns that without "ties" and "affections" he must turn to "hatred and vice," linking moral life to belonging.

Vocabulary with etymology notes

Word	Definition (in this sentence)	In context	Word history
insurmountable (adjective)	impossible to overcome	*But that cannot be; the human senses are insurmountable barriers to our union.*	
concede (verb)	to grant; to give	*This you alone can do; and I demand it of you as a right which you must not refuse to concede."*	"concede": From Middle English, from Old French conceder, from Latin concēdō "give way, yield", from con- "wholly" + cēdō "to yield, give way, to go, grant", from Proto-Indo-European *ked- "to go, yield". (Wiktionary, https://en.wiktionary.org/wiki/concede#Etymology)
trifled (verb)	treated lightly; toyed with	*I must not be trifled with: and I demand an answer.*	"trifled": From Middle English trefle,trifel,trifle,triful,trufful,truyfle "false or idle tale; nonsense; playful activity; something unimportant", from Old French trufle "mockery", a byform of trufe, truffe "deception", of uncertain origin. (Wiktionary, https://en.wiktionary.org/wiki/trifle#Etymology)
protectors (noun)	a person who cares for persons or property	*I thought of the promise of virtues which he had displayed on the opening of his existence, and the subsequent blight of all kindly feeling by the loathing and scorn which his protectors had manifested towards him.*	
sickened (verb)	cause aversion in; offend the moral sense of	*I compassionated him, and sometimes felt a wish to console him; but when I looked upon him, when I saw the filthy mass that moved and talked, my heart sickened, and my feelings were altered to those of horror and hatred.*	
		"You must create a female for me, with whom I can	"interchange": From Old French entrechange, By surface analysis, inter- + change. (Wiktionary,

interchange (noun)	an exchange; a giving and receiving	*live in the interchange of those sympathies necessary for my being.*	https://en.wiktionary.org/wiki/interchange#Etymology)
precipices (noun)	a very steep cliff	*His power and threats were not omitted in my calculations: a creature who could exist in the ice-caves of the glaciers, and hide himself from pursuit among the ridges of inaccessible precipices, was a being possessing faculties it would be vain to cope with.*	“precipices”: First attested in 1598, from Middle French precipice, from Latin praecipitium "a steep place", from praeceps "steep", from prae + caput "head", ultimately from Proto-Indo-European *kap- "head". (Wiktionary, https://en.wiktionary.org/wiki/precipice#Etymology)
narrated (verb)	provide commentary for a film, for example	*The latter part of his tale had kindled anew in me the anger that had died away while he narrated his peaceful life among the cottagers, and, as he said this, I could no longer suppress the rage that burned within me.*	“narrated”: In English (recorded only since 1656, but until the 19th century stigmatized as 'Scottish') apparently from narration. (Wiktionary, https://en.wiktionary.org/wiki/narrate#Etymology)
barriers (noun)	a structure or object that impedes free movement	*But that cannot be; the human senses are insurmountable barriers to our union.*	“barriers”: From Middle English barrer, barrere, barryȝer, from Anglo-Norman barrere (compare French barrière), from barre "bar". (Wiktionary, https://en.wiktionary.org/wiki/barrier#Etymology)
persevere (verb)	be persistent, refuse to stop	*How can you, who long for the love and sympathy of man, persevere in this exile?*	

Discussion questions

1. Is the creature's request fair? What risks does Victor consider?
2. Where does theme appear in this chapter, and what effect does it have? Point to one passage.
3. How does this chapter connect to the book's larger concern with isolation and the need for companionship?

Classroom discussion questions (30, tiered)

Wait time after every question (3 s for DOK 1, 5 s for DOK 2, 8 to 10 s for DOK 3 and 4); think-pair-share on DOK 3 and 4; answer each response with a follow-up probe; close with student-generated questions. Focus sets by rigor level: Middle School: 1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 6, 11, 12, 13, 14, 21, 22; HS Freshman: 1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 12, 13, 14, 15, 22, 23, 24; HS Sophomore: 1, 2, 3, 4, 13, 14, 15, 16, 17, 23, 24, 25; HS Junior: 1, 2, 3, 14, 15, 16, 17, 18, 24, 25, 26, 27; HS Senior: 1, 2, 3, 15, 16, 17, 18, 25, 26, 27, 28, 29; AP: 1, 2, 16, 17, 18, 19, 20, 26, 27, 28, 29, 30; College Freshman: 1, 2, 17, 18, 19, 20, 21, 22, 27, 28, 29, 30; College Sophomore: 1, 2, 11, 18, 19, 20, 21, 22, 23, 28, 29, 30; College Junior: 1, 11, 12, 19, 20, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 29, 30; College Senior: 1, 11, 12, 13, 20, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 26, 30; Graduate / PhD: 1, 11, 12, 13, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 26, 27, 28

Literal / recall

1. What does the creature demand? [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · 7.RC.1, 7.CC.1, 9-10.RC.1] Look for: A female companion
2. Where does he promise to go? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · 7.RC.1, 7.CC.1, 9-10.RC.1] Look for: The wilds of South America
3. Why does Victor agree? [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · 7.RC.1, 7.CC.1, 9-10.RC.1] Look for: He feels compassion and fear
4. What theme does the request highlight? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · 7.RC.1, 7.CC.1, 9-10.RC.1] Look for: The need for companionship
5. What kind of moment is this in the plot? [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · 7.RC.1, 7.CC.1, 9-10.RC.1] Look for: A turning point bargain
6. Retell the three most important events of "Chapter XVII" in order, in one sentence each. [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · 7.RC.1, 7.CC.1, 9-10.RC.1] Look for: The creature demands a female companion as wretched as himself, promising to withdraw to South America. Moved and afraid, Victor agrees.
7. Which characters appear or are mentioned in "Chapter XVII"? Name two and one thing each says or does. [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · 7.RC.1, 7.CC.1, 9-10.RC.1] Look for: Names and actions taken from the chapter; check against the teacher summary.
8. Where and when does "Chapter XVII" take place? Point to the line that tells you. [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · 7.RC.1, 7.CC.1, 9-10.RC.1] Look for: A place/time detail quoted from the chapter.
9. Reread: "But that cannot be; the human senses are insurmountable barriers to our union." What does "insurmountable" mean here, and what is literally happening in this line? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · 7.RC.1, 7.CC.1, 9-10.RC.1] Look for: insurmountable: impossible to overcome.
10. Reread: "This you alone can do; and I demand it of you as a right which you must not refuse to concede."" What does "concede" mean here, and what is literally happening in this line? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · 7.RC.1, 7.CC.1, 9-10.RC.1] Look for: concede: to grant; to give.

Inferential / analytical

1. What does "Chapter XVII" suggest about the demand for a companion? State the inference and the line that supports it. [DOK 2 · thinkPairShare · wait 5 s · 7.RC.2, 7.CC.2, 9-10.RC.2] Look for: This bargain is the hinge of the plot; Victor's later choice will decide everyone's fate.
2. Find one example of theme in this chapter. What does it reveal that a plain statement would not? [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · 7.RC.2, 7.CC.2, 9-10.RC.2] Look for: Look for statements or moments that connect to the book's big ideas.
3. How does the characterization in this chapter shape what we understand about the demand for a companion? [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · 7.RC.3, 7.CC.2, 9-10.RC.1] Look for: Look for what characters say, do and think, and how others react to them.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The creature's demand rests on the novel's claim that companionship is a basic need. Useful evidence: "You must create a female for me, with whom I can live in the interchange of those sympathies necessary for my being" (Chapter XVII, paragraph 2): "Necessary": sympathy as a need like food. On characterization: The creature demands a female companion and argues like a lawyer; Victor wavers between horror and pity. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

4. In the passage that begins ““You must create a female for me, with whom I can live in the interchange of those sympathies necessary for my being.”, why might Shelley have chosen these particular words? Pick two and explain their connotations. [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · 7.RC.12, 7.CC.2, 9-10.RC.12] Look for: Diction analysis of two words in the anchor passage.
5. What causes the main turn in “Chapter XVII”, and what effect is it likely to have on what follows? [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · 7.RC.3, 7.CC.2, 9-10.RC.1] Look for: The creature demands a female companion as wretched as himself, promising to withdraw to South America. Moved and afraid, Victor agrees.
6. How does “Chapter XVII” build on “Chapter XVI”? Name one link of cause and effect. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · 7.RC.3, 7.CC.2, 9-10.RC.3] Look for: A causal or structural link between this and the previous chapter.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The creature's demand rests on the novel's claim that companionship is a basic need. Useful evidence: “If I have no ties and no affections, hatred and vice must be my portion” (Chapter XVII, paragraph 14): The argument from isolation. Theme link: the plea for a companion is the novel's most direct statement of the need for love. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
7. What can we infer about a character's motives from what they say and do here, as opposed to what they claim? [DOK 3 · followUp · wait 8 s · 7.RC.3, 7.CC.2, 9-10.RC.1] Look for: An inference about motive supported by a quoted line.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The creature's demand rests on the novel's claim that companionship is a basic need. Useful evidence: “I shall feel the affections of a sensitive being, and become linked to the chain of existence and events, from which I am now excluded” (Chapter XVII, paragraph 14): The wish to belong. On characterization: The creature demands a female companion and argues like a lawyer; Victor wavers between horror and pity. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
8. The bell-ringer asked: “Is the creature's request fair? What risks does Victor consider?” Now that we have read closely, how would you revise your first answer, and which line changed your mind? [DOK 2 · thinkPairShare · wait 5 s · 7.RC.2, 7.CC.2, 9-10.RC.2] Look for: A revised answer anchored in the text.
9. Where does conflict appear, and how does it connect this chapter to the larger concern with isolation and the need for companionship? [DOK 3 · followUp · wait 8 s · 7.RC.3, 7.CC.2, 9-10.RC.1] Look for: Look for the forces, people or desires pulling against each other.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The creature's demand rests on the novel's claim that companionship is a basic need. Useful evidence: “You must create a female for me, with whom I can live in the interchange of those sympathies necessary for my being” (Chapter XVII, paragraph 2): "Necessary": sympathy as a need like food. On conflict: Creator versus creation, argument versus revulsion. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
10. Background: Debates on whether humans have natural rights to companionship and happiness echo Enlightenment philosophy. How does knowing this change the way you read one moment in the chapter? [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · 7.RC.3, 7.CC.2, 9-10.RC.1] Look for: A specific moment reread in light of the context.

    Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The creature's demand rests on the novel's claim that companionship is a basic need. Useful evidence: “If I have no ties and no affections, hatred and vice must be my portion” (Chapter XVII, paragraph 14): The argument from isolation. Theme link: the plea for a

companion is the novel's most direct statement of the need for love. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

Evaluative / synthesis / creative

1. A critic might argue: “This bargain is the hinge of the plot; Victor's later choice will decide everyone's fate.” How far do you agree? Take a stand and defend it with two lines from the chapter. [DOK 3 · fourCorners · wait 8 s · 7.RC.2, 7.CC.3, 9-10.RC.2] Look for: A defended position with evidence and one counterpoint.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The creature's demand rests on the novel's claim that companionship is a basic need. Useful evidence: “I shall feel the affections of a sensitive being, and become linked to the chain of existence and events, from which I am now excluded” (Chapter XVII, paragraph 14): The wish to belong. Theme link: the plea for a companion is the novel's most direct statement of the need for love. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
2. Which character in this chapter acts most wisely, and which least? Judge them by a standard you name. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · 7.RC.3, 7.CC.3, 9-10.RC.1] Look for: An evaluation using an explicit criterion and evidence.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The creature's demand rests on the novel's claim that companionship is a basic need. Useful evidence: “You must create a female for me, with whom I can live in the interchange of those sympathies necessary for my being” (Chapter XVII, paragraph 2): "Necessary": sympathy as a need like food. On characterization: The creature demands a female companion and argues like a lawyer; Victor wavers between horror and pity. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
3. Rewrite one moment of “Chapter XVII” from the point of view of a different character. What does the new angle reveal or hide about the demand for a companion? [DOK 4 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · 7.RC.1, 7.CC.3, 9-10.RC.1] Look for: A creative product with a rationale tied to the text.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The creature's demand rests on the novel's claim that companionship is a basic need. Useful evidence: “If I have no ties and no affections, hatred and vice must be my portion” (Chapter XVII, paragraph 14): The argument from isolation. Theme link: the plea for a companion is the novel's most direct statement of the need for love. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
4. Write three questions of your own about “Chapter XVII”: one recall, one “why/how”, and one “should/what if”. Trade with a partner and answer theirs. [DOK 3 · studentGenerated · wait 8 s · 7.RC.2, 7.CC.3, 9-10.RC.2] Look for: Student-generated questions at three levels.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The creature's demand rests on the novel's claim that companionship is a basic need. Useful evidence: “I shall feel the affections of a sensitive being, and become linked to the chain of existence and events, from which I am now excluded” (Chapter XVII, paragraph 14): The wish to belong. Theme link: the plea for a companion is the novel's most direct statement of the need for love. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
5. Connect this chapter to nature versus nurture: is the link strong or weak so far? What would Shelley need to show next to strengthen it? [DOK 4 · socraticCircle · wait 8 s · 7.RC.2, 7.CC.3, 9-10.RC.2] Look for: A judgment of thematic development across the work.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The creature's demand rests on the novel's claim that

companionship is a basic need. Useful evidence: “You must create a female for me, with whom I can live in the interchange of those sympathies necessary for my being” (Chapter XVII, paragraph 2): "Necessary": sympathy as a need like food. Theme link: the plea for a companion is the novel's most direct statement of the need for love. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

6. Is the theme in this chapter effective, or does it feel heavy-handed? Evaluate it as a reader would in a review. [DOK 3 · fourCorners · wait 8 s · 7.RC.2, 7.CC.3, 9-10.RC.2] Look for: An evaluative judgment with criteria and evidence.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The creature's demand rests on the novel's claim that companionship is a basic need. Useful evidence: “If I have no ties and no affections, hatred and vice must be my portion” (Chapter XVII, paragraph 14): The argument from isolation. Theme link: the plea for a companion is the novel's most direct statement of the need for love. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

7. Compare how “Chapter XVII” treats the demand for a companion with how another text, film or event you know treats a similar idea. What does Frankenstein see that the other misses? [DOK 4 · socraticCircle · wait 8 s · 7.RC.2, 7.CC.3, 9-10.RC.2] Look for: A cross-text synthesis.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The creature's demand rests on the novel's claim that companionship is a basic need. Useful evidence: “I shall feel the affections of a sensitive being, and become linked to the chain of existence and events, from which I am now excluded” (Chapter XVII, paragraph 14): The wish to belong. Theme link: the plea for a companion is the novel's most direct statement of the need for love. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

8. Predict what “Chapter XVIII” will bring, using two clues from this chapter. After reading, evaluate your prediction. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · 7.RC.3, 7.CC.3, 9-10.RC.3] Look for: A prediction or judgment justified with textual clues.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The creature's demand rests on the novel's claim that companionship is a basic need. Useful evidence: “You must create a female for me, with whom I can live in the interchange of those sympathies necessary for my being” (Chapter XVII, paragraph 2): "Necessary": sympathy as a need like food. Theme link: the plea for a companion is the novel's most direct statement of the need for love. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

9. Design a one-paragraph modern adaptation of this chapter (setting, characters, conflict). What must stay the same for it to still be about the demand for a companion? [DOK 4 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · 7.RC.2, 7.CC.3, 9-10.RC.2] Look for: A creative transfer that keeps the core idea.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The creature's demand rests on the novel's claim that companionship is a basic need. Useful evidence: “If I have no ties and no affections, hatred and vice must be my portion” (Chapter XVII, paragraph 14): The argument from isolation. Theme link: the plea for a companion is the novel's most direct statement of the need for love. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

10. What question would you most like to ask Mary Shelley about this chapter, and what answer do you think the text itself gives? [DOK 4 · studentGenerated · wait 8 s · 7.RC.2, 7.CC.3, 9-10.RC.2] Look for: A student-generated question answered from evidence.

    Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The creature's demand rests on the novel's claim that

companionship is a basic need. Useful evidence: "I shall feel the affections of a sensitive being, and become linked to the chain of existence and events, from which I am now excluded" (Chapter XVII, paragraph 14): The wish to belong. Theme link: the plea for a companion is the novel's most direct statement of the need for love. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

Annotation focus

- **Theme:** look for statements or moments that connect to the book's big ideas (anchor passage in the We do segment)
- Also notice **Characterization**: what characters say, do and think, and how others react to them
- Also notice **Conflict**: the forces, people or desires pulling against each other

Chapter quiz: item bank (all eleven rigor versions)

1. [fill · recall · DOK 1] Complete the quotation from Chapter XVII, paragraph 14: "I shall feel the _____ of a sensitive being, and become linked to the chain of existence and events, from which I am now excluded"
   Key: affections
2. [mc · recall · DOK 1] What kind of moment is this in the plot?
   A. An ending
   B. A flashback only
   C. A turning point bargain
   D. A comic interlude

   Key: C (A turning point bargain)
3. [fill · recall · DOK 1] Fill in the blank with the vocabulary word that fits: ""You must create a female for me, with whom I can live in the _____ of those sympathies necessary for my being." Word bank: insurmountable, concede, interchange, trifled
   Key: interchange
4. [mc · recall · DOK 1] In the line "I thought of the promise of virtues which he had displayed on the opening of his existence, and the subsequent blight of all kindly feeling by the loathing and scorn which his protectors had manifested towards him.", what does "protectors" most nearly mean?
   A. a person who cares for persons or property
   B. to speed up; to hasten
   C. uselessness as a consequence of having no practical result
   D. to urge on; to provoke

   Key: A (a person who cares for persons or property)
5. [mc · recall · DOK 1] In the line "But that cannot be; the human senses are insurmountable barriers to our union.", what does "insurmountable" most nearly mean?
   A. impossible to overcome
   B. a means to an end; not necessarily a principled or ethical one
   C. dotted; spotted
   D. to cut apart in order to examine closely

   Key: A (impossible to overcome)

6. [fill · recall · DOK 1] Fill in the blank with the vocabulary word that fits: “I compassionated him, and sometimes felt a wish to console him; but when I looked upon him, when I saw the filthy mass that moved and talked, my heart _____, and my feelings were altered to those of horror and hatred.” Word bank: trifled, insurmountable, sickened, concede

   Key: sickened

7. [fill · recall · DOK 1] Complete the quotation from Chapter XVII, paragraph 14: “If I have no ties and no _____, hatred and vice must be my portion”

   Key: affections

8. [mc · recall · DOK 1] Why does Victor agree?

   A. Elizabeth asks him

   B. He feels compassion and fear

   C. He is curious

   D. He is bribed

   Key: B (He feels compassion and fear)

9. [mc · recall · DOK 1] What does the creature demand?

   A. To live in Geneva

   B. Money

   C. Victor's death

   D. A female companion

   Key: D (A female companion)

10. [mc · inference · DOK 2] Which choice best states a central concern of “Chapter XVII”?

    A. Loneliness and the desire for a friend

    B. Isolation in the north

    C. Reading and identity

    D. The demand for a companion

    Key: D (The demand for a companion)

11. [short · inference · DOK 2] What can you infer from this line? “You must create a female for me, with whom I can live in the interchange of those sympathies necessary for my being” (Chapter XVII, paragraph 2) Answer in two or three sentences with one detail.

    Sample answer: "Necessary": sympathy as a need like food.

12. [mc · inference · DOK 2] What does this passage most clearly show? “I shall feel the affections of a sensitive being, and become linked to the chain of existence and events, from which I am now excluded” (Chapter XVII, paragraph 14)

    A. Walton admits his feelings run away with him, a trait he shares with Victor.

    B. The wish to belong.

    C. Metaphor tying his ruin to the blasted oak.

    D. Repetition of the threat.

    Key: B (The wish to belong.)

13. [mc · inference · DOK 2] What does this passage most clearly show? “If I have no ties and no affections, hatred and vice must be my portion” (Chapter XVII, paragraph 14)

    A. Anguish and accusation.

    B. Justine was pressured by her confessor; evidence about injustice and power.

    C. Echoes the "lifeless matter" of creation.

    D. The argument from isolation.

    Key: D (The argument from isolation.)

14. [mc · analysis · DOK 3] Which literary element does this describe in “Chapter XVII”? The creature demands a female companion and argues like a lawyer; Victor wavers between horror and pity.

    A. Characterization

    B. Setting

    C. Point of view

    D. Hyperbole

    Key: A (Characterization)

15. [mc · analysis · DOK 3] Which literary element does this describe in “Chapter XVII”? Creator versus creation, argument versus revulsion.

    A. Conflict

    B. Plot

    C. Diction / vocabulary

    D. Alliteration

    Key: A (Conflict)

16. [short · synthesis · DOK 4] Evaluate this claim about the chapter: “The creature's demand rests on the novel's claim that companionship is a basic need.” Is it fully persuasive? Argue with evidence, including a passage that complicates it.

    Sample answer: He calls sympathy "necessary for my being" and warns that without "ties" and "affections" he must turn to "hatred and vice," linking moral life to belonging.

17. [mc · recall · DOK 1] In the line “This you alone can do; and I demand it of you as a right which you must not refuse to concede.””, what does “concede” most nearly mean?

    A. healthy; good for the body

    B. cunning; craftiness

    C. to grant; to give

    D. something that tempts or attracts

    Key: C (to grant; to give)

18. [fill · recall · DOK 1] Complete the quotation from Chapter XVII, paragraph 2: “You must create a female for me, with whom I can live in the _____ of those sympathies necessary for my being”

    Key: interchange

19. [fill · recall · DOK 1] Fill in the blank with the vocabulary word that fits: “The latter part of his tale had kindled anew in me the anger that had died away while he _____ his peaceful life among the cottagers, and, as he said this, I could no longer suppress the rage that burned within me.” Word bank: concede,

insurmountable, trifled, narrated

Key: narrated

20. [mc · inference · DOK 2] What does this passage most clearly show? “You must create a female for me, with whom I can live in the interchange of those sympathies necessary for my being” (Chapter XVII, paragraph 2)

    A. Human violence comes first.

    B. "Necessary": sympathy as a need like food.

    C. Atmospheric recognition scene; the creature as shadow and double.

    D. Elizabeth is presented as a gift; useful for discussions of how women are treated in the novel.

    Key: B ("Necessary": sympathy as a need like food.)

21. [short · analysis · DOK 3] Claim: The creature's demand rests on the novel's claim that companionship is a basic need. Explain how this evidence supports the claim: “If I have no ties and no affections, hatred and vice must be my portion” (Chapter XVII, paragraph 14).

    Sample answer: He calls sympathy "necessary for my being" and warns that without "ties" and "affections" he must turn to "hatred and vice," linking moral life to belonging.

22. [short · analysis · DOK 3] Analyze the word choice in “I shall feel the affections of a sensitive being, and become linked to the chain of existence and events, from which I am now excluded” (Chapter XVII, paragraph 14). Pick two words and explain what they suggest.

    Sample answer: The wish to belong.

23. [short · synthesis · DOK 4] Synthesis: trace how isolation and companionship develops from an earlier chapter to “Chapter XVII”. Use one quotation from each.

    Sample answer: the plea for a companion is the novel's most direct statement of the need for love.

24. [fill · recall · DOK 1] Fill in the blank with the vocabulary word that fits: “His power and threats were not omitted in my calculations: a creature who could exist in the ice-caves of the glaciers, and hide himself from pursuit among the ridges of inaccessible _____, was a being possessing faculties it would be vain to cope with.” Word bank: insurmountable, precipices, concede, trifled

    Key: precipices

25. [mc · recall · DOK 1] Where does he promise to go?

    A. Italy

    B. London

    C. The North Pole

    D. The wilds of South America

    Key: D (The wilds of South America)

26. [short · synthesis · DOK 4] Close reading: how do the diction and syntax of “If I have no ties and no affections, hatred and vice must be my portion” (Chapter XVII, paragraph 14) shape its meaning? Consider a second, competing reading.

    Sample answer: The argument from isolation.

27. [mc · recall · DOK 1] What theme does the request highlight?

    A. Wealth

    B. Religion

    C. The need for companionship

D. Love of fame

Key: C (The need for companionship)

28. [short · inference · DOK 2] What can you infer from this line? “If I have no ties and no affections, hatred and vice must be my portion” (Chapter XVII, paragraph 14) Answer in two or three sentences with one detail.
Sample answer: The argument from isolation.

29. [short · synthesis · DOK 4] Close reading: how do the diction and syntax of “You must create a female for me, with whom I can live in the interchange of those sympathies necessary for my being” (Chapter XVII, paragraph 2) shape its meaning? Consider a second, competing reading.
Sample answer: "Necessary": sympathy as a need like food.

30. [mc · recall · DOK 1] In the line “I must not be trifled with: and I demand an answer.”, what does “trifled” most nearly mean?

A. treated lightly; toyed with

B. a person who cares for persons or property

C. impossible to overcome

D. to grant; to give

Key: A (treated lightly; toyed with)

Rigor version	Items (in order)	Mix
Middle School	1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 6, 7, 8, 9, 10, 11, 12, 13, 14, 15, 16	recall 9, inference 4, analysis 2, synthesis 1
HS Freshman	4, 7, 17, 2, 6, 18, 9, 19, 13, 12, 11, 20, 14, 21, 22, 23	recall 8, inference 4, analysis 3, synthesis 1
HS Sophomore	17, 24, 1, 25, 7, 4, 11, 12, 20, 10, 13, 15, 21, 14, 26, 16	recall 6, inference 5, analysis 3, synthesis 2
HS Junior	3, 2, 27, 25, 6, 13, 28, 11, 10, 12, 14, 22, 15, 21, 29, 16	recall 5, inference 5, analysis 4, synthesis 2
HS Senior	27, 8, 19, 6, 20, 10, 11, 13, 12, 22, 21, 14, 15, 23, 29, 16	recall 4, inference 5, analysis 4, synthesis 3
AP	3, 6, 30, 10, 20, 13, 28, 11, 22, 15, 21, 14, 26, 23, 29, 16	recall 3, inference 5, analysis 4, synthesis 4
College Freshman	6, 3, 5, 20, 13, 10, 28, 12, 14, 15, 21, 22, 29, 16, 26, 23	recall 3, inference 5, analysis 4, synthesis 4
College Sophomore	6, 3, 10, 11, 20, 13, 12, 28, 21, 22, 14, 15, 26, 23, 16, 29	recall 2, inference 6, analysis 4, synthesis 4
College Junior	6, 7, 13, 12, 28, 10, 20, 11, 14, 15, 22, 21, 26, 23, 29, 16	recall 2, inference 6, analysis 4, synthesis 4
College Senior	6, 3, 11, 13, 12, 10, 20, 28, 14, 15, 21, 22, 26, 29, 16, 23	recall 2, inference 6, analysis 4, synthesis 4
Graduate / PhD	6, 3, 20, 12, 13, 28, 10, 11, 21, 15, 14, 22, 16, 23, 29, 26	recall 2, inference 6, analysis 4, synthesis 4

Writing prompts (eleven rigor levels)

Middle School (250 words; Indiana 2023: 7.RC.2, 7.W.1): Supported track (work from the passage your teacher selects). In “Chapter XVII,” how does Shelley show the demand for a companion? Write a paragraph that states your claim, quotes two details from the passage, and explains how each detail supports your idea. Use the theme you noticed as one piece of evidence.

HS Freshman (350 words; Indiana 2023: 9-10.RC.2, 9-10.W.1): In Chapter XVII, how does Shelley develop the idea of the demand for a companion? State a clear claim, support it with two or three quotations, and explain how the theme in the chapter helps build that idea.

HS Sophomore (450 words; Indiana 2023: 9-10.RC.2, 9-10.W.1): Analyze how Chapter XVII develops the idea of the demand for a companion. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of theme and characterization shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.

HS Junior (550 words; Indiana 2023: 11-12.RC.3, 11-12.RC.1, 11-12.W.1): Analyze how the structure of Chapter XVII (where it begins, turns and ends) and its theme shape the reader's understanding of the demand for a companion. Identify one place where the text leaves matters uncertain and explain how that uncertainty adds to its meaning.

HS Senior (600 words; Indiana 2023: 11-12.RC.1, 11-12.W.1): Two readers disagree about what Chapter XVII suggests about the demand for a companion. Lay out two plausible interpretations, weigh the evidence for each (including the chapter's theme and characterization), and argue for the stronger one in a sustained, well-organized essay.

AP (650 words; Indiana 2023: 11-12.RC.1, 11-12.W.1): Write a literary argument in which you analyze how Mary Shelley uses theme in Chapter XVII to complicate the reader's understanding of the demand for a companion. Develop a defensible thesis, select evidence purposefully, and explain how specific choices of diction and syntax create meaning.

College Freshman (1000 words; Indiana 2023: see unit standards): Situate Chapter XVII within its historical and literary context and argue how the chapter's treatment of the demand for a companion responds to that context. Engage with at least one secondary perspective (a critic, historian or the author's own statements), integrate quotations smoothly, and cite in MLA style.

College Sophomore (1250 words; Indiana 2023: see unit standards): Read Chapter XVII alongside the conventions of its genre and period. Argue how the chapter's handling of the demand for a companion follows or bends those conventions, using the theme as evidence, and test your reading against one published critic. Document two secondary sources in MLA.

College Junior (1500 words; Indiana 2023: see unit standards): Apply a named critical approach (for example formalist, historicist, feminist, psychoanalytic or ecocritical) to Chapter XVII and its treatment of the demand for a companion. State your method, show what it reveals in the chapter's theme and characterization, and identify where the text resists it.

College Senior (2000 words; Indiana 2023: see unit standards): Develop a research argument that reads Chapter XVII as evidence for a larger claim about the demand for a companion in Frankenstein. Connect close reading of the chapter to the whole novel, engage at least four scholarly sources, and state precisely where your reading departs from theirs (Chicago style).

Graduate / PhD (2500 words; Indiana 2023: see unit standards): Develop an original argument that reads Chapter XVII as a hinge in the novel's larger treatment of the demand for a companion. Position your reading within a named critical conversation (for example formalist, historicist, psychoanalytic, feminist or postcolonial approaches), account for the textual history where relevant, and articulate the stakes of your intervention for scholarship on Frankenstein.

SAT-style questions

1. *I must not be trifled with: and I demand an answer.*

   As used in the text, what does the word "trifled" most nearly mean?

   A. a structure or object that impedes free movement
   B. treated lightly; toyed with
   C. be persistent, refuse to stop
   D. provide commentary for a film, for example

2. *"You must create a female for me, with whom I can live in the interchange of those sympathies necessary for my being. This you alone can do; and I demand it of you as a right which you must not refuse to concede."*

   Which choice best states a central concern of "Chapter XVII"?

   A. Confrontation between creator and creation
   B. The wedding night and its catastrophe
   C. The demand for a companion
   D. Isolation in the north

SAT key: 1. B (treated lightly; toyed with); 2. C (The demand for a companion)

Lesson 25: Chapter XVIII

Focus: delay and dread

Objective: Students will analyze how foreshadowing develops in “Chapter XVIII” by writing a claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph that cites at least 2 quotations from the section, and will score at least 80% on the section quiz.

Standards: CCSS RL.9-10.5, W.9-10.1, L.9-10.4 · IN 9-10.RC.3, 9-10.W.1, 9-10.RC.9, 9-10.RC.11

Teacher only · spoilers

Back in Geneva, Victor delays. His father asks whether he loves another; Victor agrees to marry Elizabeth after a trip to England, where he will secretly do his work. He travels with Clerval through Germany and down the Rhine.

Background: The Rhine was celebrated for picturesque castles and vineyards in Romantic travel writing.

Significance: Clerval's joy in nature contrasts with Victor's dread, heightening tension.

Lesson plan and lecture script (90 minutes)

0–8 min · Bell-ringer · You do (8 min)
Students write to the bell-ringer, then pair-share.
How does Clerval's attitude toward nature differ from Victor's at this point? Write for five minutes. Starters: I think... because... / This connects to isolation and companionship because....
Prompt: How does Clerval's attitude toward nature differ from Victor's at this point?
Sentence starters: I think… because… · This connects to isolation and companionship because…
Strong response: A strong response takes a position and anticipates this: Victor feels "an insurmountable barrier" between himself and others.

8–18 min · Vocabulary with etymology notes · I do (10 min)
Five key words in context, with verified word histories.
Today's words: eradicating — removing completely; enfranchised — set free; sedulous — careful and persistent; meandering — winding; following a curving course; dilatory — slow; tending to delay. “dilatory”: From Middle English dilatorie, from Old French dilatoire, from Latin dīlātōrius "extending or putting off (time)", from dīlātor, from differō. Not etymologically related to delay.
Words: eradicating: removing completely · enfranchised: set free · sedulous: careful and persistent · meandering: winding; following a curving course · dilatory: slow; tending to delay

18–28 min · Background and context · I do (10 min)
Mini-lecture (read or adapt the script).
The Rhine was celebrated for picturesque castles and vineyards in Romantic travel writing. Clerval's joy in nature contrasts with Victor's dread, heightening tension. Conflict: Victor delays: fear of the creature's revenge against disgust at the work, while his father presses for marriage to Elizabeth. Characterization: Clerval, a lover of nature and poetry, contrasts with Victor's misery. Tone / mood: Dread pervades even beauty. Watch for light and fire: Light stands for knowledge and fire for its double edge: warmth and burning. Victor seeks the "light" of discovery; the creature discovers fire and is burned by it. In this chapter: "waves, silent and listless. But the fresh air and bright sun seldom failed to restore me to some degree of composure; and" (Chapter XVIII, paragraph 1).

28–40 min · I do: modeled close reading · I do (12 min)
Model the close reading of the anchor quotation using the written think-aloud below.
I read the line once for meaning and once for craft. "the "very poetry of nature" (Chapter XVIII, paragraph 19). Clerval's character; he loves nature directly. That is conflict at work: Victor delays: fear of the creature's revenge against disgust at the work, while his father presses for marriage to Elizabeth.

> *the "very poetry of nature* (Chapter XVIII, paragraph 19)

Think-aloud: I read the line once for meaning and once for craft. "the "very poetry of nature" (Chapter XVIII, paragraph 19). Clerval's character; he loves nature directly. That is conflict at work: Victor delays: fear of the creature's revenge against disgust at the work, while his father presses for marriage to Elizabeth.

40–55 min · We do: guided annotation · We do (15 min)
Guided analysis of a second quotation; expected answers given.
Ask: What words in this line stand out, and what do they suggest? Expected: "Disappointed fiend" shows he expects revenge; "repugnance" (disgust) shows why he cannot work. Link: his secret keeps him from sharing the burden, so even beside Clerval he is alone. Ask: How does this line connect to isolation and companionship? Expected: Victor feels "an insurmountable barrier" between himself and others. (Fear and disgust pull against each other: the source of his delay.)

> *I feared the vengeance of the disappointed fiend, yet I was unable to overcome my repugnance to the task which was enjoined me* (Chapter XVIII, paragraph 1)

Ask: What words in this line stand out, and what do they suggest?
Expected answer: "Disappointed fiend" shows he expects revenge; "repugnance" (disgust) shows why he cannot work. Link: his secret keeps him from sharing the burden, so even beside Clerval he is alone.
Ask: How does this line connect to isolation and companionship?
Expected answer: Victor feels "an insurmountable barrier" between himself and others. (Fear and disgust pull against each other: the source of his delay.)

55–70 min · You do: independent annotation · You do (15 min)
Independent annotation and a claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph (exemplar given).
Annotate the chapter for conflict, characterization (three marks with a margin note each), then write one claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph: what does this chapter suggest about delay and dread? Then start your writing prompt at your assigned level (HS Sophomore: Analyze how Chapter XVIII develops the idea of delay and dread. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of foreshadowing and setting shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.) Exemplar: Victor's delay comes from a conflict between fear and revulsion, and it hands the creature power over him. When the text says "I feared the vengeance of the disappointed fiend, yet I was unable to overcome my repugnance to the task which was enjoined me" (Chapter XVIII, paragraph 1), it shows this directly. He fears "the vengeance of the disappointed fiend" but cannot overcome his "repugnance to the task," and so he drifts; by his own admission he becomes "the slave of my creature."
Task: Annotate the chapter for conflict, characterization (three marks with a margin note each), then write one claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph: what does this chapter suggest about delay and dread? Then start your writing prompt at your assigned level (HS Sophomore: Analyze how Chapter XVIII develops the idea of delay and dread. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of foreshadowing and setting shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.)
Exemplar: Victor's delay comes from a conflict between fear and revulsion, and it hands the creature power over him. When the text says "I feared the vengeance of the disappointed fiend, yet I was unable to overcome my repugnance to the task which was enjoined me" (Chapter XVIII, paragraph 1), it shows this directly. He fears "the vengeance of the disappointed fiend" but cannot overcome his "repugnance to the task," and so he drifts; by his own admission he becomes "the slave of my creature."

70–80 min · Discussion · We do (10 min)
Structured discussion from the 30 tiered questions, with facilitation notes.
Anchor question: How does Clerval's attitude toward nature differ from Victor's at this point? Compare Victor's isolation to the creature's: which is chosen?
Anchor question: How does Clerval's attitude toward nature differ from Victor's at this point?
Facilitation: Compare Victor's isolation to the creature's: which is chosen?

80–87 min · Exit ticket / chapter quiz · You do (7 min)
Chapter quiz in the app and an exit ticket (answer given).
Chapter quiz in the app, then: In one sentence, what does this chapter suggest about delay and dread? Support it with one short quotation. Model answer: Victor's delay comes from a conflict between fear and revulsion, and it hands the creature power over him. ("I feared the vengeance of the disappointed fiend, yet I was unable to overcome my repugnance to the task which was enjoined me", Chapter XVIII, paragraph 1). Accept any defensible claim backed by a quotation from the chapter; the answer key for the quiz is in the Quiz section.
Exit ticket: In one sentence, what does this chapter suggest about delay and dread? Support it with one short quotation.
Answer: Model answer: Victor's delay comes from a conflict between fear and revulsion, and it hands the creature power over him. ("I feared the vengeance of the disappointed fiend, yet I was unable to overcome my repugnance to the task which was enjoined me", Chapter XVIII, paragraph 1). Accept any defensible claim backed by a quotation from the chapter; the answer key for the quiz is in the Quiz section.

> **87–90 min · Closure · I do (3 min)**
> Summarize the lesson and preview the next reading.
> *Today we saw how conflict shapes delay and dread. Key takeaway: Victor feels "an insurmountable barrier" between himself and others.*

Total: 90 minutes.

Teacher analysis (spoilers)

Literary elements

- **Conflict:** Victor delays: fear of the creature's revenge against disgust at the work, while his father presses for marriage to Elizabeth.
- **Characterization:** Clerval, a lover of nature and poetry, contrasts with Victor's misery.
- **Tone / mood:** Dread pervades even beauty.

Themes and how they develop

- **isolation and companionship:** Victor feels "an insurmountable barrier" between himself and others.

Symbols and motifs

- **light and fire:** Light stands for knowledge and fire for its double edge: warmth and burning. Victor seeks the "light" of discovery; the creature discovers fire and is burned by it. In this chapter: “waves, silent and listless. But the fresh air and bright sun seldom failed to restore me to some degree of composure; and” (Chapter XVIII, paragraph 1).
- **sublime nature:** Mountains, glaciers, storms and lakes reflect and sometimes soothe the characters' feelings; the sublime is both comfort and terror. In this chapter: “the most perfect solitude. I passed whole days on the lake alone in a little boat, watching the clouds, and listening to” (Chapter XVIII, paragraph 1).

Key quotations (checked against the reading text)

- “I feared the vengeance of the disappointed fiend, yet I was unable to overcome my repugnance to the task which was enjoined me” (Chapter XVIII, paragraph 1) Fear and disgust pull against each other: the source of his delay.
- “the “very poetry of nature” (Chapter XVIII, paragraph 19) Clerval's character; he loves nature directly.
- “I was the slave of my creature” (Chapter XVIII, paragraph 13) The master has become the slave; a reversal the creature will state aloud in Chapter XX.

Model claim-evidence-reasoning

Claim: Victor's delay comes from a conflict between fear and revulsion, and it hands the creature power over him.
Evidence: “I feared the vengeance of the disappointed fiend, yet I was unable to overcome my repugnance to the task which was enjoined me” (Chapter XVIII, paragraph 1)

Reasoning: He fears "the vengeance of the disappointed fiend" but cannot overcome his "repugnance to the task," and so he drifts; by his own admission he becomes "the slave of my creature."

Vocabulary with etymology notes

Word	Definition (in this sentence)	In context	Word history
eradicating (verb)	removing completely	*My father saw this change with pleasure, and he turned his thoughts towards the best method of eradicating the remains of my melancholy, which every now and then would return by fits, and with a devouring blackness overcast the approaching sunshine.*	
enfranchised (verb)	set free	*For myself, there was one reward I promised myself from my detested toils—one consolation for my unparalleled sufferings; it was the prospect of that day when, enfranchised from my miserable slavery, I might claim Elizabeth, and forget the past in my union with her.*	
sedulous (adjective)	careful and persistent	*It had been her care which provided me a companion in Clerval—and yet a man is blind to a thousand minute circumstances, which call forth a woman's sedulous attention.*	
meandering (adjective)	winding; following a curving course	*In one spot you view rugged hills, ruined castles overlooking tremendous precipices, with the dark Rhine rushing beneath; and, on the sudden turn of a promontory, flourishing vineyards, with green sloping banks, and a meandering river, and populous towns occupy the scene.*	
dilatory (adjective)	slow; tending to delay	*The latter method of obtaining the desired intelligence was dilatory and unsatisfactory: besides, I had an insurmountable aversion to the idea of engaging myself in my loathsome task in my father's house, while in habits of familiar intercourse with those I loved.*	"dilatory": From Middle English dilatorie, from Old French dilatoire, from Latin dīlātōrius "extending or putting off (time)", from dīlātor, from differō. Not etymologically related to delay. (Wiktionary, https://en.wiktionary.org/wiki/dilatory#Etymology)

inhabits (verb)	inhabit or live in; be an inhabitant of	*Oh, surely, the spirit that inhabits and guards this place has a soul more in harmony with man, than those who pile the glacier, or retire to the inaccessible peaks of the mountains of our own country."*	"inhabits": From Old French enhabiter, from Latin inhabitāre (in + habitāre). (Wiktionary, https://en.wiktionary.org/wiki/inhabit#Etymology)
inroads (noun)	an encroachment or intrusion	*My journey had been my own suggestion, and Elizabeth, therefore, acquiesced: but she was filled with disquiet at the idea of my suffering, away from her, the inroads of misery and grief.*	"inroads": The noun is derived from in + road. (Wiktionary, https://en.wiktionary.org/wiki/inroad#Etymology)
harrowing (adjective)	deeply distressing	*I was aware also that I should often lose all self-command, all capacity of hiding the harrowing sensations that would possess me during the progress of my unearthly occupation.*	"harrowing": By surface analysis, en + harrow + ing. (Wiktionary, https://en.wiktionary.org/wiki/harrowing#Etymology)
unexampled (adjective)	never seen before; unequaled	*Pardon this gush of sorrow; these ineffectual words are but a slight tribute to the unexampled worth of Henry, but they soothe my heart, overflowing with the anguish which his remembrance creates.*	
variegated (adjective)	varied in color or appearance	*This part of the Rhine, indeed, presents a singularly variegated landscape.*	

Discussion questions

1. How does Clerval's attitude toward nature differ from Victor's at this point?
2. Where does foreshadowing appear in this chapter, and what effect does it have? Point to one passage.
3. How does this chapter connect to the book's larger concern with nature versus nurture?

Classroom discussion questions (30, tiered)

Wait time after every question (3 s for DOK 1, 5 s for DOK 2, 8 to 10 s for DOK 3 and 4); think-pair-share on DOK 3 and 4; answer each response with a follow-up probe; close with student-generated questions. Focus sets by rigor level: Middle School: 1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 6, 11, 12, 13, 14, 21, 22; HS Freshman: 1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 12, 13, 14, 15, 22, 23, 24; HS Sophomore: 1, 2, 3, 4, 13, 14, 15, 16, 17, 23, 24, 25; HS Junior: 1, 2, 3, 14, 15, 16, 17, 18, 24, 25, 26, 27; HS Senior: 1, 2, 3, 15, 16, 17, 18, 25, 26, 27, 28, 29; AP: 1, 2, 16, 17, 18, 19, 20, 26, 27, 28, 29, 30; College Freshman: 1, 2, 17, 18, 19, 20, 21, 22, 27, 28, 29, 30; College Sophomore: 1, 2, 11, 18, 19, 20, 21, 22, 23, 28, 29, 30; College Junior: 1, 11, 12, 19, 20, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 29, 30; College Senior: 1, 11, 12, 13, 20, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 26, 30; Graduate / PhD: 1, 11, 12, 13, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 26, 27, 28

Literal / recall

1. Why does Victor travel to England? [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · 7.RC.1, 7.CC.1, 9-10.RC.1] Look for: To create the female in secret
2. Who travels with him? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · 7.RC.1, 7.CC.1, 9-10.RC.1] Look for: Clerval
3. What river do they travel along? [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · 7.RC.1, 7.CC.1, 9-10.RC.1] Look for: The Rhine
4. What does Victor's father want to know? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · 7.RC.1, 7.CC.1, 9-10.RC.1] Look for: Whether Victor loves someone else
5. How is Clerval described in this chapter? [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · 7.RC.1, 7.CC.1, 9-10.RC.1] Look for: Joyful and alive to nature
6. Retell the three most important events of "Chapter XVIII" in order, in one sentence each. [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · 7.RC.1, 7.CC.1, 9-10.RC.1] Look for: Back in Geneva, Victor delays. His father asks whether he loves another; Victor agrees to marry Elizabeth after a trip to England, where he will secretly do his work. He travels with Clerval through Germany and down the Rhine.
7. Which characters appear or are mentioned in "Chapter XVIII"? Name two and one thing each says or does. [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · 7.RC.1, 7.CC.1, 9-10.RC.1] Look for: Names and actions taken from the chapter; check against the teacher summary.
8. Where and when does "Chapter XVIII" take place? Point to the line that tells you. [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · 7.RC.1, 7.CC.1, 9-10.RC.1] Look for: A place/time detail quoted from the chapter.
9. Reread: "My father saw this change with pleasure, and he turned his thoughts towards the best method of eradicating the remains of my melancholy, which every now and then would return by fits, and with a devouring blackness…" What does "eradicating" mean here, and what is literally happening in this line? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · 7.RC.1, 7.CC.1, 9-10.RC.1] Look for: eradicating: removing completely.
10. Reread: "For myself, there was one reward I promised myself from my detested toils—one consolation for my unparalleled sufferings; it was the prospect of that day when, enfranchised from my miserable slavery, I might claim…" What does "enfranchised" mean here, and what is literally happening in this line? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · 7.RC.1, 7.CC.1, 9-10.RC.1] Look for: enfranchised: set free.

Inferential / analytical

1. What does "Chapter XVIII" suggest about delay and dread? State the inference and the line that supports it. [DOK 2 · thinkPairShare · wait 5 s · 7.RC.2, 7.CC.2, 9-10.RC.2] Look for: Clerval's joy in nature contrasts with Victor's dread, heightening tension.
2. Find one example of foreshadowing in this chapter. What does it reveal that a plain statement would not? [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · 7.RC.3, 7.CC.2, 9-10.RC.3] Look for: Look for hints, warnings or images that point to later events.
3. How does the setting in this chapter shape what we understand about delay and dread? [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · 7.RC.3, 7.CC.2, 9-10.RC.1] Look for: Look for where and when events happen and how place shapes action or feeling.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Victor's delay comes from a conflict between fear and revulsion, and it hands the creature power over him. Useful evidence: "I feared the vengeance of the disappointed fiend, yet I was unable to overcome my repugnance to the task which was enjoined me" (Chapter XVIII, paragraph 1): Fear and disgust pull against each other: the source of his delay. Theme link:

Victor feels "an insurmountable barrier" between himself and others. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

4. In the passage that begins “To England, therefore, I was bound, and it was understood that my union with Elizabeth should take place immediately on my return.”, why might Shelley have chosen these particular words? Pick two and explain their connotations. [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · 7.RC.12, 7.CC.2, 9-10.RC.12] Look for: Diction analysis of two words in the anchor passage.
5. What causes the main turn in “Chapter XVIII”, and what effect is it likely to have on what follows? [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · 7.RC.3, 7.CC.2, 9-10.RC.1] Look for: Back in Geneva, Victor delays. His father asks whether he loves another; Victor agrees to marry Elizabeth after a trip to England, where he will secretly do his work. He travels with Clerval through Germany and down the Rhine.
6. How does “Chapter XVIII” build on “Chapter XVII”? Name one link of cause and effect. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · 7.RC.3, 7.CC.2, 9-10.RC.3] Look for: A causal or structural link between this and the previous chapter.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Victor's delay comes from a conflict between fear and revulsion, and it hands the creature power over him. Useful evidence: “the “very poetry of nature” (Chapter XVIII, paragraph 19): Clerval's character; he loves nature directly. Theme link: Victor feels "an insurmountable barrier" between himself and others. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
7. What can we infer about a character's motives from what they say and do here, as opposed to what they claim? [DOK 3 · followUp · wait 8 s · 7.RC.3, 7.CC.2, 9-10.RC.1] Look for: An inference about motive supported by a quoted line.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Victor's delay comes from a conflict between fear and revulsion, and it hands the creature power over him. Useful evidence: “I was the slave of my creature” (Chapter XVIII, paragraph 13): The master has become the slave; a reversal the creature will state aloud in Chapter XX. On characterization: Clerval, a lover of nature and poetry, contrasts with Victor's misery. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
8. The bell-ringer asked: “How does Clerval's attitude toward nature differ from Victor's at this point?” Now that we have read closely, how would you revise your first answer, and which line changed your mind? [DOK 2 · thinkPairShare · wait 5 s · 7.RC.2, 7.CC.2, 9-10.RC.2] Look for: A revised answer anchored in the text.
9. Where does characterization appear, and how does it connect this chapter to the larger concern with nature versus nurture? [DOK 3 · followUp · wait 8 s · 7.RC.3, 7.CC.2, 9-10.RC.1] Look for: Look for what characters say, do and think, and how others react to them.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Victor's delay comes from a conflict between fear and revulsion, and it hands the creature power over him. Useful evidence: “I feared the vengeance of the disappointed fiend, yet I was unable to overcome my repugnance to the task which was enjoined me” (Chapter XVIII, paragraph 1): Fear and disgust pull against each other: the source of his delay. On characterization: Clerval, a lover of nature and poetry, contrasts with Victor's misery. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
10. Background: The Rhine was celebrated for picturesque castles and vineyards in Romantic travel writing. How does knowing this change the way you read one moment in the chapter? [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · 7.RC.3, 7.CC.2, 9-10.RC.1] Look for: A specific moment reread in light of the context.

Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Victor's delay comes from a conflict between fear and revulsion, and it hands the creature power over him. Useful evidence: “the “very poetry of nature” (Chapter XVIII, paragraph 19): Clerval's character; he loves nature directly. Theme link: Victor feels "an insurmountable barrier" between himself and others. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

Evaluative / synthesis / creative

1. A critic might argue: “Clerval's joy in nature contrasts with Victor's dread, heightening tension.” How far do you agree? Take a stand and defend it with two lines from the chapter. [DOK 3 · fourCorners · wait 8 s · 7.RC.2, 7.CC.3, 9-10.RC.2] Look for: A defended position with evidence and one counterpoint.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Victor's delay comes from a conflict between fear and revulsion, and it hands the creature power over him. Useful evidence: “I was the slave of my creature” (Chapter XVIII, paragraph 13): The master has become the slave; a reversal the creature will state aloud in Chapter XX. Theme link: Victor feels "an insurmountable barrier" between himself and others. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
2. Which character in this chapter acts most wisely, and which least? Judge them by a standard you name. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · 7.RC.3, 7.CC.3, 9-10.RC.1] Look for: An evaluation using an explicit criterion and evidence.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Victor's delay comes from a conflict between fear and revulsion, and it hands the creature power over him. Useful evidence: “I feared the vengeance of the disappointed fiend, yet I was unable to overcome my repugnance to the task which was enjoined me” (Chapter XVIII, paragraph 1): Fear and disgust pull against each other: the source of his delay. On characterization: Clerval, a lover of nature and poetry, contrasts with Victor's misery. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
3. Rewrite one moment of “Chapter XVIII” from the point of view of a different character. What does the new angle reveal or hide about delay and dread? [DOK 4 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · 7.RC.1, 7.CC.3, 9-10.RC.1] Look for: A creative product with a rationale tied to the text.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Victor's delay comes from a conflict between fear and revulsion, and it hands the creature power over him. Useful evidence: “the “very poetry of nature” (Chapter XVIII, paragraph 19): Clerval's character; he loves nature directly. Theme link: Victor feels "an insurmountable barrier" between himself and others. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
4. Write three questions of your own about “Chapter XVIII”: one recall, one “why/how”, and one “should/what if”. Trade with a partner and answer theirs. [DOK 3 · studentGenerated · wait 8 s · 7.RC.2, 7.CC.3, 9-10.RC.2] Look for: Student-generated questions at three levels.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Victor's delay comes from a conflict between fear and revulsion, and it hands the creature power over him. Useful evidence: “I was the slave of my creature” (Chapter XVIII, paragraph 13): The master has become the slave; a reversal the creature will state aloud in Chapter XX. Theme link: Victor feels "an insurmountable barrier" between himself and others. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

5. Connect this chapter to the sublime power of nature: is the link strong or weak so far? What would Shelley need to show next to strengthen it? [DOK 4 · socraticCircle · wait 8 s · 7.RC.2, 7.CC.3, 9-10.RC.2] Look for: A judgment of thematic development across the work.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Victor's delay comes from a conflict between fear and revulsion, and it hands the creature power over him. Useful evidence: “I feared the vengeance of the disappointed fiend, yet I was unable to overcome my repugnance to the task which was enjoined me” (Chapter XVIII, paragraph 1): Fear and disgust pull against each other: the source of his delay. Theme link: Victor feels "an insurmountable barrier" between himself and others. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

6. Is the foreshadowing in this chapter effective, or does it feel heavy-handed? Evaluate it as a reader would in a review. [DOK 3 · fourCorners · wait 8 s · 7.RC.3, 7.CC.3, 9-10.RC.3] Look for: An evaluative judgment with criteria and evidence.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Victor's delay comes from a conflict between fear and revulsion, and it hands the creature power over him. Useful evidence: “the “very poetry of nature” (Chapter XVIII, paragraph 19): Clerval's character; he loves nature directly. Theme link: Victor feels "an insurmountable barrier" between himself and others. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

7. Compare how “Chapter XVIII” treats delay and dread with how another text, film or event you know treats a similar idea. What does Frankenstein see that the other misses? [DOK 4 · socraticCircle · wait 8 s · 7.RC.2, 7.CC.3, 9-10.RC.2] Look for: A cross-text synthesis.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Victor's delay comes from a conflict between fear and revulsion, and it hands the creature power over him. Useful evidence: “I was the slave of my creature” (Chapter XVIII, paragraph 13): The master has become the slave; a reversal the creature will state aloud in Chapter XX. Theme link: Victor feels "an insurmountable barrier" between himself and others. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

8. Predict what “Chapter XIX” will bring, using two clues from this chapter. After reading, evaluate your prediction. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · 7.RC.3, 7.CC.3, 9-10.RC.3] Look for: A prediction or judgment justified with textual clues.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Victor's delay comes from a conflict between fear and revulsion, and it hands the creature power over him. Useful evidence: “I feared the vengeance of the disappointed fiend, yet I was unable to overcome my repugnance to the task which was enjoined me” (Chapter XVIII, paragraph 1): Fear and disgust pull against each other: the source of his delay. Theme link: Victor feels "an insurmountable barrier" between himself and others. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

9. Design a one-paragraph modern adaptation of this chapter (setting, characters, conflict). What must stay the same for it to still be about delay and dread? [DOK 4 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · 7.RC.2, 7.CC.3, 9-10.RC.2] Look for: A creative transfer that keeps the core idea.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Victor's delay comes from a conflict between fear and revulsion, and it hands the creature power over him. Useful evidence: “the “very poetry of nature” (Chapter XVIII, paragraph 19): Clerval's character; he loves nature directly. Theme link: Victor feels "an insurmountable barrier" between himself and others. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

10. What question would you most like to ask Mary Shelley about this chapter, and what answer do you think the text itself gives? [DOK 4 · studentGenerated · wait 8 s · 7.RC.2, 7.CC.3, 9-10.RC.2] Look for: A student-generated question answered from evidence.
    Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Victor's delay comes from a conflict between fear and revulsion, and it hands the creature power over him. Useful evidence: “I was the slave of my creature” (Chapter XVIII, paragraph 13): The master has become the slave; a reversal the creature will state aloud in Chapter XX. Theme link: Victor feels "an insurmountable barrier" between himself and others. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

Annotation focus

- **Foreshadowing:** look for hints, warnings or images that point to later events (anchor passage in the We do segment)
- Also notice **Setting**: where and when events happen and how place shapes action or feeling
- Also notice **Characterization**: what characters say, do and think, and how others react to them

Chapter quiz: item bank (all eleven rigor versions)

1. [fill · recall · DOK 1] Fill in the blank with the vocabulary word that fits: “My journey had been my own suggestion, and Elizabeth, therefore, acquiesced: but she was filled with disquiet at the idea of my suffering, away from her, the _____ of misery and grief.” Word bank: enfranchised, eradicating, sedulous, inroads
   Key: inroads
2. [mc · recall · DOK 1] In the line “My father saw this change with pleasure, and he turned his thoughts towards the best method of eradicating the remains of my melancholy, which every now and then would return by fits, and with a devouring blackness…”, what does “eradicating” most nearly mean?
   A. increase
   B. used on the high seas
   C. provide commentary for a film, for example
   D. removing completely

   Key: D (removing completely)
3. [mc · recall · DOK 1] Who travels with him?
   A. Justine
   B. Elizabeth
   C. Ernest
   D. Clerval

   Key: D (Clerval)
4. [mc · recall · DOK 1] In the line “It had been her care which provided me a companion in Clerval—and yet a man is blind to a thousand minute circumstances, which call forth a woman’s sedulous attention.”, what does “sedulous” most nearly mean?
   A. cunning; craftiness
   B. careful and persistent
   C. the ritual placing of a corpse in a grave

D. shared with others

Key: B (careful and persistent)

5. [mc · recall · DOK 1] Why does Victor travel to England?

   A. To meet Walton

   B. To create the female in secret

   C. To visit his mother

   D. To study law

   Key: B (To create the female in secret)

6. [fill · recall · DOK 1] Fill in the blank with the vocabulary word that fits: “The latter method of obtaining the desired intelligence was _____ and unsatisfactory: besides, I had an insurmountable aversion to the idea of engaging myself in my loathsome task in my father’s house, while in habits of familiar intercourse with those I…” Word bank: eradicating, sedulous, enfranchised, dilatory

   Key: dilatory

7. [fill · recall · DOK 1] Fill in the blank with the vocabulary word that fits: “I was aware also that I should often lose all self-command, all capacity of hiding the _____ sensations that would possess me during the progress of my unearthly occupation.” Word bank: enfranchised, eradicating, sedulous, harrowing

   Key: harrowing

8. [mc · recall · DOK 1] What does Victor's father want to know?

   A. Whether he is ill

   B. Where the creature is

   C. If he needs money

   D. Whether Victor loves someone else

   Key: D (Whether Victor loves someone else)

9. [fill · recall · DOK 1] Complete the quotation from Chapter XVIII, paragraph 1: “I feared the vengeance of the _____ fiend, yet I was unable to overcome my repugnance to the task which was enjoined me”

   Key: disappointed

10. [short · inference · DOK 2] What can you infer from this line? “the “very poetry of nature” (Chapter XVIII, paragraph 19) Answer in two or three sentences with one detail.

    Sample answer: Clerval's character; he loves nature directly.

11. [mc · inference · DOK 2] What does this passage most clearly show? “I was the slave of my creature” (Chapter XVIII, paragraph 13)

    A. The master has become the slave; a reversal the creature will state aloud in Chapter XX.

    B. The wish to belong.

    C. Blunt, short sentence in the father's letter.

    D. Simile for knowledge that cannot be unlearned.

    Key: A (The master has become the slave; a reversal the creature will state aloud in Chapter XX.)

12. [mc · inference · DOK 2] Which choice best states a central concern of “Chapter XVIII”?

    A. Isolation in the north

    B. Injustice and the burden of silence

    C. Delay and dread

D. Language, knowledge and sorrow

Key: C (Delay and dread)

13. [mc · inference · DOK 2] What does this passage most clearly show? “I feared the vengeance of the disappointed fiend, yet I was unable to overcome my repugnance to the task which was enjoined me” (Chapter XVIII, paragraph 1)

A. Fear and disgust pull against each other: the source of his delay.

B. Possessive language; evidence for a claim about Victor's self-centeredness.

C. Victor concludes guilt from appearance, as others will judge the creature.

D. The heart of Victor's ambition: more than anyone before.

Key: A (Fear and disgust pull against each other: the source of his delay.)

14. [short · analysis · DOK 3] Analyze the word choice in “I was the slave of my creature” (Chapter XVIII, paragraph 13). Pick two words and explain what they suggest.

Sample answer: The master has become the slave; a reversal the creature will state aloud in Chapter XX.

15. [mc · analysis · DOK 3] Which literary element does this describe in “Chapter XVIII”? Clerval, a lover of nature and poetry, contrasts with Victor's misery.

A. Personification

B. Irony

C. Characterization

D. Metaphor

Key: C (Characterization)

16. [short · synthesis · DOK 4] Evaluate this claim about the chapter: “Victor's delay comes from a conflict between fear and revulsion, and it hands the creature power over him.” Is it fully persuasive? Argue with evidence, including a passage that complicates it.

Sample answer: He fears "the vengeance of the disappointed fiend" but cannot overcome his "repugnance to the task," and so he drifts; by his own admission he becomes "the slave of my creature."

17. [mc · recall · DOK 1] In the line “In one spot you view rugged hills, ruined castles overlooking tremendous precipices, with the dark Rhine rushing beneath; and, on the sudden turn of a promontory, flourishing vineyards, with green sloping banks, and a…”, what does “meandering” most nearly mean?

A. winding; following a curving course

B. weakened

C. instruments that make distant objects look closer

D. huge slow-moving masses of ice

Key: A (winding; following a curving course)

18. [mc · recall · DOK 1] In the line “For myself, there was one reward I promised myself from my detested toils—one consolation for my unparalleled sufferings; it was the prospect of that day when, enfranchised from my miserable slavery, I might claim…”, what does “enfranchised” most nearly mean?

A. oriented toward home

B. a wooden floor laid in a pattern

C. treated lightly; toyed with

D. set free

Key: D (set free)

19. [mc · recall · DOK 1] What river do they travel along?

    A. The Rhine

    B. The Seine

    C. The Danube

    D. The Thames

    Key: A (The Rhine)

20. [short · inference · DOK 2] What can you infer from this line? “I feared the vengeance of the disappointed fiend, yet I was unable to overcome my repugnance to the task which was enjoined me” (Chapter XVIII, paragraph 1) Answer in two or three sentences with one detail.

    Sample answer: Fear and disgust pull against each other: the source of his delay.

21. [short · analysis · DOK 3] Claim: Victor's delay comes from a conflict between fear and revulsion, and it hands the creature power over him. Explain how this evidence supports the claim: “I feared the vengeance of the disappointed fiend, yet I was unable to overcome my repugnance to the task which was enjoined me” (Chapter XVIII, paragraph 1).

    Sample answer: He fears "the vengeance of the disappointed fiend" but cannot overcome his "repugnance to the task," and so he drifts; by his own admission he becomes "the slave of my creature."

22. [mc · analysis · DOK 3] Which literary element does this describe in “Chapter XVIII”? Victor delays: fear of the creature's revenge against disgust at the work, while his father presses for marriage to Elizabeth.

    A. Setting

    B. Theme

    C. Conflict

    D. Simile

    Key: C (Conflict)

23. [short · synthesis · DOK 4] Close reading: how do the diction and syntax of “the “very poetry of nature” (Chapter XVIII, paragraph 19) shape its meaning? Consider a second, competing reading.

    Sample answer: Clerval's character; he loves nature directly.

24. [fill · recall · DOK 1] Complete the quotation from Chapter XVIII, paragraph 13: “I was the slave of my _____”

    Key: creature

25. [fill · recall · DOK 1] Fill in the blank with the vocabulary word that fits: “Oh, surely, the spirit that _____ and guards this place has a soul more in harmony with man, than those who pile the glacier, or retire to the inaccessible peaks of the mountains of our own country.”” Word bank: inhabits, eradicating, sedulous, enfranchised

    Key: inhabits

26. [mc · inference · DOK 2] What does this passage most clearly show? “the “very poetry of nature” (Chapter XVIII, paragraph 19)

    A. Clerval's character; he loves nature directly.

    B. "Unhallowed" means unholy, and "thing" refuses the creation a name. Students can use this to argue that the novel judges the act of creation as a transgression from its first image.

    C. Ambiguity ("shape of a man") makes the creature's humanity a question from his first appearance.

    D. "Necessary": sympathy as a need like food.

Key: A (Clerval's character; he loves nature directly.)

27. [short · synthesis · DOK 4] Synthesis: trace how isolation and companionship develops from an earlier chapter to “Chapter XVIII”. Use one quotation from each.

    Sample answer: Victor feels "an insurmountable barrier" between himself and others.

28. [short · synthesis · DOK 4] Close reading: how do the diction and syntax of “I feared the vengeance of the disappointed fiend, yet I was unable to overcome my repugnance to the task which was enjoined me” (Chapter XVIII, paragraph 1) shape its meaning? Consider a second, competing reading.

    Sample answer: Fear and disgust pull against each other: the source of his delay.

Rigor version	Items (in order)	Mix
Middle School	1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 6, 7, 8, 9, 10, 11, 12, 13, 14, 15, 16	recall 9, inference 4, analysis 2, synthesis 1
HS Freshman	17, 18, 4, 6, 8, 19, 2, 7, 12, 20, 10, 11, 21, 22, 15, 23	recall 8, inference 4, analysis 3, synthesis 1
HS Sophomore	2, 1, 19, 9, 24, 25, 13, 11, 10, 20, 26, 14, 21, 22, 23, 27	recall 6, inference 5, analysis 3, synthesis 2
HS Junior	9, 19, 8, 5, 6, 26, 10, 11, 20, 12, 21, 14, 15, 22, 23, 16	recall 5, inference 5, analysis 4, synthesis 2
HS Senior	6, 25, 2, 8, 13, 10, 26, 20, 11, 21, 15, 22, 14, 23, 28, 27	recall 4, inference 5, analysis 4, synthesis 3
AP	6, 25, 19, 13, 26, 20, 10, 12, 22, 15, 14, 21, 28, 16, 27, 23	recall 3, inference 5, analysis 4, synthesis 4
College Freshman	7, 6, 8, 26, 12, 20, 10, 11, 15, 22, 14, 21, 27, 16, 28, 23	recall 3, inference 5, analysis 4, synthesis 4
College Sophomore	6, 1, 26, 10, 20, 11, 12, 13, 21, 22, 14, 15, 27, 16, 28, 23	recall 2, inference 6, analysis 4, synthesis 4
College Junior	1, 24, 13, 26, 20, 11, 12, 10, 21, 14, 15, 22, 28, 27, 23, 16	recall 2, inference 6, analysis 4, synthesis 4
College Senior	6, 25, 13, 11, 20, 10, 26, 12, 21, 15, 22, 14, 28, 27, 16, 23	recall 2, inference 6, analysis 4, synthesis 4
Graduate / PhD	6, 24, 11, 12, 26, 10, 13, 20, 22, 14, 15, 21, 23, 28, 16, 27	recall 2, inference 6, analysis 4, synthesis 4

Writing prompts (eleven rigor levels)

Middle School (250 words; Indiana 2023: 7.RC.3, 7.W.1): Supported track (work from the passage your teacher selects). In “Chapter XVIII,” how does Shelley show delay and dread? Write a paragraph that states your claim, quotes two details from the passage, and explains how each detail supports your idea. Use the foreshadowing you noticed as one piece of evidence.

HS Freshman (350 words; Indiana 2023: 9-10.RC.3, 9-10.W.1): In Chapter XVIII, how does Shelley develop the idea of delay and dread? State a clear claim, support it with two or three quotations, and explain how the foreshadowing in the chapter helps build that idea.

HS Sophomore (450 words; Indiana 2023: 9-10.RC.3, 9-10.W.1): Analyze how Chapter XVIII develops the idea of delay and dread. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of foreshadowing and setting shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.

HS Junior (550 words; Indiana 2023: 11-12.RC.3, 11-12.RC.1, 11-12.W.1): Analyze how the structure of Chapter XVIII (where it begins, turns and ends) and its foreshadowing shape the reader's understanding of delay and dread. Identify one place where the text leaves matters uncertain and explain how that uncertainty adds to its meaning.

HS Senior (600 words; Indiana 2023: 11-12.RC.3, 11-12.W.1): Two readers disagree about what Chapter XVIII suggests about delay and dread. Lay out two plausible interpretations, weigh the evidence for each (including the chapter's foreshadowing and setting), and argue for the stronger one in a sustained, well-organized essay.

AP (650 words; Indiana 2023: 11-12.RC.3, 11-12.W.1): Write a literary argument in which you analyze how Mary Shelley uses foreshadowing in Chapter XVIII to complicate the reader's understanding of delay and dread. Develop a defensible thesis, select evidence purposefully, and explain how specific choices of diction and syntax create meaning.

College Freshman (1000 words; Indiana 2023: see unit standards): Situate Chapter XVIII within its historical and literary context and argue how the chapter's treatment of delay and dread responds to that context. Engage with at least one secondary perspective (a critic, historian or the author's own statements), integrate quotations smoothly, and cite in MLA style.

College Sophomore (1250 words; Indiana 2023: see unit standards): Read Chapter XVIII alongside the conventions of its genre and period. Argue how the chapter's handling of delay and dread follows or bends those conventions, using the foreshadowing as evidence, and test your reading against one published critic. Document two secondary sources in MLA.

College Junior (1500 words; Indiana 2023: see unit standards): Apply a named critical approach (for example formalist, historicist, feminist, psychoanalytic or ecocritical) to Chapter XVIII and its treatment of delay and dread. State your method, show what it reveals in the chapter's foreshadowing and setting, and identify where the text resists it.

College Senior (2000 words; Indiana 2023: see unit standards): Develop a research argument that reads Chapter XVIII as evidence for a larger claim about delay and dread in Frankenstein. Connect close reading of the chapter to the whole novel, engage at least four scholarly sources, and state precisely where your reading departs from theirs (Chicago style).

Graduate / PhD (2500 words; Indiana 2023: see unit standards): Develop an original argument that reads Chapter XVIII as a hinge in the novel's larger treatment of delay and dread. Position your reading within a named critical conversation (for example formalist, historicist, psychoanalytic, feminist or postcolonial approaches), account for the textual history where relevant, and articulate the stakes of your intervention for scholarship on Frankenstein.

SAT-style questions

1. *It had been her care which provided me a companion in Clerval—and yet a man is blind to a thousand minute circumstances, which call forth a woman's sedulous attention.*

   As used in the text, what does the word "sedulous" most nearly mean?

   A. careful and persistent
   B. varied in color or appearance
   C. never seen before; unequaled
   D. deeply distressing

2. *To England, therefore, I was bound, and it was understood that my union with Elizabeth should take place immediately on my return. My father's age rendered him extremely averse to delay. For myself, there was one reward I promised myself from my detested toils—one consolation for my unparalleled sufferings; it was the prospect of that day when, enfranchised from my miserable slavery, I might claim Elizabeth, and forget the past in my union with her.*

   Which choice best states a central concern of "Chapter XVIII"?

   A. Confrontation between creator and creation
   B. Delay and dread
   C. Confidence before danger
   D. Reading and identity

SAT key: 1. A (careful and persistent); 2. B (Delay and dread)

Lesson 26: Chapter XIX

Focus: isolation in the north

Objective: Students will analyze how setting develops in “Chapter XIX” by writing a claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph that cites at least 2 quotations from the section, and will score at least 80% on the section quiz.

Standards: CCSS RL.9-10.3, W.9-10.1, L.9-10.4 · IN 9-10.RC.1, 9-10.W.1, 9-10.RC.9, 9-10.RC.11

Teacher only · spoilers

In London, Oxford and later Scotland, Victor gathers knowledge, then leaves Clerval and goes alone to a remote Orkney island to build the female creature, working in misery.

Background: Oxford's association with the English Civil War and the poet-patriot John Hampden is mentioned.

Significance: The bleak island mirrors Victor's isolation and moral desolation.

Lesson plan and lecture script (90 minutes)

0–8 min · Bell-ringer · You do (8 min)
Students write to the bell-ringer, then pair-share.
Why does Victor choose such a desolate place? Write for five minutes. Starters: I think... because... / This connects to creation and responsibility because....
Prompt: Why does Victor choose such a desolate place?
Sentence starters: I think… because… · This connects to creation and responsibility because…
Strong response: A strong response takes a position and anticipates this: making a second being makes him think about consequences, at last.

8–18 min · Vocabulary with etymology notes · I do (10 min)
Five key words in context, with verified word histories.
Today's words: expedite — to speed up; to hasten; roarings — loud, deep sounds; debasing — degrading; lowering in dignity; oatmeal — porridge made of rolled oats; scraggy — being very thin. “expedite”: From Latin expedītus "unimpeded, unfettered", perfect passive participle of expediō "bring forward, set right". “roarings”: By surface analysis, roar + -ing. “debasing”: From de + base, from Old French bas, from Latin bassus. Cognate with Spanish debajo "under, beneath, below". Compare abase. “oatmeal”: From Middle English otemele, from ote "oat" + mele "meal, coarse-ground grains". Equivalent to oat + meal<id:from milling-related origins>.
Words: expedite: to speed up; to hasten · roarings: loud, deep sounds · debasing: degrading; lowering in dignity · oatmeal: porridge made of rolled oats · scraggy: being very thin

18–28 min · Background and context · I do (10 min)
Mini-lecture (read or adapt the script).
Oxford's association with the English Civil War and the poet-patriot John Hampden is mentioned. The bleak island mirrors Victor's isolation and moral desolation. Setting: The remote Orkneys: bleak and barren, matching his work and mind. Imagery: "I am a blasted tree": recalling the lightning-struck oak. Characterization: Victor works with sickened heart, unable to share his burden. Watch for sublime nature: Mountains, glaciers, storms and lakes reflect and sometimes soothe the characters' feelings; the sublime is both comfort and terror. In this chapter: "and I, although I abhorred society, wished to view again mountains and streams, and all the wondrous works with which Nature adorns" (Chapter XIX, paragraph 4).

28–40 min · I do: modeled close reading · I do (12 min)
Model the close reading of the anchor quotation using the written think-aloud below.
I read the line once for meaning and once for craft. "my heart often sickened at the work of my hands" (Chapter XIX, paragraph 21). Revulsion at his labor. That is setting at work: The remote Orkneys: bleak and barren, matching his work and mind.

> *my heart often sickened at the work of my hands* (Chapter XIX, paragraph 21)

Think-aloud: I read the line once for meaning and once for craft. "my heart often sickened at the work of my hands" (Chapter XIX, paragraph 21). Revulsion at his labor. That is setting at work: The remote Orkneys: bleak and barren, matching his work and mind.

40–55 min · We do: guided annotation · We do (15 min)
Guided analysis of a second quotation; expected answers given.
Ask: What words in this line stand out, and what do they suggest? Expected: The blasted tree was destroyed by lightning; Victor is destroyed by his discovery. Symbol from Chapter II returns. Ask: How does this line connect to creation and responsibility? Expected: Making a second being makes him think about consequences, at last. (Metaphor tying his ruin to the blasted oak.)

> *I am a blasted tree; the bolt has entered my soul* (Chapter XIX, paragraph 8)

Ask: What words in this line stand out, and what do they suggest?
Expected answer: The blasted tree was destroyed by lightning; Victor is destroyed by his discovery. Symbol from Chapter II returns.
Ask: How does this line connect to creation and responsibility?
Expected answer: Making a second being makes him think about consequences, at last. (Metaphor tying his ruin to the blasted oak.)

55–70 min · You do: independent annotation · You do (15 min)

Independent annotation and a claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph (exemplar given).

Annotate the chapter for setting, imagery (three marks with a margin note each), then write one claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph: what does this chapter suggest about isolation in the north? Then start your writing prompt at your assigned level (HS Sophomore: Analyze how Chapter XIX develops the idea of isolation in the north. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of setting and tone / mood shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.) Exemplar: Victor's second act of creation is joyless because he now sees its consequences. When the text says “my heart often sickened at the work of my hands” (Chapter XIX, paragraph 21), it shows this directly. He says his "heart often sickened at the work of my hands," a sharp contrast to the rapture of the first creation, which shows responsibility arriving too late.

Task: Annotate the chapter for setting, imagery (three marks with a margin note each), then write one claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph: what does this chapter suggest about isolation in the north? Then start your writing prompt at your assigned level (HS Sophomore: Analyze how Chapter XIX develops the idea of isolation in the north. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of setting and tone / mood shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.)

Exemplar: Victor's second act of creation is joyless because he now sees its consequences. When the text says “my heart often sickened at the work of my hands” (Chapter XIX, paragraph 21), it shows this directly. He says his "heart often sickened at the work of my hands," a sharp contrast to the rapture of the first creation, which shows responsibility arriving too late.

70–80 min · Discussion · We do (10 min)

Structured discussion from the 30 tiered questions, with facilitation notes.

Anchor question: Why does Victor choose such a desolate place? Ask whether Victor has changed since Chapter IV. What evidence shows growth or its lack?

Anchor question: Why does Victor choose such a desolate place?

Facilitation: Ask whether Victor has changed since Chapter IV. What evidence shows growth or its lack?

80–87 min · Exit ticket / chapter quiz · You do (7 min)

Chapter quiz in the app and an exit ticket (answer given).

Chapter quiz in the app, then: In one sentence, what does this chapter suggest about isolation in the north? Support it with one short quotation. Model answer: Victor's second act of creation is joyless because he now sees its consequences. (“my heart often sickened at the work of my hands”, Chapter XIX, paragraph 21). Accept any defensible claim backed by a quotation from the chapter; the answer key for the quiz is in the Quiz section.

Exit ticket: In one sentence, what does this chapter suggest about isolation in the north? Support it with one short quotation.

Answer: Model answer: Victor's second act of creation is joyless because he now sees its consequences. (“my heart often sickened at the work of my hands”, Chapter XIX, paragraph 21). Accept any defensible claim backed by a quotation from the chapter; the answer key for the quiz is in the Quiz section.

> **87–90 min · Closure · I do (3 min)**
> Summarize the lesson and preview the next reading.
> *Today we saw how setting shapes isolation in the north. Key takeaway: making a second being makes him think about consequences, at last.*

Total: 90 minutes.

Teacher analysis (spoilers)

Literary elements

- **Setting:** The remote Orkneys: bleak and barren, matching his work and mind.
- **Imagery:** "I am a blasted tree": recalling the lightning-struck oak.
- **Characterization:** Victor works with sickened heart, unable to share his burden.

Themes and how they develop

- **creation and responsibility:** making a second being makes him think about consequences, at last.

Symbols and motifs

- **sublime nature:** Mountains, glaciers, storms and lakes reflect and sometimes soothe the characters' feelings; the sublime is both comfort and terror. In this chapter: “and I, although I abhorred society, wished to view again mountains and streams, and all the wondrous works with which Nature adorns” (Chapter XIX, paragraph 4).
- **naming the creature:** Victor never names his creation; the words he uses (wretch, daemon, fiend, monster) show his rejection and shape the reader's view. In this chapter: “for some time, and I feared the effects of the daemon’s disappointment. He might remain in Switzerland, and wreak his vengeance on” (Chapter XIX, paragraph 13).

Key quotations (checked against the reading text)

- “I am a blasted tree; the bolt has entered my soul” (Chapter XIX, paragraph 8) Metaphor tying his ruin to the blasted oak.
- “my heart often sickened at the work of my hands” (Chapter XIX, paragraph 21) Revulsion at his labor.
- “In this retreat I devoted the morning to labour” (Chapter XIX, paragraph 20) The isolation of work.

Model claim-evidence-reasoning

Claim: Victor's second act of creation is joyless because he now sees its consequences.
Evidence: “my heart often sickened at the work of my hands” (Chapter XIX, paragraph 21)
Reasoning: He says his "heart often sickened at the work of my hands," a sharp contrast to the rapture of the first creation, which shows responsibility arriving too late.

Vocabulary with etymology notes

Word	Definition (in this sentence)	In context	Word history
expedite (verb)	to speed up; to hasten	*Sometimes I thought that the fiend followed me, and might expedite my remissness by murdering my companion.*	“expedite”: From Latin expedītus "unimpeded, unfettered", perfect passive participle of expediō "bring forward, set right". (Wiktionary, https://en.wiktionary.org/wiki/expedite#Etymology)
roarings (noun)	loud, deep sounds	*Its fair lakes reflect a blue and gentle sky; and, when troubled by the winds, their tumult is but as the play of a lively infant, when compared to the roarings of the giant ocean.*	“roarings”: By surface analysis, roar + -ing. (Wiktionary, https://en.wiktionary.org/wiki/roaring#Etymology)
debasing (adjective)	degrading; lowering in dignity	*For a moment my soul was elevated from its debasing and miserable fears, to contemplate the divine ideas of liberty and self-sacrifice, of which these sights were the monuments and the remembrancers.*	“debasing”: From de + base, from Old French bas, from Latin bassus. Cognate with Spanish debajo "under, beneath, below". Compare abase. (Wiktionary, https://en.wiktionary.org/wiki/debase#Etymology)
oatmeal (noun)	porridge made of rolled oats	*The soil was barren, scarcely affording pasture for a few miserable cows, and oatmeal for its inhabitants, which consisted of five persons, whose gaunt and scraggy limbs gave tokens of their miserable fare.*	“oatmeal”: From Middle English otemele, from ote "oat" + mele "meal, coarse-ground grains". Equivalent to oat + meal<id:from milling-related origins>. (Wiktionary, https://en.wiktionary.org/wiki/oatmeal#Etymology)
scraggy (adjective)	being very thin	*The soil was barren, scarcely affording pasture for a few miserable cows, and oatmeal for its inhabitants, which consisted of five persons, whose gaunt and scraggy limbs gave tokens of their miserable fare.*	
engages (verb)	holds (attention)	*His feelings are forever on the stretch; and when he begins to sink into repose, he finds himself obliged to quit that on which he rests in pleasure for something new, which again engages his attention, and which also he forsakes for other novelties.*	
intermixed (verb)	combine into one	*I looked towards its completion with a tremulous and eager hope, which I dared not trust myself to question, but which was intermixed with obscure*	

		forebodings of evil, that made my heart sicken in my bosom.	
highlands (noun)	hilly or mountainous country	*I packed up my chemical instruments, and the materials I had collected, resolving to finish my labours in some obscure nook in the northern highlands of Scotland.*	
forsakes (verb)	gives up; abandons	*His feelings are forever on the stretch; and when he begins to sink into repose, he finds himself obliged to quit that on which he rests in pleasure for something new, which again engages his attention, and which also he forsakes for other novelties.*	
remonstrate (verb)	argue in protest or opposition	*Henry wished to dissuade me; but, seeing me bent on this plan, ceased to remonstrate.*	"remonstrate": From (the participle stem of) Late Latin remōnstrō, from Latin re- + mōnstrō. (Wiktionary, https://en.wiktionary.org/wiki/remonstrate#Etymology)

Discussion questions

1. Why does Victor choose such a desolate place?
2. Where does setting appear in this chapter, and what effect does it have? Point to one passage.
3. How does this chapter connect to the book's larger concern with the sublime power of nature?

Classroom discussion questions (30, tiered)

Wait time after every question (3 s for DOK 1, 5 s for DOK 2, 8 to 10 s for DOK 3 and 4); think-pair-share on DOK 3 and 4; answer each response with a follow-up probe; close with student-generated questions. Focus sets by rigor level: Middle School: 1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 6, 11, 12, 13, 14, 21, 22; HS Freshman: 1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 12, 13, 14, 15, 22, 23, 24; HS Sophomore: 1, 2, 3, 4, 13, 14, 15, 16, 17, 23, 24, 25; HS Junior: 1, 2, 3, 14, 15, 16, 17, 18, 24, 25, 26, 27; HS Senior: 1, 2, 3, 15, 16, 17, 18, 25, 26, 27, 28, 29; AP: 1, 2, 16, 17, 18, 19, 20, 26, 27, 28, 29, 30; College Freshman: 1, 2, 17, 18, 19, 20, 21, 22, 27, 28, 29, 30; College Sophomore: 1, 2, 11, 18, 19, 20, 21, 22, 23, 28, 29, 30; College Junior: 1, 11, 12, 19, 20, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 29, 30; College Senior: 1, 11, 12, 13, 20, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 26, 30; Graduate / PhD: 1, 11, 12, 13, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 26, 27, 28

Literal / recall

1. Where does Victor work on the second creature? [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · 7.RC.1, 7.CC.1, 9-10.RC.1] Look for: A remote island in the Orkneys
2. Who does he leave behind? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · 7.RC.1, 7.CC.1, 9-10.RC.1] Look for: Clerval
3. What is Victor's mood while working? [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · 7.RC.1, 7.CC.1, 9-10.RC.1] Look for: Miserable and filled with dread
4. Which English city prompts thoughts of history? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · 7.RC.1, 7.CC.1, 9-10.RC.1] Look for: Oxford

5. What does the desolate setting mirror? [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · 7.RC.1, 7.CC.1, 9-10.RC.1] Look for: Victor's inner isolation
6. Retell the three most important events of “Chapter XIX” in order, in one sentence each. [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · 7.RC.1, 7.CC.1, 9-10.RC.1] Look for: In London, Oxford and later Scotland, Victor gathers knowledge, then leaves Clerval and goes alone to a remote Orkney island to build the female creature, working in misery.
7. Which characters appear or are mentioned in “Chapter XIX”? Name two and one thing each says or does. [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · 7.RC.1, 7.CC.1, 9-10.RC.1] Look for: Names and actions taken from the chapter; check against the teacher summary.
8. Where and when does “Chapter XIX” take place? Point to the line that tells you. [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · 7.RC.1, 7.CC.1, 9-10.RC.1] Look for: A place/time detail quoted from the chapter.
9. Reread: “Sometimes I thought that the fiend followed me, and might expedite my remissness by murdering my companion.” What does “expedite” mean here, and what is literally happening in this line? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · 7.RC.1, 7.CC.1, 9-10.RC.1] Look for: expedite: to speed up; to hasten.
10. Reread: “Its fair lakes reflect a blue and gentle sky; and, when troubled by the winds, their tumult is but as the play of a lively infant, when compared to the roarings of the giant ocean.” What does “roarings” mean here, and what is literally happening in this line? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · 7.RC.1, 7.CC.1, 9-10.RC.1] Look for: roarings: loud, deep sounds.

Inferential / analytical

1. What does “Chapter XIX” suggest about isolation in the north? State the inference and the line that supports it. [DOK 2 · thinkPairShare · wait 5 s · 7.RC.2, 7.CC.2, 9-10.RC.2] Look for: The bleak island mirrors Victor's isolation and moral desolation.
2. Find one example of setting in this chapter. What does it reveal that a plain statement would not? [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · 7.RC.3, 7.CC.2, 9-10.RC.1] Look for: Look for where and when events happen and how place shapes action or feeling.
3. How does the tone / mood in this chapter shape what we understand about isolation in the north? [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · 7.RC.12, 7.CC.2, 9-10.RC.12] Look for: Look for word choices that reveal the narrator's attitude or the scene's feeling.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Victor's second act of creation is joyless because he now sees its consequences. Useful evidence: “I am a blasted tree; the bolt has entered my soul” (Chapter XIX, paragraph 8): Metaphor tying his ruin to the blasted oak. Theme link: making a second being makes him think about consequences, at last. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
4. In the passage that begins “We had arrived in England at the beginning of October, and it was now February.”, why might Shelley have chosen these particular words? Pick two and explain their connotations. [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · 7.RC.12, 7.CC.2, 9-10.RC.12] Look for: Diction analysis of two words in the anchor passage.
5. What causes the main turn in “Chapter XIX”, and what effect is it likely to have on what follows? [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · 7.RC.3, 7.CC.2, 9-10.RC.1] Look for: In London, Oxford and later Scotland, Victor gathers knowledge, then leaves Clerval and goes alone to a remote Orkney island to build the female creature, working in misery.
6. How does “Chapter XIX” build on “Chapter XVIII”? Name one link of cause and effect. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · 7.RC.3, 7.CC.2, 9-10.RC.3] Look for: A causal or structural link between this and the previous

chapter.

Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Victor's second act of creation is joyless because he now sees its consequences. Useful evidence: “my heart often sickened at the work of my hands” (Chapter XIX, paragraph 21): Revulsion at his labor. Theme link: making a second being makes him think about consequences, at last. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

7. What can we infer about a character's motives from what they say and do here, as opposed to what they claim? [DOK 3 · followUp · wait 8 s · 7.RC.3, 7.CC.2, 9-10.RC.1] Look for: An inference about motive supported by a quoted line.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Victor's second act of creation is joyless because he now sees its consequences. Useful evidence: “In this retreat I devoted the morning to labour” (Chapter XIX, paragraph 20): The isolation of work. On characterization: Victor works with sickened heart, unable to share his burden. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

8. The bell-ringer asked: “Why does Victor choose such a desolate place?” Now that we have read closely, how would you revise your first answer, and which line changed your mind? [DOK 2 · thinkPairShare · wait 5 s · 7.RC.2, 7.CC.2, 9-10.RC.2] Look for: A revised answer anchored in the text.

9. Where does foreshadowing appear, and how does it connect this chapter to the larger concern with the sublime power of nature? [DOK 3 · followUp · wait 8 s · 7.RC.3, 7.CC.2, 9-10.RC.3] Look for: Look for hints, warnings or images that point to later events.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Victor's second act of creation is joyless because he now sees its consequences. Useful evidence: “I am a blasted tree; the bolt has entered my soul” (Chapter XIX, paragraph 8): Metaphor tying his ruin to the blasted oak. Theme link: making a second being makes him think about consequences, at last. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

10. Background: Oxford's association with the English Civil War and the poet-patriot John Hampden is mentioned. How does knowing this change the way you read one moment in the chapter? [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · 7.RC.3, 7.CC.2, 9-10.RC.1] Look for: A specific moment reread in light of the context.

    Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Victor's second act of creation is joyless because he now sees its consequences. Useful evidence: “my heart often sickened at the work of my hands” (Chapter XIX, paragraph 21): Revulsion at his labor. On setting: The remote Orkneys: bleak and barren, matching his work and mind. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

Evaluative / synthesis / creative

1. A critic might argue: “The bleak island mirrors Victor's isolation and moral desolation.” How far do you agree? Take a stand and defend it with two lines from the chapter. [DOK 3 · fourCorners · wait 8 s · 7.RC.2, 7.CC.3, 9-10.RC.2] Look for: A defended position with evidence and one counterpoint.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Victor's second act of creation is joyless because he now sees its consequences. Useful evidence: “In this retreat I devoted the morning to labour” (Chapter XIX, paragraph 20): The isolation of work. Theme link: making a second being makes him think about consequences, at last. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

2. Which character in this chapter acts most wisely, and which least? Judge them by a standard you name. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · 7.RC.3, 7.CC.3, 9-10.RC.1] Look for: An evaluation using an explicit criterion and evidence.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Victor's second act of creation is joyless because he now sees its consequences. Useful evidence: “I am a blasted tree; the bolt has entered my soul” (Chapter XIX, paragraph 8): Metaphor tying his ruin to the blasted oak. On characterization: Victor works with sickened heart, unable to share his burden. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
3. Rewrite one moment of “Chapter XIX” from the point of view of a different character. What does the new angle reveal or hide about isolation in the north? [DOK 4 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · 7.RC.1, 7.CC.3, 9-10.RC.1] Look for: A creative product with a rationale tied to the text.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Victor's second act of creation is joyless because he now sees its consequences. Useful evidence: “my heart often sickened at the work of my hands” (Chapter XIX, paragraph 21): Revulsion at his labor. Theme link: making a second being makes him think about consequences, at last. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
4. Write three questions of your own about “Chapter XIX”: one recall, one “why/how”, and one “should/what if”. Trade with a partner and answer theirs. [DOK 3 · studentGenerated · wait 8 s · 7.RC.2, 7.CC.3, 9-10.RC.2] Look for: Student-generated questions at three levels.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Victor's second act of creation is joyless because he now sees its consequences. Useful evidence: “In this retreat I devoted the morning to labour” (Chapter XIX, paragraph 20): The isolation of work. Theme link: making a second being makes him think about consequences, at last. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
5. Connect this chapter to the costs of unchecked ambition: is the link strong or weak so far? What would Shelley need to show next to strengthen it? [DOK 4 · socraticCircle · wait 8 s · 7.RC.2, 7.CC.3, 9-10.RC.2] Look for: A judgment of thematic development across the work.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Victor's second act of creation is joyless because he now sees its consequences. Useful evidence: “I am a blasted tree; the bolt has entered my soul” (Chapter XIX, paragraph 8): Metaphor tying his ruin to the blasted oak. Theme link: making a second being makes him think about consequences, at last. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
6. Is the setting in this chapter effective, or does it feel heavy-handed? Evaluate it as a reader would in a review. [DOK 3 · fourCorners · wait 8 s · 7.RC.3, 7.CC.3, 9-10.RC.1] Look for: An evaluative judgment with criteria and evidence.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Victor's second act of creation is joyless because he now sees its consequences. Useful evidence: “my heart often sickened at the work of my hands” (Chapter XIX, paragraph 21): Revulsion at his labor. On setting: The remote Orkneys: bleak and barren, matching his work and mind. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
7. Compare how “Chapter XIX” treats isolation in the north with how another text, film or event you know treats a similar idea. What does Frankenstein see that the other misses? [DOK 4 · socraticCircle · wait 8 s · 7.RC.2, 7.CC.3, 9-10.RC.2] Look for: A cross-text synthesis.

Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Victor's second act of creation is joyless because he now sees its consequences. Useful evidence: “In this retreat I devoted the morning to labour” (Chapter XIX, paragraph 20): The isolation of work. Theme link: making a second being makes him think about consequences, at last. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

8. Predict what “Chapter XX” will bring, using two clues from this chapter. After reading, evaluate your prediction. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · 7.RC.3, 7.CC.3, 9-10.RC.3] Look for: A prediction or judgment justified with textual clues.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Victor's second act of creation is joyless because he now sees its consequences. Useful evidence: “I am a blasted tree; the bolt has entered my soul” (Chapter XIX, paragraph 8): Metaphor tying his ruin to the blasted oak. Theme link: making a second being makes him think about consequences, at last. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

9. Design a one-paragraph modern adaptation of this chapter (setting, characters, conflict). What must stay the same for it to still be about isolation in the north? [DOK 4 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · 7.RC.2, 7.CC.3, 9-10.RC.2] Look for: A creative transfer that keeps the core idea.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Victor's second act of creation is joyless because he now sees its consequences. Useful evidence: “my heart often sickened at the work of my hands” (Chapter XIX, paragraph 21): Revulsion at his labor. Theme link: making a second being makes him think about consequences, at last. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

10. What question would you most like to ask Mary Shelley about this chapter, and what answer do you think the text itself gives? [DOK 4 · studentGenerated · wait 8 s · 7.RC.2, 7.CC.3, 9-10.RC.2] Look for: A student-generated question answered from evidence.

    Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Victor's second act of creation is joyless because he now sees its consequences. Useful evidence: “In this retreat I devoted the morning to labour” (Chapter XIX, paragraph 20): The isolation of work. Theme link: making a second being makes him think about consequences, at last. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

Annotation focus

- **Setting:** look for where and when events happen and how place shapes action or feeling (anchor passage in the We do segment)
- Also notice **Tone / mood**: word choices that reveal the narrator's attitude or the scene's feeling
- Also notice **Foreshadowing**: hints, warnings or images that point to later events

Chapter quiz: item bank (all eleven rigor versions)

1. [fill · recall · DOK 1] Complete the quotation from Chapter XIX, paragraph 8: “I am a _____ tree; the bolt has entered my soul”

   Key: blasted

2. [mc · recall · DOK 1] What does the desolate setting mirror?

   A. Victor's inner isolation

B. Elizabeth's beauty

C. Clerval's happiness

D. The creature's joy

Key: A (Victor's inner isolation)

3. [fill · recall · DOK 1] Fill in the blank with the vocabulary word that fits: “I looked towards its completion with a tremulous and eager hope, which I dared not trust myself to question, but which was _____ with obscure forebodings of evil, that made my heart sicken in my bosom.” Word bank: debasing, intermixed, roarings, expedite

   Key: intermixed

4. [mc · recall · DOK 1] In the line “The soil was barren, scarcely affording pasture for a few miserable cows, and oatmeal for its inhabitants, which consisted of five persons, whose gaunt and scraggy limbs gave tokens of their miserable fare.”, what does “oatmeal” most nearly mean?

   A. spreading out

   B. porridge made of rolled oats

   C. the quality of having an inferior or less favorable position

   D. an early limited awareness of something yet to occur

   Key: B (porridge made of rolled oats)

5. [fill · recall · DOK 1] Complete the quotation from Chapter XIX, paragraph 20: “In this _____ I devoted the morning to labour”

   Key: retreat

6. [fill · recall · DOK 1] Fill in the blank with the vocabulary word that fits: “I packed up my chemical instruments, and the materials I had collected, resolving to finish my labours in some obscure nook in the northern _____ of Scotland.” Word bank: expedite, roarings, highlands, debasing

   Key: highlands

7. [mc · recall · DOK 1] Which English city prompts thoughts of history?

   A. Bristol

   B. Manchester

   C. Oxford

   D. Bath

   Key: C (Oxford)

8. [mc · recall · DOK 1] In the line “Its fair lakes reflect a blue and gentle sky; and, when troubled by the winds, their tumult is but as the play of a lively infant, when compared to the roarings of the giant ocean.”, what does “roarings” most nearly mean?

   A. loud, deep sounds

   B. to put off doing something

   C. people who live in a place

   D. killing large numbers of people

   Key: A (loud, deep sounds)

9. [fill · recall · DOK 1] Complete the quotation from Chapter XIX, paragraph 21: “my heart often _____ at the work of my hands”

   Key: sickened

10. [mc · inference · DOK 2] What does this passage most clearly show? “my heart often sickened at the work of my hands” (Chapter XIX, paragraph 21)

    A. Ambiguity ("shape of a man") makes the creature's humanity a question from his first appearance.

    B. Human violence comes first.

    C. Revulsion at his labor.

    D. Shot after a rescue; bitter irony.

    Key: C (Revulsion at his labor.)

11. [short · inference · DOK 2] What can you infer from this line? “I am a blasted tree; the bolt has entered my soul” (Chapter XIX, paragraph 8) Answer in two or three sentences with one detail.

    Sample answer: Metaphor tying his ruin to the blasted oak.

12. [mc · inference · DOK 2] What does this passage most clearly show? “I am a blasted tree; the bolt has entered my soul” (Chapter XIX, paragraph 8)

    A. Justine was pressured by her confessor; evidence about injustice and power.

    B. Political education; links to Godwin.

    C. Metaphor tying his ruin to the blasted oak.

    D. Religious, heightened language for exploration; compare later with Victor's rapture.

    Key: C (Metaphor tying his ruin to the blasted oak.)

13. [short · inference · DOK 2] What can you infer from this line? “my heart often sickened at the work of my hands” (Chapter XIX, paragraph 21) Answer in two or three sentences with one detail.

    Sample answer: Revulsion at his labor.

14. [mc · analysis · DOK 3] In this chapter, which theme does the following most directly develop? Making a second being makes him think about consequences, at last.

    A. Creation and responsibility

    B. Isolation and the need for companionship

    C. The costs of unchecked ambition

    D. Nature versus nurture

    Key: A (Creation and responsibility)

15. [short · analysis · DOK 3] Claim: Victor's second act of creation is joyless because he now sees its consequences. Explain how this evidence supports the claim: “my heart often sickened at the work of my hands” (Chapter XIX, paragraph 21).

    Sample answer: He says his "heart often sickened at the work of my hands," a sharp contrast to the rapture of the first creation, which shows responsibility arriving too late.

16. [short · synthesis · DOK 4] Close reading: how do the diction and syntax of “I am a blasted tree; the bolt has entered my soul” (Chapter XIX, paragraph 8) shape its meaning? Consider a second, competing reading.

    Sample answer: Metaphor tying his ruin to the blasted oak.

17. [fill · recall · DOK 1] Fill in the blank with the vocabulary word that fits: “The soil was barren, scarcely affording pasture for a few miserable cows, and oatmeal for its inhabitants, which consisted of five persons, whose gaunt and _____ limbs gave tokens of their miserable fare.” Word bank: roarings, debasing, scraggy, expedite

    Key: scraggy

18. [mc · recall · DOK 1] Where does Victor work on the second creature?
    A. Edinburgh University
    B. London
    C. A remote island in the Orkneys
    D. Oxford

    Key: C (A remote island in the Orkneys)

19. [mc · recall · DOK 1] Who does he leave behind?
    A. Walton
    B. Elizabeth
    C. Clerval
    D. His father

    Key: C (Clerval)

20. [mc · recall · DOK 1] What is Victor's mood while working?
    A. Miserable and filled with dread
    B. Peaceful
    C. Excited
    D. Hopeful

    Key: A (Miserable and filled with dread)

21. [mc · recall · DOK 1] In the line “Sometimes I thought that the fiend followed me, and might expedite my remissness by murdering my companion.”, what does “expedite” most nearly mean?
    A. wet with drops, as of dew or tears
    B. a person who cares for persons or property
    C. varied in color or appearance
    D. to speed up; to hasten

    Key: D (to speed up; to hasten)

22. [mc · inference · DOK 2] Which choice best states a central concern of “Chapter XIX”?
    A. The first death and growing guilt
    B. The wedding night and its catastrophe
    C. Isolation in the north
    D. Loneliness and the desire for a friend

    Key: C (Isolation in the north)

23. [mc · inference · DOK 2] What does this passage most clearly show? “In this retreat I devoted the morning to labour” (Chapter XIX, paragraph 20)
    A. Shelley presents herself as a parent of the book. Use this to connect author and character: both make something "hideous," but only one blesses it.
    B. Blunt, short sentence in the father's letter.
    C. Ingratitude repays virtue; the word "treacherous" carries the creature's (and the narrative's) judgment.
    D. The isolation of work.

    Key: D (The isolation of work.)

24. [mc · analysis · DOK 3] Which literary element does this describe in “Chapter XIX”? "I am a blasted tree": recalling the lightning-struck oak.

    A. Allusion

    B. Diction / vocabulary

    C. Irony

    D. Imagery

    Key: D (Imagery)

25. [short · synthesis · DOK 4] Evaluate this claim about the chapter: “Victor's second act of creation is joyless because he now sees its consequences.” Is it fully persuasive? Argue with evidence, including a passage that complicates it.

    Sample answer: He says his "heart often sickened at the work of my hands," a sharp contrast to the rapture of the first creation, which shows responsibility arriving too late.

26. [mc · analysis · DOK 3] Which literary element does this describe in “Chapter XIX”? The remote Orkneys: bleak and barren, matching his work and mind.

    A. Metaphor

    B. Personification

    C. Imagery

    D. Setting

    Key: D (Setting)

27. [short · analysis · DOK 3] Analyze the word choice in “In this retreat I devoted the morning to labour” (Chapter XIX, paragraph 20). Pick two words and explain what they suggest.

    Sample answer: The isolation of work.

28. [short · synthesis · DOK 4] Synthesis: trace how creation and responsibility develops from an earlier chapter to “Chapter XIX”. Use one quotation from each.

    Sample answer: making a second being makes him think about consequences, at last.

29. [fill · recall · DOK 1] Fill in the blank with the vocabulary word that fits: “His feelings are forever on the stretch; and when he begins to sink into repose, he finds himself obliged to quit that on which he rests in pleasure for something new, which again _____ his attention, and which also he forsakes for other novelties.” Word bank: expedite, debasing, engages, roarings

    Key: engages

30. [mc · recall · DOK 1] In the line “For a moment my soul was elevated from its debasing and miserable fears, to contemplate the divine ideas of liberty and self-sacrifice, of which these sights were the monuments and the remembrancers.”, what does “debasing” most nearly mean?

    A. turning aside; straying

    B. following the course of; marking out

    C. expressing congratulations

    D. degrading; lowering in dignity

    Key: D (degrading; lowering in dignity)

31. [short · synthesis · DOK 4] Close reading: how do the diction and syntax of “my heart often sickened at the work of my hands” (Chapter XIX, paragraph 21) shape its meaning? Consider a second, competing reading.

    Sample answer: Revulsion at his labor.

Rigor version	Items (in order)	Mix
Middle School	1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 6, 7, 8, 9, 10, 11, 12, 13, 14, 15, 16	recall 9, inference 4, analysis 2, synthesis 1
HS Freshman	17, 18, 5, 7, 2, 19, 20, 21, 22, 23, 11, 12, 15, 24, 14, 25	recall 8, inference 4, analysis 3, synthesis 1
HS Sophomore	3, 19, 20, 17, 7, 8, 22, 13, 11, 23, 10, 26, 24, 27, 28, 25	recall 6, inference 5, analysis 3, synthesis 2
HS Junior	1, 21, 29, 7, 30, 11, 13, 23, 22, 12, 15, 24, 27, 14, 16, 31	recall 5, inference 5, analysis 4, synthesis 2
HS Senior	17, 29, 4, 2, 22, 13, 23, 10, 12, 24, 26, 27, 14, 16, 28, 25	recall 4, inference 5, analysis 4, synthesis 3
AP	17, 3, 18, 10, 11, 13, 22, 15, 26, 27, 24, 14, 16, 28, 31, 25	recall 3, inference 4, analysis 5, synthesis 4
College Freshman	17, 1, 7, 12, 13, 22, 11, 27, 24, 26, 14, 15, 25, 16, 31, 28	recall 3, inference 4, analysis 5, synthesis 4
College Sophomore	1, 17, 10, 23, 12, 11, 22, 27, 24, 15, 14, 26, 31, 25, 16, 28	recall 2, inference 5, analysis 5, synthesis 4
College Junior	6, 17, 12, 22, 10, 23, 13, 27, 15, 26, 24, 14, 28, 31, 16, 25	recall 2, inference 5, analysis 5, synthesis 4
College Senior	17, 29, 22, 23, 11, 10, 12, 27, 26, 14, 24, 15, 28, 31, 16, 25	recall 2, inference 5, analysis 5, synthesis 4
Graduate / PhD	9, 17, 12, 13, 11, 23, 22, 24, 15, 27, 26, 14, 25, 31, 16, 28	recall 2, inference 5, analysis 5, synthesis 4

Writing prompts (eleven rigor levels)

Middle School (250 words; Indiana 2023: 7.RC.3, 7.W.1): Supported track (work from the passage your teacher selects). In “Chapter XIX,” how does Shelley show isolation in the north? Write a paragraph that states your claim, quotes two details from the passage, and explains how each detail supports your idea. Use the setting you noticed as one piece of evidence.

HS Freshman (350 words; Indiana 2023: 9-10.RC.1, 9-10.W.1): In Chapter XIX, how does Shelley develop the idea of isolation in the north? State a clear claim, support it with two or three quotations, and explain how the setting in the chapter helps build that idea.

HS Sophomore (450 words; Indiana 2023: 9-10.RC.1, 9-10.W.1): Analyze how Chapter XIX develops the idea of isolation in the north. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of setting and tone / mood shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.

HS Junior (550 words; Indiana 2023: 11-12.RC.3, 11-12.RC.1, 11-12.W.1): Analyze how the structure of Chapter XIX (where it begins, turns and ends) and its setting shape the reader's understanding of isolation in the north. Identify one place where the text leaves matters uncertain and explain how that uncertainty adds to its meaning.

HS Senior (600 words; Indiana 2023: 11-12.RC.1, 11-12.W.1): Two readers disagree about what Chapter XIX suggests about isolation in the north. Lay out two plausible interpretations, weigh the evidence for each (including the chapter's setting and tone / mood), and argue for the stronger one in a sustained, well-organized essay.

AP (650 words; Indiana 2023: 11-12.RC.1, 11-12.W.1): Write a literary argument in which you analyze how Mary Shelley uses setting in Chapter XIX to complicate the reader's understanding of isolation in the north. Develop a defensible thesis, select evidence purposefully, and explain how specific choices of diction and syntax create meaning.

College Freshman (1000 words; Indiana 2023: see unit standards): Situate Chapter XIX within its historical and literary context and argue how the chapter's treatment of isolation in the north responds to that context. Engage with at least one secondary perspective (a critic, historian or the author's own statements), integrate quotations smoothly, and cite in MLA style.

College Sophomore (1250 words; Indiana 2023: see unit standards): Read Chapter XIX alongside the conventions of its genre and period. Argue how the chapter's handling of isolation in the north follows or bends those conventions, using the setting as evidence, and test your reading against one published critic. Document two secondary sources in MLA.

College Junior (1500 words; Indiana 2023: see unit standards): Apply a named critical approach (for example formalist, historicist, feminist, psychoanalytic or ecocritical) to Chapter XIX and its treatment of isolation in the north. State your method, show what it reveals in the chapter's setting and tone / mood, and identify where the text resists it.

College Senior (2000 words; Indiana 2023: see unit standards): Develop a research argument that reads Chapter XIX as evidence for a larger claim about isolation in the north in Frankenstein. Connect close reading of the chapter to the whole novel, engage at least four scholarly sources, and state precisely where your reading departs from theirs (Chicago style).

Graduate / PhD (2500 words; Indiana 2023: see unit standards): Develop an original argument that reads Chapter XIX as a hinge in the novel's larger treatment of isolation in the north. Position your reading within a named critical conversation (for example formalist, historicist, psychoanalytic, feminist or postcolonial approaches), account for the textual history where relevant, and articulate the stakes of your intervention for scholarship on Frankenstein.

SAT-style questions

1. *For a moment my soul was elevated from its debasing and miserable fears, to contemplate the divine ideas of liberty and self-sacrifice, of which these sights were the monuments and the remembrancers.*

   As used in the text, what does the word “debasing” most nearly mean?

   A. degrading; lowering in dignity

   B. gives up; abandons

   C. argue in protest or opposition

   D. hilly or mountainous country

2. *We had arrived in England at the beginning of October, and it was now February. We accordingly determined to commence our journey towards the north at the expiration of another month. In this expedition we did not intend to follow the great road to Edinburgh, but to visit Windsor, Oxford, Matlock, and the Cumberland lakes, resolving to arrive at the completion of this tour about the end of July. I packed up my chemical instruments, and the materials I had collected, resolving to finish my labours in some obscure nook in the northern highlands of Scotland.*

Which choice best states a central concern of "Chapter XIX"?

A. Learning compassion by watching

B. Isolation in the north

C. The final reckoning

D. Despair and the sublime

SAT key: 1. A (degrading; lowering in dignity); 2. B (Isolation in the north)

Lesson 27: Chapter XX

Focus: destroying the companion

Objective: Students will analyze how conflict develops in “Chapter XX” by writing a claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph that cites at least 2 quotations from the section, and will score at least 80% on the section quiz.

Standards: CCSS RL.9-10.3, W.9-10.1, L.9-10.4 · IN 9-10.RC.1, 9-10.W.1, 9-10.RC.9, 9-10.RC.11

Teacher only · spoilers

Fearing a 'race of devils,' Victor tears apart the half-finished female while the creature watches. The creature vows: 'I shall be with you on your wedding-night.' Victor rows out to sea to dump the remains, drifts, and lands in Ireland, where he is arrested for a murder.

Background: Fears of uncontrolled reproduction reflect debates sparked by Malthus on population.

Significance: Victor's choice can be read as moral courage or as a second abandonment—a rich debate topic.

Lesson plan and lecture script (90 minutes)

0–8 min · Bell-ringer · You do (8 min)
Students write to the bell-ringer, then pair-share.
Was destroying the female the right choice? Argue both sides. Write for five minutes. Starters: I think... because... / This connects to creation and responsibility because....
Prompt: Was destroying the female the right choice? Argue both sides.
Sentence starters: I think… because… · This connects to creation and responsibility because…
Strong response: A strong response takes a position and anticipates this: is destroying the female responsible or another betrayal?

8–18 min · Vocabulary with etymology notes · I do (10 min)
Five key words in context, with verified word histories.
Today's words: specked — dotted; spotted; wiliness — cunning; craftiness; slenderly — only slightly; poorly; debility — the state of being weak in health or body (especially from old age); buffeted — struck again and again. “specked”: From Middle English speckyd; equivalent to speck + ed. “slenderly”: From slender + ly. “debility”: From Middle English debylite, from Old French debilité (French débilité), from Latin dēbilitās "weakness", from dēbilis "weak", from dē- + habilis "able".
Words: specked: dotted; spotted · wiliness: cunning; craftiness · slenderly: only slightly; poorly · debility: the state of being weak in health or body (especially from old age) · buffeted: struck again and again

18–28 min · Background and context · I do (10 min)
Mini-lecture (read or adapt the script).
Fears of uncontrolled reproduction reflect debates sparked by Malthus on population. Victor's choice can be read as moral courage or as a second abandonment—a rich debate topic. Conflict: Victor destroys the female in front of the creature; the creature vows revenge. Foreshadowing: "I shall be with you on your wedding-night" is a threat Victor misunderstands. Characterization: Victor reasons about future generations (a "race of devils") for the first time, and acts. Watch for light and fire: Light stands for knowledge and fire for its double edge: warmth and burning. Victor seeks the "light" of discovery; the creature discovers fire and is burned by it. In this chapter: "I sat one evening in my laboratory; the sun had set, and the moon was just rising from the sea" (Chapter XX, paragraph 1).

28–40 min · I do: modeled close reading · I do (12 min)
Model the close reading of the anchor quotation using the written think-aloud below.
I read the line once for meaning and once for craft. "a race of devils would be propagated upon the earth" (Chapter XX, paragraph 2). Victor's fear of consequences. That is conflict at work: Victor destroys the female in front of the creature; the creature vows revenge.

> *a race of devils would be propagated upon the earth (Chapter XX, paragraph 2)*

Think-aloud: I read the line once for meaning and once for craft. "a race of devils would be propagated upon the earth" (Chapter XX, paragraph 2). Victor's fear of consequences. That is conflict at work: Victor destroys the female in front of the creature; the creature vows revenge.

40–55 min · We do: guided annotation · We do (15 min)
Guided analysis of a second quotation; expected answers given.
Ask: What words in this line stand out, and what do they suggest? Expected: The key threat; Victor assumes it targets himself. Look at the craft: "I shall be with you on your wedding-night" is a threat Victor misunderstands. Ask: How does this line connect to creation and responsibility? Expected: Is destroying the female responsible or another betrayal? (The key threat; Victor assumes it targets himself.)

> *I shall be with you on your wedding night (Chapter XX, paragraph 15)*

Ask: What words in this line stand out, and what do they suggest?
Expected answer: The key threat; Victor assumes it targets himself. Look at the craft: "I shall be with you on your wedding-night" is a threat Victor misunderstands.
Ask: How does this line connect to creation and responsibility?
Expected answer: Is destroying the female responsible or another betrayal? (The key threat; Victor assumes it targets himself.)

55–70 min · You do: independent annotation · You do (15 min)

Independent annotation and a claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph (exemplar given).

Annotate the chapter for conflict, foreshadowing (three marks with a margin note each), then write one claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph: what does this chapter suggest about destroying the companion? Then start your writing prompt at your assigned level (HS Sophomore: Analyze how Chapter XX develops the idea of destroying the companion. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of conflict and foreshadowing shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.) Exemplar: Destroying the female is the first time Victor thinks about consequences, but it also breaks his promise. When the text says “a race of devils would be propagated upon the earth” (Chapter XX, paragraph 2), it shows this directly. He fears "a race of devils would be propagated upon the earth," thinking of future people, yet he does it in front of the creature, who answers "I shall be with you on your wedding-night."

Task: Annotate the chapter for conflict, foreshadowing (three marks with a margin note each), then write one claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph: what does this chapter suggest about destroying the companion? Then start your writing prompt at your assigned level (HS Sophomore: Analyze how Chapter XX develops the idea of destroying the companion. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of conflict and foreshadowing shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.)

Exemplar: Destroying the female is the first time Victor thinks about consequences, but it also breaks his promise. When the text says “a race of devils would be propagated upon the earth” (Chapter XX, paragraph 2), it shows this directly. He fears "a race of devils would be propagated upon the earth," thinking of future people, yet he does it in front of the creature, who answers "I shall be with you on your wedding-night."

70–80 min · Discussion · We do (10 min)

Structured discussion from the 30 tiered questions, with facilitation notes.

Anchor question: Was destroying the female the right choice? Argue both sides. Debate whether destroying the female was right. Many students switch sides; ask what changed their mind.

Anchor question: Was destroying the female the right choice? Argue both sides.

Facilitation: Debate whether destroying the female was right. Many students switch sides; ask what changed their mind.

80–87 min · Exit ticket / chapter quiz · You do (7 min)
Chapter quiz in the app and an exit ticket (answer given).
Chapter quiz in the app, then: In one sentence, what does this chapter suggest about destroying the companion? Support it with one short quotation. Model answer: Destroying the female is the first time Victor thinks about consequences, but it also breaks his promise. ("a race of devils would be propagated upon the earth", Chapter XX, paragraph 2). Accept any defensible claim backed by a quotation from the chapter; the answer key for the quiz is in the Quiz section.
Exit ticket: In one sentence, what does this chapter suggest about destroying the companion? Support it with one short quotation.
Answer: Model answer: Destroying the female is the first time Victor thinks about consequences, but it also breaks his promise. ("a race of devils would be propagated upon the earth", Chapter XX, paragraph 2). Accept any defensible claim backed by a quotation from the chapter; the answer key for the quiz is in the Quiz section.

87–90 min · Closure · I do (3 min)
Summarize the lesson and preview the next reading.
Today we saw how conflict shapes destroying the companion. Key takeaway: is destroying the female responsible or another betrayal?

Total: 90 minutes.

Teacher analysis (spoilers)

Literary elements

- **Conflict:** Victor destroys the female in front of the creature; the creature vows revenge.
- **Foreshadowing:** "I shall be with you on your wedding-night" is a threat Victor misunderstands.
- **Characterization:** Victor reasons about future generations (a "race of devils") for the first time, and acts.

Themes and how they develop

- **creation and responsibility:** is destroying the female responsible or another betrayal?

Symbols and motifs

- **light and fire:** Light stands for knowledge and fire for its double edge: warmth and burning. Victor seeks the "light" of discovery; the creature discovers fire and is burned by it. In this chapter: "I sat one evening in my laboratory; the sun had set, and the moon was just rising from the sea" (Chapter XX, paragraph 1).
- **naming the creature:** Victor never names his creation; the words he uses (wretch, daemon, fiend, monster) show his rejection and shape the reader's view. In this chapter: "was engaged in the same manner, and had created a fiend whose unparalleled barbarity had desolated my heart, and filled it forever" (Chapter XX, paragraph 1).

Key quotations (checked against the reading text)

- "a race of devils would be propagated upon the earth" (Chapter XX, paragraph 2) Victor's fear of consequences.
- "I shall be with you on your wedding night" (Chapter XX, paragraph 15) The key threat; Victor assumes it targets himself.
- "Slave, I before reasoned with you, but you have proved yourself unworthy of my condescension" (Chapter XX, paragraph 11) The creature reverses the master-slave relationship.

Model claim-evidence-reasoning

Claim: Destroying the female is the first time Victor thinks about consequences, but it also breaks his promise.
Evidence: "a race of devils would be propagated upon the earth" (Chapter XX, paragraph 2)
Reasoning: He fears "a race of devils would be propagated upon the earth," thinking of future people, yet he does it in front of the creature, who answers "I shall be with you on your wedding-night."

Vocabulary with etymology notes

Word	Definition (in this sentence)	In context	Word history
specked (verb)	dotted; spotted	*A few fishing vessels alone specked the water, and now and then the gentle breeze wafted the sound of voices, as the fishermen called to one another.*	"specked": From Middle English speckyd; equivalent to speck + ed. (Wiktionary, https://en.wiktionary.org/wiki/specked#Etymology)
wiliness (noun)	cunning; craftiness	*I will watch with the wiliness of a snake, that I may sting with its venom.*	
slenderly (adverb)	only slightly; poorly	*I had no compass with me, and was so slenderly acquainted with the geography of this part of the world, that the sun was of little benefit to me.*	"slenderly": From slender + ly. (Wiktionary, https://en.wiktionary.org/wiki/slenderly#Etymology)
debility (noun)	the state of being weak in health or body (especially from old age)	*As I was in a state of extreme debility, I resolved to sail directly towards the town, as a place where I could most easily procure nourishment.*	"debility": From Middle English debylite, from Old French debilité (French débilité), from Latin dēbilitās "weakness", from dēbilis "weak", from dē- + habilis "able". (Wiktionary, https://en.wiktionary.org/wiki/debility#Etymology)
buffeted (verb)	struck again and again	*I might be driven into the wide Atlantic, and feel all the tortures of starvation, or be swallowed up in the immeasurable waters that roared and buffeted around me.*	

paddling (verb)	propel with a paddle	*I felt the silence, although I was hardly conscious of its extreme profundity, until my ear was suddenly arrested by the paddling of oars near the shore, and a person landed close to my house.*	
irresolution (noun)	doubt concerning two or more possible alternatives or courses of action	*"The hour of my irresolution is past, and the period of your power is arrived.*	"irresolution": Probably from Middle French irresolution (modern French irrésolution), from ir- + resolution "resolution"; compare Italian irresoluzione. By surface analysis, ir- + resolution. (Wiktionary, https://en.wiktionary.org/wiki/irresolution#Etymology)
construed (verb)	make sense of; assign a meaning to	*I was ready to sink from fatigue and hunger; but, being surrounded by a crowd, I thought it politic to rouse all my strength, that no physical debility might be construed into apprehension or conscious guilt.*	
mutable (adjective)	capable of or tending to change in form or quality or nature	*How mutable are our feelings, and how strange is that clinging love we have of life even in the excess of misery!*	"mutable": From Middle English mutable, from Old French mutable, from Latin mutabilis "liable to change". By surface analysis, muta- + -able. (Wiktionary, https://en.wiktionary.org/wiki/mutable#Etymology)
loitered (verb)	lingered; hung about	*Yes, he had followed me in my travels; he had loitered in forests, hid himself in caves, or taken refuge in wide and desert heaths; and he now came to mark my progress, and claim the fulfilment of my promise.*	

Discussion questions

1. Was destroying the female the right choice? Argue both sides.
2. Where does conflict appear in this chapter, and what effect does it have? Point to one passage.
3. How does this chapter connect to the book's larger concern with the costs of unchecked ambition?

Classroom discussion questions (30, tiered)

Wait time after every question (3 s for DOK 1, 5 s for DOK 2, 8 to 10 s for DOK 3 and 4); think-pair-share on DOK 3 and 4; answer each response with a follow-up probe; close with student-generated questions. Focus sets by rigor level: Middle School: 1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 6, 11, 12, 13, 14, 21, 22; HS Freshman: 1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 12, 13, 14, 15, 22, 23, 24; HS Sophomore: 1, 2, 3, 4, 13, 14, 15, 16, 17, 23, 24, 25; HS Junior: 1, 2, 3, 14, 15, 16, 17, 18, 24, 25, 26, 27; HS Senior: 1, 2, 3, 15, 16, 17, 18, 25, 26, 27, 28, 29; AP: 1, 2, 16, 17, 18, 19, 20, 26, 27, 28, 29, 30; College Freshman: 1, 2, 17, 18, 19, 20, 21, 22, 27, 28, 29, 30; College Sophomore: 1, 2, 11, 18, 19, 20, 21, 22,

23, 28, 29, 30; College Junior: 1, 11, 12, 19, 20, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 29, 30; College Senior: 1, 11, 12, 13, 20, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 26, 30; Graduate / PhD: 1, 11, 12, 13, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 26, 27, 28

Literal / recall

1. Why does Victor destroy the female? [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · 7.RC.1, 7.CC.1, 9-10.RC.1] Look for: He fears a race of devils
2. What does the creature threaten? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · 7.RC.1, 7.CC.1, 9-10.RC.1] Look for: To be with Victor on his wedding night
3. Where does Victor land after drifting at sea? [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · 7.RC.1, 7.CC.1, 9-10.RC.1] Look for: Ireland
4. What happens when he lands? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · 7.RC.1, 7.CC.1, 9-10.RC.1] Look for: He is arrested for murder
5. How might readers view his decision? [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · 7.RC.1, 7.CC.1, 9-10.RC.1] Look for: As courage or as another abandonment
6. Retell the three most important events of “Chapter XX” in order, in one sentence each. [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · 7.RC.1, 7.CC.1, 9-10.RC.1] Look for: Fearing a 'race of devils,' Victor tears apart the half-finished female while the creature watches. The creature vows: 'I shall be with you on your wedding-night.' Victor rows out to sea to dump the remains, drifts, and lands in Ireland, where he is arrested for a murder.
7. Which characters appear or are mentioned in “Chapter XX”? Name two and one thing each says or does. [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · 7.RC.1, 7.CC.1, 9-10.RC.1] Look for: Names and actions taken from the chapter; check against the teacher summary.
8. Where and when does “Chapter XX” take place? Point to the line that tells you. [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · 7.RC.1, 7.CC.1, 9-10.RC.1] Look for: A place/time detail quoted from the chapter.
9. Reread: “A few fishing vessels alone specked the water, and now and then the gentle breeze wafted the sound of voices, as the fishermen called to one another.” What does “specked” mean here, and what is literally happening in this line? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · 7.RC.1, 7.CC.1, 9-10.RC.1] Look for: specked: dotted; spotted.
10. Reread: “I will watch with the wiliness of a snake, that I may sting with its venom.” What does “wiliness” mean here, and what is literally happening in this line? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · 7.RC.1, 7.CC.1, 9-10.RC.1] Look for: wiliness: cunning; craftiness.

Inferential / analytical

1. What does “Chapter XX” suggest about destroying the companion? State the inference and the line that supports it. [DOK 2 · thinkPairShare · wait 5 s · 7.RC.2, 7.CC.2, 9-10.RC.2] Look for: Victor's choice can be read as moral courage or as a second abandonment—a rich debate topic.
2. Find one example of conflict in this chapter. What does it reveal that a plain statement would not? [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · 7.RC.3, 7.CC.2, 9-10.RC.1] Look for: Look for the forces, people or desires pulling against each other.
3. How does the foreshadowing in this chapter shape what we understand about destroying the companion? [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · 7.RC.3, 7.CC.2, 9-10.RC.3] Look for: Look for hints, warnings or images that point to later events.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Destroying the female is the first time Victor thinks about consequences, but it also breaks his promise. Useful evidence: “a race of devils would be propagated

upon the earth” (Chapter XX, paragraph 2): Victor's fear of consequences. On foreshadowing: "I shall be with you on your wedding-night" is a threat Victor misunderstands. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

4. In the passage that begins “I trembled, and my heart failed within me; when, on looking up, I saw, by the light of the moon, the daemon at the casement.”, why might Shelley have chosen these particular words? Pick two and explain their connotations. [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · 7.RC.12, 7.CC.2, 9-10.RC.12] Look for: Diction analysis of two words in the anchor passage.
5. What causes the main turn in “Chapter XX”, and what effect is it likely to have on what follows? [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · 7.RC.3, 7.CC.2, 9-10.RC.1] Look for: Fearing a 'race of devils,' Victor tears apart the half-finished female while the creature watches. The creature vows: 'I shall be with you on your wedding-night.' Victor rows out to sea to dump the remains, drifts, and lands in Ireland, where he is arrested for a murder.
6. How does “Chapter XX” build on “Chapter XIX”? Name one link of cause and effect. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · 7.RC.3, 7.CC.2, 9-10.RC.3] Look for: A causal or structural link between this and the previous chapter.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Destroying the female is the first time Victor thinks about consequences, but it also breaks his promise. Useful evidence: “I shall be with you on your wedding night” (Chapter XX, paragraph 15): The key threat; Victor assumes it targets himself. Theme link: is destroying the female responsible or another betrayal? Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
7. What can we infer about a character's motives from what they say and do here, as opposed to what they claim? [DOK 3 · followUp · wait 8 s · 7.RC.3, 7.CC.2, 9-10.RC.1] Look for: An inference about motive supported by a quoted line.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Destroying the female is the first time Victor thinks about consequences, but it also breaks his promise. Useful evidence: “Slave, I before reasoned with you, but you have proved yourself unworthy of my condescension” (Chapter XX, paragraph 11): The creature reverses the master-slave relationship. On characterization: Victor reasons about future generations (a "race of devils") for the first time, and acts. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
8. The bell-ringer asked: “Was destroying the female the right choice? Argue both sides.” Now that we have read closely, how would you revise your first answer, and which line changed your mind? [DOK 2 · thinkPairShare · wait 5 s · 7.RC.2, 7.CC.2, 9-10.RC.2] Look for: A revised answer anchored in the text.
9. Where does characterization appear, and how does it connect this chapter to the larger concern with the costs of unchecked ambition? [DOK 3 · followUp · wait 8 s · 7.RC.3, 7.CC.2, 9-10.RC.1] Look for: Look for what characters say, do and think, and how others react to them.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Destroying the female is the first time Victor thinks about consequences, but it also breaks his promise. Useful evidence: “a race of devils would be propagated upon the earth” (Chapter XX, paragraph 2): Victor's fear of consequences. On characterization: Victor reasons about future generations (a "race of devils") for the first time, and acts. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
10. Background: Fears of uncontrolled reproduction reflect debates sparked by Malthus on population. How does knowing this change the way you read one moment in the chapter? [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · 7.RC.3, 7.CC.2, 9-10.RC.1] Look for: A specific moment reread in light of the context.

    Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Destroying the female is the first time Victor thinks about consequences, but it also breaks his promise. Useful evidence: “I shall be with you on your wedding

night" (Chapter XX, paragraph 15): The key threat; Victor assumes it targets himself. Theme link: is destroying the female responsible or another betrayal? Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

Evaluative / synthesis / creative

1. A critic might argue: "Victor's choice can be read as moral courage or as a second abandonment—a rich debate topic." How far do you agree? Take a stand and defend it with two lines from the chapter. [DOK 3 · fourCorners · wait 8 s · 7.RC.2, 7.CC.3, 9-10.RC.2] Look for: A defended position with evidence and one counterpoint.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Destroying the female is the first time Victor thinks about consequences, but it also breaks his promise. Useful evidence: "Slave, I before reasoned with you, but you have proved yourself unworthy of my condescension" (Chapter XX, paragraph 11): The creature reverses the master-slave relationship. Theme link: is destroying the female responsible or another betrayal? Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
2. Which character in this chapter acts most wisely, and which least? Judge them by a standard you name. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · 7.RC.3, 7.CC.3, 9-10.RC.1] Look for: An evaluation using an explicit criterion and evidence.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Destroying the female is the first time Victor thinks about consequences, but it also breaks his promise. Useful evidence: "a race of devils would be propagated upon the earth" (Chapter XX, paragraph 2): Victor's fear of consequences. On characterization: Victor reasons about future generations (a "race of devils") for the first time, and acts. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
3. Rewrite one moment of "Chapter XX" from the point of view of a different character. What does the new angle reveal or hide about destroying the companion? [DOK 4 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · 7.RC.1, 7.CC.3, 9-10.RC.1] Look for: A creative product with a rationale tied to the text.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Destroying the female is the first time Victor thinks about consequences, but it also breaks his promise. Useful evidence: "I shall be with you on your wedding night" (Chapter XX, paragraph 15): The key threat; Victor assumes it targets himself. Theme link: is destroying the female responsible or another betrayal? Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
4. Write three questions of your own about "Chapter XX": one recall, one "why/how", and one "should/what if". Trade with a partner and answer theirs. [DOK 3 · studentGenerated · wait 8 s · 7.RC.2, 7.CC.3, 9-10.RC.2] Look for: Student-generated questions at three levels.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Destroying the female is the first time Victor thinks about consequences, but it also breaks his promise. Useful evidence: "Slave, I before reasoned with you, but you have proved yourself unworthy of my condescension" (Chapter XX, paragraph 11): The creature reverses the master-slave relationship. Theme link: is destroying the female responsible or another betrayal? Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
5. Connect this chapter to creation and responsibility: is the link strong or weak so far? What would Shelley need to show next to strengthen it? [DOK 4 · socraticCircle · wait 8 s · 7.RC.2, 7.CC.3, 9-10.RC.2] Look for: A judgment of thematic development across the work.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Destroying the female is the first time Victor thinks

about consequences, but it also breaks his promise. Useful evidence: “a race of devils would be propagated upon the earth” (Chapter XX, paragraph 2): Victor's fear of consequences. Theme link: is destroying the female responsible or another betrayal? Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

6. Is the conflict in this chapter effective, or does it feel heavy-handed? Evaluate it as a reader would in a review. [DOK 3 · fourCorners · wait 8 s · 7.RC.3, 7.CC.3, 9-10.RC.1] Look for: An evaluative judgment with criteria and evidence.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Destroying the female is the first time Victor thinks about consequences, but it also breaks his promise. Useful evidence: “I shall be with you on your wedding night” (Chapter XX, paragraph 15): The key threat; Victor assumes it targets himself. On conflict: Victor destroys the female in front of the creature; the creature vows revenge. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

7. Compare how “Chapter XX” treats destroying the companion with how another text, film or event you know treats a similar idea. What does Frankenstein see that the other misses? [DOK 4 · socraticCircle · wait 8 s · 7.RC.2, 7.CC.3, 9-10.RC.2] Look for: A cross-text synthesis.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Destroying the female is the first time Victor thinks about consequences, but it also breaks his promise. Useful evidence: “Slave, I before reasoned with you, but you have proved yourself unworthy of my condescension” (Chapter XX, paragraph 11): The creature reverses the master-slave relationship. Theme link: is destroying the female responsible or another betrayal? Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

8. Predict what “Chapter XXI” will bring, using two clues from this chapter. After reading, evaluate your prediction. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · 7.RC.3, 7.CC.3, 9-10.RC.3] Look for: A prediction or judgment justified with textual clues.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Destroying the female is the first time Victor thinks about consequences, but it also breaks his promise. Useful evidence: “a race of devils would be propagated upon the earth” (Chapter XX, paragraph 2): Victor's fear of consequences. On foreshadowing: "I shall be with you on your wedding-night" is a threat Victor misunderstands. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

9. Design a one-paragraph modern adaptation of this chapter (setting, characters, conflict). What must stay the same for it to still be about destroying the companion? [DOK 4 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · 7.RC.2, 7.CC.3, 9-10.RC.2] Look for: A creative transfer that keeps the core idea.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Destroying the female is the first time Victor thinks about consequences, but it also breaks his promise. Useful evidence: “I shall be with you on your wedding night” (Chapter XX, paragraph 15): The key threat; Victor assumes it targets himself. Theme link: is destroying the female responsible or another betrayal? Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

10. What question would you most like to ask Mary Shelley about this chapter, and what answer do you think the text itself gives? [DOK 4 · studentGenerated · wait 8 s · 7.RC.2, 7.CC.3, 9-10.RC.2] Look for: A student-generated question answered from evidence.

    Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Destroying the female is the first time Victor thinks about consequences, but it also breaks his promise. Useful evidence: “Slave, I before reasoned with you, but you have proved yourself unworthy of my condescension” (Chapter XX, paragraph 11): The creature

reverses the master-slave relationship. Theme link: is destroying the female responsible or another betrayal? Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

Annotation focus

- **Conflict:** look for the forces, people or desires pulling against each other (anchor passage in the We do segment)
- Also notice **Foreshadowing**: hints, warnings or images that point to later events
- Also notice **Characterization**: what characters say, do and think, and how others react to them

Chapter quiz: item bank (all eleven rigor versions)

1. [mc · recall · DOK 1] How might readers view his decision?

   A. As courage or as another abandonment

   B. As unimportant

   C. As accidental

   D. As purely comic

   Key: A (As courage or as another abandonment)

2. [fill · recall · DOK 1] Fill in the blank with the vocabulary word that fits: "I was ready to sink from fatigue and hunger; but, being surrounded by a crowd, I thought it politic to rouse all my strength, that no physical debility might be _____ into apprehension or conscious guilt." Word bank: slenderly, construed, specked, wiliness

   Key: construed

3. [mc · recall · DOK 1] Where does Victor land after drifting at sea?

   A. Ireland

   B. Norway

   C. France

   D. Iceland

   Key: A (Ireland)

4. [mc · recall · DOK 1] Why does Victor destroy the female?

   A. He fears a race of devils

   B. The creature asks him

   C. He runs out of materials

   D. She is finished and dangerous

   Key: A (He fears a race of devils)

5. [fill · recall · DOK 1] Complete the quotation from Chapter XX, paragraph 11: "Slave, I before reasoned with you, but you have proved yourself unworthy of my _____"

   Key: condescension

6. [fill · recall · DOK 1] Complete the quotation from Chapter XX, paragraph 2: "a race of devils would be _____ upon the earth"

   Key: propagated

7. [mc · recall · DOK 1] In the line “A few fishing vessels alone specked the water, and now and then the gentle breeze wafted the sound of voices, as the fishermen called to one another.”, what does “specked” most nearly mean?

   A. dotted; spotted

   B. a vault or building where corpses or bones are deposited

   C. instruments that make distant objects look closer

   D. a room used primarily for sleeping

   Key: A (dotted; spotted)

8. [mc · recall · DOK 1] What happens when he lands?

   A. He marries

   B. He is arrested for murder

   C. He meets Walton

   D. He is welcomed

   Key: B (He is arrested for murder)

9. [fill · recall · DOK 1] Fill in the blank with the vocabulary word that fits: “I might be driven into the wide Atlantic, and feel all the tortures of starvation, or be swallowed up in the immeasurable waters that roared and _____ around me.” Word bank: buffeted, specked, slenderly, wiliness

   Key: buffeted

10. [mc · inference · DOK 2] What does this passage most clearly show? “I shall be with you on your wedding night” (Chapter XX, paragraph 15)

    A. The first words he learns: basic needs and the home.

    B. The first sentence already contains a warning (his sister's "evil forebodings"). Strong evidence for foreshadowing.

    C. The key threat; Victor assumes it targets himself.

    D. His education; each book shapes him.

    Key: C (The key threat; Victor assumes it targets himself.)

11. [mc · inference · DOK 2] What does this passage most clearly show? “Slave, I before reasoned with you, but you have proved yourself unworthy of my condescension” (Chapter XX, paragraph 11)

    A. The creature reverses the master-slave relationship.

    B. Ingratitude repays virtue; the word "treacherous" carries the creature's (and the narrative's) judgment.

    C. Self-blame.

    D. Short and plain amid his long sentences: the emotional core of the letter.

    Key: A (The creature reverses the master-slave relationship.)

12. [short · inference · DOK 2] What can you infer from this line? “I shall be with you on your wedding night” (Chapter XX, paragraph 15) Answer in two or three sentences with one detail.

    Sample answer: The key threat; Victor assumes it targets himself.

13. [short · inference · DOK 2] What can you infer from this line? “a race of devils would be propagated upon the earth” (Chapter XX, paragraph 2) Answer in two or three sentences with one detail.

    Sample answer: Victor's fear of consequences.

14. [mc · analysis · DOK 3] In this chapter, which theme does the following most directly develop? Is destroying the female responsible or another betrayal?

    A. Nature versus nurture

    B. Creation and responsibility

    C. Isolation and the need for companionship

    D. The costs of unchecked ambition

    Key: B (Creation and responsibility)

15. [short · analysis · DOK 3] Claim: Destroying the female is the first time Victor thinks about consequences, but it also breaks his promise. Explain how this evidence supports the claim: “a race of devils would be propagated upon the earth” (Chapter XX, paragraph 2).

    Sample answer: He fears "a race of devils would be propagated upon the earth," thinking of future people, yet he does it in front of the creature, who answers "I shall be with you on your wedding-night."

16. [short · synthesis · DOK 4] Close reading: how do the diction and syntax of “I shall be with you on your wedding night” (Chapter XX, paragraph 15) shape its meaning? Consider a second, competing reading.

    Sample answer: The key threat; Victor assumes it targets himself.

17. [mc · recall · DOK 1] In the line “I will watch with the wiliness of a snake, that I may sting with its venom.”, what does “wiliness” most nearly mean?

    A. be persistent, refuse to stop

    B. a defamatory or abusive word or phrase

    C. a sloping gallery with seats for spectators (as in an operating room or theater)

    D. cunning; craftiness

    Key: D (cunning; craftiness)

18. [fill · recall · DOK 1] Fill in the blank with the vocabulary word that fits: “I felt the silence, although I was hardly conscious of its extreme profundity, until my ear was suddenly arrested by the _____ of oars near the shore, and a person landed close to my house.” Word bank: specked, paddling, slenderly, wiliness

    Key: paddling

19. [mc · inference · DOK 2] Which choice best states a central concern of “Chapter XX”?

    A. Destroying the companion

    B. The first death and growing guilt

    C. The final reckoning

    D. A privileged childhood and family love

    Key: A (Destroying the companion)

20. [short · analysis · DOK 3] Analyze the word choice in “Slave, I before reasoned with you, but you have proved yourself unworthy of my condescension” (Chapter XX, paragraph 11). Pick two words and explain what they suggest.

    Sample answer: The creature reverses the master-slave relationship.

21. [mc · analysis · DOK 3] Which literary element does this describe in “Chapter XX”? Victor destroys the female in front of the creature; the creature vows revenge.

    A. Symbolism

    B. Conflict

    C. Allusion

D. Plot

Key: B (Conflict)

22. [mc · recall · DOK 1] What does the creature threaten?

A. To burn Geneva

B. To kill Walton

C. To leave forever

D. To be with Victor on his wedding night

Key: D (To be with Victor on his wedding night)

23. [fill · recall · DOK 1] Complete the quotation from Chapter XX, paragraph 15: “I shall be with you on your _____ night”

Key: wedding

24. [mc · inference · DOK 2] What does this passage most clearly show? “a race of devils would be propagated upon the earth” (Chapter XX, paragraph 2)

A. His education; each book shapes him.

B. Simile for knowledge that cannot be unlearned.

C. The master has become the slave; a reversal the creature will state aloud in Chapter XX.

D. Victor's fear of consequences.

Key: D (Victor's fear of consequences.)

25. [mc · analysis · DOK 3] Which literary element does this describe in “Chapter XX”? "I shall be with you on your wedding-night" is a threat Victor misunderstands.

A. Foreshadowing

B. Tone / mood

C. Simile

D. Personification

Key: A (Foreshadowing)

26. [short · synthesis · DOK 4] Close reading: how do the diction and syntax of “a race of devils would be propagated upon the earth” (Chapter XX, paragraph 2) shape its meaning? Consider a second, competing reading.

Sample answer: Victor's fear of consequences.

27. [mc · recall · DOK 1] In the line “I had no compass with me, and was so slenderly acquainted with the geography of this part of the world, that the sun was of little benefit to me.”, what does “slenderly” most nearly mean?

A. treated lightly; toyed with

B. encouraging; filling with spirit

C. friendly and trying to win good will

D. only slightly; poorly

Key: D (only slightly; poorly)

28. [short · synthesis · DOK 4] Synthesis: trace how creation and responsibility develops from an earlier chapter to “Chapter XX”. Use one quotation from each.

Sample answer: is destroying the female responsible or another betrayal?

29. [short · synthesis · DOK 4] Evaluate this claim about the chapter: “Destroying the female is the first time Victor thinks about consequences, but it also breaks his promise.” Is it fully persuasive? Argue with evidence, including a passage that complicates it.
    Sample answer: He fears "a race of devils would be propagated upon the earth," thinking of future people, yet he does it in front of the creature, who answers "I shall be with you on your wedding-night."

Rigor version	Items (in order)	Mix
Middle School	1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 6, 7, 8, 9, 10, 11, 12, 13, 14, 15, 16	recall 9, inference 4, analysis 2, synthesis 1
HS Freshman	17, 2, 5, 7, 9, 18, 3, 1, 12, 19, 13, 10, 20, 21, 15, 16	recall 8, inference 4, analysis 3, synthesis 1
HS Sophomore	17, 22, 6, 23, 3, 7, 24, 12, 19, 11, 13, 25, 15, 14, 16, 26	recall 6, inference 5, analysis 3, synthesis 2
HS Junior	9, 3, 8, 27, 6, 11, 12, 19, 13, 10, 15, 25, 21, 20, 28, 29	recall 5, inference 5, analysis 4, synthesis 2
HS Senior	9, 18, 4, 17, 24, 19, 11, 13, 12, 20, 15, 14, 25, 28, 26, 29	recall 4, inference 5, analysis 4, synthesis 3
AP	5, 6, 3, 13, 11, 24, 19, 15, 25, 20, 21, 14, 16, 26, 28, 29	recall 3, inference 4, analysis 5, synthesis 4
College Freshman	9, 18, 17, 13, 10, 19, 11, 15, 14, 25, 20, 21, 26, 28, 29, 16	recall 3, inference 4, analysis 5, synthesis 4
College Sophomore	9, 18, 11, 10, 24, 12, 13, 21, 14, 25, 15, 20, 26, 28, 16, 29	recall 2, inference 5, analysis 5, synthesis 4
College Junior	9, 18, 13, 11, 10, 19, 24, 15, 14, 25, 21, 20, 26, 29, 28, 16	recall 2, inference 5, analysis 5, synthesis 4
College Senior	9, 18, 10, 19, 24, 12, 11, 14, 15, 20, 25, 21, 26, 29, 28, 16	recall 2, inference 5, analysis 5, synthesis 4
Graduate / PhD	9, 18, 10, 19, 12, 13, 11, 25, 21, 20, 14, 15, 29, 16, 26, 28	recall 2, inference 5, analysis 5, synthesis 4

Writing prompts (eleven rigor levels)

Middle School (250 words; Indiana 2023: 7.RC.3, 7.W.1): Supported track (work from the passage your teacher selects). In “Chapter XX,” how does Shelley show destroying the companion? Write a paragraph that states your claim, quotes two details from the passage, and explains how each detail supports your idea. Use the conflict you noticed as one piece of evidence.

HS Freshman (350 words; Indiana 2023: 9-10.RC.1, 9-10.W.1): In Chapter XX, how does Shelley develop the idea of destroying the companion? State a clear claim, support it with two or three quotations, and explain how the conflict in the chapter helps build that idea.

HS Sophomore (450 words; Indiana 2023: 9-10.RC.1, 9-10.W.1): Analyze how Chapter XX develops the idea of destroying the companion. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of conflict and foreshadowing shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.

HS Junior (550 words; Indiana 2023: 11-12.RC.3, 11-12.RC.1, 11-12.W.1): Analyze how the structure of Chapter XX (where it begins, turns and ends) and its conflict shape the reader's understanding of destroying the companion. Identify one place where the text leaves matters uncertain and explain how that uncertainty adds to its meaning.

HS Senior (600 words; Indiana 2023: 11-12.RC.1, 11-12.W.1): Two readers disagree about what Chapter XX suggests about destroying the companion. Lay out two plausible interpretations, weigh the evidence for each

(including the chapter's conflict and foreshadowing), and argue for the stronger one in a sustained, well-organized essay.

AP (650 words; Indiana 2023: 11-12.RC.1, 11-12.W.1): Write a literary argument in which you analyze how Mary Shelley uses conflict in Chapter XX to complicate the reader's understanding of destroying the companion. Develop a defensible thesis, select evidence purposefully, and explain how specific choices of diction and syntax create meaning.

College Freshman (1000 words; Indiana 2023: see unit standards): Situate Chapter XX within its historical and literary context and argue how the chapter's treatment of destroying the companion responds to that context. Engage with at least one secondary perspective (a critic, historian or the author's own statements), integrate quotations smoothly, and cite in MLA style.

College Sophomore (1250 words; Indiana 2023: see unit standards): Read Chapter XX alongside the conventions of its genre and period. Argue how the chapter's handling of destroying the companion follows or bends those conventions, using the conflict as evidence, and test your reading against one published critic. Document two secondary sources in MLA.

College Junior (1500 words; Indiana 2023: see unit standards): Apply a named critical approach (for example formalist, historicist, feminist, psychoanalytic or ecocritical) to Chapter XX and its treatment of destroying the companion. State your method, show what it reveals in the chapter's conflict and foreshadowing, and identify where the text resists it.

College Senior (2000 words; Indiana 2023: see unit standards): Develop a research argument that reads Chapter XX as evidence for a larger claim about destroying the companion in Frankenstein. Connect close reading of the chapter to the whole novel, engage at least four scholarly sources, and state precisely where your reading departs from theirs (Chicago style).

Graduate / PhD (2500 words; Indiana 2023: see unit standards): Develop an original argument that reads Chapter XX as a hinge in the novel's larger treatment of destroying the companion. Position your reading within a named critical conversation (for example formalist, historicist, psychoanalytic, feminist or postcolonial approaches), account for the textual history where relevant, and articulate the stakes of your intervention for scholarship on Frankenstein.

SAT-style questions

1. *I had no compass with me, and was so slenderly acquainted with the geography of this part of the world, that the sun was of little benefit to me.*

   As used in the text, what does the word “slenderly” most nearly mean?

   A. only slightly; poorly

   B. capable of or tending to change in form or quality or nature

   C. lingered; hung about

   D. make sense of; assign a meaning to

2. *I trembled, and my heart failed within me; when, on looking up, I saw, by the light of the moon, the daemon at the casement. A ghastly grin wrinkled his lips as he gazed on me, where I sat fulfilling the task which he*

had allotted to me. Yes, he had followed me in my travels; he had loitered in forests, hid himself in caves, or taken refuge in wide and desert heaths; and he now came to mark my progress, and claim the fulfilment of my promise.

Which choice best states a central concern of "Chapter XX"?

A. The meeting of two ambitious men

B. The first death and growing guilt

C. Destroying the companion

D. The wedding night and its catastrophe

SAT key: 1. A (only slightly; poorly); 2. C (Destroying the companion)

Lesson 28: Chapter XXI

Focus: grief, prison and return

Objective: Students will analyze how irony develops in “Chapter XXI” by writing a claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph that cites at least 2 quotations from the section, and will score at least 80% on the section quiz.

Standards: CCSS RL.9-10.6, W.9-10.1, L.9-10.4 · IN 9-10.RC.1, 9-10.W.1, 9-10.RC.9, 9-10.RC.11

Teacher only · spoilers

Victor discovers the murdered man is Clerval. He falls into fever in prison for two months. Mr. Kirwin, the magistrate, is kind; his father arrives; Victor is acquitted and they return home.

Background: Grand juries and assizes were standard in British and Irish courts.

Significance: Clerval's death destroys the last emblem of Victor's healthy past.

Lesson plan and lecture script (90 minutes)

0–8 min · Bell-ringer · You do (8 min)
Students write to the bell-ringer, then pair-share.
How does Clerval's death affect Victor differently from William's? Write for five minutes. Starters: I think... because... / This connects to creation and responsibility because....
Prompt: How does Clerval's death affect Victor differently from William's?
Sentence starters: I think… because… · This connects to creation and responsibility because…
Strong response: A strong response takes a position and anticipates this: Victor calls himself the cause.

8–18 min · Vocabulary with etymology notes · I do (10 min)
Five key words in context, with verified word histories.
Today's words: turnkeys — jailers who keep the keys; gaolers — jailers (British spelling); assizes — regular court sessions held in English counties (until 1971); vexations — annoyances; worries; retrospect — contemplation of things past. “turnkeys”: From turn + key. “gaolers”: By surface analysis, gaol + -er<id:agent noun>. “retrospect”: Borrowed from Latin retrōspectum, from retrōspicio "to look back at", equivalent to retro + spect. Compare review.
Words: turnkeys: jailers who keep the keys · gaolers: jailers (British spelling) · assizes: regular court sessions held in English counties (until 1971) · vexations: annoyances; worries · retrospect: contemplation of things past

18–28 min · Background and context · I do (10 min)
Mini-lecture (read or adapt the script).
Grand juries and assizes were standard in British and Irish courts. Clerval's death destroys the last emblem of Victor's healthy past. Plot: Victor lands in Ireland, is accused of murder, and sees Clerval's body. Irony: Victor is accused of a murder he did cause indirectly. Characterization: Mr. Kirwin's kindness; Victor's collapse. Watch for light and fire: Light stands for knowledge and fire for its double edge: warmth and burning. Victor seeks the "light" of discovery; the creature discovers fire and is burned by it. In this chapter: "His companions came up to assist him; and, by the light of their lantern, they found that he had fallen on the" (Chapter XXI, paragraph 2).

28–40 min · I do: modeled close reading · I do (12 min)
Model the close reading of the anchor quotation using the written think-aloud below.
I read the line once for meaning and once for craft. "The human frame could no longer support the agonies that I endured" (Chapter XXI, paragraph 10). Physical collapse. That is plot at work: Victor lands in Ireland, is accused of murder, and sees Clerval's body.

> *The human frame could no longer support the agonies that I endured* (Chapter XXI, paragraph 10)

Think-aloud: I read the line once for meaning and once for craft. "The human frame could no longer support the agonies that I endured" (Chapter XXI, paragraph 10). Physical collapse. That is plot at work: Victor lands in Ireland, is accused of murder, and sees Clerval's body.

40–55 min · We do: guided annotation · We do (15 min)
Guided analysis of a second quotation; expected answers given.
Ask: What words in this line stand out, and what do they suggest? Expected: "Murderous machinations" means his plots; he admits causing the death. This connects to responsibility. Ask: How does this line connect to creation and responsibility? Expected: Victor calls himself the cause. (Self-blame.)

> *Have my murderous machinations deprived you also, my dearest Henry, of life* (Chapter XXI, paragraph 9)

Ask: What words in this line stand out, and what do they suggest?
Expected answer: "Murderous machinations" means his plots; he admits causing the death. This connects to responsibility.
Ask: How does this line connect to creation and responsibility?
Expected answer: Victor calls himself the cause. (Self-blame.)

55–70 min · You do: independent annotation · You do (15 min)
Independent annotation and a claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph (exemplar given).
Annotate the chapter for plot, irony (three marks with a margin note each), then write one claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph: what does this chapter suggest about grief, prison and return? Then start your writing prompt at your assigned level (HS Sophomore: Analyze how Chapter XXI develops the idea of grief, prison and return. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of irony and plot shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.) Exemplar: Clerval's murder makes Victor admit his responsibility in his own words. When the text says "Have my murderous machinations deprived you also, my dearest Henry, of life" (Chapter XXI, paragraph 9), it shows this directly. He asks whether his "murderous machinations" have killed Henry, naming his own schemes as the cause.
Task: Annotate the chapter for plot, irony (three marks with a margin note each), then write one claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph: what does this chapter suggest about grief, prison and return? Then start your writing prompt at your assigned level (HS Sophomore: Analyze how Chapter XXI develops the idea of grief, prison and return. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of irony and plot shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.)
Exemplar: Clerval's murder makes Victor admit his responsibility in his own words. When the text says "Have my murderous machinations deprived you also, my dearest Henry, of life" (Chapter XXI, paragraph 9), it shows this directly. He asks whether his "murderous machinations" have killed Henry, naming his own schemes as the cause.

70–80 min · Discussion · We do (10 min)
Structured discussion from the 30 tiered questions, with facilitation notes.
Anchor question: How does Clerval's death affect Victor differently from William's? Ask why Shelley has Victor accused of this particular murder.
Anchor question: How does Clerval's death affect Victor differently from William's?
Facilitation: Ask why Shelley has Victor accused of this particular murder.

80–87 min · Exit ticket / chapter quiz · You do (7 min)
Chapter quiz in the app and an exit ticket (answer given).
Chapter quiz in the app, then: In one sentence, what does this chapter suggest about grief, prison and return? Support it with one short quotation. Model answer: Clerval's murder makes Victor admit his responsibility in his own words. ("Have my murderous machinations deprived you also, my dearest Henry, of life", Chapter XXI, paragraph 9). Accept any defensible claim backed by a quotation from the chapter; the answer key for the quiz is in the Quiz section.
Exit ticket: In one sentence, what does this chapter suggest about grief, prison and return? Support it with one short quotation.
Answer: Model answer: Clerval's murder makes Victor admit his responsibility in his own words. ("Have my murderous machinations deprived you also, my dearest Henry, of life", Chapter XXI, paragraph 9). Accept any defensible claim backed by a quotation from the chapter; the answer key for the quiz is in the Quiz section.

87–90 min · Closure · I do (3 min)
Summarize the lesson and preview the next reading.
Today we saw how plot shapes grief, prison and return. Key takeaway: Victor calls himself the cause.

Total: 90 minutes.

Teacher analysis (spoilers)

Literary elements

- **Plot:** Victor lands in Ireland, is accused of murder, and sees Clerval's body.
- **Irony:** Victor is accused of a murder he did cause indirectly.
- **Characterization:** Mr. Kirwin's kindness; Victor's collapse.

Themes and how they develop

- **creation and responsibility:** Victor calls himself the cause.

Symbols and motifs

- **light and fire:** Light stands for knowledge and fire for its double edge: warmth and burning. Victor seeks the "light" of discovery; the creature discovers fire and is burned by it. In this chapter: “His companions came up to assist him; and, by the light of their lantern, they found that he had fallen on the” (Chapter XXI, paragraph 2).
- **sublime nature:** Mountains, glaciers, storms and lakes reflect and sometimes soothe the characters' feelings; the sublime is both comfort and terror. In this chapter: “devouring maladie du pays, to see once more the blue lake and rapid Rhône, that had been so dear to me in” (Chapter XXI, paragraph 46).

Key quotations (checked against the reading text)

- “Have my murderous machinations deprived you also, my dearest Henry, of life” (Chapter XXI, paragraph 9) Self-blame.
- “The human frame could no longer support the agonies that I endured” (Chapter XXI, paragraph 10) Physical collapse.
- “Why did I not die” (Chapter XXI, paragraph 12) Despair.

Model claim-evidence-reasoning

Claim: Clerval's murder makes Victor admit his responsibility in his own words.
Evidence: “Have my murderous machinations deprived you also, my dearest Henry, of life” (Chapter XXI, paragraph 9)
Reasoning: He asks whether his "murderous machinations" have killed Henry, naming his own schemes as the cause.

Vocabulary with etymology notes

Word	Definition (in this sentence)	In context	Word history
turnkeys (noun)	jailers who keep the keys	*But I was doomed to live; and, in two months, found myself as awaking from a dream, in a prison, stretched on a wretched*	“turnkeys”: From turn + key. (Wiktionary, https://en.wiktionary.org/wiki/turnkey#Etymology)

		bed, surrounded by gaolers, turnkeys, bolts, and all the miserable apparatus of a dungeon.	
gaolers (noun)	jailers (British spelling)	*But I was doomed to live; and, in two months, found myself as awaking from a dream, in a prison, stretched on a wretched bed, surrounded by gaolers, turnkeys, bolts, and all the miserable apparatus of a dungeon.*	“gaolers”: By surface analysis, gaol + -er<id:agent noun>. (Wiktionary, https://en.wiktionary.org/wiki/gaoler#Etymology)
assizes (noun)	regular court sessions held in English counties (until 1971)	*The season of the assizes approached.*	
vexations (noun)	annoyances; worries	*My father was enraptured on finding me freed from the vexations of a criminal charge, that I was again allowed to breathe the fresh atmosphere, and permitted to return to my native country.*	
retrospect (noun)	contemplation of things past	*Kirwin said this, notwithstanding the agitation I endured on this retrospect of my sufferings, I also felt considerable surprise at the knowledge he seemed to possess concerning me.*	“retrospect”: Borrowed from Latin retrōspectum, from retrōspicio "to look back at", equivalent to retro + spect. Compare review. (Wiktionary, https://en.wiktionary.org/wiki/retrospect#Etymology)
hangman (noun)	an executioner who hangs the condemned person	*Who could be interested in the fate of a murderer, but the hangman who would gain his fee?*	“hangman”: Middle English hangman, hongman, hangeman, equivalent to hang + man. (Wiktionary, https://en.wiktionary.org/wiki/hangman#Etymology)
liberated (verb)	set free	*The grand jury rejected the bill, on its being proved that I was on the Orkney Islands at the hour the body of my friend was found; and a fortnight after my removal I was liberated from prison.*	
residing (verb)	make one's home in a particular place or community	*I repassed, in my memory, my whole life; my quiet happiness while residing with my family in Geneva, the death of my mother, and my departure for Ingolstadt.*	“residing”: From Middle English residen, from Old French resider, from Latin resideō "remain behind, reside, dwell", from re- "back" + sedeō "sit". (Wiktionary, https://en.wiktionary.org/wiki/reside#Etymology)

laudanum (noun)	narcotic consisting of an alcohol solution of opium or any preparation in which opium is the main ingredient	*Ever since my recovery from the fever, I had been in the custom of taking every night a small quantity of laudanum; for it was by means of this drug only that I was enabled to gain the rest necessary for the preservation of life.*	“laudanum”: From New Latin -, from lādanum "a gum resin", from Ancient Greek λᾶδανον. Originally the same word as ladanum, labdanum, compare French laudanum, Italian laudano, ladano. Perhaps influenced by Latin laudō "to praise". See ladanum. (Wiktionary, https://en.wiktionary.org/wiki/laudanum#Etymology)
decides (verb)	reach, make, or come to a decision about something	*I was spared the disgrace of appearing publicly as a criminal, as the case was not brought before the court that decides on life and death.*	“decides”: From Middle English deciden, from Old French decider, from Latin dēcīdere, infinitive of dēcīdō "cut off, decide", from dē "down from" + caedō "cut". (Wiktionary, https://en.wiktionary.org/wiki/decide#Etymology)

Discussion questions

1. How does Clerval's death affect Victor differently from William's?
2. Where does irony appear in this chapter, and what effect does it have? Point to one passage.
3. How does this chapter connect to the book's larger concern with creation and responsibility?

Classroom discussion questions (30, tiered)

Wait time after every question (3 s for DOK 1, 5 s for DOK 2, 8 to 10 s for DOK 3 and 4); think-pair-share on DOK 3 and 4; answer each response with a follow-up probe; close with student-generated questions. Focus sets by rigor level: Middle School: 1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 6, 11, 12, 13, 14, 21, 22; HS Freshman: 1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 12, 13, 14, 15, 22, 23, 24; HS Sophomore: 1, 2, 3, 4, 13, 14, 15, 16, 17, 23, 24, 25; HS Junior: 1, 2, 3, 14, 15, 16, 17, 18, 24, 25, 26, 27; HS Senior: 1, 2, 3, 15, 16, 17, 18, 25, 26, 27, 28, 29; AP: 1, 2, 16, 17, 18, 19, 20, 26, 27, 28, 29, 30; College Freshman: 1, 2, 17, 18, 19, 20, 21, 22, 27, 28, 29, 30; College Sophomore: 1, 2, 11, 18, 19, 20, 21, 22, 23, 28, 29, 30; College Junior: 1, 11, 12, 19, 20, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 29, 30; College Senior: 1, 11, 12, 13, 20, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 26, 30; Graduate / PhD: 1, 11, 12, 13, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 26, 27, 28

Literal / recall

1. Who is the murdered man? [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · 7.RC.1, 7.CC.1, 9-10.RC.1] Look for: Henry Clerval
2. How long does Victor lie ill in prison? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · 7.RC.1, 7.CC.1, 9-10.RC.1] Look for: About two months
3. Who is kind to Victor in Ireland? [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · 7.RC.1, 7.CC.1, 9-10.RC.1] Look for: Mr. Kirwin
4. Who comes to bring Victor home? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · 7.RC.1, 7.CC.1, 9-10.RC.1] Look for: His father
5. What is ironic about Victor being accused? [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · 7.RC.1, 7.CC.1, 9-10.RC.1] Look for: He is guilty in a sense, though innocent of the act
6. Retell the three most important events of “Chapter XXI” in order, in one sentence each. [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · 7.RC.1, 7.CC.1, 9-10.RC.1] Look for: Victor discovers the murdered man is Clerval. He falls into fever in prison for two months. Mr. Kirwin, the magistrate, is kind; his father arrives; Victor is acquitted and they return home.

7. Which characters appear or are mentioned in “Chapter XXI”? Name two and one thing each says or does. [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · 7.RC.1, 7.CC.1, 9-10.RC.1] Look for: Names and actions taken from the chapter; check against the teacher summary.
8. Where and when does “Chapter XXI” take place? Point to the line that tells you. [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · 7.RC.1, 7.CC.1, 9-10.RC.1] Look for: A place/time detail quoted from the chapter.
9. Reread: “But I was doomed to live; and, in two months, found myself as awaking from a dream, in a prison, stretched on a wretched bed, surrounded by gaolers, turnkeys, bolts, and all the miserable apparatus of a dungeon.” What does “turnkeys” mean here, and what is literally happening in this line? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · 7.RC.1, 7.CC.1, 9-10.RC.1] Look for: turnkeys: jailers who keep the keys.
10. Reread: “But I was doomed to live; and, in two months, found myself as awaking from a dream, in a prison, stretched on a wretched bed, surrounded by gaolers, turnkeys, bolts, and all the miserable apparatus of a dungeon.” What does “gaolers” mean here, and what is literally happening in this line? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · 7.RC.1, 7.CC.1, 9-10.RC.1] Look for: gaolers: jailers (British spelling).

Inferential / analytical

1. What does “Chapter XXI” suggest about grief, prison and return? State the inference and the line that supports it. [DOK 2 · thinkPairShare · wait 5 s · 7.RC.2, 7.CC.2, 9-10.RC.2] Look for: Clerval's death destroys the last emblem of Victor's healthy past.
2. Find one example of irony in this chapter. What does it reveal that a plain statement would not? [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · 7.RC.1, 7.CC.2, 9-10.RC.1] Look for: Look for gaps between what characters expect or say and what is true.
3. How does the plot in this chapter shape what we understand about grief, prison and return? [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · 7.RC.3, 7.CC.2, 9-10.RC.1] Look for: Look for key events and the causes linking them.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Clerval's murder makes Victor admit his responsibility in his own words. Useful evidence: “Have my murderous machinations deprived you also, my dearest Henry, of life” (Chapter XXI, paragraph 9): Self-blame. On plot: Victor lands in Ireland, is accused of murder, and sees Clerval's body. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
4. In the passage that begins “But I was doomed to live; and, in two months, found myself as awaking from a dream, in a prison, stretched on a wretched bed, surrounded by gaolers, turnkeys, bolts, and all the…”, why might Shelley have chosen these particular words? Pick two and explain their connotations. [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · 7.RC.12, 7.CC.2, 9-10.RC.12] Look for: Diction analysis of two words in the anchor passage.
5. What causes the main turn in “Chapter XXI”, and what effect is it likely to have on what follows? [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · 7.RC.3, 7.CC.2, 9-10.RC.1] Look for: Victor discovers the murdered man is Clerval. He falls into fever in prison for two months. Mr. Kirwin, the magistrate, is kind; his father arrives; Victor is acquitted and they return home.
6. How does “Chapter XXI” build on “Chapter XX”? Name one link of cause and effect. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · 7.RC.3, 7.CC.2, 9-10.RC.3] Look for: A causal or structural link between this and the previous chapter.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Clerval's murder makes Victor admit his responsibility in his own words. Useful evidence: “The human frame could no longer support the agonies that I endured” (Chapter XXI, paragraph 10): Physical collapse. Theme link: Victor calls himself the cause. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

7. What can we infer about a character's motives from what they say and do here, as opposed to what they claim? [DOK 3 · followUp · wait 8 s · 7.RC.3, 7.CC.2, 9-10.RC.1] Look for: An inference about motive supported by a quoted line.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Clerval's murder makes Victor admit his responsibility in his own words. Useful evidence: “Why did I not die” (Chapter XXI, paragraph 12): Despair. On characterization: Mr. Kirwin's kindness; Victor's collapse. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
8. The bell-ringer asked: “How does Clerval's death affect Victor differently from William's?” Now that we have read closely, how would you revise your first answer, and which line changed your mind? [DOK 2 · thinkPairShare · wait 5 s · 7.RC.2, 7.CC.2, 9-10.RC.2] Look for: A revised answer anchored in the text.
9. Where does tone / mood appear, and how does it connect this chapter to the larger concern with creation and responsibility? [DOK 3 · followUp · wait 8 s · 7.RC.12, 7.CC.2, 9-10.RC.12] Look for: Look for word choices that reveal the narrator's attitude or the scene's feeling.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Clerval's murder makes Victor admit his responsibility in his own words. Useful evidence: “Have my murderous machinations deprived you also, my dearest Henry, of life” (Chapter XXI, paragraph 9): Self-blame. Theme link: Victor calls himself the cause. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
10. Background: Grand juries and assizes were standard in British and Irish courts. How does knowing this change the way you read one moment in the chapter? [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · 7.RC.3, 7.CC.2, 9-10.RC.1] Look for: A specific moment reread in light of the context.
    Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Clerval's murder makes Victor admit his responsibility in his own words. Useful evidence: “The human frame could no longer support the agonies that I endured” (Chapter XXI, paragraph 10): Physical collapse. Theme link: Victor calls himself the cause. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

Evaluative / synthesis / creative

1. A critic might argue: “Clerval's death destroys the last emblem of Victor's healthy past.” How far do you agree? Take a stand and defend it with two lines from the chapter. [DOK 3 · fourCorners · wait 8 s · 7.RC.2, 7.CC.3, 9-10.RC.2] Look for: A defended position with evidence and one counterpoint.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Clerval's murder makes Victor admit his responsibility in his own words. Useful evidence: “Why did I not die” (Chapter XXI, paragraph 12): Despair. Theme link: Victor calls himself the cause. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
2. Which character in this chapter acts most wisely, and which least? Judge them by a standard you name. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · 7.RC.3, 7.CC.3, 9-10.RC.1] Look for: An evaluation using an explicit criterion and evidence.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Clerval's murder makes Victor admit his responsibility in his own words. Useful evidence: “Have my murderous machinations deprived you also, my dearest Henry, of life” (Chapter XXI, paragraph 9): Self-blame. On characterization: Mr. Kirwin's kindness; Victor's collapse. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

3. Rewrite one moment of “Chapter XXI” from the point of view of a different character. What does the new angle reveal or hide about grief, prison and return? [DOK 4 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · 7.RC.1, 7.CC.3, 9-10.RC.1] Look for: A creative product with a rationale tied to the text.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Clerval's murder makes Victor admit his responsibility in his own words. Useful evidence: “The human frame could no longer support the agonies that I endured” (Chapter XXI, paragraph 10): Physical collapse. Theme link: Victor calls himself the cause. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

4. Write three questions of your own about “Chapter XXI”: one recall, one “why/how”, and one “should/what if”. Trade with a partner and answer theirs. [DOK 3 · studentGenerated · wait 8 s · 7.RC.2, 7.CC.3, 9-10.RC.2] Look for: Student-generated questions at three levels.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Clerval's murder makes Victor admit his responsibility in his own words. Useful evidence: “Why did I not die” (Chapter XXI, paragraph 12): Despair. Theme link: Victor calls himself the cause. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

5. Connect this chapter to isolation and the need for companionship: is the link strong or weak so far? What would Shelley need to show next to strengthen it? [DOK 4 · socraticCircle · wait 8 s · 7.RC.2, 7.CC.3, 9-10.RC.2] Look for: A judgment of thematic development across the work.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Clerval's murder makes Victor admit his responsibility in his own words. Useful evidence: “Have my murderous machinations deprived you also, my dearest Henry, of life” (Chapter XXI, paragraph 9): Self-blame. Theme link: Victor calls himself the cause. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

6. Is the irony in this chapter effective, or does it feel heavy-handed? Evaluate it as a reader would in a review. [DOK 3 · fourCorners · wait 8 s · 7.RC.1, 7.CC.3, 9-10.RC.1] Look for: An evaluative judgment with criteria and evidence.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Clerval's murder makes Victor admit his responsibility in his own words. Useful evidence: “The human frame could no longer support the agonies that I endured” (Chapter XXI, paragraph 10): Physical collapse. On irony: Victor is accused of a murder he did cause indirectly. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

7. Compare how “Chapter XXI” treats grief, prison and return with how another text, film or event you know treats a similar idea. What does Frankenstein see that the other misses? [DOK 4 · socraticCircle · wait 8 s · 7.RC.2, 7.CC.3, 9-10.RC.2] Look for: A cross-text synthesis.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Clerval's murder makes Victor admit his responsibility in his own words. Useful evidence: “Why did I not die” (Chapter XXI, paragraph 12): Despair. Theme link: Victor calls himself the cause. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

8. Predict what “Chapter XXII” will bring, using two clues from this chapter. After reading, evaluate your prediction. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · 7.RC.3, 7.CC.3, 9-10.RC.3] Look for: A prediction or judgment justified with textual clues.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Clerval's murder makes Victor admit his responsibility in his own words. Useful evidence: “Have my murderous machinations deprived you also, my dearest Henry, of life” (Chapter XXI, paragraph 9): Self-blame. Theme link: Victor calls himself the cause. Credit

any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

9. Design a one-paragraph modern adaptation of this chapter (setting, characters, conflict). What must stay the same for it to still be about grief, prison and return? [DOK 4 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · 7.RC.2, 7.CC.3, 9-10.RC.2] Look for: A creative transfer that keeps the core idea.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Clerval's murder makes Victor admit his responsibility in his own words. Useful evidence: “The human frame could no longer support the agonies that I endured” (Chapter XXI, paragraph 10): Physical collapse. Theme link: Victor calls himself the cause. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
10. What question would you most like to ask Mary Shelley about this chapter, and what answer do you think the text itself gives? [DOK 4 · studentGenerated · wait 8 s · 7.RC.2, 7.CC.3, 9-10.RC.2] Look for: A student-generated question answered from evidence.
    Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Clerval's murder makes Victor admit his responsibility in his own words. Useful evidence: “Why did I not die” (Chapter XXI, paragraph 12): Despair. Theme link: Victor calls himself the cause. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

Annotation focus

- **Irony:** look for gaps between what characters expect or say and what is true (anchor passage in the We do segment)
- Also notice **Plot**: key events and the causes linking them
- Also notice **Tone / mood**: word choices that reveal the narrator's attitude or the scene's feeling

Chapter quiz: item bank (all eleven rigor versions)

1. [fill · recall · DOK 1] Complete the quotation from Chapter XXI, paragraph 9: “Have my murderous _____ deprived you also, my dearest Henry, of life”
   Key: machinations
2. [mc · recall · DOK 1] Who comes to bring Victor home?
   A. Walton
   B. His father
   C. Elizabeth
   D. Ernest
   Key: B (His father)
3. [mc · recall · DOK 1] In the line “The season of the assizes approached.”, what does “assizes” most nearly mean?
   A. uselessness as a consequence of having no practical result
   B. come down on or keep down by unjust use of one's authority
   C. get the meaning of something
   D. regular court sessions held in English counties (until 1971)
   Key: D (regular court sessions held in English counties (until 1971))

4. [mc · recall · DOK 1] Who is kind to Victor in Ireland?

   A. Mr. Kirwin

   B. Krempe

   C. Safie

   D. Felix

   Key: A (Mr. Kirwin)

5. [fill · recall · DOK 1] Fill in the blank with the vocabulary word that fits: “The grand jury rejected the bill, on its being proved that I was on the Orkney Islands at the hour the body of my friend was found; and a fortnight after my removal I was _____ from prison.” Word bank: liberated, assizes, turnkeys, gaolers

   Key: liberated

6. [mc · recall · DOK 1] What is ironic about Victor being accused?

   A. He is guilty in a sense, though innocent of the act

   B. He was in Geneva

   C. He likes jail

   D. He confesses

   Key: A (He is guilty in a sense, though innocent of the act)

7. [mc · recall · DOK 1] In the line “My father was enraptured on finding me freed from the vexations of a criminal charge, that I was again allowed to breathe the fresh atmosphere, and permitted to return to my native country.”, what does “vexations” most nearly mean?

   A. a fast, graceful animal with horns, like a deer

   B. resembling or characteristic of a phantom

   C. disturb in mind or make uneasy or cause to be worried or alarmed

   D. annoyances; worries

   Key: D (annoyances; worries)

8. [fill · recall · DOK 1] Complete the quotation from Chapter XXI, paragraph 10: “The human frame could no longer _____ the agonies that I endured”

   Key: support

9. [mc · recall · DOK 1] In the line “But I was doomed to live; and, in two months, found myself as awaking from a dream, in a prison, stretched on a wretched bed, surrounded by gaolers, turnkeys, bolts, and all the miserable apparatus of a dungeon.”, what does “gaolers” most nearly mean?

   A. covered as if with a carpet

   B. remove, usually with some force or effort; also used in an abstract sense

   C. immune to attack; impregnable

   D. jailers (British spelling)

   Key: D (jailers (British spelling))

10. [short · inference · DOK 2] What can you infer from this line? “The human frame could no longer support the agonies that I endured” (Chapter XXI, paragraph 10) Answer in two or three sentences with one detail.

    Sample answer: Physical collapse.

11. [mc · inference · DOK 2] What does this passage most clearly show? “Why did I not die” (Chapter XXI, paragraph 12)
    A. The first words he learns: basic needs and the home.
    B. The creature will ask for exactly this. Evidence that the need for companionship is universal in the novel.
    C. Dismissal without explanation; Victor later blames this.
    D. Despair.

    Key: D (Despair.)

12. [short · inference · DOK 2] What can you infer from this line? “Have my murderous machinations deprived you also, my dearest Henry, of life” (Chapter XXI, paragraph 9) Answer in two or three sentences with one detail.

    Sample answer: Self-blame.

13. [mc · inference · DOK 2] What does this passage most clearly show? “Have my murderous machinations deprived you also, my dearest Henry, of life” (Chapter XXI, paragraph 9)
    A. Biblical image of hell (Isaiah, Mark): remorse as eternal torment.
    B. Fire's double nature; symbol for knowledge and for the creature.
    C. Claims a relationship and a duty.
    D. Self-blame.

    Key: D (Self-blame.)

14. [mc · analysis · DOK 3] In this chapter, which theme does the following most directly develop? Victor calls himself the cause.
    A. Isolation and the need for companionship
    B. The costs of unchecked ambition
    C. Nature versus nurture
    D. Creation and responsibility

    Key: D (Creation and responsibility)

15. [mc · analysis · DOK 3] Which literary element does this describe in “Chapter XXI”? Victor is accused of a murder he did cause indirectly.
    A. Irony
    B. Alliteration
    C. Theme
    D. Metaphor

    Key: A (Irony)

16. [short · synthesis · DOK 4] Close reading: how do the diction and syntax of “Have my murderous machinations deprived you also, my dearest Henry, of life” (Chapter XXI, paragraph 9) shape its meaning? Consider a second, competing reading.

    Sample answer: Self-blame.

17. [mc · recall · DOK 1] In the line “But I was doomed to live; and, in two months, found myself as awaking from a dream, in a prison, stretched on a wretched bed, surrounded by gaolers, turnkeys, bolts, and all the miserable apparatus of a dungeon.”, what does “turnkeys” most nearly mean?

    A. an exchange; a giving and receiving

    B. jailers who keep the keys

    C. hold spellbound

    D. place at intervals in or among

    Key: B (jailers who keep the keys)

18. [fill · recall · DOK 1] Fill in the blank with the vocabulary word that fits: “Who could be interested in the fate of a murderer, but the _____ who would gain his fee?” Word bank: gaolers, assizes, hangman, turnkeys

    Key: hangman

19. [mc · inference · DOK 2] What does this passage most clearly show? “The human frame could no longer support the agonies that I endured” (Chapter XXI, paragraph 10)

    A. Restoration that the reader suspects cannot last.

    B. Physical collapse.

    C. The first words he learns: basic needs and the home.

    D. Benevolence repaid with treachery.

    Key: B (Physical collapse.)

20. [mc · analysis · DOK 3] Which literary element does this describe in “Chapter XXI”? Victor lands in Ireland, is accused of murder, and sees Clerval's body.

    A. Personification

    B. Symbolism

    C. Plot

    D. Point of view

    Key: C (Plot)

21. [short · analysis · DOK 3] Claim: Clerval's murder makes Victor admit his responsibility in his own words. Explain how this evidence supports the claim: “Have my murderous machinations deprived you also, my dearest Henry, of life” (Chapter XXI, paragraph 9).

    Sample answer: He asks whether his "murderous machinations" have killed Henry, naming his own schemes as the cause.

22. [fill · recall · DOK 1] Fill in the blank with the vocabulary word that fits: “I repassed, in my memory, my whole life; my quiet happiness while _____ with my family in Geneva, the death of my mother, and my departure for Ingolstadt.” Word bank: residing, turnkeys, assizes, gaolers

    Key: residing

23. [mc · inference · DOK 2] Which choice best states a central concern of “Chapter XXI”?

    A. Loss and leaving home

    B. Ambition and the hunger for discovery

    C. Grief, prison and return

    D. The first spark of obsession

    Key: C (Grief, prison and return)

24. [short · synthesis · DOK 4] Synthesis: trace how creation and responsibility develops from an earlier chapter to "Chapter XXI". Use one quotation from each.
    Sample answer: Victor calls himself the cause.
25. [short · analysis · DOK 3] Analyze the word choice in "Why did I not die" (Chapter XXI, paragraph 12). Pick two words and explain what they suggest.
    Sample answer: Despair.
26. [fill · recall · DOK 1] Fill in the blank with the vocabulary word that fits: "Kirwin said this, notwithstanding the agitation I endured on this _____ of my sufferings, I also felt considerable surprise at the knowledge he seemed to possess concerning me." Word bank: retrospect, turnkeys, assizes, gaolers
    Key: retrospect
27. [mc · recall · DOK 1] How long does Victor lie ill in prison?
    A. One day
    B. About two months
    C. Five years
    D. One week
    Key: B (About two months)
28. [short · synthesis · DOK 4] Close reading: how do the diction and syntax of "The human frame could no longer support the agonies that I endured" (Chapter XXI, paragraph 10) shape its meaning? Consider a second, competing reading.
    Sample answer: Physical collapse.
29. [short · synthesis · DOK 4] Evaluate this claim about the chapter: "Clerval's murder makes Victor admit his responsibility in his own words." Is it fully persuasive? Argue with evidence, including a passage that complicates it.
    Sample answer: He asks whether his "murderous machinations" have killed Henry, naming his own schemes as the cause.

Rigor version	Items (in order)	Mix
Middle School	1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 6, 7, 8, 9, 10, 11, 12, 13, 14, 15, 16	recall 9, inference 4, analysis 2, synthesis 1
HS Freshman	17, 7, 8, 4, 1, 6, 18, 5, 19, 13, 12, 11, 14, 20, 21, 16	recall 8, inference 4, analysis 3, synthesis 1
HS Sophomore	8, 3, 22, 17, 2, 4, 13, 12, 23, 10, 11, 21, 15, 20, 16, 24	recall 6, inference 5, analysis 3, synthesis 2
HS Junior	9, 5, 2, 18, 1, 11, 23, 19, 13, 10, 20, 25, 15, 21, 24, 16	recall 5, inference 5, analysis 4, synthesis 2
HS Senior	1, 26, 9, 27, 19, 12, 23, 13, 11, 21, 20, 25, 14, 24, 28, 16	recall 4, inference 5, analysis 4, synthesis 3
AP	18, 3, 26, 12, 10, 19, 23, 14, 15, 20, 25, 21, 24, 16, 28, 29	recall 3, inference 4, analysis 5, synthesis 4
College Freshman	26, 18, 27, 11, 12, 10, 23, 25, 15, 21, 20, 14, 16, 29, 28, 24	recall 3, inference 4, analysis 5, synthesis 4

College Sophomore	26, 18, 19, 23, 10, 13, 11, 20, 25, 14, 21, 15, 28, 29, 24, 16	recall 2, inference 5, analysis 5, synthesis 4
College Junior	26, 1, 23, 11, 13, 10, 12, 15, 20, 21, 25, 14, 16, 28, 24, 29	recall 2, inference 5, analysis 5, synthesis 4
College Senior	26, 18, 19, 10, 12, 23, 11, 21, 14, 20, 15, 25, 28, 29, 16, 24	recall 2, inference 5, analysis 5, synthesis 4
Graduate / PhD	8, 26, 12, 11, 23, 19, 13, 25, 14, 20, 21, 15, 24, 28, 29, 16	recall 2, inference 5, analysis 5, synthesis 4

Writing prompts (eleven rigor levels)

Middle School (250 words; Indiana 2023: 7.RC.1, 7.W.1): Supported track (work from the passage your teacher selects). In “Chapter XXI,” how does Shelley show grief, prison and return? Write a paragraph that states your claim, quotes two details from the passage, and explains how each detail supports your idea. Use the irony you noticed as one piece of evidence.

HS Freshman (350 words; Indiana 2023: 9-10.RC.1, 9-10.W.1): In Chapter XXI, how does Shelley develop the idea of grief, prison and return? State a clear claim, support it with two or three quotations, and explain how the irony in the chapter helps build that idea.

HS Sophomore (450 words; Indiana 2023: 9-10.RC.1, 9-10.W.1): Analyze how Chapter XXI develops the idea of grief, prison and return. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of irony and plot shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.

HS Junior (550 words; Indiana 2023: 11-12.RC.3, 11-12.RC.1, 11-12.W.1): Analyze how the structure of Chapter XXI (where it begins, turns and ends) and its irony shape the reader's understanding of grief, prison and return. Identify one place where the text leaves matters uncertain and explain how that uncertainty adds to its meaning. Distinguish what is directly stated from what is really meant.

HS Senior (600 words; Indiana 2023: 11-12.RC.1, 11-12.W.1): Two readers disagree about what Chapter XXI suggests about grief, prison and return. Lay out two plausible interpretations, weigh the evidence for each (including the chapter's irony and plot), and argue for the stronger one in a sustained, well-organized essay. Distinguish what is directly stated from what is really meant.

AP (650 words; Indiana 2023: 11-12.RC.1, 11-12.W.1): Write a literary argument in which you analyze how Mary Shelley uses irony in Chapter XXI to complicate the reader's understanding of grief, prison and return. Develop a defensible thesis, select evidence purposefully, and explain how specific choices of diction and syntax create meaning.

College Freshman (1000 words; Indiana 2023: see unit standards): Situate Chapter XXI within its historical and literary context and argue how the chapter's treatment of grief, prison and return responds to that context. Engage with at least one secondary perspective (a critic, historian or the author's own statements), integrate quotations smoothly, and cite in MLA style.

College Sophomore (1250 words; Indiana 2023: see unit standards): Read Chapter XXI alongside the conventions of its genre and period. Argue how the chapter's handling of grief, prison and return follows or bends those conventions, using the irony as evidence, and test your reading against one published critic. Document two secondary sources in MLA.

College Junior (1500 words; Indiana 2023: see unit standards): Apply a named critical approach (for example formalist, historicist, feminist, psychoanalytic or ecocritical) to Chapter XXI and its treatment of grief, prison and return. State your method, show what it reveals in the chapter's irony and plot, and identify where the text resists it.

College Senior (2000 words; Indiana 2023: see unit standards): Develop a research argument that reads Chapter XXI as evidence for a larger claim about grief, prison and return in Frankenstein. Connect close reading of the chapter to the whole novel, engage at least four scholarly sources, and state precisely where your reading departs from theirs (Chicago style).

Graduate / PhD (2500 words; Indiana 2023: see unit standards): Develop an original argument that reads Chapter XXI as a hinge in the novel's larger treatment of grief, prison and return. Position your reading within a named critical conversation (for example formalist, historicist, psychoanalytic, feminist or postcolonial approaches), account for the textual history where relevant, and articulate the stakes of your intervention for scholarship on Frankenstein.

SAT-style questions

1. *The season of the assizes approached.*

   As used in the text, what does the word “assizes” most nearly mean?

   A. narcotic consisting of an alcohol solution of opium or any preparation in which opium is the main ingredient

   B. regular court sessions held in English counties (until 1971)

   C. reach, make, or come to a decision about something

   D. make one's home in a particular place or community

2. *But I was doomed to live; and, in two months, found myself as awaking from a dream, in a prison, stretched on a wretched bed, surrounded by gaolers, turnkeys, bolts, and all the miserable apparatus of a dungeon. It was morning, I remember, when I thus awoke to understanding: I had forgotten the particulars of what had happened, and only felt as if some great misfortune had suddenly overwhelmed me; but when I looked around, and saw the barred windows, and the squalidness of the room in which I was, all flashed across my memory, and I groaned bitterly.*

   Which choice best states a central concern of “Chapter XXI”?

   A. Loneliness and the desire for a friend

   B. Grief, prison and return

   C. A privileged childhood and family love

   D. Injustice and exile

SAT key: 1. B (regular court sessions held in English counties (until 1971)); 2. B (Grief, prison and return)

Lesson 29: Chapter XXII

Focus: a letter, a secret and the wedding

Objective: Students will analyze how foreshadowing develops in “Chapter XXII” by writing a claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph that cites at least 2 quotations from the section, and will score at least 80% on the section quiz.

Standards: CCSS RL.9-10.5, W.9-10.1, L.9-10.4 · IN 9-10.RC.3, 9-10.W.1, 9-10.RC.9, 9-10.RC.11

Teacher only · spoilers

Victor recovers in Paris with his father, who takes his claim that he murdered William, Justine and Clerval as delirium. Elizabeth writes asking whether he loves someone else; Victor answers that he has one dreadful secret, which he will confide to her the day after their marriage. Remembering the creature's threat (“I will be with you on your wedding night”), he assumes he himself is the target and carries pistols and a dagger. Back in Geneva the wedding is fixed; after the ceremony the couple sail across the lake to spend the night at Evian, and the chapter ends as they near the shore at sunset.

Background: Weddings in this social class involved property arrangements; the Frankensteins regain some of Elizabeth's inheritance.

Significance: Dramatic irony: readers can see that the threat may be aimed at Elizabeth, while Victor thinks only of his own danger.

Lesson plan and lecture script (90 minutes)

0–8 min · Bell-ringer · You do (8 min)
Students write to the bell-ringer, then pair-share.
Why does Victor misread the creature's threat, and what does that reveal about him? Write for five minutes. Starters: I think... because... / This connects to isolation and companionship because....
Prompt: Why does Victor misread the creature's threat, and what does that reveal about him?
Sentence starters: I think… because… · This connects to isolation and companionship because…
Strong response: A strong response takes a position and anticipates this: secrets poison his relationship with Elizabeth.

8–18 min · Vocabulary with etymology notes · I do (10 min)
Five key words in context, with verified word histories.
Today's words: overtaxed — strained by asking too much of; unchained — set free from chains; released; obliterate — to erase completely; amphitheatre — a sloping gallery with seats for spectators (as in an operating room or theater); playmate — a companion at play. “overtaxed”: From over + tax. “playmate”: From play + mate. Compare earlier playfeer "playmate" of similar construction.
Words: overtaxed: strained by asking too much of · unchained: set free from chains; released · obliterate: to erase completely · amphitheatre: a sloping gallery with seats for spectators (as in an operating room or theater) · playmate: a companion at play

18–28 min · Background and context · I do (10 min)
Mini-lecture (read or adapt the script).
Weddings in this social class involved property arrangements; the Frankensteins regain some of Elizabeth's inheritance. Dramatic irony: readers can see that the threat may be aimed at Elizabeth, while Victor thinks only of his own danger. Characterization: Elizabeth's letter asks if he loves another; Victor hints at a "dreadful secret." Foreshadowing: He prepares to defend himself, not Elizabeth. Irony: The wedding is a step toward the catastrophe. Watch for light and fire: Light stands for knowledge and fire for its double edge: warmth and burning. Victor seeks the "light" of discovery; the creature discovers fire and is burned by it. In this chapter: "I am not mad," I cried energetically; "the sun and the heavens, who have viewed my operations, can bear witness" (Chapter XXII, paragraph 6).

28–40 min · I do: modeled close reading · I do (12 min)
Model the close reading of the anchor quotation using the written think-aloud below.
I read the line once for meaning and once for craft. "Do you not love another" (Chapter XXII, paragraph 14). Elizabeth's honest question. That is characterization at work: Elizabeth's letter asks if he loves another; Victor hints at a "dreadful secret."

> *Do you not love another* (Chapter XXII, paragraph 14)

Think-aloud: I read the line once for meaning and once for craft. "Do you not love another" (Chapter XXII, paragraph 14). Elizabeth's honest question. That is characterization at work: Elizabeth's letter asks if he loves another; Victor hints at a "dreadful secret."

40–55 min · We do: guided annotation · We do (15 min)
Guided analysis of a second quotation; expected answers given.
Ask: What words in this line stand out, and what do they suggest? Expected: Confession to his father, dismissed as madness. Look at the craft: He prepares to defend himself, not Elizabeth. Ask: How does this line connect to isolation and companionship? Expected: Secrets poison his relationship with Elizabeth. (Confession to his father, dismissed as madness.)

> *I am the assassin of those most innocent victims; they died by my machinations* (Chapter XXII, paragraph 6)

Ask: What words in this line stand out, and what do they suggest?
Expected answer: Confession to his father, dismissed as madness. Look at the craft: He prepares to defend himself, not Elizabeth.
Ask: How does this line connect to isolation and companionship?
Expected answer: Secrets poison his relationship with Elizabeth. (Confession to his father, dismissed as madness.)

55–70 min · You do: independent annotation · You do (15 min)

Independent annotation and a claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph (exemplar given).

Annotate the chapter for characterization, foreshadowing (three marks with a margin note each), then write one claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph: what does this chapter suggest about a letter, a secret and the wedding? Then start your writing prompt at your assigned level (HS Sophomore: Analyze how Chapter XXII develops the idea of a letter, a secret and the wedding. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of foreshadowing and irony shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.)

Exemplar: Victor's secrecy leaves Elizabeth vulnerable. When the text says “I am the assassin of those most innocent victims; they died by my machinations” (Chapter XXII, paragraph 6), it shows this directly. He confesses only in riddles ("I am the assassin") and fixates on the creature's threat to himself, so the one person who loves him never learns the danger she is in.

Task: Annotate the chapter for characterization, foreshadowing (three marks with a margin note each), then write one claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph: what does this chapter suggest about a letter, a secret and the wedding? Then start your writing prompt at your assigned level (HS Sophomore: Analyze how Chapter XXII develops the idea of a letter, a secret and the wedding. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of foreshadowing and irony shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.)

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70–80 min · Discussion · We do (10 min)

Structured discussion from the 30 tiered questions, with facilitation notes.

Anchor question: Why does Victor misread the creature's threat, and what does that reveal about him? Ask: would telling the truth have saved Elizabeth?

Anchor question: Why does Victor misread the creature's threat, and what does that reveal about him?

Facilitation: Ask: would telling the truth have saved Elizabeth?

80–87 min · Exit ticket / chapter quiz · You do (7 min)

Chapter quiz in the app and an exit ticket (answer given).

Chapter quiz in the app, then: In one sentence, what does this chapter suggest about a letter, a secret and the wedding? Support it with one short quotation. Model answer: Victor's secrecy leaves Elizabeth vulnerable. (“I am the assassin of those most innocent victims; they died by my machinations”, Chapter XXII, paragraph 6). Accept any defensible claim backed by a quotation from the chapter; the answer key for the quiz is in the Quiz section.

Exit ticket: In one sentence, what does this chapter suggest about a letter, a secret and the wedding? Support it with one short quotation.

Answer: Model answer: Victor's secrecy leaves Elizabeth vulnerable. (“I am the assassin of those most innocent victims; they died by my machinations”, Chapter XXII, paragraph 6). Accept any defensible claim backed by a quotation from the chapter; the answer key for the quiz is in the Quiz section.

> **87–90 min · Closure · I do (3 min)**
> Summarize the lesson and preview the next reading.
> *Today we saw how characterization shapes a letter, a secret and the wedding. Key takeaway: secrets poison his relationship with Elizabeth.*

Total: 90 minutes.

Teacher analysis (spoilers)

Literary elements

- **Characterization:** Elizabeth's letter asks if he loves another; Victor hints at a "dreadful secret."
- **Foreshadowing:** He prepares to defend himself, not Elizabeth.
- **Irony:** The wedding is a step toward the catastrophe.

Themes and how they develop

- **isolation and companionship:** secrets poison his relationship with Elizabeth.

Symbols and motifs

- **light and fire:** Light stands for knowledge and fire for its double edge: warmth and burning. Victor seeks the "light" of discovery; the creature discovers fire and is burned by it. In this chapter: “I am not mad,” I cried energetically; “the sun and the heavens, who have viewed my operations, can bear witness” (Chapter XXII, paragraph 6).
- **sublime nature:** Mountains, glaciers, storms and lakes reflect and sometimes soothe the characters' feelings; the sublime is both comfort and terror. In this chapter: “had ever been since my journey to the sea of ice” (Chapter XXII, paragraph 8).

Key quotations (checked against the reading text)

- “Do you not love another” (Chapter XXII, paragraph 14) Elizabeth's honest question.
- “I am the assassin of those most innocent victims; they died by my machinations” (Chapter XXII, paragraph 6) Confession to his father, dismissed as madness.
- “I shall be with you on your wedding night” (Chapter XXII, paragraph 29) Repetition of the threat.

Model claim-evidence-reasoning

> **Claim:** Victor's secrecy leaves Elizabeth vulnerable.
> **Evidence:** “I am the assassin of those most innocent victims; they died by my machinations” (Chapter XXII, paragraph 6)
> **Reasoning:** He confesses only in riddles ("I am the assassin") and fixates on the creature's threat to himself, so the one person who loves him never learns the danger she is in.

Vocabulary with etymology notes

Word		In context	Word history

	Definition (in this sentence)		
overtaxed (verb)	strained by asking too much of	*I soon found that I had overtaxed my strength, and that I must repose before I could continue my journey.*	"overtaxed": From over + tax. (Wiktionary, https://en.wiktionary.org/wiki/overtax#Etymology)
unchained (verb)	set free from chains; released	*I had unchained an enemy among them, whose joy it was to shed their blood, and to revel in their groans.*	
obliterate (verb)	to erase completely	*He wished as much as possible to obliterate the memory of the scenes that had taken place in Ireland, and never alluded to them, or suffered me to speak of my misfortunes.*	
amphitheatre (noun)	a sloping gallery with seats for spectators (as in an operating room or theater)	*The Alps here come closer to the lake, and we approached the amphitheatre of mountains which forms its eastern boundary.*	
playmate (noun)	a companion at play	*Victor, be assured that your cousin and playmate has too sincere a love for you not to be made miserable by this supposition.*	"playmate": From play + mate. Compare earlier playfeer "playmate" of similar construction. (Wiktionary, https://en.wiktionary.org/wiki/playmate#Etymology)
centred (verb)	focused; concentrated (British spelling)	*I said, "little happiness remains for us on earth; yet all that I may one day enjoy is centred in you.*	
futility (noun)	uselessness as a consequence of having no practical result	*Sometimes he thought that I felt deeply the degradation of being obliged to answer a charge of murder, and he endeavoured to prove to me the futility of pride.*	"futility": From Latin fūtilitās "worthlessness, futility". By surface analysis, futile + -ity. (Wiktionary, https://en.wiktionary.org/wiki/futility#Etymology)
penniless (adjective)	not having enough money to pay for necessities	*Alas! what freedom? such as the peasant enjoys when his family have been massacred before his eyes, his cottage burnt, his lands laid waste, and he is turned adrift, homeless, penniless, and alone, but free.*	"penniless": From Middle English penyles, penylees; equivalent to penny + less. Compare Old Norse penningalauss "penniless". (Wiktionary, https://en.wiktionary.org/wiki/penniless#Etymology)
conduce (verb)	be conducive to	*I resolved, therefore, that if my immediate union with my cousin*	

		would conduce either to hers or my father's happiness, my adversary's designs against my life should not retard it a single hour.	
menaces (noun)	something that is a source of danger	*My destruction might indeed arrive a few months sooner; but if my torturer should suspect that I postponed it, influenced by his menaces, he would surely find other, and perhaps more dreadful means of revenge.*	"menaces": From Middle English manace, from Old French manace, menace, &c., from Late Latin minācia "threat, menace", from Latin mināx "threatening" + -ia. (Wiktionary, https://en.wiktionary.org/wiki/menace#Etymology)

Discussion questions

1. Why does Victor misread the creature's threat, and what does that reveal about him?
2. Where does foreshadowing appear in this chapter, and what effect does it have? Point to one passage.
3. How does this chapter connect to the book's larger concern with isolation and the need for companionship?

Classroom discussion questions (30, tiered)

Wait time after every question (3 s for DOK 1, 5 s for DOK 2, 8 to 10 s for DOK 3 and 4); think-pair-share on DOK 3 and 4; answer each response with a follow-up probe; close with student-generated questions. Focus sets by rigor level: Middle School: 1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 6, 11, 12, 13, 14, 21, 22; HS Freshman: 1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 12, 13, 14, 15, 22, 23, 24; HS Sophomore: 1, 2, 3, 4, 13, 14, 15, 16, 17, 23, 24, 25; HS Junior: 1, 2, 3, 14, 15, 16, 17, 18, 24, 25, 26, 27; HS Senior: 1, 2, 3, 15, 16, 17, 18, 25, 26, 27, 28, 29; AP: 1, 2, 16, 17, 18, 19, 20, 26, 27, 28, 29, 30; College Freshman: 1, 2, 17, 18, 19, 20, 21, 22, 27, 28, 29, 30; College Sophomore: 1, 2, 11, 18, 19, 20, 21, 22, 23, 28, 29, 30; College Junior: 1, 11, 12, 19, 20, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 29, 30; College Senior: 1, 11, 12, 13, 20, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 26, 30; Graduate / PhD: 1, 11, 12, 13, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 26, 27, 28

Literal / recall

1. Who travels with Victor to Paris and cares for him there? [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · 7.RC.1, 7.CC.1, 9-10.RC.1] Look for: His father
2. What does Victor promise to tell Elizabeth the day after the wedding? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · 7.RC.1, 7.CC.1, 9-10.RC.1] Look for: His dreadful secret
3. Whom does Victor believe the creature will attack on the wedding night? [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · 7.RC.1, 7.CC.1, 9-10.RC.1] Look for: Himself
4. How do Victor and Elizabeth travel after the ceremony? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · 7.RC.1, 7.CC.1, 9-10.RC.1] Look for: By boat across the lake to Evian
5. What does Victor carry to protect himself? [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · 7.RC.1, 7.CC.1, 9-10.RC.1] Look for: Pistols and a dagger
6. Retell the three most important events of "Chapter XXII" in order, in one sentence each. [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · 7.RC.1, 7.CC.1, 9-10.RC.1] Look for: Victor recovers in Paris with his father, who takes his claim that he murdered William, Justine and Clerval as delirium. Elizabeth writes asking whether he loves someone else; Victor

answers that he has one dreadful secret, which he will confide to her the day after their marriage. Remembering the creature's threat (“I will be with you on your wedding night”), he assumes he himself is the target…

7. Which characters appear or are mentioned in “Chapter XXII”? Name two and one thing each says or does. [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · 7.RC.1, 7.CC.1, 9-10.RC.1] Look for: Names and actions taken from the chapter; check against the teacher summary.
8. Where and when does “Chapter XXII” take place? Point to the line that tells you. [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · 7.RC.1, 7.CC.1, 9-10.RC.1] Look for: A place/time detail quoted from the chapter.
9. Reread: “I soon found that I had overtaxed my strength, and that I must repose before I could continue my journey.” What does “overtaxed” mean here, and what is literally happening in this line? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · 7.RC.1, 7.CC.1, 9-10.RC.1] Look for: overtaxed: strained by asking too much of.
10. Reread: “I had unchained an enemy among them, whose joy it was to shed their blood, and to revel in their groans.” What does “unchained” mean here, and what is literally happening in this line? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · 7.RC.1, 7.CC.1, 9-10.RC.1] Look for: unchained: set free from chains; released.

Inferential / analytical

1. What does “Chapter XXII” suggest about a letter, a secret and the wedding? State the inference and the line that supports it. [DOK 2 · thinkPairShare · wait 5 s · 7.RC.2, 7.CC.2, 9-10.RC.2] Look for: Dramatic irony: readers can see that the threat may be aimed at Elizabeth, while Victor thinks only of his own danger.
2. Find one example of foreshadowing in this chapter. What does it reveal that a plain statement would not? [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · 7.RC.3, 7.CC.2, 9-10.RC.3] Look for: Look for hints, warnings or images that point to later events.
3. How does the irony in this chapter shape what we understand about a letter, a secret and the wedding? [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · 7.RC.1, 7.CC.2, 9-10.RC.1] Look for: Look for gaps between what characters expect or say and what is true.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Victor's secrecy leaves Elizabeth vulnerable. Useful evidence: “Do you not love another” (Chapter XXII, paragraph 14): Elizabeth's honest question. On irony: The wedding is a step toward the catastrophe. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
4. In the passage that begins “My father yielded at length to my desire to avoid society, and strove by various arguments to banish my despair.”, why might Shelley have chosen these particular words? Pick two and explain their connotations. [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · 7.RC.12, 7.CC.2, 9-10.RC.12] Look for: Diction analysis of two words in the anchor passage.
5. What causes the main turn in “Chapter XXII”, and what effect is it likely to have on what follows? [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · 7.RC.3, 7.CC.2, 9-10.RC.1] Look for: Victor recovers in Paris with his father, who takes his claim that he murdered William, Justine and Clerval as delirium. Elizabeth writes asking whether he loves someone else; Victor answers that he has one dreadful secret, which he will confide to her the day after their marriage. Remembering the…
6. How does “Chapter XXII” build on “Chapter XXI”? Name one link of cause and effect. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · 7.RC.3, 7.CC.2, 9-10.RC.3] Look for: A causal or structural link between this and the previous chapter.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Victor's secrecy leaves Elizabeth vulnerable. Useful evidence: “I am the assassin of those most innocent victims; they died by my machinations” (Chapter XXII, paragraph 6): Confession to his father, dismissed as madness. Theme link: secrets poison his relationship

with Elizabeth. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

7. What can we infer about a character's motives from what they say and do here, as opposed to what they claim? [DOK 3 · followUp · wait 8 s · 7.RC.3, 7.CC.2, 9-10.RC.1] Look for: An inference about motive supported by a quoted line.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Victor's secrecy leaves Elizabeth vulnerable. Useful evidence: “I shall be with you on your wedding night” (Chapter XXII, paragraph 29): Repetition of the threat. On characterization: Elizabeth's letter asks if he loves another; Victor hints at a "dreadful secret." Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
8. The bell-ringer asked: “Why does Victor misread the creature's threat, and what does that reveal about him?” Now that we have read closely, how would you revise your first answer, and which line changed your mind? [DOK 2 · thinkPairShare · wait 5 s · 7.RC.2, 7.CC.2, 9-10.RC.2] Look for: A revised answer anchored in the text.
9. Where does characterization appear, and how does it connect this chapter to the larger concern with isolation and the need for companionship? [DOK 3 · followUp · wait 8 s · 7.RC.3, 7.CC.2, 9-10.RC.1] Look for: Look for what characters say, do and think, and how others react to them.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Victor's secrecy leaves Elizabeth vulnerable. Useful evidence: “Do you not love another” (Chapter XXII, paragraph 14): Elizabeth's honest question. On characterization: Elizabeth's letter asks if he loves another; Victor hints at a "dreadful secret." Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
10. Background: Weddings in this social class involved property arrangements; the Frankensteins regain some of Elizabeth's inheritance. How does knowing this change the way you read one moment in the chapter? [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · 7.RC.3, 7.CC.2, 9-10.RC.1] Look for: A specific moment reread in light of the context.
    Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Victor's secrecy leaves Elizabeth vulnerable. Useful evidence: “I am the assassin of those most innocent victims; they died by my machinations” (Chapter XXII, paragraph 6): Confession to his father, dismissed as madness. Theme link: secrets poison his relationship with Elizabeth. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

Evaluative / synthesis / creative

1. A critic might argue: “Dramatic irony: readers can see that the threat may be aimed at Elizabeth, while Victor thinks only of his own danger.” How far do you agree? Take a stand and defend it with two lines from the chapter. [DOK 3 · fourCorners · wait 8 s · 7.RC.2, 7.CC.3, 9-10.RC.2] Look for: A defended position with evidence and one counterpoint.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Victor's secrecy leaves Elizabeth vulnerable. Useful evidence: “I shall be with you on your wedding night” (Chapter XXII, paragraph 29): Repetition of the threat. Theme link: secrets poison his relationship with Elizabeth. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
2. Which character in this chapter acts most wisely, and which least? Judge them by a standard you name. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · 7.RC.3, 7.CC.3, 9-10.RC.1] Look for: An evaluation using an explicit criterion and evidence.

Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Victor's secrecy leaves Elizabeth vulnerable. Useful evidence: “Do you not love another” (Chapter XXII, paragraph 14): Elizabeth's honest question. On characterization: Elizabeth's letter asks if he loves another; Victor hints at a "dreadful secret." Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

3. Rewrite one moment of “Chapter XXII” from the point of view of a different character. What does the new angle reveal or hide about a letter, a secret and the wedding? [DOK 4 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · 7.RC.1, 7.CC.3, 9-10.RC.1] Look for: A creative product with a rationale tied to the text.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Victor's secrecy leaves Elizabeth vulnerable. Useful evidence: “I am the assassin of those most innocent victims; they died by my machinations” (Chapter XXII, paragraph 6): Confession to his father, dismissed as madness. Theme link: secrets poison his relationship with Elizabeth. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

4. Write three questions of your own about “Chapter XXII”: one recall, one “why/how”, and one “should/what if”. Trade with a partner and answer theirs. [DOK 3 · studentGenerated · wait 8 s · 7.RC.2, 7.CC.3, 9-10.RC.2] Look for: Student-generated questions at three levels.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Victor's secrecy leaves Elizabeth vulnerable. Useful evidence: “I shall be with you on your wedding night” (Chapter XXII, paragraph 29): Repetition of the threat. Theme link: secrets poison his relationship with Elizabeth. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

5. Connect this chapter to nature versus nurture: is the link strong or weak so far? What would Shelley need to show next to strengthen it? [DOK 4 · socraticCircle · wait 8 s · 7.RC.2, 7.CC.3, 9-10.RC.2] Look for: A judgment of thematic development across the work.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Victor's secrecy leaves Elizabeth vulnerable. Useful evidence: “Do you not love another” (Chapter XXII, paragraph 14): Elizabeth's honest question. Theme link: secrets poison his relationship with Elizabeth. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

6. Is the foreshadowing in this chapter effective, or does it feel heavy-handed? Evaluate it as a reader would in a review. [DOK 3 · fourCorners · wait 8 s · 7.RC.3, 7.CC.3, 9-10.RC.3] Look for: An evaluative judgment with criteria and evidence.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Victor's secrecy leaves Elizabeth vulnerable. Useful evidence: “I am the assassin of those most innocent victims; they died by my machinations” (Chapter XXII, paragraph 6): Confession to his father, dismissed as madness. On foreshadowing: He prepares to defend himself, not Elizabeth. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

7. Compare how “Chapter XXII” treats a letter, a secret and the wedding with how another text, film or event you know treats a similar idea. What does Frankenstein see that the other misses? [DOK 4 · socraticCircle · wait 8 s · 7.RC.2, 7.CC.3, 9-10.RC.2] Look for: A cross-text synthesis.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Victor's secrecy leaves Elizabeth vulnerable. Useful evidence: “I shall be with you on your wedding night” (Chapter XXII, paragraph 29): Repetition of the threat. Theme link: secrets poison his relationship with Elizabeth. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

8. Predict what “Chapter XXIII” will bring, using two clues from this chapter. After reading, evaluate your prediction. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · 7.RC.3, 7.CC.3, 9-10.RC.3] Look for: A prediction or judgment justified with textual clues.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Victor's secrecy leaves Elizabeth vulnerable. Useful evidence: “Do you not love another” (Chapter XXII, paragraph 14): Elizabeth's honest question. On foreshadowing: He prepares to defend himself, not Elizabeth. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
9. Design a one-paragraph modern adaptation of this chapter (setting, characters, conflict). What must stay the same for it to still be about a letter, a secret and the wedding? [DOK 4 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · 7.RC.2, 7.CC.3, 9-10.RC.2] Look for: A creative transfer that keeps the core idea.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Victor's secrecy leaves Elizabeth vulnerable. Useful evidence: “I am the assassin of those most innocent victims; they died by my machinations” (Chapter XXII, paragraph 6): Confession to his father, dismissed as madness. Theme link: secrets poison his relationship with Elizabeth. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
10. What question would you most like to ask Mary Shelley about this chapter, and what answer do you think the text itself gives? [DOK 4 · studentGenerated · wait 8 s · 7.RC.2, 7.CC.3, 9-10.RC.2] Look for: A student-generated question answered from evidence.
    Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Victor's secrecy leaves Elizabeth vulnerable. Useful evidence: “I shall be with you on your wedding night” (Chapter XXII, paragraph 29): Repetition of the threat. Theme link: secrets poison his relationship with Elizabeth. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

Annotation focus

- **Foreshadowing:** look for hints, warnings or images that point to later events (anchor passage in the We do segment)
- Also notice **Irony**: gaps between what characters expect or say and what is true
- Also notice **Characterization**: what characters say, do and think, and how others react to them

Chapter quiz: item bank (all eleven rigor versions)

1. [mc · recall · DOK 1] Whom does Victor believe the creature will attack on the wedding night?
   A. Elizabeth
   B. Himself
   C. Ernest
   D. His father

   Key: B (Himself)
2. [mc · recall · DOK 1] In the line “The Alps here come closer to the lake, and we approached the amphitheatre of mountains which forms its eastern boundary.”, what does “amphitheatre” most nearly mean?
   A. abundant wealth
   B. a small, agile mountain goat
   C. a sloping gallery with seats for spectators (as in an operating room or theater)
   D. seize on its way

Key: C (a sloping gallery with seats for spectators (as in an operating room or theater))

3. [fill · recall · DOK 1] Fill in the blank with the vocabulary word that fits: “Alas! what freedom? such as the peasant enjoys when his family have been massacred before his eyes, his cottage burnt, his lands laid waste, and he is turned adrift, homeless, _____, and alone, but free.” Word bank: penniless, obliterate, overtaxed, unchained

   Key: penniless

4. [mc · recall · DOK 1] Who travels with Victor to Paris and cares for him there?

   A. His father

   B. Elizabeth

   C. Walton

   D. Clerval

   Key: A (His father)

5. [mc · recall · DOK 1] In the line “I soon found that I had overtaxed my strength, and that I must repose before I could continue my journey.”, what does “overtaxed” most nearly mean?

   A. strained by asking too much of

   B. get on top of; deal with successfully

   C. drifting on water

   D. porridge made of rolled oats

   Key: A (strained by asking too much of)

6. [fill · recall · DOK 1] Fill in the blank with the vocabulary word that fits: “Sometimes he thought that I felt deeply the degradation of being obliged to answer a charge of murder, and he endeavoured to prove to me the _____ of pride.” Word bank: overtaxed, futility, obliterate, unchained

   Key: futility

7. [mc · recall · DOK 1] How do Victor and Elizabeth travel after the ceremony?

   A. By ship to England

   B. By boat across the lake to Evian

   C. By coach to Paris

   D. On foot to Chamounix

   Key: B (By boat across the lake to Evian)

8. [fill · recall · DOK 1] Complete the quotation from Chapter XXII, paragraph 29: “I shall be with you on your _____ night”

   Key: wedding

9. [fill · recall · DOK 1] Fill in the blank with the vocabulary word that fits: “I said, “little happiness remains for us on earth; yet all that I may one day enjoy is _____ in you.” Word bank: overtaxed, centred, obliterate, unchained

   Key: centred

10. [short · inference · DOK 2] What can you infer from this line? “Do you not love another” (Chapter XXII, paragraph 14) Answer in two or three sentences with one detail.

    Sample answer: Elizabeth's honest question.

11. [mc · inference · DOK 2] Which choice best states a central concern of “Chapter XXII”?

    A. A letter, a secret and the wedding

    B. Confidence before danger

C. Destroying the companion

D. The final reckoning

Key: A (A letter, a secret and the wedding)

12. [short · inference · DOK 2] What can you infer from this line? “I am the assassin of those most innocent victims; they died by my machinations” (Chapter XXII, paragraph 6) Answer in two or three sentences with one detail.

Sample answer: Confession to his father, dismissed as madness.

13. [mc · inference · DOK 2] What does this passage most clearly show? “I am the assassin of those most innocent victims; they died by my machinations” (Chapter XXII, paragraph 6)

A. The discovery itself, told without explanation; Victor withholds the secret.

B. The heart of Victor's ambition: more than anyone before.

C. Confession to his father, dismissed as madness.

D. "Divine" means to discover by intuition and also suggests godlike power.

Key: C (Confession to his father, dismissed as madness.)

14. [mc · analysis · DOK 3] Which literary element does this describe in “Chapter XXII”? Elizabeth's letter asks if he loves another; Victor hints at a "dreadful secret."

A. Simile

B. Diction / vocabulary

C. Characterization

D. Tone / mood

Key: C (Characterization)

15. [mc · analysis · DOK 3] Which literary element does this describe in “Chapter XXII”? He prepares to defend himself, not Elizabeth.

A. Theme

B. Tone / mood

C. Simile

D. Foreshadowing

Key: D (Foreshadowing)

16. [short · synthesis · DOK 4] Close reading: how do the diction and syntax of “Do you not love another” (Chapter XXII, paragraph 14) shape its meaning? Consider a second, competing reading.

Sample answer: Elizabeth's honest question.

17. [mc · recall · DOK 1] What does Victor promise to tell Elizabeth the day after the wedding?

A. Where he hid the journal

B. Why he left Ingolstadt

C. The name of a rival

D. His dreadful secret

Key: D (His dreadful secret)

18. [mc · recall · DOK 1] In the line “I had unchained an enemy among them, whose joy it was to shed their blood, and to revel in their groans.”, what does “unchained” most nearly mean?

A. to grant; to give

B. set free from chains; released

C. calms; settles

D. regular court sessions held in English counties (until 1971)

Key: B (set free from chains; released)

19. [fill · recall · DOK 1] Fill in the blank with the vocabulary word that fits: “Victor, be assured that your cousin and _____ has too sincere a love for you not to be made miserable by this supposition.” Word bank: unchained, overtaxed, playmate, obliterate

    Key: playmate

20. [mc · inference · DOK 2] What does this passage most clearly show? “Do you not love another” (Chapter XXII, paragraph 14)

    A. Elizabeth's honest question.

    B. The master has become the slave; a reversal the creature will state aloud in Chapter XX.

    C. Self-horror learned from others' standards of beauty.

    D. Restoration that the reader suspects cannot last.

    Key: A (Elizabeth's honest question.)

21. [short · analysis · DOK 3] Claim: Victor's secrecy leaves Elizabeth vulnerable. Explain how this evidence supports the claim: “I am the assassin of those most innocent victims; they died by my machinations” (Chapter XXII, paragraph 6).

    Sample answer: He confesses only in riddles ("I am the assassin") and fixates on the creature's threat to himself, so the one person who loves him never learns the danger she is in.

22. [short · synthesis · DOK 4] Synthesis: trace how isolation and companionship develops from an earlier chapter to “Chapter XXII”. Use one quotation from each.

    Sample answer: secrets poison his relationship with Elizabeth.

23. [mc · recall · DOK 1] In the line “He wished as much as possible to obliterate the memory of the scenes that had taken place in Ireland, and never alluded to them, or suffered me to speak of my misfortunes.”, what does “obliterate” most nearly mean?

    A. loud, deep sounds

    B. to erase completely

    C. impossible to overcome

    D. adjusted in tone

    Key: B (to erase completely)

24. [mc · inference · DOK 2] What does this passage most clearly show? “I shall be with you on your wedding night” (Chapter XXII, paragraph 29)

    A. A question of identity.

    B. Metaphor tying his ruin to the blasted oak.

    C. "Divine" means to discover by intuition and also suggests godlike power.

    D. Repetition of the threat.

    Key: D (Repetition of the threat.)

25. [short · synthesis · DOK 4] Evaluate this claim about the chapter: “Victor's secrecy leaves Elizabeth vulnerable.” Is it fully persuasive? Argue with evidence, including a passage that complicates it.

Sample answer: He confesses only in riddles ("I am the assassin") and fixates on the creature's threat to himself, so the one person who loves him never learns the danger she is in.

26. [fill · recall · DOK 1] Complete the quotation from Chapter XXII, paragraph 6: "I am the assassin of those most innocent victims; they died by my _____"

    Key: machinations

27. [short · analysis · DOK 3] Analyze the word choice in "I shall be with you on your wedding night" (Chapter XXII, paragraph 29). Pick two words and explain what they suggest.

    Sample answer: Repetition of the threat.

28. [short · synthesis · DOK 4] Close reading: how do the diction and syntax of "I am the assassin of those most innocent victims; they died by my machinations" (Chapter XXII, paragraph 6) shape its meaning? Consider a second, competing reading.

    Sample answer: Confession to his father, dismissed as madness.

29. [mc · recall · DOK 1] What does Victor carry to protect himself?

    A. A sword

    B. A letter of safe conduct

    C. Nothing

    D. Pistols and a dagger

    Key: D (Pistols and a dagger)

Rigor version	Items (in order)	Mix
Middle School	1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 6, 7, 8, 9, 10, 11, 12, 13, 14, 15, 16	recall 9, inference 4, analysis 2, synthesis 1
HS Freshman	17, 18, 5, 6, 3, 4, 19, 7, 11, 20, 12, 10, 14, 15, 21, 22	recall 8, inference 4, analysis 3, synthesis 1
HS Sophomore	18, 4, 9, 23, 8, 7, 10, 13, 24, 20, 12, 14, 21, 15, 25, 16	recall 6, inference 5, analysis 3, synthesis 2
HS Junior	5, 2, 6, 3, 26, 12, 24, 11, 10, 13, 14, 27, 21, 15, 28, 22	recall 5, inference 5, analysis 4, synthesis 2
HS Senior	19, 4, 29, 6, 11, 20, 24, 10, 13, 14, 15, 27, 21, 28, 25, 16	recall 4, inference 5, analysis 4, synthesis 3
AP	19, 26, 17, 13, 24, 20, 10, 11, 14, 27, 15, 21, 16, 22, 25, 28	recall 3, inference 5, analysis 4, synthesis 4
College Freshman	9, 1, 3, 12, 24, 13, 11, 20, 15, 27, 21, 14, 16, 25, 22, 28	recall 3, inference 5, analysis 4, synthesis 4
College Sophomore	19, 9, 10, 12, 20, 24, 11, 13, 15, 21, 27, 14, 25, 22, 28, 16	recall 2, inference 6, analysis 4, synthesis 4
College Junior	3, 19, 11, 10, 20, 12, 13, 24, 15, 21, 14, 27, 16, 28, 22, 25	recall 2, inference 6, analysis 4, synthesis 4
College Senior	19, 6, 11, 13, 12, 10, 20, 24, 21, 27, 15, 14, 22, 25, 16, 28	recall 2, inference 6, analysis 4, synthesis 4
Graduate / PhD	3, 19, 12, 10, 24, 13, 11, 20, 14, 21, 15, 27, 25, 28, 16, 22	

		recall 2, inference 6, analysis 4, synthesis 4

Writing prompts (eleven rigor levels)

Middle School (250 words; Indiana 2023: 7.RC.3, 7.W.1): Supported track (work from the passage your teacher selects). In “Chapter XXII,” how does Shelley show a letter, a secret and the wedding? Write a paragraph that states your claim, quotes two details from the passage, and explains how each detail supports your idea. Use the foreshadowing you noticed as one piece of evidence.

HS Freshman (350 words; Indiana 2023: 9-10.RC.3, 9-10.W.1): In Chapter XXII, how does Shelley develop the idea of a letter, a secret and the wedding? State a clear claim, support it with two or three quotations, and explain how the foreshadowing in the chapter helps build that idea.

HS Sophomore (450 words; Indiana 2023: 9-10.RC.3, 9-10.W.1): Analyze how Chapter XXII develops the idea of a letter, a secret and the wedding. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of foreshadowing and irony shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.

HS Junior (550 words; Indiana 2023: 11-12.RC.3, 11-12.RC.1, 11-12.W.1): Analyze how the structure of Chapter XXII (where it begins, turns and ends) and its foreshadowing shape the reader's understanding of a letter, a secret and the wedding. Identify one place where the text leaves matters uncertain and explain how that uncertainty adds to its meaning.

HS Senior (600 words; Indiana 2023: 11-12.RC.3, 11-12.W.1): Two readers disagree about what Chapter XXII suggests about a letter, a secret and the wedding. Lay out two plausible interpretations, weigh the evidence for each (including the chapter's foreshadowing and irony), and argue for the stronger one in a sustained, well-organized essay.

AP (650 words; Indiana 2023: 11-12.RC.3, 11-12.W.1): Write a literary argument in which you analyze how Mary Shelley uses foreshadowing in Chapter XXII to complicate the reader's understanding of a letter, a secret and the wedding. Develop a defensible thesis, select evidence purposefully, and explain how specific choices of diction and syntax create meaning.

College Freshman (1000 words; Indiana 2023: see unit standards): Situate Chapter XXII within its historical and literary context and argue how the chapter's treatment of a letter, a secret and the wedding responds to that context. Engage with at least one secondary perspective (a critic, historian or the author's own statements), integrate quotations smoothly, and cite in MLA style.

College Sophomore (1250 words; Indiana 2023: see unit standards): Read Chapter XXII alongside the conventions of its genre and period. Argue how the chapter's handling of a letter, a secret and the wedding follows or bends those conventions, using the foreshadowing as evidence, and test your reading against one published critic. Document two secondary sources in MLA.

College Junior (1500 words; Indiana 2023: see unit standards): Apply a named critical approach (for example formalist, historicist, feminist, psychoanalytic or ecocritical) to Chapter XXII and its treatment of a letter, a

secret and the wedding. State your method, show what it reveals in the chapter's foreshadowing and irony, and identify where the text resists it.

College Senior (2000 words; Indiana 2023: see unit standards): Develop a research argument that reads Chapter XXII as evidence for a larger claim about a letter, a secret and the wedding in Frankenstein. Connect close reading of the chapter to the whole novel, engage at least four scholarly sources, and state precisely where your reading departs from theirs (Chicago style).

Graduate / PhD (2500 words; Indiana 2023: see unit standards): Develop an original argument that reads Chapter XXII as a hinge in the novel's larger treatment of a letter, a secret and the wedding. Position your reading within a named critical conversation (for example formalist, historicist, psychoanalytic, feminist or postcolonial approaches), account for the textual history where relevant, and articulate the stakes of your intervention for scholarship on Frankenstein.

SAT-style questions

1. *He wished as much as possible to obliterate the memory of the scenes that had taken place in Ireland, and never alluded to them, or suffered me to speak of my misfortunes.*

   As used in the text, what does the word “obliterate” most nearly mean?

   A. to erase completely

   B. something that is a source of danger

   C. be conducive to

   D. not having enough money to pay for necessities

2. *My father yielded at length to my desire to avoid society, and strove by various arguments to banish my despair. Sometimes he thought that I felt deeply the degradation of being obliged to answer a charge of murder, and he endeavoured to prove to me the futility of pride.*

   Which choice best states a central concern of “Chapter XXII”?

   A. Injustice and exile

   B. The wedding night and its catastrophe

   C. A letter, a secret and the wedding

   D. First experiences of the senses

SAT key: 1. A (to erase completely); 2. C (A letter, a secret and the wedding)

Lesson 30: Chapter XXIII

Focus: the wedding night and its catastrophe

Objective: Students will analyze how foreshadowing develops in “Chapter XXIII” by writing a claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph that cites at least 2 quotations from the section, and will score at least 80% on the section quiz.

Standards: CCSS RL.9-10.5, W.9-10.1, L.9-10.4 · IN 9-10.RC.3, 9-10.W.1, 9-10.RC.9, 9-10.RC.11

Critical voice: “After the death of Elizabeth, the story, like a stream which grows at once more rapid and profound as it proceeds, assumes an irresistible solemnity, and the magnificent energy and swiftness of a tempest.” (Percy Bysshe Shelley, poet, *"On 'Frankenstein'" (written c.1817; pub. The Athenaeum, 10 Nov 1832), in The Prose Works of Percy Bysshe Shelley (1880), paragraph 4*; public domain). Craft focus: mark how sentence length and chapter speed change after Elizabeth's death. Does the "tempest" image fit? *Objective:* Analyze pacing and structure in the catastrophe of the wedding night. *Standards:* RL.11-12.5, 11-12.RC.3

Content note (murder, grief): Elizabeth is murdered on her wedding night and Victor's father dies of grief. Allow students space; do not ask for vivid description.
Student preview: This chapter includes a murder and a death from grief.
Suggested language: “How does loss change Victor's purpose?”

Teacher only · spoilers

At the inn at Evian, Victor, pistol in hand, sends Elizabeth to bed while he searches the house; he then hears her scream and finds her murdered. He sees the creature grinning at the window and fires, but it escapes into the lake. Victor returns to Geneva, where his father dies of grief within days. Victor is confined for months as a madman; on release he tells his story to a Genevan magistrate, who listens with half-belief but doubts anything can be done, and Victor vows to pursue the creature himself.

Background: Weddings in this social class involved property arrangements; after Victor's release his family's affairs are settled and he leaves Geneva for good.

Significance: The catastrophe Victor never foresaw shows how completely his self-absorption has blinded him; his loss turns him into the creature's pursuer.

Lesson plan and lecture script (90 minutes)

0–8 min · Bell-ringer · You do (8 min)
Students write to the bell-ringer, then pair-share.
How does the wedding-night catastrophe change Victor from creator to hunter? Write for five minutes. Starters: I think... because... / This connects to creation and responsibility because.... Content note before we start: This chapter includes a murder and a death from grief.
Prompt: How does the wedding-night catastrophe change Victor from creator to hunter?
Sentence starters: I think… because… · This connects to creation and responsibility because…
Strong response: A strong response takes a position and anticipates this: Victor becomes the pursuer.

8–18 min · Vocabulary with etymology notes · I do (10 min)
Five key words in context, with verified word histories.
Today's words: deviating — turning aside; straying; inspecting — looking at closely; examining; intimidated — frightened; made fearful; seizure — capture; being taken by force; maddening — driving one wild. “deviating”: From Late Latin dēviātus, perfect passive participle of dēviō, see -ate for more. Compare French dévier. “inspecting”: From Latin inspectum, past participle of inspicere "to look into", from in "in" + specere "to look at", equivalent to in + spect. “intimidated”: From Medieval Latin intimidātus, perfect passive participle of Latin intimidō "to intimidate, terrify" (see -ate), from in- "in" + timidus "afraid, timid" + -ō; see timid.
Words: deviating: turning aside; straying · inspecting: looking at closely; examining · intimidated: frightened; made fearful · seizure: capture; being taken by force · maddening: driving one wild

18–28 min · Background and context · I do (10 min)
Mini-lecture (read or adapt the script).
Weddings in this social class involved property arrangements; after Victor's release his family's affairs are settled and he leaves Geneva for good. The catastrophe Victor never foresaw shows how completely his self-absorption has blinded him; his loss turns him into the creature's pursuer. Plot: Elizabeth's murder on the wedding night; the creature at the window; the father's death. Imagery: Elizabeth "thrown across the bed"; the creature's grin. Characterization: Victor dedicates himself to revenge. Watch for light and fire: Light stands for knowledge and fire for its double edge: warmth and burning. Victor seeks the "light" of discovery; the creature discovers fire and is burned by it. In this chapter: “for a short time on the shore, enjoying the transitory light, and then retired to the inn, and contemplated the lovely scene” (Chapter XXIII, paragraph 1).

28–40 min · I do: modeled close reading · I do (12 min)
Model the close reading of the anchor quotation using the written think-aloud below.
I read the line once for meaning and once for craft. “with his fiendish finger he pointed towards the corpse of my wife” (Chapter XXIII, paragraph 10). Mocking accusation. That is plot at work: Elizabeth's murder on the wedding night; the creature at the window; the father's death.

> *with his fiendish finger he pointed towards the corpse of my wife* (Chapter XXIII, paragraph 10)

Think-aloud: I read the line once for meaning and once for craft. “with his fiendish finger he pointed towards the corpse of my wife” (Chapter XXIII, paragraph 10). Mocking accusation. That is plot at work: Elizabeth's murder on the wedding night; the creature at the window; the father's death.

40–55 min · We do: guided annotation · We do (15 min)
Guided analysis of a second quotation; expected answers given.
Ask: What words in this line stand out, and what do they suggest? Expected: "Lifeless" recalls the lifeless matter of creation: Victor's work turned into death. Ask: How does this line connect to creation and responsibility? Expected: Victor becomes the pursuer. (Echoes the "lifeless matter" of creation.)

> *She was there, lifeless and inanimate, thrown across the bed (Chapter XXIII, paragraph 8)*

Ask: What words in this line stand out, and what do they suggest?
Expected answer: "Lifeless" recalls the lifeless matter of creation: Victor's work turned into death.
Ask: How does this line connect to creation and responsibility?
Expected answer: Victor becomes the pursuer. (Echoes the "lifeless matter" of creation.)

55–70 min · You do: independent annotation · You do (15 min)
Independent annotation and a claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph (exemplar given).
Annotate the chapter for plot, imagery (three marks with a margin note each), then write one claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph: what does this chapter suggest about the wedding night and its catastrophe? Then start your writing prompt at your assigned level (HS Sophomore: Analyze how Chapter XXIII develops the idea of the wedding night and its catastrophe. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of foreshadowing and irony shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.) Exemplar: Elizabeth's murder strips Victor of everything the creature lost, making creator and creation doubles. When the text says “A fiend had snatched from me every hope of future happiness” (Chapter XXIII, paragraph 14), it shows this directly. He says "a fiend had snatched from me every hope of future happiness," the same hopeless isolation the creature described, and like the creature he turns to vengeance.
Task: Annotate the chapter for plot, imagery (three marks with a margin note each), then write one claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph: what does this chapter suggest about the wedding night and its catastrophe? Then start your writing prompt at your assigned level (HS Sophomore: Analyze how Chapter XXIII develops the idea of the wedding night and its catastrophe. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of foreshadowing and irony shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.)
Exemplar: Elizabeth's murder strips Victor of everything the creature lost, making creator and creation doubles. When the text says “A fiend had snatched from me every hope of future happiness” (Chapter XXIII, paragraph 14), it shows this directly. He says "a fiend had snatched from me every hope of future happiness," the same hopeless isolation the creature described, and like the creature he turns to vengeance.

70–80 min · Discussion · We do (10 min)
Structured discussion from the 30 tiered questions, with facilitation notes.
Anchor question: How does the wedding-night catastrophe change Victor from creator to hunter? Ask: who is the monster now?
Anchor question: How does the wedding-night catastrophe change Victor from creator to hunter?
Facilitation: Ask: who is the monster now?

80–87 min · Exit ticket / chapter quiz · You do (7 min)
Chapter quiz in the app and an exit ticket (answer given).
Chapter quiz in the app, then: In one sentence, what does this chapter suggest about the wedding night and its catastrophe? Support it with one short quotation. Model answer: Elizabeth's murder strips Victor of everything the creature lost, making creator and creation doubles. ("A fiend had snatched from me every hope of future happiness", Chapter XXIII, paragraph 14). Accept any defensible claim backed by a quotation from the chapter; the answer key for the quiz is in the Quiz section.
Exit ticket: In one sentence, what does this chapter suggest about the wedding night and its catastrophe? Support it with one short quotation.
Answer: Model answer: Elizabeth's murder strips Victor of everything the creature lost, making creator and creation doubles. ("A fiend had snatched from me every hope of future happiness", Chapter XXIII, paragraph 14). Accept any defensible claim backed by a quotation from the chapter; the answer key for the quiz is in the Quiz section.

87–90 min · Closure · I do (3 min)
Summarize the lesson and preview the next reading.
Today we saw how plot shapes the wedding night and its catastrophe. Key takeaway: Victor becomes the pursuer.

Total: 90 minutes.

Teacher analysis (spoilers)

Literary elements

- **Plot:** Elizabeth's murder on the wedding night; the creature at the window; the father's death.
- **Imagery:** Elizabeth "thrown across the bed"; the creature's grin.
- **Characterization:** Victor dedicates himself to revenge.

Themes and how they develop

- **creation and responsibility:** Victor becomes the pursuer.

Symbols and motifs

- **light and fire:** Light stands for knowledge and fire for its double edge: warmth and burning. Victor seeks the "light" of discovery; the creature discovers fire and is burned by it. In this chapter: "for a short time on the shore, enjoying the transitory light, and then retired to the inn, and contemplated the lovely scene" (Chapter XXIII, paragraph 1).
- **sublime nature:** Mountains, glaciers, storms and lakes reflect and sometimes soothe the characters' feelings; the sublime is both comfort and terror. In this chapter: "inn, and contemplated the lovely scene of waters, woods, and mountains, obscured in darkness, yet still displaying their black outlines" (Chapter XXIII, paragraph 1).

Key quotations (checked against the reading text)

- “She was there, lifeless and inanimate, thrown across the bed” (Chapter XXIII, paragraph 8) Echoes the "lifeless matter" of creation.
- “with his fiendish finger he pointed towards the corpse of my wife” (Chapter XXIII, paragraph 10) Mocking accusation.
- “A fiend had snatched from me every hope of future happiness” (Chapter XXIII, paragraph 14) Total despair; in the next chapter it becomes a vow of revenge.

Model claim-evidence-reasoning

Claim: Elizabeth's murder strips Victor of everything the creature lost, making creator and creation doubles.
Evidence: “A fiend had snatched from me every hope of future happiness” (Chapter XXIII, paragraph 14)
Reasoning: He says "a fiend had snatched from me every hope of future happiness," the same hopeless isolation the creature described, and like the creature he turns to vengeance.

Vocabulary with etymology notes

Word	Definition (in this sentence)	In context	Word history
deviating (verb)	turning aside; straying	*I now related my history, briefly, but with firmness and precision, marking the dates with accuracy, and never deviating into invective or exclamation.*	“deviating”: From Late Latin dēviātus, perfect passive participle of dēviō, see -ate for more. Compare French dévier. (Wiktionary, https://en.wiktionary.org/wiki/deviate#Etymology)
inspecting (verb)	looking at closely; examining	*She left me, and I continued some time walking up and down the passages of the house, and inspecting every corner that might afford a retreat to my adversary.*	“inspecting”: From Latin inspectum, past participle of inspicere "to look into", from in "in" + specere "to look at", equivalent to in + spect. (Wiktionary, https://en.wiktionary.org/wiki/inspect#Etymology)
intimidated (verb)	frightened; made fearful	*As I spoke, rage sparkled in my eyes; the magistrate was intimidated:—“You are mistaken,” said he, “I will exert myself; and if it is in my power to seize the monster, be assured that he shall suffer punishment proportionate to his crimes.*	“intimidated”: From Medieval Latin intimidātus, perfect passive participle of Latin intimidō "to intimidate, terrify" (see -ate), from in- "in" + timidus "afraid, timid" + -ō; see timid. (Wiktionary, https://en.wiktionary.org/wiki/intimidate#Etymology)
seizure (noun)	capture; being taken by force	*When I had concluded my narration, I said, “This is the being whom I accuse, and for whose seizure and punishment I call upon you to exert your whole power.*	
	driving one wild	*I was possessed by a maddening rage when I thought of him, and*	

maddening (adjective)		*desired and ardently prayed that I might have him within my grasp to wreak a great and signal revenge on his cursed head.*	
auditor (noun)	someone who listens attentively	*This address caused a considerable change in the physiognomy of my own auditor.*	“auditor”: From Anglo-Norman auditour, from Latin audītor "hearer, auditor". (Wiktionary, https://en.wiktionary.org/wiki/auditor#Etymology)
tingling (verb)	prickling or stinging slightly	*As I heard it, the whole truth rushed into my mind, my arms dropped, the motion of every muscle and fibre was suspended; I could feel the blood trickling in my veins, and tingling in the extremities of my limbs.*	
intervened (verb)	get involved, so as to alter or hinder an action, or through force or threat of force	*But I discovered no trace of him, and was beginning to conjecture that some fortunate chance had intervened to prevent the execution of his menaces; when suddenly I heard a shrill and dreadful scream.*	
torrents (noun)	a heavy rain	*There were no horses to be procured, and I must return by the lake; but the wind was unfavourable, and the rain fell in torrents.*	“torrents”: Borrowed from French torrent, from Italian torrente, from Latin torrentem, accusative of torrēns "burning, seething, roaring", from Latin torrēre "to parch, scorch". (Wiktionary, https://en.wiktionary.org/wiki/torrent#Etymology)
conjured (verb)	summon into action or bring into existence, often as if by magic	*After passing several hours, we returned hopeless, most of my companions believing it to have been a form conjured up by my fancy.*	“conjured”: From Middle English conjuren, from Old French conjurer, from Latin coniūrō "to swear together; conspire", from con- "with, together" + iūro "to swear or take an oath". (Wiktionary, https://en.wiktionary.org/wiki/conjure#Etymology)

Discussion questions

1. How does the wedding-night catastrophe change Victor from creator to hunter?
2. Where does foreshadowing appear in this chapter, and what effect does it have? Point to one passage.
3. How does this chapter connect to the book's larger concern with nature versus nurture?

Classroom discussion questions (30, tiered)

Wait time after every question (3 s for DOK 1, 5 s for DOK 2, 8 to 10 s for DOK 3 and 4); think-pair-share on DOK 3 and 4; answer each response with a follow-up probe; close with student-generated questions. Focus sets by rigor level: Middle School: 1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 6, 11, 12, 13, 14, 21, 22; HS Freshman: 1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 12, 13, 14, 15, 22, 23, 24; HS Sophomore: 1, 2, 3, 4, 13, 14, 15, 16, 17, 23, 24, 25; HS Junior: 1, 2, 3, 14, 15, 16, 17, 18, 24, 25, 26, 27; HS Senior: 1, 2, 3, 15, 16, 17, 18, 25, 26, 27, 28, 29; AP: 1, 2, 16, 17, 18, 19,

20, 26, 27, 28, 29, 30; College Freshman: 1, 2, 17, 18, 19, 20, 21, 22, 27, 28, 29, 30; College Sophomore: 1, 2, 11, 18, 19, 20, 21, 22, 23, 28, 29, 30; College Junior: 1, 11, 12, 19, 20, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 29, 30; College Senior: 1, 11, 12, 13, 20, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 26, 30; Graduate / PhD: 1, 11, 12, 13, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 26, 27, 28

Literal / recall

1. Where does Elizabeth's murder take place? [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · 7.RC.1, 7.CC.1, 9-10.RC.1] Look for: At the inn at Evian
2. What does Victor see at the window after finding Elizabeth? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · 7.RC.1, 7.CC.1, 9-10.RC.1] Look for: The creature, grinning
3. How does Victor's father die? [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · 7.RC.1, 7.CC.1, 9-10.RC.1] Look for: Of grief, soon after the news
4. What happens to Victor after his father's death? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · 7.RC.1, 7.CC.1, 9-10.RC.1] Look for: He is confined as a madman for months
5. How does the Genevan magistrate respond to Victor's story? [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · 7.RC.1, 7.CC.1, 9-10.RC.1] Look for: With half-belief, doubting anything can be done
6. Retell the three most important events of “Chapter XXIII” in order, in one sentence each. [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · 7.RC.1, 7.CC.1, 9-10.RC.1] Look for: At the inn at Evian, Victor, pistol in hand, sends Elizabeth to bed while he searches the house; he then hears her scream and finds her murdered. He sees the creature grinning at the window and fires, but it escapes into the lake. Victor returns to Geneva, where his father dies of grief within days. Victor is confined for months as a madman; on release he tells his story to a Genevan magistrate,…
7. Which characters appear or are mentioned in “Chapter XXIII”? Name two and one thing each says or does. [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · 7.RC.1, 7.CC.1, 9-10.RC.1] Look for: Names and actions taken from the chapter; check against the teacher summary.
8. Where and when does “Chapter XXIII” take place? Point to the line that tells you. [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · 7.RC.1, 7.CC.1, 9-10.RC.1] Look for: A place/time detail quoted from the chapter.
9. Reread: “I now related my history, briefly, but with firmness and precision, marking the dates with accuracy, and never deviating into invective or exclamation.” What does “deviating” mean here, and what is literally happening in this line? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · 7.RC.1, 7.CC.1, 9-10.RC.1] Look for: deviating: turning aside; straying.
10. Reread: “She left me, and I continued some time walking up and down the passages of the house, and inspecting every corner that might afford a retreat to my adversary.” What does “inspecting” mean here, and what is literally happening in this line? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · 7.RC.1, 7.CC.1, 9-10.RC.1] Look for: inspecting: looking at closely; examining.

Inferential / analytical

1. What does “Chapter XXIII” suggest about the wedding night and its catastrophe? State the inference and the line that supports it. [DOK 2 · thinkPairShare · wait 5 s · 7.RC.2, 7.CC.2, 9-10.RC.2] Look for: The catastrophe Victor never foresaw shows how completely his self-absorption has blinded him; his loss turns him into the creature's pursuer.
2. Find one example of foreshadowing in this chapter. What does it reveal that a plain statement would not? [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · 7.RC.3, 7.CC.2, 9-10.RC.3] Look for: Look for hints, warnings or images that point to later events.

3. How does the irony in this chapter shape what we understand about the wedding night and its catastrophe? [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · 7.RC.1, 7.CC.2, 9-10.RC.1] Look for: Look for gaps between what characters expect or say and what is true.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Elizabeth's murder strips Victor of everything the creature lost, making creator and creation doubles. Useful evidence: “She was there, lifeless and inanimate, thrown across the bed” (Chapter XXIII, paragraph 8): Echoes the "lifeless matter" of creation. Theme link: Victor becomes the pursuer. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
4. In the passage that begins “She left me, and I continued some time walking up and down the passages of the house, and inspecting every corner that might afford a retreat to my adversary.”, why might Shelley have chosen these particular words? Pick two and explain their connotations. [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · 7.RC.12, 7.CC.2, 9-10.RC.12] Look for: Diction analysis of two words in the anchor passage.
5. What causes the main turn in “Chapter XXIII”, and what effect is it likely to have on what follows? [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · 7.RC.3, 7.CC.2, 9-10.RC.1] Look for: At the inn at Evian, Victor, pistol in hand, sends Elizabeth to bed while he searches the house; he then hears her scream and finds her murdered. He sees the creature grinning at the window and fires, but it escapes into the lake. Victor returns to Geneva, where his father dies of grief within…
6. How does “Chapter XXIII” build on “Chapter XXII”? Name one link of cause and effect. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · 7.RC.3, 7.CC.2, 9-10.RC.3] Look for: A causal or structural link between this and the previous chapter.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Elizabeth's murder strips Victor of everything the creature lost, making creator and creation doubles. Useful evidence: “with his fiendish finger he pointed towards the corpse of my wife” (Chapter XXIII, paragraph 10): Mocking accusation. Theme link: Victor becomes the pursuer. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
7. What can we infer about a character's motives from what they say and do here, as opposed to what they claim? [DOK 3 · followUp · wait 8 s · 7.RC.3, 7.CC.2, 9-10.RC.1] Look for: An inference about motive supported by a quoted line.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Elizabeth's murder strips Victor of everything the creature lost, making creator and creation doubles. Useful evidence: “A fiend had snatched from me every hope of future happiness” (Chapter XXIII, paragraph 14): Total despair; in the next chapter it becomes a vow of revenge. On characterization: Victor dedicates himself to revenge. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
8. The bell-ringer asked: “How does the wedding-night catastrophe change Victor from creator to hunter?” Now that we have read closely, how would you revise your first answer, and which line changed your mind? [DOK 2 · thinkPairShare · wait 5 s · 7.RC.2, 7.CC.2, 9-10.RC.2] Look for: A revised answer anchored in the text.
9. Where does characterization appear, and how does it connect this chapter to the larger concern with nature versus nurture? [DOK 3 · followUp · wait 8 s · 7.RC.3, 7.CC.2, 9-10.RC.1] Look for: Look for what characters say, do and think, and how others react to them.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Elizabeth's murder strips Victor of everything the creature lost, making creator and creation doubles. Useful evidence: “She was there, lifeless and inanimate, thrown across the bed” (Chapter XXIII, paragraph 8): Echoes the "lifeless matter" of creation. On characterization: Victor dedicates himself to revenge. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

10. Background: Weddings in this social class involved property arrangements; after Victor's release his family's affairs are settled and he leaves Geneva for good. How does knowing this change the way you read one moment in the chapter? [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · 7.RC.3, 7.CC.2, 9-10.RC.1] Look for: A specific moment reread in light of the context.
    Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Elizabeth's murder strips Victor of everything the creature lost, making creator and creation doubles. Useful evidence: “with his fiendish finger he pointed towards the corpse of my wife” (Chapter XXIII, paragraph 10): Mocking accusation. Theme link: Victor becomes the pursuer. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

Evaluative / synthesis / creative

1. A critic might argue: “The catastrophe Victor never foresaw shows how completely his self-absorption has blinded him; his loss turns him into the creature's pursuer.” How far do you agree? Take a stand and defend it with two lines from the chapter. [DOK 3 · fourCorners · wait 8 s · 7.RC.2, 7.CC.3, 9-10.RC.2] Look for: A defended position with evidence and one counterpoint.
    Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Elizabeth's murder strips Victor of everything the creature lost, making creator and creation doubles. Useful evidence: “A fiend had snatched from me every hope of future happiness” (Chapter XXIII, paragraph 14): Total despair; in the next chapter it becomes a vow of revenge. Theme link: Victor becomes the pursuer. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
2. Which character in this chapter acts most wisely, and which least? Judge them by a standard you name. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · 7.RC.3, 7.CC.3, 9-10.RC.1] Look for: An evaluation using an explicit criterion and evidence.
    Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Elizabeth's murder strips Victor of everything the creature lost, making creator and creation doubles. Useful evidence: “She was there, lifeless and inanimate, thrown across the bed” (Chapter XXIII, paragraph 8): Echoes the "lifeless matter" of creation. On characterization: Victor dedicates himself to revenge. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
3. Rewrite one moment of “Chapter XXIII” from the point of view of a different character. What does the new angle reveal or hide about the wedding night and its catastrophe? [DOK 4 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · 7.RC.1, 7.CC.3, 9-10.RC.1] Look for: A creative product with a rationale tied to the text.
    Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Elizabeth's murder strips Victor of everything the creature lost, making creator and creation doubles. Useful evidence: “with his fiendish finger he pointed towards the corpse of my wife” (Chapter XXIII, paragraph 10): Mocking accusation. Theme link: Victor becomes the pursuer. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
4. Write three questions of your own about “Chapter XXIII”: one recall, one “why/how”, and one “should/what if”. Trade with a partner and answer theirs. [DOK 3 · studentGenerated · wait 8 s · 7.RC.2, 7.CC.3, 9-10.RC.2] Look for: Student-generated questions at three levels.
    Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Elizabeth's murder strips Victor of everything the creature lost, making creator and creation doubles. Useful evidence: “A fiend had snatched from me every hope of future happiness” (Chapter XXIII, paragraph 14): Total despair; in the next chapter it becomes a

vow of revenge. Theme link: Victor becomes the pursuer. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

5. Connect this chapter to the sublime power of nature: is the link strong or weak so far? What would Shelley need to show next to strengthen it? [DOK 4 · socraticCircle · wait 8 s · 7.RC.2, 7.CC.3, 9-10.RC.2] Look for: A judgment of thematic development across the work.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Elizabeth's murder strips Victor of everything the creature lost, making creator and creation doubles. Useful evidence: “She was there, lifeless and inanimate, thrown across the bed” (Chapter XXIII, paragraph 8): Echoes the "lifeless matter" of creation. Theme link: Victor becomes the pursuer. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

6. Is the foreshadowing in this chapter effective, or does it feel heavy-handed? Evaluate it as a reader would in a review. [DOK 3 · fourCorners · wait 8 s · 7.RC.3, 7.CC.3, 9-10.RC.3] Look for: An evaluative judgment with criteria and evidence.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Elizabeth's murder strips Victor of everything the creature lost, making creator and creation doubles. Useful evidence: “with his fiendish finger he pointed towards the corpse of my wife” (Chapter XXIII, paragraph 10): Mocking accusation. Theme link: Victor becomes the pursuer. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

7. Compare how “Chapter XXIII” treats the wedding night and its catastrophe with how another text, film or event you know treats a similar idea. What does Frankenstein see that the other misses? [DOK 4 · socraticCircle · wait 8 s · 7.RC.2, 7.CC.3, 9-10.RC.2] Look for: A cross-text synthesis.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Elizabeth's murder strips Victor of everything the creature lost, making creator and creation doubles. Useful evidence: “A fiend had snatched from me every hope of future happiness” (Chapter XXIII, paragraph 14): Total despair; in the next chapter it becomes a vow of revenge. Theme link: Victor becomes the pursuer. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

8. Predict what “Chapter XXIV” will bring, using two clues from this chapter. After reading, evaluate your prediction. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · 7.RC.3, 7.CC.3, 9-10.RC.3] Look for: A prediction or judgment justified with textual clues.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Elizabeth's murder strips Victor of everything the creature lost, making creator and creation doubles. Useful evidence: “She was there, lifeless and inanimate, thrown across the bed” (Chapter XXIII, paragraph 8): Echoes the "lifeless matter" of creation. Theme link: Victor becomes the pursuer. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

9. Design a one-paragraph modern adaptation of this chapter (setting, characters, conflict). What must stay the same for it to still be about the wedding night and its catastrophe? [DOK 4 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · 7.RC.2, 7.CC.3, 9-10.RC.2] Look for: A creative transfer that keeps the core idea.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Elizabeth's murder strips Victor of everything the creature lost, making creator and creation doubles. Useful evidence: “with his fiendish finger he pointed towards the corpse of my wife” (Chapter XXIII, paragraph 10): Mocking accusation. Theme link: Victor becomes the pursuer. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

10. What question would you most like to ask Mary Shelley about this chapter, and what answer do you think the text itself gives? [DOK 4 · studentGenerated · wait 8 s · 7.RC.2, 7.CC.3, 9-10.RC.2] Look for: A student-generated question answered from evidence.
    Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Elizabeth's murder strips Victor of everything the creature lost, making creator and creation doubles. Useful evidence: “A fiend had snatched from me every hope of future happiness” (Chapter XXIII, paragraph 14): Total despair; in the next chapter it becomes a vow of revenge. Theme link: Victor becomes the pursuer. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

Annotation focus

- **Foreshadowing:** look for hints, warnings or images that point to later events (anchor passage in the We do segment)
- Also notice **Irony**: gaps between what characters expect or say and what is true
- Also notice **Characterization**: what characters say, do and think, and how others react to them

Chapter quiz: item bank (all eleven rigor versions)

1. [fill · recall · DOK 1] Fill in the blank with the vocabulary word that fits: “I was possessed by a _____ rage when I thought of him, and desired and ardently prayed that I might have him within my grasp to wreak a great and signal revenge on his cursed head.” Word bank: maddening, inspecting, intimidated, deviating
   Key: maddening
2. [mc · recall · DOK 1] What happens to Victor after his father's death?
   A. He is confined as a madman for months
   B. He marries again
   C. He is tried for murder
   D. He sails to the Arctic at once

   Key: A (He is confined as a madman for months)
3. [mc · recall · DOK 1] In the line “When I had concluded my narration, I said, “This is the being whom I accuse, and for whose seizure and punishment I call upon you to exert your whole power.”, what does “seizure” most nearly mean?
   A. struck again and again
   B. to argue earnestly with someone to change their mind
   C. capture; being taken by force
   D. brought back to life or strength; revived

   Key: C (capture; being taken by force)
4. [fill · recall · DOK 1] Fill in the blank with the vocabulary word that fits: “But I discovered no trace of him, and was beginning to conjecture that some fortunate chance had _____ to prevent the execution of his menaces; when suddenly I heard a shrill and dreadful scream.” Word bank: intimidated, deviating, intervened, inspecting
   Key: intervened

5. [mc · recall · DOK 1] In the line “She left me, and I continued some time walking up and down the passages of the house, and inspecting every corner that might afford a retreat to my adversary.”, what does “inspecting” most nearly mean?

   A. combine into one

   B. looking at closely; examining

   C. the usage or vocabulary that is characteristic of a specific group of people

   D. annoyances; worries

   Key: B (looking at closely; examining)

6. [mc · recall · DOK 1] In the line “As I spoke, rage sparkled in my eyes; the magistrate was intimidated:—“You are mistaken,” said he, “I will exert myself; and if it is in my power to seize the monster, be assured that he shall suffer punishment…”, what does “intimidated” most nearly mean?

   A. degree of figurative distance or separation; or

   B. frightened; made fearful

   C. deeply distressing

   D. to thicken or freeze (here, with horror)

   Key: B (frightened; made fearful)

7. [mc · recall · DOK 1] In the line “I now related my history, briefly, but with firmness and precision, marking the dates with accuracy, and never deviating into invective or exclamation.”, what does “deviating” most nearly mean?

   A. combine into one

   B. convert code into ordinary language

   C. turning aside; straying

   D. basic; fundamental

   Key: C (turning aside; straying)

8. [mc · recall · DOK 1] What does Victor see at the window after finding Elizabeth?

   A. Clerval's ghost

   B. The creature, grinning

   C. His father

   D. A magistrate

   Key: B (The creature, grinning)

9. [mc · recall · DOK 1] Where does Elizabeth's murder take place?

   A. In Paris

   B. On the boat

   C. In Geneva

   D. At the inn at Evian

   Key: D (At the inn at Evian)

10. [short · inference · DOK 2] What can you infer from this line? “She was there, lifeless and inanimate, thrown across the bed” (Chapter XXIII, paragraph 8) Answer in two or three sentences with one detail.

    Sample answer: Echoes the "lifeless matter" of creation.

11. [mc · inference · DOK 2] Which choice best states a central concern of “Chapter XXIII”?
    A. Despair and the sublime
    B. The wedding night and its catastrophe
    C. Obsession and the discovery of life
    D. The first death and growing guilt

    Key: B (The wedding night and its catastrophe)

12. [mc · inference · DOK 2] What does this passage most clearly show? “She was there, lifeless and inanimate, thrown across the bed” (Chapter XXIII, paragraph 8)
    A. Metaphor tying his ruin to the blasted oak.
    B. "Unhallowed" means unholy, and "thing" refuses the creation a name. Students can use this to argue that the novel judges the act of creation as a transgression from its first image.
    C. Anguish and accusation.
    D. Echoes the "lifeless matter" of creation.

    Key: D (Echoes the "lifeless matter" of creation.)

13. [mc · inference · DOK 2] What does this passage most clearly show? “A fiend had snatched from me every hope of future happiness” (Chapter XXIII, paragraph 14)
    A. Total despair; in the next chapter it becomes a vow of revenge.
    B. Moral reasoning; strong evidence of his goodness.
    C. Milton's Satan: the hell is internal.
    D. A careful double negative: not "possible," only "not impossible." Evidence that the book presents itself as grounded in real science.

    Key: A (Total despair; in the next chapter it becomes a vow of revenge.)

14. [mc · analysis · DOK 3] Which literary element does this describe in “Chapter XXIII”? Elizabeth's murder on the wedding night; the creature at the window; the father's death.
    A. Plot
    B. Setting
    C. Alliteration
    D. Symbolism

    Key: A (Plot)

15. [mc · analysis · DOK 3] Which literary element does this describe in “Chapter XXIII”? Elizabeth "thrown across the bed"; the creature's grin.
    A. Structure
    B. Imagery
    C. Tone / mood
    D. Conflict

    Key: B (Imagery)

16. [short · synthesis · DOK 4] Evaluate this claim about the chapter: “Elizabeth's murder strips Victor of everything the creature lost, making creator and creation doubles.” Is it fully persuasive? Argue with evidence, including a passage that complicates it.

Sample answer: He says "a fiend had snatched from me every hope of future happiness," the same hopeless isolation the creature described, and like the creature he turns to vengeance.

17. [fill · recall · DOK 1] Complete the quotation from Chapter XXIII, paragraph 8: “She was there, lifeless and _____, thrown across the bed”

    Key: inanimate

18. [fill · recall · DOK 1] Complete the quotation from Chapter XXIII, paragraph 14: “A fiend had snatched from me every hope of future _____”

    Key: happiness

19. [mc · recall · DOK 1] How does Victor's father die?

    A. At sea

    B. Murdered by the creature

    C. Of grief, soon after the news

    D. In a duel

    Key: C (Of grief, soon after the news)

20. [fill · recall · DOK 1] Fill in the blank with the vocabulary word that fits: “As I heard it, the whole truth rushed into my mind, my arms dropped, the motion of every muscle and fibre was suspended; I could feel the blood trickling in my veins, and _____ in the extremities of my limbs.” Word bank: intimidated, tingling, deviating, inspecting

    Key: tingling

21. [mc · recall · DOK 1] How does the Genevan magistrate respond to Victor's story?

    A. With half-belief, doubting anything can be done

    B. By arresting Victor

    C. With laughter

    D. With full belief and action

    Key: A (With half-belief, doubting anything can be done)

22. [mc · inference · DOK 2] What does this passage most clearly show? “with his fiendish finger he pointed towards the corpse of my wife” (Chapter XXIII, paragraph 10)

    A. Victor concludes guilt from appearance, as others will judge the creature.

    B. Mocking accusation.

    C. Guilt imagined as hell.

    D. Opens with pride in lineage and status.

    Key: B (Mocking accusation.)

23. [short · analysis · DOK 3] Analyze the word choice in “A fiend had snatched from me every hope of future happiness” (Chapter XXIII, paragraph 14). Pick two words and explain what they suggest.

    Sample answer: Total despair; in the next chapter it becomes a vow of revenge.

24. [short · analysis · DOK 3] Claim: Elizabeth's murder strips Victor of everything the creature lost, making creator and creation doubles. Explain how this evidence supports the claim: “A fiend had snatched from me every hope of future happiness” (Chapter XXIII, paragraph 14).

    Sample answer: He says "a fiend had snatched from me every hope of future happiness," the same hopeless isolation the creature described, and like the creature he turns to vengeance.

25. [mc · analysis · DOK 3] In this chapter, which theme does the following most directly develop? Victor becomes the pursuer.

    A. The costs of unchecked ambition

    B. Nature versus nurture

    C. Isolation and the need for companionship

    D. Creation and responsibility

    Key: D (Creation and responsibility)

26. [fill · recall · DOK 1] Complete the quotation from Chapter XXIII, paragraph 10: “with his _____ finger he pointed towards the corpse of my wife”

    Key: fiendish

27. [short · inference · DOK 2] What can you infer from this line? “with his fiendish finger he pointed towards the corpse of my wife” (Chapter XXIII, paragraph 10) Answer in two or three sentences with one detail.

    Sample answer: Mocking accusation.

28. [short · synthesis · DOK 4] Close reading: how do the diction and syntax of “She was there, lifeless and inanimate, thrown across the bed” (Chapter XXIII, paragraph 8) shape its meaning? Consider a second, competing reading.

    Sample answer: Echoes the "lifeless matter" of creation.

29. [short · synthesis · DOK 4] Close reading: how do the diction and syntax of “with his fiendish finger he pointed towards the corpse of my wife” (Chapter XXIII, paragraph 10) shape its meaning? Consider a second, competing reading.

    Sample answer: Mocking accusation.

30. [fill · recall · DOK 1] Fill in the blank with the vocabulary word that fits: “This address caused a considerable change in the physiognomy of my own _____.” Word bank: inspecting, deviating, auditor, intimidated

    Key: auditor

31. [short · synthesis · DOK 4] Synthesis: trace how creation and responsibility develops from an earlier chapter to “Chapter XXIII”. Use one quotation from each.

    Sample answer: Victor becomes the pursuer.

Rigor version	Items (in order)	Mix
Middle School	1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 6, 7, 8, 9, 10, 11, 12, 13, 14, 15, 16	recall 9, inference 4, analysis 2, synthesis 1
HS Freshman	17, 18, 4, 19, 20, 21, 9, 8, 12, 13, 11, 22, 23, 24, 25, 16	recall 8, inference 4, analysis 3, synthesis 1
HS Sophomore	6, 2, 3, 4, 26, 5, 10, 27, 13, 12, 11, 14, 15, 25, 28, 16	recall 6, inference 5, analysis 3, synthesis 2
HS Junior	1, 5, 3, 4, 20, 11, 22, 12, 27, 13, 25, 15, 14, 24, 28, 29	recall 5, inference 5, analysis 4, synthesis 2
HS Senior	1, 7, 6, 30, 12, 22, 10, 13, 27, 14, 25, 15, 23, 28, 31, 29	recall 4, inference 5, analysis 4, synthesis 3
AP	19, 1, 30, 13, 12, 10, 27, 23, 24, 25, 14, 15, 31, 28, 29, 16	recall 3, inference 4, analysis 5, synthesis 4
College Freshman	26, 1, 9, 13, 22, 10, 12, 24, 14, 23, 15, 25, 31, 29, 28, 16	recall 3, inference 4, analysis 5, synthesis 4
College Sophomore	1, 20, 27, 22, 11, 10, 12, 25, 14, 24, 15, 23, 28, 29, 16, 31	recall 2, inference 5, analysis 5, synthesis 4
College Junior	30, 1, 27, 11, 22, 10, 12, 24, 25, 14, 15, 23, 16, 31, 29, 28	recall 2, inference 5, analysis 5, synthesis 4
College Senior	18, 1, 10, 12, 11, 13, 22, 23, 14, 25, 15, 24, 16, 31, 29, 28	recall 2, inference 5, analysis 5, synthesis 4

Graduate / PhD	30, 1, 27, 11, 13, 12, 10, 25, 24, 14, 23, 15, 16, 28, 31, 29	recall 2, inference 5, analysis 5, synthesis 4

Writing prompts (eleven rigor levels)

Middle School (250 words; Indiana 2023: 7.RC.3, 7.W.1): Supported track (work from the passage your teacher selects). In “Chapter XXIII,” how does Shelley show the wedding night and its catastrophe? Write a paragraph that states your claim, quotes two details from the passage, and explains how each detail supports your idea. Use the foreshadowing you noticed as one piece of evidence.

HS Freshman (350 words; Indiana 2023: 9-10.RC.3, 9-10.W.1): In Chapter XXIII, how does Shelley develop the idea of the wedding night and its catastrophe? State a clear claim, support it with two or three quotations, and explain how the foreshadowing in the chapter helps build that idea.

HS Sophomore (450 words; Indiana 2023: 9-10.RC.3, 9-10.W.1): Analyze how Chapter XXIII develops the idea of the wedding night and its catastrophe. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of foreshadowing and irony shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.

HS Junior (550 words; Indiana 2023: 11-12.RC.3, 11-12.RC.1, 11-12.W.1): Analyze how the structure of Chapter XXIII (where it begins, turns and ends) and its foreshadowing shape the reader's understanding of the wedding night and its catastrophe. Identify one place where the text leaves matters uncertain and explain how that uncertainty adds to its meaning.

HS Senior (600 words; Indiana 2023: 11-12.RC.3, 11-12.W.1): Two readers disagree about what Chapter XXIII suggests about the wedding night and its catastrophe. Lay out two plausible interpretations, weigh the evidence for each (including the chapter's foreshadowing and irony), and argue for the stronger one in a sustained, well-organized essay.

AP (650 words; Indiana 2023: 11-12.RC.3, 11-12.W.1): Write a literary argument in which you analyze how Mary Shelley uses foreshadowing in Chapter XXIII to complicate the reader's understanding of the wedding night and its catastrophe. Develop a defensible thesis, select evidence purposefully, and explain how specific choices of diction and syntax create meaning.

College Freshman (1000 words; Indiana 2023: see unit standards): Situate Chapter XXIII within its historical and literary context and argue how the chapter's treatment of the wedding night and its catastrophe responds to that context. Engage with at least one secondary perspective (a critic, historian or the author's own statements), integrate quotations smoothly, and cite in MLA style.

College Sophomore (1250 words; Indiana 2023: see unit standards): Read Chapter XXIII alongside the conventions of its genre and period. Argue how the chapter's handling of the wedding night and its catastrophe follows or bends those conventions, using the foreshadowing as evidence, and test your reading against one published critic. Document two secondary sources in MLA.

College Junior (1500 words; Indiana 2023: see unit standards): Apply a named critical approach (for example formalist, historicist, feminist, psychoanalytic or ecocritical) to Chapter XXIII and its treatment of the wedding

night and its catastrophe. State your method, show what it reveals in the chapter's foreshadowing and irony, and identify where the text resists it.

College Senior (2000 words; Indiana 2023: see unit standards): Develop a research argument that reads Chapter XXIII as evidence for a larger claim about the wedding night and its catastrophe in Frankenstein. Connect close reading of the chapter to the whole novel, engage at least four scholarly sources, and state precisely where your reading departs from theirs (Chicago style).

Graduate / PhD (2500 words; Indiana 2023: see unit standards): Develop an original argument that reads Chapter XXIII as a hinge in the novel's larger treatment of the wedding night and its catastrophe. Position your reading within a named critical conversation (for example formalist, historicist, psychoanalytic, feminist or postcolonial approaches), account for the textual history where relevant, and articulate the stakes of your intervention for scholarship on Frankenstein.

SAT-style questions

1. *As I spoke, rage sparkled in my eyes; the magistrate was intimidated:—"You are mistaken," said he, "I will exert myself; and if it is in my power to seize the monster, be assured that he shall suffer punishment proportionate to his crimes.*

   As used in the text, what does the word "intimidated" most nearly mean?

   A. frightened; made fearful

   B. a heavy rain

   C. summon into action or bring into existence, often as if by magic

   D. get involved, so as to alter or hinder an action, or through force or threat of force

2. *She left me, and I continued some time walking up and down the passages of the house, and inspecting every corner that might afford a retreat to my adversary. But I discovered no trace of him, and was beginning to conjecture that some fortunate chance had intervened to prevent the execution of his menaces; when suddenly I heard a shrill and dreadful scream. It came from the room into which Elizabeth had retired. As I heard it, the whole truth rushed into my mind, my arms dropped, the motion of every muscle and fibre was suspended; I could feel the blood trickling in my veins, and tingling in the extremities of my limbs. This state lasted but for an instant; the scream was repeated, and I rushed into the room.*

   Which choice best states a central concern of "Chapter XXIII"?

   A. Loneliness and the desire for a friend

   B. First experiences of the senses

   C. Delay and dread

   D. The wedding night and its catastrophe

SAT key: 1. A (frightened; made fearful); 2. D (The wedding night and its catastrophe)

Lesson 31: Chapter XXIV

Focus: the final reckoning

Objective: Students will analyze how point of view develops in “Chapter XXIV” by writing a claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph that cites at least 2 quotations from the section, and will score at least 80% on the section quiz.

Standards: CCSS RL.9-10.6, W.9-10.1, L.9-10.4 · IN 9-10.RC.1, 9-10.W.1, 9-10.RC.9, 9-10.RC.11

Critical voice: “The scene in the cabin of Walton's ship—the more than mortal enthusiasm and grandeur of the Being's speech over the dead body of his victim—is an exhibition of intellectual and imaginative power, which we think the reader will acknowledge has seldom been surpassed.” (Percy Bysshe Shelley, poet, *"On 'Frankenstein'" (written c.1817; pub. The Athenaeum, 10 Nov 1832), in The Prose Works of Percy Bysshe Shelley (1880), paragraph 5*; public domain). Exit ticket: name one rhetorical move in the creature's last speech that earns Shelley's "grandeur." *Objective:* Evaluate the creature's final speech as the novel's climax. *Standards:* RL.11-12.3, 11-12.RC.1

Content note (suicide (planned self-destruction), the word “abortion”): The creature vows to destroy himself on a funeral pyre, and calls himself “an abortion” (meaning a failed or monstrous creation). Use the safe-messaging script; the word is not on the vocabulary list.
Student preview: The ending includes a character planning to end his own life. Support is available if this is hard to read.
Suggested language: “What does the creature's final speech claim about responsibility?”
Safe messaging: Discuss the character's despair and what the text does with it; do not dwell on methods. Before the lesson, remind students that support is available and how to reach the counselor. Check in privately with any student who seems affected and follow your school's referral protocol. **Share with students:** If you or someone you know is struggling or thinking about suicide, call or text 988 (Suicide & Crisis Lifeline, U.S.) or talk with a school counselor today. Let a counselor know in advance that this chapter is being taught.

Teacher only · spoilers

Walton resumes writing. The ice traps the ship; the crew demands to turn south, and Walton yields. Victor dies. The creature appears over his body, mourns, condemns himself, and vows to destroy himself on a funeral pyre before vanishing into darkness.

Background: Walton's choice to return is a moral decision, contrasting with Victor's refusal to stop.

Significance: The ending lets Walton learn the lesson, while the creature's final speech gives him the last eloquent word.

Lesson plan and lecture script (90 minutes)

0–8 min · Bell-ringer · You do (8 min)
Students write to the bell-ringer, then pair-share.
Does Walton learn from Victor? What evidence shows it? Write for five minutes. Starters: I think... because... / This connects to ambition and knowledge because.... Content note before we start: The ending includes a character planning to end his own life. Support is available if this is hard to read. If you or someone you know is struggling or thinking about suicide, call or text 988 (Suicide & Crisis Lifeline, U.S.) or talk with a school counselor today.
Prompt: Does Walton learn from Victor? What evidence shows it?
Sentence starters: I think… because… · This connects to ambition and knowledge because…
Strong response: A strong response takes a position and anticipates this: Victor's final advice: "Seek happiness in tranquillity and avoid ambition."

8–18 min · Vocabulary with etymology notes · I do (10 min)
Five key words in context, with verified word histories.
Today's words: curdles — thickens with horror (of blood); turns cold; disencumbered — freed from a burden; execrate — to curse; to hate; congeal — to thicken or freeze (here, with horror); glimmers — shines faintly. “curdles”: Frequentative of curd (v.) "to form curds"; English, not from Latin cura. “execrate”: From Latin exsecrārī, execrārī, from ex "out" + sacrāre "to consecrate, declare accursed".
Words: curdles: thickens with horror (of blood); turns cold · disencumbered: freed from a burden · execrate: to curse; to hate · congeal: to thicken or freeze (here, with horror) · glimmers: shines faintly

18–28 min · Background and context · I do (10 min)
Mini-lecture (read or adapt the script).
Walton's choice to return is a moral decision, contrasting with Victor's refusal to stop. The ending lets Walton learn the lesson, while the creature's final speech gives him the last eloquent word. Structure: The frame closes: Walton's letters resume; the creature appears over Victor's body. Characterization: The creature's final speech mixes grief and self-hatred. Setting: The Arctic ice traps the ship; the crew demands return. Watch for light and fire: Light stands for knowledge and fire for its double edge: warmth and burning. Victor seeks the "light" of discovery; the creature discovers fire and is burned by it. In this chapter: “to execute this dear revenge, will I again behold the sun, and tread the green herbage of earth, which otherwise should vanish” (Chapter XXIV, paragraph 5).

28–40 min · I do: modeled close reading · I do (12 min)
Model the close reading of the anchor quotation using the written think-aloud below.
I read the line once for meaning and once for craft. “Seek happiness in tranquillity, and avoid ambition” (Chapter XXIV, paragraph 57). Victor's lesson; partly retracted. That is structure at work: The frame closes: Walton's letters resume; the creature appears over Victor's body.

> *Seek happiness in tranquillity, and avoid ambition (Chapter XXIV, paragraph 57)*

Think-aloud: I read the line once for meaning and once for craft. “Seek happiness in tranquillity, and avoid ambition” (Chapter XXIV, paragraph 57). Victor's lesson; partly retracted. That is structure at work: The frame closes: Walton's letters resume; the creature appears over Victor's body.

40–55 min · We do: guided annotation · We do (15 min)
Guided analysis of a second quotation; expected answers given.
Ask: What words in this line stand out, and what do they suggest? Expected: The ending is open: we don't see the creature die. The darkness echoes the novel's theme of the unknown. Ask: How does this line connect to ambition and knowledge? Expected: Victor's final advice: "Seek happiness in tranquillity and avoid ambition." (The ending: ambiguous death.)

> *He was soon borne away by the waves, and lost in darkness and distance (Chapter XXIV, paragraph 75)*

Ask: What words in this line stand out, and what do they suggest?
Expected answer: The ending is open: we don't see the creature die. The darkness echoes the novel's theme of the unknown.
Ask: How does this line connect to ambition and knowledge?
Expected answer: Victor's final advice: "Seek happiness in tranquillity and avoid ambition." (The ending: ambiguous death.)

55–70 min · You do: independent annotation · You do (15 min)
Independent annotation and a claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph (exemplar given).
Annotate the chapter for structure, characterization (three marks with a margin note each), then write one claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph: what does this chapter suggest about the final reckoning? Then start your writing prompt at your assigned level (HS Sophomore: Analyze how Chapter XXIV develops the idea of the final reckoning. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of point of view and theme shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.) Exemplar: The ending leaves the reader to judge, with Victor's lesson undercut by his doubt and the creature's grief. When the text says “He was soon borne away by the waves, and lost in darkness and distance” (Chapter XXIV, paragraph 75), it shows this directly. Victor advises "seek happiness in tranquillity and avoid ambition" yet adds that another may succeed; the creature disappears into "darkness and distance," leaving judgment open.
Task: Annotate the chapter for structure, characterization (three marks with a margin note each), then write one claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph: what does this chapter suggest about the final reckoning? Then start your writing prompt at your assigned level (HS Sophomore: Analyze how Chapter XXIV develops the idea of the final reckoning. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of point of view and theme shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.)
Exemplar: The ending leaves the reader to judge, with Victor's lesson undercut by his doubt and the creature's grief. When the text says “He was soon borne away by the waves, and lost in darkness and distance” (Chapter XXIV, paragraph 75), it shows this directly. Victor advises "seek happiness in tranquillity and avoid ambition" yet adds that another may succeed; the creature disappears into "darkness and distance," leaving judgment open.

70–80 min · Discussion · We do (10 min)
Structured discussion from the 30 tiered questions, with facilitation notes.
Anchor question: Does Walton learn from Victor? What evidence shows it? Ask: does Walton learn the lesson? Point to his decision to turn back.
Anchor question: Does Walton learn from Victor? What evidence shows it?
Facilitation: Ask: does Walton learn the lesson? Point to his decision to turn back.

80–87 min · Exit ticket / chapter quiz · You do (7 min)
Chapter quiz in the app and an exit ticket (answer given).
Chapter quiz in the app, then: In one sentence, what does this chapter suggest about the final reckoning? Support it with one short quotation. Model answer: The ending leaves the reader to judge, with Victor's lesson undercut by his doubt and the creature's grief. (“He was soon borne away by the waves, and lost in darkness and distance”, Chapter XXIV, paragraph 75). Accept any defensible claim backed by a quotation from the chapter; the answer key for the quiz is in the Quiz section.
Exit ticket: In one sentence, what does this chapter suggest about the final reckoning? Support it with one short quotation.
Answer: Model answer: The ending leaves the reader to judge, with Victor's lesson undercut by his doubt and the creature's grief. (“He was soon borne away by the waves, and lost in darkness and distance”, Chapter XXIV, paragraph 75). Accept any defensible claim backed by a quotation from the chapter; the answer key for the quiz is in the Quiz section.

87–90 min · Closure · I do (3 min)
Summarize the lesson and preview the next reading.
Today we saw how structure shapes the final reckoning. Key takeaway: Victor's final advice: "Seek happiness in tranquillity and avoid ambition."

Total: 90 minutes.

Teacher analysis (spoilers)

Literary elements

- **Structure:** The frame closes: Walton's letters resume; the creature appears over Victor's body.
- **Characterization:** The creature's final speech mixes grief and self-hatred.
- **Setting:** The Arctic ice traps the ship; the crew demands return.

Themes and how they develop

- **ambition and knowledge:** Victor's final advice: "Seek happiness in tranquillity and avoid ambition."

Symbols and motifs

- **light and fire:** Light stands for knowledge and fire for its double edge: warmth and burning. Victor seeks the "light" of discovery; the creature discovers fire and is burned by it. In this chapter: “to execute this dear revenge, will I again behold the sun, and tread the green herbage of earth, which otherwise should vanish” (Chapter XXIV, paragraph 5).

- **sublime nature:** Mountains, glaciers, storms and lakes reflect and sometimes soothe the characters' feelings; the sublime is both comfort and terror. In this chapter: “laugh. It rung on my ears long and heavily; the mountains reechoed it, and I felt as if all hell surrounded me” (Chapter XXIV, paragraph 7).

Key quotations (checked against the reading text)

- “Seek happiness in tranquillity, and avoid ambition” (Chapter XXIV, paragraph 57) Victor's lesson; partly retracted.
- “He was soon borne away by the waves, and lost in darkness and distance” (Chapter XXIV, paragraph 75) The ending: ambiguous death.
- “I shall die, and what I now feel be no longer felt” (Chapter XXIV, paragraph 74) The creature's longing for release.

Model claim-evidence-reasoning

Claim: The ending leaves the reader to judge, with Victor's lesson undercut by his doubt and the creature's grief.
Evidence: “He was soon borne away by the waves, and lost in darkness and distance” (Chapter XXIV, paragraph 75)
Reasoning: Victor advises "seek happiness in tranquillity and avoid ambition" yet adds that another may succeed; the creature disappears into "darkness and distance," leaving judgment open.

Vocabulary with etymology notes

Word	Definition (in this sentence)	In context	Word history
curdles (verb)	thickens with horror (of blood); turns cold	*You have read this strange and terrific story, Margaret; and do you not feel your blood congeal with horror, like that which even now curdles mine?*	“curdles”: Frequentative of curd (v.) "to form curds"; English, not from Latin cura. (Online Etymology Dictionary, https://www.etymonline.com/word/curdle)
disencumbered (verb)	freed from a burden	*But this was not the time for delay: I disencumbered the dogs of their dead companion, gave them a plentiful portion of food; and, after an hour's rest, which was absolutely necessary, and yet which was bitterly irksome to me, I continued my route.*	
execrate (verb)	to curse; to hate	*Why do you not execrate the rustic who sought to destroy the saviour of his child?*	“execrate”: From Latin exsecrārī, execrārī, from ex "out" + sacrāre "to consecrate, declare accursed". (Wiktionary, https://en.wiktionary.org/wiki/execrate#Etymology)
congeal (verb)		*You have read this strange and terrific story, Margaret; and*	

	to thicken or freeze (here, with horror)	*do you not feel your blood congeal with horror, like that which even now curdles mine?*	
glimmers (verb)	shines faintly	*Frankenstein has daily declined in health: a feverish fire still glimmers in his eyes; but he is exhausted, and, when suddenly roused to any exertion, he speedily sinks again into apparent lifelessness.*	
scaring (adjective)	frightening	*I approached this tremendous being; I dared not again raise my eyes to his face, there was something so scaring and unearthly in his ugliness.*	"scaring": From Middle English sker, skere "terror, fright", from the verb Middle English skerren "to frighten" (see below). (Wiktionary, https://en.wiktionary.org/wiki/scare#Etymology)
tardily (adverb)	slowly; late	*You will find near this place, if you follow not too tardily, a dead hare; eat, and be refreshed.*	"tardily": tardy + -ly; tardy is from Old French tardif, from Latin tardus "slow." (Not from ardere "to burn.") (Online Etymology Dictionary, https://www.etymonline.com/word/tardy)
composes (verb)	calms; settles	*Oh, no! the only joy that he can now know will be when he composes his shattered spirit to peace and death.*	"composes": From Middle English composen, from Old French composer "to compose, compound, adjust, settle", from com- + poser, as an adaptation of Latin componere "to put together, compose", from com- "together" + ponere "to put, place". (Wiktionary, https://en.wiktionary.org/wiki/compose#Etymology)
modulated (verb)	adjusted in tone	*He spoke this with a voice so modulated to the different feelings expressed in his speech, with an eye so full of lofty design and heroism, that can you wonder that these men were moved?*	
participated (verb)	shared with others	*When I first sought it, it was the love of virtue, the feelings of happiness and affection with which my whole being overflowed, that I wished to be participated.*	"participated": Latin participātus, the perfect passive participle of participō "to take part in, share in, give part in, impart" (see -ate and -ate), from particeps "taking part (in), sharing (in); someone who takes part (in)", from pars + -ceps; see part and capable. Compare Old English dælniman "to participate", an earlier calque of the same Latin verb. (Wiktionary, https://en.wiktionary.org/wiki/participate#Etymology)

Discussion questions

1. Does Walton learn from Victor? What evidence shows it?
2. Where does point of view appear in this chapter, and what effect does it have? Point to one passage.
3. How does this chapter connect to the book's larger concern with the sublime power of nature?

Classroom discussion questions (30, tiered)

Wait time after every question (3 s for DOK 1, 5 s for DOK 2, 8 to 10 s for DOK 3 and 4); think-pair-share on DOK 3 and 4; answer each response with a follow-up probe; close with student-generated questions. Focus sets by rigor level: Middle School: 1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 6, 11, 12, 13, 14, 21, 22; HS Freshman: 1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 12, 13, 14, 15, 22, 23, 24; HS Sophomore: 1, 2, 3, 4, 13, 14, 15, 16, 17, 23, 24, 25; HS Junior: 1, 2, 3, 14, 15, 16, 17, 18, 24, 25, 26, 27; HS Senior: 1, 2, 3, 15, 16, 17, 18, 25, 26, 27, 28, 29; AP: 1, 2, 16, 17, 18, 19, 20, 26, 27, 28, 29, 30; College Freshman: 1, 2, 17, 18, 19, 20, 21, 22, 27, 28, 29, 30; College Sophomore: 1, 2, 11, 18, 19, 20, 21, 22, 23, 28, 29, 30; College Junior: 1, 11, 12, 19, 20, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 29, 30; College Senior: 1, 11, 12, 13, 20, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 26, 30; Graduate / PhD: 1, 11, 12, 13, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 26, 27, 28

Literal / recall

1. What do Walton's crew demand? [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · 7.RC.1, 7.CC.1, 9-10.RC.1] Look for: To turn back south
2. How does Walton respond? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · 7.RC.1, 7.CC.1, 9-10.RC.1] Look for: He agrees to return
3. What happens to Victor? [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · 7.RC.1, 7.CC.1, 9-10.RC.1] Look for: He dies on the ship
4. What does the creature plan to do? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · 7.RC.1, 7.CC.1, 9-10.RC.1] Look for: Destroy himself on a funeral pyre
5. Whose voice ends the story? [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · 7.RC.1, 7.CC.1, 9-10.RC.1] Look for: Walton's, recording the creature's departure
6. Retell the three most important events of "Chapter XXIV" in order, in one sentence each. [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · 7.RC.1, 7.CC.1, 9-10.RC.1] Look for: Walton resumes writing. The ice traps the ship; the crew demands to turn south, and Walton yields. Victor dies. The creature appears over his body, mourns, condemns himself, and vows to destroy himself on a funeral pyre before vanishing into darkness.
7. Which characters appear or are mentioned in "Chapter XXIV"? Name two and one thing each says or does. [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · 7.RC.1, 7.CC.1, 9-10.RC.1] Look for: Names and actions taken from the chapter; check against the teacher summary.
8. Where and when does "Chapter XXIV" take place? Point to the line that tells you. [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · 7.RC.1, 7.CC.1, 9-10.RC.1] Look for: A place/time detail quoted from the chapter.
9. Reread: "You have read this strange and terrific story, Margaret; and do you not feel your blood congeal with horror, like that which even now curdles mine?" What does "curdles" mean here, and what is literally happening in this line? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · 7.RC.1, 7.CC.1, 9-10.RC.1] Look for: curdles: thickens with horror (of blood); turns cold.
10. Reread: "But this was not the time for delay: I disencumbered the dogs of their dead companion, gave them a plentiful portion of food; and, after an hour's rest, which was absolutely necessary, and yet which was bitterly irksome…" What does "disencumbered" mean here, and what is literally happening in this line? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · 7.RC.1, 7.CC.1, 9-10.RC.1] Look for: disencumbered: freed from a burden.

Inferential / analytical

1. What does “Chapter XXIV” suggest about the final reckoning? State the inference and the line that supports it. [DOK 2 · thinkPairShare · wait 5 s · 7.RC.2, 7.CC.2, 9-10.RC.2] Look for: The ending lets Walton learn the lesson, while the creature's final speech gives him the last eloquent word.
2. Find one example of point of view in this chapter. What does it reveal that a plain statement would not? [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · 7.RC.1, 7.CC.2, 9-10.RC.1] Look for: Look for who is telling the story and what that narrator can and cannot know.
3. How does the theme in this chapter shape what we understand about the final reckoning? [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · 7.RC.2, 7.CC.2, 9-10.RC.2] Look for: Look for statements or moments that connect to the book's big ideas.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The ending leaves the reader to judge, with Victor's lesson undercut by his doubt and the creature's grief. Useful evidence: “Seek happiness in tranquillity, and avoid ambition” (Chapter XXIV, paragraph 57): Victor's lesson; partly retracted. Theme link: Victor's final advice: "Seek happiness in tranquillity and avoid ambition." Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
4. In the passage that begins “What his feelings were whom I pursued I cannot know.”, why might Shelley have chosen these particular words? Pick two and explain their connotations. [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · 7.RC.12, 7.CC.2, 9-10.RC.12] Look for: Diction analysis of two words in the anchor passage.
5. What causes the main turn in “Chapter XXIV”, and what effect is it likely to have on what follows? [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · 7.RC.3, 7.CC.2, 9-10.RC.1] Look for: Walton resumes writing. The ice traps the ship; the crew demands to turn south, and Walton yields. Victor dies. The creature appears over his body, mourns, condemns himself, and vows to destroy himself on a funeral pyre before vanishing into darkness.
6. How does “Chapter XXIV” build on “Chapter XXIII”? Name one link of cause and effect. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · 7.RC.3, 7.CC.2, 9-10.RC.3] Look for: A causal or structural link between this and the previous chapter.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The ending leaves the reader to judge, with Victor's lesson undercut by his doubt and the creature's grief. Useful evidence: “He was soon borne away by the waves, and lost in darkness and distance” (Chapter XXIV, paragraph 75): The ending: ambiguous death. On structure: The frame closes: Walton's letters resume; the creature appears over Victor's body. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
7. What can we infer about a character's motives from what they say and do here, as opposed to what they claim? [DOK 3 · followUp · wait 8 s · 7.RC.3, 7.CC.2, 9-10.RC.1] Look for: An inference about motive supported by a quoted line.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The ending leaves the reader to judge, with Victor's lesson undercut by his doubt and the creature's grief. Useful evidence: “I shall die, and what I now feel be no longer felt” (Chapter XXIV, paragraph 74): The creature's longing for release. On characterization: The creature's final speech mixes grief and self-hatred. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
8. The bell-ringer asked: “Does Walton learn from Victor? What evidence shows it?” Now that we have read closely, how would you revise your first answer, and which line changed your mind? [DOK 2 · thinkPairShare · wait 5 s · 7.RC.2, 7.CC.2, 9-10.RC.2] Look for: A revised answer anchored in the text.

9. Where does irony appear, and how does it connect this chapter to the larger concern with the sublime power of nature? [DOK 3 · followUp · wait 8 s · 7.RC.1, 7.CC.2, 9-10.RC.1] Look for: Look for gaps between what characters expect or say and what is true.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The ending leaves the reader to judge, with Victor's lesson undercut by his doubt and the creature's grief. Useful evidence: “Seek happiness in tranquillity, and avoid ambition” (Chapter XXIV, paragraph 57): Victor's lesson; partly retracted. Theme link: Victor's final advice: "Seek happiness in tranquillity and avoid ambition." Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
10. Background: Walton's choice to return is a moral decision, contrasting with Victor's refusal to stop. How does knowing this change the way you read one moment in the chapter? [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · 7.RC.3, 7.CC.2, 9-10.RC.1] Look for: A specific moment reread in light of the context.
    Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The ending leaves the reader to judge, with Victor's lesson undercut by his doubt and the creature's grief. Useful evidence: “He was soon borne away by the waves, and lost in darkness and distance” (Chapter XXIV, paragraph 75): The ending: ambiguous death. On setting: The Arctic ice traps the ship; the crew demands return. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

Evaluative / synthesis / creative

1. A critic might argue: “The ending lets Walton learn the lesson, while the creature's final speech gives him the last eloquent word.” How far do you agree? Take a stand and defend it with two lines from the chapter. [DOK 3 · fourCorners · wait 8 s · 7.RC.2, 7.CC.3, 9-10.RC.2] Look for: A defended position with evidence and one counterpoint.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The ending leaves the reader to judge, with Victor's lesson undercut by his doubt and the creature's grief. Useful evidence: “I shall die, and what I now feel be no longer felt” (Chapter XXIV, paragraph 74): The creature's longing for release. Theme link: Victor's final advice: "Seek happiness in tranquillity and avoid ambition." Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
2. Which character in this chapter acts most wisely, and which least? Judge them by a standard you name. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · 7.RC.3, 7.CC.3, 9-10.RC.1] Look for: An evaluation using an explicit criterion and evidence.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The ending leaves the reader to judge, with Victor's lesson undercut by his doubt and the creature's grief. Useful evidence: “Seek happiness in tranquillity, and avoid ambition” (Chapter XXIV, paragraph 57): Victor's lesson; partly retracted. On characterization: The creature's final speech mixes grief and self-hatred. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
3. Rewrite one moment of “Chapter XXIV” from the point of view of a different character. What does the new angle reveal or hide about the final reckoning? [DOK 4 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · 7.RC.1, 7.CC.3, 9-10.RC.1] Look for: A creative product with a rationale tied to the text.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The ending leaves the reader to judge, with Victor's lesson undercut by his doubt and the creature's grief. Useful evidence: “He was soon borne away by the waves, and lost in darkness and distance” (Chapter XXIV, paragraph 75): The ending: ambiguous death. Theme link: Victor's final advice: "Seek happiness in tranquillity and avoid ambition." Credit any position

that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

4. Write three questions of your own about “Chapter XXIV”: one recall, one “why/how”, and one “should/what if”. Trade with a partner and answer theirs. [DOK 3 · studentGenerated · wait 8 s · 7.RC.2, 7.CC.3, 9-10.RC.2] Look for: Student-generated questions at three levels.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The ending leaves the reader to judge, with Victor's lesson undercut by his doubt and the creature's grief. Useful evidence: “I shall die, and what I now feel be no longer felt” (Chapter XXIV, paragraph 74): The creature's longing for release. Theme link: Victor's final advice: "Seek happiness in tranquillity and avoid ambition." Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

5. Connect this chapter to the costs of unchecked ambition: is the link strong or weak so far? What would Shelley need to show next to strengthen it? [DOK 4 · socraticCircle · wait 8 s · 7.RC.2, 7.CC.3, 9-10.RC.2] Look for: A judgment of thematic development across the work.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The ending leaves the reader to judge, with Victor's lesson undercut by his doubt and the creature's grief. Useful evidence: “Seek happiness in tranquillity, and avoid ambition” (Chapter XXIV, paragraph 57): Victor's lesson; partly retracted. Theme link: Victor's final advice: "Seek happiness in tranquillity and avoid ambition." Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

6. Is the point of view in this chapter effective, or does it feel heavy-handed? Evaluate it as a reader would in a review. [DOK 3 · fourCorners · wait 8 s · 7.RC.1, 7.CC.3, 9-10.RC.1] Look for: An evaluative judgment with criteria and evidence.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The ending leaves the reader to judge, with Victor's lesson undercut by his doubt and the creature's grief. Useful evidence: “He was soon borne away by the waves, and lost in darkness and distance” (Chapter XXIV, paragraph 75): The ending: ambiguous death. Theme link: Victor's final advice: "Seek happiness in tranquillity and avoid ambition." Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

7. Compare how “Chapter XXIV” treats the final reckoning with how another text, film or event you know treats a similar idea. What does Frankenstein see that the other misses? [DOK 4 · socraticCircle · wait 8 s · 7.RC.2, 7.CC.3, 9-10.RC.2] Look for: A cross-text synthesis.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The ending leaves the reader to judge, with Victor's lesson undercut by his doubt and the creature's grief. Useful evidence: “I shall die, and what I now feel be no longer felt” (Chapter XXIV, paragraph 74): The creature's longing for release. Theme link: Victor's final advice: "Seek happiness in tranquillity and avoid ambition." Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

8. As the final chapter, does this ending resolve the sublime power of nature? Argue whether the ending is earned. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · 7.RC.3, 7.CC.3, 9-10.RC.3] Look for: A prediction or judgment justified with textual clues.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The ending leaves the reader to judge, with Victor's lesson undercut by his doubt and the creature's grief. Useful evidence: “Seek happiness in tranquillity, and avoid ambition” (Chapter XXIV, paragraph 57): Victor's lesson; partly retracted. Theme link: Victor's final advice: "Seek happiness in tranquillity and avoid ambition." Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

9. Design a one-paragraph modern adaptation of this chapter (setting, characters, conflict). What must stay the same for it to still be about the final reckoning? [DOK 4 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · 7.RC.2, 7.CC.3, 9-10.RC.2] Look for: A creative transfer that keeps the core idea.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The ending leaves the reader to judge, with Victor's lesson undercut by his doubt and the creature's grief. Useful evidence: “He was soon borne away by the waves, and lost in darkness and distance” (Chapter XXIV, paragraph 75): The ending: ambiguous death. Theme link: Victor's final advice: "Seek happiness in tranquillity and avoid ambition." Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
10. What question would you most like to ask Mary Shelley about this chapter, and what answer do you think the text itself gives? [DOK 4 · studentGenerated · wait 8 s · 7.RC.2, 7.CC.3, 9-10.RC.2] Look for: A student-generated question answered from evidence.
    Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The ending leaves the reader to judge, with Victor's lesson undercut by his doubt and the creature's grief. Useful evidence: “I shall die, and what I now feel be no longer felt” (Chapter XXIV, paragraph 74): The creature's longing for release. Theme link: Victor's final advice: "Seek happiness in tranquillity and avoid ambition." Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

Annotation focus

- **Point of view:** look for who is telling the story and what that narrator can and cannot know (anchor passage in the We do segment)
- Also notice **Theme**: statements or moments that connect to the book's big ideas
- Also notice **Irony**: gaps between what characters expect or say and what is true

Chapter quiz: item bank (all eleven rigor versions)

1. [mc · recall · DOK 1] What happens to Victor?
   A. He returns to Geneva
   B. He kills the creature
   C. He dies on the ship
   D. He marries again

   Key: C (He dies on the ship)
2. [mc · recall · DOK 1] What does the creature plan to do?
   A. Destroy himself on a funeral pyre
   B. Rule the Arctic
   C. Go to London
   D. Create a mate

   Key: A (Destroy himself on a funeral pyre)
3. [mc · recall · DOK 1] Whose voice ends the story?
   A. Elizabeth's
   B. Victor's
   C. Walton's, recording the creature's departure

D. Clerval's

Key: C (Walton's, recording the creature's departure)

4. [fill · recall · DOK 1] Fill in the blank with the vocabulary word that fits: “You will find near this place, if you follow not too _____, a dead hare; eat, and be refreshed.” Word bank: execrate, tardily, disencumbered, curdles
   Key: tardily
5. [fill · recall · DOK 1] Fill in the blank with the vocabulary word that fits: “Oh, no! the only joy that he can now know will be when he _____ his shattered spirit to peace and death.” Word bank: execrate, disencumbered, curdles, composes
   Key: composes
6. [mc · recall · DOK 1] In the line “You have read this strange and terrific story, Margaret; and do you not feel your blood congeal with horror, like that which even now curdles mine?”, what does “curdles” most nearly mean?
   A. basic; fundamental
   B. thickens with horror (of blood); turns cold
   C. holds (attention)
   D. weakened

   Key: B (thickens with horror (of blood); turns cold)
7. [mc · recall · DOK 1] In the line “Why do you not execrate the rustic who sought to destroy the saviour of his child?”, what does “execrate” most nearly mean?
   A. a sloping gallery with seats for spectators (as in an operating room or theater)
   B. made loved or liked
   C. to curse; to hate
   D. a very large seabird of the southern oceans

   Key: C (to curse; to hate)
8. [mc · recall · DOK 1] In the line “You have read this strange and terrific story, Margaret; and do you not feel your blood congeal with horror, like that which even now curdles mine?”, what does “congeal” most nearly mean?
   A. to thicken or freeze (here, with horror)
   B. be undecided about something; waver between conflicting positions or courses of action
   C. dullness; a lack of freshness or originality
   D. prevent deliberately (as by making a will) from inheriting

   Key: A (to thicken or freeze (here, with horror))
9. [fill · recall · DOK 1] Complete the quotation from Chapter XXIV, paragraph 75: “He was soon borne away by the waves, and lost in _____ and distance”
   Key: darkness
10. [mc · inference · DOK 2] What does this passage most clearly show? “I shall die, and what I now feel be no longer felt” (Chapter XXIV, paragraph 74)
    A. Biblical image of hell (Isaiah, Mark): remorse as eternal torment.
    B. "Crown" suggests royal triumph; the promise reads as hubris.
    C. The creature's longing for release.

D. The discovery itself, told without explanation; Victor withholds the secret.

Key: C (The creature's longing for release.)

11. [mc · inference · DOK 2] What does this passage most clearly show? “Seek happiness in tranquillity, and avoid ambition” (Chapter XXIV, paragraph 57)

A. "Necessary": sympathy as a need like food.

B. Physical collapse.

C. Victor's lesson; partly retracted.

D. The heart of Victor's ambition: more than anyone before.

Key: C (Victor's lesson; partly retracted.)

12. [short · inference · DOK 2] What can you infer from this line? “Seek happiness in tranquillity, and avoid ambition” (Chapter XXIV, paragraph 57) Answer in two or three sentences with one detail.

Sample answer: Victor's lesson; partly retracted.

13. [mc · inference · DOK 2] Which choice best states a central concern of “Chapter XXIV”?

A. The final reckoning

B. The first death and growing guilt

C. Recovery and false peace

D. Rejection and the turn to revenge

Key: A (The final reckoning)

14. [short · analysis · DOK 3] Analyze the word choice in “I shall die, and what I now feel be no longer felt” (Chapter XXIV, paragraph 74). Pick two words and explain what they suggest.

Sample answer: The creature's longing for release.

15. [mc · analysis · DOK 3] Which literary element does this describe in “Chapter XXIV”? The creature's final speech mixes grief and self-hatred.

A. Characterization

B. Conflict

C. Diction / vocabulary

D. Alliteration

Key: A (Characterization)

16. [short · synthesis · DOK 4] Close reading: how do the diction and syntax of “He was soon borne away by the waves, and lost in darkness and distance” (Chapter XXIV, paragraph 75) shape its meaning? Consider a second, competing reading.

Sample answer: The ending: ambiguous death.

17. [mc · recall · DOK 1] How does Walton respond?

A. He leaves the ship

B. He punishes them

C. He refuses

D. He agrees to return

Key: D (He agrees to return)

18. [fill · recall · DOK 1] Fill in the blank with the vocabulary word that fits: “Frankenstein has daily declined in health: a feverish fire still _____ in his eyes; but he is exhausted, and, when suddenly roused to any

exertion, he speedily sinks again into apparent lifelessness." Word bank: curdles, disencumbered, execrate, glimmers

Key: glimmers

19. [mc · recall · DOK 1] In the line "But this was not the time for delay: I disencumbered the dogs of their dead companion, gave them a plentiful portion of food; and, after an hour's rest, which was absolutely necessary, and yet which was bitterly irksome…", what does "disencumbered" most nearly mean?

    A. only slightly; poorly

    B. to feel or show pity for

    C. make one's home in a particular place or community

    D. freed from a burden

    Key: D (freed from a burden)

20. [short · inference · DOK 2] What can you infer from this line? "He was soon borne away by the waves, and lost in darkness and distance" (Chapter XXIV, paragraph 75) Answer in two or three sentences with one detail.

    Sample answer: The ending: ambiguous death.

21. [mc · inference · DOK 2] What does this passage most clearly show? "He was soon borne away by the waves, and lost in darkness and distance" (Chapter XXIV, paragraph 75)

    A. The ending: ambiguous death.

    B. Victor treats science as a spirit controlling him, shifting responsibility.

    C. Physical collapse.

    D. Victor concludes guilt from appearance, as others will judge the creature.

    Key: A (The ending: ambiguous death.)

22. [mc · analysis · DOK 3] Which literary element does this describe in "Chapter XXIV"? The frame closes: Walton's letters resume; the creature appears over Victor's body.

    A. Personification

    B. Irony

    C. Structure

    D. Hyperbole

    Key: C (Structure)

23. [short · analysis · DOK 3] Claim: The ending leaves the reader to judge, with Victor's lesson undercut by his doubt and the creature's grief. Explain how this evidence supports the claim: "He was soon borne away by the waves, and lost in darkness and distance" (Chapter XXIV, paragraph 75).

    Sample answer: Victor advises "seek happiness in tranquillity and avoid ambition" yet adds that another may succeed; the creature disappears into "darkness and distance," leaving judgment open.

24. [short · synthesis · DOK 4] Evaluate this claim about the chapter: "The ending leaves the reader to judge, with Victor's lesson undercut by his doubt and the creature's grief." Is it fully persuasive? Argue with evidence, including a passage that complicates it.

    Sample answer: Victor advises "seek happiness in tranquillity and avoid ambition" yet adds that another may succeed; the creature disappears into "darkness and distance," leaving judgment open.

25. [mc · recall · DOK 1] What do Walton's crew demand?

    A. To find the creature

    B. More pay

C. To land in Russia

D. To turn back south

Key: D (To turn back south)

26. [fill · recall · DOK 1] Complete the quotation from Chapter XXIV, paragraph 74: “I shall die, and what I now feel be no _____ felt”

    Key: longer

27. [short · synthesis · DOK 4] Synthesis: trace how ambition and knowledge develops from an earlier chapter to “Chapter XXIV”. Use one quotation from each.

    Sample answer: Victor's final advice: "Seek happiness in tranquillity and avoid ambition."

28. [short · synthesis · DOK 4] Close reading: how do the diction and syntax of “Seek happiness in tranquillity, and avoid ambition” (Chapter XXIV, paragraph 57) shape its meaning? Consider a second, competing reading.

    Sample answer: Victor's lesson; partly retracted.

29. [fill · recall · DOK 1] Fill in the blank with the vocabulary word that fits: “I approached this tremendous being; I dared not again raise my eyes to his face, there was something so _____ and unearthly in his ugliness.”

    Word bank: execrate, disencumbered, curdles, scaring

    Key: scaring

Rigor version	Items (in order)	Mix
Middle School	1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 6, 7, 8, 9, 10, 11, 12, 13, 14, 15, 16	recall 9, inference 4, analysis 2, synthesis 1
HS Freshman	17, 4, 18, 5, 3, 7, 19, 8, 11, 20, 12, 21, 15, 22, 23, 24	recall 8, inference 4, analysis 3, synthesis 1
HS Sophomore	18, 7, 4, 6, 2, 8, 21, 13, 20, 11, 12, 14, 15, 22, 24, 16	recall 6, inference 5, analysis 3, synthesis 2
HS Junior	8, 25, 1, 4, 26, 21, 12, 20, 11, 10, 22, 15, 14, 23, 16, 27	recall 5, inference 5, analysis 4, synthesis 2
HS Senior	5, 18, 8, 3, 21, 11, 10, 13, 20, 15, 14, 23, 22, 24, 27, 28	recall 4, inference 5, analysis 4, synthesis 3
AP	4, 18, 8, 12, 21, 10, 20, 13, 15, 23, 14, 22, 16, 28, 24, 27	recall 3, inference 5, analysis 4, synthesis 4
College Freshman	18, 29, 7, 13, 10, 21, 12, 20, 22, 23, 15, 14, 24, 28, 27, 16	recall 3, inference 5, analysis 4, synthesis 4
College Sophomore	5, 18, 11, 20, 10, 21, 13, 12, 23, 14, 15, 22, 16, 24, 28, 27	recall 2, inference 6, analysis 4, synthesis 4
College Junior	18, 29, 11, 12, 13, 21, 20, 10, 15, 14, 23, 22, 24, 27, 28, 16	recall 2, inference 6, analysis 4, synthesis 4
College Senior	18, 29, 12, 10, 20, 21, 11, 13, 15, 23, 14, 22, 24, 28, 16, 27	recall 2, inference 6, analysis 4, synthesis 4
Graduate / PhD	18, 5, 10, 21, 12, 20, 13, 11, 14, 15, 22, 23, 28, 27, 24, 16	recall 2, inference 6, analysis 4, synthesis 4

Writing prompts (eleven rigor levels)

Middle School (250 words; Indiana 2023: 7.RC.1, 7.W.1): Supported track (work from the passage your teacher selects). In “Chapter XXIV,” how does Shelley show the final reckoning? Write a paragraph that states your claim, quotes two details from the passage, and explains how each detail supports your idea. Use the point of view you noticed as one piece of evidence.

HS Freshman (350 words; Indiana 2023: 9-10.RC.1, 9-10.W.1): In Chapter XXIV, how does Shelley develop the idea of the final reckoning? State a clear claim, support it with two or three quotations, and explain how the point of view in the chapter helps build that idea.

HS Sophomore (450 words; Indiana 2023: 9-10.RC.1, 9-10.W.1): Analyze how Chapter XXIV develops the idea of the final reckoning. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of point of view and theme shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.

HS Junior (550 words; Indiana 2023: 11-12.RC.3, 11-12.RC.1, 11-12.W.1): Analyze how the structure of Chapter XXIV (where it begins, turns and ends) and its point of view shape the reader's understanding of the final reckoning. Identify one place where the text leaves matters uncertain and explain how that uncertainty adds to its meaning. Distinguish what is directly stated from what is really meant.

HS Senior (600 words; Indiana 2023: 11-12.RC.1, 11-12.W.1): Two readers disagree about what Chapter XXIV suggests about the final reckoning. Lay out two plausible interpretations, weigh the evidence for each (including the chapter's point of view and theme), and argue for the stronger one in a sustained, well-organized essay. Distinguish what is directly stated from what is really meant.

AP (650 words; Indiana 2023: 11-12.RC.1, 11-12.W.1): Write a literary argument in which you analyze how Mary Shelley uses point of view in Chapter XXIV to complicate the reader's understanding of the final reckoning. Develop a defensible thesis, select evidence purposefully, and explain how specific choices of diction and syntax create meaning.

College Freshman (1000 words; Indiana 2023: see unit standards): Situate Chapter XXIV within its historical and literary context and argue how the chapter's treatment of the final reckoning responds to that context. Engage with at least one secondary perspective (a critic, historian or the author's own statements), integrate quotations smoothly, and cite in MLA style.

College Sophomore (1250 words; Indiana 2023: see unit standards): Read Chapter XXIV alongside the conventions of its genre and period. Argue how the chapter's handling of the final reckoning follows or bends those conventions, using the point of view as evidence, and test your reading against one published critic. Document two secondary sources in MLA.

College Junior (1500 words; Indiana 2023: see unit standards): Apply a named critical approach (for example formalist, historicist, feminist, psychoanalytic or ecocritical) to Chapter XXIV and its treatment of the final reckoning. State your method, show what it reveals in the chapter's point of view and theme, and identify where the text resists it.

College Senior (2000 words; Indiana 2023: see unit standards): Develop a research argument that reads Chapter XXIV as evidence for a larger claim about the final reckoning in Frankenstein. Connect close reading of the chapter to the whole novel, engage at least four scholarly sources, and state precisely where your reading departs from theirs (Chicago style).

Graduate / PhD (2500 words; Indiana 2023: see unit standards): Develop an original argument that reads Chapter XXIV as a hinge in the novel's larger treatment of the final reckoning. Position your reading within a named critical conversation (for example formalist, historicist, psychoanalytic, feminist or postcolonial approaches), account for the textual history where relevant, and articulate the stakes of your intervention for scholarship on Frankenstein.

SAT-style questions

1. *Why do you not execrate the rustic who sought to destroy the saviour of his child?*

   As used in the text, what does the word “execrate” most nearly mean?

   A. shared with others

   B. to curse; to hate

   C. adjusted in tone

   D. calms; settles

2. *What his feelings were whom I pursued I cannot know. Sometimes, indeed, he left marks in writing on the barks of the trees, or cut in stone, that guided me, and instigated my fury. “My reign is not yet over,” (these words were legible in one of these inscriptions;) “you live, and my power is complete. Follow me; I seek the everlasting ices of the north, where you will feel the misery of cold and frost, to which I am impassive. You will find near this place, if you follow not too tardily, a dead hare; eat, and be refreshed. Come on, my enemy; we have yet to wrestle for our lives; but many hard and miserable hours must you endure until that period shall arrive.”*

   Which choice best states a central concern of “Chapter XXIV”?

   A. Reading and identity

   B. A privileged childhood and family love

   C. Horror at the moment of creation

   D. The final reckoning

SAT key: 1. B (to curse; to hate); 2. D (The final reckoning)

Unit test

Frankenstein: unit test · 90 minutes · 50 questions per rigor version (multiple choice, fill in the blank, short answer). The class rigor level picks the version; student auto-adjust applies.

Short-answer scoring guides

Middle School and HS Freshman (2 points): correct answer in a complete sentence with a detail from the text. HS Sophomore to HS Senior (3 points): claim, one accurate quotation, one sentence of explanation. AP to College Sophomore (4 points): precise claim, two embedded quotations, commentary on word choice or structure, link to theme. College Junior to Graduate (5 points): nuanced thesis, close reading of two passages, synthesis across sections, a competing reading answered. Each item lists a sample answer; partial credit is described in the app.

Unit test: item bank (all eleven rigor versions)

1. [mc · recall · DOK 1] What scientific topic did the group discuss that influenced the idea?
   A. Astronomy
   B. Botany
   C. Steam engines
   D. Galvanism and the principle of life

   Key: D (Galvanism and the principle of life)
2. [fill · recall · DOK 1] Complete the quotation from Introduction, paragraph 9: "_____, it must be humbly admitted, does not consist in creating out of void, but out of chaos"

   Key: Invention
3. [mc · recall · DOK 1] In the line "Blank and dreary on retrospection I call them; they were not so to me then.", what does "retrospection" most nearly mean?
   A. abundant wealth
   B. looking back on the past
   C. troubled; inconvenienced
   D. the state of being excommunicated

   Key: B (looking back on the past)
4. [fill · recall · DOK 1] Fill in the blank with the vocabulary word that fits: "Perhaps a corpse would be _____; galvanism had given token of such things: perhaps the component parts of a creature might be manufactured, brought together, and endued with vital warmth." Word bank: retrospection, platitude, invocations, reanimated

   Key: reanimated
5. [mc · recall · DOK 1] In the line "I felt that blank incapability of invention which is the greatest misery of authorship, when dull Nothing replies to our anxious invocations.", what does "invocations" most nearly mean?
   A. following the course of; marking out
   B. hold spellbound
   C. calls or appeals for help or inspiration

D. prickling or stinging slightly

Key: C (calls or appeals for help or inspiration)

6. [fill · recall · DOK 1] Complete the quotation from Introduction, paragraph 15: “And now, once again, I bid my _____ progeny go forth and prosper”

   Key: hideous

7. [fill · recall · DOK 1] Complete the quotation from Introduction, paragraph 11: “I saw the pale student of _____ arts kneeling beside the thing he had put together”

   Key: unhallowed

8. [mc · recall · DOK 1] Where was Shelley staying when the ghost-story contest began?

   A. In Venice

   B. On a ship to the Arctic

   C. In London

   D. Near Geneva, Switzerland

   Key: D (Near Geneva, Switzerland)

9. [mc · recall · DOK 1] How did the central image of the novel come to Shelley?

   A. In a vivid waking vision as she lay in bed

   B. From a newspaper story

   C. In a letter from a friend

   D. While reading a play

   Key: A (In a vivid waking vision as she lay in bed)

10. [mc · recall · DOK 1] Who proposed that each guest write a ghost story?

    A. Victor Frankenstein

    B. Shelley's father

    C. Robert Walton

    D. Lord Byron

    Key: D (Lord Byron)

11. [fill · recall · DOK 1] Complete the quotation from Chapter XIII, paragraph 19: “Of what a strange nature is _____! It clings to the mind, when it has once seized on it, like a lichen on the rock”

    Key: knowledge

12. [mc · recall · DOK 1] How does Safie's arrival help the creature?

    A. She feeds him

    B. She brings him chemistry books

    C. He learns language as she is taught

    D. She befriends him

    Key: C (He learns language as she is taught)

13. [mc · recall · DOK 1] Which book does Felix read to Safie?

    A. The Bible

    B. Plutarch's Lives

    C. Paradise Lost

    D. Ruins of Empires

Key: D (Ruins of Empires)

14. [fill · recall · DOK 1] Fill in the blank with the vocabulary word that fits: "I was, besides, endued with a figure _____ deformed and loathsome; I was not even of the same nature as man." Word bank: hideously, dissipates, narrations, recommencing

    Key: hideously

15. [mc · recall · DOK 1] How does knowledge affect him?

    A. It increases his sorrow

    B. It makes him content

    C. It makes him rich

    D. It cures his loneliness

    Key: A (It increases his sorrow)

16. [mc · recall · DOK 1] What question does the creature ask himself?

    A. Who is Walton?

    B. What was I?

    C. Where is Geneva?

    D. Why is it cold?

    Key: B (What was I?)

17. [fill · recall · DOK 1] Fill in the blank with the vocabulary word that fits: "The old man appeared _____, and said some words, which Agatha endeavoured to explain to Safie, and by which he appeared to wish to express that she bestowed on him the greatest delight by her music." Word bank: recommencing, enraptured, narrations, dissipates

    Key: enraptured

18. [mc · recall · DOK 1] In the line ""These wonderful narrations inspired me with strange feelings.", what does "narrations" most nearly mean?

    A. beats; throbs (of the heart)

    B. stories; accounts of events

    C. adjusted in tone

    D. jailers (British spelling)

    Key: B (stories; accounts of events)

19. [mc · recall · DOK 1] In the line "They made many signs which I did not comprehend; but I saw that her presence diffused gladness through the cottage, dispelling their sorrow as the sun dissipates the morning mists.", what does "dissipates" most nearly mean?

    A. place at intervals in or among

    B. makes disappear; scatters

    C. a companion at play

    D. drifting on water

    Key: B (makes disappear; scatters)

20. [mc · recall · DOK 1] Who arrives at the cottage?

    A. Elizabeth

    B. Safie

C. Clerval

D. Justine

Key: B (Safie)

21. [fill · recall · DOK 1] Complete the quotation from Chapter XV, paragraph 3: "_____ Lost, a volume of Plutarch's Lives, and the Sorrows of Werther"

    Key: Paradise

22. [fill · recall · DOK 1] Fill in the blank with the vocabulary word that fits: "The _____ upon death and suicide were calculated to fill me with wonder." Word bank: disquisitions, instigate, massacring, undeceiving

    Key: disquisitions

23. [fill · recall · DOK 1] Complete the quotation from Chapter XV, paragraph 8: "Hateful day when I _____ life"

    Key: received

24. [mc · recall · DOK 1] In the line "I read of men concerned in public affairs, governing or massacring their species.", what does "massacring" most nearly mean?

    A. brought back to life or strength; revived

    B. killing large numbers of people

    C. to thicken or freeze (here, with horror)

    D. healthy; good for the body

    Key: B (killing large numbers of people)

25. [mc · recall · DOK 1] In the line "I sympathised with, and partly understood them, but I was unformed in mind; I was dependent on none, and related to none. 'The path of my departure was free'; and there was none to lament my annihilation.", what does "unformed" most nearly mean?

    A. a feeling of evil to come

    B. weakened

    C. not having form or shape

    D. focused; concentrated (British spelling)

    Key: C (not having form or shape)

26. [mc · recall · DOK 1] Why does he choose the blind father first?

    A. He cannot judge by appearance

    B. He is the strongest

    C. He speaks German

    D. He has money

    Key: A (He cannot judge by appearance)

27. [mc · recall · DOK 1] What document does he discover in his clothing?

    A. Victor's laboratory journal

    B. A map

    C. A letter from Elizabeth

    D. A will

    Key: A (Victor's laboratory journal)

28. [mc · recall · DOK 1] Which character in Milton does he feel most like?

    A. Michael

B. Eve

C. Satan, the outcast

D. Gabriel

Key: C (Satan, the outcast)

29. [fill · recall · DOK 1] Fill in the blank with the vocabulary word that fits: “I learned, from the views of social life which it developed, to admire their virtues, and to _____ the vices of mankind.” Word bank: massacring, undeceiving, instigate, deprecate

    Key: deprecate

30. [short · inference · DOK 2] What can you infer from this line? “And now, once again, I bid my hideous progeny go forth and prosper” (Introduction, paragraph 15) Answer in two or three sentences with one detail.

    Sample answer: Shelley presents herself as a parent of the book. Use this to connect author and character: both make something "hideous," but only one blesses it.

31. [mc · inference · DOK 2] What does this passage most clearly show? “And now, once again, I bid my hideous progeny go forth and prosper” (Introduction, paragraph 15)

    A. Shot after a rescue; bitter irony.

    B. Elizabeth sees what Victor hides; his guilt shows on his face.

    C. A careful double negative: not "possible," only "not impossible." Evidence that the book presents itself as grounded in real science.

    D. Shelley presents herself as a parent of the book. Use this to connect author and character: both make something "hideous," but only one blesses it.

    Key: D (Shelley presents herself as a parent of the book. Use this to connect author and character: both make something "hideous," but only one blesses it.)

32. [short · inference · DOK 2] What can you infer from this line? “I saw the pale student of unhallowed arts kneeling beside the thing he had put together” (Introduction, paragraph 11) Answer in two or three sentences with one detail.

    Sample answer: "Unhallowed" means unholy, and "thing" refuses the creation a name. Students can use this to argue that the novel judges the act of creation as a transgression from its first image.

33. [mc · inference · DOK 2] What does this passage most clearly show? “I saw the pale student of unhallowed arts kneeling beside the thing he had put together” (Introduction, paragraph 11)

    A. Dismissal without explanation; Victor later blames this.

    B. Self-horror learned from others' standards of beauty.

    C. Elizabeth is presented as a gift; useful for discussions of how women are treated in the novel.

    D. "Unhallowed" means unholy, and "thing" refuses the creation a name. Students can use this to argue that the novel judges the act of creation as a transgression from its first image.

    Key: D ("Unhallowed" means unholy, and "thing" refuses the creation a name. Students can use this to argue that the novel judges the act of creation as a transgression from its first image.)

34. [short · inference · DOK 2] What can you infer from this line? “I heard of the division of property, of immense wealth and squalid poverty; of rank, descent, and noble blood” (Chapter XIII, paragraph 16) Answer in two or three sentences with one detail.

    Sample answer: Political education; links to Godwin.

35. [short · inference · DOK 2] What can you infer from this line? “Of what a strange nature is knowledge! It clings to the mind, when it has once seized on it, like a lichen on the rock” (Chapter XIII, paragraph 19) Answer in two or three sentences with one detail.

    Sample answer: Simile for knowledge that cannot be unlearned.

36. [mc · inference · DOK 2] What does this passage most clearly show? “And what was I” (Chapter XIII, paragraph 17)

    A. A newborn's memory; invites sympathy.

    B. A question of identity.

    C. Isolation through allusion.

    D. Self-horror learned from others' standards of beauty.

    Key: B (A question of identity.)

37. [mc · inference · DOK 2] What does this passage most clearly show? “Of what a strange nature is knowledge! It clings to the mind, when it has once seized on it, like a lichen on the rock” (Chapter XIII, paragraph 19)

    A. Blunt, short sentence in the father's letter.

    B. Simile for knowledge that cannot be unlearned.

    C. The wish to belong.

    D. The argument from isolation.

    Key: B (Simile for knowledge that cannot be unlearned.)

38. [mc · inference · DOK 2] What does this passage most clearly show? “Paradise Lost, a volume of Plutarch’s Lives, and the Sorrows of Werther” (Chapter XV, paragraph 3)

    A. Biblical image of hell (Isaiah, Mark): remorse as eternal torment.

    B. Victor concludes guilt from appearance, as others will judge the creature.

    C. His education; each book shapes him.

    D. Ingratitude repays virtue; the word "treacherous" carries the creature's (and the narrative's) judgment.

    Key: C (His education; each book shapes him.)

39. [short · inference · DOK 2] What can you infer from this line? “Like Adam, I was apparently united by no link to any other being in existence” (Chapter XV, paragraph 7) Answer in two or three sentences with one detail.

    Sample answer: Isolation through allusion.

40. [mc · inference · DOK 2] What does this passage most clearly show? “Hateful day when I received life” (Chapter XV, paragraph 8)

    A. The creature curses his own birth, echoing Job.

    B. Echoes the "lifeless matter" of creation.

    C. Narrated with hindsight; sets a pattern of suffering.

    D. Milton allusion; the creature casts Victor as a God who failed.

    Key: A (The creature curses his own birth, echoing Job.)

41. [mc · inference · DOK 2] Which choice best states a central concern of “Chapter XV”?

    A. Recovery and false peace

    B. First experiences of the senses

    C. Confrontation between creator and creation

D. Reading and identity

Key: D (Reading and identity)

42. [mc · analysis · DOK 3] In this chapter, which theme does the following most directly develop? Shelley calls the book her "hideous progeny" and sends it out into the world, as Victor does his creature; but unlike Victor she wishes it to "prosper." The author models the care the character fails to give.

A. Isolation and the need for companionship

B. Nature versus nurture

C. Creation and responsibility

D. The costs of unchecked ambition

Key: C (Creation and responsibility)

43. [mc · analysis · DOK 3] Which literary element does this describe in “Introduction”? The Introduction is thick with real names (Byron, Percy Shelley, Dr. Darwin, galvanism). Each one ties the fiction to real science and real literary rivalry, which is why the story felt possible to its first readers.

A. Symbolism

B. Tone / mood

C. Allusion

D. Alliteration

Key: C (Allusion)

44. [mc · analysis · DOK 3] Which literary element does this describe in “Chapter XIII”? Abstract nouns (property, wealth, poverty, rank) enter his vocabulary; knowledge brings grief.

A. Diction / vocabulary

B. Structure

C. Imagery

D. Metaphor

Key: A (Diction / vocabulary)

45. [short · analysis · DOK 3] Claim: For the creature, knowledge brings not power but a painful awareness of exclusion. Explain how this evidence supports the claim: “I heard of the division of property, of immense wealth and squalid poverty; of rank, descent, and noble blood” (Chapter XIII, paragraph 16).

Sample answer: Learning of "rank, descent, and noble blood" leads him straight to "And what was I?", because society's categories leave no place for him.

46. [mc · analysis · DOK 3] Which literary element does this describe in “Chapter XV”? He identifies with both Adam and Satan, and reads Victor's journal about his own creation.

A. Diction / vocabulary

B. Characterization

C. Conflict

D. Allusion

Key: B (Characterization)

47. [short · analysis · DOK 3] Analyze the word choice in “Hateful day when I received life” (Chapter XV, paragraph 8). Pick two words and explain what they suggest.

Sample answer: The creature curses his own birth, echoing Job.

48. [short · synthesis · DOK 4] Synthesis: trace how creation and responsibility develops from an earlier chapter to “Introduction”. Use one quotation from each.

    Sample answer: Shelley calls the book her "hideous progeny" and sends it out into the world, as Victor does his creature; but unlike Victor she wishes it to "prosper." The author models the care the character fails to give.

49. [short · synthesis · DOK 4] Close reading: how do the diction and syntax of “Of what a strange nature is knowledge! It clings to the mind, when it has once seized on it, like a lichen on the rock” (Chapter XIII, paragraph 19) shape its meaning? Consider a second, competing reading.

    Sample answer: Simile for knowledge that cannot be unlearned.

50. [short · synthesis · DOK 4] Synthesis: trace how nature and nurture develops from an earlier chapter to “Chapter XV”. Use one quotation from each.

    Sample answer: rejection is based on sight; the blind man alone judges him by his words.

51. [mc · recall · DOK 1] In the line “Perhaps a corpse would be reanimated; galvanism had given token of such things: perhaps the component parts of a creature might be manufactured, brought together, and endued with vital warmth.”, what does “galvanism” most nearly mean?

    A. in a kind, well-meaning way

    B. cannot be removed or erased

    C. argue in protest or opposition

    D. electricity produced by chemical action, used in early experiments on muscles

    Key: D (electricity produced by chemical action, used in early experiments on muscles)

52. [fill · recall · DOK 1] Fill in the blank with the vocabulary word that fits: “The shape was lost beneath the shadow of the castle walls; but soon a gate swung back, a step was heard, the door of the chamber opened, and he advanced to the couch of the blooming youths, _____ in healthy sleep.” Word bank: cradled, invocations, retrospection, platitude

    Key: cradled

53. [fill · recall · DOK 1] Complete the quotation from Chapter XIII, paragraph 16: “I heard of the _____ of property, of immense wealth and squalid poverty; of rank, descent, and noble blood”

    Key: division

54. [fill · recall · DOK 1] Fill in the blank with the vocabulary word that fits: “At first I had neglected them; but now that I was able to _____ the characters in which they were written, I began to study them with diligence.” Word bank: undeceiving, massacring, decipher, instigate

    Key: decipher

55. [fill · recall · DOK 1] Fill in the blank with the vocabulary word that fits: “I am blind, and cannot judge of your countenance, but there is something in your words, which _____ me that you are sincere.” Word bank: undeceiving, persuades, massacring, instigate

    Key: persuades

56. [mc · recall · DOK 1] Which book is NOT among those he finds?

    A. The Sorrows of Young Werther

    B. Robinson Crusoe

    C. Paradise Lost

    D. Plutarch's Lives

    Key: B (Robinson Crusoe)

57. [mc · inference · DOK 2] What does this passage most clearly show? “Invention, it must be humbly admitted, does not consist in creating out of void, but out of chaos” (Introduction, paragraph 9)
    A. Victor makes Justine's death about his suffering: a striking self-centeredness.
    B. Shelley's theory of creativity: you build from existing materials, as Victor builds from old bones. Good evidence for a claim about the novel's self-awareness.
    C. Confession to his father, dismissed as madness.
    D. Ingratitude repays virtue; the word "treacherous" carries the creature's (and the narrative's) judgment.

    Key: B (Shelley's theory of creativity: you build from existing materials, as Victor builds from old bones. Good evidence for a claim about the novel's self-awareness.)

58. [mc · inference · DOK 2] Which choice best states a central concern of “Chapter XIII”?
    A. Language, knowledge and sorrow
    B. Loss and leaving home
    C. Despair and the sublime
    D. Isolation in the north

    Key: A (Language, knowledge and sorrow)

59. [mc · inference · DOK 2] What does this passage most clearly show? “Like Adam, I was apparently united by no link to any other being in existence” (Chapter XV, paragraph 7)
    A. "Satiate" (fully satisfy) and "ardent" reveal appetite-like ambition. Use for a claim about the dangers of curiosity.
    B. Isolation through allusion.
    C. Claims a relationship and a duty.
    D. Victor concludes guilt from appearance, as others will judge the creature.

    Key: B (Isolation through allusion.)

60. [short · analysis · DOK 3] Claim: Shelley frames her novel as a creation that, unlike Victor's, is accepted and sent out with care. Explain how this evidence supports the claim: “And now, once again, I bid my hideous progeny go forth and prosper” (Introduction, paragraph 15).
    Sample answer: By calling the book her "hideous progeny" she uses the language of parenthood; wishing it to "prosper" is exactly the blessing the creature never receives, so the frame sets up the novel's test of what makers owe what they make.

61. [short · analysis · DOK 3] Analyze the word choice in “Invention, it must be humbly admitted, does not consist in creating out of void, but out of chaos” (Introduction, paragraph 9). Pick two words and explain what they suggest.
    Sample answer: Shelley's theory of creativity: you build from existing materials, as Victor builds from old bones. Good evidence for a claim about the novel's self-awareness.

62. [mc · analysis · DOK 3] Which literary element does this describe in “Chapter XIII”? Learning history and social order, the creature realizes he has no place: no money, family or name.
    A. Diction / vocabulary
    B. Simile
    C. Personification
    D. Characterization

    Key: D (Characterization)

63. [mc · analysis · DOK 3] Quote identification: in which section does this passage appear? “Of what a strange nature is knowledge! It clings to the mind, when it has once seized on it, like a lichen on the rock”

    A. Chapter XIV

    B. Preface

    C. Chapter VI

    D. Chapter XIII

    Key: D (Chapter XIII)

64. [mc · analysis · DOK 3] Which literary element does this describe in “Chapter XV”? The three books he finds (Paradise Lost, Plutarch's Lives, The Sorrows of Werter) give him models of a creator, of public virtue and of feeling.

    A. Allusion

    B. Simile

    C. Tone / mood

    D. Structure

    Key: A (Allusion)

65. [short · synthesis · DOK 4] Close reading: how do the diction and syntax of “I saw the pale student of unhallowed arts kneeling beside the thing he had put together” (Introduction, paragraph 11) shape its meaning? Consider a second, competing reading.

    Sample answer: "Unhallowed" means unholy, and "thing" refuses the creation a name. Students can use this to argue that the novel judges the act of creation as a transgression from its first image.

66. [short · synthesis · DOK 4] Evaluate this claim about the chapter: “For the creature, knowledge brings not power but a painful awareness of exclusion.” Is it fully persuasive? Argue with evidence, including a passage that complicates it.

    Sample answer: Learning of "rank, descent, and noble blood" leads him straight to "And what was I?", because society's categories leave no place for him.

67. [short · synthesis · DOK 4] Close reading: how do the diction and syntax of “Like Adam, I was apparently united by no link to any other being in existence” (Chapter XV, paragraph 7) shape its meaning? Consider a second, competing reading.

    Sample answer: Isolation through allusion.

68. [mc · recall · DOK 1] What does Shelley call her book?

    A. Her little ghost

    B. Her hideous progeny

    C. Her Prometheus

    D. Her summer diary

    Key: B (Her hideous progeny)

69. [mc · recall · DOK 1] In the line “The illustrious poets also, annoyed by the platitude of prose, speedily relinquished their uncongenial task.”, what does “platitude” most nearly mean?

    A. dullness; a lack of freshness or originality

    B. frightened; made fearful

    C. increase

    D. people who live in a place

Key: A (dullness; a lack of freshness or originality)

70. [fill · recall · DOK 1] Fill in the blank with the vocabulary word that fits: “One which would speak to the mysterious fears of our nature, and awaken thrilling horror—one to make the reader dread to look round, to curdle the blood, and quicken the _____ of the heart.” Word bank: retrospection, platitude, invocations, beatings

Key: beatings

71. [mc · inference · DOK 2] Which choice best states a central concern of “Introduction”?

A. Destroying the companion

B. Horror at the moment of creation

C. The origin of the novel and the idea of creation

D. Learning compassion by watching

Key: C (The origin of the novel and the idea of creation)

72. [mc · inference · DOK 2] What does this passage most clearly show? “I heard of the division of property, of immense wealth and squalid poverty; of rank, descent, and noble blood” (Chapter XIII, paragraph 16)

A. Political education; links to Godwin.

B. The creature's longing for release.

C. Possessive language; evidence for a claim about Victor's self-centeredness.

D. The discovery itself, told without explanation; Victor withholds the secret.

Key: A (Political education; links to Godwin.)

73. [short · inference · DOK 2] What can you infer from this line? “Paradise Lost, a volume of Plutarch’s Lives, and the Sorrows of Werther” (Chapter XV, paragraph 3) Answer in two or three sentences with one detail.

Sample answer: His education; each book shapes him.

74. [mc · analysis · DOK 3] Which literary element does this describe in “Introduction”? Shelley speaks in her own voice, thirteen years later, as an author looking back. She shapes a legend about herself: a shy young woman among famous poets who cannot think of a story until a vision comes. Ask students what she gains by…

A. Theme

B. Foreshadowing

C. Imagery

D. Point of view

Key: D (Point of view)

75. [mc · analysis · DOK 3] Quote identification: in which section does this passage appear? “Paradise Lost, a volume of Plutarch’s Lives, and the Sorrows of Werther”

A. Chapter XIV

B. Letter I

C. Chapter XV

D. Chapter XVII

Key: C (Chapter XV)

76. [short · analysis · DOK 3] Claim: The creature's rejection by the De Laceys proves that appearance, not character, condemns him. Explain how this evidence supports the claim: “Paradise Lost, a volume of Plutarch’s Lives, and the Sorrows of Werther” (Chapter XV, paragraph 3).

Sample answer: Old De Lacey, who is blind, responds kindly to his words, but the family sees him and attacks; the scene shows that only someone who cannot see him can judge him fairly.

77. [short · synthesis · DOK 4] Close reading: how do the diction and syntax of "And now, once again, I bid my hideous progeny go forth and prosper" (Introduction, paragraph 15) shape its meaning? Consider a second, competing reading.
Sample answer: Shelley presents herself as a parent of the book. Use this to connect author and character: both make something "hideous," but only one blesses it.

78. [short · synthesis · DOK 4] Evaluate this claim about the chapter: "Shelley frames her novel as a creation that, unlike Victor's, is accepted and sent out with care." Is it fully persuasive? Argue with evidence, including a passage that complicates it.
Sample answer: By calling the book her "hideous progeny" she uses the language of parenthood; wishing it to "prosper" is exactly the blessing the creature never receives, so the frame sets up the novel's test of what makers owe what they make.

79. [short · synthesis · DOK 4] Close reading: how do the diction and syntax of "I heard of the division of property, of immense wealth and squalid poverty; of rank, descent, and noble blood" (Chapter XIII, paragraph 16) shape its meaning? Consider a second, competing reading.
Sample answer: Political education; links to Godwin.

80. [fill · recall · DOK 1] Fill in the blank with the vocabulary word that fits: "Her hair of a shining raven black, and curiously braided; her eyes were dark, but gentle, although animated; her features of a regular proportion, and her complexion _____ fair, each cheek tinged with a lovely pink." Word bank: narrations, recommencing, dissipates, wondrously
Key: wondrously

81. [fill · recall · DOK 1] Fill in the blank with the vocabulary word that fits: "Was I then a monster, a blot upon the earth, from which all men fled, and whom all men _____?" Word bank: recommencing, disowned, narrations, dissipates
Key: disowned

82. [mc · recall · DOK 1] In the line "" 'Heaven forbid! even if you were really criminal; for that can only drive you to desperation, and not instigate you to virtue.", what does "instigate" most nearly mean?
A. wet with drops, as of dew or tears
B. cause to start burning
C. to urge on; to provoke
D. to rise and fall; to change often
Key: C (to urge on; to provoke)

83. [mc · analysis · DOK 3] Quote identification: in which section does this passage appear? "I saw the pale student of unhallowed arts kneeling beside the thing he had put together"
A. Chapter XVI
B. Introduction
C. Chapter XIV
D. Chapter XVII
Key: B (Introduction)

84. [short · analysis · DOK 3] Analyze the word choice in "And what was I" (Chapter XIII, paragraph 17). Pick two words and explain what they suggest.
Sample answer: A question of identity.

85. [short · synthesis · DOK 4] Synthesis: trace how ambition and knowledge develops from an earlier chapter to “Chapter XIII”. Use one quotation from each.

    Sample answer: "Of what a strange nature is knowledge!": knowledge as a burden.

86. [short · synthesis · DOK 4] Evaluate this claim about the chapter: “The creature's rejection by the De Laceys proves that appearance, not character, condemns him.” Is it fully persuasive? Argue with evidence, including a passage that complicates it.

    Sample answer: Old De Lacey, who is blind, responds kindly to his words, but the family sees him and attacks; the scene shows that only someone who cannot see him can judge him fairly.

87. [mc · recall · DOK 1] In the line “I heard of the slothful Asiatics; of the stupendous genius and mental activity of the Grecians; of the wars and wonderful virtue of the early Romans—of their subsequent degenerating—of the decline of that mighty empire;…”, what does “degenerating” most nearly mean?

    A. express strong disapproval of

    B. grow worse

    C. tiring

    D. dip a foot or hand briefly into a liquid

    Key: B (grow worse)

88. [short · synthesis · DOK 4] Close reading: how do the diction and syntax of “Paradise Lost, a volume of Plutarch’s Lives, and the Sorrows of Werther” (Chapter XV, paragraph 3) shape its meaning? Consider a second, competing reading.

    Sample answer: His education; each book shapes him.

89. [short · synthesis · DOK 4] Close reading: how do the diction and syntax of “Learn from me, if not by my precepts, at least by my example, how dangerous is the acquirement of knowledge” (Chapter IV, paragraph 6) shape its meaning? Consider a second, competing reading.

    Sample answer: The novel's warning stated outright.

90. [short · synthesis · DOK 4] Synthesis: trace how ambition and knowledge develops from an earlier chapter to “Chapter IV”. Use one quotation from each.

    Sample answer: Victor fantasizes that "a new species would bless me as its creator," revealing the wish to be worshipped.

91. [short · synthesis · DOK 4] Evaluate this claim about the chapter: “Victor's motive for creating life is the desire to be honored, not to care for what he creates.” Is it fully persuasive? Argue with evidence, including a passage that complicates it.

    Sample answer: He imagines a new species that "would bless me as its creator," which centers his own glory; nothing in his plans considers what the being will need.

92. [short · synthesis · DOK 4] Synthesis: trace how nature and nurture develops from an earlier chapter to “Chapter XI”. Use one quotation from each.

    Sample answer: he begins innocent; humans attack him on sight.

93. [short · synthesis · DOK 4] Synthesis: trace how ambition and knowledge develops from an earlier chapter to “Chapter XXIV”. Use one quotation from each.

    Sample answer: Victor's final advice: "Seek happiness in tranquillity and avoid ambition."

94. [short · synthesis · DOK 4] Evaluate this claim about the chapter: “The creature begins as an innocent who meets violence before he commits any.” Is it fully persuasive? Argue with evidence, including a passage that complicates it.

Sample answer: He remembers "considerable difficulty" in understanding his first sensations, a newborn's helplessness, and the villagers' response to his approach is that "some fled, some attacked me," so hostility comes from them.

95. [short · synthesis · DOK 4] Close reading: how do the diction and syntax of “How strange, I thought, that the same cause should produce such opposite effects” (Chapter XI, paragraph 6) shape its meaning? Consider a second, competing reading.
    Sample answer: Fire's double nature; symbol for knowledge and for the creature.

96. [short · synthesis · DOK 4] Close reading: how do the diction and syntax of “He was soon borne away by the waves, and lost in darkness and distance” (Chapter XXIV, paragraph 75) shape its meaning? Consider a second, competing reading.
    Sample answer: The ending: ambiguous death.

97. [short · synthesis · DOK 4] Evaluate this claim about the chapter: “The ending leaves the reader to judge, with Victor's lesson undercut by his doubt and the creature's grief.” Is it fully persuasive? Argue with evidence, including a passage that complicates it.
    Sample answer: Victor advises "seek happiness in tranquillity and avoid ambition" yet adds that another may succeed; the creature disappears into "darkness and distance," leaving judgment open.

98. [fill · recall · DOK 1] Fill in the blank with the vocabulary word that fits: “In all matters of discovery and invention, even of those that _____ to the imagination, we are continually reminded of the story of Columbus and his egg.” Word bank: invocations, platitude, retrospection, appertain
    Key: appertain

99. [short · synthesis · DOK 4] Close reading: how do the diction and syntax of “A new species would bless me as its creator and source” (Chapter IV, paragraph 8) shape its meaning? Consider a second, competing reading.
    Sample answer: Desire for glory, not care; evidence of selfish motives.

100. [fill · recall · DOK 1] Complete the quotation from Chapter XV, paragraph 7: “Like Adam, I was _____ united by no link to any other being in existence”
    Key: apparently

101. [short · synthesis · DOK 4] Synthesis: trace how ambition and knowledge develops from an earlier chapter to “Chapter II”. Use one quotation from each.
    Sample answer: the desire to learn "the secrets of heaven and earth" begins as wonder and becomes obsession.

102. [short · synthesis · DOK 4] Close reading: how do the diction and syntax of “It is with considerable difficulty that I remember the original era of my being” (Chapter XI, paragraph 1) shape its meaning? Consider a second, competing reading.
    Sample answer: A newborn's memory; invites sympathy.

103. [short · synthesis · DOK 4] Close reading: how do the diction and syntax of “Seek happiness in tranquillity, and avoid ambition” (Chapter XXIV, paragraph 57) shape its meaning? Consider a second, competing reading.
    Sample answer: Victor's lesson; partly retracted.

Rigor version	Items (in order)	Mix
Middle School	1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 6, 7, 8, 9, 10, 11, 12, 13, 14, 15, 16, 17, 18, 19, 20, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 26, 27, 28, 29, 30, 31, 32, 33, 34, 35, 36, 37, 38, 39, 40, 41, 42, 43, 44, 45, 46, 47, 48, 49, 50	recall 29, inference 12, analysis 6, synthesis 3
HS Freshman		

	5, 1, 51, 7, 2, 4, 52, 9, 3, 18, 13, 16, 20, 14, 11, 19, 17, 53, 22, 29, 54, 55, 21, 23, 25, 56, 31, 30, 33, 57, 58, 35, 36, 34, 41, 39, 59, 38, 60, 61, 43, 62, 63, 45, 64, 46, 47, 65, 66, 67	recall 26, inference 12, analysis 9, synthesis 3
HS Sophomore	2, 68, 5, 51, 69, 70, 4, 15, 12, 17, 20, 53, 19, 25, 54, 22, 29, 28, 26, 31, 32, 33, 71, 30, 57, 34, 37, 36, 72, 58, 59, 40, 73, 39, 38, 42, 43, 74, 45, 62, 63, 46, 75, 76, 77, 78, 49, 79, 67, 50	recall 19, inference 16, analysis 9, synthesis 6
HS Junior	10, 68, 5, 52, 2, 1, 18, 80, 81, 16, 13, 25, 82, 23, 28, 26, 33, 32, 57, 31, 71, 30, 58, 35, 72, 36, 37, 41, 38, 40, 59, 39, 60, 83, 74, 43, 63, 62, 44, 84, 75, 76, 46, 64, 48, 65, 79, 85, 86, 67	recall 16, inference 16, analysis 12, synthesis 6
HS Senior	52, 9, 3, 8, 70, 87, 14, 81, 53, 82, 25, 22, 27, 31, 57, 32, 33, 30, 71, 35, 36, 37, 72, 34, 59, 38, 73, 40, 39, 61, 74, 42, 60, 84, 45, 62, 63, 64, 75, 76, 46, 48, 77, 78, 79, 49, 66, 67, 88, 50	recall 13, inference 16, analysis 12, synthesis 9
AP	69, 7, 51, 53, 80, 15, 82, 24, 56, 30, 33, 31, 57, 58, 36, 37, 34, 38, 59, 73, 40, 42, 61, 83, 74, 60, 43, 45, 84, 63, 44, 62, 47, 46, 64, 75, 76, 48, 78, 65, 77, 89, 85, 49, 79, 66, 67, 50, 88, 86	recall 9, inference 12, analysis 16, synthesis 13
College Freshman	4, 3, 10, 17, 87, 14, 82, 27, 25, 31, 33, 30, 57, 34, 58, 72, 36, 40, 73, 59, 41, 42, 83, 74, 61, 60, 43, 44, 45, 84, 62, 63, 47, 64, 76, 75, 46, 77, 48, 65, 78, 90, 79, 49, 85, 66, 88, 67, 86, 50	recall 9, inference 12, analysis 16, synthesis 13
College Sophomore	52, 5, 12, 14, 22, 26, 31, 33, 32, 30, 34, 35, 72, 58, 41, 39, 40, 38, 74, 42, 43, 83, 61, 60, 62, 63, 45, 44, 84, 75, 47, 46, 64, 76, 65, 48, 78, 77, 91, 90, 92, 66, 49, 85, 79, 88, 67, 50, 86, 93	recall 6, inference 12, analysis 16, synthesis 16
College Junior	8, 51, 80, 53, 55, 56, 71, 33, 30, 35, 36, 58, 73, 39, 41, 43, 74, 61, 60, 83, 42, 45, 63, 62, 44, 84, 64, 76, 46, 47, 75, 78, 65, 77, 48, 91, 90, 89, 94, 95, 66, 85, 49, 79, 88, 67, 86, 50, 96, 97	recall 6, inference 9, analysis 16, synthesis 19
College Senior	98, 18, 22, 71, 31, 33, 58, 37, 35, 41, 73, 38, 74, 42, 43, 61, 83, 60, 84, 62, 45, 44, 63, 75, 64, 46, 76, 47, 78, 77, 65, 48, 89, 99, 91, 90, 92, 95, 94, 49, 79, 85, 66, 67, 88, 86, 50, 96, 93, 97	recall 3, inference 9, analysis 16, synthesis 22
Graduate / PhD	6, 16, 100, 71, 32, 58, 72, 39, 73, 60, 42, 83, 43, 61, 74, 62, 63, 84, 45, 44, 47, 46, 75, 76, 64, 78, 65, 77, 48, 101, 90, 91, 89, 99, 94, 92, 95, 102, 85, 66, 49, 79, 67, 86, 88, 50, 97, 96, 93, 103	recall 3, inference 6, analysis 16, synthesis 25

Final paper

Frankenstein: final paper (formal literary analysis). Choose one prompt.

1. Analyze how Mary Shelley develops the costs of unchecked ambition across Frankenstein. Trace the idea through at least three moments (beginning, middle and end) and argue what the ending finally suggests.
2. Choose one recurring symbol, image or motif in Frankenstein and argue how its meaning changes over the novel and why that change matters to creation and responsibility.
3. Analyze a central character's choices in Frankenstein. Argue whether the novel judges that character, and how its structure or point of view shapes your answer.
4. Two readers disagree about whether Frankenstein finally endorses or criticizes its society's view of isolation and the need for companionship. Weigh both readings and argue for one, answering the strongest objection.

Length: Middle School 500-700 words; HS Freshman 700-900 words; HS Sophomore 900-1,100 words; HS Junior 1,000-1,300 words; HS Senior 1,200-1,500 words; AP 1,300-1,600 words; College Freshman 1,500-2,000 words; College Sophomore 2,000-2,500 words; College Junior 2,500-3,000 words; College Senior 3,000-4,000 words; Graduate / PhD 4,000-6,000 words

Evidence requirement: at least 6 quotations from at least three sections, from the beginning, middle and end. Quote the reading text exactly and cite the chapter and paragraph (MLA style). HS Senior and above: one scholarly or historical source; College Sophomore and above: two, cited in MLA.

Criterion	Points	Descriptor
Thesis	20	A specific, arguable claim that answers the prompt and organizes the paper.
Evidence	25	Well-chosen, accurately quoted and cited passages from across the work, meeting the evidence requirement.
Analysis	30	Explains how language, structure and literary elements create meaning; goes beyond summary.
Organization	15	Logical progression, clear topic sentences and transitions; introduction and conclusion frame the argument.
Style and conventions	10	Formal academic voice, present tense for literature, correct grammar and MLA format.

Essay assignments

Essay: The costs of unchecked ambition

Middle School (600 words; Indiana 2023: 7.W.1, 7.RC.2): Supported track: write a five-paragraph essay explaining what Frankenstein teaches about the costs of unchecked ambition. Use at least three quotations from passages your teacher selects from different parts of the book.

HS Freshman (800 words; Indiana 2023: 9-10.W.1, 9-10.RC.2): Write a multi-paragraph essay explaining how Mary Shelley develops the costs of unchecked ambition in Frankenstein. Use evidence from the beginning, middle and end of the book.

HS Sophomore (1000 words; Indiana 2023: 9-10.W.1, 9-10.RC.2): Write an argumentative essay analyzing how Mary Shelley develops the costs of unchecked ambition across Frankenstein. Trace the idea through at least three chapters and address a counterclaim.

HS Junior (1100 words; Indiana 2023: 11-12.W.1, 11-12.RC.3): Write an analytical essay on how the structure of Frankenstein (its order, turns and ending) shapes the meaning of the costs of unchecked ambition. Discuss at least one place where the book leaves the question open.

HS Senior (1200 words; Indiana 2023: 11-12.W.1, 11-12.RC.1): Write a sustained argument comparing two interpretations of the costs of unchecked ambition in Frankenstein. Weigh the evidence for each and defend the stronger reading in a mature, well-organized essay.

AP (1300 words; Indiana 2023: 11-12.W.1, 11-12.RC.1): Write a literary argument: develop a defensible thesis about how Mary Shelley's choices in Frankenstein (a recurring element, structure and narration) shape a complex understanding of the costs of unchecked ambition, weigh at least one competing reading, and sustain commentary on well-chosen evidence. Do not merely summarize.

College Freshman (1600 words; Indiana 2023: see unit standards): Write a researched essay (4–6 pages) that places Frankenstein's treatment of the costs of unchecked ambition in its historical context, using at least two scholarly sources.

College Sophomore (2200 words; Indiana 2023: see unit standards): Write a contextual essay (6–8 pages) on the costs of unchecked ambition in Frankenstein that reads the novel against its genre and period and engages two published critics. At this level students write ONE of the unit's essays (choose one theme), not all five.

College Junior (2800 words; Indiana 2023: see unit standards): Write a theoretically informed essay (8–10 pages) on the costs of unchecked ambition in Frankenstein. Name your critical method, apply it closely, and acknowledge its limits. At this level students write ONE of the unit's essays (choose one theme), not all five.

College Senior (4000 words; Indiana 2023: see unit standards): Write a research paper (12–15 pages) with an original argument about the costs of unchecked ambition in Frankenstein, engaging at least four scholarly sources in Chicago style. At this level students write ONE of the unit's essays (choose one theme), not all five.

Graduate / PhD (6000 words; Indiana 2023: see unit standards): Write a seminar paper (15–20 pages) that intervenes in the critical conversation on the costs of unchecked ambition in Frankenstein, engaging the relevant scholarship and textual history. At this level students write ONE of the unit's essays (choose one theme), not all five.

Rubric: Claim · Evidence · Analysis · Organization · Conventions

Essay: Creation and responsibility

Middle School (600 words; Indiana 2023: 7.W.1, 7.RC.2): Supported track: write a five-paragraph essay explaining what Frankenstein teaches about creation and responsibility. Use at least three quotations from passages your teacher selects from different parts of the book.

HS Freshman (800 words; Indiana 2023: 9-10.W.1, 9-10.RC.2): Write a multi-paragraph essay explaining how Mary Shelley develops creation and responsibility in Frankenstein. Use evidence from the beginning, middle and end of the book.

HS Sophomore (1000 words; Indiana 2023: 9-10.W.1, 9-10.RC.2): Write an argumentative essay analyzing how Mary Shelley develops creation and responsibility across Frankenstein. Trace the idea through at least three chapters and address a counterclaim.

HS Junior (1100 words; Indiana 2023: 11-12.W.1, 11-12.RC.3): Write an analytical essay on how the structure of Frankenstein (its order, turns and ending) shapes the meaning of creation and responsibility. Discuss at least one place where the book leaves the question open.

HS Senior (1200 words; Indiana 2023: 11-12.W.1, 11-12.RC.1): Write a sustained argument comparing two interpretations of creation and responsibility in Frankenstein. Weigh the evidence for each and defend the stronger reading in a mature, well-organized essay.

AP (1300 words; Indiana 2023: 11-12.W.1, 11-12.RC.1): Write a literary argument: develop a defensible thesis about how Mary Shelley's choices in Frankenstein (a recurring element, structure and narration) shape a complex understanding of creation and responsibility, weigh at least one competing reading, and sustain commentary on well-chosen evidence. Do not merely summarize.

College Freshman (1600 words; Indiana 2023: see unit standards): Write a researched essay (4–6 pages) that places Frankenstein's treatment of creation and responsibility in its historical context, using at least two scholarly sources.

College Sophomore (2200 words; Indiana 2023: see unit standards): Write a contextual essay (6–8 pages) on creation and responsibility in Frankenstein that reads the novel against its genre and period and engages two published critics. At this level students write ONE of the unit's essays (choose one theme), not all five.

College Junior (2800 words; Indiana 2023: see unit standards): Write a theoretically informed essay (8–10 pages) on creation and responsibility in Frankenstein. Name your critical method, apply it closely, and acknowledge its limits. At this level students write ONE of the unit's essays (choose one theme), not all five.

College Senior (4000 words; Indiana 2023: see unit standards): Write a research paper (12–15 pages) with an original argument about creation and responsibility in Frankenstein, engaging at least four scholarly sources in Chicago style. At this level students write ONE of the unit's essays (choose one theme), not all five.

Graduate / PhD (6000 words; Indiana 2023: see unit standards): Write a seminar paper (15–20 pages) that intervenes in the critical conversation on creation and responsibility in Frankenstein, engaging the relevant scholarship and textual history. At this level students write ONE of the unit's essays (choose one theme), not all five.

Rubric: Claim · Evidence · Analysis · Organization · Conventions

Essay: Isolation and the need for companionship

Middle School (600 words; Indiana 2023: 7.W.1, 7.RC.2): Supported track: write a five-paragraph essay explaining what Frankenstein teaches about isolation and the need for companionship. Use at least three quotations from passages your teacher selects from different parts of the book.

HS Freshman (800 words; Indiana 2023: 9-10.W.1, 9-10.RC.2): Write a multi-paragraph essay explaining how Mary Shelley develops isolation and the need for companionship in Frankenstein. Use evidence from the beginning, middle and end of the book.

HS Sophomore (1000 words; Indiana 2023: 9-10.W.1, 9-10.RC.2): Write an argumentative essay analyzing how Mary Shelley develops isolation and the need for companionship across Frankenstein. Trace the idea through at least three chapters and address a counterclaim.

HS Junior (1100 words; Indiana 2023: 11-12.W.1, 11-12.RC.3): Write an analytical essay on how the structure of Frankenstein (its order, turns and ending) shapes the meaning of isolation and the need for companionship. Discuss at least one place where the book leaves the question open.

HS Senior (1200 words; Indiana 2023: 11-12.W.1, 11-12.RC.1): Write a sustained argument comparing two interpretations of isolation and the need for companionship in Frankenstein. Weigh the evidence for each and defend the stronger reading in a mature, well-organized essay.

AP (1300 words; Indiana 2023: 11-12.W.1, 11-12.RC.1): Write a literary argument: develop a defensible thesis about how Mary Shelley's choices in Frankenstein (a recurring element, structure and narration) shape a complex understanding of isolation and the need for companionship, weigh at least one competing reading, and sustain commentary on well-chosen evidence. Do not merely summarize.

College Freshman (1600 words; Indiana 2023: see unit standards): Write a researched essay (4–6 pages) that places Frankenstein's treatment of isolation and the need for companionship in its historical context, using at least two scholarly sources.

College Sophomore (2200 words; Indiana 2023: see unit standards): Write a contextual essay (6–8 pages) on isolation and the need for companionship in Frankenstein that reads the novel against its genre and period and engages two published critics. At this level students write ONE of the unit's essays (choose one theme), not all five.

College Junior (2800 words; Indiana 2023: see unit standards): Write a theoretically informed essay (8–10 pages) on isolation and the need for companionship in Frankenstein. Name your critical method, apply it closely, and acknowledge its limits. At this level students write ONE of the unit's essays (choose one theme), not all five.

College Senior (4000 words; Indiana 2023: see unit standards): Write a research paper (12–15 pages) with an original argument about isolation and the need for companionship in Frankenstein, engaging at least four scholarly sources in Chicago style. At this level students write ONE of the unit's essays (choose one theme), not all five.

Graduate / PhD (6000 words; Indiana 2023: see unit standards): Write a seminar paper (15–20 pages) that intervenes in the critical conversation on isolation and the need for companionship in Frankenstein, engaging the relevant scholarship and textual history. At this level students write ONE of the unit's essays (choose one theme), not all five.

Rubric: Claim · Evidence · Analysis · Organization · Conventions

Essay: Nature versus nurture

Middle School (600 words; Indiana 2023: 7.W.1, 7.RC.2): Supported track: write a five-paragraph essay explaining what Frankenstein teaches about nature versus nurture. Use at least three quotations from passages your teacher selects from different parts of the book.

HS Freshman (800 words; Indiana 2023: 9-10.W.1, 9-10.RC.2): Write a multi-paragraph essay explaining how Mary Shelley develops nature versus nurture in Frankenstein. Use evidence from the beginning, middle and end of the book.

HS Sophomore (1000 words; Indiana 2023: 9-10.W.1, 9-10.RC.2): Write an argumentative essay analyzing how Mary Shelley develops nature versus nurture across Frankenstein. Trace the idea through at least three chapters and address a counterclaim.

HS Junior (1100 words; Indiana 2023: 11-12.W.1, 11-12.RC.3): Write an analytical essay on how the structure of Frankenstein (its order, turns and ending) shapes the meaning of nature versus nurture. Discuss at least one place where the book leaves the question open.

HS Senior (1200 words; Indiana 2023: 11-12.W.1, 11-12.RC.1): Write a sustained argument comparing two interpretations of nature versus nurture in Frankenstein. Weigh the evidence for each and defend the stronger reading in a mature, well-organized essay.

AP (1300 words; Indiana 2023: 11-12.W.1, 11-12.RC.1): Write a literary argument: develop a defensible thesis about how Mary Shelley's choices in Frankenstein (a recurring element, structure and narration) shape a complex understanding of nature versus nurture, weigh at least one competing reading, and sustain commentary on well-chosen evidence. Do not merely summarize.

College Freshman (1600 words; Indiana 2023: see unit standards): Write a researched essay (4–6 pages) that places Frankenstein's treatment of nature versus nurture in its historical context, using at least two scholarly sources.

College Sophomore (2200 words; Indiana 2023: see unit standards): Write a contextual essay (6–8 pages) on nature versus nurture in Frankenstein that reads the novel against its genre and period and engages two published critics. At this level students write ONE of the unit's essays (choose one theme), not all five.

College Junior (2800 words; Indiana 2023: see unit standards): Write a theoretically informed essay (8–10 pages) on nature versus nurture in Frankenstein. Name your critical method, apply it closely, and acknowledge its limits. At this level students write ONE of the unit's essays (choose one theme), not all five.

College Senior (4000 words; Indiana 2023: see unit standards): Write a research paper (12–15 pages) with an original argument about nature versus nurture in Frankenstein, engaging at least four scholarly sources in Chicago style. At this level students write ONE of the unit's essays (choose one theme), not all five.

Graduate / PhD (6000 words; Indiana 2023: see unit standards): Write a seminar paper (15–20 pages) that intervenes in the critical conversation on nature versus nurture in Frankenstein, engaging the relevant scholarship and textual history. At this level students write ONE of the unit's essays (choose one theme), not all five.

Rubric: Claim · Evidence · Analysis · Organization · Conventions

Essay: The sublime power of nature

Middle School (600 words; Indiana 2023: 7.W.1, 7.RC.2): Supported track: write a five-paragraph essay explaining what Frankenstein teaches about the sublime power of nature. Use at least three quotations from passages your teacher selects from different parts of the book.

HS Freshman (800 words; Indiana 2023: 9-10.W.1, 9-10.RC.2): Write a multi-paragraph essay explaining how Mary Shelley develops the sublime power of nature in Frankenstein. Use evidence from the beginning, middle and end of the book.

HS Sophomore (1000 words; Indiana 2023: 9-10.W.1, 9-10.RC.2): Write an argumentative essay analyzing how Mary Shelley develops the sublime power of nature across Frankenstein. Trace the idea through at least three chapters and address a counterclaim.

HS Junior (1100 words; Indiana 2023: 11-12.W.1, 11-12.RC.3): Write an analytical essay on how the structure of Frankenstein (its order, turns and ending) shapes the meaning of the sublime power of nature. Discuss at least one place where the book leaves the question open.

HS Senior (1200 words; Indiana 2023: 11-12.W.1, 11-12.RC.1): Write a sustained argument comparing two interpretations of the sublime power of nature in Frankenstein. Weigh the evidence for each and defend the stronger reading in a mature, well-organized essay.

AP (1300 words; Indiana 2023: 11-12.W.1, 11-12.RC.1): Write a literary argument: develop a defensible thesis about how Mary Shelley's choices in Frankenstein (a recurring element, structure and narration) shape a

complex understanding of the sublime power of nature, weigh at least one competing reading, and sustain commentary on well-chosen evidence. Do not merely summarize.

College Freshman (1600 words; Indiana 2023: see unit standards): Write a researched essay (4–6 pages) that places Frankenstein's treatment of the sublime power of nature in its historical context, using at least two scholarly sources.

College Sophomore (2200 words; Indiana 2023: see unit standards): Write a contextual essay (6–8 pages) on the sublime power of nature in Frankenstein that reads the novel against its genre and period and engages two published critics. At this level students write ONE of the unit's essays (choose one theme), not all five.

College Junior (2800 words; Indiana 2023: see unit standards): Write a theoretically informed essay (8–10 pages) on the sublime power of nature in Frankenstein. Name your critical method, apply it closely, and acknowledge its limits. At this level students write ONE of the unit's essays (choose one theme), not all five.

College Senior (4000 words; Indiana 2023: see unit standards): Write a research paper (12–15 pages) with an original argument about the sublime power of nature in Frankenstein, engaging at least four scholarly sources in Chicago style. At this level students write ONE of the unit's essays (choose one theme), not all five.

Graduate / PhD (6000 words; Indiana 2023: see unit standards): Write a seminar paper (15–20 pages) that intervenes in the critical conversation on the sublime power of nature in Frankenstein, engaging the relevant scholarship and textual history. At this level students write ONE of the unit's essays (choose one theme), not all five.

Rubric: Claim · Evidence · Analysis · Organization · Conventions

Original Liber et Libri curriculum. Quotations from the public-domain text. Vocabulary definitions are modern and contextual (curated; based on Princeton WordNet 3.0). Word histories appear only where verified (Online Etymology Dictionary or Wiktionary, 2026-10-20); unverified ones are left out. AP and Cambridge entries are our own summaries with links, not College Board or Cambridge text; ICC-WC and LeL IDs are Liber et Libri labels. Included with every curriculum purchase and with Classroom Pro.